# Jude, Unfolded

*An Exploration of Every Verse, Word, Image, and Meaning*

[Author Name]

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**Greek manuscripts.** The manuscript readings in section A of each chapter, and in the manuscript tables of Chapters 3 and 12, are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (NTVMR) of the Institut für Neutestamentliche Textforschung (INTF), Münster, https://ntvmr.uni-muenster.de/. The transcriptions are licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 License (CC BY 4.0). The manuscripts are P72, P78, 01 (א, Sinaiticus), 02 (A, Alexandrinus), 03 (B, Vaticanus), 04 (C,

Ephraemi Rescriptus), 018 (K), 020 (L), 044 (Ψ), and 1739. Dates are those given in the NTVMR metadata.

**Other Greek texts (public domain).** *The New Testament in the Original Greek: Byzantine Textform 2018*, edited by Maurice A. Robinson and William G. Pierpont; the Greek Textus Receptus; and the Septuagint with the Apocrypha as printed in Sir Lancelot C. L. Brenton's edition. All were obtained from eBible.org.

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## English translations

No translation is treated as more important than another. Each verse of Jude is printed in all eighteen translations below, in order of first publication. Every quotation reproduces its translation's wording without alteration. Square brackets inside a quotation belong to that translation, and ellipses ( … ) mark omitted words. The commentary's own renderings of the Greek are never placed inside another translation's quotation marks. They are labeled "literally," "or," or "my rendering," or are set in single quotation marks.

| Abbreviation | Translation | Date | License and credit |
|---|---|---|---|
| TNT | Tyndale New Testament | 1534 | Public domain |
| GNV | Geneva Bible | 1560 (1599 edition) | Public domain |
| DRA | Douay-Rheims, American edition | 1582 (1899 edition) | Public domain |
| WBS | Noah Webster's revision of the Common Version | 1833 | Public domain |
| NOY | George Noyes's translation | 1869 | Public domain |
| RV | Revised Version | 1881 | Public domain |
| DBY | Darby Translation | 1890 | Public domain |
| YLT | Young's Literal Translation | 1898 | Public domain |
| ASV | American Standard Version | 1901 | Public domain |

| Abbreviation | Translation | Date | License and credit |
|---|---|---|---|
| WEB | World English Bible | 2000 (2020 stable edition) | Public domain. “World English Bible” is a trademark of eBible.org. |
| T4T | Translation for Translators | 2008–2017 | Copyright © 2008–2017 Ellis W. Deibler, Jr. CC BY-SA 4.0. |
| OEB | Open English Bible | 2010 | Public domain |
| ULB | Unlocked Literal Bible | 2017 | Copyright © 2017 Door43 World Missions Community. CC BY-SA 4.0. |
| FBV | Free Bible Version | 2018 | Copyright © 2018 Dr. Jonathan Gallagher. CC BY-SA 4.0. |
| LSV | Literal Standard Version | 2020 | The Literal Standard Version of the Holy Bible is a registered copyright of Covenant Press and the Covenant Christian Coalition (© 2020). CC BY-SA 4.0. Reproduced without alteration, as its publisher requests. |
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## Other ancient texts and older scholarship

R. H. Charles's translation of 1 Enoch (1917); J. W. Etheridge's translation of the Targums (1862); William Whiston's translation of Josephus (1737); H. E. Butler's translation of Quintilian (1920); and the early Christian writers in the *Ante-Nicene Fathers* and *Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers* translations. All are in the public domain. Translations from Pliny's Latin and of the Greek catena fragment in Chapter 4 are the author's own.

The older commentaries cited are all in the public domain. They include the *Pulpit Commentary*; the *Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges* (E. H. Plumptre); *Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers* (A. Plummer); Plummer's volume in the *Expositor's Bible* (1891); J. B. Mayor in the *Expositor's Greek Testament* (1910); J. E. Huther in the Meyer series (English translation 1881); Joseph Benson; and E. H. Gillett's 1859 translation of Luther's sermons on Peter and Jude. Facts drawn from Wikipedia (CC BY-SA 4.0) are cited to the article used.

Full details of every source, including what was verified and how, appear in the Bibliography and in the Translation and Licensing Acknowledgments at the end of the book.

# A Reader’s Introduction

Jude is easy to miss. It sits just before Revelation, a single chapter of twenty-five verses, and in the Greek text that underlies this book it runs to about 460 words. Most people could read it aloud in under three minutes. Many Christians know only its closing benediction, “Now to him that is able to keep you from falling” (v. 24, WBS), and perhaps its call to “contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered to the saints” (v. 3, WEB). The middle of the letter (fallen angels, an archangel quarrelling with the Devil over a corpse, a prophecy from Enoch, reefs, clouds, uprooted trees, and stars that have wandered from their paths) can seem so strange that readers hurry past it.

This book is written for readers who would rather slow down.

Jude rewards slowness because it is so compressed. Almost every phrase calls up a story, a scripture, or a tradition that its first readers knew well and we mostly do not. “The way of Cain” assumes a whole history of how Jewish interpreters understood Cain. “Clouds without water” assumes a farmer’s dread of a rainless sky. “Love feasts” assumes a practice of shared meals in early Christian communities that most churches no longer keep in that form. When Jude names Michael and Moses’ body, or quotes “Enoch, the seventh from Adam,” he speaks the language of a world of Jewish scriptural interpretation that has its own texts, conventions, and arguments. Unfold those references and the letter changes from a cryptic rant into a carefully built piece of pastoral persuasion. It is written with real literary skill, steeped in Israel’s scriptures, and aimed at keeping a community together in the love of God.

## What this book is

*Jude, Unfolded* is an expository commentary: a guided walk through the text, verse by verse and phrase by phrase. It sets out to explain:

- **what the text says**, in the Greek in which Jude wrote it, as the earliest manuscripts preserve it, and in many English translations;
- **what it likely meant** to its first readers, given their scriptures, customs, and situation;
- **why it may have been said that way**, which means attending to Jude’s images, his rhetorical patterns, and his choices among traditions;
- **how it may be responsibly applied today**, kept clearly separate from the explanation of what the text meant.

Along the way the book stops for **deep dives**, longer explorations of subjects that modern readers rarely meet elsewhere. A reader who wonders “What exactly was a love feast?” will find a full answer in Chapter 6, drawn from the New Testament and from the earliest Christian and Roman writers who describe such meals. The same care goes to the Book of Enoch, the dispute over Moses’ body, the wandering stars, the “faith once delivered,” and more than a dozen other subjects.

## How the chapters work

After the introductory chapters, each of the thirteen main chapters follows the same pattern, so you can always find your way:

- **A. The Text**: the passage in Greek, a table of what the earliest manuscripts read, and every verse in eighteen free English translations.
- **B. Plain-English Orientation**: the big picture before the details.
- **C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration**: the heart of each chapter. Each heading gives a Greek phrase, its transliteration, and a plain rendering in single quotation marks.
- **D. Original-Language Investigation**: the Greek words that matter, explained for readers who know no Greek.
- **E. The Historical and Cultural World**: the customs, beliefs, and institutions the text assumes.
- **F. Connections Across Scripture**: quotations, allusions, and shared themes, each explained.
- **G. Scholarly and Theological Questions**: where interpreters disagree, and why.
- **H. The Passage Within Jude**: how this section advances the letter’s argument.
- **I. Contemporary Understanding**: possible implications for faith and life today.
- **J. Reflection and Discussion**: questions for personal study or groups.
- **K. Sources**: the notes behind the chapter’s claims.
- **L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter**: every passage of Scripture (and of 1 Enoch and the Apocrypha) that the chapter cites or alludes to, printed in full in the original language and in two English translations. References in the chapter link to these entries.

You do not need to read every section in order. A small group might read A, B, C, and I together, use J for discussion, and leave D and G to members who want more detail. A preacher or teacher will probably want everything. Section L is there to be consulted: when a chapter says that Jude echoes the rebellion of Korah or the vision of Joshua the high priest, the passage itself is a click or a few pages away.

## The original first, and many translations

Jude wrote in Greek, and his letter reached us through handwritten copies. This book therefore starts every passage with the Greek text, and it gives priority to the manuscripts themselves. Section A of each chapter shows what ten of the earliest and most important manuscripts actually read, from papyri copied in the third or fourth century to the ninth- and tenth-century copies that stand behind most later texts. The readings are checked against published transcriptions of the manuscripts, not taken on trust. When the commentary turns to the Old Testament, it reads the Hebrew (and, where Jude seems to have known it, the Greek Septuagint).

No English translation is treated as more important than another. Each verse of Jude is printed in eighteen free translations, from William Tyndale's New Testament of 1534 to translations completed in the last few years, in order of first publication. Some are strictly word-for-word (Young's Literal Translation, the Literal Standard Version, the Unlocked Literal Bible); some aim at natural modern English (the Berean Standard Bible, the Open English Bible, the Free Bible Version); one, the Translation for Translators, spells out meaning the Greek leaves implicit. Reading them side by side shows where translators agree, where they must choose, and why. When the commentary quotes another passage of Scripture, it names the translation it quotes, and it often uses a literal one so that the structure of the original stays visible. Section L then prints that passage in full in its original language and in the Berean Standard Bible and the World English Bible, two public-domain translations that between them follow both of the main forms of the Greek text.

Every text in this book is in the public domain or under a free license. That is a principle, not an accident: Scripture should be free to read, copy, translate, and share, and so should a book that tries to open it. Translations whose publishers require permission, such as the ESV, NASB, NLT, the Amplified Bible, and *The Message*, are therefore not quoted. The Copyright and Licensing page explains this and lists the free translations that cover the same range.

## What you will not need

You will not need to know Greek. Every Greek word appears with a transliteration and a plain explanation. You will not need a theological education; technical terms are explained when they first appear and collected in the Glossary. You will not need to agree with every conclusion. Where good interpreters disagree, this book tries to set out the options fairly and to show the evidence on each side, so you can weigh them for yourself.

## A word about the tone of Jude

Jude can sound harsh. It speaks of judgment, fire, and darkness, and it describes certain people in vivid and unflattering images. Some readers find this off-putting, and others find it attractive for the wrong reasons. This book takes the severity of Jude seriously without making it the whole story. The letter begins with readers who are “called, … loved, … and … kept,” and it ends with praise to the God who is able to keep them from stumbling. Its last practical words are about mercy, rescue, and compassion for those who are wavering. The darkness of the middle section stands inside a frame of love, and the letter cannot be read rightly without both.

Jude wanted, by his own account, to write about “our common salvation” (v. 3). Circumstances forced him to write a warning instead. Even so, the salvation he wanted to celebrate shines through the warning, and helping you see it is the purpose of this book.

# Research Method and Interpretive Principles

A commentary is only as trustworthy as the way it was made. This chapter sets out how this book was researched, what kinds of sources stand behind its claims, and the principles that guided interpretation. Readers who want to get straight to the text can skip ahead and come back later. Readers who want to know how far to trust what follows should read on.

## Sources and how they were used

Every source behind this book is free: in the public domain or under a Creative Commons license that allows anyone to copy and adapt it. That rule was applied strictly. Where a useful modern work could not be quoted freely, or could not be checked directly during the research, it was left out, and the point it would have supported was either established from a free source or not made.

The sources are used in a fixed order of priority.

**1. The manuscripts.** Jude's words reach us through handwritten copies, so the manuscripts come first. For ten of the earliest and most important witnesses (the papyri P72 and P78, the great fourth- and fifth-century codices ℵ, A, B, and C, and the later manuscripts K, L, Ψ, and 1739), the book reads the transcriptions published by the Institute for New Testament Textual Research in Münster. Every reading reported in a manuscript table was checked by a script against those transcriptions.

**2. The Greek and Hebrew texts.** The Greek text printed and discussed is the SBL Greek New Testament, edited by Michael W. Holmes, with its apparatus of variant readings. An updated form of that apparatus records where the Nestle–Aland 28th edition (NA28) differs. The Byzantine text (Robinson–Pierpont, 2018) and the Textus Receptus are compared throughout. Old Testament passages are read in the Hebrew of the Westminster Leningrad Codex and, where Jude seems to depend on it, in the Greek of the Septuagint.

**3. Translations, with no favorite.** Eighteen free English translations, from 1534 to 2022, are printed for every verse of Jude. They are quoted exactly from their electronic editions, and a script checks every quotation in the book against the translation it names. The commentary often quotes a literal translation when it is explaining the structure of a Greek or Hebrew sentence.

That is a choice made for clarity in a particular place, not a judgment that one translation is better than the others.

**4. Ancient sources.** When Jude alludes to a Jewish or early Christian tradition, the book goes back to the ancient text itself in a free edition: 1 Enoch in R. H. Charles's translation, the Targums in J. W. Etheridge's, Josephus in William Whiston's, the Septuagint and the Apocrypha in Brenton's edition, and the church fathers in the nineteenth-century *Ante-Nicene* and *Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers* translations. Each passage relied on was read directly. The notes give book, chapter, and section so that readers can check them.

**5. Lexical data.** Greek word meanings are drawn mainly from G. Abbott-Smith's *Manual Greek Lexicon of the New Testament* (1922). It is a public-domain lexicon that summarizes the classical, Septuagint, and papyrus evidence for each New Testament word. Word counts and grammatical data were computed directly from the MorphGNT edition of the SBLGNT, so a statement such as "this word occurs nowhere else in the New Testament" rests on a count of the actual text.

**6. Older commentaries.** Commentators of the nineteenth and early twentieth centuries did careful work on Jude, and their books are now in the public domain. This book cites J. B. Mayor (*Expositor's Greek Testament*, 1910), Alfred Plummer (in *Ellicott's Commentary* and the *Expositor's Bible*), E. H. Plumptre (*Cambridge Bible*), J. E. Huther (Meyer series), the *Pulpit Commentary*, and others, always quoting them directly from the text consulted. Where their views have been overtaken by later evidence, such as the discovery among the Dead Sea Scrolls of Aramaic fragments of 1 Enoch, the book says so. For facts that are well established but postdate these authors, it cites the relevant Wikipedia article (CC BY-SA), identified by title.

The full **source ledger**, which records what was verified, how, and what remains uncertain, is part of the project files that accompany the manuscript, together with the scripts that generate and check the texts.

## Principles of interpretation

**1. The text has the first word.** Fidelity to Scripture comes before defending any preferred interpretation. Where a popular reading does not fit Jude's words, the book says so, even when that reading is cherished.

**2. Meaning before application.** Each chapter separates what the text meant in its first setting from how it may be applied now. The two are related, but they are not the same thing, and confusing them is the source of much misuse of Jude.

**3. Kinds of claims are labeled.** The book tries to make clear whether a statement is a textual fact ("the Greek word occurs only here"), historical evidence ("Pliny reports…"), scholarly consensus, a contested interpretation, a theological tradition, a plausible inference, or a suggested application. Historical reconstructions, however likely, are presented as reconstructions.

**4. Words mean what they mean in use.** A Greek word's meaning is determined by how it was actually used in its period, not by its etymology or by adding up its parts. The book points out etymologies when they are interesting and warns when they have been overworked. For example, ἐκκλησία does not mean "the called-out ones" just because it contains the parts "out" and "call." Jude's word σπιλάδες, discussed in Chapter 6, is a good example of a word whose sense must be settled by usage.

**5. Traditions outside the Bible are taken seriously and handled carefully.** Jude quotes 1 Enoch and alludes to a tradition about Michael and Moses that appears nowhere in the Old Testament. The book does not explain these away. It shows where they come from, how Jude uses them, and how the church has argued about what that use implies. Quoting a text is not the same as endorsing everything in it, and the book is careful not to claim more than Jude does.

**6. Disagreements are presented fairly.** When responsible scholars disagree, the book sets out the main options, the evidence for each, and their strengths and weaknesses. It sometimes states a preference and gives reasons, but it tries to give readers what they need to decide differently.

**7. No denominational polemics.** Christians read Jude within many traditions. Where those traditions differ in ways that affect the meaning, for example on the "brothers" of Jesus or on how believers are "kept," the book describes the differences without taking sides in old quarrels.

**8. The letter stays whole.** Word studies serve the reading of the letter and do not replace it. Each chapter ends by placing its passage in the flow of Jude's argument, and the overview chapter maps the whole.

## About the Greek

Greek words appear in Greek script with a transliteration in italics, for example ἀγάπη (*agapē*). The transliteration follows a simple scholarly system: η = *ē*, ω = *ō*, υ = *y* (*u* in diphthongs), χ = *ch*, θ = *th*, φ = *ph*, ψ = *ps*, and rough breathing = *h*. Readers who do not read Greek can ignore the Greek script and follow the transliteration and explanation. Grammatical terms are explained when they first appear and collected in the Glossary.

A few grammatical ideas recur often enough to introduce here:

- **Tense and aspect.** Greek verb forms say less about *when* an action happens than English tenses do and more about *how* the action is viewed. The **perfect** presents a completed action with continuing results ("having been loved," and still loved). The **aorist** presents an action as a whole, without comment on its duration. The **present** presents an action as ongoing or in progress.
- **Participles** are verbal adjectives ("having been called," "praying"). Jude uses them heavily, and much of his meaning rides on them.
- **The optative** is a verb form used to express wishes ("may mercy … be multiplied"). It is rare in the New Testament, and Jude uses it twice.
- **Cases** (nominative, genitive, dative, accusative) mark a noun's role in the sentence. The **dative** in particular can mean "to," "for," "by," or "in," and Jude's first verse depends on which is chosen.

## About the variant readings

The New Testament survives in thousands of handwritten manuscripts, and they differ in small and sometimes significant ways. Jude has more than its share of interesting variants. One of them changes who is said to have led Israel out of Egypt, and another changes the shape of the letter's final instructions. The book explains the significant variants where they arise and gathers them in Appendix A. Readers should know that none of these variants touches the substance of the Christian faith. Some do, however, affect how particular verses are read, and they deserve honest explanation.

## About application

The "Contemporary Understanding" sections suggest ways Jude's message may inform belief, worship, fellowship, ethics, and spiritual practice today. They are offered as possibilities to weigh, not as divine instructions. Jude was written against particular people doing particular things, and it is easy to aim its sharpest words at whoever we happen to dislike. The book tries to resist that temptation and to let Jude question its readers, this author included, before it is turned on anyone else.

# Historical and Literary Introduction to Jude

Before walking through Jude verse by verse, it helps to ask the questions any careful reader asks of an ancient letter. Who wrote it? When, and to whom? What was happening that made it necessary? What kind of writing is it, and what world of ideas does it assume? How did the early church receive it? For a letter as short as Jude, the answers are often less certain than we would like. The evidence is still worth laying out, both for what it shows and for what it leaves open.

## 1. "Judas … brother of James": who wrote the letter?

The letter opens:

> Judas, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, …
>
> — Jude 1, LSV

The Greek name Ἰούδας (*Ioudas*) is the Greek form of the Hebrew *Yehudah*, Judah, the name of Jacob's fourth son and of the tribe and land descended from him. English Bibles usually write "Jude" for the author of this letter. The convention distinguishes him from Judas Iscariot, but the Greek name is the same, and the LSV keeps "Judas." The name was very common among Jews of the period, so the author's identity depends on the clue he gives: he is the "brother of James."

### The candidates

Several men named Judas appear in the New Testament:

1. **Judas the brother of Jesus.** Mark lists him among Jesus' brothers: "Is this not the carpenter, the Son of Mary, and brother of James, and Joses, and Judas, and Simon?" (Mark 6:3, LSV; cf. Matt 13:55).
2. **Judas "of James,"** one of the Twelve, listed by Luke: "Judas of James, and Judas Iscariot, who also became betrayer" (Luke 6:16, LSV; cf. Acts 1:13). John calls him "Judas … (not the Iscariot)" (John 14:22, LSV). The Greek Ἰούδας Ἰακώβου most naturally means "Judas son of James," which is the usual way of using a genitive with a personal name. It does not mean "brother of James."
3. **Judas called Barsabbas**, a prophet and leader in the Jerusalem church who carried the apostolic letter to Antioch (Acts 15:22, 32).

4. **Judas Thomas**, a figure of later Syriac Christian tradition in which the apostle Thomas (“twin”) is named Judas.

Among these, the first is the only one for whom “brother of James” is a natural self-description. Only one James in early Christianity was famous enough to identify someone simply by naming him: James of Jerusalem, “the brother of the LORD” (Gal 1:19, LSV). Paul names him as one of the “pillars” of the Jerusalem church (Gal 2:9). He leads the council in Acts 15 and receives Paul in Acts 21:18, and tradition takes him to be the author of the Letter of James, who also calls himself simply “a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ” (Jas 1:1, LSV). A Judas who introduces himself as “brother of James” is almost certainly claiming to be the brother of *that* James, and so a brother of Jesus.

### Why “brother of James” and not “brother of the Lord”?

If Jude was the brother of Jesus, why did he not say so? Ancient readers asked the same question. Clement of Alexandria, writing around AD 200, answered with a comment that later readers have found persuasive:

> Jude, who wrote the Catholic Epistle, the brother of the sons of Joseph, and very religious, while knowing the near relationship of the Lord, yet did not say that he himself was His brother. But what said he? Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ,—of Him as Lord; but the brother of James.[1]

Several factors probably worked together. The family relationship was no longer the defining fact; after the resurrection, Jesus’ brothers came to know him as Lord. The Gospels remember that during Jesus’ ministry “not even His brothers were believing in Him” (John 7:5, LSV). Yet after Easter they appear among the praying disciples (Acts 1:14), and Paul knows that the risen Christ “appeared to James” (1 Cor 15:7, LSV). A brother by birth who had become a servant by faith might well prefer to call himself the second. Naming James also placed Jude within a recognized line of authority without claiming the title of apostle, which he appears to reserve for others (v. 17).

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1. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* (Comments) on the Epistle of Jude, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers* 2, “Fragments of Clemens Alexandrinus,” II; online at https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0211.htm. The comment also identifies Jude as “His brother, (the son) of Joseph.”↩

### The family of Jesus in early tradition

Two pieces of evidence outside the Gospels fill out the picture.

First, Paul mentions in passing that “the brothers of the LORD” traveled on missionary work with their wives (1 Cor 9:5, LSV). That remark, written in the

mid-50s, shows that at least some of Jesus' brothers besides James were known as traveling preachers among the churches. Jude, who writes to readers he knows and who are at some distance from him, fits that profile.

Second, the second-century Jewish-Christian writer Hegesippus, quoted by Eusebius, tells a story about Jude's grandsons. When the emperor Domitian (reigned AD 81–96) feared the descendants of David, "the grandchildren of Jude, who is said to have been the Lord's brother according to the flesh," were brought before him. They owned a small farm worth nine thousand denarii, showed him the calluses on their hands from working it, and explained that Christ's kingdom was "not a temporal nor an earthly kingdom, but a heavenly and angelic one." Domitian let them go as harmless. Afterward, Hegesippus says, they "ruled the churches because they were witnesses and were also relatives of the Lord," and they lived until the time of Trajan.[2] The story probably includes some legendary color, but it preserves a memory of Jude's family as Galilean farmers, rooted in Jewish Christianity and respected in the churches.

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2. Eusebius, *Ecclesiastical History* 3.19–20, quoting Hegesippus (NPNF² 1; https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/250103.htm).↩

### Deep dive: who were Jesus' "brothers"?

The New Testament names four brothers of Jesus (James, Joses or Joseph, Judas, and Simon) and mentions sisters (Mark 6:3). Christians have understood these relationships in three main ways, and the differences matter for how readers picture Jude.

- **Full brothers (the "Helvidian" view, after Helvidius, a fourth-century writer).** On this view they were children of Mary and Joseph born after Jesus. Most Protestant interpreters hold it, pointing to the plain sense of the word ἀδελφός (*adelphos*) and to texts such as Matt 1:25.
- **Older half-brothers, sons of Joseph by an earlier marriage (the "Epiphanian" view, after Epiphanius of Salamis).** This view is attested in second-century writings. It has been common in Eastern Orthodox tradition and fits Clement's description of Jude as "the brother of the sons of Joseph."
- **Cousins (the "Hieronymian" view, after Jerome).** This view takes *adelphos* in the broader sense of "kinsman," a sense it can carry in Jewish usage. It became standard in the Latin West and is common in Roman Catholic interpretation.

All three views agree on what matters most for this book: Jude belonged to Jesus' own family circle, grew up near him, and came to call him "Master and

Lord" (v. 4). Readers who hold different views of Mary can read Jude in the same way.

### Did Jude himself write it?

Many scholars accept that the letter was written by Jude, the brother of Jesus. Many others think it was written later by someone using his name, a practice called pseudonymity that was known in the ancient world. The main arguments for a later writer are these:

- **The Greek is good.** Jude's vocabulary is rich, with sixteen words found nowhere else in the New Testament, and his style is vivid and carefully patterned. Could a Galilean villager write like this?
- **"The faith once delivered" (v. 3)** is said to treat Christianity as a fixed body of doctrine, which some regard as typical of a later, more institutional stage.
- **The apostles seem to belong to the past** (v. 17).

Defenders of authenticity reply:

- **Greek was widely used in Galilee**, and a family whose members traveled as missionaries in the Greek-speaking world (1 Cor 9:5) had every opportunity to learn it well. Ancient authors also commonly used secretaries, who could polish style. The quality of the Greek is a real question, but it does not settle authorship.
- **"The faith" as the content of the Christian message** already appears in Paul's earliest letters: "he who is persecuting us then, now proclaims good news—the faith that he was then destroying" (Gal 1:23, LSV). Language about "delivering" teaching is also early (1 Cor 11:2; 15:3).
- **Verse 17 asks readers to remember what the apostles told *them***. That requires only that the apostles had preached to these readers earlier, not that they were all long dead.
- **The choice of name is the strongest argument.** A later writer who wanted authority would hardly choose an obscure figure like Jude, and having chosen him, would likely have added the impressive title "brother of the Lord." A modest self-description fits the real Jude better than an imitator.

This book treats authorship by Jude the brother of Jesus as a responsible conclusion that fits the evidence well. It does not regard the question as closed, and very little of the letter's interpretation depends on the answer.[3]

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3. For the case for authenticity, see Alfred Plummer, introduction to Jude in *Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers*: "sober criticism requires us to believe that this Epistle was written by the man whose name it bears. To suppose that Jude is an assumed name is gratuitous." Plummer also lists the objections raised against it: that

"it cites apocryphal books; has a suspicious relationship to Romans and 2 Peter; is difficult in style." Text at https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ellicott/jude/1.htm. For the argument that the letter alludes to the second-century teacher Carpocrates and so cannot be by the Lord's brother, see Plummer's discussion in *The General Epistles of St. James and St. Jude* (Expositor's Bible, 1891), on Jude 4, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/expositors/jude/1.htm. On modern opinion, see "Epistle of Jude," *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA; accessed 7 November 2026): "Scholars who consider the letter a pseudonymous work generally favor the later dates." De Wette's judgment that "no important objection to the genuineness of the Epistle can be made good" is quoted in E. H. Gillett's notes to Luther's sermons on Jude (1859), Project Gutenberg #29678.↩

## 2. Language and style

Jude writes a compact, energetic, and artful Greek. Several features stand out, and they will recur throughout this book:

- **Rare words.** Of about 226 distinct words in Jude, sixteen occur nowhere else in the New Testament, among them the words meaning 'contend for' (v. 3), 'slip in' (v. 4), 'reefs' (v. 12), 'late-autumn' (v. 12), 'foam up' (v. 13), 'wanderers' (v. 13), 'grumblers' and 'fault-finders' (v. 16), 'make divisions' (v. 19), and 'without stumbling' (v. 24).[4]
- **Triads.** Jude thinks in threes: called, loved, kept (v. 1); mercy, peace, love (v. 2); three examples of judgment (vv. 5–7); three sins of the 'dreamers' (v. 8); Cain, Balaam, Korah (v. 11); three groups to whom mercy is shown (vv. 22–23).
- **Catchwords.** Key words return in new settings and bind the letter together. The clearest is "keep" (τηρέω, *tēreō*): the readers are "kept" (v. 1), the angels did not "keep" their position and are "kept" for judgment (v. 6), darkness is "kept" for the wandering stars (v. 13), and the readers are to "keep" themselves in God's love (v. 21) as they trust the God who is able to "guard" them (v. 24).
- **The "these" pattern.** After each example or prophecy, Jude turns to the troublemakers with "these" (οὗτοι, *houtoi*): "those dreaming" (v. 8, where the LSV renders the word "those"), "these, indeed, whatever [things] they have not known" (v. 10), "These are stains" (v. 12), "These are … grumblers" (v. 16), "these are those causing divisions" (v. 19).
- **Vivid images drawn from nature and from Israel's story.**

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4. Counts computed from the SBLGNT with MorphGNT lemmatization: 459 words, 226 distinct lemmas, 16 lemmas unique to Jude within the New Testament. See the project file `research/data-notes.md`. A different edition or lemmatization would change the figures slightly.↩

## 3. Date and setting

The letter gives no explicit date. If Jude the brother of Jesus wrote it, it was written within his lifetime, probably before the 90s and possibly much earlier, since Hegesippus's story about Domitian concerns his grandsons. Some scholars date it to the 50s or early 60s, which would make it one of the earliest New Testament writings. Others place it between 70 and 100. The letter's horizon is strikingly Jewish and apocalyptic. It never mentions the destruction of Jerusalem's temple (AD 70), but arguments from silence are weak in so short a letter.

This uncertainty affects the interpretation less than one might expect. Jude's concerns are about holding to the received faith, moral integrity, authority, divisive teachers, and mercy toward the wavering. Those concerns fit the first Christian century at almost any point.

## 4. The recipients

Jude addresses "those called, having been loved … and having been kept" (v. 1), a description of all believers rather than of a particular place. Yet the letter is clearly written to particular people: he calls them "beloved" three times (vv. 3, 17, 20). He knows that intruders have slipped into their community (v. 4) and sit at their love feasts (v. 12), and he can remind them of what the apostles had told them (vv. 17–18).

He also assumes that they will understand compressed references to the exodus, to fallen angels, to Michael and Moses, to Cain, Balaam, and Korah, and to the prophecy of Enoch. Such readers were most likely Jewish Christians, or a mixed community deeply formed by Jewish scriptural interpretation. Suggested locations include Palestine, Syria, Egypt, and Asia Minor. None can be proven, and this book does not build on any of them.

## 5. The troublemakers

Jude does not name the people he opposes. He calls them "certain men" (v. 4), and everything we know about them comes from his description. Gathering his charges gives this profile:

- They are **inside** the community. They "came in … stealthily" (v. 4) and share its meals (v. 12).
- They turn **grace into license**, especially sexual license (vv. 4, 7–8, 16, 18).
- They **deny** Jesus Christ as Master and Lord, probably by the way they live rather than by explicit doctrinal denial (v. 4).
- They appeal to **dreams**, apparently claimed revelations (v. 8).
- They **reject authority** and **slander glorious beings** (vv. 8–10).

- They are **self-serving**, “shepherding themselves” (v. 12), “for the sake of profit” (v. 16), like Balaam “for reward” (v. 11).
- They are **divisive** and, in Jude’s judgment, **“not having the Spirit”** (v. 19).

Older commentators often identified them as Gnostics, members of the second-century movements that taught salvation through secret knowledge and despised the material world. The resemblance is partial at best. Jude says nothing about a lower creator-god, a cosmic myth, or a doctrine of secret knowledge. The developed Gnostic systems also belong to a later period than most scholars assign to Jude. The *Pulpit Commentary* already judged that nothing in the letter warrants the supposition that Jude “was thinking of Simon Magus in particular, or of Carpocrates, or any of the early Gnostics,” though it allowed that “the seeds which were to develop into the pronounced Gnosticism of a later time were already sown.”[5] Jude’s own charges suggest something simpler: traveling teachers who claimed prophetic or charismatic authority and taught that grace freed believers from moral law. That picture is this book’s reconstruction, built from Jude’s words and from early Christian instructions for testing traveling prophets (Chapter 2), and the book treats it as a reconstruction.

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5. *The Pulpit Commentary*, ed. H. D. M. Spence and J. S. Exell, on Jude 4 (public domain), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/pulpit/jude/1.htm. By contrast, Joseph Benson’s commentary (early nineteenth century) thought the teachers “seem to have been the Nicolaitans,” and perhaps “the Gnostics and Carpocratians” (on Jude 4, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/benson/jude/1.htm).↩

## 6. What kind of writing is Jude?

Jude is a **letter**. It has the standard opening (sender, recipients, greeting) and an elaborate closing doxology in place of the usual farewell. In substance it is a **sermon or word of exhortation in letter form**, with a clear rhetorical aim: to move its hearers to “fight for the faith” (v. 3).

Two ways of describing its structure are especially illuminating:

- **A Jewish interpretive pattern.** The central section (vv. 5–19) alternates between *texts* (scriptural examples, a tradition, a prophecy, an apostolic prediction) and *interpretations* introduced by “these” (οὗτοι). J. B. Mayor, following F. H. Chase, noted that the formula οὗτοί εἰσιν (“these are”) belongs to apocalyptic writing that explains visions. Zechariah’s angel says, “These [are] they whom YHWH has sent” (Zech 1:10, LSV), and Revelation’s elder says, “These are those who are coming out of the Great Tribulation” (Rev 7:14, LSV). Mayor suggested that Jude adopted the formula from such writings.[6] The pattern also resembles the *pesher*

commentaries among the Dead Sea Scrolls, which quote a prophetic text and then explain its “interpretation” in terms of the community’s own time.[7] It suggests a writer trained in Jewish ways of reading Scripture as prophecy fulfilled in his own day.

- **Greco-Roman rhetoric.** Ancient teachers of speech described the parts of a persuasive address. Quintilian, writing in the first century AD, reports that “most authorities divide the forensic speech into five parts: the exordium, the statement of facts, the proof, the refutation, and the peroration.”[8] Read with these categories, Jude has an introduction stating its purpose (v. 3), a statement of the situation (v. 4), the proofs (vv. 5–16), and a concluding appeal (vv. 17–23), framed by the letter opening and the doxology. This is offered as a reading aid; Jude never names these categories.

The two analyses do not compete. A Jewish author writing in Greek could use both inherited Jewish methods and the persuasive patterns any educated speaker of Greek would know.

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6. J. B. Mayor, “The General Epistle of Jude,” in *The Expositor’s Greek Testament*, ed. W. Robertson Nicoll, vol. 5 (London: Hodder & Stoughton, 1910), on Jude 12: “Dr. Chase quotes Zechariah 1:10 f., Revelation 7:14, Enoch xlvi. 3 … for the phrase οὗτοί εἰσιν, adding that it was probably adopted by St. Jude from apocalyptic writings.” Public domain; text at https://biblehub.com/commentaries/egt/jude/1.htm.↩

7. “Pesher,” *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA; accessed 7 November 2026): pesher, “from the Hebrew root meaning ‘interpretation,’ is a group of interpretive commentaries on scripture,” with the Habakkuk Commentary (1QpHab) as the classic example.↩

8. Quintilian, *Institutio Oratoria* 3.9.1, trans. H. E. Butler (Loeb Classical Library, 1920–22; public domain), LacusCurtius edition, https://penelope.uchicago.edu/Thayer/E/Roman/Texts/Quintilian/Institutio_Oratoria/3C*.ht

## 7. Jude’s scriptural world

Jude is saturated with Israel’s scriptures, yet he never introduces an Old Testament quotation with “it is written.” His one formal quotation comes from 1 Enoch (vv. 14–15). His references to the Hebrew Bible are compressed allusions that assume the reader knows the story:

| Jude | Allusion |
|---|---|
| 5 | The exodus and the wilderness unbelief (Exod 12–14; Num 14) |
| 6 | The “sons of God” (Gen 6:1–4) as read in 1 Enoch 6–16 |
| 7 | Sodom and Gomorrah (Gen 19) |

| Jude | Allusion |
|---|---|
| 9 | Michael and Moses' burial (Deut 34:5–6) via later tradition; Michael's words echo Zech 3:2 ("YHWH pushes against you, O Satan") |
| 11 | Cain (Gen 4), Balaam (Num 22–24; 31:16), Korah (Num 16) |
| 12 | Shepherds feeding themselves (Ezek 34:2); clouds and wind without rain (Prov 25:14) |
| 13 | The restless sea casting up mire (Isa 57:20) |
| 14–15 | Enoch (Gen 5:21–24); 1 Enoch 1:9 |
| 16 | The wilderness grumbling (Exod 16; Num 14) |
| 23 | A brand snatched from the fire; filthy garments (Zech 3:2–4; Amos 4:11) |

One detail suggests that Jude knew his scriptures in Hebrew or Aramaic rather than only in the Greek Septuagint. In Isa 57:20 and Prov 25:14, the passages behind his images of the foaming sea and the rainless clouds, the Hebrew text contains the very details Jude uses: the sea "casts out filth and mire," and there are "clouds and wind without rain" (LSV, translating the Hebrew). The Septuagint versions of both verses lack those details.[9] This is not proof, but it fits a Palestinian Jewish author.

Jude also draws on **Jewish traditions outside the Hebrew Bible**: 1 Enoch, the fullest surviving source for the Watcher story and for the prophecy he quotes, and a tradition about Michael's dispute with the Devil over Moses' body, which early Christian writers associated with a work called the *Assumption* (or *Ascension*) *of Moses*. These references were the main reason some early Christians hesitated over Jude. They are discussed fully in Chapters 3, 4, and 8.

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9. Compare the Septuagint of Isa 57:20 (Οἱ δὲ ἄδικοι κλυδωνισθήσονται, καὶ ἀναπαύσασθαι οὐ δυνήσονται, "the unrighteous will be tossed like waves and will not be able to rest"), which lacks the mire, and LXX Prov 25:14, which differs substantially from the Hebrew. Greek text from Brenton's Septuagint, eBible.org edition. The observation that these allusions follow the Hebrew rather than the Greek is this book's, based on comparing the texts.↩

## 8. Jude and 2 Peter

Anyone who reads Jude and then 2 Peter 2 notices the resemblance. The same sequence of themes and images appears in both: intruders who deny the Master (Jude 4; 2 Pet 2:1), sinning angels kept in gloom for judgment (Jude 6; 2 Pet 2:4), Sodom and Gomorrah (Jude 7; 2 Pet 2:6), defiling the flesh and

despising authority (Jude 8; 2 Pet 2:10), angels who do not bring a slanderous judgment (Jude 9; 2 Pet 2:11), creatures without reason (Jude 10; 2 Pet 2:12), Balaam's love of reward (Jude 11; 2 Pet 2:15), feasting together (Jude 12; 2 Pet 2:13), waterless clouds and gloom of darkness (Jude 12–13; 2 Pet 2:17), "swollen" words (Jude 16; 2 Pet 2:18), and scoffers foretold by the apostles (Jude 17–18; 2 Pet 3:2–3). Three Greek words occur in the New Testament only in these two letters.

There are three main explanations:

1. **2 Peter used Jude.** Most modern scholars hold this view.[10] Jude's version is usually the more compact and more Jewish, and it is easier to explain why 2 Peter would omit Jude's quotation from Enoch and his named Michael story than why Jude would add them. 2 Peter also arranges the examples in biblical order (angels, flood, Sodom), while Jude's order follows his own thematic logic.
2. **Jude used 2 Peter.** This was Martin Luther's opinion. He wrote that Jude "refers to the second Epistle of St. Peter, from which it has taken nearly all its words." Some later scholars agreed, among them F. Spitta, as Mayor reports.[11] This view points to 2 Peter's future tense ("there will be false teachers," 2 Pet 2:1) and Jude's past tense ("there came in," Jude 4), as if Jude were reporting the fulfillment of 2 Peter's prediction.
3. **Both used a common source**, perhaps a body of early Christian teaching about false teachers.

Alfred Plummer, who weighed the question carefully in 1891, admitted that he "remains still uncertain as to the true relation between the two, and that he has inclined sometimes to the one, and sometimes to the other."[12] That honest uncertainty is a good guide.

The question matters for the study of 2 Peter more than for Jude. This book reads Jude on its own terms and uses 2 Peter as an early interpreter of Jude's language. Appendix C gives the parallel texts side by side.

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10. "Epistle of Jude," *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA; accessed 7 November 2026): "most scholars consider Jude the source for the similar passages of 2 Peter."↩

11. Martin Luther, *The Epistles of St. Peter and St. Jude Preached and Explained* (Wittenberg, 1523–24), trans. E. H. Gillett (New York: Anson D. F. Randolph, 1859), on Jude 1–2, Project Gutenberg #29678. Mayor, *Expositor's Greek Testament*, on Jude 8, mentions "Spitta (holding that Jude copied from 2 Peter)" and "those who take the opposite view (viz. that 2 Peter was copied from Jude)."↩

12. Alfred Plummer, *The General Epistles of St. James and St. Jude* (Expositor's Bible; London: Hodder & Stoughton, 1891), on Jude 4, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/expositors/jude/1.htm. Plummer notes that "only the first three and last seven verses, i.e., about a third of the whole, have no intimate relations with 2 Peter."↩

## 9. How the church received Jude

Jude's place in the New Testament was secure early in some regions and debated in others, and the debate centered on his use of Enoch.

- **Late second century:** the Muratorian Fragment, a Latin list of accepted books whose date is debated, includes "the Epistle of Jude."[13] Clement of Alexandria commented on Jude in his *Hypotyposes*, and part of that commentary survives in Latin.[14] Tertullian, around AD 200, used Jude to defend Enoch's authority: "Enoch possesses a testimony in the Apostle Jude."[15]
- **Third century:** Origen praised Jude as "a letter of few lines, it is true, but filled with the healthful words of heavenly grace."[16]
- **Early fourth century:** Eusebius placed Jude among the "disputed writings, which are nevertheless recognized by many," noting that "not many of the ancients have mentioned it" but that it had been "read publicly in very many churches."[17]
- **AD 367:** Athanasius's Easter letter listing the books of the New Testament includes "one of Jude" among the seven catholic epistles.[18]
- **Late fourth century:** Jerome explained the hesitation directly: "because in it he quotes from the apocryphal Book of Enoch it is rejected by many. Nevertheless by age and use it has gained authority and is reckoned among the Holy Scriptures."[19]

At the Reformation, Martin Luther judged in his 1523 sermons on Jude that the letter "cannot be looked upon as being that of one who was truly an Apostle, for the author speaks in it of the Apostles, as being much their junior," and that it "refers to the second Epistle of St. Peter, from which it has taken nearly all its words."[20] John Calvin defended its authority and suggested that Jude drew on ancient tradition, not necessarily on an apocryphal book.[21]

One further fact helps modern readers understand the issue. **The Book of Enoch, which Jude quotes, is itself part of the Old Testament canon of the Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church and the Eritrean Orthodox Tewahedo Church**, though not of other churches or of Judaism.[22] The question "What does it mean that Jude quotes Enoch?" therefore receives different answers in different Christian traditions. Chapter 8 explores it.

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13. Muratorian Fragment, in *Ante-Nicene Fathers* 5, "Fragments of Caius," §4 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0510.htm).↩

14. Eusebius, *Ecclesiastical History* 6.14.1 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/250106.htm); Clement, *Adumbrationes* (see n. 1).↩

15. Tertullian, *On the Apparel of Women* (*De cultu feminarum*) 1.3 (ANF 4; https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0402.htm).↩

16. Origen, *Commentary on Matthew* 10.17 (ANF 9; https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/101610.htm).↩

17. Eusebius, *Ecclesiastical History* 3.25.3 and 2.23.25 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/250103.htm, https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/250102.htm).↩

18. Athanasius, *Festal Letter* 39.5 (NPNF² 4; https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/2806039.htm).↩

19. Jerome, *On Illustrious Men* (*De viris illustribus*) 4 (NPNF² 3; https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/2708.htm).↩

20. Luther, *The Epistles of St. Peter and St. Jude Preached and Explained*, trans. Gillett (1859), on Jude 1–2, Project Gutenberg #29678 (public domain).↩

21. John Calvin, *Commentaries on the Catholic Epistles*, trans. John Owen (Edinburgh: Calvin Translation Society, 1855), on Jude 9 and 14 (CCEL edition).↩

22. On the canonical status and textual history of 1 Enoch, see "Book of Enoch," *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA; accessed 7 November 2026). On its rediscovery in Europe (from Ethiopia, in 1773) and its first modern edition (Dillmann, 1853), see Plummer (Expositor's Bible) and E. H. Plumptre (*Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges*) on Jude 14.↩

## 10. Why Jude matters

Jude has been called the most neglected book of the New Testament. Its neglect is understandable but costly. In twenty-five verses it offers:

- a picture of **Christian identity** as gift before task: called, loved, kept;
- a clear statement that the **gospel has content**, entrusted once for all and worth contending for;
- an unflinching moral seriousness about **grace twisted into license**;
- a demonstration of how the first Christians read **Israel's scriptures and traditions** as speaking to their present;
- a remarkably early and high **Christology**: Jesus is "our only Master and Lord," possibly the one who saved Israel from Egypt, and the coming Lord of Enoch's prophecy;
- a model of **contending without contempt**, defending the faith while showing mercy to the wavering and rescuing those in danger;
- one of the most beautiful **doxologies** in Scripture, which turns the whole letter toward the God who keeps his people.

The chapters that follow try to show how these pieces fit together.

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## Texts Highlighted in This Introduction

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this introduction is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Genesis 4

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וְהָאָדָם יָדַע אֶת־חַוָּה אִשְׁתּוֹ וַתַּהַר וַתֵּלֶד אֶת־קָיִן וַתֹּאמֶר קָנִיתִי אִישׁ אֶת־יְהוָה **2** וַתֹּסֶף לָלֶדֶת אֶת־
אָחִיו אֶת־הָבֶל וַיְהִי־הֶבֶל רֹעֵה צֹאן וְקַיִן הָיָה עֹבֵד אֲדָמָה **3** וַיְהִי מִקֵּץ יָמִים וַיָּבֵא קַיִן מִפְּרִי הָאֲדָמָה
מִנְחָה לַיהוָה **4** וְהֶבֶל הֵבִיא גַם־הוּא מִבְּכֹרוֹת צֹאנוֹ וּמֵחֶלְבֵהֶן וַיִּשַׁע יְהוָה אֶל־הֶבֶל וְאֶל־מִנְחָתוֹ **5**
וְאֶל־קַיִן וְאֶל־מִנְחָתוֹ לֹא שָׁעָה וַיִּחַר לְקַיִן מְאֹד וַיִּפְּלוּ פָּנָיו **6** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־קַיִן לָמָּה חָרָה לָךְ
וְלָמָּה נָפְלוּ פָנֶיךָ **7** הֲלוֹא אִם־תֵּיטִיב שְׂאֵת וְאִם לֹא תֵּיטִיב לַפֶּתַח חַטָּאת רֹבֵץ וְאֵלֶיךָ תְּשׁוּקָתוֹ וְאַתָּה
תִּמְשָׁל־בּוֹ **8** וַיֹּאמֶר קַיִן אֶל־הֶבֶל אָחִיו וַיְהִי בִּהְיוֹתָם בַּשָּׂדֶה וַיָּקָם קַיִן אֶל־הֶבֶל אָחִיו וַיַּהַרְגֵהוּ **9**
וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־קַיִן אֵי הֶבֶל אָחִיךָ וַיֹּאמֶר לֹא יָדַעְתִּי הֲשֹׁמֵר אָחִי אָנֹכִי **10** וַיֹּאמֶר מָה עָשִׂיתָ קוֹל
דְּמֵי אָחִיךָ צֹעֲקִים אֵלַי מִן־הָאֲדָמָה **11** וְעַתָּה אָרוּר אָתָּה מִן־הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר פָּצְתָה אֶת־פִּיהָ לָקַחַת
אֶת־דְּמֵי אָחִיךָ מִיָּדֶךָ **12** כִּי תַעֲבֹד אֶת־הָאֲדָמָה לֹא־תֹסֶף תֵּת־כֹּחָהּ לָךְ נָע וָנָד תִּהְיֶה בָאָרֶץ **13**
וַיֹּאמֶר קַיִן אֶל־יְהוָה גָּדוֹל עֲוֹנִי מִנְּשֹׂא **14** הֵן גֵּרַשְׁתָּ אֹתִי הַיּוֹם מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה וּמִפָּנֶיךָ אֶסָּתֵר
וְהָיִיתִי נָע וָנָד בָּאָרֶץ וְהָיָה כָל־מֹצְאִי יַהַרְגֵנִי **15** וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ יְהוָה לָכֵן כָּל־הֹרֵג קַיִן שִׁבְעָתַיִם יֻקָּם
וַיָּשֶׂם יְהוָה לְקַיִן אוֹת לְבִלְתִּי הַכּוֹת־אֹתוֹ כָּל־מֹצְאוֹ **16** וַיֵּצֵא קַיִן מִלִּפְנֵי יְהוָה וַיֵּשֶׁב בְּאֶרֶץ־נוֹד
קִדְמַת־עֵדֶן **17** וַיֵּדַע קַיִן אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וַתַּהַר וַתֵּלֶד אֶת־חֲנוֹךְ וַיְהִי בֹּנֶה עִיר וַיִּקְרָא שֵׁם הָעִיר כְּשֵׁם בְּנוֹ
חֲנוֹךְ **18** וַיִּוָּלֵד לַחֲנוֹךְ אֶת־עִירָד וְעִירָד יָלַד אֶת־מְחוּיָאֵל וּמְחִיָּאֵל יָלַד אֶת־מְתוּשָׁאֵל וּמְתוּשָׁאֵל
יָלַד אֶת־לָמֶךְ **19** וַיִּקַּח־לוֹ לָמֶךְ שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים שֵׁם הָאַחַת עָדָה וְשֵׁם הַשֵּׁנִית צִלָּה **20** וַתֵּלֶד עָדָה אֶת־יָבָל
הוּא הָיָה אֲבִי יֹשֵׁב אֹהֶל וּמִקְנֶה **21** וְשֵׁם אָחִיו יוּבָל הוּא הָיָה אֲבִי כָּל־תֹּפֵשׂ כִּנּוֹר וְעוּגָב **22** וְצִלָּה
גַּם־הִוא יָלְדָה אֶת־תּוּבַל קַיִן לֹטֵשׁ כָּל־חֹרֵשׁ נְחֹשֶׁת וּבַרְזֶל וַאֲחוֹת תּוּבַל־קַיִן נַעֲמָה **23** וַיֹּאמֶר לֶמֶךְ
לְנָשָׁיו עָדָה וְצִלָּה שְׁמַעַן קוֹלִי נְשֵׁי לֶמֶךְ הַאְזֵנָּה אִמְרָתִי כִּי אִישׁ הָרַגְתִּי לְפִצְעִי וְיֶלֶד לְחַבֻּרָתִי **24** כִּי
שִׁבְעָתַיִם יֻקַּם־קָיִן וְלֶמֶךְ שִׁבְעִים וְשִׁבְעָה **25** וַיֵּדַע אָדָם עוֹד אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וַתֵּלֶד בֵּן וַתִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שֵׁת
כִּי שָׁת־לִי אֱלֹהִים זֶרַע אַחֵר תַּחַת הֶבֶל כִּי הָרָגוֹ קָיִן **26** וּלְשֵׁת גַּם־הוּא יֻלַּד־בֵּן וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ אֱנוֹשׁ
אָז הוּחַל לִקְרֹא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** And Adam had relations with his wife Eve, and she conceived and gave birth to Cain. "With the help of the LORD I have brought forth a man," she said. **2** Later she gave birth to Cain's brother Abel. Now Abel was a keeper of sheep, while Cain was a tiller of the soil. **3** So in the course of time, Cain brought some of the fruit of the soil as an offering to the LORD, **4** while Abel brought the best portions of the firstborn of his flock. And the LORD looked with favor

on Abel and his offering, **5** but He had no regard for Cain and his offering. So Cain became very angry, and his countenance fell. **6** “Why are you angry,” said the LORD to Cain, “and why has your countenance fallen? **7** If you do what is right, will you not be accepted? But if you refuse to do what is right, sin is crouching at your door; it desires you, but you must master it.” **8** Then Cain said to his brother Abel, “Let us go out to the field.” And while they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel and killed him. **9** And the LORD said to Cain, “Where is your brother Abel?” “I do not know!” he answered. “Am I my brother’s keeper?” **10** “What have you done?” replied the LORD. “The voice of your brother’s blood cries out to Me from the ground. **11** Now you are cursed and banished from the ground, which has opened its mouth to receive your brother’s blood from your hand. **12** When you till the ground, it will no longer yield its produce to you. You will be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth.” **13** But Cain said to the LORD, “My punishment is greater than I can bear. **14** Behold, this day You have driven me from the face of the earth, and from Your face I will be hidden; I will be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth, and whoever finds me will kill me.” **15** “Not so!” replied the LORD. “If anyone slays Cain, then Cain will be avenged sevenfold.” And the LORD placed a mark on Cain, so that no one who found him would kill him. **16** So Cain went out from the presence of the LORD and settled in the land of Nod, east of Eden. **17** And Cain had relations with his wife, and she conceived and gave birth to Enoch. Then Cain built a city and named it after his son Enoch. **18** Now to Enoch was born Irad, and Irad was the father of Mehujael, and Mehujael was the father of Methusael, and Methusael was the father of Lamech. **19** And Lamech married two women, one named Adah and the other Zillah. **20** Adah gave birth to Jabal; he was the father of those who dwell in tents and raise livestock. **21** And his brother’s name was Jubal; he was the father of all who play the harp and flute. **22** And Zillah gave birth to Tubal-cain, a forger of every implement of bronze and iron. And the sister of Tubal-cain was Naamah. **23** Then Lamech said to his wives: “Adah and Zillah, hear my voice; wives of Lamech, listen to my speech. For I have slain a man for wounding me, a young man for striking me. **24** If Cain is avenged sevenfold, then Lamech seventy-sevenfold.” **25** And Adam again had relations with his wife, and she gave birth to a son and named him Seth, saying, “God has granted me another seed in place of Abel, since Cain killed him.” **26** And to Seth also a son was born, and he called him Enosh. At that time men began to call upon the name of the LORD.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The man knew Eve his wife. She conceived, and gave birth to Cain, and said, “I have gotten a man with the LORD’s help.” **2** Again she gave birth, to Cain’s brother Abel. Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain was a tiller of the ground. **3** As time passed, Cain brought an offering to the LORD from the fruit of the ground. **4** Abel also brought some of the firstborn of his flock and of its fat.

The LORD respected Abel and his offering, **5** but he didn't respect Cain and his offering. Cain was very angry, and the expression on his face fell. **6** The LORD said to Cain, "Why are you angry? Why has the expression of your face fallen? **7** If you do well, won't it be lifted up? If you don't do well, sin crouches at the door. Its desire is for you, but you are to rule over it." **8** Cain said to Abel, his brother, "Let's go into the field." While they were in the field, Cain rose up against Abel, his brother, and killed him. **9** The LORD said to Cain, "Where is Abel, your brother?" He said, "I don't know. Am I my brother's keeper?" **10** The LORD said, "What have you done? The voice of your brother's blood cries to me from the ground. **11** Now you are cursed because of the ground, which has opened its mouth to receive your brother's blood from your hand. **12** From now on, when you till the ground, it won't yield its strength to you. You will be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth." **13** Cain said to the LORD, "My punishment is greater than I can bear. **14** Behold, you have driven me out today from the surface of the ground. I will be hidden from your face, and I will be a fugitive and a wanderer on the earth. Whoever finds me will kill me." **15** The LORD said to him, "Therefore whoever slays Cain, vengeance will be taken on him sevenfold." The LORD appointed a sign for Cain, so that anyone finding him would not strike him. **16** Cain left the LORD's presence, and lived in the land of Nod, east of Eden. **17** Cain knew his wife. She conceived, and gave birth to Enoch. He built a city, and named the city after the name of his son, Enoch. **18** Irad was born to Enoch. Irad became the father of Mehujael. Mehujael became the father of Methushael. Methushael became the father of Lamech. **19** Lamech took two wives: the name of the first one was Adah, and the name of the second one was Zillah. **20** Adah gave birth to Jabal, who was the father of those who dwell in tents and have livestock. **21** His brother's name was Jubal, who was the father of all who handle the harp and pipe. **22** Zillah also gave birth to Tubal Cain, the forger of every cutting instrument of bronze and iron. Tubal Cain's sister was Naamah. **23** Lamech said to his wives, "Adah and Zillah, hear my voice. You wives of Lamech, listen to my speech, for I have slain a man for wounding me, a young man for bruising me. **24** If Cain will be avenged seven times, truly Lamech seventy-seven times." **25** Adam knew his wife again. She gave birth to a son, and named him Seth, saying, "for God has given me another child instead of Abel, for Cain killed him." **26** A son was also born to Seth, and he named him Enosh. At that time men began to call on the LORD's name.

## Genesis 5:21–24

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**21** וַיְחִ֖י חֲנ֣וֹךְ חָמֵ֣שׁ שָׁנִ֑ים וַיּ֖וֹלֶד אֶת־מְתוּשָֽׁלַח **22** וַיִּתְהַלֵּ֤ךְ חֲנוֹךְ֙ אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים אַחֲרֵ֥י הוֹלִיד֖וֹ
אֶת־מְתוּשֶׁ֑לַח שְׁלֹ֥שׁ מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָ֣ה וַיּ֥וֹלֶד בָּנִ֖ים וּבָנ֑וֹת **23** וַיִּהְי֣וּ כָל־יְמֵ֣י חֲנ֔וֹךְ חָמֵ֥שׁ וְשִׁשִּׁ֖ים שָׁנָ֑ה וּשְׁלֹ֥שׁ
מֵא֖וֹת שָׁנָֽה **24** וַיִּתְהַלֵּ֤ךְ חֲנוֹךְ֙ אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִ֔ים וְאֵינֶ֖נּוּ כִּֽי־לָקַ֥ח אֹת֖וֹ אֱלֹהִֽים

*English (BSB)*

**21** When Enoch was 65 years old, he became the father of Methuselah. **22** And after he had become the father of Methuselah, Enoch walked with God 300 years and had other sons and daughters. **23** So Enoch lived a total of 365 years. **24** Enoch walked with God, and then he was no more, because God had taken him away.

*English (WEB)*

**21** Enoch lived sixty-five years, then became the father of Methuselah. **22** After Methuselah's birth, Enoch walked with God for three hundred years, and became the father of more sons and daughters. **23** All the days of Enoch were three hundred sixty-five years. **24** Enoch walked with God, and he was not found, for God took him.

## Genesis 6:1–4

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְהִי כִּי־הֵחֵל הָאָדָם לָרֹב עַל־פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה וּבָנוֹת יֻלְּדוּ לָהֶם **2** וַיִּרְאוּ בְנֵי־הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת־בְּנוֹת
הָאָדָם כִּי טֹבֹת הֵנָּה וַיִּקְחוּ לָהֶם נָשִׁים מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר בָּחָרוּ **3** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה לֹא־יָדוֹן רוּחִי בָאָדָם לְעֹלָם
בְּשַׁגַּם הוּא בָשָׂר וְהָיוּ יָמָיו מֵאָה וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה **4** הַנְּפִלִים הָיוּ בָאָרֶץ בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם וְגַם אַחֲרֵי־כֵן אֲשֶׁר
יָבֹאוּ בְּנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים אֶל־בְּנוֹת הָאָדָם וְיָלְדוּ לָהֶם הַמָּה הַגִּבֹּרִים אֲשֶׁר מֵעוֹלָם אַנְשֵׁי הַשֵּׁם

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now when men began to multiply on the face of the earth and daughters were born to them, **2** the sons of God saw that the daughters of men were beautiful, and they took as wives whomever they chose. **3** So the LORD said, "My Spirit will not contend with man forever, for he is mortal; his days shall be 120 years." **4** The Nephilim were on the earth in those days—and afterward as well—when the sons of God had relations with the daughters of men. And they bore them children who became the mighty men of old, men of renown.

*English (WEB)*

**1** When men began to multiply on the surface of the ground, and daughters were born to them, **2** God's sons saw that men's daughters were beautiful, and they took any that they wanted for themselves as wives. **3** The LORD said, "My Spirit will not strive with man forever, because he also is flesh; so his days will be one hundred twenty years." **4** The Nephilim were on the earth in those days, and also after that, when God's sons came in to men's daughters and had children with them. Those were the mighty men who were of old, men of renown.

## Genesis 19

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיָּבֹאוּ שְׁנֵי הַמַּלְאָכִים סְדֹמָה בָּעֶרֶב וְלוֹט יֹשֵׁב בִּשַׁעַר־סְדֹם וַיַּרְא־לוֹט וַיָּקָם לִקְרָאתָם וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ
אַפַּיִם אָרְצָה **2** וַיֹּאמֶר הִנֶּה נָא־אֲדֹנַי סוּרוּ נָא אֶל־בֵּית עַבְדְּכֶם וְלִינוּ וְרַחֲצוּ רַגְלֵיכֶם וְהִשְׁכַּמְתֶּם
וַהֲלַכְתֶּם לְדַרְכְּכֶם וַיֹּאמְרוּ לֹא כִּי בָרְחוֹב נָלִין **3** וַיִּפְצַר־בָּם מְאֹד וַיָּסֻרוּ אֵלָיו וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־בֵּיתוֹ וַיַּעַשׂ
לָהֶם מִשְׁתֶּה וּמַצּוֹת אָפָה וַיֹּאכֵלוּ **4** טֶרֶם יִשְׁכָּבוּ וְאַנְשֵׁי הָעִיר אַנְשֵׁי סְדֹם נָסַבּוּ עַל־הַבַּיִת מִנַּעַר וְעַד־
זָקֵן כָּל־הָעָם מִקָּצֶה **5** וַיִּקְרְאוּ אֶל־לוֹט וַיֹּאמְרוּ לוֹ אַיֵּה הָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־בָּאוּ אֵלֶיךָ הַלָּיְלָה הוֹצִיאֵם
אֵלֵינוּ וְנֵדָעָה אֹתָם **6** וַיֵּצֵא אֲלֵהֶם לוֹט הַפֶּתְחָה וְהַדֶּלֶת סָגַר אַחֲרָיו **7** וַיֹּאמַר אַל־נָא אַחַי תָּרֵעוּ **8**
הִנֵּה־נָא לִי שְׁתֵּי בָנוֹת אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדְעוּ אִישׁ אוֹצִיאָה־נָּא אֹתָן אֲלֵיכֶם וַעֲשׂוּ לָהֶן כַּטּוֹב בְּעֵינֵיכֶם רַק
לָאֲנָשִׁים הָאֵל אַל־תַּעֲשׂוּ דָבָר כִּי־עַל־כֵּן בָּאוּ בְּצֵל קֹרָתִי **9** וַיֹּאמְרוּ גֶּשׁ־הָלְאָה וַיֹּאמְרוּ הָאֶחָד בָּא־
לָגוּר וַיִּשְׁפֹּט שָׁפוֹט עַתָּה נָרַע לְךָ מֵהֶם וַיִּפְצְרוּ בָאִישׁ בְּלוֹט מְאֹד וַיִּגְּשׁוּ לִשְׁבֹּר הַדָּלֶת **10** וַיִּשְׁלְחוּ
הָאֲנָשִׁים אֶת־יָדָם וַיְבִיאוּ אֶת־לוֹט אֲלֵיהֶם הַבָּיְתָה וְאֶת־הַדֶּלֶת סָגָרוּ **11** וְאֶת־הָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־פֶּתַח
הַבַּיִת הִכּוּ בַּסַּנְוֵרִים מִקָּטֹן וְעַד־גָּדוֹל וַיִּלְאוּ לִמְצֹא הַפָּתַח **12** וַיֹּאמְרוּ הָאֲנָשִׁים אֶל־לוֹט עֹד מִי־לְךָ
פֹּה חָתָן וּבָנֶיךָ וּבְנֹתֶיךָ וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־לְךָ בָּעִיר הוֹצֵא מִן־הַמָּקוֹם **13** כִּי־מַשְׁחִתִים אֲנַחְנוּ אֶת־הַמָּקוֹם
הַזֶּה כִּי־גָדְלָה צַעֲקָתָם אֶת־פְּנֵי יְהוָה וַיְשַׁלְּחֵנוּ יְהוָה לְשַׁחֲתָהּ **14** וַיֵּצֵא לוֹט וַיְדַבֵּר אֶל־חֲתָנָיו לֹקְחֵי
בְנֹתָיו וַיֹּאמֶר קוּמוּ צְאוּ מִן־הַמָּקוֹם הַזֶּה כִּי־מַשְׁחִית יְהוָה אֶת־הָעִיר וַיְהִי כִמְצַחֵק בְּעֵינֵי חֲתָנָיו **15**
וּכְמוֹ הַשַּׁחַר עָלָה וַיָּאִיצוּ הַמַּלְאָכִים בְּלוֹט לֵאמֹר קוּם קַח אֶת־אִשְׁתְּךָ וְאֶת־שְׁתֵּי בְנֹתֶיךָ הַנִּמְצָאֹת פֶּן־
תִּסָּפֶה בַּעֲוֹן הָעִיר **16** וַיִּתְמַהְמָהּ וַיַּחֲזִקוּ הָאֲנָשִׁים בְּיָדוֹ וּבְיַד־אִשְׁתּוֹ וּבְיַד שְׁתֵּי בְנֹתָיו בְּחֶמְלַת יְהוָה
עָלָיו וַיֹּצִאֻהוּ וַיַּנִּחֻהוּ מִחוּץ לָעִיר **17** וַיְהִי כְהוֹצִיאָם אֹתָם הַחוּצָה וַיֹּאמֶר הִמָּלֵט עַל־נַפְשֶׁךָ אַל־
תַּבִּיט אַחֲרֶיךָ וְאַל־תַּעֲמֹד בְּכָל־הַכִּכָּר הָהָרָה הִמָּלֵט פֶּן־תִּסָּפֶה **18** וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹט אֲלֵהֶם אַל־נָא אֲדֹנָי
**19** הִנֵּה־נָא מָצָא עַבְדְּךָ חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ וַתַּגְדֵּל חַסְדְּךָ אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתָ עִמָּדִי לְהַחֲיוֹת אֶת־נַפְשִׁי וְאָנֹכִי לֹא
אוּכַל לְהִמָּלֵט הָהָרָה פֶּן־תִּדְבָּקַנִי הָרָעָה וָמַתִּי **20** הִנֵּה־נָא הָעִיר הַזֹּאת קְרֹבָה לָנוּס שָׁמָּה וְהִיא
מִצְעָר אִמָּלְטָה נָּא שָׁמָּה הֲלֹא מִצְעָר הִוא וּתְחִי נַפְשִׁי **21** וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו הִנֵּה נָשָׂאתִי פָנֶיךָ גַּם לַדָּבָר
הַזֶּה לְבִלְתִּי הָפְכִּי אֶת־הָעִיר אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתָּ **22** מַהֵר הִמָּלֵט שָׁמָּה כִּי לֹא אוּכַל לַעֲשׂוֹת דָּבָר עַד־בֹּאֲךָ
שָׁמָּה עַל־כֵּן קָרָא שֵׁם־הָעִיר צוֹעַר **23** הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ יָצָא עַל־הָאָרֶץ וְלוֹט בָּא צֹעַרָה **24** וַיהוָה הִמְטִיר עַל־
סְדֹם וְעַל־עֲמֹרָה גָּפְרִית וָאֵשׁ מֵאֵת יְהוָה מִן־הַשָּׁמָיִם **25** וַיַּהֲפֹךְ אֶת־הֶעָרִים הָאֵל וְאֵת כָּל־הַכִּכָּר וְאֵת
כָּל־יֹשְׁבֵי הֶעָרִים וְצֶמַח הָאֲדָמָה **26** וַתַּבֵּט אִשְׁתּוֹ מֵאַחֲרָיו וַתְּהִי נְצִיב מֶלַח **27** וַיַּשְׁכֵּם אַבְרָהָם בַּבֹּקֶר
אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־עָמַד שָׁם אֶת־פְּנֵי יְהוָה **28** וַיַּשְׁקֵף עַל־פְּנֵי סְדֹם וַעֲמֹרָה וְעַל־כָּל־פְּנֵי אֶרֶץ הַכִּכָּר
וַיַּרְא וְהִנֵּה עָלָה קִיטֹר הָאָרֶץ כְּקִיטֹר הַכִּבְשָׁן **29** וַיְהִי בְּשַׁחֵת אֱלֹהִים אֶת־עָרֵי הַכִּכָּר וַיִּזְכֹּר אֱלֹהִים
אֶת־אַבְרָהָם וַיְשַׁלַּח אֶת־לוֹט מִתּוֹךְ הַהֲפֵכָה בַּהֲפֹךְ אֶת־הֶעָרִים אֲשֶׁר־יָשַׁב בָּהֶן לוֹט **30** וַיַּעַל לוֹט
מִצּוֹעַר וַיֵּשֶׁב בָּהָר וּשְׁתֵּי בְנֹתָיו עִמּוֹ כִּי יָרֵא לָשֶׁבֶת בְּצוֹעַר וַיֵּשֶׁב בַּמְּעָרָה הוּא וּשְׁתֵּי בְנֹתָיו **31**
וַתֹּאמֶר הַבְּכִירָה אֶל־הַצְּעִירָה אָבִינוּ זָקֵן וְאִישׁ אֵין בָּאָרֶץ לָבוֹא עָלֵינוּ כְּדֶרֶךְ כָּל־הָאָרֶץ **32** לְכָה
נַשְׁקֶה אֶת־אָבִינוּ יַיִן וְנִשְׁכְּבָה עִמּוֹ וּנְחַיֶּה מֵאָבִינוּ זָרַע **33** וַתַּשְׁקֶיןָ אֶת־אֲבִיהֶן יַיִן בַּלַּיְלָה הוּא וַתָּבֹא
הַבְּכִירָה וַתִּשְׁכַּב אֶת־אָבִיהָ וְלֹא־יָדַע בְּשִׁכְבָהּ וּבְקוּמָהּ **34** וַיְהִי מִמָּחֳרָת וַתֹּאמֶר הַבְּכִירָה אֶל־
הַצְּעִירָה הֵן־שָׁכַבְתִּי אֶמֶשׁ אֶת־אָבִי נַשְׁקֶנּוּ יַיִן גַּם־הַלַּיְלָה וּבֹאִי שִׁכְבִי עִמּוֹ וּנְחַיֶּה מֵאָבִינוּ זָרַע **35**
וַתַּשְׁקֶיןָ גַּם בַּלַּיְלָה הַהוּא אֶת־אֲבִיהֶן יַיִן וַתָּקָם הַצְּעִירָה וַתִּשְׁכַּב עִמּוֹ וְלֹא־יָדַע בְּשִׁכְבָהּ וּבְקוּמָהּ **36**
וַתַּהֲרֶיןָ שְׁתֵּי בְנוֹת־לוֹט מֵאֲבִיהֶן **37** וַתֵּלֶד הַבְּכִירָה בֵּן וַתִּקְרָא שְׁמוֹ מוֹאָב הוּא אֲבִי־מוֹאָב עַד־הַיּוֹם
**38** וְהַצְּעִירָה גַּם־הִוא יָלְדָה בֵּן וַתִּקְרָא שְׁמוֹ בֶּן־עַמִּי הוּא אֲבִי בְנֵי־עַמּוֹן עַד־הַיּוֹם

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now the two angels arrived at Sodom in the evening, and Lot was sitting in
the gateway of the city. When Lot saw them, he got up to meet them, bowed
facedown, **2** and said, “My lords, please turn aside into the house of your
servant; wash your feet and spend the night. Then you can rise early and go on
your way.” “No,” they answered, “we will spend the night in the square.” **3** But
Lot insisted so strongly that they followed him into his house. He prepared a
feast for them and baked unleavened bread, and they ate. **4** Before they had
gone to bed, all the men of the city of Sodom, both young and old, surrounded
the house. **5** They called out to Lot, saying, “Where are the men who came to
you tonight? Send them out to us so we can have relations with them!” **6** Lot
went outside to meet them, shutting the door behind him. **7** “Please, my
brothers,” he pleaded, “don’t do such a wicked thing! **8** Look, I have two
daughters who have never slept with a man. Let me bring them to you, and
you can do to them as you please. But do not do anything to these men, for
they have come under the protection of my roof.” **9** “Get out of the way!” they
replied. And they declared, “This one came here as a foreigner, and he is
already acting like a judge! Now we will treat you worse than them.” And they
pressed in on Lot and moved in to break down the door. **10** But the men inside
reached out, pulled Lot into the house with them, and shut the door. **11** And
they struck the men at the entrance, young and old, with blindness, so that
they wearied themselves trying to find the door. **12** Then the two men said to
Lot, “Do you have anyone else here—a son-in-law, your sons or daughters, or
anyone else in the city who belongs to you? Get them out of here, **13** because
we are about to destroy this place. For the outcry to the LORD against its
people is so great that He has sent us to destroy it.” **14** So Lot went out and
spoke to the sons-in-law who were pledged in marriage to his daughters. “Get
up,” he said. “Get out of this place, for the LORD is about to destroy the city!”
But his sons-in-law thought he was joking. **15** At daybreak the angels hurried
Lot along, saying, “Get up! Take your wife and your two daughters who are
here, or you will be swept away in the punishment of the city.” **16** But when
Lot hesitated, the men grabbed his hand and the hands of his wife and his two
daughters. And they led them safely out of the city, because of the LORD’s
compassion for them. **17** As soon as the men had brought them out, one of
them said, “Run for your lives! Do not look back, and do not stop anywhere on
the plain! Flee to the mountains, or you will be swept away!” **18** But Lot
replied, “No, my lords, please! **19** Your servant has indeed found favor in your
sight, and you have shown me great kindness by sparing my life. But I cannot
run to the mountains; the disaster will overtake me, and I will die. **20** Look,
there is a town nearby where I can flee, and it is a small place. Please let me
flee there—is it not a small place? Then my life will be saved.” **21** “Very well,”
he answered, “I will grant this request as well, and will not demolish the town
you indicate. **22** Hurry! Run there quickly, for I cannot do anything until you
reach it.” That is why the town was called Zoar. **23** And by the time the sun
had risen over the land, Lot had reached Zoar. **24** Then the LORD rained down
sulfur and fire on Sodom and Gomorrah—from the LORD out of the heavens.

**25** Thus He destroyed these cities and the entire plain, including all the inhabitants of the cities and everything that grew on the ground. **26** But Lot's wife looked back, and she became a pillar of salt. **27** Early the next morning, Abraham got up and returned to the place where he had stood before the LORD. **28** He looked down toward Sodom and Gomorrah and all the land of the plain, and he saw the smoke rising from the land like smoke from a furnace. **29** So when God destroyed the cities of the plain, He remembered Abraham, and He brought Lot out of the catastrophe that destroyed the cities where he had lived. **30** Lot and his two daughters left Zoar and settled in the mountains—for he was afraid to stay in Zoar—where they lived in a cave. **31** One day the older daughter said to the younger, "Our father is old, and there is no man in the land to sleep with us, as is the custom over all the earth. **32** Come, let us get our father drunk with wine so we can sleep with him and preserve his line." **33** So that night they got their father drunk with wine, and the firstborn went in and slept with her father; he was not aware when she lay down or when she got up. **34** The next day the older daughter said to the younger, "Look, I slept with my father last night. Let us get him drunk with wine again tonight so you can go in and sleep with him and we can preserve our father's line." **35** So again that night they got their father drunk with wine, and the younger daughter went in and slept with him; he was not aware when she lay down or when she got up. **36** Thus both of Lot's daughters became pregnant by their father. **37** The older daughter gave birth to a son and named him Moab. He is the father of the Moabites of today. **38** The younger daughter also gave birth to a son, and she named him Ben-ammi. He is the father of the Ammonites of today.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The two angels came to Sodom at evening. Lot sat in the gate of Sodom. Lot saw them, and rose up to meet them. He bowed himself with his face to the earth, **2** and he said, "See now, my lords, please come into your servant's house, stay all night, wash your feet, and you can rise up early, and go on your way." They said, "No, but we will stay in the street all night." **3** He urged them greatly, and they came in with him, and entered into his house. He made them a feast, and baked unleavened bread, and they ate. **4** But before they lay down, the men of the city, the men of Sodom, surrounded the house, both young and old, all the people from every quarter. **5** They called to Lot, and said to him, "Where are the men who came in to you this night? Bring them out to us, that we may have sex with them." **6** Lot went out to them through the door, and shut the door after himself. **7** He said, "Please, my brothers, don't act so wickedly. **8** See now, I have two virgin daughters. Please let me bring them out to you, and you may do to them what seems good to you. Only don't do anything to these men, because they have come under the shadow of my roof." **9** They said, "Stand back!" Then they said, "This one fellow came in to live as a foreigner, and he appoints himself a judge. Now we will deal worse with you

than with them!” They pressed hard on the man Lot, and came near to break the door. **10** But the men reached out their hand, and brought Lot into the house to them, and shut the door. **11** They struck the men who were at the door of the house with blindness, both small and great, so that they wearied themselves to find the door. **12** The men said to Lot, “Do you have anybody else here? Sons-in-law, your sons, your daughters, and whomever you have in the city, bring them out of the place: **13** for we will destroy this place, because the outcry against them has grown so great before the LORD that the LORD has sent us to destroy it.” **14** Lot went out, and spoke to his sons-in-law, who were pledged to marry his daughters, and said, “Get up! Get out of this place, for the LORD will destroy the city!” But he seemed to his sons-in-law to be joking. **15** When the morning came, then the angels hurried Lot, saying, “Get up! Take your wife and your two daughters who are here, lest you be consumed in the iniquity of the city.” **16** But he lingered; and the men grabbed his hand, his wife’s hand, and his two daughters’ hands, the LORD being merciful to him; and they took him out, and set him outside of the city. **17** It came to pass, when they had taken them out, that he said, “Escape for your life! Don’t look behind you, and don’t stay anywhere in the plain. Escape to the mountains, lest you be consumed!” **18** Lot said to them, “Oh, not so, my lord. **19** See now, your servant has found favor in your sight, and you have magnified your loving kindness, which you have shown to me in saving my life. I can’t escape to the mountain, lest evil overtake me, and I die. **20** See now, this city is near to flee to, and it is a little one. Oh let me escape there (isn’t it a little one?), and my soul will live.” **21** He said to him, “Behold, I have granted your request concerning this thing also, that I will not overthrow the city of which you have spoken. **22** Hurry, escape there, for I can’t do anything until you get there.” Therefore the name of the city was called Zoar. **23** The sun had risen on the earth when Lot came to Zoar. **24** Then the LORD rained on Sodom and on Gomorrah sulfur and fire from the LORD out of the sky. **25** He overthrew those cities, all the plain, all the inhabitants of the cities, and that which grew on the ground. **26** But Lot’s wife looked back from behind him, and she became a pillar of salt. **27** Abraham went up early in the morning to the place where he had stood before the LORD. **28** He looked toward Sodom and Gomorrah, and toward all the land of the plain, and saw that the smoke of the land went up as the smoke of a furnace. **29** When God destroyed the cities of the plain, God remembered Abraham, and sent Lot out of the middle of the overthrow, when he overthrew the cities in which Lot lived. **30** Lot went up out of Zoar, and lived in the mountain, and his two daughters with him; for he was afraid to live in Zoar. He lived in a cave with his two daughters. **31** The firstborn said to the younger, “Our father is old, and there is not a man on the earth to come in to us in the way of all the earth. **32** Come, let’s make our father drink wine, and we will lie with him, that we may preserve our father’s family line.” **33** They made their father drink wine that night: and the firstborn went in, and lay with her father. He didn’t know when she lay down, nor when she arose. **34** It came to pass on the next day, that the

firstborn said to the younger, “Behold, I lay last night with my father. Let’s make him drink wine again tonight. You go in, and lie with him, that we may preserve our father’s family line.” **35** They made their father drink wine that night also. The younger went and lay with him. He didn’t know when she lay down, nor when she got up. **36** Thus both of Lot’s daughters were with child by their father. **37** The firstborn bore a son, and named him Moab. He is the father of the Moabites to this day. **38** The younger also bore a son, and called his name Ben Ammi. He is the father of the children of Ammon to this day.

## Exodus 12

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם לֵאמֹר **2** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים רִאשׁוֹן
הוּא לָכֶם לְחָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה **3** דַּבְּרוּ אֶל־כָּל־עֲדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר בָּעֲשֹׂר לַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה וְיִקְחוּ לָהֶם אִישׁ שֶׂה
לְבֵית־אָבֹת שֶׂה לַבָּיִת **4** וְאִם־יִמְעַט הַבַּיִת מִהְיֹת מִשֶּׂה וְלָקַח הוּא וּשְׁכֵנוֹ הַקָּרֹב אֶל־בֵּיתוֹ בְּמִכְסַת
נְפָשֹׁת אִישׁ לְפִי אָכְלוֹ תָּכֹסּוּ עַל־הַשֶּׂה **5** שֶׂה תָמִים זָכָר בֶּן־שָׁנָה יִהְיֶה לָכֶם מִן־הַכְּבָשִׂים וּמִן־הָעִזִּים
תִּקָּחוּ **6** וְהָיָה לָכֶם לְמִשְׁמֶרֶת עַד אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה וְשָׁחֲטוּ אֹתוֹ כֹּל קְהַל עֲדַת־יִשְׂרָאֵל
בֵּין הָעַרְבָּיִם **7** וְלָקְחוּ מִן־הַדָּם וְנָתְנוּ עַל־שְׁתֵּי הַמְּזוּזֹת וְעַל־הַמַּשְׁקוֹף עַל הַבָּתִּים אֲשֶׁר־יֹאכְלוּ אֹתוֹ
בָּהֶם **8** וְאָכְלוּ אֶת־הַבָּשָׂר בַּלַּיְלָה הַזֶּה צְלִי־אֵשׁ וּמַצּוֹת עַל־מְרֹרִים יֹאכְלֵהוּ **9** אַל־תֹּאכְלוּ מִמֶּנּוּ נָא
וּבָשֵׁל מְבֻשָּׁל בַּמָּיִם כִּי אִם־צְלִי־אֵשׁ רֹאשׁוֹ עַל־כְּרָעָיו וְעַל־קִרְבּוֹ **10** וְלֹא־תוֹתִירוּ מִמֶּנּוּ עַד־בֹּקֶר
וְהַנּוֹתָר מִמֶּנּוּ עַד־בֹּקֶר בָּאֵשׁ תִּשְׂרֹפוּ **11** וְכָכָה תֹּאכְלוּ אֹתוֹ מָתְנֵיכֶם חֲגֻרִים נַעֲלֵיכֶם בְּרַגְלֵיכֶם
וּמַקֶּלְכֶם בְּיֶדְכֶם וַאֲכַלְתֶּם אֹתוֹ בְּחִפָּזוֹן פֶּסַח הוּא לַיהוָה **12** וְעָבַרְתִּי בְאֶרֶץ־מִצְרַיִם בַּלַּיְלָה הַזֶּה
וְהִכֵּיתִי כָל־בְּכוֹר בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם מֵאָדָם וְעַד־בְּהֵמָה וּבְכָל־אֱלֹהֵי מִצְרַיִם אֶעֱשֶׂה שְׁפָטִים אֲנִי יְהוָה **13**
וְהָיָה הַדָּם לָכֶם לְאֹת עַל הַבָּתִּים אֲשֶׁר אַתֶּם שָׁם וְרָאִיתִי אֶת־הַדָּם וּפָסַחְתִּי עֲלֵכֶם וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה בָכֶם
נֶגֶף לְמַשְׁחִית בְּהַכֹּתִי בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם **14** וְהָיָה הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה לָכֶם לְזִכָּרוֹן וַחֲגֹתֶם אֹתוֹ חַג לַיהוָה
לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם חֻקַּת עוֹלָם תָּחְגֻּהוּ **15** שִׁבְעַת יָמִים מַצּוֹת תֹּאכֵלוּ אַךְ בַּיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן תַּשְׁבִּיתוּ שְׂאֹר
מִבָּתֵּיכֶם כִּי כָּל־אֹכֵל חָמֵץ וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל מִיּוֹם הָרִאשֹׁן עַד־יוֹם הַשְּׁבִעִי **16** וּבַיּוֹם
הָרִאשׁוֹן מִקְרָא־קֹדֶשׁ וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מִקְרָא־קֹדֶשׁ יִהְיֶה לָכֶם כָּל־מְלָאכָה לֹא־יֵעָשֶׂה בָהֶם אַךְ אֲשֶׁר
יֵאָכֵל לְכָל־נֶפֶשׁ הוּא לְבַדּוֹ יֵעָשֶׂה לָכֶם **17** וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם אֶת־הַמַּצּוֹת כִּי בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה הוֹצֵאתִי אֶת־
צִבְאוֹתֵיכֶם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם אֶת־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם חֻקַּת עוֹלָם **18** בָּרִאשֹׁן בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר
יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ בָּעֶרֶב תֹּאכְלוּ מַצֹּת עַד יוֹם הָאֶחָד וְעֶשְׂרִים לַחֹדֶשׁ בָּעָרֶב **19** שִׁבְעַת יָמִים שְׂאֹר לֹא יִמָּצֵא
בְּבָתֵּיכֶם כִּי כָּל־אֹכֵל מַחְמֶצֶת וְנִכְרְתָה הַנֶּפֶשׁ הַהִוא מֵעֲדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּגֵּר וּבְאֶזְרַח הָאָרֶץ **20** כָּל־
מַחְמֶצֶת לֹא תֹאכֵלוּ בְּכֹל מוֹשְׁבֹתֵיכֶם תֹּאכְלוּ מַצּוֹת **21** וַיִּקְרָא מֹשֶׁה לְכָל־זִקְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם
מְשְׁכוּ וּקְחוּ לָכֶם צֹאן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתֵיכֶם וְשַׁחֲטוּ הַפָּסַח **22** וּלְקַחְתֶּם אֲגֻדַּת אֵזוֹב וּטְבַלְתֶּם בַּדָּם אֲשֶׁר־בַּסַּף
וְהִגַּעְתֶּם אֶל־הַמַּשְׁקוֹף וְאֶל־שְׁתֵּי הַמְּזוּזֹת מִן־הַדָּם אֲשֶׁר בַּסַּף וְאַתֶּם לֹא תֵצְאוּ אִישׁ מִפֶּתַח־בֵּיתוֹ עַד־
בֹּקֶר **23** וְעָבַר יְהוָה לִנְגֹּף אֶת־מִצְרַיִם וְרָאָה אֶת־הַדָּם עַל־הַמַּשְׁקוֹף וְעַל שְׁתֵּי הַמְּזוּזֹת וּפָסַח יְהוָה
עַל־הַפֶּתַח וְלֹא יִתֵּן הַמַּשְׁחִית לָבֹא אֶל־בָּתֵּיכֶם לִנְגֹּף **24** וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם אֶת־הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה לְחָק־לְךָ וּלְבָנֶיךָ
עַד־עוֹלָם **25** וְהָיָה כִּי־תָבֹאוּ אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר יִתֵּן יְהוָה לָכֶם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם אֶת־הָעֲבֹדָה
הַזֹּאת **26** וְהָיָה כִּי־יֹאמְרוּ אֲלֵיכֶם בְּנֵיכֶם מָה הָעֲבֹדָה הַזֹּאת לָכֶם **27** וַאֲמַרְתֶּם זֶבַח־פֶּסַח הוּא לַיהוָה
אֲשֶׁר פָּסַח עַל־בָּתֵּי בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִצְרַיִם בְּנָגְפּוֹ אֶת־מִצְרַיִם וְאֶת־בָּתֵּינוּ הִצִּיל וַיִּקֹּד הָעָם וַיִּשְׁתַּחֲווּ

**28** וַיֵּלְכוּ וַיַּעֲשׂוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן כֵּן עָשׂוּ **29** וַיְהִי בַּחֲצִי הַלַּיְלָה וַיהוָה
הִכָּה כָל־בְּכוֹר בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם מִבְּכֹר פַּרְעֹה הַיֹּשֵׁב עַל־כִּסְאוֹ עַד בְּכוֹר הַשֶּׁבִי אֲשֶׁר בְּבֵית הַבּוֹר וְכֹל
בְּכוֹר בְּהֵמָה **30** וַיָּקָם פַּרְעֹה לַיְלָה הוּא וְכָל־עֲבָדָיו וְכָל־מִצְרַיִם וַתְּהִי צְעָקָה גְדֹלָה בְּמִצְרָיִם כִּי־
אֵין בַּיִת אֲשֶׁר אֵין־שָׁם מֵת **31** וַיִּקְרָא לְמֹשֶׁה וּלְאַהֲרֹן לַיְלָה וַיֹּאמֶר קוּמוּ צְאוּ מִתּוֹךְ עַמִּי גַּם־אַתֶּם גַּם־
בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּלְכוּ עִבְדוּ אֶת־יְהוָה כְּדַבֶּרְכֶם **32** גַּם־צֹאנְכֶם גַּם־בְּקַרְכֶם קְחוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתֶּם וְלֵכוּ
וּבֵרַכְתֶּם גַּם־אֹתִי **33** וַתֶּחֱזַק מִצְרַיִם עַל־הָעָם לְמַהֵר לְשַׁלְּחָם מִן־הָאָרֶץ כִּי אָמְרוּ כֻּלָּנוּ מֵתִים **34**
וַיִּשָּׂא הָעָם אֶת־בְּצֵקוֹ טֶרֶם יֶחְמָץ מִשְׁאֲרֹתָם צְרֻרֹת בְּשִׂמְלֹתָם עַל־שִׁכְמָם **35** וּבְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל עָשׂוּ כִּדְבַר
מֹשֶׁה וַיִּשְׁאֲלוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם כְּלֵי־כֶסֶף וּכְלֵי זָהָב וּשְׂמָלֹת **36** וַיהוָה נָתַן אֶת־חֵן הָעָם בְּעֵינֵי מִצְרַיִם
וַיַּשְׁאִלוּם וַיְנַצְּלוּ אֶת־מִצְרָיִם **37** וַיִּסְעוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מַרַעְמְסֵס סְכֹתָה כְּשֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת אֶלֶף רַגְלִי הַגְּבָרִים
לְבַד מִטָּף **38** וְגַם־עֵרֶב רַב עָלָה אִתָּם וְצֹאן וּבָקָר מִקְנֶה כָּבֵד מְאֹד **39** וַיֹּאפוּ אֶת־הַבָּצֵק אֲשֶׁר
הוֹצִיאוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם עֻגֹת מַצּוֹת כִּי לֹא חָמֵץ כִּי־גֹרְשׁוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם וְלֹא יָכְלוּ לְהִתְמַהְמֵהַּ וְגַם־צֵדָה לֹא־עָשׂוּ
לָהֶם **40** וּמוֹשַׁב בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר יָשְׁבוּ בְּמִצְרָיִם שְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וְאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה **41** וַיְהִי מִקֵּץ
שְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וְאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיְהִי בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה יָצְאוּ כָּל־צִבְאוֹת יְהוָה מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם **42** לֵיל
שִׁמֻּרִים הוּא לַיהוָה לְהוֹצִיאָם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם הוּא־הַלַּיְלָה הַזֶּה לַיהוָה שִׁמֻּרִים לְכָל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
לְדֹרֹתָם **43** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן זֹאת חֻקַּת הַפָּסַח כָּל־בֶּן־נֵכָר לֹא־יֹאכַל בּוֹ **44** וְכָל־עֶבֶד
אִישׁ מִקְנַת־כֶּסֶף וּמַלְתָּה אֹתוֹ אָז יֹאכַל בּוֹ **45** תּוֹשָׁב וְשָׂכִיר לֹא־יֹאכַל־בּוֹ **46** בְּבַיִת אֶחָד יֵאָכֵל לֹא־
תוֹצִיא מִן־הַבַּיִת מִן־הַבָּשָׂר חוּצָה וְעֶצֶם לֹא תִשְׁבְּרוּ־בוֹ **47** כָּל־עֲדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל יַעֲשׂוּ אֹתוֹ **48** וְכִי־יָגוּר
אִתְּךָ גֵּר וְעָשָׂה פֶסַח לַיהוָה הִמּוֹל לוֹ כָל־זְכָר וְאָז יִקְרַב לַעֲשֹׂתוֹ וְהָיָה כְּאֶזְרַח הָאָרֶץ וְכָל־עָרֵל לֹא־
יֹאכַל בּוֹ **49** תּוֹרָה אַחַת יִהְיֶה לָאֶזְרָח וְלַגֵּר הַגָּר בְּתוֹכְכֶם **50** וַיַּעֲשׂוּ כָּל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה
יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶת־אַהֲרֹן כֵּן עָשׂוּ **51** וַיְהִי בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה הוֹצִיא יְהוָה אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֶרֶץ
מִצְרַיִם עַל־צִבְאֹתָם

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now the LORD said to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, **2** “This month
is the beginning of months for you; it shall be the first month of your year. **3**
Tell the whole congregation of Israel that on the tenth day of this month each
man must select a lamb for his family, one per household. **4** If the household is
too small for a whole lamb, they are to share with the nearest neighbor based
on the number of people, and apportion the lamb accordingly. **5** Your lamb
must be an unblemished year-old male, and you may take it from the sheep or
the goats. **6** You must keep it until the fourteenth day of the month, when the
whole assembly of the congregation of Israel will slaughter the animals at
twilight. **7** They are to take some of the blood and put it on the sides and tops
of the doorframes of the houses where they eat the lambs. **8** They are to eat
the meat that night, roasted over the fire, along with unleavened bread and
bitter herbs. **9** Do not eat any of the meat raw or cooked in boiling water, but
only roasted over the fire—its head and legs and inner parts. **10** Do not leave
any of it until morning; before the morning you must burn up any part that is
left over. **11** This is how you are to eat it: You must be fully dressed for travel,
with your sandals on your feet and your staff in your hand. You are to eat in
haste; it is the LORD’s Passover. **12** On that night I will pass through the land

of Egypt and strike down every firstborn male, both man and beast, and I will execute judgment against all the gods of Egypt. I am the LORD. **13** The blood on the houses where you are staying will distinguish them; when I see the blood, I will pass over you. No plague will fall on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt. **14** And this day will be a memorial for you, and you are to celebrate it as a feast to the LORD, as a permanent statute for the generations to come. **15** For seven days you must eat unleavened bread. On the first day you are to remove the leaven from your houses. Whoever eats anything leavened from the first day through the seventh must be cut off from Israel. **16** On the first day you are to hold a sacred assembly, and another on the seventh day. You must not do any work on those days, except to prepare the meals—that is all you may do. **17** So you are to keep the Feast of Unleavened Bread, for on this very day I brought your divisions out of the land of Egypt. You must keep this day as a permanent statute for the generations to come. **18** In the first month you are to eat unleavened bread, from the evening of the fourteenth day until the evening of the twenty-first day. **19** For seven days there must be no leaven found in your houses. If anyone eats something leavened, that person, whether a foreigner or native of the land, must be cut off from the congregation of Israel. **20** You are not to eat anything leavened; eat unleavened bread in all your homes." **21** Then Moses summoned all the elders of Israel and told them, "Go at once and select for yourselves a lamb for each family, and slaughter the Passover lamb. **22** Take a cluster of hyssop, dip it into the blood in the basin, and brush the blood on the top and sides of the doorframe. None of you shall go out the door of his house until morning. **23** When the LORD passes through to strike down the Egyptians, He will see the blood on the top and sides of the doorframe and will pass over that doorway; so He will not allow the destroyer to enter your houses and strike you down. **24** And you are to keep this command as a permanent statute for you and your descendants. **25** When you enter the land that the LORD will give you as He promised, you are to keep this service. **26** When your children ask you, 'What does this service mean to you?' **27** you are to reply, 'It is the Passover sacrifice to the LORD, who passed over the houses of the Israelites in Egypt when He struck down the Egyptians and spared our homes.'" Then the people bowed down and worshiped. **28** And the Israelites went and did just what the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron. **29** Now at midnight the LORD struck down every firstborn male in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh, who sat on his throne, to the firstborn of the prisoner in the dungeon, as well as all the firstborn among the livestock. **30** During the night Pharaoh got up—he and all his officials and all the Egyptians—and there was loud wailing in Egypt; for there was no house without someone dead. **31** Then Pharaoh summoned Moses and Aaron by night and said, "Get up, leave my people, both you and the Israelites! Go, worship the LORD as you have requested. **32** Take your flocks and herds as well, just as you have said, and depart! And bless me also." **33** And in order to send them out of the land quickly, the Egyptians urged the people on. "For otherwise," they said, "we are all going to die!" **34** So the

people took their dough before it was leavened, carrying it on their shoulders in kneading bowls wrapped in clothing. **35** Furthermore, the Israelites acted on Moses' word and asked the Egyptians for articles of silver and gold, and for clothing. **36** And the LORD gave the people such favor in the sight of the Egyptians that they granted their request. In this way they plundered the Egyptians. **37** The Israelites journeyed from Rameses to Succoth with about 600,000 men on foot, besides women and children. **38** And a mixed multitude also went up with them, along with great droves of livestock, both flocks and herds. **39** Since their dough had no leaven, the people baked what they had brought out of Egypt into unleavened loaves. For when they had been driven out of Egypt, they could not delay and had not prepared any provisions for themselves. **40** Now the duration of the Israelites' stay in Egypt was 430 years. **41** At the end of the 430 years, to the very day, all the LORD's divisions went out of the land of Egypt. **42** Because the LORD kept a vigil that night to bring them out of the land of Egypt, this same night is to be a vigil to the LORD, to be observed by all the Israelites for the generations to come. **43** And the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "This is the statute of the Passover: No foreigner is to eat of it. **44** But any slave who has been purchased may eat of it, after you have circumcised him. **45** A temporary resident or hired hand shall not eat the Passover. **46** It must be eaten inside one house. You are not to take any of the meat outside the house, and you may not break any of the bones. **47** The whole congregation of Israel must celebrate it. **48** If a foreigner resides with you and wants to celebrate the LORD's Passover, all the males in the household must be circumcised; then he may come near to celebrate it, and he shall be like a native of the land. But no uncircumcised man may eat of it. **49** The same law shall apply to both the native and the foreigner who resides among you." **50** Then all the Israelites did this—they did just as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron. **51** And on that very day the LORD brought the Israelites out of the land of Egypt by their divisions.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD spoke to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, saying, **2** "This month shall be to you the beginning of months. It shall be the first month of the year to you. **3** Speak to all the congregation of Israel, saying, 'On the tenth day of this month, they shall take to them every man a lamb, according to their fathers' houses, a lamb for a household; **4** and if the household is too little for a lamb, then he and his neighbor next to his house shall take one according to the number of the souls. You shall make your count for the lamb according to what everyone can eat. **5** Your lamb shall be without defect, a male a year old. You shall take it from the sheep or from the goats. **6** You shall keep it until the fourteenth day of the same month; and the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill it at evening. **7** They shall take some of the blood, and put it on the two door posts and on the lintel, on the houses in which they shall eat it. **8** They shall eat the meat in that night, roasted with

fire, with unleavened bread. They shall eat it with bitter herbs. **9** Don't eat it raw, nor boiled at all with water, but roasted with fire; with its head, its legs and its inner parts. **10** You shall let nothing of it remain until the morning; but that which remains of it until the morning you shall burn with fire. **11** This is how you shall eat it: with your belt on your waist, your sandals on your feet, and your staff in your hand; and you shall eat it in haste: it is the LORD's Passover. **12** For I will go through the land of Egypt in that night, and will strike all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and animal. I will execute judgments against all the gods of Egypt. I am the LORD. **13** The blood shall be to you for a token on the houses where you are. When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will be on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt. **14** This day shall be a memorial for you. You shall keep it as a feast to the LORD. You shall keep it as a feast throughout your generations by an ordinance forever. **15** "'Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread; even the first day you shall put away yeast out of your houses, for whoever eats leavened bread from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall be cut off from Israel. **16** In the first day there shall be to you a holy convocation, and in the seventh day a holy convocation; no kind of work shall be done in them, except that which every man must eat, only that may be done by you. **17** You shall observe the feast of unleavened bread; for in this same day I have brought your armies out of the land of Egypt. Therefore you shall observe this day throughout your generations by an ordinance forever. **18** In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month at evening, you shall eat unleavened bread, until the twenty first day of the month at evening. **19** There shall be no yeast found in your houses for seven days, for whoever eats that which is leavened, that soul shall be cut off from the congregation of Israel, whether he is a foreigner, or one who is born in the land. **20** You shall eat nothing leavened. In all your habitations you shall eat unleavened bread.'" **21** Then Moses called for all the elders of Israel, and said to them, "Draw out, and take lambs according to your families, and kill the Passover. **22** You shall take a bunch of hyssop, and dip it in the blood that is in the basin, and strike the lintel and the two door posts with the blood that is in the basin. None of you shall go out of the door of his house until the morning. **23** For the LORD will pass through to strike the Egyptians; and when he sees the blood on the lintel, and on the two door posts, the LORD will pass over the door, and will not allow the destroyer to come in to your houses to strike you. **24** You shall observe this thing for an ordinance to you and to your sons forever. **25** It shall happen when you have come to the land which the LORD will give you, as he has promised, that you shall keep this service. **26** It will happen, when your children ask you, 'What do you mean by this service?' **27** that you shall say, 'It is the sacrifice of the LORD's Passover, who passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt, when he struck the Egyptians, and spared our houses.'" The people bowed their heads and worshiped. **28** The children of Israel went and did so; as the LORD had commanded Moses and Aaron, so they did. **29** At midnight, the LORD struck all the firstborn in the land of

Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sat on his throne to the firstborn of the captive who was in the dungeon, and all the firstborn of livestock. **30** Pharaoh rose up in the night, he, and all his servants, and all the Egyptians; and there was a great cry in Egypt, for there was not a house where there was not one dead. **31** He called for Moses and Aaron by night, and said, “Rise up, get out from among my people, both you and the children of Israel; and go, serve the LORD, as you have said! **32** Take both your flocks and your herds, as you have said, and be gone; and bless me also!” **33** The Egyptians were urgent with the people, to send them out of the land in haste, for they said, “We are all dead men.” **34** The people took their dough before it was leavened, their kneading troughs being bound up in their clothes on their shoulders. **35** The children of Israel did according to the word of Moses; and they asked of the Egyptians jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and clothing. **36** The LORD gave the people favor in the sight of the Egyptians, so that they let them have what they asked. They plundered the Egyptians. **37** The children of Israel traveled from Rameses to Succoth, about six hundred thousand on foot who were men, in addition to children. **38** A mixed multitude went up also with them, with flocks, herds, and even very much livestock. **39** They baked unleavened cakes of the dough which they brought out of Egypt; for it wasn’t leavened, because they were thrust out of Egypt, and couldn’t wait, and they had not prepared any food for themselves. **40** Now the time that the children of Israel lived in Egypt was four hundred thirty years. **41** At the end of four hundred thirty years, to the day, all of the LORD’s armies went out from the land of Egypt. **42** It is a night to be much observed to the LORD for bringing them out from the land of Egypt. This is that night of the LORD, to be much observed by all the children of Israel throughout their generations. **43** The LORD said to Moses and Aaron, “This is the ordinance of the Passover. No foreigner shall eat of it, **44** but every man’s servant who is bought for money, when you have circumcised him, then shall he eat of it. **45** A foreigner and a hired servant shall not eat of it. **46** It must be eaten in one house. You shall not carry any of the meat outside of the house. Do not break any of its bones. **47** All the congregation of Israel shall keep it. **48** When a stranger lives as a foreigner with you, and would like to keep the Passover to the LORD, let all his males be circumcised, and then let him come near and keep it. He shall be as one who is born in the land; but no uncircumcised person shall eat of it. **49** One law shall be to him who is born at home, and to the stranger who lives as a foreigner among you.” **50** All the children of Israel did so. As the LORD commanded Moses and Aaron, so they did. **51** That same day, the LORD brought the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt by their armies.

## Exodus 13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵאמֹר **2** קַדֶּשׁ־לִי כָל־בְּכוֹר פֶּטֶר כָּל־רֶחֶם בִּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּאָדָם וּבַבְּהֵמָה לִי
הוּא **3** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־הָעָם זָכוֹר אֶת־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר יְצָאתֶם מִמִּצְרַיִם מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים כִּי בְּחֹזֶק יָד
הוֹצִיא יְהוָה אֶתְכֶם מִזֶּה וְלֹא יֵאָכֵל חָמֵץ **4** הַיּוֹם אַתֶּם יֹצְאִים בְּחֹדֶשׁ הָאָבִיב **5** וְהָיָה כִּי־יְבִיאֲךָ יְהוָה
אֶל־אֶרֶץ הַכְּנַעֲנִי וְהַחִתִּי וְהָאֱמֹרִי וְהַחִוִּי וְהַיְבוּסִי אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ לָתֶת לְךָ אֶרֶץ זָבַת חָלָב
וּדְבָשׁ וְעָבַדְתָּ אֶת־הָעֲבֹדָה הַזֹּאת בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה **6** שִׁבְעַת יָמִים תֹּאכַל מַצּוֹת וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי חַג לַיהוָה **7**
מַצּוֹת יֵאָכֵל אֶת שִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים וְלֹא־יֵרָאֶה לְךָ חָמֵץ וְלֹא־יֵרָאֶה לְךָ שְׂאֹר בְּכָל־גְּבֻלֶךָ **8** וְהִגַּדְתָּ לְבִנְךָ
בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא לֵאמֹר בַּעֲבוּר זֶה עָשָׂה יְהוָה לִי בְּצֵאתִי מִמִּצְרָיִם **9** וְהָיָה לְךָ לְאוֹת עַל־יָדְךָ וּלְזִכָּרוֹן
בֵּין עֵינֶיךָ לְמַעַן תִּהְיֶה תּוֹרַת יְהוָה בְּפִיךָ כִּי בְיָד חֲזָקָה הוֹצִאֲךָ יְהוָה מִמִּצְרָיִם **10** וְשָׁמַרְתָּ אֶת־הַחֻקָּה
הַזֹּאת לְמוֹעֲדָהּ מִיָּמִים יָמִימָה **11** וְהָיָה כִּי־יְבִאֲךָ יְהוָה אֶל־אֶרֶץ הַכְּנַעֲנִי כַּאֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע לְךָ וְלַאֲבֹתֶיךָ
וּנְתָנָהּ לָךְ **12** וְהַעֲבַרְתָּ כָל־פֶּטֶר־רֶחֶם לַיהוָה וְכָל־פֶּטֶר שֶׁגֶר בְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר יִהְיֶה לְךָ הַזְּכָרִים לַיהוָה
**13** וְכָל־פֶּטֶר חֲמֹר תִּפְדֶּה בְשֶׂה וְאִם־לֹא תִפְדֶּה וַעֲרַפְתּוֹ וְכֹל בְּכוֹר אָדָם בְּבָנֶיךָ תִּפְדֶּה **14** וְהָיָה כִּי־
יִשְׁאָלְךָ בִנְךָ מָחָר לֵאמֹר מַה־זֹּאת וְאָמַרְתָּ אֵלָיו בְּחֹזֶק יָד הוֹצִיאָנוּ יְהוָה מִמִּצְרַיִם מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים
**15** וַיְהִי כִּי־הִקְשָׁה פַּרְעֹה לְשַׁלְּחֵנוּ וַיַּהַרֹג יְהוָה כָּל־בְּכוֹר בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם מִבְּכֹר אָדָם וְעַד־בְּכוֹר בְּהֵמָה
עַל־כֵּן אֲנִי זֹבֵחַ לַיהוָה כָּל־פֶּטֶר רֶחֶם הַזְּכָרִים וְכָל־בְּכוֹר בָּנַי אֶפְדֶּה **16** וְהָיָה לְאוֹת עַל־יָדְכָה
וּלְטוֹטָפֹת בֵּין עֵינֶיךָ כִּי בְּחֹזֶק יָד הוֹצִיאָנוּ יְהוָה מִמִּצְרָיִם **17** וַיְהִי בְּשַׁלַּח פַּרְעֹה אֶת־הָעָם וְלֹא־נָחָם
אֱלֹהִים דֶּרֶךְ אֶרֶץ פְּלִשְׁתִּים כִּי קָרוֹב הוּא כִּי אָמַר אֱלֹהִים פֶּן־יִנָּחֵם הָעָם בִּרְאֹתָם מִלְחָמָה וְשָׁבוּ
מִצְרַיְמָה **18** וַיַּסֵּב אֱלֹהִים אֶת־הָעָם דֶּרֶךְ הַמִּדְבָּר יַם־סוּף וַחֲמֻשִׁים עָלוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם
**19** וַיִּקַּח מֹשֶׁה אֶת־עַצְמוֹת יוֹסֵף עִמּוֹ כִּי הַשְׁבֵּעַ הִשְׁבִּיעַ אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר פָּקֹד יִפְקֹד אֱלֹהִים
אֶתְכֶם וְהַעֲלִיתֶם אֶת־עַצְמֹתַי מִזֶּה אִתְּכֶם **20** וַיִּסְעוּ מִסֻּכֹּת וַיַּחֲנוּ בְאֵתָם בִּקְצֵה הַמִּדְבָּר **21** וַיהוָה
הֹלֵךְ לִפְנֵיהֶם יוֹמָם בְּעַמּוּד עָנָן לַנְחֹתָם הַדֶּרֶךְ וְלַיְלָה בְּעַמּוּד אֵשׁ לְהָאִיר לָהֶם לָלֶכֶת יוֹמָם וָלָיְלָה
**22** לֹא־יָמִישׁ עַמּוּד הֶעָנָן יוֹמָם וְעַמּוּד הָאֵשׁ לָיְלָה לִפְנֵי הָעָם

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the LORD said to Moses, **2** “Consecrate to Me every firstborn male. The firstborn from every womb among the Israelites belongs to Me, both of man and beast.” **3** So Moses told the people, “Remember this day, the day you came out of Egypt, out of the house of slavery; for the LORD brought you out of it by the strength of His hand. And nothing leavened shall be eaten. **4** Today, in the month of Abib, you are leaving. **5** And when the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanites, Hittites, Amorites, Hivites, and Jebusites—the land He swore to your fathers that He would give you, a land flowing with milk and honey—you shall keep this service in this month. **6** For seven days you are to eat unleavened bread, and on the seventh day there shall be a feast to the LORD. **7** Unleavened bread shall be eaten during those seven days. Nothing leavened may be found among you, nor shall leaven be found anywhere within your borders. **8** And on that day you are to explain to your son, ‘This is because of what the LORD did for me when I came out of Egypt.’ **9** It shall be a sign for you on your hand and a reminder on your forehead that the Law of the LORD is to be on your lips. For with a mighty hand the LORD brought you out of Egypt. **10** Therefore you shall keep this statute at the appointed time year after year. **11** And after the LORD brings you into the land of the

Canaanites and gives it to you, as He swore to you and your fathers, **12** you are to present to the LORD the firstborn male of every womb. All the firstborn males of your livestock belong to the LORD. **13** You must redeem every firstborn donkey with a lamb, and if you do not redeem it, you are to break its neck. And every firstborn of your sons you must redeem. **14** In the future, when your son asks you, 'What does this mean?' you are to tell him, 'With a mighty hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt, out of the house of slavery. **15** And when Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, the LORD killed every firstborn in the land of Egypt, both of man and beast. This is why I sacrifice to the LORD the firstborn male of every womb, but I redeem all the firstborn of my sons.' **16** So it shall serve as a sign on your hand and a symbol on your forehead, for with a mighty hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt." **17** When Pharaoh let the people go, God did not lead them along the road through the land of the Philistines, though it was shorter. For God said, "If the people face war, they might change their minds and return to Egypt." **18** So God led the people around by the way of the wilderness toward the Red Sea. And the Israelites left the land of Egypt arrayed for battle. **19** Moses took the bones of Joseph with him because Joseph had made the sons of Israel swear a solemn oath when he said, "God will surely attend to you, and then you must carry my bones with you from this place." **20** They set out from Succoth and camped at Etham on the edge of the wilderness. **21** And the LORD went before them in a pillar of cloud to guide their way by day, and in a pillar of fire to give them light by night, so that they could travel by day or night. **22** Neither the pillar of cloud by day nor the pillar of fire by night left its place before the people.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **2** "Sanctify to me all the firstborn, whatever opens the womb among the children of Israel, both of man and of animal. It is mine." **3** Moses said to the people, "Remember this day, in which you came out of Egypt, out of the house of bondage; for by strength of hand the LORD brought you out from this place. No leavened bread shall be eaten. **4** Today you go out in the month Abib. **5** It shall be, when the LORD brings you into the land of the Canaanite, and the Hittite, and the Amorite, and the Hivite, and the Jebusite, which he swore to your fathers to give you, a land flowing with milk and honey, that you shall keep this service in this month. **6** Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, and in the seventh day shall be a feast to the LORD. **7** Unleavened bread shall be eaten throughout the seven days; and no leavened bread shall be seen with you. No yeast shall be seen with you, within all your borders. **8** You shall tell your son in that day, saying, 'It is because of that which the LORD did for me when I came out of Egypt.' **9** It shall be for a sign to you on your hand, and for a memorial between your eyes, that the LORD's law may be in your mouth; for with a strong hand the LORD has brought you out of Egypt. **10** You shall therefore keep this ordinance in its season from year to year. **11** "It shall be, when the LORD brings you into the

land of the Canaanite, as he swore to you and to your fathers, and will give it to you, **12** that you shall set apart to the LORD all that opens the womb, and every firstborn that comes from an animal which you have. The males shall be the LORD's. **13** Every firstborn of a donkey you shall redeem with a lamb; and if you will not redeem it, then you shall break its neck; and you shall redeem all the firstborn of man among your sons. **14** It shall be, when your son asks you in time to come, saying, 'What is this?' that you shall tell him, 'By strength of hand the LORD brought us out from Egypt, from the house of bondage. **15** When Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, the LORD killed all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man, and the firstborn of livestock. Therefore I sacrifice to the LORD all that opens the womb, being males; but all the firstborn of my sons I redeem.' **16** It shall be for a sign on your hand, and for symbols between your eyes; for by strength of hand the LORD brought us out of Egypt." **17** When Pharaoh had let the people go, God didn't lead them by the way of the land of the Philistines, although that was near; for God said, "Lest perhaps the people change their minds when they see war, and they return to Egypt"; **18** but God led the people around by the way of the wilderness by the Red Sea; and the children of Israel went up armed out of the land of Egypt. **19** Moses took the bones of Joseph with him, for he had made the children of Israel swear, saying, "God will surely visit you, and you shall carry up my bones away from here with you." **20** They took their journey from Succoth, and encamped in Etham, in the edge of the wilderness. **21** The LORD went before them by day in a pillar of cloud, to lead them on their way, and by night in a pillar of fire, to give them light, that they might go by day and by night: **22** the pillar of cloud by day, and the pillar of fire by night, didn't depart from before the people.

## Exodus 14

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵאמֹר **2** דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיָשֻׁבוּ וְיַחֲנוּ לִפְנֵי פִּי הַחִירֹת בֵּין מִגְדֹּל וּבֵין
הַיָּם לִפְנֵי בַּעַל צְפֹן נִכְחוֹ תַּחֲנוּ עַל־הַיָּם **3** וְאָמַר פַּרְעֹה לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל נְבֻכִים הֵם בָּאָרֶץ סָגַר עֲלֵיהֶם
הַמִּדְבָּר **4** וְחִזַּקְתִּי אֶת־לֵב־פַּרְעֹה וְוְרַדַף אַחֲרֵיהֶם וְאִכָּבְדָה בְּפַרְעֹה וּבְכָל־חֵילוֹ וְיָדְעוּ מִצְרַיִם כִּי־
אֲנִי יְהוָה וַיַּעֲשׂוּ־כֵן **5** וַיֻּגַּד לְמֶלֶךְ מִצְרַיִם כִּי בָרַח הָעָם וַיֵּהָפֵךְ לְבַב פַּרְעֹה וַעֲבָדָיו אֶל־הָעָם
וַיֹּאמְרוּ מַה־זֹּאת עָשִׂינוּ כִּי־שִׁלַּחְנוּ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵעָבְדֵנוּ **6** וַיֶּאְסֹר אֶת־רִכְבּוֹ וְאֶת־עַמּוֹ לָקַח עִמּוֹ **7**
וַיִּקַּח שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת רֶכֶב בָּחוּר וְכֹל רֶכֶב מִצְרָיִם וְשָׁלִשִׁם עַל־כֻּלּוֹ **8** וַיְחַזֵּק יְהוָה אֶת־לֵב פַּרְעֹה מֶלֶךְ
מִצְרַיִם וַיִּרְדֹּף אַחֲרֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל יֹצְאִים בְּיָד רָמָה **9** וַיִּרְדְּפוּ מִצְרַיִם אַחֲרֵיהֶם וַיַּשִּׂגוּ
אוֹתָם חֹנִים עַל־הַיָּם כָּל־סוּס רֶכֶב פַּרְעֹה וּפָרָשָׁיו וְחֵילוֹ עַל־פִּי הַחִירֹת לִפְנֵי בַּעַל צְפֹן **10** וּפַרְעֹה
הִקְרִיב וַיִּשְׂאוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־עֵינֵיהֶם וְהִנֵּה מִצְרַיִם נֹסֵעַ אַחֲרֵיהֶם וַיִּירְאוּ מְאֹד וַיִּצְעֲקוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל
אֶל־יְהוָה **11** וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֶל־מֹשֶׁה הֲמִבְּלִי אֵין־קְבָרִים בְּמִצְרַיִם לְקַחְתָּנוּ לָמוּת בַּמִּדְבָּר מַה־זֹּאת עָשִׂיתָ
לָּנוּ לְהוֹצִיאֵנוּ מִמִּצְרָיִם **12** הֲלֹא־זֶה הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְנוּ אֵלֶיךָ בְמִצְרַיִם לֵאמֹר חֲדַל מִמֶּנּוּ וְנַעַבְדָה
אֶת־מִצְרַיִם כִּי טוֹב לָנוּ עָבֹד אֶת־מִצְרַיִם מִמֻּתֵנוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר **13** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־הָעָם אַל־תִּירָאוּ

הִתְנַצְּבוּ וּרְאוּ אֶת־יְשׁוּעַת יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂה לָכֶם הַיּוֹם כִּי אֲשֶׁר רְאִיתֶם אֶת־מִצְרַיִם הַיּוֹם לֹא תֹסִיפוּ
לִרְאֹתָם עוֹד עַד־עוֹלָם **14** יְהוָה יִלָּחֶם לָכֶם וְאַתֶּם תַּחֲרִישׁוּן **15** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה מַה־תִּצְעַק
אֵלָי דַּבֵּר אֶל־בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיִסָּעוּ **16** וְאַתָּה הָרֵם אֶת־מַטְּךָ וּנְטֵה אֶת־יָדְךָ עַל־הַיָּם וּבְקָעֵהוּ וְיָבֹאוּ
בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּתוֹךְ הַיָּם בַּיַּבָּשָׁה **17** וַאֲנִי הִנְנִי מְחַזֵּק אֶת־לֵב מִצְרַיִם וְיָבֹאוּ אַחֲרֵיהֶם וְאִכָּבְדָה בְּפַרְעֹה
וּבְכָל־חֵילוֹ בְּרִכְבּוֹ וּבְפָרָשָׁיו **18** וְיָדְעוּ מִצְרַיִם כִּי־אֲנִי יְהוָה בְּהִכָּבְדִי בְּפַרְעֹה בְּרִכְבּוֹ וּבְפָרָשָׁיו **19**
וַיִּסַּע מַלְאַךְ הָאֱלֹהִים הַהֹלֵךְ לִפְנֵי מַחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֵּלֶךְ מֵאֲחֵרֵיהֶם וַיִּסַּע עַמּוּד הֶעָנָן מִפְּנֵיהֶם וַיַּעֲמֹד
מֵאֲחֵרֵיהֶם **20** וַיָּבֹא בֵּין מַחֲנֵה מִצְרַיִם וּבֵין מַחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיְהִי הֶעָנָן וְהַחֹשֶׁךְ וַיָּאֶר אֶת־הַלָּיְלָה וְלֹא־
קָרַב זֶה אֶל־זֶה כָּל־הַלָּיְלָה **21** וַיֵּט מֹשֶׁה אֶת־יָדוֹ עַל־הַיָּם וַיּוֹלֶךְ יְהוָה אֶת־הַיָּם בְּרוּחַ קָדִים עַזָּה
כָּל־הַלָּיְלָה וַיָּשֶׂם אֶת־הַיָּם לֶחָרָבָה וַיִּבָּקְעוּ הַמָּיִם **22** וַיָּבֹאוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּתוֹךְ הַיָּם בַּיַּבָּשָׁה וְהַמַּיִם
לָהֶם חֹמָה מִימִינָם וּמִשְׂמֹאלָם **23** וַיִּרְדְּפוּ מִצְרַיִם וַיָּבֹאוּ אַחֲרֵיהֶם כֹּל סוּס פַּרְעֹה רִכְבּוֹ וּפָרָשָׁיו אֶל־
תּוֹךְ הַיָּם **24** וַיְהִי בְּאַשְׁמֹרֶת הַבֹּקֶר וַיַּשְׁקֵף יְהוָה אֶל־מַחֲנֵה מִצְרַיִם בְּעַמּוּד אֵשׁ וְעָנָן וַיָּהָם אֵת מַחֲנֵה
מִצְרָיִם **25** וַיָּסַר אֵת אֹפַן מַרְכְּבֹתָיו וַיְנַהֲגֵהוּ בִּכְבֵדֻת וַיֹּאמֶר מִצְרַיִם אָנוּסָה מִפְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כִּי יְהוָה
נִלָּחֶם לָהֶם בְּמִצְרָיִם **26** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה נְטֵה אֶת־יָדְךָ עַל־הַיָּם וְיָשֻׁבוּ הַמַּיִם עַל־מִצְרַיִם עַל־
רִכְבּוֹ וְעַל־פָּרָשָׁיו **27** וַיֵּט מֹשֶׁה אֶת־יָדוֹ עַל־הַיָּם וַיָּשָׁב הַיָּם לִפְנוֹת בֹּקֶר לְאֵיתָנוֹ וּמִצְרַיִם נָסִים
לִקְרָאתוֹ וַיְנַעֵר יְהוָה אֶת־מִצְרַיִם בְּתוֹךְ הַיָּם **28** וַיָּשֻׁבוּ הַמַּיִם וַיְכַסּוּ אֶת־הָרֶכֶב וְאֶת־הַפָּרָשִׁים לְכֹל
חֵיל פַּרְעֹה הַבָּאִים אַחֲרֵיהֶם בַּיָּם לֹא־נִשְׁאַר בָּהֶם עַד־אֶחָד **29** וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הָלְכוּ בַיַּבָּשָׁה בְּתוֹךְ הַיָּם
וְהַמַּיִם לָהֶם חֹמָה מִימִינָם וּמִשְׂמֹאלָם **30** וַיּוֹשַׁע יְהוָה בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִיַּד מִצְרָיִם וַיַּרְא
יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־מִצְרַיִם מֵת עַל־שְׂפַת הַיָּם **31** וַיַּרְא יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הַיָּד הַגְּדֹלָה אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה יְהוָה בְּמִצְרַיִם
וַיִּירְאוּ הָעָם אֶת־יְהוָה וַיַּאֲמִינוּ בַּיהוָה וּבְמֹשֶׁה עַבְדּוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the LORD said to Moses, **2** “Tell the Israelites to turn back and encamp before Pi-hahiroth, between Migdol and the sea. You are to encamp by the sea, directly opposite Baal-zephon. **3** For Pharaoh will say of the Israelites, ‘They are wandering the land in confusion; the wilderness has boxed them in.’ **4** And I will harden Pharaoh’s heart so that he will pursue them. But I will gain honor by means of Pharaoh and all his army, and the Egyptians will know that I am the LORD.” So this is what the Israelites did. **5** When the king of Egypt was told that the people had fled, Pharaoh and his officials changed their minds about them and said, “What have we done? We have released Israel from serving us.” **6** So Pharaoh prepared his chariot and took his army with him. **7** He took 600 of the best chariots, and all the other chariots of Egypt, with officers over all of them. **8** And the LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt so that he pursued the Israelites, who were marching out defiantly. **9** The Egyptians—all Pharaoh’s horses and chariots, horsemen and troops—pursued the Israelites and overtook them as they camped by the sea near Pi-hahiroth, opposite Baal-zephon. **10** As Pharaoh approached, the Israelites looked up and saw the Egyptians marching after them, and they were terrified and cried out to the LORD. **11** They said to Moses, “Was it because there were no graves in Egypt that you brought us into the wilderness to die? What have you done to us by bringing us out of Egypt? **12** Did we not say to you in Egypt,

‘Leave us alone so that we may serve the Egyptians’? For it would have been better for us to serve the Egyptians than to die in the wilderness.” **13** But Moses told the people, “Do not be afraid. Stand firm and you will see the LORD’s salvation, which He will accomplish for you today; for the Egyptians you see today, you will never see again. **14** The LORD will fight for you; you need only to be still.” **15** Then the LORD said to Moses, “Why are you crying out to Me? Tell the Israelites to go forward. **16** And as for you, lift up your staff and stretch out your hand over the sea and divide it, so that the Israelites can go through the sea on dry ground. **17** And I will harden the hearts of the Egyptians so that they will go in after them. Then I will gain honor by means of Pharaoh and all his army and chariots and horsemen. **18** The Egyptians will know that I am the LORD when I am honored through Pharaoh, his chariots, and his horsemen.” **19** And the angel of God, who had gone before the camp of Israel, withdrew and went behind them. The pillar of cloud also moved from before them and stood behind them, **20** so that it came between the camps of Egypt and Israel. The cloud was there in the darkness, but it lit up the night. So all night long neither camp went near the other. **21** Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and all that night the LORD drove back the sea with a strong east wind that turned it into dry land. So the waters were divided, **22** and the Israelites went through the sea on dry ground, with walls of water on their right and on their left. **23** And the Egyptians chased after them—all Pharaoh’s horses, chariots, and horsemen—and followed them into the sea. **24** At morning watch, however, the LORD looked down on the army of the Egyptians from the pillar of fire and cloud, and He threw their camp into confusion. **25** He caused their chariot wheels to wobble, so that they had difficulty driving. “Let us flee from the Israelites,” said the Egyptians, “for the LORD is fighting for them against Egypt!” **26** Then the LORD said to Moses, “Stretch out your hand over the sea, so that the waters may flow back over the Egyptians and their chariots and horsemen.” **27** So Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and at daybreak the sea returned to its normal state. As the Egyptians were retreating, the LORD swept them into the sea. **28** The waters flowed back and covered the chariots and horsemen—the entire army of Pharaoh that had chased the Israelites into the sea. Not one of them survived. **29** But the Israelites had walked through the sea on dry ground, with walls of water on their right and on their left. **30** That day the LORD saved Israel from the hand of the Egyptians, and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the shore. **31** When Israel saw the great power that the LORD had exercised over the Egyptians, the people feared the LORD and believed in Him and in His servant Moses.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **2** “Speak to the children of Israel, that they turn back and encamp before Pihahiroth, between Migdol and the sea, before Baal Zephon. You shall encamp opposite it by the sea. **3** Pharaoh will

say of the children of Israel, ‘They are entangled in the land. The wilderness has shut them in.’ **4** I will harden Pharaoh’s heart, and he will follow after them; and I will get honor over Pharaoh, and over all his armies; and the Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD.” They did so. **5** The king of Egypt was told that the people had fled; and the heart of Pharaoh and of his servants was changed toward the people, and they said, “What is this we have done, that we have let Israel go from serving us?” **6** He prepared his chariot, and took his army with him; **7** and he took six hundred chosen chariots, and all the chariots of Egypt, with captains over all of them. **8** The LORD hardened the heart of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he pursued the children of Israel; for the children of Israel went out with a high hand. **9** The Egyptians pursued them. All the horses and chariots of Pharaoh, his horsemen, and his army overtook them encamping by the sea, beside Pihahiroth, before Baal Zephon. **10** When Pharaoh came near, the children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and behold, the Egyptians were marching after them; and they were very afraid. The children of Israel cried out to the LORD. **11** They said to Moses, “Because there were no graves in Egypt, have you taken us away to die in the wilderness? Why have you treated us this way, to bring us out of Egypt? **12** Isn’t this the word that we spoke to you in Egypt, saying, ‘Leave us alone, that we may serve the Egyptians’? For it would have been better for us to serve the Egyptians than to die in the wilderness.” **13** Moses said to the people, “Don’t be afraid. Stand still, and see the salvation of the LORD, which he will work for you today; for you will never again see the Egyptians whom you have seen today. **14** The LORD will fight for you, and you shall be still.” **15** The LORD said to Moses, “Why do you cry to me? Speak to the children of Israel, that they go forward. **16** Lift up your rod, and stretch out your hand over the sea and divide it. Then the children of Israel shall go into the middle of the sea on dry ground. **17** Behold, I myself will harden the hearts of the Egyptians, and they will go in after them. I will get myself honor over Pharaoh, and over all his armies, over his chariots, and over his horsemen. **18** The Egyptians shall know that I am the LORD when I have gotten myself honor over Pharaoh, over his chariots, and over his horsemen.” **19** The angel of God, who went before the camp of Israel, moved and went behind them; and the pillar of cloud moved from before them, and stood behind them. **20** It came between the camp of Egypt and the camp of Israel. There was the cloud and the darkness, yet it gave light by night. One didn’t come near the other all night. **21** Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and the LORD caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all night, and made the sea dry land, and the waters were divided. **22** The children of Israel went into the middle of the sea on the dry ground; and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left. **23** The Egyptians pursued, and went in after them into the middle of the sea: all of Pharaoh’s horses, his chariots, and his horsemen. **24** In the morning watch, the LORD looked out on the Egyptian army through the pillar of fire and of cloud, and confused the Egyptian army. **25** He took off their chariot wheels, and they drove them heavily; so that the Egyptians said, “Let’s flee from the

face of Israel, for the LORD fights for them against the Egyptians!” **26** The LORD said to Moses, “Stretch out your hand over the sea, that the waters may come again on the Egyptians, on their chariots, and on their horsemen.” **27** Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and the sea returned to its strength when the morning appeared; and the Egyptians fled against it. The LORD overthrew the Egyptians in the middle of the sea. **28** The waters returned, and covered the chariots and the horsemen, even all Pharaoh’s army that went in after them into the sea. There remained not so much as one of them. **29** But the children of Israel walked on dry land in the middle of the sea, and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left. **30** Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the seashore. **31** Israel saw the great work which the LORD did to the Egyptians, and the people feared the LORD; and they believed in the LORD and in his servant Moses.

## Exodus 16

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיִּסְעוּ מֵאֵילִם וַיָּבֹאוּ כָּל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶל־מִדְבַּר־סִין אֲשֶׁר בֵּין־אֵילִם וּבֵין סִינָי בַּחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר
יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי לְצֵאתָם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם **2** וילינו כָּל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל־מֹשֶׁה וְעַל־אַהֲרֹן בַּמִּדְבָּר
**3** וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֲלֵהֶם בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִי־יִתֵּן מוּתֵנוּ בְיַד־יְהוָה בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בְּשִׁבְתֵּנוּ עַל־סִיר הַבָּשָׂר
בְּאָכְלֵנוּ לֶחֶם לָשֹׂבַע כִּי־הוֹצֵאתֶם אֹתָנוּ אֶל־הַמִּדְבָּר הַזֶּה לְהָמִית אֶת־כָּל־הַקָּהָל הַזֶּה בָּרָעָב **4** וַיֹּאמֶר
יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה הִנְנִי מַמְטִיר לָכֶם לֶחֶם מִן־הַשָּׁמָיִם וְיָצָא הָעָם וְלָקְטוּ דְּבַר־יוֹם בְּיוֹמוֹ לְמַעַן אֲנַסֶּנּוּ
הֲיֵלֵךְ בְּתוֹרָתִי אִם־לֹא **5** וְהָיָה בַּיּוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי וְהֵכִינוּ אֵת אֲשֶׁר־יָבִיאוּ וְהָיָה מִשְׁנֶה עַל אֲשֶׁר־יִלְקְטוּ יוֹם
יוֹם **6** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן אֶל־כָּל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל עֶרֶב וִידַעְתֶּם כִּי יְהוָה הוֹצִיא אֶתְכֶם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם **7**
וּבֹקֶר וּרְאִיתֶם אֶת־כְּבוֹד יְהוָה בְּשָׁמְעוֹ אֶת־תְּלֻנֹּתֵיכֶם עַל־יְהוָה וְנַחְנוּ מָה כִּי תלונו עָלֵינוּ **8** וַיֹּאמֶר
מֹשֶׁה בְּתֵת יְהוָה לָכֶם בָּעֶרֶב בָּשָׂר לֶאֱכֹל וְלֶחֶם בַּבֹּקֶר לִשְׂבֹּעַ בִּשְׁמֹעַ יְהוָה אֶת־תְּלֻנֹּתֵיכֶם אֲשֶׁר־אַתֶּם
מַלִּינִם עָלָיו וְנַחְנוּ מָה לֹא־עָלֵינוּ תְּלֻנֹּתֵיכֶם כִּי עַל־יְהוָה **9** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־אַהֲרֹן אֱמֹר אֶל־כָּל־
עֲדַת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל קִרְבוּ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה כִּי שָׁמַע אֶת תְּלֻנֹּתֵיכֶם **10** וַיְהִי כְּדַבֵּר אַהֲרֹן אֶל־כָּל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־
יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּפְנוּ אֶל־הַמִּדְבָּר וְהִנֵּה כְּבוֹד יְהוָה נִרְאָה בֶּעָנָן **11** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵּאמֹר **12** שָׁמַעְתִּי
אֶת־תְּלוּנֹּת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל דַּבֵּר אֲלֵהֶם לֵאמֹר בֵּין הָעַרְבַּיִם תֹּאכְלוּ בָשָׂר וּבַבֹּקֶר תִּשְׂבְּעוּ־לָחֶם וִידַעְתֶּם
כִּי אֲנִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם **13** וַיְהִי בָעֶרֶב וַתַּעַל הַשְּׂלָו וַתְּכַס אֶת־הַמַּחֲנֶה וּבַבֹּקֶר הָיְתָה שִׁכְבַת הַטַּל
סָבִיב לַמַּחֲנֶה **14** וַתַּעַל שִׁכְבַת הַטָּל וְהִנֵּה עַל־פְּנֵי הַמִּדְבָּר דַּק מְחֻסְפָּס דַּק כַּכְּפֹר עַל־הָאָרֶץ **15**
וַיִּרְאוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמְרוּ אִישׁ אֶל־אָחִיו מָן הוּא כִּי לֹא יָדְעוּ מַה־הוּא וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֲלֵהֶם הוּא
הַלֶּחֶם אֲשֶׁר נָתַן יְהוָה לָכֶם לְאָכְלָה **16** זֶה הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה לִקְטוּ מִמֶּנּוּ אִישׁ לְפִי אָכְלוֹ עֹמֶר
לַגֻּלְגֹּלֶת מִסְפַּר נַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶם אִישׁ לַאֲשֶׁר בְּאָהֳלוֹ תִּקָּחוּ **17** וַיַּעֲשׂוּ־כֵן בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּלְקְטוּ הַמַּרְבֶּה
וְהַמַּמְעִיט **18** וַיְמַדּוּ בָעֹמֶר וְלֹא הֶעְדִּיף הַמַּרְבֶּה וְהַמַּמְעִיט לֹא הֶחְסִיר אִישׁ לְפִי־אָכְלוֹ לָקָטוּ **19**
וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֲלֵהֶם אִישׁ אַל־יוֹתֵר מִמֶּנּוּ עַד־בֹּקֶר **20** וְלֹא־שָׁמְעוּ אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וַיּוֹתִרוּ אֲנָשִׁים מִמֶּנּוּ עַד־
בֹּקֶר וַיָּרֻם תּוֹלָעִים וַיְבְאַשׁ וַיִּקְצֹף עֲלֵהֶם מֹשֶׁה **21** וַיִּלְקְטוּ אֹתוֹ בַּבֹּקֶר בַּבֹּקֶר אִישׁ כְּפִי אָכְלוֹ וְחַם
הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְנָמָס **22** וַיְהִי בַּיּוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי לָקְטוּ לֶחֶם מִשְׁנֶה שְׁנֵי הָעֹמֶר לָאֶחָד וַיָּבֹאוּ כָּל־נְשִׂיאֵי הָעֵדָה וַיַּגִּידוּ
לְמֹשֶׁה **23** וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵהֶם הוּא אֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יְהוָה שַׁבָּתוֹן שַׁבַּת־קֹדֶשׁ לַיהוָה מָחָר אֵת אֲשֶׁר־תֹּאפוּ אֵפוּ

וְאֵת אֲשֶׁר־תְּבַשְּׁלוּ בַּשֵּׁלוּ וְאֵת כָּל־הָעֹדֵף הַנִּיחוּ לָכֶם לְמִשְׁמֶרֶת עַד־הַבֹּקֶר **24** וַיַּנִּיחוּ אֹתוֹ עַד־הַבֹּקֶר
כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה מֹשֶׁה וְלֹא הִבְאִישׁ וְרִמָּה לֹא־הָיְתָה בּוֹ **25** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אִכְלֻהוּ הַיּוֹם כִּי־שַׁבָּת הַיּוֹם לַיהוָה
הַיּוֹם לֹא תִמְצָאֻהוּ בַּשָּׂדֶה **26** שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים תִּלְקְטֻהוּ וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שַׁבָּת לֹא יִהְיֶה־בּוֹ **27** וַיְהִי בַּיּוֹם
הַשְּׁבִיעִי יָצְאוּ מִן־הָעָם לִלְקֹט וְלֹא מָצָאוּ **28** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה עַד־אָנָה מֵאַנְתֶּם לִשְׁמֹר מִצְוֹתַי
וְתוֹרֹתָי **29** רְאוּ כִּי־יְהוָה נָתַן לָכֶם הַשַּׁבָּת עַל־כֵּן הוּא נֹתֵן לָכֶם בַּיּוֹם הַשִּׁשִּׁי לֶחֶם יוֹמַיִם שְׁבוּ אִישׁ
תַּחְתָּיו אַל־יֵצֵא אִישׁ מִמְּקֹמוֹ בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **30** וַיִּשְׁבְּתוּ הָעָם בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִעִי **31** וַיִּקְרְאוּ בֵית־יִשְׂרָאֵל
אֶת־שְׁמוֹ מָן וְהוּא כְּזֶרַע גַּד לָבָן וְטַעְמוֹ כְּצַפִּיחִת בִּדְבָשׁ **32** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה זֶה הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה
מְלֹא הָעֹמֶר מִמֶּנּוּ לְמִשְׁמֶרֶת לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם לְמַעַן יִרְאוּ אֶת־הַלֶּחֶם אֲשֶׁר הֶאֱכַלְתִּי אֶתְכֶם בַּמִּדְבָּר
בְּהוֹצִיאִי אֶתְכֶם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם **33** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־אַהֲרֹן קַח צִנְצֶנֶת אַחַת וְתֶן־שָׁמָּה מְלֹא־הָעֹמֶר מָן
וְהַנַּח אֹתוֹ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה לְמִשְׁמֶרֶת לְדֹרֹתֵיכֶם **34** כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וַיַּנִּיחֵהוּ אַהֲרֹן לִפְנֵי הָעֵדֻת
לְמִשְׁמֶרֶת **35** וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אָכְלוּ אֶת־הַמָּן אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה עַד־בֹּאָם אֶל־אֶרֶץ נוֹשָׁבֶת אֶת־הַמָּן אָכְלוּ
עַד־בֹּאָם אֶל־קְצֵה אֶרֶץ כְּנָעַן **36** וְהָעֹמֶר עֶשִׂרִית הָאֵיפָה הוּא

*English (BSB)*

**1** On the fifteenth day of the second month after they had left the land of Egypt, the whole congregation of Israel set out from Elim and came to the Desert of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai. **2** And there in the desert they all grumbled against Moses and Aaron. **3** “If only we had died by the LORD’s hand in the land of Egypt!” they said. “There we sat by pots of meat and ate our fill of bread, but you have brought us into this desert to starve this whole assembly to death!” **4** Then the LORD said to Moses, “Behold, I will rain down bread from heaven for you. Each day the people are to go out and gather enough for that day. In this way I will test whether or not they will follow My instructions. **5** Then on the sixth day, when they prepare what they bring in, it will be twice as much as they gather on the other days.” **6** So Moses and Aaron said to all the Israelites, “This evening you will know that it was the LORD who brought you out of the land of Egypt, **7** and in the morning you will see the LORD’s glory, because He has heard your grumbling against Him. For who are we that you should grumble against us?” **8** And Moses added, “The LORD will give you meat to eat this evening and bread to fill you in the morning, for He has heard your grumbling against Him. Who are we? Your grumblings are not against us but against the LORD.” **9** Then Moses said to Aaron, “Tell the whole congregation of Israel, ‘Come before the LORD, for He has heard your grumbling.’” **10** And as Aaron was speaking to the whole congregation of Israel, they looked toward the desert, and there in a cloud the glory of the LORD appeared. **11** Then the LORD said to Moses, **12** “I have heard the grumbling of the Israelites. Tell them, ‘At twilight you will eat meat, and in the morning you will be filled with bread. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God.’” **13** That evening quail came and covered the camp, and in the morning there was a layer of dew around the camp. **14** When the layer of dew had evaporated, there were thin flakes on the desert floor, as fine as frost on the ground. **15** When the Israelites saw it, they asked one another,

“What is it?” For they did not know what it was. So Moses told them, “It is the bread that the LORD has given you to eat. **16** This is what the LORD has commanded: ‘Each one is to gather as much as he needs. You may take an omer for each person in your tent.’” **17** So the Israelites did this. Some gathered more, and some less. **18** When they measured it by the omer, he who gathered much had no excess, and he who gathered little had no shortfall. Each one gathered as much as he needed to eat. **19** Then Moses said to them, “No one may keep any of it until morning.” **20** But they did not listen to Moses; some people left part of it until morning, and it became infested with maggots and began to smell. So Moses was angry with them. **21** Every morning each one gathered as much as was needed, and when the sun grew hot, it melted away. **22** On the sixth day, they gathered twice as much food—two omers per person —and all the leaders of the congregation came and reported this to Moses. **23** He told them, “This is what the LORD has said: ‘Tomorrow is to be a day of complete rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD. So bake what you want to bake, and boil what you want to boil. Then set aside whatever remains and keep it until morning.’” **24** So they set it aside until morning as Moses had commanded, and it did not smell or contain any maggots. **25** “Eat it today,” Moses said, “because today is a Sabbath to the LORD. Today you will not find anything in the field. **26** For six days you may gather, but on the seventh day, the Sabbath, it will not be there.” **27** Yet on the seventh day some of the people went out to gather, but they did not find anything. **28** Then the LORD said to Moses, “How long will you refuse to keep My commandments and instructions? **29** Understand that the LORD has given you the Sabbath; that is why on the sixth day He will give you bread for two days. On the seventh day, everyone must stay where he is; no one may leave his place.” **30** So the people rested on the seventh day. **31** Now the house of Israel called the bread manna. It was white like coriander seed and tasted like wafers made with honey. **32** Moses said, “This is what the LORD has commanded: ‘Keep an omer of manna for the generations to come, so that they may see the bread I fed you in the wilderness when I brought you out of the land of Egypt.’” **33** So Moses told Aaron, “Take a jar and fill it with an omer of manna. Then place it before the LORD to be preserved for the generations to come.” **34** And Aaron placed it in front of the Testimony, to be preserved just as the LORD had commanded Moses. **35** The Israelites ate manna forty years, until they came to a land where they could settle; they ate manna until they reached the border of Canaan. **36** (Now an omer is a tenth of an ephah.)

*English (WEB)*

**1** They took their journey from Elim, and all the congregation of the children of Israel came to the wilderness of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai, on the fifteenth day of the second month after their departing out of the land of Egypt. **2** The whole congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron in the wilderness; **3** and the children of Israel said to

them, “We wish that we had died by the LORD’s hand in the land of Egypt, when we sat by the meat pots, when we ate our fill of bread, for you have brought us out into this wilderness to kill this whole assembly with hunger.” **4** Then the LORD said to Moses, “Behold, I will rain bread from the sky for you, and the people shall go out and gather a day’s portion every day, that I may test them, whether they will walk in my law or not. **5** It shall come to pass on the sixth day, that they shall prepare that which they bring in, and it shall be twice as much as they gather daily.” **6** Moses and Aaron said to all the children of Israel, “At evening, you shall know that the LORD has brought you out from the land of Egypt. **7** In the morning, you shall see the LORD’s glory; because he hears your murmurings against the LORD. Who are we, that you murmur against us?” **8** Moses said, “Now the LORD will give you meat to eat in the evening, and in the morning bread to satisfy you, because the LORD hears your murmurings which you murmur against him. And who are we? Your murmurings are not against us, but against the LORD.” **9** Moses said to Aaron, “Tell all the congregation of the children of Israel, ‘Come close to the LORD, for he has heard your murmurings.’” **10** As Aaron spoke to the whole congregation of the children of Israel, they looked toward the wilderness, and behold, the LORD’s glory appeared in the cloud. **11** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **12** “I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel. Speak to them, saying, ‘At evening you shall eat meat, and in the morning you shall be filled with bread. Then you will know that I am the LORD your God.’” **13** In the evening, quail came up and covered the camp; and in the morning the dew lay around the camp. **14** When the dew that lay had gone, behold, on the surface of the wilderness was a small round thing, small as the frost on the ground. **15** When the children of Israel saw it, they said to one another, “What is it?” For they didn’t know what it was. Moses said to them, “It is the bread which the LORD has given you to eat. **16** This is the thing which the LORD has commanded: ‘Gather of it everyone according to his eating; an omer a head, according to the number of your persons, you shall take it, every man for those who are in his tent.’” **17** The children of Israel did so, and some gathered more, some less. **18** When they measured it with an omer, he who gathered much had nothing over, and he who gathered little had no lack. They each gathered according to his eating. **19** Moses said to them, “Let no one leave of it until the morning.” **20** Notwithstanding they didn’t listen to Moses, but some of them left of it until the morning, so it bred worms and became foul; and Moses was angry with them. **21** They gathered it morning by morning, everyone according to his eating. When the sun grew hot, it melted. **22** On the sixth day, they gathered twice as much bread, two omers for each one; and all the rulers of the congregation came and told Moses. **23** He said to them, “This is that which the LORD has spoken, ‘Tomorrow is a solemn rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD. Bake that which you want to bake, and boil that which you want to boil; and all that remains over lay up for yourselves to be kept until the morning.’” **24** They laid it up until the morning, as Moses ordered, and it didn’t become foul, and there were no worms in it. **25** Moses said, “Eat

that today, for today is a Sabbath to the LORD. Today you shall not find it in the field. **26** Six days you shall gather it, but on the seventh day is the Sabbath. In it there shall be none." **27** On the seventh day, some of the people went out to gather, and they found none. **28** The LORD said to Moses, "How long do you refuse to keep my commandments and my laws? **29** Behold, because the LORD has given you the Sabbath, therefore he gives you on the sixth day the bread of two days. Everyone stay in his place. Let no one go out of his place on the seventh day." **30** So the people rested on the seventh day. **31** The house of Israel called its name "Manna", and it was like coriander seed, white; and its taste was like wafers with honey. **32** Moses said, "This is the thing which the LORD has commanded, 'Let an omer-full of it be kept throughout your generations, that they may see the bread with which I fed you in the wilderness, when I brought you out of the land of Egypt.'" **33** Moses said to Aaron, "Take a pot, and put an omer-full of manna in it, and lay it up before the LORD, to be kept throughout your generations." **34** As the LORD commanded Moses, so Aaron laid it up before the Testimony, to be kept. **35** The children of Israel ate the manna forty years, until they came to an inhabited land. They ate the manna until they came to the borders of the land of Canaan. **36** Now an omer is one tenth of an ephah.

## Numbers 14

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַתִּשָּׂא כָּל־הָעֵדָה וַיִּתְּנוּ אֶת־קוֹלָם וַיִּבְכּוּ הָעָם בַּלַּיְלָה הַהוּא **2** וַיִּלֹּנוּ עַל־מֹשֶׁה וְעַל־אַהֲרֹן כֹּל בְּנֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֲלֵהֶם כָּל־הָעֵדָה לוּ־מַתְנוּ בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם אוֹ בַּמִּדְבָּר הַזֶּה לוּ־מָתְנוּ **3** וְלָמָּה יְהוָה
מֵבִיא אֹתָנוּ אֶל־הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת לִנְפֹּל בַּחֶרֶב נָשֵׁינוּ וְטַפֵּנוּ יִהְיוּ לָבַז הֲלוֹא טוֹב לָנוּ שׁוּב מִצְרַיְמָה **4**
וַיֹּאמְרוּ אִישׁ אֶל־אָחִיו נִתְּנָה רֹאשׁ וְנָשׁוּבָה מִצְרַיְמָה **5** וַיִּפֹּל מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן עַל־פְּנֵיהֶם לִפְנֵי כָּל־קְהַל
עֲדַת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **6** וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן וְכָלֵב בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה מִן־הַתָּרִים אֶת־הָאָרֶץ קָרְעוּ בִּגְדֵיהֶם **7** וַיֹּאמְרוּ
אֶל־כָּל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵאמֹר הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר עָבַרְנוּ בָהּ לָתוּר אֹתָהּ טוֹבָה הָאָרֶץ מְאֹד מְאֹד **8** אִם־
חָפֵץ בָּנוּ יְהוָה וְהֵבִיא אֹתָנוּ אֶל־הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת וּנְתָנָהּ לָנוּ אֶרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־הִוא זָבַת חָלָב וּדְבָשׁ **9** אַךְ
בַּיהוָה אַל־תִּמְרֹדוּ וְאַתֶּם אַל־תִּירְאוּ אֶת־עַם הָאָרֶץ כִּי לַחְמֵנוּ הֵם סָר צִלָּם מֲעֲלֵיהֶם וַיהוָה אִתָּנוּ
אַל־תִּירָאֻם **10** וַיֹּאמְרוּ כָּל־הָעֵדָה לִרְגּוֹם אֹתָם בָּאֲבָנִים וּכְבוֹד יְהוָה נִרְאָה בְאֹהֶל מוֹעֵד אֶל־כָּל־
בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **11** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה עַד־אָנָה יְנַאֲצֵנִי הָעָם הַזֶּה וְעַד־אָנָה לֹא־יַאֲמִינוּ בִי בְּכֹל
הָאֹתוֹת אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי בְּקִרְבּוֹ **12** אַכֶּנּוּ בַדֶּבֶר וְאוֹרִשֶׁנּוּ וְאֶעֱשֶׂה אֹתְךָ לְגוֹי־גָּדוֹל וְעָצוּם מִמֶּנּוּ **13**
וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־יְהוָה וְשָׁמְעוּ מִצְרַיִם כִּי־הֶעֱלִיתָ בְכֹחֲךָ אֶת־הָעָם הַזֶּה מִקִּרְבּוֹ **14** וְאָמְרוּ אֶל־יוֹשֵׁב
הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת שָׁמְעוּ כִּי־אַתָּה יְהוָה בְּקֶרֶב הָעָם הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר־עַיִן בְּעַיִן נִרְאָה אַתָּה יְהוָה וַעֲנָנְךָ עֹמֵד
עֲלֵהֶם וּבְעַמֻּד עָנָן אַתָּה הֹלֵךְ לִפְנֵיהֶם יוֹמָם וּבְעַמּוּד אֵשׁ לָיְלָה **15** וְהֵמַתָּה אֶת־הָעָם הַזֶּה כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד
וְאָמְרוּ הַגּוֹיִם אֲשֶׁר־שָׁמְעוּ אֶת־שִׁמְעֲךָ לֵאמֹר **16** מִבִּלְתִּי יְכֹלֶת יְהוָה לְהָבִיא אֶת־הָעָם הַזֶּה אֶל־הָאָרֶץ
אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁבַּע לָהֶם וַיִּשְׁחָטֵם בַּמִּדְבָּר **17** וְעַתָּה יִגְדַּל־נָא כֹּחַ אֲדֹנָי כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתָּ לֵאמֹר **18** יְהוָה אֶרֶךְ
אַפַּיִם וְרַב־חֶסֶד נֹשֵׂא עָוֹן וָפָשַׁע וְנַקֵּה לֹא יְנַקֶּה פֹּקֵד עֲוֹן אָבוֹת עַל־בָּנִים עַל־שִׁלֵּשִׁים וְעַל־רִבֵּעִים
**19** סְלַח־נָא לַעֲוֹן הָעָם הַזֶּה כְּגֹדֶל חַסְדֶּךָ וְכַאֲשֶׁר נָשָׂאתָה לָעָם הַזֶּה מִמִּצְרַיִם וְעַד־הֵנָּה **20** וַיֹּאמֶר

יְהוָה סָלַחְתִּי כִּדְבָרֶךָ **21** וְאוּלָם חַי־אָנִי וְיִמָּלֵא כְבוֹד־יְהוָה אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ **22** כִּי כָל־הָאֲנָשִׁים
הָרֹאִים אֶת־כְּבֹדִי וְאֶת־אֹתֹתַי אֲשֶׁר־עָשִׂיתִי בְּמִצְרַיִם וּבַמִּדְבָּר וַיְנַסּוּ אֹתִי זֶה עֶשֶׂר פְּעָמִים וְלֹא שָׁמְעוּ
בְּקוֹלִי **23** אִם־יִרְאוּ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי לַאֲבֹתָם וְכָל־מְנַאֲצַי לֹא יִרְאוּהָ **24** וְעַבְדִּי כָלֵב עֵקֶב
הָיְתָה רוּחַ אַחֶרֶת עִמּוֹ וַיְמַלֵּא אַחֲרַי וַהֲבִיאֹתִיו אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־בָּא שָׁמָּה וְזַרְעוֹ יוֹרִשֶׁנָּה **25**
וְהָעֲמָלֵקִי וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי יוֹשֵׁב בָּעֵמֶק מָחָר פְּנוּ וּסְעוּ לָכֶם הַמִּדְבָּר דֶּרֶךְ יַם־סוּף **26** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה
וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן לֵאמֹר **27** עַד־מָתַי לָעֵדָה הָרָעָה הַזֹּאת אֲשֶׁר הַמָּה מַלִּינִים עָלַי אֶת־תְּלֻנּוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
אֲשֶׁר הַמָּה מַלִּינִים עָלַי שָׁמָעְתִּי **28** אֱמֹר אֲלֵהֶם חַי־אָנִי נְאֻם־יְהוָה אִם־לֹא כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתֶּם בְּאָזְנָי כֵּן
אֶעֱשֶׂה לָכֶם **29** בַּמִּדְבָּר הַזֶּה יִפְּלוּ פִגְרֵיכֶם וְכָל־פְּקֻדֵיכֶם לְכָל־מִסְפַּרְכֶם מִבֶּן עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה וָמָעְלָה
אֲשֶׁר הֲלִינֹתֶם עָלָי **30** אִם־אַתֶּם תָּבֹאוּ אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר נָשָׂאתִי אֶת־יָדִי לְשַׁכֵּן אֶתְכֶם בָּהּ כִּי אִם־כָּלֵב
בֶּן־יְפֻנֶּה וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן **31** וְטַפְּכֶם אֲשֶׁר אֲמַרְתֶּם לָבַז יִהְיֶה וְהֵבִיאתִי אֹתָם וְיָדְעוּ אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר
מְאַסְתֶּם בָּהּ **32** וּפִגְרֵיכֶם אַתֶּם יִפְּלוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר הַזֶּה **33** וּבְנֵיכֶם יִהְיוּ רֹעִים בַּמִּדְבָּר אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה
וְנָשְׂאוּ אֶת־זְנוּתֵיכֶם עַד־תֹּם פִּגְרֵיכֶם בַּמִּדְבָּר **34** בְּמִסְפַּר הַיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר־תַּרְתֶּם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים
יוֹם יוֹם לַשָּׁנָה יוֹם לַשָּׁנָה תִּשְׂאוּ אֶת־עֲוֹנֹתֵיכֶם אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה וִידַעְתֶּם אֶת־תְּנוּאָתִי **35** אֲנִי יְהוָה
דִּבַּרְתִּי אִם־לֹא זֹאת אֶעֱשֶׂה לְכָל־הָעֵדָה הָרָעָה הַזֹּאת הַנּוֹעָדִים עָלַי בַּמִּדְבָּר הַזֶּה יִתַּמּוּ וְשָׁם יָמֻתוּ **36**
וְהָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַח מֹשֶׁה לָתוּר אֶת־הָאָרֶץ וַיָּשֻׁבוּ וילונו וילונו עָלָיו אֶת־כָּל־הָעֵדָה לְהוֹצִיא דִבָּה עַל־
הָאָרֶץ **37** וַיָּמֻתוּ הָאֲנָשִׁים מוֹצְאֵי דִבַּת־הָאָרֶץ רָעָה בַּמַּגֵּפָה לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **38** וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּן־נוּן וְכָלֵב בֶּן־
יְפֻנֶּה חָיוּ מִן־הָאֲנָשִׁים הָהֵם הַהֹלְכִים לָתוּר אֶת־הָאָרֶץ **39** וַיְדַבֵּר מֹשֶׁה אֶת־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה אֶל־כָּל־
בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּתְאַבְּלוּ הָעָם מְאֹד **40** וַיַּשְׁכִּמוּ בַבֹּקֶר וַיַּעֲלוּ אֶל־רֹאשׁ־הָהָר לֵאמֹר הִנֶּנּוּ וְעָלִינוּ אֶל־
הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־אָמַר יְהוָה כִּי חָטָאנוּ **41** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה לָמָּה זֶּה אַתֶּם עֹבְרִים אֶת־פִּי יְהוָה וְהוּא לֹא
תִצְלָח **42** אַל־תַּעֲלוּ כִּי אֵין יְהוָה בְּקִרְבְּכֶם וְלֹא תִנָּגְפוּ לִפְנֵי אֹיְבֵיכֶם **43** כִּי הָעֲמָלֵקִי וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי שָׁם
לִפְנֵיכֶם וּנְפַלְתֶּם בֶּחָרֶב כִּי־עַל־כֵּן שַׁבְתֶּם מֵאַחֲרֵי יְהוָה וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה יְהוָה עִמָּכֶם **44** וַיַּעְפְּלוּ לַעֲלוֹת
אֶל־רֹאשׁ הָהָר וַאֲרוֹן בְּרִית־יְהוָה וּמֹשֶׁה לֹא־מָשׁוּ מִקֶּרֶב הַמַּחֲנֶה **45** וַיֵּרֶד הָעֲמָלֵקִי וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי הַיֹּשֵׁב
בָּהָר הַהוּא וַיַּכּוּם וַיַּכְּתוּם עַד־הַחָרְמָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the whole congregation lifted up their voices and cried out, and that night the people wept. **2** All the Israelites grumbled against Moses and Aaron, and the whole congregation said to them, “If only we had died in the land of Egypt, or if only we had died in this wilderness! **3** Why is the LORD bringing us into this land to fall by the sword? Our wives and children will become plunder. Would it not be better for us to go back to Egypt?” **4** So they said to one another, “Let us appoint a leader and return to Egypt.” **5** Then Moses and Aaron fell facedown before the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel. **6** Joshua son of Nun and Caleb son of Jephunneh, who were among those who had spied out the land, tore their clothes **7** and said to the whole congregation of Israel, “The land we passed through and explored is an exceedingly good land. **8** If the LORD delights in us, He will bring us into this land, a land flowing with milk and honey, and He will give it to us. **9** Only do not rebel against the LORD, and do not be afraid of the people of the land, for they will be like bread for us. Their protection has been removed, and the LORD is with us. Do not be afraid of them!” **10** But the whole congregation threatened to

stone Joshua and Caleb. Then the glory of the LORD appeared to all the Israelites at the Tent of Meeting. **11** And the LORD said to Moses, “How long will this people treat Me with contempt? How long will they refuse to believe in Me, despite all the signs I have performed among them? **12** I will strike them with a plague and destroy them—and I will make you into a nation greater and mightier than they are.” **13** But Moses said to the LORD, “The Egyptians will hear of it, for by Your strength You brought this people from among them. **14** And they will tell it to the inhabitants of this land. They have already heard that You, O LORD, are in the midst of this people, that You, O LORD, have been seen face to face, that Your cloud stands over them, and that You go before them in a pillar of cloud by day and a pillar of fire by night. **15** If You kill this people as one man, the nations who have heard of Your fame will say, **16** ‘Because the LORD was unable to bring this people into the land He swore to give them, He has slaughtered them in the wilderness.’ **17** So now I pray, may the power of my Lord be magnified, just as You have declared: **18** ‘The LORD is slow to anger and abounding in loving devotion, forgiving iniquity and transgression. Yet He will by no means leave the guilty unpunished; He will visit the iniquity of the fathers upon their children to the third and fourth generation.’ **19** Pardon, I pray, the iniquity of this people, in keeping with the greatness of Your loving devotion, just as You have forgiven them ever since they left Egypt.” **20** “I have pardoned them as you requested,” the LORD replied. **21** “Yet as surely as I live and as surely as the whole earth is filled with the glory of the LORD, **22** not one of the men who have seen My glory and the signs I performed in Egypt and in the wilderness—yet have tested Me and disobeyed Me these ten times— **23** not one will ever see the land that I swore to give their fathers. None of those who have treated Me with contempt will see it. **24** But because My servant Caleb has a different spirit and has followed Me wholeheartedly, I will bring him into the land he has entered, and his descendants will inherit it. **25** Now since the Amalekites and Canaanites are living in the valleys, turn back tomorrow and head for the wilderness along the route to the Red Sea.” **26** Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, **27** “How long will this wicked congregation grumble against Me? I have heard the complaints that the Israelites are making against Me. **28** So tell them: As surely as I live, declares the LORD, I will do to you exactly as I heard you say. **29** Your bodies will fall in this wilderness—all who were numbered in the census, everyone twenty years of age or older—because you have grumbled against Me. **30** Surely none of you will enter the land in which I swore to settle you, except Caleb son of Jephunneh and Joshua son of Nun. **31** But I will bring your children, whom you said would become plunder, into the land you have rejected—and they will enjoy it. **32** As for you, however, your bodies will fall in this wilderness. **33** Your children will be shepherds in the wilderness for forty years, and they will suffer for your unfaithfulness until the last of your bodies lies in the wilderness. **34** In keeping with the forty days you spied out the land, you shall bear your guilt forty years—a year for each day—and you will experience My alienation. **35** I, the LORD, have spoken, and

I will surely do these things to this entire wicked congregation, which has conspired against Me. They will meet their end in the wilderness, and there they will die.” **36** So the men Moses had sent to spy out the land, who had returned and made the whole congregation grumble against him by bringing out a bad report about the land— **37** those men who had brought out the bad report about the land—were struck down by a plague before the LORD. **38** Of those men who had gone to spy out the land, only Joshua son of Nun and Caleb son of Jephunneh remained alive. **39** And when Moses relayed these words to all the Israelites, the people mourned bitterly. **40** Early the next morning they got up and went up toward the ridge of the hill country. “We have indeed sinned,” they said, “but we will go to the place the LORD has promised.” **41** But Moses said, “Why are you transgressing the commandment of the LORD? This will not succeed! **42** Do not go up, lest you be struck down by your enemies, because the LORD is not among you. **43** For there the Amalekites and Canaanites will face you, and you will fall by the sword. Because you have turned away from the LORD, He will not be with you.” **44** But they dared to go up to the ridge of the hill country, though neither Moses nor the ark of the covenant of the LORD moved from the camp. **45** Then the Amalekites and Canaanites who lived in that part of the hill country came down, attacked them, and routed them all the way to Hormah.

*English (WEB)*

**1** All the congregation lifted up their voice, and cried; and the people wept that night. **2** All the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron. The whole congregation said to them, “We wish that we had died in the land of Egypt, or that we had died in this wilderness! **3** Why does the LORD bring us to this land, to fall by the sword? Our wives and our little ones will be captured or killed! Wouldn’t it be better for us to return into Egypt?” **4** They said to one another, “Let’s choose a leader, and let’s return into Egypt.” **5** Then Moses and Aaron fell on their faces before all the assembly of the congregation of the children of Israel. **6** Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh, who were of those who spied out the land, tore their clothes. **7** They spoke to all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying, “The land, which we passed through to spy it out, is an exceedingly good land. **8** If the LORD delights in us, then he will bring us into this land, and give it to us: a land which flows with milk and honey. **9** Only don’t rebel against the LORD, neither fear the people of the land; for they are bread for us. Their defense is removed from over them, and the LORD is with us. Don’t fear them.” **10** But all the congregation threatened to stone them with stones. The LORD’s glory appeared in the Tent of Meeting to all the children of Israel. **11** The LORD said to Moses, “How long will this people despise me? How long will they not believe in me, for all the signs which I have worked among them? **12** I will strike them with the pestilence, and disinherit them, and will make of you a nation greater and mightier than they.” **13** Moses said to the LORD,

“Then the Egyptians will hear it; for you brought up this people in your might
from among them. **14** They will tell it to the inhabitants of this land. They have
heard that you LORD are among this people; for you LORD are seen face to
face, and your cloud stands over them, and you go before them, in a pillar of
cloud by day, and in a pillar of fire by night. **15** Now if you killed this people as
one man, then the nations which have heard the fame of you will speak,
saying, **16** ‘Because the LORD was not able to bring this people into the land
which he swore to them, therefore he has slain them in the wilderness.’ **17**
Now please let the power of the Lord be great, according as you have spoken,
saying, **18** ‘The LORD is slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness,
forgiving iniquity and disobedience; and he will by no means clear the guilty,
visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children, on the third and on the
fourth generation.’ **19** Please pardon the iniquity of this people according to
the greatness of your loving kindness, and just as you have forgiven this
people, from Egypt even until now.” **20** The LORD said, “I have pardoned
according to your word; **21** but in very deed—as I live, and as all the earth
shall be filled with the LORD’s glory— **22** because all those men who have
seen my glory and my signs, which I worked in Egypt and in the wilderness,
yet have tempted me these ten times, and have not listened to my voice; **23**
surely they shall not see the land which I swore to their fathers, neither shall
any of those who despised me see it. **24** But my servant Caleb, because he had
another spirit with him, and has followed me fully, him I will bring into the
land into which he went. His offspring shall possess it. **25** Since the Amalekite
and the Canaanite dwell in the valley, tomorrow turn and go into the
wilderness by the way to the Red Sea.” **26** The LORD spoke to Moses and to
Aaron, saying, **27** “How long shall I bear with this evil congregation that
complain against me? I have heard the complaints of the children of Israel,
which they complain against me. **28** Tell them, ‘As I live, says the LORD, surely
as you have spoken in my ears, so I will do to you. **29** Your dead bodies shall
fall in this wilderness; and all who were counted of you, according to your
whole number, from twenty years old and upward, who have complained
against me, **30** surely you shall not come into the land concerning which I
swore that I would make you dwell therein, except Caleb the son of
Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun. **31** But I will bring in your little ones
that you said should be captured or killed, and they shall know the land which
you have rejected. **32** But as for you, your dead bodies shall fall in this
wilderness. **33** Your children shall be wanderers in the wilderness forty years,
and shall bear your prostitution, until your dead bodies are consumed in the
wilderness. **34** After the number of the days in which you spied out the land,
even forty days, for every day a year, you will bear your iniquities, even forty
years, and you will know my alienation.’ **35** I, the LORD, have spoken. I will
surely do this to all this evil congregation who are gathered together against
me. In this wilderness they shall be consumed, and there they shall die.” **36**
The men whom Moses sent to spy out the land, who returned and made all the
congregation to murmur against him by bringing up an evil report against the

land, **37** even those men who brought up an evil report of the land, died by the plague before the LORD. **38** But Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the son of Jephunneh remained alive of those men who went to spy out the land. **39** Moses told these words to all the children of Israel, and the people mourned greatly. **40** They rose up early in the morning and went up to the top of the mountain, saying, “Behold, we are here, and will go up to the place which the LORD has promised; for we have sinned.” **41** Moses said, “Why now do you disobey the commandment of the LORD, since it shall not prosper? **42** Don’t go up, for the LORD isn’t among you; that way you won’t be struck down before your enemies. **43** For there the Amalekite and the Canaanite are before you, and you will fall by the sword because you turned back from following the LORD; therefore the LORD will not be with you.” **44** But they presumed to go up to the top of the mountain. Nevertheless, the ark of the LORD’s covenant and Moses didn’t depart out of the camp. **45** Then the Amalekites came down, and the Canaanites who lived in that mountain, and struck them and beat them down even to Hormah.

## Numbers 16

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**1** וַיִּקַּח קֹרַח בֶּן־יִצְהָר בֶּן־קְהָת בֶּן־לֵוִי וְדָתָן וַאֲבִירָם בְּנֵי אֱלִיאָב וְאוֹן בֶּן־פֶּלֶת בְּנֵי רְאוּבֵן **2** וַיָּקֻמוּ
לִפְנֵי מֹשֶׁה וַאֲנָשִׁים מִבְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל חֲמִשִּׁים וּמָאתַיִם נְשִׂיאֵי עֵדָה קְרָאֵי מוֹעֵד אַנְשֵׁי־שֵׁם **3** וַיִּקָּהֲלוּ עַל־
מֹשֶׁה וְעַל־אַהֲרֹן וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֲלֵהֶם רַב־לָכֶם כִּי כָל־הָעֵדָה כֻּלָּם קְדֹשִׁים וּבְתוֹכָם יְהוָה וּמַדּוּעַ תִּתְנַשְּׂאוּ
עַל־קְהַל יְהוָה **4** וַיִּשְׁמַע מֹשֶׁה וַיִּפֹּל עַל־פָּנָיו **5** וַיְדַבֵּר אֶל־קֹרַח וְאֶל־כָּל־עֲדָתוֹ לֵאמֹר בֹּקֶר וְיֹדַע
יְהוָה אֶת־אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ וְאֶת־הַקָּדוֹשׁ וְהִקְרִיב אֵלָיו וְאֵת אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר־בּוֹ יַקְרִיב אֵלָיו **6** זֹאת עֲשׂוּ קְחוּ־
לָכֶם מַחְתּוֹת קֹרַח וְכָל־עֲדָתוֹ **7** וּתְנוּ בָהֵן אֵשׁ וְשִׂימוּ עֲלֵיהֶן קְטֹרֶת לִפְנֵי יְהוָה מָחָר וְהָיָה הָאִישׁ
אֲשֶׁר־יִבְחַר יְהוָה הוּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ רַב־לָכֶם בְּנֵי לֵוִי **8** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־קֹרַח שִׁמְעוּ־נָא בְּנֵי לֵוִי **9** הַמְעַט
מִכֶּם כִּי־הִבְדִּיל אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶתְכֶם מֵעֲדַת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהַקְרִיב אֶתְכֶם אֵלָיו לַעֲבֹד אֶת־עֲבֹדַת מִשְׁכַּן
יְהוָה וְלַעֲמֹד לִפְנֵי הָעֵדָה לְשָׁרְתָם **10** וַיַּקְרֵב אֹתְךָ וְאֶת־כָּל־אַחֶיךָ בְּנֵי־לֵוִי אִתָּךְ וּבַקַּשְׁתֶּם גַּם־כְּהֻנָּה
**11** לָכֵן אַתָּה וְכָל־עֲדָתְךָ הַנֹּעָדִים עַל־יְהוָה וְאַהֲרֹן מַה־הוּא כִּי תלונו עָלָיו **12** וַיִּשְׁלַח מֹשֶׁה לִקְרֹא
לְדָתָן וְלַאֲבִירָם בְּנֵי אֱלִיאָב וַיֹּאמְרוּ לֹא נַעֲלֶה **13** הַמְעַט כִּי הֶעֱלִיתָנוּ מֵאֶרֶץ זָבַת חָלָב וּדְבַשׁ
לַהֲמִיתָנוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר כִּי־תִשְׂתָּרֵר עָלֵינוּ גַּם־הִשְׂתָּרֵר **14** אַף לֹא אֶל־אֶרֶץ זָבַת חָלָב וּדְבַשׁ הֱבִיאֹתָנוּ
וַתִּתֶּן־לָנוּ נַחֲלַת שָׂדֶה וָכָרֶם הַעֵינֵי הָאֲנָשִׁים הָהֵם תְּנַקֵּר לֹא נַעֲלֶה **15** וַיִּחַר לְמֹשֶׁה מְאֹד וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־
יְהוָה אַל־תֵּפֶן אֶל־מִנְחָתָם לֹא חֲמוֹר אֶחָד מֵהֶם נָשָׂאתִי וְלֹא הֲרֵעֹתִי אֶת־אַחַד מֵהֶם **16** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה
אֶל־קֹרַח אַתָּה וְכָל־עֲדָתְךָ הֱיוּ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אַתָּה וָהֵם וְאַהֲרֹן מָחָר **17** וּקְחוּ אִישׁ מַחְתָּתוֹ וּנְתַתֶּם
עֲלֵיהֶם קְטֹרֶת וְהִקְרַבְתֶּם לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אִישׁ מַחְתָּתוֹ חֲמִשִּׁים וּמָאתַיִם מַחְתֹּת וְאַתָּה וְאַהֲרֹן אִישׁ מַחְתָּתוֹ
**18** וַיִּקְחוּ אִישׁ מַחְתָּתוֹ וַיִּתְּנוּ עֲלֵיהֶם אֵשׁ וַיָּשִׂימוּ עֲלֵיהֶם קְטֹרֶת וַיַּעַמְדוּ פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וּמֹשֶׁה
וְאַהֲרֹן **19** וַיַּקְהֵל עֲלֵיהֶם קֹרַח אֶת־כָּל־הָעֵדָה אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וַיֵּרָא כְבוֹד־יְהוָה אֶל־כָּל־הָעֵדָה
**20** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן לֵאמֹר **21** הִבָּדְלוּ מִתּוֹךְ הָעֵדָה הַזֹּאת וַאֲכַלֶּה אֹתָם כְּרָגַע **22**
וַיִּפְּלוּ עַל־פְּנֵיהֶם וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֵל אֱלֹהֵי הָרוּחֹת לְכָל־בָּשָׂר הָאִישׁ אֶחָד יֶחֱטָא וְעַל כָּל־הָעֵדָה תִּקְצֹף **23**

וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵאמֹר **24** דַּבֵּר אֶל־הָעֵדָה לֵאמֹר הֵעָלוּ מִסָּבִיב לְמִשְׁכַּן־קֹרַח דָּתָן וַאֲבִירָם **25**
וַיָּקָם מֹשֶׁה וַיֵּלֶךְ אֶל־דָּתָן וַאֲבִירָם וַיֵּלְכוּ אַחֲרָיו זִקְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **26** וַיְדַבֵּר אֶל־הָעֵדָה לֵאמֹר סוּרוּ נָא
מֵעַל אָהֳלֵי הָאֲנָשִׁים הָרְשָׁעִים הָאֵלֶּה וְאַל־תִּגְּעוּ בְּכָל־אֲשֶׁר לָהֶם פֶּן־תִּסָּפּוּ בְּכָל־חַטֹּאתָם **27** וַיַּעֲלוּ
מֵעַל מִשְׁכַּן־קֹרַח דָּתָן וַאֲבִירָם מִסָּבִיב וְדָתָן וַאֲבִירָם יָצְאוּ נִצָּבִים פֶּתַח אָהֳלֵיהֶם וּנְשֵׁיהֶם וּבְנֵיהֶם
וְטַפָּם **28** וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה בְּזֹאת תֵּדְעוּן כִּי־יְהוָה שְׁלָחַנִי לַעֲשׂוֹת אֵת כָּל־הַמַּעֲשִׂים הָאֵלֶּה כִּי־לֹא מִלִּבִּי
**29** אִם־כְּמוֹת כָּל־הָאָדָם יְמֻתוּן אֵלֶּה וּפְקֻדַּת כָּל־הָאָדָם יִפָּקֵד עֲלֵיהֶם לֹא יְהוָה שְׁלָחָנִי **30** וְאִם־
בְּרִיאָה יִבְרָא יְהוָה וּפָצְתָה הָאֲדָמָה אֶת־פִּיהָ וּבָלְעָה אֹתָם וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר לָהֶם וְיָרְדוּ חַיִּים שְׁאֹלָה
וִידַעְתֶּם כִּי נִאֲצוּ הָאֲנָשִׁים הָאֵלֶּה אֶת־יְהוָה **31** וַיְהִי כְּכַלֹּתוֹ לְדַבֵּר אֵת כָּל־הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה וַתִּבָּקַע
הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר תַּחְתֵּיהֶם **32** וַתִּפְתַּח הָאָרֶץ אֶת־פִּיהָ וַתִּבְלַע אֹתָם וְאֶת־בָּתֵּיהֶם וְאֵת כָּל־הָאָדָם אֲשֶׁר
לְקֹרַח וְאֵת כָּל־הָרְכוּשׁ **33** וַיֵּרְדוּ הֵם וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר לָהֶם חַיִּים שְׁאֹלָה וַתְּכַס עֲלֵיהֶם הָאָרֶץ וַיֹּאבְדוּ
מִתּוֹךְ הַקָּהָל **34** וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר סְבִיבֹתֵיהֶם נָסוּ לְקֹלָם כִּי אָמְרוּ פֶּן־תִּבְלָעֵנוּ הָאָרֶץ **35** וְאֵשׁ
יָצְאָה מֵאֵת יְהוָה וַתֹּאכַל אֶת הַחֲמִשִּׁים וּמָאתַיִם אִישׁ מַקְרִיבֵי הַקְּטֹרֶת **36** [17:1] וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־
מֹשֶׁה לֵאמֹר **37** [17:2] אֱמֹר אֶל־אֶלְעָזָר בֶּן־אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן וְיָרֵם אֶת־הַמַּחְתּוֹת מִבֵּין הַשָּׂרֵפָה וְאֶת־הָאֵשׁ
זָרֵה־הָלְאָה כִּי קָדֵשׁוּ **38** [17:3] אֵת מַחְתּוֹת הַחַטָּאִים הָאֵלֶּה בְּנַפְשֹׁתָם וְעָשׂוּ אֹתָם רִקְעֵי פַחִים צִפּוּי
לַמִּזְבֵּחַ כִּי־הִקְרִיבָם לִפְנֵי־יְהוָה וַיִּקְדָּשׁוּ וְיִהְיוּ לְאוֹת לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **39** [17:4] וַיִּקַּח אֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן
אֵת מַחְתּוֹת הַנְּחֹשֶׁת אֲשֶׁר הִקְרִיבוּ הַשְּׂרֻפִים וַיִּרְקְעוּם צִפּוּי לַמִּזְבֵּחַ **40** [17:5] זִכָּרוֹן לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
לְמַעַן אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִקְרַב אִישׁ זָר אֲשֶׁר לֹא מִזֶּרַע אַהֲרֹן הוּא לְהַקְטִיר קְטֹרֶת לִפְנֵי יְהוָה וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה
כְּקֹרַח וְכַעֲדָתוֹ כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר יְהוָה בְּיַד־מֹשֶׁה לוֹ **41** [17:6] וַיִּלֹּנוּ כָּל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמָּחֳרָת עַל־
מֹשֶׁה וְעַל־אַהֲרֹן לֵאמֹר אַתֶּם הֲמִתֶּם אֶת־עַם יְהוָה **42** [17:7] וַיְהִי בְּהִקָּהֵל הָעֵדָה עַל־מֹשֶׁה וְעַל־
אַהֲרֹן וַיִּפְנוּ אֶל־אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וְהִנֵּה כִסָּהוּ הֶעָנָן וַיֵּרָא כְּבוֹד יְהוָה **43** [17:8] וַיָּבֹא מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן אֶל־
פְּנֵי אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד **44** [17:9] וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵאמֹר **45** [17:10] הֵרֹמּוּ מִתּוֹךְ הָעֵדָה הַזֹּאת
וַאֲכַלֶּה אֹתָם כְּרָגַע וַיִּפְּלוּ עַל־פְּנֵיהֶם **46** [17:11] וַיֹּאמֶר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־אַהֲרֹן קַח אֶת־הַמַּחְתָּה וְתֶן־עָלֶיהָ
אֵשׁ מֵעַל הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וְשִׂים קְטֹרֶת וְהוֹלֵךְ מְהֵרָה אֶל־הָעֵדָה וְכַפֵּר עֲלֵיהֶם כִּי־יָצָא הַקֶּצֶף מִלִּפְנֵי יְהוָה
הֵחֵל הַנָּגֶף **47** [17:12] וַיִּקַּח אַהֲרֹן כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר מֹשֶׁה וַיָּרָץ אֶל־תּוֹךְ הַקָּהָל וְהִנֵּה הֵחֵל הַנָּגֶף בָּעָם
וַיִּתֵּן אֶת־הַקְּטֹרֶת וַיְכַפֵּר עַל־הָעָם **48** [17:13] וַיַּעֲמֹד בֵּין־הַמֵּתִים וּבֵין הַחַיִּים וַתֵּעָצַר הַמַּגֵּפָה **49**
[17:14] וַיִּהְיוּ הַמֵּתִים בַּמַּגֵּפָה אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר אֶלֶף וּשְׁבַע מֵאוֹת מִלְּבַד הַמֵּתִים עַל־דְּבַר־קֹרַח **50**
[17:15] וַיָּשָׁב אַהֲרֹן אֶל־מֹשֶׁה אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד וְהַמַּגֵּפָה נֶעֱצָרָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now Korah son of Izhar, the son of Kohath son of Levi, along with some Reubenites—Dathan and Abiram, sons of Eliab, and On son of Peleth—conducted **2** a rebellion against Moses, along with 250 men of Israel renowned as leaders of the congregation and representatives in the assembly. **3** They came together against Moses and Aaron and told them, “You have taken too much upon yourselves! For everyone in the entire congregation is holy, and the LORD is in their midst. Why then do you exalt yourselves above the assembly of the LORD?” **4** When Moses heard this, he fell facedown. **5** Then he said to Korah and all his followers, “Tomorrow morning the LORD will reveal who belongs to Him and who is holy, and He will bring that person near to Himself. The one He chooses, He will bring near to Himself. **6** You, Korah, and all your

followers are to do as follows: Take censers, **7** and tomorrow you are to place fire and incense in them in the presence of the LORD. Then the man the LORD chooses will be the one who is holy. It is you sons of Levi who have taken too much upon yourselves!" **8** Moses also said to Korah, "Now listen, you sons of Levi! **9** Is it not enough for you that the God of Israel has separated you from the congregation of Israel and brought you near to Himself to perform the work at the LORD's tabernacle, and to stand before the congregation to minister to them? **10** He has brought you near, you and all your fellow Levites, but you are seeking the priesthood as well. **11** Therefore, it is you and all your followers who have conspired against the LORD! As for Aaron, who is he that you should grumble against him?" **12** Then Moses summoned Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab, but they said, "We will not come! **13** Is it not enough that you have brought us up out of a land flowing with milk and honey to kill us in the wilderness? Must you also appoint yourself as ruler over us? **14** Moreover, you have not brought us into a land flowing with milk and honey or given us an inheritance of fields and vineyards. Will you gouge out the eyes of these men? No, we will not come!" **15** Then Moses became very angry and said to the LORD, "Do not regard their offering. I have not taken one donkey from them or mistreated a single one of them." **16** And Moses said to Korah, "You and all your followers are to appear before the LORD tomorrow—you and they and Aaron. **17** Each man is to take his censer, place incense in it, and present it before the LORD—250 censers. You and Aaron are to present your censers as well." **18** So each man took his censer, put fire and incense in it, and stood with Moses and Aaron at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. **19** When Korah had gathered his whole assembly against them at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, the glory of the LORD appeared to the whole congregation. **20** And the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, **21** "Separate yourselves from this congregation so that I may consume them in an instant." **22** But Moses and Aaron fell facedown and said, "O God, the God of the spirits of all flesh, when one man sins, will You be angry with the whole congregation?" **23** Then the LORD said to Moses, **24** "Tell the congregation to move away from the dwellings of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram." **25** So Moses got up and went to Dathan and Abiram, and the elders of Israel followed him. **26** And he warned the congregation, "Move away now from the tents of these wicked men. Do not touch anything that belongs to them, or you will be swept away because of all their sins." **27** So they moved away from the dwellings of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram. Meanwhile, Dathan and Abiram had come out and stood at the entrances to their tents with their wives and children and infants. **28** Then Moses said, "This is how you will know that the LORD has sent me to do all these things, for it was not my own doing: **29** If these men die a natural death, or if they suffer the fate of all men, then the LORD has not sent me. **30** But if the LORD brings about something unprecedented, and the earth opens its mouth and swallows them and all that belongs to them so that they go down alive into Sheol, then you will know that these men have treated the LORD with contempt." **31** As soon as Moses had finished saying all this, the

ground beneath them split open, **32** and the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them and their households—all Korah's men and all their possessions. **33** They went down alive into Sheol with all they owned. The earth closed over them, and they vanished from the assembly. **34** At their cries, all the people of Israel who were around them fled, saying, "The earth may swallow us too!" **35** And fire came forth from the LORD and consumed the 250 men who were offering the incense. **36** Then the LORD said to Moses, **37** "Tell Eleazar son of Aaron the priest to remove the censers from the flames and to scatter the coals far away, because the censers are holy. **38** As for the censers of those who sinned at the cost of their own lives, hammer them into sheets to overlay the altar, for these were presented before the LORD, and so have become holy. They will serve as a sign to the Israelites." **39** So Eleazar the priest took the bronze censers brought by those who had been burned up, and he had them hammered out to overlay the altar, **40** just as the LORD commanded him through Moses. This was to be a reminder to the Israelites that no outsider who is not a descendant of Aaron should approach to offer incense before the LORD, lest he become like Korah and his followers. **41** The next day the whole congregation of Israel grumbled against Moses and Aaron, saying, "You have killed the LORD's people!" **42** But when the congregation gathered against them, Moses and Aaron turned toward the Tent of Meeting, and suddenly the cloud covered it and the glory of the LORD appeared. **43** Then Moses and Aaron went to the front of the Tent of Meeting, **44** and the LORD said to Moses, **45** "Get away from this congregation so that I may consume them in an instant." And Moses and Aaron fell facedown. **46** Moses said to Aaron, "Take your censer, place fire from the altar in it, and add incense. Go quickly to the congregation and make atonement for them, because wrath has come out from the LORD; the plague has begun." **47** So Aaron took the censer as Moses had ordered and ran into the midst of the assembly. And seeing that the plague had begun among the people, he offered the incense and made atonement for the people. **48** He stood between the living and the dead, and the plague was halted. **49** But those who died from the plague numbered 14,700, in addition to those who had died on account of Korah. **50** Then Aaron returned to Moses at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, since the plague had been halted.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now Korah, the son of Izhar, the son of Kohath, the son of Levi, with Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab, and On, the son of Peleth, sons of Reuben, took some men. **2** They rose up before Moses, with some of the children of Israel, two hundred fifty princes of the congregation, called to the assembly, men of renown. **3** They assembled themselves together against Moses and against Aaron, and said to them, "You take too much on yourself, since all the congregation are holy, everyone of them, and the LORD is among them! Why do you lift yourselves up above the LORD's assembly?" **4** When Moses heard

it, he fell on his face. **5** He said to Korah and to all his company, “In the morning, the LORD will show who are his, and who is holy, and will cause him to come near to him. Even him whom he shall choose, he will cause to come near to him. **6** Do this: have Korah and all his company take censers, **7** put fire in them, and put incense on them before the LORD tomorrow. It shall be that the man whom the LORD chooses, he shall be holy. You have gone too far, you sons of Levi!” **8** Moses said to Korah, “Hear now, you sons of Levi! **9** Is it a small thing to you that the God of Israel has separated you from the congregation of Israel, to bring you near to himself, to do the service of the LORD’s tabernacle, and to stand before the congregation to minister to them; **10** and that he has brought you near, and all your brothers the sons of Levi with you? Do you seek the priesthood also? **11** Therefore you and all your company have gathered together against the LORD! What is Aaron that you complain against him?” **12** Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab; and they said, “We won’t come up! **13** Is it a small thing that you have brought us up out of a land flowing with milk and honey, to kill us in the wilderness, but you must also make yourself a prince over us? **14** Moreover you haven’t brought us into a land flowing with milk and honey, nor given us inheritance of fields and vineyards. Will you put out the eyes of these men? We won’t come up.” **15** Moses was very angry, and said to the LORD, “Don’t respect their offering. I have not taken one donkey from them, neither have I hurt one of them.” **16** Moses said to Korah, “You and all your company go before the LORD, you, and they, and Aaron, tomorrow. **17** Each man take his censer and put incense on it, and each man bring before the LORD his censer, two hundred fifty censers; you also, and Aaron, each with his censer.” **18** They each took his censer, and put fire in it, and laid incense on it, and stood at the door of the Tent of Meeting with Moses and Aaron. **19** Korah assembled all the congregation opposite them to the door of the Tent of Meeting. The LORD’s glory appeared to all the congregation. **20** The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, **21** “Separate yourselves from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment!” **22** They fell on their faces, and said, “God, the God of the spirits of all flesh, shall one man sin, and will you be angry with all the congregation?” **23** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **24** “Speak to the congregation, saying, ‘Get away from around the tent of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram!’” **25** Moses rose up and went to Dathan and Abiram; and the elders of Israel followed him. **26** He spoke to the congregation, saying, “Depart, please, from the tents of these wicked men, and touch nothing of theirs, lest you be consumed in all their sins!” **27** So they went away from the tent of Korah, Dathan, and Abiram, on every side. Dathan and Abiram came out, and stood at the door of their tents with their wives, their sons, and their little ones. **28** Moses said, “Hereby you shall know that the LORD has sent me to do all these works; for they are not from my own mind. **29** If these men die the common death of all men, or if they experience what all men experience, then the LORD hasn’t sent me. **30** But if the LORD makes a new thing, and the ground opens its mouth, and swallows them up with all that belong to them, and they

go down alive into Sheol, then you shall understand that these men have despised the LORD." **31** As he finished speaking all these words, the ground that was under them split apart. **32** The earth opened its mouth and swallowed them up with their households, all of Korah's men, and all their goods. **33** So they, and all that belonged to them went down alive into Sheol. The earth closed on them, and they perished from among the assembly. **34** All Israel that were around them fled at their cry; for they said, "Lest the earth swallow us up!" **35** Fire came out from the LORD, and devoured the two hundred fifty men who offered the incense. **36** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **37** "Speak to Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, that he take up the censers out of the burning, and scatter the fire away from the camp; for they are holy, **38** even the censers of those who sinned against their own lives. Let them be beaten into plates for a covering of the altar, for they offered them before the LORD. Therefore they are holy. They shall be a sign to the children of Israel." **39** Eleazar the priest took the bronze censers which those who were burned had offered; and they beat them out for a covering of the altar, **40** to be a memorial to the children of Israel, to the end that no stranger who isn't of the offspring of Aaron, would come near to burn incense before the LORD, that he not be as Korah and as his company; as the LORD spoke to him by Moses. **41** But on the next day all the congregation of the children of Israel complained against Moses and against Aaron, saying, "You have killed the LORD's people!" **42** When the congregation was assembled against Moses and against Aaron, they looked toward the Tent of Meeting. Behold, the cloud covered it, and the LORD's glory appeared. **43** Moses and Aaron came to the front of the Tent of Meeting. **44** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **45** "Get away from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment!" They fell on their faces. **46** Moses said to Aaron, "Take your censer, put fire from the altar in it, lay incense on it, carry it quickly to the congregation, and make atonement for them; for wrath has gone out from the LORD! The plague has begun." **47** Aaron did as Moses said, and ran into the middle of the assembly. The plague had already begun among the people. He put on the incense, and made atonement for the people. **48** He stood between the dead and the living; and the plague was stayed. **49** Now those who died by the plague were fourteen thousand seven hundred, in addition to those who died about the matter of Korah. **50** Aaron returned to Moses to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and the plague was stopped.

## Numbers 22

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיִּסְעוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַיִּחֲנוּ בְּעַרְבוֹת מוֹאָב מֵעֵבֶר לְיַרְדֵּן יְרֵחוֹ **2** וַיַּרְא בָּלָק בֶּן־צִפּוֹר אֵת כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־
עָשָׂה יִשְׂרָאֵל לָאֱמֹרִי **3** וַיָּגָר מוֹאָב מִפְּנֵי הָעָם מְאֹד כִּי רַב־הוּא וַיָּקָץ מוֹאָב מִפְּנֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **4**
וַיֹּאמֶר מוֹאָב אֶל־זִקְנֵי מִדְיָן עַתָּה יְלַחֲכוּ הַקָּהָל אֶת־כָּל־סְבִיבֹתֵינוּ כִּלְחֹךְ הַשּׁוֹר אֵת יֶרֶק הַשָּׂדֶה

וּבִלְק בֶּן־צִפּוֹר מֶלֶךְ לְמוֹאָב בָּעֵת הַהִוא **5** וַיִּשְׁלַח מַלְאָכִים אֶל־בִּלְעָם בֶּן־בְּעוֹר פְּתוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר עַל־
הַנָּהָר אֶרֶץ בְּנֵי־עַמּוֹ לִקְרֹא־לוֹ לֵאמֹר הִנֵּה עַם יָצָא מִמִּצְרַיִם הִנֵּה כִסָּה אֶת־עֵין הָאָרֶץ וְהוּא יֹשֵׁב
מִמֻּלִי **6** וְעַתָּה לְכָה־נָּא אָרָה־לִּי אֶת־הָעָם הַזֶּה כִּי־עָצוּם הוּא מִמֶּנִּי אוּלַי אוּכַל נַכֶּה־בּוֹ וַאֲגָרְשֶׁנּוּ מִן־
הָאָרֶץ כִּי יָדַעְתִּי אֵת אֲשֶׁר־תְּבָרֵךְ מְבֹרָךְ וַאֲשֶׁר תָּאֹר יוּאָר **7** וַיֵּלְכוּ זִקְנֵי מוֹאָב וְזִקְנֵי מִדְיָן וּקְסָמִים
בְּיָדָם וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־בִּלְעָם וַיְדַבְּרוּ אֵלָיו דִּבְרֵי בָלָק **8** וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם לִינוּ פֹּה הַלַּיְלָה וַהֲשֵׁבֹתִי אֶתְכֶם
דָּבָר כַּאֲשֶׁר יְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֵלָי וַיֵּשְׁבוּ שָׂרֵי־מוֹאָב עִם־בִּלְעָם **9** וַיָּבֹא אֱלֹהִים אֶל־בִּלְעָם וַיֹּאמֶר מִי
הָאֲנָשִׁים הָאֵלֶּה עִמָּךְ **10** וַיֹּאמֶר בִּלְעָם אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים בָּלָק בֶּן־צִפּוֹר מֶלֶךְ מוֹאָב שָׁלַח אֵלָי **11** הִנֵּה
הָעָם הַיֹּצֵא מִמִּצְרַיִם וְיָכֵס אֶת־עֵין הָאָרֶץ עַתָּה לְכָה קָבָה־לִּי אֹתוֹ אוּלַי אוּכַל לְהִלָּחֶם בּוֹ וְגָרַשְׁתִּיו
**12** וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֶל־בִּלְעָם לֹא תֵלֵךְ עִמָּהֶם לֹא תָאֹר אֶת־הָעָם כִּי בָרוּךְ הוּא **13** וַיָּקָם בִּלְעָם
בַּבֹּקֶר וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־שָׂרֵי בָלָק לְכוּ אֶל־אַרְצְכֶם כִּי מֵאֵן יְהוָה לְהִתְּהֵלֵךְ עִמָּכֶם **14** וַיָּקוּמוּ שָׂרֵי
מוֹאָב וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־בָּלָק וַיֹּאמְרוּ מֵאֵן בִּלְעָם הָלֵךְ עִמָּנוּ **15** וַיֹּסֶף עוֹד בָּלָק שְׁלֹחַ שָׂרִים רַבִּים וְנִכְבָּדִים
מֵאֵלֶּה **16** וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־בִּלְעָם וַיֹּאמְרוּ לוֹ כֹּה אָמַר בָּלָק בֶּן־צִפּוֹר אַל־נָא תִמָּנַע מֵהֲלֹךְ אֵלָי **17** כִּי־
כַבֵּד אֲכַבֶּדְךָ מְאֹד וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־תֹּאמַר אֵלַי אֶעֱשֶׂה וּלְכָה־נָּא קָבָה־לִּי אֵת הָעָם הַזֶּה **18** וַיַּעַן בִּלְעָם
וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־עַבְדֵי בָלָק אִם־יִתֶּן־לִי בָלָק מְלֹא בֵיתוֹ כֶּסֶף וְזָהָב לֹא אוּכַל לַעֲבֹר אֶת־פִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהָי
לַעֲשׂוֹת קְטַנָּה אוֹ גְדוֹלָה **19** וְעַתָּה שְׁבוּ נָא בָזֶה גַּם־אַתֶּם הַלָּיְלָה וְאֵדְעָה מַה־יֹּסֵף יְהוָה דַּבֵּר עִמִּי **20**
וַיָּבֹא אֱלֹהִים אֶל־בִּלְעָם לַיְלָה וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ אִם־לִקְרֹא לְךָ בָּאוּ הָאֲנָשִׁים קוּם לֵךְ אִתָּם וְאַךְ אֶת־הַדָּבָר
אֲשֶׁר־אֲדַבֶּר אֵלֶיךָ אֹתוֹ תַּעֲשֶׂה **21** וַיָּקָם בִּלְעָם בַּבֹּקֶר וַיַּחֲבֹשׁ אֶת־אֲתֹנוֹ וַיֵּלֶךְ עִם־שָׂרֵי מוֹאָב **22**
וַיִּחַר־אַף אֱלֹהִים כִּי־הוֹלֵךְ הוּא וַיִּתְיַצֵּב מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה בַּדֶּרֶךְ לְשָׂטָן לוֹ וְהוּא רֹכֵב עַל־אֲתֹנוֹ וּשְׁנֵי
נְעָרָיו עִמּוֹ **23** וַתֵּרֶא הָאָתוֹן אֶת־מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה נִצָּב בַּדֶּרֶךְ וְחַרְבּוֹ שְׁלוּפָה בְּיָדוֹ וַתֵּט הָאָתוֹן מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ
וַתֵּלֶךְ בַּשָּׂדֶה וַיַּךְ בִּלְעָם אֶת־הָאָתוֹן לְהַטֹּתָהּ הַדַּרְךְ **24** וַיַּעֲמֹד מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה בְּמִשְׁעוֹל הַכְּרָמִים גָּדֵר
מִזֶּה וְגָדֵר מִזֶּה **25** וַתֵּרֶא הָאָתוֹן אֶת־מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה וַתִּלָּחֵץ אֶל־הַקִּיר וַתִּלְחַץ אֶת־רֶגֶל בִּלְעָם אֶל־
הַקִּיר וַיֹּסֶף לְהַכֹּתָהּ **26** וַיּוֹסֶף מַלְאַךְ־יְהוָה עֲבוֹר וַיַּעֲמֹד בְּמָקוֹם צָר אֲשֶׁר אֵין־דֶּרֶךְ לִנְטוֹת יָמִין
וּשְׂמֹאוֹל **27** וַתֵּרֶא הָאָתוֹן אֶת־מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה וַתִּרְבַּץ תַּחַת בִּלְעָם וַיִּחַר־אַף בִּלְעָם וַיַּךְ אֶת הָאָתוֹן
בַּמַּקֵּל **28** וַיִּפְתַּח יְהוָה אֶת־פִּי הָאָתוֹן וַתֹּאמֶר לְבִלְעָם מָה־עָשִׂיתִי לָךְ כִּי הִכִּיתַנִי זֶה שָׁלֹשׁ רְגָלִים **29**
וַיֹּאמֶר בִּלְעָם לָאָתוֹן כִּי הִתְעַלַּלְתְּ בִּי לוּ יֶשׁ־חֶרֶב בְּיָדִי כִּי עַתָּה הֲרַגְתִּיךְ **30** וַתֹּאמֶר הָאָתוֹן אֶל־
בִּלְעָם הֲלוֹא אָנֹכִי אָתְּנֵךְ אֲשֶׁר־רָכַבְתָּ עָלַי מֵעוֹדְךָ עַד־הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה הַהַסְכֵּן הִסְכַּנְתִּי לַעֲשׂוֹת לְךָ כֹּה
וַיֹּאמֶר לֹא **31** וַיְגַל יְהוָה אֶת־עֵינֵי בִלְעָם וַיַּרְא אֶת־מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה נִצָּב בַּדֶּרֶךְ וְחַרְבּוֹ שְׁלֻפָה בְּיָדוֹ
וַיִּקֹּד וַיִּשְׁתַּחוּ לְאַפָּיו **32** וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה עַל־מָה הִכִּיתָ אֶת־אֲתֹנְךָ זֶה שָׁלֹשׁ רְגָלִים הִנֵּה
אָנֹכִי יָצָאתִי לְשָׂטָן כִּי־יָרַט הַדֶּרֶךְ לְנֶגְדִּי **33** וַתִּרְאַנִי הָאָתוֹן וַתֵּט לְפָנַי זֶה שָׁלֹשׁ רְגָלִים אוּלַי נָטְתָה
מִפָּנַי כִּי עַתָּה גַּם־אֹתְכָה הָרַגְתִּי וְאוֹתָהּ הֶחֱיֵיתִי **34** וַיֹּאמֶר בִּלְעָם אֶל־מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה חָטָאתִי כִּי לֹא
יָדַעְתִּי כִּי אַתָּה נִצָּב לִקְרָאתִי בַּדָּרֶךְ וְעַתָּה אִם־רַע בְּעֵינֶיךָ אֶשּׁוּבָה לִי **35** וַיֹּאמֶר מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה אֶל־
בִּלְעָם לֵךְ עִם־הָאֲנָשִׁים וְאֶפֶס אֶת־הַדָּבָר אֲשֶׁר־אֲדַבֵּר אֵלֶיךָ אֹתוֹ תְדַבֵּר וַיֵּלֶךְ בִּלְעָם עִם־שָׂרֵי בָלָק
**36** וַיִּשְׁמַע בָּלָק כִּי בָא בִלְעָם וַיֵּצֵא לִקְרָאתוֹ אֶל־עִיר מוֹאָב אֲשֶׁר עַל־גְּבוּל אַרְנֹן אֲשֶׁר בִּקְצֵה הַגְּבוּל
**37** וַיֹּאמֶר בָּלָק אֶל־בִּלְעָם הֲלֹא שָׁלֹחַ שָׁלַחְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ לִקְרֹא־לָךְ לָמָּה לֹא־הָלַכְתָּ אֵלַי הַאָמְנָם לֹא
אוּכַל כַּבֶּדְךָ **38** וַיֹּאמֶר בִּלְעָם אֶל־בָּלָק הִנֵּה־בָאתִי אֵלֶיךָ עַתָּה הֲיָכוֹל אוּכַל דַּבֵּר מְאוּמָה הַדָּבָר
אֲשֶׁר יָשִׂים אֱלֹהִים בְּפִי אֹתוֹ אֲדַבֵּר **39** וַיֵּלֶךְ בִּלְעָם עִם־בָּלָק וַיָּבֹאוּ קִרְיַת חֻצוֹת **40** וַיִּזְבַּח בָּלָק בָּקָר
וְצֹאן וַיִּשְׁלַח לְבִלְעָם וְלַשָּׂרִים אֲשֶׁר אִתּוֹ **41** וַיְהִי בַבֹּקֶר וַיִּקַּח בָּלָק אֶת־בִּלְעָם וַיַּעֲלֵהוּ בָּמוֹת בָּעַל
וַיַּרְא מִשָּׁם קְצֵה הָעָם

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the Israelites traveled on and camped in the plains of Moab near the Jordan, across from Jericho. **2** Now Balak son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites, **3** and Moab was terrified of the people because they were numerous. Indeed, Moab dreaded the Israelites. **4** So the Moabites said to the elders of Midian, “This horde will devour everything around us, as an ox licks up the grass of the field.” Since Balak son of Zippor was king of Moab at that time, **5** he sent messengers to Balaam son of Beor at Pethor, which is by the Euphrates in the land of his people. “Behold, a people has come out of Egypt,” said Balak. “They cover the face of the land and have settled next to me. **6** So please come now and put a curse on this people, because they are too mighty for me. Perhaps I may be able to defeat them and drive them out of the land; for I know that those you bless are blessed, and those you curse are cursed.” **7** The elders of Moab and Midian departed with the fees for divination in hand. They came to Balaam and relayed to him the words of Balak. **8** “Spend the night here,” Balaam replied, “and I will give you the answer that the LORD speaks to me.” So the princes of Moab stayed with Balaam. **9** Then God came to Balaam and asked, “Who are these men with you?” **10** And Balaam said to God, “Balak son of Zippor, king of Moab, sent me this message: **11** ‘Behold, a people has come out of Egypt, and they cover the face of the land. Now come and put a curse on them for me. Perhaps I may be able to fight against them and drive them away.’” **12** But God said to Balaam, “Do not go with them. You are not to curse this people, for they are blessed.” **13** So Balaam got up the next morning and said to Balak’s princes, “Go back to your homeland, because the LORD has refused to let me go with you.” **14** And the princes of Moab arose, returned to Balak, and said, “Balaam refused to come with us.” **15** Then Balak sent other princes, more numerous and more distinguished than the first messengers. **16** They came to Balaam and said, “This is what Balak son of Zippor says: ‘Please let nothing hinder you from coming to me, **17** for I will honor you richly and do whatever you say. So please come and put a curse on this people for me!’” **18** But Balaam replied to the servants of Balak, “If Balak were to give me his house full of silver and gold, I could not do anything small or great to go beyond the command of the LORD my God. **19** So now, please stay here overnight as the others did, that I may find out what else the LORD has to tell me.” **20** That night God came to Balaam and said, “Since these men have come to summon you, get up and go with them, but you must only do what I tell you.” **21** So in the morning Balaam got up, saddled his donkey, and went with the princes of Moab. **22** Then God’s anger was kindled because Balaam was going along, and the angel of the LORD stood in the road to oppose him. Balaam was riding his donkey, and his two servants were with him. **23** When the donkey saw the angel of the LORD standing in the road with a drawn sword in his hand, she turned off the path and went into a field. So Balaam beat her to return her to the path. **24** Then the angel of the LORD stood in a narrow passage between two vineyards, with

walls on either side. **25** And the donkey saw the angel of the LORD and pressed herself against the wall, crushing Balaam's foot against it. So he beat her once again. **26** And the angel of the LORD moved on ahead and stood in a narrow place where there was no room to turn to the right or left. **27** When the donkey saw the angel of the LORD, she lay down under Balaam, and he became furious and beat her with his staff. **28** Then the LORD opened the donkey's mouth, and she said to Balaam, "What have I done to you that you have beaten me these three times?" **29** Balaam answered the donkey, "You have made a fool of me! If I had a sword in my hand, I would kill you right now!" **30** But the donkey said to Balaam, "Am I not the donkey you have ridden all your life until today? Have I ever treated you this way before?" "No," he replied. **31** Then the LORD opened Balaam's eyes, and he saw the angel of the LORD standing in the road with a drawn sword in his hand. And Balaam bowed low and fell facedown. **32** The angel of the LORD asked him, "Why have you beaten your donkey these three times? Behold, I have come out to oppose you, because your way is perverse before me. **33** The donkey saw me and turned away from me these three times. If she had not turned away, then by now I would surely have killed you and let her live." **34** "I have sinned," Balaam said to the angel of the LORD, "for I did not realize that you were standing in the road to confront me. And now, if this is displeasing in your sight, I will go back home." **35** But the angel of the LORD said to Balaam, "Go with the men, but you are to speak only what I tell you." So Balaam went with the princes of Balak. **36** When Balak heard that Balaam was coming, he went out to meet him at the Moabite city on the Arnon border, at the edge of his territory. **37** And he said to Balaam, "Did I not send you an urgent summons? Why did you not come to me? Am I really not able to richly reward you?" **38** "See, I have come to you," Balaam replied, "but can I say just anything? I must speak only the word that God puts in my mouth." **39** So Balaam accompanied Balak, and they came to Kiriath-huzoth. **40** Balak sacrificed cattle and sheep, and he gave portions to Balaam and the princes who were with him. **41** The next morning, Balak took Balaam and brought him up to Bamoth-baal. From there he could see the outskirts of the camp of the people.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The children of Israel traveled, and encamped in the plains of Moab beyond the Jordan at Jericho. **2** Balak the son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites. **3** Moab was very afraid of the people, because they were many. Moab was distressed because of the children of Israel. **4** Moab said to the elders of Midian, "Now this multitude will lick up all that is around us, as the ox licks up the grass of the field." Balak the son of Zippor was king of Moab at that time. **5** He sent messengers to Balaam the son of Beor, to Pethor, which is by the River, to the land of the children of his people, to call him, saying, "Behold, there is a people who came out of Egypt. Behold, they cover the

surface of the earth, and they are staying opposite me. **6** Please come now therefore, and curse this people for me; for they are too mighty for me. Perhaps I shall prevail, that we may strike them, and that I may drive them out of the land; for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed." **7** The elders of Moab and the elders of Midian departed with the rewards of divination in their hand. They came to Balaam, and spoke to him the words of Balak. **8** He said to them, "Lodge here this night, and I will bring you word again, as the LORD shall speak to me." The princes of Moab stayed with Balaam. **9** God came to Balaam, and said, "Who are these men with you?" **10** Balaam said to God, "Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, has said to me, **11** 'Behold, the people that has come out of Egypt covers the surface of the earth. Now, come curse them for me. Perhaps I shall be able to fight against them, and shall drive them out.'" **12** God said to Balaam, "You shall not go with them. You shall not curse the people, for they are blessed." **13** Balaam rose up in the morning, and said to the princes of Balak, "Go to your land; for the LORD refuses to permit me to go with you." **14** The princes of Moab rose up, and they went to Balak, and said, "Balaam refuses to come with us." **15** Balak again sent princes, more, and more honorable than they. **16** They came to Balaam, and said to him, "Balak the son of Zippor says, 'Please let nothing hinder you from coming to me, **17** for I will promote you to very great honor, and whatever you say to me I will do. Please come therefore, and curse this people for me.'" **18** Balaam answered the servants of Balak, "If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I can't go beyond the word of the LORD my God, to do less or more. **19** Now therefore please stay here tonight as well, that I may know what else the LORD will speak to me." **20** God came to Balaam at night, and said to him, "If the men have come to call you, rise up, go with them; but only the word which I speak to you, that you shall do." **21** Balaam rose up in the morning, and saddled his donkey, and went with the princes of Moab. **22** God's anger burned because he went; and the LORD's angel placed himself in the way as an adversary against him. Now he was riding on his donkey, and his two servants were with him. **23** The donkey saw the LORD's angel standing in the way, with his sword drawn in his hand; and the donkey turned out of the path, and went into the field. Balaam struck the donkey, to turn her into the path. **24** Then the LORD's angel stood in a narrow path between the vineyards, a wall being on this side, and a wall on that side. **25** The donkey saw the LORD's angel, and she thrust herself to the wall, and crushed Balaam's foot against the wall. He struck her again. **26** The LORD's angel went further, and stood in a narrow place, where there was no way to turn either to the right hand or to the left. **27** The donkey saw the LORD's angel, and she lay down under Balaam. Balaam's anger burned, and he struck the donkey with his staff. **28** The LORD opened the mouth of the donkey, and she said to Balaam, "What have I done to you, that you have struck me these three times?" **29** Balaam said to the donkey, "Because you have mocked me, I wish there were a sword in my hand, for now I would have killed you." **30** The donkey said to Balaam, "Am I not your donkey, on which

you have ridden all your life long until today? Was I ever in the habit of doing so to you?" He said, "No." **31** Then the LORD opened the eyes of Balaam, and he saw the LORD's angel standing in the way, with his sword drawn in his hand; and he bowed his head, and fell on his face. **32** The LORD's angel said to him, "Why have you struck your donkey these three times? Behold, I have come out as an adversary, because your way is perverse before me. **33** The donkey saw me, and turned away before me these three times. Unless she had turned away from me, surely now I would have killed you, and saved her alive." **34** Balaam said to the LORD's angel, "I have sinned; for I didn't know that you stood in the way against me. Now therefore, if it displeases you, I will go back again." **35** The LORD's angel said to Balaam, "Go with the men; but you shall only speak the word that I shall speak to you." So Balaam went with the princes of Balak. **36** When Balak heard that Balaam had come, he went out to meet him to the City of Moab, which is on the border of the Arnon, which is in the utmost part of the border. **37** Balak said to Balaam, "Didn't I earnestly send for you to summon you? Why didn't you come to me? Am I not able indeed to promote you to honor?" **38** Balaam said to Balak, "Behold, I have come to you. Have I now any power at all to speak anything? I will speak the word that God puts in my mouth." **39** Balaam went with Balak, and they came to Kiriath Huzoth. **40** Balak sacrificed cattle and sheep, and sent to Balaam, and to the princes who were with him. **41** In the morning, Balak took Balaam, and brought him up into the high places of Baal; and he saw from there part of the people.

## Numbers 23

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיֹּאמֶר בִּלְעָם אֶל־בָּלָק בְּנֵה־לִי בָזֶה שִׁבְעָה מִזְבְּחֹת וְהָכֵן לִי בָּזֶה שִׁבְעָה פָרִים וְשִׁבְעָה אֵילִים **2**
וַיַּעַשׂ בָּלָק כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר בִּלְעָם וַיַּעַל בָּלָק וּבִלְעָם פָּר וָאַיִל בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ **3** וַיֹּאמֶר בִּלְעָם לְבָלָק הְתְיַצֵּב
עַל־עֹלָתֶךָ וְאֵלְכָה אוּלַי יִקָּרֶה יְהוָה לִקְרָאתִי וּדְבַר מַה־יַּרְאֵנִי וְהִגַּדְתִּי לָךְ וַיֵּלֶךְ שָׁפִי **4** וַיִּקַּר אֱלֹהִים
אֶל־בִּלְעָם וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו אֶת־שִׁבְעַת הַמִּזְבְּחֹת עָרַכְתִּי וָאַעַל פָּר וָאַיִל בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ **5** וַיָּשֶׂם יְהוָה דָּבָר בְּפִי
בִלְעָם וַיֹּאמֶר שׁוּב אֶל־בָּלָק וְכֹה תְדַבֵּר **6** וַיָּשָׁב אֵלָיו וְהִנֵּה נִצָּב עַל־עֹלָתוֹ הוּא וְכָל־שָׂרֵי מוֹאָב **7**
וַיִּשָּׂא מְשָׁלוֹ וַיֹּאמַר מִן־אֲרָם יַנְחֵנִי בָלָק מֶלֶךְ־מוֹאָב מֵהָרְרֵי־קֶדֶם לְכָה אָרָה־לִּי יַעֲקֹב וּלְכָה זֹעֲמָה
יִשְׂרָאֵל **8** מָה אֶקֹּב לֹא קַבֹּה אֵל וּמָה אֶזְעֹם לֹא זָעַם יְהוָה **9** כִּי־מֵרֹאשׁ צֻרִים אֶרְאֶנּוּ וּמִגְּבָעוֹת
אֲשׁוּרֶנּוּ הֶן־עָם לְבָדָד יִשְׁכֹּן וּבַגּוֹיִם לֹא יִתְחַשָּׁב **10** מִי מָנָה עֲפַר יַעֲקֹב וּמִסְפָּר אֶת־רֹבַע יִשְׂרָאֵל תָּמֹת
נַפְשִׁי מוֹת יְשָׁרִים וּתְהִי אַחֲרִיתִי כָּמֹהוּ **11** וַיֹּאמֶר בָּלָק אֶל־בִּלְעָם מָה עָשִׂיתָ לִי לָקֹב אֹיְבַי לְקַחְתִּיךָ
וְהִנֵּה בֵּרַכְתָּ בָרֶךְ **12** וַיַּעַן וַיֹּאמַר הֲלֹא אֵת אֲשֶׁר יָשִׂם יְהוָה בְּפִי אֹתוֹ אִשָּׁמֵר לְדַבֵּר **13** וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו
בָּלָק לְךָ־נָּא אִתִּי אֶל־מָקוֹם אַחֵר אֲשֶׁר תִּרְאֶנּוּ מִשָּׁם אֶפֶס קָצֵהוּ תִרְאֶה וְכֻלּוֹ לֹא תִרְאֶה וְקָבְנוֹ־לִי
מִשָּׁם **14** וַיִּקָּחֵהוּ שְׂדֵה צֹפִים אֶל־רֹאשׁ הַפִּסְגָּה וַיִּבֶן שִׁבְעָה מִזְבְּחֹת וַיַּעַל פָּר וָאַיִל בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ **15** וַיֹּאמֶר
אֶל־בָּלָק הְתְיַצֵּב כֹּה עַל־עֹלָתֶךָ וְאָנֹכִי אִקָּרֶה כֹּה **16** וַיִּקֶר יְהוָה אֶל־בִּלְעָם וַיָּשֶׂם דָּבָר בְּפִיו וַיֹּאמֶר
שׁוּב אֶל־בָּלָק וְכֹה תְדַבֵּר **17** וַיָּבֹא אֵלָיו וְהִנּוֹ נִצָּב עַל־עֹלָתוֹ וְשָׂרֵי מוֹאָב אִתּוֹ וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ בָּלָק מַה־
דִּבֶּר יְהוָה **18** וַיִּשָּׂא מְשָׁלוֹ וַיֹּאמַר קוּם בָּלָק וּשְׁמָע הַאֲזִינָה עָדַי בְּנוֹ צִפֹּר **19** לֹא אִישׁ אֵל וְיכַזֵּב וּבֶן־

אָדָם וְיִתְנַחֵם הַהוּא אָמַר וְלֹא יַעֲשֶׂה וְדִבֶּר וְלֹא יְקִימֶנָּה **20** הִנֵּה בָרֵךְ לָקָחְתִּי וּבֵרַךְ וְלֹא אֲשִׁיבֶנָּה **21**
לֹא־הִבִּיט אָוֶן בְּיַעֲקֹב וְלֹא־רָאָה עָמָל בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל יְהוָה אֱלֹהָיו עִמּוֹ וּתְרוּעַת מֶלֶךְ בּוֹ **22** אֵל מוֹצִיאָם
מִמִּצְרַיִם כְּתוֹעֲפֹת רְאֵם לוֹ **23** כִּי לֹא־נַחַשׁ בְּיַעֲקֹב וְלֹא־קֶסֶם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל כָּעֵת יֵאָמֵר לְיַעֲקֹב וּלְיִשְׂרָאֵל
מַה־פָּעַל אֵל **24** הֶן־עָם כְּלָבִיא יָקוּם וְכַאֲרִי יִתְנַשָּׂא לֹא יִשְׁכַּב עַד־יֹאכַל טֶרֶף וְדַם־חֲלָלִים יִשְׁתֶּה **25**
וַיֹּאמֶר בָּלָק אֶל־בִּלְעָם גַּם־קֹב לֹא תְקֻבֶנּוּ גַּם־בָּרֵךְ לֹא תְבָרְכֶנּוּ **26** וַיַּעַן בִּלְעָם וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־בָּלָק
הֲלֹא דִבַּרְתִּי אֵלֶיךָ לֵאמֹר כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־יְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֹתוֹ אֶעֱשֶׂה **27** וַיֹּאמֶר בָּלָק אֶל־בִּלְעָם לְכָה־נָּא
אֶקָּחֲךָ אֶל־מָקוֹם אַחֵר אוּלַי יִישַׁר בְּעֵינֵי הָאֱלֹהִים וְקַבֹּתוֹ לִי מִשָּׁם **28** וַיִּקַּח בָּלָק אֶת־בִּלְעָם רֹאשׁ
הַפְּעוֹר הַנְּשָׁקֻף עַל־פְּנֵי הַיְשִׁימֹן **29** וַיֹּאמֶר בִּלְעָם אֶל־בָּלָק בְּנֵה־לִי בָזֶה שִׁבְעָה מִזְבְּחֹת וְהָכֵן לִי בָּזֶה
שִׁבְעָה פָרִים וְשִׁבְעָה אֵילִים **30** וַיַּעַשׂ בָּלָק כַּאֲשֶׁר אָמַר בִּלְעָם וַיַּעַל פָּר וָאַיִל בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then Balaam said to Balak, “Build for me seven altars here, and prepare for me seven bulls and seven rams.” **2** So Balak did as Balaam had instructed, and Balak and Balaam offered a bull and a ram on each altar. **3** “Stay here by your burnt offering while I am gone,” Balaam said to Balak. “Perhaps the LORD will meet with me. And whatever He reveals to me, I will tell you.” So Balaam went off to a barren height, **4** and God met with him. “I have set up seven altars,” Balaam said, “and on each altar I have offered a bull and a ram.” **5** Then the LORD put a message in Balaam’s mouth, saying, “Return to Balak and give him this message.” **6** So he returned to Balak, who was standing there beside his burnt offering, with all the princes of Moab. **7** And Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying: “Balak brought me from Aram, the king of Moab from the mountains of the east. ‘Come,’ he said, ‘put a curse on Jacob for me; come and denounce Israel!’ **8** How can I curse what God has not cursed? How can I denounce what the LORD has not denounced? **9** For I see them from atop the rocky cliffs, and I watch them from the hills. Behold, a people dwelling apart, not reckoning themselves among the nations. **10** Who can count the dust of Jacob or number even a fourth of Israel? Let me die the death of the righteous; let my end be like theirs!” **11** Then Balak said to Balaam, “What have you done to me? I brought you here to curse my enemies, and behold, you have only blessed them!” **12** But Balaam replied, “Should I not speak exactly what the LORD puts in my mouth?” **13** Then Balak said to him, “Please come with me to another place where you can see them. You will only see the outskirts of their camp—not all of them. And from there, curse them for me.” **14** So Balak took him to the field of Zophim, to the top of Pisgah, where he built seven altars and offered a bull and a ram on each altar. **15** Balaam said to Balak, “Stay here beside your burnt offering while I meet the LORD over there.” **16** And the LORD met with Balaam and put a message in his mouth, saying, “Return to Balak and speak what I tell you.” **17** So he returned to Balak, who was standing there by his burnt offering with the princes of Moab. “What did the LORD say?” Balak asked. **18** Then Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying: “Arise, O Balak, and listen; give ear to me, O son of Zippor. **19** God is not a man, that He should lie, or a son of man, that He should change His mind. Does He speak

and not act? Does He promise and not fulfill? **20** I have indeed received a command to bless; He has blessed, and I cannot change it. **21** He considers no disaster for Jacob; He sees no trouble for Israel. The LORD their God is with them, and the shout of the King is among them. **22** God brought them out of Egypt with strength like a wild ox. **23** For there is no spell against Jacob and no divination against Israel. It will now be said of Jacob and Israel, 'What great things God has done!' **24** Behold, the people rise like a lioness; they rouse themselves like a lion, not resting until they devour their prey and drink the blood of the slain." **25** Now Balak said to Balaam, "Then neither curse them at all nor bless them at all!" **26** But Balaam replied, "Did I not tell you that whatever the LORD says, I must do?" **27** "Please come," said Balak, "I will take you to another place. Perhaps it will please God that you curse them for me from there." **28** And Balak took Balaam to the top of Peor, which overlooks the wasteland. **29** Then Balaam said, "Build for me seven altars here, and prepare for me seven bulls and seven rams." **30** So Balak did as Balaam had instructed, and he offered a bull and a ram on each altar.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Balaam said to Balak, "Build here seven altars for me, and prepare here seven bulls and seven rams for me." **2** Balak did as Balaam had spoken; and Balak and Balaam offered on every altar a bull and a ram. **3** Balaam said to Balak, "Stand by your burnt offering, and I will go. Perhaps the LORD will come to meet me. Whatever he shows me I will tell you." He went to a bare height. **4** God met Balaam, and he said to him, "I have prepared the seven altars, and I have offered up a bull and a ram on every altar." **5** The LORD put a word in Balaam's mouth, and said, "Return to Balak, and thus you shall speak." **6** He returned to him, and behold, he was standing by his burnt offering, he, and all the princes of Moab. **7** He took up his parable, and said, "From Aram has Balak brought me, the king of Moab from the mountains of the East. Come, curse Jacob for me. Come, defy Israel. **8** How shall I curse whom God has not cursed? How shall I defy whom the LORD has not defied? **9** For from the top of the rocks I see him. From the hills I see him. Behold, it is a people that dwells alone, and shall not be listed among the nations. **10** Who can count the dust of Jacob, or count the fourth part of Israel? Let me die the death of the righteous! Let my last end be like his!" **11** Balak said to Balaam, "What have you done to me? I took you to curse my enemies, and behold, you have blessed them altogether." **12** He answered and said, "Must I not take heed to speak that which the LORD puts in my mouth?" **13** Balak said to him, "Please come with me to another place, where you may see them. You shall see just part of them, and shall not see them all. Curse them from there for me." **14** He took him into the field of Zophim, to the top of Pisgah, and built seven altars, and offered up a bull and a ram on every altar. **15** He said to Balak, "Stand here by your burnt offering, while I meet God over there." **16** The LORD met Balaam, and put a word in his mouth, and said, "Return to Balak,

and say this.” **17** He came to him, and behold, he was standing by his burnt offering, and the princes of Moab with him. Balak said to him, “What has the LORD spoken?” **18** He took up his parable, and said, “Rise up, Balak, and hear! Listen to me, you son of Zippor. **19** God is not a man, that he should lie, nor a son of man, that he should repent. Has he said, and he won’t do it? Or has he spoken, and he won’t make it good? **20** Behold, I have received a command to bless. He has blessed, and I can’t reverse it. **21** He has not seen iniquity in Jacob. Neither has he seen perverseness in Israel. The LORD his God is with him. The shout of a king is among them. **22** God brings them out of Egypt. He has as it were the strength of the wild ox. **23** Surely there is no enchantment with Jacob; neither is there any divination with Israel. Now it shall be said of Jacob and of Israel, ‘What has God done!’ **24** Behold, a people rises up as a lioness. As a lion he lifts himself up. He shall not lie down until he eats of the prey, and drinks the blood of the slain.” **25** Balak said to Balaam, “Neither curse them at all, nor bless them at all.” **26** But Balaam answered Balak, “Didn’t I tell you, saying, ‘All that the LORD speaks, that I must do’?” **27** Balak said to Balaam, “Come now, I will take you to another place; perhaps it will please God that you may curse them for me from there.” **28** Balak took Balaam to the top of Peor, that looks down on the desert. **29** Balaam said to Balak, “Build seven altars for me here, and prepare seven bulls and seven rams for me here.” **30** Balak did as Balaam had said, and offered up a bull and a ram on every altar.

## Numbers 24

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיַּ֤רְא בִּלְעָם֙ כִּי֙ ט֣וֹב בְּעֵינֵ֣י יְהוָ֔ה לְבָרֵ֖ךְ אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל וְלֹא־הָלַ֤ךְ כְּפַ֙עַם֙־בְּפַ֔עַם לִקְרַ֖את נְחָשִׁ֑ים וַיָּ֥שֶׁת
אֶל־הַמִּדְבָּ֖ר פָּנָֽיו **2** וַיִּשָּׂ֤א בִלְעָם֙ אֶת־עֵינָ֔יו וַיַּ֖רְא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל שֹׁכֵ֥ן לִשְׁבָטָ֖יו וַתְּהִ֥י עָלָ֛יו רוּחַ֥ אֱלֹהִֽים **3**
וַיִּשָּׂ֥א מְשָׁלֹ֖ו וַיֹּאמַ֑ר נְאֻ֥ם בִּלְעָ֛ם בְּנ֥וֹ בְעֹ֖ר וּנְאֻ֣ם הַגֶּ֑בֶר שְׁתֹ֖ם הָעָֽיִן **4** נְאֻ֥ם שֹׁמֵ֛עַ אִמְרֵי־אֵ֖ל אֲשֶׁ֣ר מַחֲזֵ֑ה
שַׁדַּ֥י יֶחֱזֶ֖ה נֹפֵ֥ל וּגְלוּי֖ עֵינָֽיִם **5** מַה־טֹּ֥בוּ אֹהָלֶ֛יךָ יַעֲקֹ֖ב מִשְׁכְּנֹתֶ֑יךָ יִשְׂרָאֵֽל **6** כִּנְחָלִ֣ים נְטָ֔יוּ כְּגַנֹּ֖ת עֲלֵ֣י
נָהָ֑ר כַּאֲהָלִ֣ים נָטַ֔ע יְהוָ֖ה כַּאֲרָזִ֥ים עֲלֵי־מָֽיִם **7** יִזַּל־מַ֙יִם֙ מִדָּלָ֔יו וְזַרְעוֹ֖ בְּמַ֣יִם רַבִּ֑ים וְיָרֹ֤ם מֵאֲגַג֙ מַלְכּ֔וֹ
וְתִנַּשֵּׂ֖א מַלְכֻתֹֽו **8** אֵ֚ל מוֹצִיא֣וֹ מִמִּצְרַ֔יִם כְּתוֹעֲפֹ֥ת רְאֵ֖ם לֹ֑ו יֹאכַ֞ל גּוֹיִ֤ם צָרָיו֙ וְעַצְמֹתֵיהֶ֣ם יְגָרֵ֔ם וְחִצָּ֖יו
יִמְחָֽץ **9** כָּרַ֤ע שָׁכַב֙ כַּאֲרִ֣י וּכְלָבִ֔יא מִ֥י יְקִימֶ֖נּוּ מְבָרֲכֶ֣יךָ בָר֑וּךְ וְאֹרְרֶ֖יךָ אָר֥וּר **10** וַיִּֽחַר־אַ֤ף בָּלָק֙ אֶל־
בִּלְעָ֔ם וַיִּסְפֹּ֥ק אֶת־כַּפָּ֖יו וַיֹּ֣אמֶר בָּלָ֑ק אֶל־בִּלְעָ֕ם לָקֹ֥ב אֹיְבַ֖י קְרָאתִ֑יךָ וְהִנֵּ֥ה בֵּרַ֛כְתָּ בָּרֶ֖ךְ זֶ֥ה שָׁלֹֽשׁ
פְּעָמִֽים **11** וְעַתָּ֕ה בְּרַח־לְךָ֖ אֶל־מְקוֹמֶ֑ךָ אָמַ֙רְתִּי֙ כַּבֵּ֣ד אֲכַבֶּדְךָ֔ וְהִנֵּ֥ה מְנָעֲךָ֖ יְהוָ֥ה מִכָּבֽוֹד **12** וַיֹּ֤אמֶר
בִּלְעָם֙ אֶל־בָּלָ֔ק הֲלֹא֙ גַּ֣ם אֶל־מַלְאָכֶ֔יךָ אֲשֶׁר־שָׁלַ֖חְתָּ אֵלַ֑י דִּבַּ֖רְתִּי לֵאמֹֽר **13** אִם־יִתֶּן־לִ֨י בָלָ֜ק מְלֹ֣א
בֵיתֹ֗ו כֶּ֚סֶף וְזָהָב֙ לֹ֣א אוּכַ֔ל לַעֲבֹ֖ר אֶת־פִּ֣י יְהוָ֑ה לַעֲשׂ֥וֹת טוֹבָ֛ה אוֹ֥ רָעָ֖ה מִלִּבִּ֑י אֲשֶׁר־יְדַבֵּ֥ר יְהוָ֖ה אֹתֹ֥ו
אֲדַבֵּֽר **14** וְעַתָּ֕ה הִנְנִ֥י הוֹלֵ֖ךְ לְעַמִּ֑י לְכָה֙ אִיָּעֲצְךָ֔ אֲשֶׁ֥ר יַעֲשֶׂ֛ה הָעָ֥ם הַזֶּ֖ה לְעַמְּךָ֥ בְּאַחֲרִ֖ית הַיָּמִֽים **15**
וַיִּשָּׂ֥א מְשָׁלֹ֖ו וַיֹּאמַ֑ר נְאֻ֥ם בִּלְעָ֛ם בְּנ֥וֹ בְעֹ֖ר וּנְאֻ֣ם הַגֶּ֑בֶר שְׁתֹ֖ם הָעָֽיִן **16** נְאֻ֥ם שֹׁמֵ֛עַ אִמְרֵי־אֵ֖ל וְיֹדֵ֣עַ דַּ֔עַת
עָלְיֹ֥ון מַחֲזֵ֖ה שַׁדַּ֣י יֶחֱזֶ֑ה נֹפֵ֥ל וּגְלוּי֖ עֵינָֽיִם **17** אֶרְאֶ֙נּוּ֙ וְלֹ֣א עַתָּ֔ה אֲשׁוּרֶ֖נּוּ וְלֹ֣א קָר֑וֹב דָּרַ֤ךְ כֹּוכָב֙ מִיַּעֲקֹ֔ב
וְקָ֥ם שֵׁ֛בֶט מִיִּשְׂרָאֵ֖ל וּמָחַ֣ץ פַּאֲתֵ֣י מוֹאָ֔ב וְקַרְקַ֖ר כָּל־בְּנֵ֥י שֵֽׁת **18** וְהָיָ֥ה אֱדוֹם֙ יְרֵשָׁ֔ה וְהָיָ֥ה יְרֵשָׁ֖ה שֵׂעִ֑יר
אֹיְבָ֖יו וְיִשְׂרָאֵ֥ל עֹשֶׂ֖ה חָֽיִל **19** וְיֵרְדְ֥ מִיַּעֲקֹ֖ב וְהֵאֲבִ֣יד שָׂרִ֑יד מֵעִֽיר **20** וַיַּ֤רְא אֶת־עֲמָלֵק֙ וַיִּשָּׂ֣א מְשָׁלֹ֔ו

וַיֹּאמַר רַאשִׁית גּוֹיִם עֲמָלֵק וְאַחֲרִיתוֹ עֲדֵי אֹבֵד **21** וַיַּרְא אֶת־הַקֵּינִי וַיִּשָּׂא מְשָׁלוֹ וַיֹּאמַר אֵיתָן מוֹשָׁבֶךָ
וְשִׂים בַּסֶּלַע קִנֶּךָ **22** כִּי אִם־יִהְיֶה לְבָעֵר קָיִן עַד־מָה אַשּׁוּר תִּשְׁבֶּךָּ **23** וַיִּשָּׂא מְשָׁלוֹ וַיֹּאמַר אוֹי מִי
יִחְיֶה מִשָּׂמוֹ אֵל **24** וְצִים מִיַּד כִּתִּים וְעִנּוּ אַשּׁוּר וְעִנּוּ־עֵבֶר וְגַם־הוּא עֲדֵי אֹבֵד **25** וַיָּקָם בִּלְעָם וַיֵּלֶךְ
וַיָּשָׁב לִמְקֹמוֹ וְגַם־בָּלָק הָלַךְ לְדַרְכּוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**1** And when Balaam saw that it pleased the LORD to bless Israel, he did not resort to sorcery as on previous occasions, but he turned his face toward the wilderness. **2** When Balaam looked up and saw Israel encamped tribe by tribe, the Spirit of God came upon him, **3** and he lifted up an oracle, saying: “This is the prophecy of Balaam son of Beor, the prophecy of a man whose eyes are open, **4** the prophecy of one who hears the words of God, who sees a vision from the Almighty, who bows down with eyes wide open: **5** How lovely are your tents, O Jacob, your dwellings, O Israel! **6** They spread out like palm groves, like gardens beside a stream, like aloes the LORD has planted, like cedars beside the waters. **7** Water will flow from his buckets, and his seed will have abundant water. His king will be greater than Agag, and his kingdom will be exalted. **8** God brought him out of Egypt with strength like a wild ox, to devour hostile nations and crush their bones, to pierce them with arrows. **9** He crouches, he lies down like a lion; like a lioness, who dares to rouse him? Blessed are those who bless you and cursed are those who curse you.” **10** Then Balak’s anger burned against Balaam, and he struck his hands together and said to Balaam, “I summoned you to curse my enemies, but behold, you have persisted in blessing them these three times. **11** Therefore, flee at once to your home! I said I would richly reward you, but instead the LORD has denied your reward.” **12** Balaam answered Balak, “Did I not already tell the messengers you sent me **13** that even if Balak were to give me his house full of silver and gold, I could not do anything of my own accord, good or bad, to go beyond the command of the LORD? I will speak whatever the LORD says. **14** Now I am going back to my people, but come, let me warn you what this people will do to your people in the days to come.” **15** Then Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying, “This is the prophecy of Balaam son of Beor, the prophecy of a man whose eyes are open, **16** the prophecy of one who hears the words of God, who has knowledge from the Most High, who sees a vision from the Almighty, who bows down with eyes wide open: **17** I see him, but not now; I behold him, but not near. A star will come forth from Jacob, and a scepter will arise from Israel. He will crush the skulls of Moab and strike down all the sons of Sheth. **18** Edom will become a possession, as will Seir, his enemy; but Israel will perform with valor. **19** A ruler will come from Jacob and destroy the survivors of the city.” **20** Then Balaam saw Amalek and lifted up an oracle, saying: “Amalek was first among the nations, but his end is destruction.” **21** Next he saw the Kenites and lifted up an oracle, saying: “Your dwelling place is secure, and your nest is set in a cliff. **22** Yet Kain will be destroyed when Asshur takes you captive.” **23** Once more Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying:

“Ah, who can live unless God has ordained it? **24** Ships will come from the coasts of Cyprus; they will subdue Asshur and Eber, but they too will perish forever.” **25** Then Balaam arose and returned to his homeland, and Balak also went on his way.

*English (WEB)*

**1** When Balaam saw that it pleased the LORD to bless Israel, he didn’t go, as at the other times, to use divination, but he set his face toward the wilderness. **2** Balaam lifted up his eyes, and he saw Israel dwelling according to their tribes; and the Spirit of God came on him. **3** He took up his parable, and said, “Balaam the son of Beor says, the man whose eyes are open says; **4** he says, who hears the words of God, who sees the vision of the Almighty, falling down, and having his eyes open: **5** How goodly are your tents, Jacob, and your dwellings, Israel! **6** As valleys they are spread out, as gardens by the riverside, as aloes which the LORD has planted, as cedar trees beside the waters. **7** Water shall flow from his buckets. His seed shall be in many waters. His king shall be higher than Agag. His kingdom shall be exalted. **8** God brings him out of Egypt. He has as it were the strength of the wild ox. He shall consume the nations his adversaries, shall break their bones in pieces, and pierce them with his arrows. **9** He couched, he lay down as a lion, as a lioness; who shall rouse him up? Everyone who blesses you is blessed. Everyone who curses you is cursed.” **10** Balak’s anger burned against Balaam, and he struck his hands together. Balak said to Balaam, “I called you to curse my enemies, and, behold, you have altogether blessed them these three times. **11** Therefore, flee to your place, now! I thought to promote you to great honor; but, behold, the LORD has kept you back from honor.” **12** Balaam said to Balak, “Didn’t I also tell your messengers whom you sent to me, saying, **13** ‘If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I can’t go beyond the LORD’s word, to do either good or bad from my own mind. I will say what the LORD says’? **14** Now, behold, I go to my people. Come, I will inform you what this people shall do to your people in the latter days.” **15** He took up his parable, and said, “Balaam the son of Beor says, the man whose eyes are open says; **16** he says, who hears the words of God, knows the knowledge of the Most High, and who sees the vision of the Almighty, falling down, and having his eyes open: **17** I see him, but not now. I see him, but not near. A star will come out of Jacob. A scepter will rise out of Israel, and shall strike through the corners of Moab, and crush all the sons of Sheth. **18** Edom shall be a possession. Seir, his enemy, also shall be a possession, while Israel does valiantly. **19** Out of Jacob shall one have dominion, and shall destroy the remnant from the city.” **20** He looked at Amalek, and took up his parable, and said, “Amalek was the first of the nations, but his latter end shall come to destruction.” **21** He looked at the Kenite, and took up his parable, and said, “Your dwelling place is strong. Your nest is set in the rock. **22** Nevertheless Kain shall be wasted, until Asshur carries you away captive.” **23** He took up his parable, and said, “Alas, who

shall live when God does this? **24** But ships shall come from the coast of Kittim. They shall afflict Asshur, and shall afflict Eber. He also shall come to destruction." **25** Balaam rose up, and went and returned to his place; and Balak also went his way.

### Numbers 31:16

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**16** הֵן הֵנָּה הָיוּ לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּדְבַר בִּלְעָם לִמְסָר־מַעַל בַּיהוָה עַל־דִּבְר־פְּעוֹר וַתְּהִי הַמַּגֵּפָה בַּעֲדַת יְהוָה

*English (BSB)*

**16** "Look, these women caused the sons of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to turn unfaithfully against the LORD at Peor, so that the plague struck the congregation of the LORD.

*English (WEB)*

**16** Behold, these caused the children of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to commit trespass against the LORD in the matter of Peor, and so the plague was among the congregation of the LORD.

### Deuteronomy 34:5–6

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**5** וַיָּמָת שָׁם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד־יְהוָה בְּאֶרֶץ מוֹאָב עַל־פִּי יְהוָה **6** וַיִּקְבֹּר אֹתוֹ בַּגַּי בְּאֶרֶץ מוֹאָב מוּל בֵּית פְּעוֹר וְלֹא־יָדַע אִישׁ אֶת־קְבֻרָתוֹ עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

*English (BSB)*

**5** So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, as the LORD had said. **6** And He buried him in a valley in the land of Moab facing Beth-peor, and no one to this day knows the location of his grave.

*English (WEB)*

**5** So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, according to the LORD's word. **6** He buried him in the valley in the land of Moab opposite Beth Peor, but no man knows where his tomb is to this day.

### Proverbs 25:14

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**14** נְשִׂיאִים וְרוּחַ וְגֶשֶׁם אָיִן אִישׁ מִתְהַלֵּל בְּמַתַּת־שָׁקֶר

*English (BSB)*

**14** Like clouds and wind without rain is the man who boasts of gifts never given.

*English (WEB)*

**14** As clouds and wind without rain, so is he who boasts of gifts deceptively.

### Isaiah 57:20

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**20** וְהָרְשָׁעִים כַּיָּם נִגָּרֵשׁ כִּי הַשָּׁקֵט לֹא יוּכָל וַיִּגְרְשׁוּ מַיָּמָיו רֶפֶשׁ וָטִיט

*English (BSB)*

**20** But the wicked are like the storm-tossed sea, for it cannot be still, and its waves churn up mire and muck.

*English (WEB)*

**20** But the wicked are like the troubled sea; for it can’t rest and its waters cast up mire and mud.

### Ezekiel 34:2

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**2** בֶּן־אָדָם הִנָּבֵא עַל־רוֹעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הִנָּבֵא וְאָמַרְתָּ אֲלֵיהֶם לָרֹעִים כֹּה אָמַר אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה הוֹי רֹעֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר הָיוּ רֹעִים אוֹתָם הֲלוֹא הַצֹּאן יִרְעוּ הָרֹעִים

*English (BSB)*

**2** “Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy and tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: ’Woe to the shepherds of Israel, who only feed themselves! Should not the shepherds feed their flock?

*English (WEB)*

**2** “Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy, and tell them, even the shepherds, ’The Lord GOD says: “Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Shouldn’t the shepherds feed the sheep?

### Amos 4:11

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**11** הֲפֻכְתִּי בָכֶם כְּמַהְפֵּכַת אֱלֹהִים אֶת־סְדֹם וְאֶת־עֲמֹרָה וַתִּהְיוּ כְּאוּד מֻצָּל מִשְּׂרֵפָה וְלֹא־שַׁבְתֶּם עָדַי נְאֻם־יְהוָה

*English (BSB)*

**11** “Some of you I overthrew as I overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and you were like a firebrand snatched from a blaze, yet you did not return to Me,” declares the LORD.

*English (WEB)*

**11** “I have overthrown some of you, as when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and you were like a burning stick plucked out of the fire; yet you haven’t returned to me,” says the LORD.

## Zechariah 1:10

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**10** וַיַּעַן הָאִישׁ הָעֹמֵד בֵּין־הַהֲדַסִּים וַיֹּאמַר אֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר שָׁלַח יְהוָה לְהִתְהַלֵּךְ בָּאָרֶץ

*English (BSB)*

**10** Then the man standing among the myrtle trees explained, “They are the ones the LORD has sent to patrol the earth.”

*English (WEB)*

**10** The man who stood among the myrtle trees answered, “They are the ones the LORD has sent to go back and forth through the earth.”

## Zechariah 3:2–4

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**2** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־הַשָּׂטָן יִגְעַר יְהוָה בְּךָ הַשָּׂטָן וְיִגְעַר יְהוָה בְּךָ הַבּוֹחֵר בִּירוּשָׁלִַם הֲלוֹא זֶה אוּד מֻצָּל מֵאֵשׁ **3** וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ הָיָה לָבֻשׁ בְּגָדִים צוֹאִים וְעֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הַמַּלְאָךְ **4** וַיַּעַן וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־הָעֹמְדִים לְפָנָיו לֵאמֹר הָסִירוּ הַבְּגָדִים הַצֹּאִים מֵעָלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו רְאֵה הֶעֱבַרְתִּי מֵעָלֶיךָ עֲוֹנֶךָ וְהַלְבֵּשׁ אֹתְךָ מַחֲלָצוֹת

*English (BSB)*

**2** And the LORD said to Satan: “The LORD rebukes you, Satan! Indeed, the LORD, who has chosen Jerusalem, rebukes you! Is not this man a firebrand snatched from the fire?” **3** Now Joshua was dressed in filthy garments as he stood before the angel. **4** So the angel said to those standing before him, “Take

off his filthy clothes!" Then he said to Joshua, "See, I have removed your iniquity, and I will clothe you with splendid robes."

*English (WEB)*

**2** The LORD said to Satan, "The LORD rebuke you, Satan! Yes, the LORD who has chosen Jerusalem rebuke you! Isn't this a burning stick plucked out of the fire?" **3** Now Joshua was clothed with filthy garments, and was standing before the angel. **4** He answered and spoke to those who stood before him, saying, "Take the filthy garments off him." To him he said, "Behold, I have caused your iniquity to pass from you, and I will clothe you with rich clothing."

### Matthew 1:25

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**25** καὶ οὐκ ἐγίνωσκεν αὐτὴν ἕως οὗ ἔτεκεν υἱόν· καὶ ἐκάλεσεν τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ Ἰησοῦν.

*English (BSB)*

**25** But he had no union with her until she gave birth to a Son. And he gave Him the name Jesus.

*English (WEB)*

**25** and didn't know her sexually until she had given birth to her firstborn son. He named him Jesus.

### Matthew 13:55

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**55** οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ τοῦ τέκτονος υἱός; οὐχ ἡ μήτηρ αὐτοῦ λέγεται Μαριὰμ καὶ οἱ ἀδελφοὶ αὐτοῦ Ἰάκωβος καὶ Ἰωσὴφ καὶ Σίμων καὶ Ἰούδας;

*English (BSB)*

**55** "Isn't this the carpenter's son? Isn't His mother's name Mary, and aren't His brothers James, Joseph, Simon, and Judas?

*English (WEB)*

**55** Isn't this the carpenter's son? Isn't his mother called Mary, and his brothers James, Joses, Simon, and Judas?

### Mark 6:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ τέκτων, ὁ υἱὸς τῆς Μαρίας καὶ ἀδελφὸς Ἰακώβου καὶ Ἰωσῆτος καὶ Ἰούδα καὶ Σίμωνος; καὶ οὐκ εἰσὶν αἱ ἀδελφαὶ αὐτοῦ ὧδε πρὸς ἡμᾶς; καὶ ἐσκανδαλίζοντο ἐν αὐτῷ.

*English (BSB)*

**3** Isn’t this the carpenter, the son of Mary and the brother of James, Joses, Judas, and Simon? Aren’t His sisters here with us as well?” And they took offense at Him.

*English (WEB)*

**3** Isn’t this the carpenter, the son of Mary and brother of James, Joses, Judah, and Simon? Aren’t his sisters here with us?” So they were offended at him.

## Luke 6:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** καὶ Ἰούδαν Ἰακώβου καὶ Ἰούδαν Ἰσκαριὼθ ὃς ἐγένετο προδότης.

*English (BSB)*

**16** Judas son of James, and Judas Iscariot, who became a traitor.

*English (WEB)*

**16** Judas the son of James; and Judas Iscariot, who also became a traitor.

## John 7:5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** οὐδὲ γὰρ οἱ ἀδελφοὶ αὐτοῦ ἐπίστευον εἰς αὐτόν.

*English (BSB)*

**5** For even His own brothers did not believe in Him.

*English (WEB)*

**5** For even his brothers didn’t believe in him.

## John 14:22

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**22** λέγει αὐτῷ Ἰούδας, οὐχ ὁ Ἰσκαριώτης· Κύριε, τί γέγονεν ὅτι ἡμῖν μέλλεις ἐμφανίζειν σεαυτὸν καὶ οὐχὶ τῷ κόσμῳ;

*English (BSB)*

**22** Judas (not Iscariot) asked Him, “Lord, why are You going to reveal Yourself to us and not to the world?”

*English (WEB)*

**22** Judas (not Iscariot) said to him, “Lord, what has happened that you are about to reveal yourself to us, and not to the world?”

## Acts 1:13–14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** καὶ ὅτε εἰσῆλθον, εἰς τὸ ὑπερῷον ἀνέβησαν οὗ ἦσαν καταμένοντες, ὅ τε Πέτρος καὶ Ἰωάννης καὶ Ἰάκωβος καὶ Ἀνδρέας, Φίλιππος καὶ Θωμᾶς, Βαρθολομαῖος καὶ Μαθθαῖος, Ἰάκωβος Ἁλφαίου καὶ Σίμων ὁ ζηλωτὴς καὶ Ἰούδας Ἰακώβου. **14** οὗτοι πάντες ἦσαν προσκαρτεροῦντες ὁμοθυμαδὸν τῇ προσευχῇ σὺν γυναιξὶν καὶ Μαριὰμ τῇ μητρὶ τοῦ Ἰησοῦ καὶ σὺν τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς αὐτοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**13** When they arrived, they went to the upper room where they were staying: Peter and John, James and Andrew, Philip and Thomas, Bartholomew and Matthew, James son of Alphaeus, Simon the Zealot, and Judas son of James. **14** With one accord they all continued in prayer, along with the women and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with His brothers.

*English (WEB)*

**13** When they had come in, they went up into the upper room where they were staying, that is Peter, John, James, Andrew, Philip, Thomas, Bartholomew, Matthew, James the son of Alphaeus, Simon the Zealot, and Judas the son of James. **14** All these with one accord continued steadfastly in prayer and supplication, along with the women and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with his brothers.

## Acts 15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Καί τινες κατελθόντες ἀπὸ τῆς Ἰουδαίας ἐδίδασκον τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς ὅτι Ἐὰν μὴ περιτμηθῆτε τῷ ἔθει τῷ Μωϋσέως, οὐ δύνασθε σωθῆναι. **2** γενομένης δὲ στάσεως καὶ ζητήσεως οὐκ ὀλίγης τῷ Παύλῳ καὶ τῷ Βαρναβᾷ πρὸς αὐτοὺς ἔταξαν ἀναβαίνειν Παῦλον καὶ Βαρναβᾶν καί τινας ἄλλους ἐξ αὐτῶν πρὸς τοὺς ἀποστόλους καὶ πρεσβυτέρους εἰς Ἰερουσαλὴμ περὶ τοῦ ζητήματος τούτου. **3** οἱ μὲν οὖν προπεμφθέντες ὑπὸ τῆς ἐκκλησίας διήρχοντο τήν τε Φοινίκην καὶ Σαμάρειαν ἐκδιηγούμενοι τὴν ἐπιστροφὴν τῶν ἐθνῶν, καὶ ἐποίουν χαρὰν μεγάλην πᾶσι τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς. **4** παραγενόμενοι δὲ εἰς Ἰεροσόλυμα παρεδέχθησαν ἀπὸ τῆς ἐκκλησίας καὶ τῶν ἀποστόλων καὶ τῶν πρεσβυτέρων, ἀνήγγειλάν τε ὅσα ὁ θεὸς ἐποίησεν μετ’ αὐτῶν. **5** ἐξανέστησαν δέ τινες τῶν ἀπὸ τῆς αἱρέσεως τῶν Φαρισαίων πεπιστευκότες, λέγοντες ὅτι δεῖ

περιτέμνειν αὐτοὺς παραγγέλλειν τε τηρεῖν τὸν νόμον Μωϋσέως. **6** Συνήχθησάν τε οἱ
ἀπόστολοι καὶ οἱ πρεσβύτεροι ἰδεῖν περὶ τοῦ λόγου τούτου. **7** πολλῆς δὲ ζητήσεως γενομένης
ἀναστὰς Πέτρος εἶπεν πρὸς αὐτούς· Ἄνδρες ἀδελφοί, ὑμεῖς ἐπίστασθε ὅτι ἀφ' ἡμερῶν ἀρχαίων
ἐν ὑμῖν ἐξελέξατο ὁ θεὸς διὰ τοῦ στόματός μου ἀκοῦσαι τὰ ἔθνη τὸν λόγον τοῦ εὐαγγελίου καὶ
πιστεῦσαι, **8** καὶ ὁ καρδιογνώστης θεὸς ἐμαρτύρησεν αὐτοῖς δοὺς τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον καθὼς
καὶ ἡμῖν, **9** καὶ οὐθὲν διέκρινεν μεταξὺ ἡμῶν τε καὶ αὐτῶν, τῇ πίστει καθαρίσας τὰς καρδίας
αὐτῶν. **10** νῦν οὖν τί πειράζετε τὸν θεόν, ἐπιθεῖναι ζυγὸν ἐπὶ τὸν τράχηλον τῶν μαθητῶν ὃν
οὔτε οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν οὔτε ἡμεῖς ἰσχύσαμεν βαστάσαι; **11** ἀλλὰ διὰ τῆς χάριτος τοῦ κυρίου
Ἰησοῦ πιστεύομεν σωθῆναι καθ' ὃν τρόπον κἀκεῖνοι. **12** Ἐσίγησεν δὲ πᾶν τὸ πλῆθος, καὶ
ἤκουον Βαρναβᾶ καὶ Παύλου ἐξηγουμένων ὅσα ἐποίησεν ὁ θεὸς σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα ἐν τοῖς
ἔθνεσιν δι' αὐτῶν. **13** μετὰ δὲ τὸ σιγῆσαι αὐτοὺς ἀπεκρίθη Ἰάκωβος λέγων· Ἄνδρες ἀδελφοί,
ἀκούσατέ μου. **14** Συμεὼν ἐξηγήσατο καθὼς πρῶτον ὁ θεὸς ἐπεσκέψατο λαβεῖν ἐξ ἐθνῶν λαὸν
τῷ ὀνόματι αὐτοῦ. **15** καὶ τούτῳ συμφωνοῦσιν οἱ λόγοι τῶν προφητῶν, καθὼς γέγραπται· **16**
Μετὰ ταῦτα ἀναστρέψω καὶ ἀνοικοδομήσω τὴν σκηνὴν Δαυὶδ τὴν πεπτωκυῖαν καὶ τὰ
κατεσκαμμένα αὐτῆς ἀνοικοδομήσω καὶ ἀνορθώσω αὐτήν, **17** ὅπως ἂν ἐκζητήσωσιν οἱ
κατάλοιποι τῶν ἀνθρώπων τὸν κύριον, καὶ πάντα τὰ ἔθνη ἐφ' οὓς ἐπικέκληται τὸ ὄνομά μου
ἐπ' αὐτούς, λέγει κύριος ποιῶν ταῦτα **18** γνωστὰ ἀπ' αἰῶνος. **19** διὸ ἐγὼ κρίνω μὴ παρενοχλεῖν
τοῖς ἀπὸ τῶν ἐθνῶν ἐπιστρέφουσιν ἐπὶ τὸν θεόν, **20** ἀλλὰ ἐπιστεῖλαι αὐτοῖς τοῦ ἀπέχεσθαι τῶν
ἀλισγημάτων τῶν εἰδώλων καὶ τῆς πορνείας καὶ τοῦ πνικτοῦ καὶ τοῦ αἵματος· **21** Μωϋσῆς γὰρ
ἐκ γενεῶν ἀρχαίων κατὰ πόλιν τοὺς κηρύσσοντας αὐτὸν ἔχει ἐν ταῖς συναγωγαῖς κατὰ πᾶν
σάββατον ἀναγινωσκόμενος. **22** Τότε ἔδοξε τοῖς ἀποστόλοις καὶ τοῖς πρεσβυτέροις σὺν ὅλῃ τῇ
ἐκκλησίᾳ ἐκλεξαμένους ἄνδρας ἐξ αὐτῶν πέμψαι εἰς Ἀντιόχειαν σὺν τῷ Παύλῳ καὶ Βαρναβᾷ,
Ἰούδαν τὸν καλούμενον Βαρσαββᾶν καὶ Σιλᾶν, ἄνδρας ἡγουμένους ἐν τοῖς ἀδελφοῖς, **23**
γράψαντες διὰ χειρὸς αὐτῶν· Οἱ ἀπόστολοι καὶ οἱ πρεσβύτεροι ἀδελφοὶ τοῖς κατὰ τὴν
Ἀντιόχειαν καὶ Συρίαν καὶ Κιλικίαν ἀδελφοῖς τοῖς ἐξ ἐθνῶν χαίρειν. **24** ἐπειδὴ ἠκούσαμεν ὅτι
τινὲς ἐξ ἡμῶν ἐξελθόντες ἐτάραξαν ὑμᾶς λόγοις ἀνασκευάζοντες τὰς ψυχὰς ὑμῶν οἷς οὐ
διεστειλάμεθα, **25** ἔδοξεν ἡμῖν γενομένοις ὁμοθυμαδὸν ἐκλεξαμένοις ἄνδρας πέμψαι πρὸς
ὑμᾶς σὺν τοῖς ἀγαπητοῖς ἡμῶν Βαρναβᾷ καὶ Παύλῳ, **26** ἀνθρώποις παραδεδωκόσι τὰς ψυχὰς
αὐτῶν ὑπὲρ τοῦ ὀνόματος τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ. **27** ἀπεστάλκαμεν οὖν Ἰούδαν καὶ
Σιλᾶν, καὶ αὐτοὺς διὰ λόγου ἀπαγγέλλοντας τὰ αὐτά. **28** ἔδοξεν γὰρ τῷ πνεύματι τῷ ἁγίῳ καὶ
ἡμῖν μηδὲν πλέον ἐπιτίθεσθαι ὑμῖν βάρος πλὴν τούτων τῶν ἐπάναγκες, **29** ἀπέχεσθαι
εἰδωλοθύτων καὶ αἵματος καὶ πνικτῶν καὶ πορνείας· ἐξ ὧν διατηροῦντες ἑαυτοὺς εὖ πράξετε.
ἔρρωσθε. **30** Οἱ μὲν οὖν ἀπολυθέντες κατῆλθον εἰς Ἀντιόχειαν, καὶ συναγαγόντες τὸ πλῆθος
ἐπέδωκαν τὴν ἐπιστολήν· **31** ἀναγνόντες δὲ ἐχάρησαν ἐπὶ τῇ παρακλήσει. **32** Ἰούδας τε καὶ
Σιλᾶς, καὶ αὐτοὶ προφῆται ὄντες, διὰ λόγου πολλοῦ παρεκάλεσαν τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς καὶ
ἐπεστήριξαν· **33** ποιήσαντες δὲ χρόνον ἀπελύθησαν μετ' εἰρήνης ἀπὸ τῶν ἀδελφῶν πρὸς τοὺς
ἀποστείλαντας αὐτούς. **35** Παῦλος δὲ καὶ Βαρναβᾶς διέτριβον ἐν Ἀντιοχείᾳ διδάσκοντες καὶ
εὐαγγελιζόμενοι μετὰ καὶ ἑτέρων πολλῶν τὸν λόγον τοῦ κυρίου. **36** Μετὰ δέ τινας ἡμέρας εἶπεν
πρὸς Βαρναβᾶν Παῦλος· Ἐπιστρέψαντες δὴ ἐπισκεψώμεθα τοὺς ἀδελφοὺς κατὰ πόλιν πᾶσαν
ἐν αἷς κατηγγείλαμεν τὸν λόγον τοῦ κυρίου, πῶς ἔχουσιν. **37** Βαρναβᾶς δὲ ἐβούλετο
συμπαραλαβεῖν καὶ τὸν Ἰωάννην τὸν καλούμενον Μᾶρκον· **38** Παῦλος δὲ ἠξίου, τὸν
ἀποστάντα ἀπ' αὐτῶν ἀπὸ Παμφυλίας καὶ μὴ συνελθόντα αὐτοῖς εἰς τὸ ἔργον, μὴ
συμπαραλαμβάνειν τοῦτον. **39** ἐγένετο δὲ παροξυσμὸς ὥστε ἀποχωρισθῆναι αὐτοὺς ἀπ'
ἀλλήλων, τόν τε Βαρναβᾶν παραλαβόντα τὸν Μᾶρκον ἐκπλεῦσαι εἰς Κύπρον, **40** Παῦλος δὲ

ἐπιλεξάμενος Σιλᾶν ἐξῆλθεν παραδοθεὶς τῇ χάριτι τοῦ κυρίου ὑπὸ τῶν ἀδελφῶν, **41** διήρχετο δὲ τὴν Συρίαν καὶ τὴν Κιλικίαν ἐπιστηρίζων τὰς ἐκκλησίας.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then some men came down from Judea and were teaching the brothers, “Unless you are circumcised according to the custom of Moses, you cannot be saved.” **2** And after engaging these men in sharp debate, Paul and Barnabas were appointed, along with some other believers, to go up to Jerusalem to see the apostles and elders about this question. **3** Sent on their way by the church, they passed through Phoenicia and Samaria, recounting the conversion of the Gentiles and bringing great joy to all the brothers. **4** On their arrival in Jerusalem, they were welcomed by the church and apostles and elders, to whom they reported all that God had done through them. **5** But some believers from the party of the Pharisees stood up and declared, “The Gentiles must be circumcised and required to obey the law of Moses.” **6** So the apostles and elders met to look into this matter. **7** After much discussion, Peter got up and said to them, “Brothers, you know that in the early days God made a choice among you that the Gentiles would hear from my lips the message of the gospel and believe. **8** And God, who knows the heart, showed His approval by giving the Holy Spirit to them, just as He did to us. **9** He made no distinction between us and them, for He cleansed their hearts by faith. **10** Now then, why do you test God by placing on the necks of the disciples a yoke that neither we nor our fathers have been able to bear? **11** On the contrary, we believe it is through the grace of the Lord Jesus that we are saved, just as they are.” **12** The whole assembly fell silent as they listened to Barnabas and Paul describing the signs and wonders God had done among the Gentiles through them. **13** When they had finished speaking, James declared, “Brothers, listen to me! **14** Simon has told us how God first visited the Gentiles to take from them a people to be His own. **15** The words of the prophets agree with this, as it is written: **16** ‘After this I will return and rebuild the fallen tent of David. Its ruins I will rebuild, and I will restore it, **17** so that the remnant of men may seek the Lord, and all the Gentiles who are called by My name, says the Lord who does these things **18** that have been known for ages.’ **19** It is my judgment, therefore, that we should not cause trouble for the Gentiles who are turning to God. **20** Instead, we should write and tell them to abstain from food polluted by idols, from sexual immorality, from the meat of strangled animals, and from blood. **21** For Moses has been proclaimed in every city from ancient times and is read in the synagogues on every Sabbath.” **22** Then the apostles and elders, with the whole church, decided to select men from among them to send to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas. They chose Judas called Barsabbas and Silas, two leaders among the brothers, **23** and sent them with this letter: The apostles and the elders, your brothers, To the brothers among the Gentiles in Antioch, Syria, and Cilicia: Greetings. **24** It has come to our attention that some went out from us without our authorization and unsettled you, troubling

your minds by what they said. **25** So we all agreed to choose men to send to you along with our beloved Barnabas and Paul, **26** men who have risked their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. **27** Therefore we are sending Judas and Silas to tell you in person the same things we are writing. **28** It seemed good to the Holy Spirit and to us not to burden you with anything beyond these essential requirements: **29** You must abstain from food sacrificed to idols, from blood, from the meat of strangled animals, and from sexual immorality. You will do well to avoid these things. Farewell. **30** So the men were sent off and went down to Antioch, where they assembled the congregation and delivered the letter. **31** When the people read it, they rejoiced at its encouraging message. **32** Judas and Silas, who themselves were prophets, said much to encourage and strengthen the brothers. **33** After spending some time there, they were sent off by the brothers in peace to return to those who had sent them. **35** But Paul and Barnabas remained at Antioch, along with many others, teaching and preaching the word of the Lord. **36** Some time later Paul said to Barnabas, “Let us go back and visit the brothers in every town where we proclaimed the word of the Lord, to see how they are doing.” **37** Barnabas wanted to take John, also called Mark. **38** But Paul thought it best not to take him, because he had deserted them in Pamphylia and had not accompanied them in the work. **39** Their disagreement was so sharp that they parted company. Barnabas took Mark and sailed for Cyprus, **40** but Paul chose Silas and left, commended by the brothers to the grace of the Lord. **41** And he traveled through Syria and Cilicia, strengthening the churches.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Some men came down from Judea and taught the brothers, “Unless you are circumcised after the custom of Moses, you can’t be saved.” **2** Therefore when Paul and Barnabas had no small discord and discussion with them, they appointed Paul, Barnabas, and some others of them to go up to Jerusalem to the apostles and elders about this question. **3** They, being sent on their way by the assembly, passed through both Phoenicia and Samaria, declaring the conversion of the Gentiles. They caused great joy to all the brothers. **4** When they had come to Jerusalem, they were received by the assembly and the apostles and the elders, and they reported everything that God had done with them. **5** But some of the sect of the Pharisees who believed rose up, saying, “It is necessary to circumcise them, and to command them to keep the law of Moses.” **6** The apostles and the elders were gathered together to see about this matter. **7** When there had been much discussion, Peter rose up and said to them, “Brothers, you know that a good while ago God made a choice among you that by my mouth the nations should hear the word of the Good News and believe. **8** God, who knows the heart, testified about them, giving them the Holy Spirit, just like he did to us. **9** He made no distinction between us and them, cleansing their hearts by faith. **10** Now therefore why do you tempt

God, that you should put a yoke on the neck of the disciples which neither our fathers nor we were able to bear? **11** But we believe that we are saved through the grace of the Lord Jesus, just as they are." **12** All the multitude kept silence, and they listened to Barnabas and Paul reporting what signs and wonders God had done among the nations through them. **13** After they were silent, James answered, "Brothers, listen to me. **14** Simeon has reported how God first visited the nations to take out of them a people for his name. **15** This agrees with the words of the prophets. As it is written, **16** 'After these things I will return. I will again build the tabernacle of David, which has fallen. I will again build its ruins. I will set it up **17** that the rest of men may seek after the Lord: all the Gentiles who are called by my name, says the Lord, who does all these things.' **18** "All of God's works are known to him from eternity. **19** Therefore my judgment is that we don't trouble those from among the Gentiles who turn to God, **20** but that we write to them that they abstain from the pollution of idols, from sexual immorality, from what is strangled, and from blood. **21** For Moses from generations of old has in every city those who preach him, being read in the synagogues every Sabbath." **22** Then it seemed good to the apostles and the elders, with the whole assembly, to choose men out of their company, and send them to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas: Judas called Barsabbas, and Silas, chief men among the brothers. **23** They wrote these things by their hand: "The apostles, the elders, and the brothers, to the brothers who are of the Gentiles in Antioch, Syria, and Cilicia: greetings. **24** Because we have heard that some who went out from us have troubled you with words, unsettling your souls, saying, 'You must be circumcised and keep the law,' to whom we gave no commandment; **25** it seemed good to us, having come to one accord, to choose out men and send them to you with our beloved Barnabas and Paul, **26** men who have risked their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. **27** We have sent therefore Judas and Silas, who themselves will also tell you the same things by word of mouth. **28** For it seemed good to the Holy Spirit, and to us, to lay no greater burden on you than these necessary things: **29** that you abstain from things sacrificed to idols, from blood, from things strangled, and from sexual immorality, from which if you keep yourselves, it will be well with you. Farewell." **30** So, when they were sent off, they came to Antioch. Having gathered the multitude together, they delivered the letter. **31** When they had read it, they rejoiced over the encouragement. **32** Judas and Silas, also being prophets themselves, encouraged the brothers with many words and strengthened them. **33** After they had spent some time there, they were dismissed in peace from the brothers to the apostles. **35** But Paul and Barnabas stayed in Antioch, teaching and preaching the word of the Lord, with many others also. **36** After some days Paul said to Barnabas, "Let's return now and visit our brothers in every city in which we proclaimed the word of the Lord, to see how they are doing." **37** Barnabas planned to take John, who was called Mark, with them also. **38** But Paul didn't think that it was a good idea to take with them someone who had withdrawn from them in Pamphylia, and didn't go with them to do the

work. **39** Then the contention grew so sharp that they separated from each other. Barnabas took Mark with him and sailed away to Cyprus, **40** but Paul chose Silas and went out, being commended by the brothers to the grace of God. **41** He went through Syria and Cilicia, strengthening the assemblies.

### Acts 21:18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** τῇ δὲ ἐπιούσῃ εἰσῄει ὁ Παῦλος σὺν ἡμῖν πρὸς Ἰάκωβον, πάντες τε παρεγένοντο οἱ πρεσβύτεροι.

*English (BSB)*

**18** The next day Paul went in with us to see James, and all the elders were present.

*English (WEB)*

**18** The day following, Paul went in with us to James; and all the elders were present.

### 1 Corinthians 9:5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** μὴ οὐκ ἔχομεν ἐξουσίαν ἀδελφὴν γυναῖκα περιάγειν, ὡς καὶ οἱ λοιποὶ ἀπόστολοι καὶ οἱ ἀδελφοὶ τοῦ κυρίου καὶ Κηφᾶς;

*English (BSB)*

**5** Have we no right to take along a believing wife, as do the other apostles and the Lord’s brothers and Cephas?

*English (WEB)*

**5** Have we no right to take along a wife who is a believer, even as the rest of the apostles, and the brothers of the Lord, and Cephas?

### 1 Corinthians 11:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** Ἐπαινῶ δὲ ὑμᾶς ὅτι πάντα μου μέμνησθε καὶ καθὼς παρέδωκα ὑμῖν τὰς παραδόσεις κατέχετε.

*English (BSB)*

**2** Now I commend you for remembering me in everything and for maintaining the traditions, just as I passed them on to you.

*English (WEB)*

**2** Now I praise you, brothers, that you remember me in all things, and hold firm the traditions, even as I delivered them to you.

## 1 Corinthians 15:3, 7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** Παρέδωκα γὰρ ὑμῖν ἐν πρώτοις, ὃ καὶ παρέλαβον, ὅτι Χριστὸς ἀπέθανεν ὑπὲρ τῶν ἁμαρτιῶν ἡμῶν κατὰ τὰς γραφάς, … **7** ἔπειτα ὤφθη Ἰακώβῳ, εἶτα τοῖς ἀποστόλοις πᾶσιν·

*English (BSB)*

**3** For what I received I passed on to you as of first importance: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, … **7** Then He appeared to James, then to all the apostles.

*English (WEB)*

**3** For I delivered to you first of all that which I also received: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures, … **7** Then he appeared to James, then to all the apostles,

## Galatians 1:19, 23

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** ἕτερον δὲ τῶν ἀποστόλων οὐκ εἶδον, εἰ μὴ Ἰάκωβον τὸν ἀδελφὸν τοῦ κυρίου. … **23** μόνον δὲ ἀκούοντες ἦσαν ὅτι Ὁ διώκων ἡμᾶς ποτε νῦν εὐαγγελίζεται τὴν πίστιν ἣν ποτε ἐπόρθει,

*English (BSB)*

**19** But I saw none of the other apostles except James, the Lord’s brother. … **23** They only heard the account: “The man who formerly persecuted us is now preaching the faith he once tried to destroy.”

*English (WEB)*

**19** But of the other apostles I saw no one except James, the Lord’s brother. … **23** but they only heard, “He who once persecuted us now preaches the faith that he once tried to destroy.”

## Galatians 2:9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**9** καὶ γνόντες τὴν χάριν τὴν δοθεῖσάν μοι, Ἰάκωβος καὶ Κηφᾶς καὶ Ἰωάννης, οἱ δοκοῦντες στῦλοι εἶναι, δεξιὰς ἔδωκαν ἐμοὶ καὶ Βαρναβᾷ κοινωνίας, ἵνα ἡμεῖς εἰς τὰ ἔθνη, αὐτοὶ δὲ εἰς

τὴν περιτομήν·

*English (BSB)*

**9** And recognizing the grace that I had been given, James, Cephas, and John—those reputed to be pillars—gave me and Barnabas the right hand of fellowship, so that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the circumcised.

*English (WEB)*

**9** and when they perceived the grace that was given to me, James and Cephas and John, those who were reputed to be pillars, gave to Barnabas and me the right hand of fellowship, that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the circumcision.

## James 1:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἰάκωβος θεοῦ καὶ κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ δοῦλος ταῖς δώδεκα φυλαῖς ταῖς ἐν τῇ διασπορᾷ χαίρειν.

*English (BSB)*

**1** James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, To the twelve tribes of the Dispersion: Greetings.

*English (WEB)*

**1** James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes which are in the Dispersion: Greetings.

## 2 Peter 2:1, 4, 6, 10–13, 15, 17–18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἐγένοντο δὲ καὶ ψευδοπροφῆται ἐν τῷ λαῷ, ὡς καὶ ἐν ὑμῖν ἔσονται ψευδοδιδάσκαλοι, οἵτινες παρεισάξουσιν αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας, καὶ τὸν ἀγοράσαντα αὐτοὺς δεσπότην ἀρνούμενοι, ἐπάγοντες ἑαυτοῖς ταχινὴν ἀπώλειαν· … **4** Εἰ γὰρ ὁ θεὸς ἀγγέλων ἁμαρτησάντων οὐκ ἐφείσατο, ἀλλὰ σειραῖς ζόφου ταρταρώσας παρέδωκεν εἰς κρίσιν τηρουμένους, … **6** καὶ πόλεις Σοδόμων καὶ Γομόρρας τεφρώσας καταστροφῇ κατέκρινεν, ὑπόδειγμα μελλόντων ἀσεβέσιν τεθεικώς, … **10** μάλιστα δὲ τοὺς ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ μιασμοῦ πορευομένους καὶ κυριότητος καταφρονοῦντας. Τολμηταί, αὐθάδεις, δόξας οὐ τρέμουσιν, βλασφημοῦντες, **11** ὅπου ἄγγελοι ἰσχύϊ καὶ δυνάμει μείζονες ὄντες οὐ φέρουσιν κατ᾽ αὐτῶν βλάσφημον κρίσιν. **12** οὗτοι δέ, ὡς ἄλογα ζῷα γεγεννημένα φυσικὰ εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν, ἐν οἷς ἀγνοοῦσιν βλασφημοῦντες, ἐν τῇ φθορᾷ αὐτῶν καὶ φθαρήσονται, **13** ἀδικούμενοι μισθὸν ἀδικίας· ἡδονὴν ἡγούμενοι τὴν ἐν ἡμέρᾳ τρυφήν, σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι ἐντρυφῶντες ἐν ταῖς ἀπάταις αὐτῶν συνευωχούμενοι ὑμῖν, … **15** καταλιπόντες εὐθεῖαν ὁδὸν ἐπλανήθησαν, ἐξακολουθήσαντες τῇ

ὁδῷ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ ὃς μισθὸν ἀδικίας ἠγάπησεν … **17** Οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται. **18** ὑπέρογκα γὰρ ματαιότητος φθεγγόμενοι δελεάζουσιν ἐν ἐπιθυμίαις σαρκὸς ἀσελγείαις τοὺς ὀλίγως ἀποφεύγοντας τοὺς ἐν πλάνῃ ἀναστρεφομένους,

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now there were also false prophets among the people, just as there will be false teachers among you. They will secretly introduce destructive heresies, even denying the Master who bought them—bringing swift destruction on themselves. … **4** For if God did not spare the angels when they sinned, but cast them deep into hell, placing them in chains of darkness to be held for judgment; … **6** if He condemned the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah to destruction, reducing them to ashes as an example of what is coming on the ungodly; … **10** Such punishment is specially reserved for those who indulge the corrupt desires of the flesh and despise authority. Bold and self-willed, they are unafraid to slander glorious beings. **11** Yet not even angels, though greater in strength and power, dare to bring such slanderous charges against them before the Lord. **12** These men are like irrational animals, creatures of instinct, born to be captured and destroyed. They blaspheme in matters they do not understand, and like such creatures, they too will be destroyed. **13** The harm they will suffer is the wages of their wickedness. They consider it a pleasure to carouse in broad daylight. They are blots and blemishes, reveling in their deception as they feast with you. … **15** They have left the straight way and wandered off to follow the way of Balaam son of Beor, who loved the wages of wickedness. … **17** These men are springs without water and mists driven by a storm. Blackest darkness is reserved for them. **18** With lofty but empty words, they appeal to the sensual passions of the flesh and entice those who are just escaping from others who live in error.

*English (WEB)*

**1** But false prophets also arose among the people, as false teachers will also be among you, who will secretly bring in destructive heresies, denying even the Master who bought them, bringing on themselves swift destruction. … **4** For if God didn’t spare angels when they sinned, but cast them down to Tartarus, and committed them to pits of darkness to be reserved for judgment; … **6** and turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah into ashes, condemned them to destruction, having made them an example to those who would live in an ungodly way, … **10** but chiefly those who walk after the flesh in the lust of defilement and despise authority. Daring, self-willed, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignitaries, **11** whereas angels, though greater in might and power, don’t bring a slanderous judgment against them before the Lord. **12** But these, as unreasoning creatures, born natural animals to be taken and destroyed, speaking evil in matters about which they are ignorant, will in their destroying surely be destroyed, **13** receiving the wages of unrighteousness;

people who count it pleasure to revel in the daytime, spots and defects, reveling in their deceit while they feast with you; … **15** Forsaking the right way, they went astray, having followed the way of Balaam the son of Beor, who loved the wages of wrongdoing; … **17** These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever. **18** For, uttering great swelling words of emptiness, they entice in the lusts of the flesh, by licentiousness, those who are indeed escaping from those who live in error;

### 2 Peter 3:2–3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** μνησθῆναι τῶν προειρημένων ῥημάτων ὑπὸ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν καὶ τῆς τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν ἐντολῆς τοῦ κυρίου καὶ σωτῆρος, **3** τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες ὅτι ἐλεύσονται ἐπ᾽ ἐσχάτων τῶν ἡμερῶν ἐν ἐμπαιγμονῇ ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι

*English (BSB)*

**2** by recalling what was foretold by the holy prophets and commanded by our Lord and Savior through your apostles. **3** Most importantly, you must understand that in the last days scoffers will come, scoffing and following their own evil desires.

*English (WEB)*

**2** that you should remember the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets and the commandment of us, the apostles of the Lord and Savior, **3** knowing this first, that in the last days mockers will come, walking after their own lusts

### Revelation 7:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** καὶ εἴρηκα αὐτῷ· Κύριέ μου, σὺ οἶδας. καὶ εἶπέν μοι· Οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἐρχόμενοι ἐκ τῆς θλίψεως τῆς μεγάλης, καὶ ἔπλυναν τὰς στολὰς αὐτῶν καὶ ἐλεύκαναν αὐτὰς ἐν τῷ αἵματι τοῦ ἀρνίου.

*English (BSB)*

**14** “Sir,” I answered, “you know.” So he replied, “These are the ones who have come out of the great tribulation; they have washed their robes and made them white in the blood of the Lamb.

*English (WEB)*

**14** I told him, “My lord, you know.” He said to me, “These are those who came out of the great suffering. They washed their robes and made them white in the Lamb’s blood.

### 1 Enoch 1:9

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**9** And behold! He cometh with ten thousands of His holy ones To execute judgement upon all, And to destroy all the ungodly: And to convict all flesh Of all the works of their ungodliness which they have ungodly committed, And of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against Him.

### 1 Enoch 6–16

This reference names a whole section of the book (11 chapters) as a whole, which is too long to print here. Verses quoted from it in this introduction have their own entries.

# The Whole Letter at a Glance

Jude is short enough to read in one sitting, and it should be read that way before it is taken apart. Its first hearers would have heard it read aloud as a whole, probably at a gathering of the church. Read it now, slowly, ideally aloud.

## The Epistle of Jude in Greek and in English

The letter is printed first in the Greek of the SBL Greek New Testament and then in two public-domain English translations. The Berean Standard Bible (BSB) generally follows the critical (eclectic) Greek text used by most modern translations, and the World English Bible (WEB) follows the Byzantine Majority Text, so between them they show both of the main textual traditions; where they differ (for example, “Jesus” or “the Lord” in v. 5), Appendix A explains why. Section A of each chapter gives every verse in eighteen free translations.

### Greek (SBLGNT)

**1** Ἰούδας Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ δοῦλος, ἀδελφὸς δὲ Ἰακώβου, τοῖς ἐν θεῷ πατρὶ ἠγαπημένοις καὶ Ἰησοῦ Χριστῷ τετηρημένοις κλητοῖς· **2** ἔλεος ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη καὶ ἀγάπη πληθυνθείη.

**3** Ἀγαπητοί, πᾶσαν σπουδὴν ποιούμενος γράφειν ὑμῖν περὶ τῆς κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας ἀνάγκην ἔσχον γράψαι ὑμῖν παρακαλῶν ἐπαγωνίζεσθαι τῇ ἅπαξ παραδοθείσῃ τοῖς ἁγίοις πίστει. **4** παρεισέδυσαν γάρ τινες ἄνθρωποι, οἱ πάλαι προγεγραμμένοι εἰς τοῦτο τὸ κρίμα, ἀσεβεῖς, τὴν τοῦ θεοῦ ἡμῶν χάριτα μετατιθέντες εἰς ἀσέλγειαν καὶ τὸν μόνον δεσπότην καὶ κύριον ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν ἀρνούμενοι.

**5** Ὑπομνῆσαι δὲ ὑμᾶς βούλομαι, εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ πάντα, ὅτι Ἰησοῦς λαὸν ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου σώσας τὸ δεύτερον τοὺς μὴ πιστεύσαντας ἀπώλεσεν, **6** ἀγγέλους τε τοὺς μὴ τηρήσαντας τὴν ἑαυτῶν ἀρχὴν ἀλλὰ ἀπολιπόντας τὸ ἴδιον οἰκητήριον εἰς κρίσιν μεγάλης ἡμέρας δεσμοῖς ἀϊδίοις ὑπὸ ζόφον τετήρηκεν· **7** ὡς Σόδομα καὶ Γόμορρα καὶ αἱ περὶ αὐτὰς πόλεις, τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον τούτοις ἐκπορνεύσασαι καὶ ἀπελθοῦσαι ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἑτέρας, πρόκεινται δεῖγμα πυρὸς αἰωνίου δίκην ὑπέχουσαι.

**8** Ὁμοίως μέντοι καὶ οὗτοι ἐνυπνιαζόμενοι σάρκα μὲν μιαίνουσιν, κυριότητα δὲ ἀθετοῦσιν, δόξας δὲ βλασφημοῦσιν. **9** ὁ δὲ Μιχαὴλ ὁ ἀρχάγγελος, ὅτε τῷ διαβόλῳ διακρινόμενος διελέγετο περὶ τοῦ Μωϋσέως σώματος, οὐκ ἐτόλμησεν κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας, ἀλλὰ εἶπεν· Ἐπιτιμήσαι σοι κύριος. **10** οὗτοι δὲ ὅσα μὲν οὐκ οἴδασιν βλασφημοῦσιν, ὅσα δὲ φυσικῶς ὡς τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα ἐπίστανται, ἐν τούτοις φθείρονται. **11** οὐαὶ αὐτοῖς, ὅτι τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Κάϊν ἐπορεύθησαν, καὶ τῇ πλάνῃ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ μισθοῦ ἐξεχύθησαν, καὶ τῇ ἀντιλογίᾳ τοῦ Κόρε ἀπώλοντο.

**12** οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἐν ταῖς ἀγάπαις ὑμῶν σπιλάδες συνευωχούμενοι, ἀφόβως ἑαυτοὺς ποιμαίνοντες, νεφέλαι ἄνυδροι ὑπὸ ἀνέμων παραφερόμεναι, δένδρα φθινοπωρινὰ ἄκαρπα δὶς ἀποθανόντα ἐκριζωθέντα, **13** κύματα ἄγρια θαλάσσης ἐπαφρίζοντα τὰς ἑαυτῶν αἰσχύνας, ἀστέρες πλανῆται οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους εἰς αἰῶνα τετήρηται.

**14** Προεφήτευσεν δὲ καὶ τούτοις ἕβδομος ἀπὸ Ἀδὰμ Ἑνὼχ λέγων· Ἰδοὺ ἦλθεν κύριος ἐν ἁγίαις μυριάσιν αὐτοῦ, **15** ποιῆσαι κρίσιν κατὰ πάντων καὶ ἐλέγξαι πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς περὶ πάντων τῶν ἔργων ἀσεβείας αὐτῶν ὧν ἠσέβησαν καὶ περὶ πάντων τῶν σκληρῶν ὧν ἐλάλησαν κατ᾽ αὐτοῦ ἁμαρτωλοὶ ἀσεβεῖς. **16** οὗτοί εἰσιν γογγυσταί, μεμψίμοιροι, κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι, καὶ τὸ στόμα αὐτῶν λαλεῖ ὑπέρογκα, θαυμάζοντες πρόσωπα ὠφελείας χάριν.

**17** Ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί, μνήσθητε τῶν ῥημάτων τῶν προειρημένων ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ· **18** ὅτι ἔλεγον ὑμῖν· Ἐπ᾽ ἐσχάτου χρόνου ἔσονται ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἑαυτῶν ἐπιθυμίας πορευόμενοι τῶν ἀσεβειῶν. **19** οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες, ψυχικοί, πνεῦμα μὴ ἔχοντες.

**20** ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί, ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει, ἐν πνεύματι ἁγίῳ προσευχόμενοι, **21** ἑαυτοὺς ἐν ἀγάπῃ θεοῦ τηρήσατε προσδεχόμενοι τὸ ἔλεος τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον. **22** καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεᾶτε διακρινομένους, **23** οὓς δὲ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ, μισοῦντες καὶ τὸν ἀπὸ τῆς σαρκὸς ἐσπιλωμένον χιτῶνα.

**24** Τῷ δὲ δυναμένῳ φυλάξαι ὑμᾶς ἀπταίστους καὶ στῆσαι κατενώπιον τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ ἀμώμους ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει **25** μόνῳ θεῷ σωτῆρι ἡμῶν διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν δόξα μεγαλωσύνη κράτος καὶ ἐξουσία πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς πάντας τοὺς αἰῶνας· ἀμήν.

## English (Berean Standard Bible, BSB)

**1** Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ and a brother of James, To those who are called, loved by God the Father, and kept in Jesus Christ: **2** Mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you.

**3** Beloved, although I made every effort to write to you about the salvation we share, I felt it necessary to write and urge you to contend earnestly for the faith entrusted once for all to the saints. **4** For certain men have crept in among you unnoticed—ungodly ones who were designated long ago for condemnation. They turn the grace of our God into a license for immorality, and they deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ.

**5** Although you are fully aware of this, I want to remind you that after Jesus had delivered His people out of the land of Egypt, He destroyed those who did not believe. **6** And the angels who did not stay within their own domain but abandoned their proper dwelling—these He has kept in eternal chains under darkness, bound for judgment on that great day. **7** In like manner, Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, who indulged in sexual immorality and

pursued strange flesh, are on display as an example of those who sustain the punishment of eternal fire.

**8** Yet in the same way these dreamers defile their bodies, reject authority, and slander glorious beings. **9** But even the archangel Michael, when he disputed with the devil over the body of Moses, did not presume to bring a slanderous charge against him, but said, “The Lord rebuke you!” **10** These men, however, slander what they do not understand, and like irrational animals, they will be destroyed by the things they do instinctively. **11** Woe to them! They have traveled the path of Cain; they have rushed headlong into the error of Balaam; they have perished in Korah’s rebellion.

**12** These men are hidden reefs in your love feasts, shamelessly feasting with you but shepherding only themselves. They are clouds without water, carried along by the wind; fruitless trees in autumn, twice dead after being uprooted. **13** They are wild waves of the sea, foaming up their own shame; wandering stars, for whom blackest darkness has been reserved forever.

**14** Enoch, the seventh from Adam, also prophesied about them: “Behold, the Lord is coming with myriads of His holy ones **15** to execute judgment on everyone, and to convict all the ungodly of every ungodly act of wickedness and every harsh word spoken against Him by ungodly sinners.” **16** These men are discontented grumblers, following after their own lusts; their mouths spew arrogance; they flatter others for their own advantage.

**17** But you, beloved, remember what was foretold by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ **18** when they said to you, “In the last times there will be scoffers who will follow after their own ungodly desires.” **19** These are the ones who cause divisions, who are worldly and devoid of the Spirit.

**20** But you, beloved, by building yourselves up in your most holy faith and praying in the Holy Spirit, **21** keep yourselves in the love of God as you await the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to bring you eternal life. **22** And indeed, have mercy on those who doubt; **23** save others by snatching them from the fire; and to still others show mercy tempered with fear, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh.

**24** Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling and to present you unblemished in His glorious presence, with great joy— **25** to the only God our Savior be glory, majesty, dominion, and authority through Jesus Christ our Lord before all time, and now, and for all eternity. Amen.

### English (World English Bible, WEB)

**1** Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to those who are called, sanctified by God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ: **2** May mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you.

**3** Beloved, while I was very eager to write to you about our common salvation, I was constrained to write to you exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered to the saints. **4** For there are certain men who crept in secretly, even those who were long ago written about for this condemnation: ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into indecency, and denying our only Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ.

**5** Now I desire to remind you, though you already know this, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who didn't believe. **6** Angels who didn't keep their first domain, but deserted their own dwelling place, he has kept in everlasting bonds under darkness for the judgment of the great day. **7** Even as Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, having in the same way as these given themselves over to sexual immorality and gone after strange flesh, are shown as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire.

**8** Yet in the same way, these also in their dreaming defile the flesh, despise authority, and slander celestial beings. **9** But Michael, the archangel, when contending with the devil and arguing about the body of Moses, dared not bring against him an abusive condemnation, but said, "May the Lord rebuke you!" **10** But these speak evil of whatever things they don't know. They are destroyed in these things that they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason. **11** Woe to them! For they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in Korah's rebellion.

**12** These are hidden rocky reefs in your love feasts when they feast with you, shepherds who without fear feed themselves; clouds without water, carried along by winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots; **13** wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

**14** About these also Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying, "Behold, the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones, **15** to execute judgment on all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their works of ungodliness which they have done in an ungodly way, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him." **16** These are murmurers and complainers, walking after their lusts—and their mouth speaks proud things—showing respect of persons to gain advantage.

**17** But you, beloved, remember the words which have been spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ. **18** They said to you, "In the last time there will be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts." **19** These are those who cause divisions and are sensual, not having the Spirit.

**20** But you, beloved, keep building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit. **21** Keep yourselves in God's love, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life. **22** On some have compassion,

making a distinction, **23** and some save, snatching them out of the fire with fear, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh.

**24** Now to him who is able to keep them from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory in great joy, **25** to God our Savior, who alone is wise, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forever. Amen.

## The shape of the letter

Read as a whole, Jude has a clear architecture: a bright frame around a dark center.

| Section | Verses | Content | Key words |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Greeting** | 1–2 | Sender; recipients called, loved, kept; wish for mercy, peace, love | *kept*, *love*, *mercy* |
| **Occasion and appeal** | 3–4 | Jude meant to write about salvation, but must urge readers to contend for the faith, because intruders have slipped in | *beloved*, *faith*, *impious* |
| **The case against the intruders** | 5–19 | Five “texts,” each followed by “these” applying it to the intruders | *these*, *impious*, *judgment*, *kept* |
| — first text | 5–7 | Three examples of judgment: wilderness generation, angels, Sodom | |
| — application | 8 | “those dreaming…” | |
| — second text | 9 | Michael’s restraint in the dispute over Moses’ body | |
| — application | 10–13 | “these … speak evil”; woe (Cain, Balaam, Korah); images from nature | |
| — third text | 14–15 | Enoch’s prophecy of the Lord’s coming with holy myriads | |
| — application | 16 | “These are … grumblers” | |

| Section | Verses | Content | Key words |
|---|---|---|---|
| — fourth text | 17–18 | The apostles' prediction of scoffers | |
| — application | 19 | "these are those causing divisions" | |
| **Exhortation** | 20–23 | Build, pray, keep yourselves, wait; show mercy, rescue, show mercy with fear | *beloved*, *keep*, *love*, *mercy* |
| **Doxology** | 24–25 | Praise to the God who is able to guard and present his people | *guard*, *glory* |

(Some outlines count the woe of v. 11 as a separate "text" and vv. 12–13 as its application, giving five texts in all. The structure is the same either way.)

Three features of this design are worth carrying into every chapter.

### 1. The frame interprets the center

The darkest material in the letter, judgment, darkness, and fire, sits between a greeting that calls the readers loved and kept and a doxology that praises God for keeping them from stumbling. The structure itself makes a theological claim: the readers' security does not depend on the absence of danger. The danger is real, but the one who keeps them is greater. A reading of Jude that remembers only the middle has misread the letter.

### 2. "Keep" runs through the whole

The Greek verb τηρέω (*tēreō*, "keep, guard, preserve") appears five times, and its near relative φυλάσσω (*phylassō*, "guard") once more at the climax:

| Verse | Greek | Meaning | Who keeps what |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | τετηρημένοις (*tetērēmenois*) | 'kept' (perfect participle) | God keeps the believers |
| 6 | μὴ τηρήσαντας (*mē tērēsantas*) | 'who did not keep' | Angels failed to keep their position |
| 6 | τετήρηκεν (*tetērēken*) | 'he has kept' | God keeps the rebel angels for judgment |
| 13 | τετήρηται (*tetērētai*) | 'has been kept' | Darkness is kept for the wanderers |
| 21 | τηρήσατε (*tērēsate*) | 'keep!' | Believers are to keep themselves |

| Verse | Greek | Meaning | Who keeps what |
|---|---|---|---|
| 24 | φυλάξαι (*phylaxai*) | ‘to guard’ | God guards the believers |

Two kinds of keeping run through the letter: protective keeping for those who belong to God, and custodial keeping for those who rebel. The angels “did not keep” what was theirs, and so they are “kept” for judgment. The readers are “kept” by God, and so they are to “keep” themselves in his love. The whole letter turns on this wordplay.

### 3. “Beloved” vs. “these”

Jude addresses his readers as “beloved” (ἀγαπητοί, *agapētoi*) three times (vv. 3, 17, 20). Each time the address marks a turning point toward them. He refers to the intruders as “these” (οὗτοι, *houtoi*) five times (vv. 8, 10, 12, 16, 19), each time applying an ancient example to them. The letter moves between the two groups, and its rhetoric depends on the contrast. In vv. 22–23, however, the line between them becomes porous. Some who have been influenced by the intruders can still be shown mercy and snatched from the fire. Jude’s contrast exists to protect people, not to write them off.

## Reading strategy for the chapters ahead

As you work through the commentary, it may help to keep three questions in mind for each passage:

1. **What is Jude asking his readers to *see*?** Much of the letter is an argument from examples: “remember,” “behold,” “these are.”
2. **What is Jude asking his readers to *do*?** The commands are few but weighty: contend (v. 3), remember (v. 17), build, pray, keep, wait (vv. 20–21), show mercy, rescue (vv. 22–23).
3. **What is Jude asking his readers to *trust*?** The letter begins and ends with God’s keeping. Everything between is written by someone who believes God is able.

# Part One: The Commentary

# Chapter 1. Called, Loved, and Kept: Identity and Greeting (Jude 1–2)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **1** Ἰούδας Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ δοῦλος, ἀδελφὸς δὲ Ἰακώβου, τοῖς ἐν θεῷ πατρὶ ἠγαπημένοις καὶ Ἰησοῦ Χριστῷ τετηρημένοις κλητοῖς· **2** ἔλεος ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη καὶ ἀγάπη πληθυνθείη.
>
> — Jude 1–2, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript's first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | ἠγαπημένοις | 'loved' | P72 א A B Ψ 1739 |
| 1 | ἡγιασμένοις | 'sanctified' | K L |
| 1 | τοῖς ἐν θεῷ πατρί | 'to those … in God the Father' | P72 א A B Ψ K L |
| 1 | τοῖς ἔθνεσιν ἐν θεῷ πατρί | 'to the Gentiles … in God the Father' | 1739 |

Notes. v. 1: not extant in P78, C. v. 2: no difference that affects translation (spelling only); not extant in P78, C.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the

public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

### Jude 1

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Iudas the servaunt of Iesus Christ the brother of Iames. To them which are cal and sanctified in god the father and preserved in Iesu Christ. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | IVde a seruaunt of Iesus Christ, and brother of Iames, to them which are called and sanctified of God the Father, and returned to Iesus Christ: |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Jude, the servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James: to them that are beloved in God the Father, and preserved in Jesus Christ, and called. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Jude, the servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to them that are sanctified by God the Father, and preserved in Jesus Christ, and called: |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to the called, loved in God the Father and kept by Jesus Christ: |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Judas, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to them that are called, beloved in God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ: |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | Jude, bondman of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to the called ones beloved in God [the] Father and preserved in Jesus Christ: |
| **YLT** Young’s Literal Translation (1898) | Judas, of Jesus Christ a servant, and brother of James, to those sanctified in God the Father, and in Jesus Christ kept — called, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to them that are called, beloved in God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ: |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to those who are called, sanctified by God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ: |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | I am Jude. I serve Jesus Christ like a voluntary slave [MET]. I am a younger brother of James, the leader of all the congregations. I am writing to you whom God has chosen to belong to him. You are loved by God our Father and protected by Jesus Christ (OR, whom God has protected to present to Jesus Christ). |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | To those who, having received the call, have been loved by God the Father and protected by Jesus Christ, From Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and the brother of James. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to those who are called, beloved in God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ: |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | This letter comes from Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ, and James' brother. I am writing to those who are called and loved by God the Father, and who are kept safe by Jesus Christ: |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | Judas, a servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to those called, having been loved in God [the] Father, and having been kept in Jesus Christ, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ and a brother of James, To those who are called, loved by God the Father, and kept in Jesus Christ: |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ and a brother of James, To those who are called, sanctified by God the Father, and kept in Jesus Christ: |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Jude, a servant of Jesus Christ and a brother of James, to those who are called and sanctified by God the Father and kept for Jesus Christ: |

### Jude 2

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Mercy vnto you and peace and love be multiplied. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | Mercie vnto you, and peace and loue be multiplied. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Mercy unto you, and peace, and charity be fulfilled. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Mercy to you, and peace, and love, be multiplied. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | Mercy and peace and love be multiplied to you. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Mercy unto you and peace and love be multiplied. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | Mercy to you, and peace, and love be multiplied. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | kindness to you, and peace, and love, be multiplied! |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Mercy unto you and peace and love be multiplied. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | May mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | I pray that you will continue to experience very much God acting mercifully toward you, causing you to have inner peace, and loving you. Jude 3-4 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | May mercy, peace, and love be yours in ever increasing measure. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | May mercy and peace and love be multiplied to you. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | May God's mercy, peace, and love increase in your experience! |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | mercy and peace and love be multiplied to you! |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Ancient letters opened with a standard formula: *From A, to B, greetings.* Jude follows the pattern, but he fills each part with meaning. He introduces himself by two relationships, servant of Jesus Christ and brother of James. He describes his readers by three things God has done for them: God has called them, loved them, and kept them. Then he wishes them three gifts in abundance: mercy, peace, and love.

These two verses are easy to skim on the way to the "real" content of the letter. They are, however, the foundation on which everything else stands. Before Jude says a word about danger, he tells his readers who they are and whose they are. The letter will speak of people who "did not keep" their place and are "kept" for judgment, and it will urge the readers to "keep" themselves in the love of God. All of that is anchored here, in a description of believers as people who have *already* been loved and kept.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### Ἰούδας (*Ioudas*) — ‘Judas’

The author’s name is the Greek form of *Judah*, the patriarch whose name became the name of a tribe, a kingdom, and finally the Jewish people as a whole. For a Jewish family in Galilee, naming a son Judah was a patriotic and pious act. The name also recalled Judas Maccabeus, the hero of the revolt against Antiochus IV in the second century BC. Among Jews of the first century it was one of the most common names.

English Bibles traditionally write “Jude” for the author of this letter and “Judas” for others, partly so that readers do not confuse him with Judas Iscariot. The LSV, true to its literal approach, keeps “Judas.” The Greek makes no distinction. As the Historical Introduction explains, the author is almost certainly the Judas named among the brothers of Jesus in Mark 6:3.

### Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ δοῦλος (*Iēsou Christou doulos*) — ‘a slave of Jesus Christ’

The Greek word is δοῦλος (*doulos*), the ordinary word for a slave. The LSV’s “servant” is a long-standing English convention, but it softens the word. In the Roman world a *doulos* was not an employee who could resign. A *doulos* was a person owned by another, whose time, labor, and body belonged to a master.

Two backgrounds give the phrase its force.

The first is the Old Testament phrase “servant of the LORD” (in Hebrew *ʿebed YHWH*). It was a title of honor, given to Moses (“My servant Moses is dead,” Josh 1:2, LSV), to David (“Go, and you have said to My servant, to David,” 2 Sam 7:5, LSV), and to the prophets. To be someone’s servant was to be identified with that person’s authority and to act on his behalf. The Septuagint uses δοῦλος almost always to translate the Hebrew *ʿebed*.[23]

The second is Christian usage. Paul begins Romans with “Paul, a servant of Jesus Christ” (Rom 1:1, LSV), and James begins his letter “James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ” (Jas 1:1, LSV). Paul could also describe Christ himself as one who “emptied Himself, having taken the form of a servant” (Phil 2:7, LSV), using the same word, *doulos*.

For Jude the title says something personal. He grew up in the same household as Jesus. He might have presented himself as an equal, or at least as a relative with special standing. Instead he calls himself Jesus’ slave. The family tie remains, but it has been taken up into a new relationship of total belonging, the same belonging that will mark all his readers. A few lines later he will call Jesus “our only Master” (v. 4), and the Greek word there, δεσπότης (*despotēs*), is the normal word for a slave’s owner. Jude is consistent: if Jesus is the *despotēs*, Jude is his *doulos*.

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23. Abbott-Smith, *Manual Greek Lexicon*, s.v. δοῦλος: “in LXX, ὁ δ. nearly always for עֶבֶד.” ↩

### ἀδελφὸς δὲ Ἰακώβου (*adelphos de Iakōbou*) — ‘and brother of James’

The second relationship identifies Jude for his readers by naming his famous brother, James, the leader of the Jerusalem church (Gal 1:19; 2:9; Acts 15:13). As the Historical Introduction explains, early readers like Clement of Alexandria saw humility in Jude’s choice to name James rather than Jesus.[24] The phrase also establishes credentials. Jude speaks as a member of a family whose authority the churches recognized, without claiming to be an apostle.

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24. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude, ANF 2 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0211.htm): Jude, “while knowing the near relationship of the Lord, yet did not say that he himself was His brother.” ↩

### κλητοῖς (*klētois*) — ‘to those called’

In Greek the description of the readers is built so that the key word comes last: *to-the-in-God-the-Father-loved-and-for-Jesus-Christ-kept called-ones*. The final word, κλητοῖς (*klētois*), “called,” is the noun the other phrases describe. It is the readers’ basic identity: they are people God has called.

“Calling” in the Bible is not a general invitation that people may take or leave. It is God’s effective summons that brings a people into being. God called Abraham out of Ur, and he called Israel out of Egypt. In Isaiah, God says to his servant, “I, YHWH, called you in righteousness, / And I lay hold on your hand, and keep you” (Isa 42:6, LSV). There *calling* and *keeping* stand side by side, as they do in Jude.

The New Testament applies this language to the church. Paul writes to “the called of Jesus Christ … called holy ones” (Rom 1:6–7, LSV), and to “those called—both Jews and Greeks” (1 Cor 1:24, LSV). Revelation pictures the Lamb’s companions as those who “are called, and chosen, and steadfast” (Rev 17:14, LSV). By placing “called” in the climactic position, Jude says that his readers’ existence as a community begins with God’s initiative, not their own.

### ἐν θεῷ πατρὶ ἠγαπημένοις (*en theō patri ēgapēmenois*) — ‘loved in God the Father’

The Greek participle ἠγαπημένοις (*ēgapēmenois*) is in the **perfect** tense, which presents a past action with continuing results. Its sense is “having been loved and remaining loved.” The love Jude has in mind is not a passing feeling but a settled state.

The phrase “in God [the] Father” is unusual. Most often the New Testament speaks of being loved *by* God. Some interpreters take the Greek preposition ἐν (*en*) here in an instrumental sense, “loved *by* God the Father.” Others keep the local sense, “loved *in* God,” meaning that believers are held within the sphere of God’s own love. The LSV keeps the literal “in” and lets the reader feel its strangeness. Either way, the source of the love is God the Father, and it is the same love in which the readers are later told to “keep” themselves (v. 21).

The Old Testament roots of this idea are deep. Moses told Israel that God did not choose them for their size or merit, “but because of YHWH’s loving you, and because of His keeping the oath” (Deut 7:8, LSV). Love and keeping stand together there too.

**A variant reading.** Many later Greek manuscripts read ἡγιασμένοις (*hēgiasmenois*), “sanctified,” in place of ἠγαπημένοις, “loved.” Webster’s 1833 revision of the traditional English Bible follows this reading (“to them that are sanctified by God the Father”), as does the WEB, which translates the Majority Text (“sanctified by God the Father”). The critical editions (Westcott–Hort, Tregelles, NA28, and SBLGNT) all read “loved,” and the LSV, though it generally follows the Majority Text, does so here too. The likely explanation is that a scribe found “loved in God” awkward and replaced it with the more familiar “sanctified in,” which echoes 1 Cor 1:2 (“sanctified in Christ Jesus”). This variant also illustrates a basic principle of textual criticism. According to the manuscript tallies in one modern edition, “sanctified” appears in about 90 percent of surviving manuscripts and “loved” in about 9 percent.[25] Most of those manuscripts, however, are late copies of a single textual tradition. The editors of the critical texts judged that the reading of the earliest witnesses, and the harder reading that best explains its rival, is more likely original. Counting manuscripts is not the same as weighing them.

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25. The Text-Critical Greek New Testament notes (Robert Adam Boyd; eBible.org `grctcgnt`) give ἡγιασμένοις 90.2% and ἠγαπημένοις 8.9% of manuscripts. These figures count manuscripts and do not weigh them; they are cited only to illustrate the distribution. The critical editions’ choice of ἠγαπημένοις is recorded in the SBLGNT apparatus (WH, Treg, NIV, NA28 against RP).↩

### καὶ Ἰησοῦ Χριστῷ τετηρημένοις (*kai Iēsou Christō tetērēmenois*) — ‘and kept for Jesus Christ’

Again the participle is perfect: τετηρημένοις (*tetērēmenois*), “having been kept and remaining kept.” The verb τηρέω (*tēreō*) means “to watch over, guard, keep, preserve.”[26] It will become the central word of the letter.

The Greek has no preposition here. It reads simply “to-Jesus-Christ kept,” with “Jesus Christ” in the dative case. Because the Greek dative can express several relationships, three readings are possible:

1. **“kept *for* Jesus Christ”** (WEB, ASV, and most modern translations). Believers are kept safe *for* Christ, held in trust until his return. This fits Paul’s prayer that believers’ “whole spirit and soul and body be preserved, unblameably at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ” (1 Thess 5:23, LSV), and the letter’s own climax, where God sets believers before his glory (v. 24).
2. **“kept *by* Jesus Christ.”** Christ himself is the keeper. Compare Jesus’ prayer, “when I was with them in the world, I was keeping them in Your Name” (John 17:12, LSV).
3. **“kept *in* Jesus Christ”** (LSV). The preposition “in” from the previous phrase is understood again, so that believers are kept within their union with Christ.

The first reading is the most natural sense of a dative of this kind, and it fits the forward-looking shape of the letter, which ends with believers presented before God’s glory. The other readings are possible, and all three are true to the New Testament’s wider teaching. Jude’s emphasis is clear in any case: the readers’ safety is something God has done and is doing.

The word will return with sharp irony. In v. 6, angels who “did not keep” (μὴ τηρήσαντας, *mē tērēsantas*) their position are “kept” (τετήρηκεν, *tetērēken*) in bonds for judgment. In v. 13, the gloom of darkness “has been kept” (τετήρηται, *tetērētai*) for the wandering stars. In v. 21, the readers are told, “keep yourselves” (τηρήσατε, *tērēsate*). From the opening line, Jude is preparing a contrast between two kinds of keeping: keeping for glory and keeping for judgment.

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26. Abbott-Smith, s.v. τηρέω: “to watch over, guard, keep, preserve.”↩

### ἔλεος … καὶ εἰρήνη καὶ ἀγάπη (*eleos … kai eirēnē kai agapē*) — ‘mercy and peace and love’

Most New Testament letters greet their readers with “grace and peace.” The pastoral letters to Timothy and 2 John have “grace, mercy, peace.” Only Jude has **mercy, peace, and love**.

- **Mercy** (ἔλεος, *eleos*) is God’s compassion toward the needy and undeserving. In the Septuagint it most often translates the Hebrew *ḥesed*, God’s steadfast covenant love and loyalty.[27] Jude will mention mercy three more times: the readers are to wait for “the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ” (v. 21), and they are to “show mercy” to others (vv. 22–23). The letter begins with mercy given and ends with mercy passed on.
- **Peace** (εἰρήνη, *eirēnē*) carries the full sense of the Hebrew *shalom*: wholeness, safety, right relationship with God and others. In the Septuagint, *eirēnē* chiefly translates *shalom*.[28]

- **Love** (ἀγάπη, *agapē*) picks up “having been loved” from v. 1. It will appear again in a surprising place, the community’s “love-feasts” (v. 12), and once more in the command “keep yourselves in the love of God” (v. 21).

The three gifts are not three separate packages. Together they describe the life of the called community: God’s mercy received, God’s peace enjoyed, God’s love shared.

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27. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἔλεος: “[in LXX chiefly for חֶסֶד] mercy, pity, compassion”; the entry lists Jude 2 among the benedictions and Jude 21 as mercy “of Christ.”↩

28. Abbott-Smith, s.v. εἰρήνη: “[in LXX chiefly for שָׁלוֹם] peace.”↩

### ὑμῖν … πληθυνθείη (*hymin … plēthyntheiē*) — ‘may it be multiplied to you’

The verb πληθυνθείη (*plēthyntheiē*) is an **optative**, the Greek mood used for wishes and prayers. It is rare in the New Testament, which has only about sixty-eight optative forms in all.[29] Jude uses it twice: here and in Michael’s “The LORD rebuke you!” (v. 9).

The wish formula has a history. In the Greek translation of Daniel attributed to Theodotion, the royal letters of Nebuchadnezzar and Darius both open with εἰρήνη ὑμῖν πληθυνθείη, ‘peace be multiplied to you’ (Dan 4:1; 6:26).[30] First and Second Peter use the same formula: “Grace and peace be multiplied to you!” (1 Pet 1:2, LSV; cf. 2 Pet 1:2). Jude uses a familiar form of greeting, apparently at home in Jewish letters, and fills it with his own triad.

The point of “multiplied” is abundance. Jude does not wish his readers a modest share of mercy, peace, and love; he prays that these will grow and overflow. Given the troubles the letter describes, that prayer is not decoration but provision. A community facing division needs more love, not less, and mercy that grows enough to reach those who are wavering (vv. 22–23).

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29. Computed from the MorphGNT/SBLGNT data: 68 verb forms in the optative mood in the whole New Testament.↩

30. Greek Daniel (Theodotion) 4:1 and 6:26, in Brenton’s Greek Septuagint (eBible.org). Abbott-Smith, s.v. πληθύνω, also notes the construction with the dative of person in Daniel.↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In Jude 1–2 | Notes and cautions |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ἰούδας | *Ioudas* | Judah/Judas (personal name) | The author | Same name as Judas Iscariot; "Jude" is an English convention. |
| δοῦλος | *doulos* | slave, bondservant | "servant of Jesus Christ" | Implies belonging and obedience; also an OT honorific ("servant of the LORD"). "Servant" can obscure the ownership language; "slave" can obscure the honor. Both senses are present. |
| ἀδελφός | *adelphos* | brother; kinsman | "brother of James" | Can mean full brother, half-brother, or relative; see the Historical Introduction's deep dive. |
| κλητός | *klētos* | called, invited | "those called" | Placed last for emphasis. In the NT "always of the Divine call" (Abbott-Smith). |
| ἠγαπημένοις (from ἀγαπάω) | *ēgapēmenois* | having been loved | "having been loved in God [the] Father" | Perfect passive participle: a settled state. Variant ἡγιασμένοις, "sanctified." |
| τετηρημένοις (from τηρέω) | *tetērēmenois* | having been kept | "having been kept in Jesus Christ" | Perfect passive participle. Dative "Jesus Christ" may mean *for*, *by*, or *in*. |
| ἔλεος | *eleos* | mercy, compassion | "mercy" | In LXX chiefly for Hebrew *ḥesed*. |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In Jude 1–2 | Notes and cautions |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| εἰρήνη | *eirēnē* | peace | “peace” | In LXX chiefly for *shalom*: wholeness, security. |
| ἀγάπη | *agapē* | love | “love” | See caution below. |
| πληθυνθείη (from πληθύνω) | *plēthyntheiē* | may it be multiplied | “be multiplied” | Aorist passive optative: a wish or prayer. |

**A caution about *agapē*.** Popular teaching often claims that *agapē* and the verb *agapaō* name a uniquely divine, self-giving love, distinct from human affection. The New Testament’s own usage does not support so sharp a distinction. The same verb describes Demas, who deserted Paul, “having loved the present age” (2 Tim 4:10, LSV), and those of whom John says “men loved the darkness rather than the light” (John 3:19, LSV). Abbott-Smith’s lexicon notes that the traditional contrast between *agapaō* and *phileō* rests partly on a disputed etymology.[31] What gives Christian *agapē* its distinctive character is not the word itself but its object and source: the love of God shown in Christ. Jude’s usage fits this. The readers are loved *by God*, and they are to keep themselves in *God’s* love.

**A grammatical note on word order.** Greek allows an author to wrap a noun in its descriptions. Jude’s “to the … called” encloses “in God the Father loved and for Jesus Christ kept.” The arrangement places God the Father and Jesus Christ in parallel as the sources of the readers’ security, and it saves the noun of identity for last.

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31. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀγαπάω, notes that the distinction from φιλέω is drawn “from its supposed etymology” and is qualified (“If this distinction holds…”).↩

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Letter-writing conventions.** Thousands of letters survive from the Greco-Roman world, many of them on papyrus from Egypt. The typical opening was brief: “A to B, greetings (χαίρειν, *chairein*).” Jewish letters often used “peace” instead. Christian letter-writers took over the basic form and transformed it, replacing *chairein* with *charis* (“grace”) or with theological triads like Jude’s, and expanding the descriptions of sender and recipients to make theological claims. Jude’s opening is shorter than Paul’s, but it is just as deliberate.

**Slavery in the Roman world.** Slavery was pervasive in the first-century Mediterranean world. Slaves worked in households, farms, mines, workshops,

and government offices. Some held positions of considerable responsibility as stewards and agents of their masters, and a slave of a powerful master could share some of that master's status. Calling oneself "a slave of Jesus Christ" therefore said two things at once: complete submission, and representation of a master whose authority exceeded every other. Modern readers should hold both senses without romanticizing an institution that was, for most of those caught in it, brutal.

**The family of Jesus.** The household of Joseph and Mary in Nazareth was a family of craftsmen (Mark 6:3 calls Jesus "the carpenter"). Hegesippus's account of Jude's grandsons farming a small plot of land suggests a family of modest means in the following generations.[32] By the time Jude wrote, members of this family were known throughout the churches. James led the church in Jerusalem, and "the brothers of the LORD" traveled as missionaries (1 Cor 9:5, LSV). Jude writes from inside this network of relationships, but he presents himself first of all as Christ's servant.

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32. Eusebius, *Ecclesiastical History* 3.20.1–5, quoting Hegesippus.↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Called and kept (Isa 41–42; Rom 8).** The pairing of God's call with God's keeping goes back to Isaiah's portrait of the servant Israel: "I have called you, / And I say to you, You [are] My servant, / I have chosen you, and not rejected you" (Isa 41:9, LSV); "I, YHWH, called you in righteousness, / And I lay hold on your hand, and keep you" (Isa 42:6, LSV). Paul's chain of God's actions in Rom 8:30, "whom He called, these also He declared righteous; and whom He declared righteous, these also He glorified" (LSV), expresses the same confidence that God finishes what he begins. Jude belongs to this stream: those God calls, he holds. This is a shared theme rather than a direct allusion.

**Loved by God (Deut 7:7–8; Rom 1:7; 2 Thess 2:13).** Israel's election rested on God's love, not on its merit (Deut 7:7–8). Paul addresses Roman believers as "beloved of God, called holy ones" (Rom 1:7, LSV), joining "loved" and "called" as Jude does. Second Thessalonians gives thanks for "brothers, beloved by the LORD, that God chose you from the beginning to salvation" (2 Thess 2:13, LSV).

**Kept (John 17; 1 Pet 1:4–5; Rev 3:10).** Jesus' prayer, "Holy Father, keep them in Your Name" (John 17:11, LSV), uses the same verb as Jude, τηρέω. So does Jesus' further petition that the Father "keep them out of the evil" (John 17:15, LSV), and his promise in Revelation: "I also will keep you from the hour of the trial" (Rev 3:10, LSV). Peter describes believers as people "who, in the power of God are being guarded, through faith, to salvation" (1 Pet 1:5, LSV). The Aaronic blessing, "YHWH bless you and keep you" (Num 6:24, LSV),

stands behind all of this language. These passages share Jude's conviction, though Jude's wording is not drawn directly from any of them.

**The greeting formula (Dan 4:1; 6:26; 1 Pet 1:2; 2 Pet 1:2).** As noted above, "be multiplied" appears in royal letters in Greek Daniel and in the openings of 1 and 2 Peter. This is a shared epistolary convention rather than a literary dependence.

**Mercy in benedictions (Gal 6:16; 1 Tim 1:2; 2 Tim 1:2; 2 John 3).** "Mercy" appears in several New Testament blessings, but only Jude combines it with peace *and love*.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Who is Jude?** This question is treated in the Historical Introduction. For the opening verses, it is enough to note that the self-description "servant of Jesus Christ, and brother of James" is most naturally read as coming from the brother of Jesus and of James of Jerusalem. Scholars who regard the letter as pseudonymous read it as a later writer's appeal to that family's authority.

**2. "Loved" or "sanctified"?** The critical editions and the LSV read "loved." The Byzantine tradition reads "sanctified." The meaning differs only slightly, since both describe God's action on behalf of believers. The choice affects how strongly the opening anticipates the letter's theme of love (vv. 2, 12, 21).

**3. "Kept for," "by," or "in" Jesus Christ?** All three are grammatically possible. The choice affects the emphasis: Christ's return, Christ's agency, or union with Christ.

**4. How does God's keeping relate to human responsibility?** Jude says that believers *have been kept* (v. 1). He urges them to *keep themselves* (v. 21). He closes by praising the God who *is able to guard* them (v. 24). Christian traditions have related these statements in different ways:

- The **Reformed** tradition reads v. 1 and v. 24 as teaching the perseverance of the saints: those truly called and loved by God will be preserved to the end. On this view the command of v. 21 is the means by which God's keeping is worked out.
- **Wesleyan and Arminian** traditions emphasize that v. 21 is a real command whose neglect has real consequences, and they read the warnings of the letter (especially v. 5) as showing that those once delivered can fall away.
- **Catholic and Orthodox** traditions speak of grace and human cooperation working together, with God's keeping as the ground and enabling power of the believer's perseverance.

Jude himself does not resolve the theological puzzle. He states both sides with equal force and lets them stand together. This book follows his lead. The keeping of God comes first and frames everything, and the call to keep oneself is meant seriously. Readers will weigh the systematic question according to their traditions, but they should notice that Jude saw no contradiction in saying both.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

The greeting is the letter's foundation stone. It introduces three threads the rest of the letter will pull tight:

- **Keeping.** The readers are "kept" (v. 1). The rebels are "kept" for judgment (vv. 6, 13). The readers must "keep" themselves (v. 21). God is able to "guard" them (v. 24).
- **Love.** The readers are "loved" (v. 1). Love is wished upon them (v. 2). Their meals are "love-feasts" that intruders spoil (v. 12). They must stay in "the love of God" (v. 21).
- **Mercy.** Mercy is wished upon them (v. 2). They wait for Christ's mercy (v. 21). They are to show mercy to others (vv. 22–23).

These threads form a frame. The opening greeting (vv. 1–2) and the closing exhortation and doxology (vv. 20–25) share most of their key words: love, keep, mercy, Jesus Christ, God. Whatever darkness comes between, the readers are meant to read it from inside this frame.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*The following reflections suggest ways the passage may inform Christian life today. They are applications, not claims about what Jude's first readers were thinking.*

**Identity before instruction.** Jude tells his readers who they are before he tells them what to do. Modern Christian teaching often reverses the order and leads with demands. Jude's order suggests that believers may face hard truths and difficult tasks better when they begin from the security of being called, loved, and kept. For churches facing conflict, this ordering may itself be part of faithful leadership.

**Authority without self-promotion.** Jude had a family connection to Jesus that few could claim, yet he introduced himself as a servant and named his brother James instead of the Lord. Leaders in churches and Christian organizations today might ask how they present their credentials, and whether their self-descriptions point to themselves or to the one they serve.

**Being kept in a world of loss.** Many people experience faith as fragile, something they might lose through doubt, failure, or suffering. Jude's perfect participles ("having been loved," "having been kept") describe a settled state grounded in God's action. They do not deny the reality of struggle; the rest of the letter shows that Jude took struggle seriously. They do offer a place to stand.

**Blessing as a practice.** Jude's greeting is a prayer: "mercy and peace and love be multiplied to you!" Christians often greet one another casually. Jude's opening might encourage the practice of speaking blessing deliberately, in letters, messages, and gatherings, wishing others an abundance of God's gifts rather than mere pleasantries.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Jude describes his readers by what God has done for them (called, loved, kept) before he describes anything they must do. How might this order change the way you approach the challenges described later in the letter?
2. Why do you think Jude called himself a "servant of Jesus Christ" rather than "brother of the Lord"? What would each description have communicated to his readers?
3. The phrase "kept in [or for, or by] Jesus Christ" can be read three ways. Which reading seems most natural to you, and what difference does the choice make?
4. Jude says believers *have been kept* (v. 1) and must *keep themselves* (v. 21). How do you hold these two statements together? Where have you seen people emphasize one at the expense of the other?
5. Of the three gifts Jude wishes his readers (mercy, peace, love), which do you think your own community most needs "multiplied" right now, and why?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek text: SBLGNT, Jude 1–2. Variant data: SBLGNT apparatus and the eBible.org SBLGNT edition with NA28 notes; Robinson–Pierpont 2018; manuscript tallies from the Text-Critical Greek New Testament notes (eBible.org).
- Lexical data: G. Abbott-Smith, *A Manual Greek Lexicon of the New Testament* (Edinburgh: T&T Clark, 1922), s.vv. δοῦλος, κλητός, ἀγαπάω,

τηρέω, ἔλεος, εἰρήνη, πληθύνω.
- Greek Daniel (Theodotion) 4:1 and 6:26: Brenton's Greek Septuagint (eBible.org).
- Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude, ANF 2.
- Eusebius, *Ecclesiastical History* 3.19–20 (Hegesippus).
- Optative count: computed from MorphGNT (SBLGNT) data.

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Numbers 6:24

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**24** יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה וְיִשְׁמְרֶךָ

*English (BSB)*

**24** 'May the LORD bless you and keep you;

*English (WEB)*

**24** 'The LORD bless you, and keep you.

### Deuteronomy 7:7–8

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**7** לֹא מֵרֻבְּכֶם מִכָּל־הָעַמִּים חָשַׁק יְהוָה בָּכֶם וַיִּבְחַר בָּכֶם כִּי־אַתֶּם הַמְעַט מִכָּל־הָעַמִּים **8** כִּי מֵאַהֲבַת יְהוָה אֶתְכֶם וּמִשָּׁמְרוֹ אֶת־הַשְּׁבֻעָה אֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע לַאֲבֹתֵיכֶם הוֹצִיא יְהוָה אֶתְכֶם בְּיָד חֲזָקָה וַיִּפְדְּךָ מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים מִיַּד פַּרְעֹה מֶלֶךְ־מִצְרָיִם

*English (BSB)*

**7** The LORD did not set His affection on you and choose you because you were more numerous than the other peoples, for you were the fewest of all peoples. **8** But because the LORD loved you and kept the oath He swore to your fathers, He brought you out with a mighty hand and redeemed you from the house of slavery, from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt.

*English (WEB)*

**7** The LORD didn’t set his love on you nor choose you, because you were more in number than any people; for you were the fewest of all peoples; **8** but because the LORD loves you, and because he desires to keep the oath which he swore to your fathers, the LORD has brought you out with a mighty hand and redeemed you out of the house of bondage, from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt.

### Joshua 1:2

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**2** מֹשֶׁה עַבְדִּי מֵת וְעַתָּה קוּם עֲבֹר אֶת־הַיַּרְדֵּן הַזֶּה אַתָּה וְכָל־הָעָם הַזֶּה אֶל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי נֹתֵן לָהֶם לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

*English (BSB)*

**2** “Moses My servant is dead. Now therefore arise, you and all these people, and cross over the Jordan into the land that I am giving to the children of Israel.

*English (WEB)*

**2** “Moses my servant is dead. Now therefore arise, go across this Jordan, you and all these people, to the land which I am giving to them, even to the children of Israel.

### 2 Samuel 7:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**5** לֵךְ וְאָמַרְתָּ אֶל־עַבְדִּי אֶל־דָּוִד כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה הַאַתָּה תִּבְנֶה־לִּי בַיִת לְשִׁבְתִּי

*English (BSB)*

**5** “Go and tell My servant David that this is what the LORD says: Are you the one to build for Me a house to dwell in?

*English (WEB)*

**5** “Go and tell my servant David, ’The LORD says, “Should you build me a house for me to dwell in?

### Isaiah 41

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** הַחֲרִישׁוּ אֵלַי אִיִּים וּלְאֻמִּים יַחֲלִיפוּ כֹחַ יִגְּשׁוּ אָז יְדַבֵּרוּ יַחְדָּו לַמִּשְׁפָּט נִקְרָבָה **2** מִי הֵעִיר מִמִּזְרָח צֶדֶק יִקְרָאֵהוּ לְרַגְלוֹ יִתֵּן לְפָנָיו גּוֹיִם וּמְלָכִים יַרְדְּ יִתֵּן כֶּעָפָר חַרְבּוֹ כְּקַשׁ נִדָּף קַשְׁתּוֹ **3** יִרְדְּפֵם יַעֲבֹר שָׁלוֹם אֹרַח בְּרַגְלָיו לֹא יָבוֹא **4** מִי־פָעַל וְעָשָׂה קֹרֵא הַדֹּרוֹת מֵרֹאשׁ אֲנִי יְהוָה רִאשׁוֹן וְאֶת־ אַחֲרֹנִים אֲנִי־הוּא **5** רָאוּ אִיִּים וְיִרָאוּ קְצוֹת הָאָרֶץ יֶחֱרָדוּ קָרְבוּ וַיֶּאֱתָיוּן **6** אִישׁ אֶת־רֵעֵהוּ יַעְזֹרוּ וּלְאָחִיו יֹאמַר חֲזָק **7** וַיְחַזֵּק חָרָשׁ אֶת־צוֹרֵף מַחֲלִיק פַּטִּישׁ אֶת־הוֹלֶם פָּעַם אֹמֵר לַדֶּבֶק טוֹב הוּא וַיְחַזְּקֵהוּ בְמַסְמְרִים לֹא יִמּוֹט **8** וְאַתָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל עַבְדִּי יַעֲקֹב אֲשֶׁר בְּחַרְתִּיךְ זֶרַע אַבְרָהָם אֹהֲבִי **9** אֲשֶׁר הֶחֱזַקְתִּיךָ מִקְצוֹת הָאָרֶץ וּמֵאֲצִילֶיהָ קְרָאתִיךָ וָאֹמַר לְךָ עַבְדִּי־אַתָּה בְּחַרְתִּיךָ וְלֹא מְאַסְתִּיךָ **10** אַל־ תִּירָא כִּי עִמְּךָ־אָנִי אַל־תִּשְׁתָּע כִּי־אֲנִי אֱלֹהֶיךָ אִמַּצְתִּיךָ אַף־עֲזַרְתִּיךָ אַף־תְּמַכְתִּיךָ בִּימִין צִדְקִי **11** הֵן יֵבֹשׁוּ וְיִכָּלְמוּ כֹּל הַנֶּחֱרִים בָּךְ יִהְיוּ כְאַיִן וְיֹאבְדוּ אַנְשֵׁי רִיבֶךָ **12** תְּבַקְשֵׁם וְלֹא תִמְצָאֵם אַנְשֵׁי מַצֻּתֶךָ יִהְיוּ כְאַיִן וּכְאֶפֶס אַנְשֵׁי מִלְחַמְתֶּךָ **13** כִּי אֲנִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ מַחֲזִיק יְמִינֶךָ הָאֹמֵר לְךָ אַל־תִּירָא אֲנִי עֲזַרְתִּיךָ **14** אַל־תִּירְאִי תּוֹלַעַת יַעֲקֹב מְתֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲנִי עֲזַרְתִּיךְ נְאֻם־יְהוָה וְגֹאֲלֵךְ קְדוֹשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל **15** הִנֵּה שַׂמְתִּיךְ לְמוֹרַג חָרוּץ חָדָשׁ בַּעַל פִּיפִיּוֹת תָּדוֹשׁ הָרִים וְתָדֵק וּגְבָעוֹת כַּמֹּץ תָּשִׂים **16** תִּזְרֵם וְרוּחַ תִּשָּׂאֵם וּסְעָרָה תָּפִיץ אוֹתָם וְאַתָּה תָּגִיל בַּיהוָה בִּקְדוֹשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל תִּתְהַלָּל **17** הָעֲנִיִּים וְהָאֶבְיוֹנִים מְבַקְשִׁים מַיִם וְאַיִן לְשׁוֹנָם בַּצָּמָא נָשְׁתָּה אֲנִי יְהוָה אֶעֱנֵם אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֹא אֶעֱזֹבֵם **18** אֶפְתַּח עַל־ שְׁפָיִים נְהָרוֹת וּבְתוֹךְ בְּקָעוֹת מַעְיָנוֹת אָשִׂים מִדְבָּר לַאֲגַם־מַיִם וְאֶרֶץ צִיָּה לְמוֹצָאֵי מָיִם **19** אֶתֵּן בַּמִּדְבָּר אֶרֶז שִׁטָּה וַהֲדַס וְעֵץ שֶׁמֶן אָשִׂים בָּעֲרָבָה בְּרוֹשׁ תִּדְהָר וּתְאַשּׁוּר יַחְדָּו **20** לְמַעַן יִרְאוּ וְיֵדְעוּ וְיָשִׂימוּ וְיַשְׂכִּילוּ יַחְדָּו כִּי יַד־יְהוָה עָשְׂתָה זֹּאת וּקְדוֹשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּרָאָהּ **21** קָרְבוּ רִיבְכֶם יֹאמַר יְהוָה הַגִּישׁוּ עֻצְמוֹתֵיכֶם יֹאמַר מֶלֶךְ יַעֲקֹב **22** יַגִּישׁוּ וְיַגִּידוּ לָנוּ אֵת אֲשֶׁר תִּקְרֶינָה הָרִאשֹׁנוֹת מָה הֵנָּה הַגִּידוּ וְנָשִׂימָה לִבֵּנוּ וְנֵדְעָה אַחֲרִיתָן אוֹ הַבָּאוֹת הַשְׁמִיעֻנוּ **23** הַגִּידוּ הָאֹתִיוֹת לְאָחוֹר וְנֵדְעָה כִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם אַף־תֵּיטִיבוּ וְתָרֵעוּ וְנִשְׁתָּעָה ונראֶ יַחְדָּו **24** הֵן־אַתֶּם מֵאַיִן וּפָעֳלְכֶם מֵאָפַע תּוֹעֵבָה יִבְחַר בָּכֶם **25** הֵעִירוֹתִי מִצָּפוֹן וַיֵּאת מִמִּזְרַח־שֶׁמֶשׁ יִקְרָא בִשְׁמִי וְיָבֹא סְגָנִים כְּמוֹ־חֹמֶר וּכְמוֹ יוֹצֵר יִרְמָס־טִיט **26** מִי־הִגִּיד מֵרֹאשׁ וְנֵדָעָה וּמִלְפָנִים וְנֹאמַר צַדִּיק אַף אֵין־מַגִּיד אַף אֵין מַשְׁמִיעַ אַף אֵין־שֹׁמֵעַ אִמְרֵיכֶם **27** רִאשׁוֹן לְצִיּוֹן הִנֵּה הִנָּם וְלִירוּשָׁלַם מְבַשֵּׂר אֶתֵּן **28** וָאֵרֶא וְאֵין אִישׁ וּמֵאֵלֶּה וְאֵין יוֹעֵץ וְאֶשְׁאָלֵם וְיָשִׁיבוּ דָבָר **29** הֵן כֻּלָּם אָוֶן אֶפֶס מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם רוּחַ וָתֹהוּ נְסִכֵּיהֶם

*English (BSB)*

**1** “Be silent before Me, O islands, and let the peoples renew their strength. Let them come forward and testify; let us together draw near for judgment. **2** Who has aroused one from the east and called him to his feet in righteousness ? He hands nations over to him and subdues kings before him. He turns them to dust with his sword, to windblown chaff with his bow. **3** He pursues them, going on safely, hardly touching the path with his feet. **4** Who has performed this and carried it out, calling forth the generations from the beginning? I, the LORD—the first and the last— I am He.” **5** The islands see and fear; the ends of the earth tremble. They approach and come forward. **6** Each one helps the other and says to his brother, “Be strong!” **7** The craftsman encourages the goldsmith, and he who wields the hammer cheers him who strikes the anvil, saying of the welding, “It is good.” He nails it down so it will not be toppled. **8** “But you, O Israel, My servant, Jacob, whom I have chosen, descendant of Abraham My friend— **9** I brought you from the ends of the earth and called

you from its farthest corners. I said, ‘You are My servant.’ I have chosen and not rejected you. **10** Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness. **11** Behold, all who rage against you will be ashamed and disgraced; those who contend with you will be reduced to nothing and will perish. **12** You will seek them but will not find them. Those who wage war against you will come to nothing. **13** For I am the LORD your God, who takes hold of your right hand and tells you: Do not fear, I will help you. **14** Do not fear, O worm of Jacob, O few men of Israel. I will help you,” declares the LORD. “Your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel. **15** Behold, I will make you into a threshing sledge, new and sharp, with many teeth. You will thresh the mountains and crush them, and reduce the hills to chaff. **16** You will winnow them, and a wind will carry them away; a gale will scatter them. But you will rejoice in the LORD; you will glory in the Holy One of Israel. **17** The poor and needy seek water, but there is none; their tongues are parched with thirst. I, the LORD, will answer them; I, the God of Israel, will not forsake them. **18** I will open rivers on the barren heights, and fountains in the middle of the valleys. I will turn the desert into a pool of water, and the dry land into flowing springs. **19** I will plant cedars in the wilderness, acacias, myrtles, and olive trees. I will set cypresses in the desert, elms and boxwood together, **20** so that all may see and know, may consider and understand, that the hand of the LORD has done this and the Holy One of Israel has created it.” **21** “Present your case,” says the LORD. “Submit your arguments,” says the King of Jacob. **22** “Let them come and tell us what will happen. Tell the former things, so that we may reflect on them and know the outcome. Or announce to us what is coming. **23** Tell us the things that are to come, so that we may know that you are gods. Yes, do something good or evil, that we may look on together in dismay. **24** Behold, you are nothing and your work is of no value. Anyone who chooses you is detestable. **25** I have raised up one from the north, and he has come— one from the east who calls on My name. He will march over rulers as if they were mortar, like a potter who treads the clay. **26** Who has declared this from the beginning, so that we may know, and from times past, so that we may say: ‘He was right’? No one announced it, no one foretold it, no one heard your words. **27** I was the first to tell Zion: ‘Look, here they are!’ And I gave to Jerusalem a herald of good news. **28** When I look, there is no one; there is no counselor among them; when I ask them, they have nothing to say. **29** See, they are all a delusion; their works amount to nothing; their images are as empty as the wind.

*English (WEB)*

**1** “Keep silent before me, islands, and let the peoples renew their strength. Let them come near, then let them speak. Let’s meet together for judgment. **2** Who has raised up one from the east? Who called him to his feet in righteousness? He hands over nations to him and makes him rule over kings.

He gives them like the dust to his sword, like the driven stubble to his bow. **3** He pursues them and passes by safely, even by a way that he had not gone with his feet. **4** Who has worked and done it, calling the generations from the beginning? I, the LORD, the first, and with the last, I am he." **5** The islands have seen, and fear. The ends of the earth tremble. They approach, and come. **6** Everyone helps his neighbor. They say to their brothers, "Be strong!" **7** So the carpenter encourages the goldsmith. He who smooths with the hammer encourages him who strikes the anvil, saying of the soldering, "It is good;" and he fastens it with nails, that it might not totter. **8** "But you, Israel, my servant, Jacob whom I have chosen, the offspring of Abraham my friend, **9** you whom I have taken hold of from the ends of the earth, and called from its corners, and said to you, 'You are my servant. I have chosen you and have not cast you away.' **10** Don't you be afraid, for I am with you. Don't be dismayed, for I am your God. I will strengthen you. Yes, I will help you. Yes, I will uphold you with the right hand of my righteousness. **11** Behold, all those who are incensed against you will be disappointed and confounded. Those who strive with you will be like nothing, and shall perish. **12** You will seek them, and won't find them, even those who contend with you. Those who war against you will be as nothing, as a nonexistent thing. **13** For I, the LORD your God, will hold your right hand, saying to you, 'Don't be afraid. I will help you.' **14** Don't be afraid, you worm Jacob, and you men of Israel. I will help you," says the LORD. "Your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel. **15** Behold, I have made you into a new sharp threshing instrument with teeth. You will thresh the mountains, and beat them small, and will make the hills like chaff. **16** You will winnow them, and the wind will carry them away, and the whirlwind will scatter them. You will rejoice in the LORD. You will glory in the Holy One of Israel. **17** The poor and needy seek water, and there is none. Their tongue fails for thirst. I, the LORD, will answer them. I, the God of Israel, will not forsake them. **18** I will open rivers on the bare heights, and springs in the middle of the valleys. I will make the wilderness a pool of water, and the dry land springs of water. **19** I will put cedar, acacia, myrtle, and oil trees in the wilderness. I will set cypress trees, pine, and box trees together in the desert; **20** that they may see, know, consider, and understand together, that the LORD's hand has done this, and the Holy One of Israel has created it. **21** Produce your cause," says the LORD. "Bring out your strong reasons!" says the King of Jacob. **22** "Let them announce and declare to us what will happen! Declare the former things, what they are, that we may consider them, and know the latter end of them; or show us things to come. **23** Declare the things that are to come hereafter, that we may know that you are gods. Yes, do good, or do evil, that we may be dismayed, and see it together. **24** Behold, you are nothing, and your work is nothing. He who chooses you is an abomination. **25** "I have raised up one from the north, and he has come, from the rising of the sun, one who calls on my name, and he shall come on rulers as on mortar, and as the potter treads clay. **26** Who has declared it from the beginning, that we may know? and before, that we may say, 'He is right'? Surely, there is no one who declares. Surely,

there is no one who shows. Surely, there is no one who hears your words. **27** I am the first to say to Zion, 'Behold, look at them;' and I will give one who brings good news to Jerusalem. **28** When I look, there is no man, even among them there is no counselor who, when I ask, can answer a word. **29** Behold, all of their deeds are vanity and nothing. Their molten images are wind and confusion.

## Isaiah 42

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** הֵן עַבְדִּי אֶתְמָךְ־בּוֹ בְּחִירִי רָצְתָה נַפְשִׁי נָתַתִּי רוּחִי עָלָיו מִשְׁפָּט לַגּוֹיִם יוֹצִיא **2** לֹא יִצְעַק וְלֹא יִשָּׂא
וְלֹא־יַשְׁמִיעַ בַּחוּץ קוֹלוֹ **3** קָנֶה רָצוּץ לֹא יִשְׁבּוֹר וּפִשְׁתָּה כֵהָה לֹא יְכַבֶּנָּה לֶאֱמֶת יוֹצִיא מִשְׁפָּט **4** לֹא
יִכְהֶה וְלֹא יָרוּץ עַד־יָשִׂים בָּאָרֶץ מִשְׁפָּט וּלְתוֹרָתוֹ אִיִּים יְיַחֵלוּ **5** כֹּה־אָמַר הָאֵל יְהוָה בּוֹרֵא הַשָּׁמַיִם
וְנוֹטֵיהֶם רֹקַע הָאָרֶץ וְצֶאֱצָאֶיהָ נֹתֵן נְשָׁמָה לָעָם עָלֶיהָ וְרוּחַ לַהֹלְכִים בָּהּ **6** אֲנִי יְהוָה קְרָאתִיךָ בְצֶדֶק
וְאַחְזִק בְּיָדֶךָ וְאֶצָּרְךָ וְאֶתֶּנְךָ לִבְרִית עָם לְאוֹר גּוֹיִם **7** לִפְקֹחַ עֵינַיִם עִוְרוֹת לְהוֹצִיא מִמַּסְגֵּר אָסִיר
מִבֵּית כֶּלֶא יֹשְׁבֵי חֹשֶׁךְ **8** אֲנִי יְהוָה הוּא שְׁמִי וּכְבוֹדִי לְאַחֵר לֹא־אֶתֵּן וּתְהִלָּתִי לַפְּסִילִים **9** הָרִאשֹׁנוֹת
הִנֵּה־בָאוּ וַחֲדָשׁוֹת אֲנִי מַגִּיד בְּטֶרֶם תִּצְמַחְנָה אַשְׁמִיע אֶתְכֶם **10** שִׁירוּ לַיהוָה שִׁיר חָדָשׁ תְּהִלָּתוֹ מִקְצֵה
הָאָרֶץ יוֹרְדֵי הַיָּם וּמְלֹאוֹ אִיִּים וְיֹשְׁבֵיהֶם **11** יִשָּׂאוּ מִדְבָּר וְעָרָיו חֲצֵרִים תֵּשֵׁב קֵדָר יָרֹנּוּ יֹשְׁבֵי סֶלַע
מֵרֹאשׁ הָרִים יְצִוָּחוּ **12** יָשִׂימוּ לַיהוָה כָּבוֹד וּתְהִלָּתוֹ בָּאִיִּים יַגִּידוּ **13** יְהוָה כַּגִּבּוֹר יֵצֵא כְּאִישׁ
מִלְחָמוֹת יָעִיר קִנְאָה יָרִיעַ אַף־יַצְרִיחַ עַל־אֹיְבָיו יִתְגַּבָּר **14** הֶחֱשֵׁיתִי מֵעוֹלָם אַחָרִישׁ אֶתְאַפָּק
כַּיּוֹלֵדָה אֶפְעֶה אֶשֹּׁם וְאֶשְׁאַף יָחַד **15** אַחֲרִיב הָרִים וּגְבָעוֹת וְכָל־עֶשְׂבָּם אוֹבִישׁ וְשַׂמְתִּי נְהָרוֹת לָאִיִּים
וַאֲגַמִּים אוֹבִישׁ **16** וְהוֹלַכְתִּי עִוְרִים בְּדֶרֶךְ לֹא יָדָעוּ בִּנְתִיבוֹת לֹא־יָדְעוּ אַדְרִיכֵם אָשִׂים מַחְשָׁךְ
לִפְנֵיהֶם לָאוֹר וּמַעֲקַשִּׁים לְמִישׁוֹר אֵלֶּה הַדְּבָרִים עָשִׂיתִם וְלֹא עֲזַבְתִּים **17** נָסֹגוּ אָחוֹר יֵבֹשׁוּ בֹּשֶׁת
הַבֹּטְחִים בַּפֶּסֶל הָאֹמְרִים לְמַסֵּכָה אַתֶּם אֱלֹהֵינוּ **18** הַחֵרְשִׁים שְׁמָעוּ וְהַעִוְרִים הַבִּיטוּ לִרְאוֹת **19** מִי
עִוֵּר כִּי אִם־עַבְדִּי וְחֵרֵשׁ כְּמַלְאָכִי אֶשְׁלָח מִי עִוַּר כִּמְשֻׁלָּם וְעִוֵּר כְּעֶבֶד יְהוָה **20** רֹאִית רַבּוֹת וְלֹא
תִשְׁמֹר פָּקוֹחַ אָזְנַיִם וְלֹא יִשְׁמָע **21** יְהוָה חָפֵץ לְמַעַן צִדְקוֹ יַגְדִּיל תּוֹרָה וְיַאְדִּיר **22** וְהוּא עַם־בָּזוּז
וְשָׁסוּי הָפַח בְּחוּרִים כֻּלָּם וּבְבָתֵּי כְלָאִים הָחְבָּאוּ הָיוּ לָבַז וְאֵין מַצִּיל מִשִּׁסָּה וְאֵין־אֹמֵר הָשֵׁב **23** מִי
בָכֶם יַאֲזִין זֹאת יַקְשֵׁב וְיִשְׁמַע לְאָחוֹר **24** מִי־נָתַן למשוסה יַעֲקֹב וְיִשְׂרָאֵל לְבֹזְזִים הֲלוֹא יְהוָה זוּ
חָטָאנוּ לוֹ וְלֹא־אָבוּ בִדְרָכָיו הָלוֹךְ וְלֹא שָׁמְעוּ בְּתוֹרָתוֹ **25** וַיִּשְׁפֹּךְ עָלָיו חֲמָה אַפּוֹ וָעֻזּוֹ מִלְחָמָה
וַתְּלַהֲטֵהוּ מִסָּבִיב וְלֹא יָדָע וַתִּבְעַר־בּוֹ וְלֹא־יָשִׂים עַל־לֵב

*English (BSB)*

**1** "Here is My Servant, whom I uphold, My Chosen One, in whom My soul delights. I will put My Spirit on Him, and He will bring justice to the nations. **2** He will not cry out or raise His voice, nor make His voice heard in the streets. **3** A bruised reed He will not break and a smoldering wick He will not extinguish; He will faithfully bring forth justice. **4** He will not grow weak or discouraged before He has established justice on the earth. In His law the islands will put their hope." **5** This is what God the LORD says— He who created the heavens and stretched them out, who spread out the earth and its offspring, who gives breath to the people on it and life to those who walk in it:

**6** “I, the LORD, have called you for a righteous purpose, and I will take hold of your hand. I will keep you and appoint you to be a covenant for the people and a light to the nations, **7** to open the eyes of the blind, to bring prisoners out of the dungeon and those sitting in darkness out from the prison house. **8** I am the LORD; that is My name! I will not yield My glory to another or My praise to idols. **9** Behold, the former things have happened, and now I declare new things. Before they spring forth I proclaim them to you.” **10** Sing to the LORD a new song— His praise from the ends of the earth— you who go down to the sea, and all that is in it, you islands, and all who dwell in them. **11** Let the desert and its cities raise their voices; let the villages of Kedar cry aloud. Let the people of Sela sing for joy; let them cry out from the mountaintops. **12** Let them give glory to the LORD and declare His praise in the islands. **13** The LORD goes forth like a mighty one; He stirs up His zeal like a warrior. He shouts; yes, He roars in triumph over His enemies: **14** “I have kept silent from ages past; I have remained quiet and restrained. But now I will groan like a woman in labor; I will at once gasp and pant. **15** I will lay waste the mountains and hills and dry up all their vegetation. I will turn the rivers into dry land and drain the marshes. **16** I will lead the blind by a way they did not know; I will guide them on unfamiliar paths. I will turn darkness into light before them and rough places into level ground. These things I will do for them, and I will not forsake them. **17** But those who trust in idols and say to molten images, ‘You are our gods!’ will be turned back in utter shame. **18** Listen, you deaf ones; look, you blind ones, that you may see! **19** Who is blind but My servant, or deaf like the messenger I am sending? Who is blind like My covenant partner, or blind like the servant of the LORD? **20** Though seeing many things, you do not keep watch. Though your ears are open, you do not hear.” **21** The LORD was pleased, for the sake of His righteousness, to magnify His law and make it glorious. **22** But this is a people plundered and looted, all trapped in caves or imprisoned in dungeons. They have become plunder with no one to rescue them, and loot with no one to say, “Send them back!” **23** Who among you will pay attention to this? Who will listen and obey hereafter? **24** Who gave Jacob up for spoil, and Israel to the plunderers? Was it not the LORD, against whom we have sinned? They were unwilling to walk in His ways, and they would not obey His law. **25** So He poured out on them His furious anger and the fierceness of battle. It enveloped them in flames, but they did not understand; it consumed them, but they did not take it to heart.

*English (WEB)*

**1** “Behold, my servant, whom I uphold, my chosen, in whom my soul delights: I have put my Spirit on him. He will bring justice to the nations. **2** He will not shout, nor raise his voice, nor cause it to be heard in the street. **3** He won’t break a bruised reed. He won’t quench a dimly burning wick. He will faithfully bring justice. **4** He will not fail nor be discouraged, until he has set justice on the earth, and the islands wait for his law.” **5** God the LORD, he who created

the heavens and stretched them out, he who spread out the earth and that which comes out of it, he who gives breath to its people and spirit to those who walk in it, says: **6** “I, the LORD, have called you in righteousness. I will hold your hand. I will keep you, and make you a covenant for the people, as a light for the nations, **7** to open the blind eyes, to bring the prisoners out of the dungeon, and those who sit in darkness out of the prison. **8** “I am the LORD. That is my name. I will not give my glory to another, nor my praise to engraved images. **9** Behold, the former things have happened and I declare new things. I tell you about them before they come up.” **10** Sing to the LORD a new song, and his praise from the end of the earth, you who go down to the sea, and all that is therein, the islands and their inhabitants. **11** Let the wilderness and its cities raise their voices, with the villages that Kedar inhabits. Let the inhabitants of Sela sing. Let them shout from the top of the mountains! **12** Let them give glory to the LORD, and declare his praise in the islands. **13** The LORD will go out like a mighty man. He will stir up zeal like a man of war. He will raise a war cry. Yes, he will shout aloud. He will triumph over his enemies. **14** “I have been silent a long time. I have been quiet and restrained myself. Now I will cry out like a travailing woman. I will both gasp and pant. **15** I will destroy mountains and hills, and dry up all their herbs. I will make the rivers islands, and will dry up the pools. **16** I will bring the blind by a way that they don’t know. I will lead them in paths that they don’t know. I will make darkness light before them, and crooked places straight. I will do these things, and I will not forsake them. **17** “Those who trust in engraved images, who tell molten images, ‘You are our gods,’ will be turned back. They will be utterly disappointed. **18** “Hear, you deaf, and look, you blind, that you may see. **19** Who is blind, but my servant? Or who is as deaf as my messenger whom I send? Who is as blind as he who is at peace, and as blind as the LORD’s servant? **20** You see many things, but don’t observe. His ears are open, but he doesn’t listen. **21** It pleased the LORD, for his righteousness’ sake, to magnify the law and make it honorable. **22** But this is a robbed and plundered people. All of them are snared in holes, and they are hidden in prisons. They have become captives, and no one delivers, and a plunder, and no one says, ‘Restore them!’ **23** Who is there among you who will give ear to this? Who will listen and hear for the time to come? **24** Who gave Jacob as plunder, and Israel to the robbers? Didn’t the LORD, he against whom we have sinned? For they would not walk in his ways, and they disobeyed his law. **25** Therefore he poured the fierceness of his anger on him, and the strength of battle. It set him on fire all around, but he didn’t know. It burned him, but he didn’t take it to heart.”

## Daniel 4:1

*Aramaic (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**1 [3:31]** נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר מַלְכָּא לְכָל־עַמְמַיָּא אֻמַיָּא וְלִשָּׁנַיָּא דִּי־דָארִין בְּכָל־אַרְעָא שְׁלָמְכוֹן יִשְׂגֵּא

*English (BSB)*

**1** King Nebuchadnezzar, To the people of every nation and language who dwell in all the earth: May your prosperity be multiplied.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Nebuchadnezzar the king, to all the peoples, nations, and languages, who dwell in all the earth: Peace be multiplied to you.

## Daniel 6:26

*Aramaic (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**26 [6:27]** מִן־קֳדָמַי שִׂים טְעֵם דִּי בְכָל־שָׁלְטָן מַלְכוּתִי לֶהֱוֹן זאעין וְדָחֲלִין מִן־קֳדָם אֱלָהֵהּ דִּי־דָנִיֵּאל דִּי־הוּא אֱלָהָא חַיָּא וְקַיָּם לְעָלְמִין וּמַלְכוּתֵהּ דִּי־לָא תִתְחַבַּל וְשָׁלְטָנֵהּ עַד־סוֹפָא

*English (BSB)*

**26** I hereby decree that in every part of my kingdom, men are to tremble in fear before the God of Daniel: For He is the living God, and He endures forever; His kingdom will never be destroyed, and His dominion will never end.

*English (WEB)*

**26** “I make a decree that in all the dominion of my kingdom men tremble and fear before the God of Daniel. “For he is the living God, and steadfast forever. His kingdom is that which will not be destroyed. His dominion will be even to the end.

## Mark 6:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** οὐχ οὗτός ἐστιν ὁ τέκτων, ὁ υἱὸς τῆς Μαρίας καὶ ἀδελφὸς Ἰακώβου καὶ Ἰωσῆτος καὶ Ἰούδα καὶ Σίμωνος; καὶ οὐκ εἰσὶν αἱ ἀδελφαὶ αὐτοῦ ὧδε πρὸς ἡμᾶς; καὶ ἐσκανδαλίζοντο ἐν αὐτῷ.

*English (BSB)*

**3** Isn’t this the carpenter, the son of Mary and the brother of James, Joses, Judas, and Simon? Aren’t His sisters here with us as well?” And they took offense at Him.

*English (WEB)*

**3** Isn’t this the carpenter, the son of Mary and brother of James, Joses, Judah, and Simon? Aren’t his sisters here with us?” So they were offended at him.

## John 3:19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** αὕτη δέ ἐστιν ἡ κρίσις ὅτι τὸ φῶς ἐλήλυθεν εἰς τὸν κόσμον καὶ ἠγάπησαν οἱ ἄνθρωποι μᾶλλον τὸ σκότος ἢ τὸ φῶς, ἦν γὰρ αὐτῶν πονηρὰ τὰ ἔργα.

*English (BSB)*

**19** And this is the verdict: The Light has come into the world, but men loved the darkness rather than the Light because their deeds were evil.

*English (WEB)*

**19** This is the judgment, that the light has come into the world, and men loved the darkness rather than the light, for their works were evil.

## John 17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ταῦτα ἐλάλησεν Ἰησοῦς, καὶ ἐπάρας τοὺς ὀφθαλμοὺς αὐτοῦ εἰς τὸν οὐρανὸν εἶπεν· Πάτερ, ἐλήλυθεν ἡ ὥρα· δόξασόν σου τὸν υἱόν, ἵνα ὁ υἱὸς δοξάσῃ σέ, **2** καθὼς ἔδωκας αὐτῷ ἐξουσίαν πάσης σαρκός, ἵνα πᾶν ὃ δέδωκας αὐτῷ δώσῃ αὐτοῖς ζωὴν αἰώνιον. **3** αὕτη δέ ἐστιν ἡ αἰώνιος ζωὴ ἵνα γινώσκωσι σὲ τὸν μόνον ἀληθινὸν θεὸν καὶ ὃν ἀπέστειλας Ἰησοῦν Χριστόν. **4** ἐγώ σε ἐδόξασα ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς, τὸ ἔργον τελειώσας ὃ δέδωκάς μοι ἵνα ποιήσω· **5** καὶ νῦν δόξασόν με σύ, πάτερ, παρὰ σεαυτῷ τῇ δόξῃ ᾗ εἶχον πρὸ τοῦ τὸν κόσμον εἶναι παρὰ σοί. **6** Ἐφανέρωσά σου τὸ ὄνομα τοῖς ἀνθρώποις οὓς ἔδωκάς μοι ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου. σοὶ ἦσαν κἀμοὶ αὐτοὺς ἔδωκας, καὶ τὸν λόγον σου τετήρηκαν. **7** νῦν ἔγνωκαν ὅτι πάντα ὅσα δέδωκάς μοι παρὰ σοῦ εἰσιν· **8** ὅτι τὰ ῥήματα ἃ ἔδωκάς μοι δέδωκα αὐτοῖς, καὶ αὐτοὶ ἔλαβον καὶ ἔγνωσαν ἀληθῶς ὅτι παρὰ σοῦ ἐξῆλθον, καὶ ἐπίστευσαν ὅτι σύ με ἀπέστειλας. **9** ἐγὼ περὶ αὐτῶν ἐρωτῶ· οὐ περὶ τοῦ κόσμου ἐρωτῶ ἀλλὰ περὶ ὧν δέδωκάς μοι, ὅτι σοί εἰσιν, **10** καὶ τὰ ἐμὰ πάντα σά ἐστιν καὶ τὰ σὰ ἐμά, καὶ δεδόξασμαι ἐν αὐτοῖς. **11** καὶ οὐκέτι εἰμὶ ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ, καὶ αὐτοὶ ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ εἰσίν, κἀγὼ πρὸς σὲ ἔρχομαι. πάτερ ἅγιε, τήρησον αὐτοὺς ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί σου ᾧ δέδωκάς μοι, ἵνα ὦσιν ἓν καθὼς ἡμεῖς. **12** ὅτε ἤμην μετ᾽ αὐτῶν ἐγὼ ἐτήρουν αὐτοὺς ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί σου ᾧ δέδωκάς μοι, καὶ ἐφύλαξα, καὶ οὐδεὶς ἐξ αὐτῶν ἀπώλετο εἰ μὴ ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας, ἵνα ἡ γραφὴ πληρωθῇ. **13** νῦν δὲ πρὸς σὲ ἔρχομαι, καὶ ταῦτα λαλῶ ἐν τῷ κόσμῳ ἵνα ἔχωσιν τὴν χαρὰν τὴν ἐμὴν πεπληρωμένην ἐν ἑαυτοῖς. **14** ἐγὼ δέδωκα αὐτοῖς τὸν λόγον σου, καὶ ὁ κόσμος ἐμίσησεν αὐτούς, ὅτι οὐκ εἰσὶν ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου καθὼς ἐγὼ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου. **15** οὐκ ἐρωτῶ ἵνα ἄρῃς αὐτοὺς ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου ἀλλ᾽ ἵνα τηρήσῃς αὐτοὺς ἐκ τοῦ πονηροῦ. **16** ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου οὐκ εἰσὶν καθὼς ἐγὼ οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου. **17** ἁγίασον αὐτοὺς ἐν τῇ ἀληθείᾳ· ὁ λόγος ὁ σὸς ἀλήθειά ἐστιν. **18** καθὼς ἐμὲ ἀπέστειλας εἰς τὸν κόσμον, κἀγὼ ἀπέστειλα αὐτοὺς εἰς τὸν κόσμον· **19** καὶ ὑπὲρ αὐτῶν ἐγὼ ἁγιάζω ἐμαυτόν, ἵνα ὦσιν καὶ αὐτοὶ ἡγιασμένοι ἐν ἀληθείᾳ. **20** Οὐ περὶ τούτων δὲ ἐρωτῶ μόνον, ἀλλὰ καὶ περὶ τῶν πιστευόντων διὰ τοῦ λόγου αὐτῶν εἰς ἐμέ, **21** ἵνα

πάντες ἓν ὦσιν, καθὼς σύ, πάτερ, ἐν ἐμοὶ κἀγὼ ἐν σοί, ἵνα καὶ αὐτοὶ ἐν ἡμῖν ὦσιν, ἵνα ὁ κόσμος πιστεύῃ ὅτι σύ με ἀπέστειλας. **22** κἀγὼ τὴν δόξαν ἣν δέδωκάς μοι δέδωκα αὐτοῖς, ἵνα ὦσιν ἓν καθὼς ἡμεῖς ἕν, **23** ἐγὼ ἐν αὐτοῖς καὶ σὺ ἐν ἐμοί, ἵνα ὦσιν τετελειωμένοι εἰς ἕν, ἵνα γινώσκῃ ὁ κόσμος ὅτι σύ με ἀπέστειλας καὶ ἠγάπησας αὐτοὺς καθὼς ἐμὲ ἠγάπησας. **24** πάτερ, ὃ δέδωκάς μοι, θέλω ἵνα ὅπου εἰμὶ ἐγὼ κἀκεῖνοι ὦσιν μετ᾽ ἐμοῦ, ἵνα θεωρῶσιν τὴν δόξαν τὴν ἐμὴν ἣν δέδωκάς μοι, ὅτι ἠγάπησάς με πρὸ καταβολῆς κόσμου. **25** Πάτερ δίκαιε, καὶ ὁ κόσμος σε οὐκ ἔγνω, ἐγὼ δέ σε ἔγνων, καὶ οὗτοι ἔγνωσαν ὅτι σύ με ἀπέστειλας, **26** καὶ ἐγνώρισα αὐτοῖς τὸ ὄνομά σου καὶ γνωρίσω, ἵνα ἡ ἀγάπη ἣν ἠγάπησάς με ἐν αὐτοῖς ᾖ κἀγὼ ἐν αὐτοῖς.

*English (BSB)*

**1** When Jesus had spoken these things, He lifted up His eyes to heaven and said, “Father, the hour has come. Glorify Your Son, that Your Son may glorify You. **2** For You granted Him authority over all people, so that He may give eternal life to all those You have given Him. **3** Now this is eternal life, that they may know You, the only true God, and Jesus Christ, whom You have sent. **4** I have glorified You on earth by accomplishing the work You gave Me to do. **5** And now, Father, glorify Me in Your presence with the glory I had with You before the world existed. **6** I have revealed Your name to those You have given Me out of the world. They were Yours; You gave them to Me, and they have kept Your word. **7** Now they know that everything You have given Me comes from You. **8** For I have given them the words You gave Me, and they have received them. They knew with certainty that I came from You, and they believed that You sent Me. **9** I ask on their behalf. I do not ask on behalf of the world, but on behalf of those You have given Me; for they are Yours. **10** All I have is Yours, and all You have is Mine; and in them I have been glorified. **11** I will no longer be in the world, but they are in the world, and I am coming to You. Holy Father, protect them by Your name, the name You gave Me, so that they may be one as We are one. **12** While I was with them, I protected and preserved them by Your name, the name You gave Me. Not one of them has been lost, except the son of destruction, so that the Scripture would be fulfilled. **13** But now I am coming to You; and I am saying these things while I am in the world, so that they may have My joy fulfilled within them. **14** I have given them Your word and the world has hated them; for they are not of the world, just as I am not of the world. **15** I am not asking that You take them out of the world, but that You keep them from the evil one. **16** They are not of the world, just as I am not of the world. **17** Sanctify them by the truth; Your word is truth. **18** As You sent Me into the world, I have also sent them into the world. **19** For them I sanctify Myself, so that they too may be sanctified by the truth. **20** I am not asking on behalf of them alone, but also on behalf of those who will believe in Me through their message, **21** that all of them may be one, as You, Father, are in Me, and I am in You. May they also be in Us, so that the world may believe that You sent Me. **22** I have given them the glory You gave Me, so that they may be one as We are one— **23** I in them and You in Me—that they may be perfectly united, so that the world may know that You sent Me

and have loved them just as You have loved Me. **24** Father, I want those You have given Me to be with Me where I am, that they may see the glory You gave Me because You loved Me before the foundation of the world. **25** Righteous Father, although the world has not known You, I know You, and they know that You sent Me. **26** And I have made Your name known to them and will continue to make it known, so that the love You have for Me may be in them, and I in them."

*English (WEB)*

**1** Jesus said these things, then lifting up his eyes to heaven, he said, "Father, the time has come. Glorify your Son, that your Son may also glorify you; **2** even as you gave him authority over all flesh, so he will give eternal life to all whom you have given him. **3** This is eternal life, that they should know you, the only true God, and him whom you sent, Jesus Christ. **4** I glorified you on the earth. I have accomplished the work which you have given me to do. **5** Now, Father, glorify me with your own self with the glory which I had with you before the world existed. **6** "I revealed your name to the people whom you have given me out of the world. They were yours, and you have given them to me. They have kept your word. **7** Now they have known that all things whatever you have given me are from you, **8** for the words which you have given me I have given to them; and they received them, and knew for sure that I came from you. They have believed that you sent me. **9** I pray for them. I don't pray for the world, but for those whom you have given me, for they are yours. **10** All things that are mine are yours, and yours are mine, and I am glorified in them. **11** I am no more in the world, but these are in the world, and I am coming to you. Holy Father, keep them through your name which you have given me, that they may be one, even as we are. **12** While I was with them in the world, I kept them in your name. I have kept those whom you have given me. None of them is lost except the son of destruction, that the Scripture might be fulfilled. **13** But now I come to you, and I say these things in the world, that they may have my joy made full in themselves. **14** I have given them your word. The world hated them because they are not of the world, even as I am not of the world. **15** I pray not that you would take them from the world, but that you would keep them from the evil one. **16** They are not of the world, even as I am not of the world. **17** Sanctify them in your truth. Your word is truth. **18** As you sent me into the world, even so I have sent them into the world. **19** For their sakes I sanctify myself, that they themselves also may be sanctified in truth. **20** "Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who will believe in me through their word, **21** that they may all be one; even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me. **22** The glory which you have given me, I have given to them, that they may be one, even as we are one, **23** I in them, and you in me, that they may be perfected into one, that the world may know that you sent me and loved them, even as you loved me. **24** Father, I desire

that they also whom you have given me be with me where I am, that they may see my glory which you have given me, for you loved me before the foundation of the world. **25** Righteous Father, the world hasn't known you, but I knew you; and these knew that you sent me. **26** I made known to them your name, and will make it known; that the love with which you loved me may be in them, and I in them."

### Acts 15:13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** μετὰ δὲ τὸ σιγῆσαι αὐτοὺς ἀπεκρίθη Ἰάκωβος λέγων· Ἄνδρες ἀδελφοί, ἀκούσατέ μου.

*English (BSB)*

**13** When they had finished speaking, James declared, "Brothers, listen to me!

*English (WEB)*

**13** After they were silent, James answered, "Brothers, listen to me.

### Romans 1:1, 6–7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Παῦλος δοῦλος Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ, κλητὸς ἀπόστολος, ἀφωρισμένος εἰς εὐαγγέλιον θεοῦ … **6** ἐν οἷς ἐστε καὶ ὑμεῖς κλητοὶ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, **7** πᾶσιν τοῖς οὖσιν ἐν Ῥώμῃ ἀγαπητοῖς θεοῦ, κλητοῖς ἁγίοις· χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη ἀπὸ θεοῦ πατρὸς ἡμῶν καὶ κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Paul, a servant of Christ Jesus, called to be an apostle, and set apart for the gospel of God— … **6** And you also are among those who are called to belong to Jesus Christ. **7** To all in Rome who are loved by God and called to be saints: Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Paul, a servant of Jesus Christ, called to be an apostle, set apart for the Good News of God, … **6** among whom you are also called to belong to Jesus Christ; **7** to all who are in Rome, beloved of God, called to be saints: Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

### Romans 8

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Οὐδὲν ἄρα νῦν κατάκριμα τοῖς ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ· **2** ὁ γὰρ νόμος τοῦ πνεύματος τῆς ζωῆς ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ ἠλευθέρωσέν σε ἀπὸ τοῦ νόμου τῆς ἁμαρτίας καὶ τοῦ θανάτου. **3** τὸ γὰρ

ἀδύνατον τοῦ νόμου, ἐν ᾧ ἠσθένει διὰ τῆς σαρκός, ὁ θεὸς τὸν ἑαυτοῦ υἱὸν πέμψας ἐν ὁμοιώματι σαρκὸς ἁμαρτίας καὶ περὶ ἁμαρτίας κατέκρινε τὴν ἁμαρτίαν ἐν τῇ σαρκί, **4** ἵνα τὸ δικαίωμα τοῦ νόμου πληρωθῇ ἐν ἡμῖν τοῖς μὴ κατὰ σάρκα περιπατοῦσιν ἀλλὰ κατὰ πνεῦμα· **5** οἱ γὰρ κατὰ σάρκα ὄντες τὰ τῆς σαρκὸς φρονοῦσιν, οἱ δὲ κατὰ πνεῦμα τὰ τοῦ πνεύματος. **6** τὸ γὰρ φρόνημα τῆς σαρκὸς θάνατος, τὸ δὲ φρόνημα τοῦ πνεύματος ζωὴ καὶ εἰρήνη· **7** διότι τὸ φρόνημα τῆς σαρκὸς ἔχθρα εἰς θεόν, τῷ γὰρ νόμῳ τοῦ θεοῦ οὐχ ὑποτάσσεται, οὐδὲ γὰρ δύναται· **8** οἱ δὲ ἐν σαρκὶ ὄντες θεῷ ἀρέσαι οὐ δύνανται. **9** Ὑμεῖς δὲ οὐκ ἐστὲ ἐν σαρκὶ ἀλλὰ ἐν πνεύματι, εἴπερ πνεῦμα θεοῦ οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν. εἰ δέ τις πνεῦμα Χριστοῦ οὐκ ἔχει, οὗτος οὐκ ἔστιν αὐτοῦ. **10** εἰ δὲ Χριστὸς ἐν ὑμῖν, τὸ μὲν σῶμα νεκρὸν διὰ ἁμαρτίαν, τὸ δὲ πνεῦμα ζωὴ διὰ δικαιοσύνην. **11** εἰ δὲ τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ ἐγείραντος τὸν Ἰησοῦν ἐκ νεκρῶν οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν, ὁ ἐγείρας ἐκ νεκρῶν Χριστὸν Ἰησοῦν ζῳοποιήσει καὶ τὰ θνητὰ σώματα ὑμῶν διὰ τὸ ἐνοικοῦν αὐτοῦ πνεῦμα ἐν ὑμῖν. **12** Ἄρα οὖν, ἀδελφοί, ὀφειλέται ἐσμέν, οὐ τῇ σαρκὶ τοῦ κατὰ σάρκα ζῆν, **13** εἰ γὰρ κατὰ σάρκα ζῆτε μέλλετε ἀποθνήσκειν, εἰ δὲ πνεύματι τὰς πράξεις τοῦ σώματος θανατοῦτε, ζήσεσθε. **14** ὅσοι γὰρ πνεύματι θεοῦ ἄγονται, οὗτοι υἱοί εἰσιν θεοῦ. **15** οὐ γὰρ ἐλάβετε πνεῦμα δουλείας πάλιν εἰς φόβον, ἀλλὰ ἐλάβετε πνεῦμα υἱοθεσίας ἐν ᾧ κράζομεν· Αββα ὁ πατήρ· **16** αὐτὸ τὸ πνεῦμα συμμαρτυρεῖ τῷ πνεύματι ἡμῶν ὅτι ἐσμὲν τέκνα θεοῦ. **17** εἰ δὲ τέκνα, καὶ κληρονόμοι· κληρονόμοι μὲν θεοῦ, συγκληρονόμοι δὲ Χριστοῦ, εἴπερ συμπάσχομεν ἵνα καὶ συνδοξασθῶμεν. **18** Λογίζομαι γὰρ ὅτι οὐκ ἄξια τὰ παθήματα τοῦ νῦν καιροῦ πρὸς τὴν μέλλουσαν δόξαν ἀποκαλυφθῆναι εἰς ἡμᾶς. **19** ἡ γὰρ ἀποκαραδοκία τῆς κτίσεως τὴν ἀποκάλυψιν τῶν υἱῶν τοῦ θεοῦ ἀπεκδέχεται· **20** τῇ γὰρ ματαιότητι ἡ κτίσις ὑπετάγη, οὐχ ἑκοῦσα ἀλλὰ διὰ τὸν ὑποτάξαντα, ἐφ’ ἐλπίδι **21** ὅτι καὶ αὐτὴ ἡ κτίσις ἐλευθερωθήσεται ἀπὸ τῆς δουλείας τῆς φθορᾶς εἰς τὴν ἐλευθερίαν τῆς δόξης τῶν τέκνων τοῦ θεοῦ. **22** οἴδαμεν γὰρ ὅτι πᾶσα ἡ κτίσις συστενάζει καὶ συνωδίνει ἄχρι τοῦ νῦν· **23** οὐ μόνον δέ, ἀλλὰ καὶ αὐτοὶ τὴν ἀπαρχὴν τοῦ πνεύματος ἔχοντες ἡμεῖς καὶ αὐτοὶ ἐν ἑαυτοῖς στενάζομεν, υἱοθεσίαν ἀπεκδεχόμενοι τὴν ἀπολύτρωσιν τοῦ σώματος ἡμῶν. **24** τῇ γὰρ ἐλπίδι ἐσώθημεν· ἐλπὶς δὲ βλεπομένη οὐκ ἔστιν ἐλπίς, ὃ γὰρ βλέπει τίς ἐλπίζει; **25** εἰ δὲ ὃ οὐ βλέπομεν ἐλπίζομεν, δι’ ὑπομονῆς ἀπεκδεχόμεθα. **26** Ὡσαύτως δὲ καὶ τὸ πνεῦμα συναντιλαμβάνεται τῇ ἀσθενείᾳ ἡμῶν· τὸ γὰρ τί προσευξώμεθα καθὸ δεῖ οὐκ οἴδαμεν, ἀλλὰ αὐτὸ τὸ πνεῦμα ὑπερεντυγχάνει στεναγμοῖς ἀλαλήτοις, **27** ὁ δὲ ἐραυνῶν τὰς καρδίας οἶδεν τί τὸ φρόνημα τοῦ πνεύματος, ὅτι κατὰ θεὸν ἐντυγχάνει ὑπὲρ ἁγίων. **28** Οἴδαμεν δὲ ὅτι τοῖς ἀγαπῶσι τὸν θεὸν πάντα συνεργεῖ εἰς ἀγαθόν, τοῖς κατὰ πρόθεσιν κλητοῖς οὖσιν. **29** ὅτι οὓς προέγνω, καὶ προώρισεν συμμόρφους τῆς εἰκόνος τοῦ υἱοῦ αὐτοῦ, εἰς τὸ εἶναι αὐτὸν πρωτότοκον ἐν πολλοῖς ἀδελφοῖς· **30** οὓς δὲ προώρισεν, τούτους καὶ ἐκάλεσεν· καὶ οὓς ἐκάλεσεν, τούτους καὶ ἐδικαίωσεν· οὓς δὲ ἐδικαίωσεν, τούτους καὶ ἐδόξασεν. **31** Τί οὖν ἐροῦμεν πρὸς ταῦτα; εἰ ὁ θεὸς ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν, τίς καθ’ ἡμῶν; **32** ὅς γε τοῦ ἰδίου υἱοῦ οὐκ ἐφείσατο, ἀλλὰ ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν πάντων παρέδωκεν αὐτόν, πῶς οὐχὶ καὶ σὺν αὐτῷ τὰ πάντα ἡμῖν χαρίσεται; **33** τίς ἐγκαλέσει κατὰ ἐκλεκτῶν θεοῦ; θεὸς ὁ δικαιῶν· **34** τίς ὁ κατακρινῶν; Χριστὸς ὁ ἀποθανών, μᾶλλον δὲ ἐγερθείς, ὅς καί ἐστιν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ θεοῦ, ὃς καὶ ἐντυγχάνει ὑπὲρ ἡμῶν· **35** τίς ἡμᾶς χωρίσει ἀπὸ τῆς ἀγάπης τοῦ Χριστοῦ; θλῖψις ἢ στενοχωρία ἢ διωγμὸς ἢ λιμὸς ἢ γυμνότης ἢ κίνδυνος ἢ μάχαιρα; **36** καθὼς γέγραπται ὅτι Ἕνεκεν σοῦ θανατούμεθα ὅλην τὴν ἡμέραν, ἐλογίσθημεν ὡς πρόβατα σφαγῆς. **37** ἀλλ’ ἐν τούτοις πᾶσιν ὑπερνικῶμεν διὰ τοῦ ἀγαπήσαντος ἡμᾶς. **38** πέπεισμαι γὰρ ὅτι οὔτε θάνατος οὔτε ζωὴ οὔτε ἄγγελοι οὔτε ἀρχαὶ οὔτε ἐνεστῶτα οὔτε μέλλοντα οὔτε δυνάμεις **39** οὔτε ὕψωμα οὔτε βάθος οὔτε τις κτίσις ἑτέρα δυνήσεται ἡμᾶς χωρίσαι ἀπὸ τῆς ἀγάπης τοῦ θεοῦ τῆς ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ τῷ κυρίῳ ἡμῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus. **2** For in Christ Jesus the law of the Spirit of life set you free from the law of sin and death. **3** For what the law was powerless to do in that it was weakened by the flesh, God did by sending His own Son in the likeness of sinful man, as an offering for sin. He thus condemned sin in the flesh, **4** so that the righteous standard of the law might be fulfilled in us, who do not walk according to the flesh but according to the Spirit. **5** Those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh; but those who live according to the Spirit set their minds on the things of the Spirit. **6** The mind of the flesh is death, but the mind of the Spirit is life and peace, **7** because the mind of the flesh is hostile to God: It does not submit to God's law, nor can it do so. **8** Those controlled by the flesh cannot please God. **9** You, however, are controlled not by the flesh, but by the Spirit, if the Spirit of God lives in you. And if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to Christ. **10** But if Christ is in you, your body is dead because of sin, yet your spirit is alive because of righteousness. **11** And if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead is living in you, He who raised Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through His Spirit, who lives in you. **12** Therefore, brothers, we have an obligation, but it is not to the flesh, to live according to it. **13** For if you live according to the flesh, you will die; but if by the Spirit you put to death the deeds of the body, you will live. **14** For all who are led by the Spirit of God are sons of God. **15** For you did not receive a spirit of slavery that returns you to fear, but you received the Spirit of sonship, by whom we cry, "Abba! Father!" **16** The Spirit Himself testifies with our spirit that we are God's children. **17** And if we are children, then we are heirs: heirs of God and co-heirs with Christ—if indeed we suffer with Him, so that we may also be glorified with Him. **18** I consider that our present sufferings are not comparable to the glory that will be revealed in us. **19** The creation waits in eager expectation for the revelation of the sons of God. **20** For the creation was subjected to futility, not by its own will, but because of the One who subjected it, in hope **21** that the creation itself will be set free from its bondage to decay and brought into the glorious freedom of the children of God. **22** We know that the whole creation has been groaning together in the pains of childbirth until the present time. **23** Not only that, but we ourselves, who have the firstfruits of the Spirit, groan inwardly as we wait eagerly for our adoption as sons, the redemption of our bodies. **24** For in this hope we were saved; but hope that is seen is no hope at all. Who hopes for what he can already see? **25** But if we hope for what we do not yet see, we wait for it patiently. **26** In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words. **27** And He who searches our hearts knows the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints according to the will of God. **28** And we know that God works all things together for the good of

those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose. **29** For those God foreknew, He also predestined to be conformed to the image of His Son, so that He would be the firstborn among many brothers. **30** And those He predestined, He also called; those He called, He also justified; those He justified, He also glorified. **31** What then shall we say in response to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? **32** He who did not spare His own Son but gave Him up for us all, how will He not also, along with Him, freely give us all things? **33** Who will bring any charge against God's elect? It is God who justifies. **34** Who is there to condemn us? For Christ Jesus, who died, and more than that was raised to life, is at the right hand of God—and He is interceding for us. **35** Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Shall trouble or distress or persecution or famine or nakedness or danger or sword? **36** As it is written: "For Your sake we face death all day long; we are considered as sheep to be slaughtered." **37** No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us. **38** For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, **39** neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

*English (WEB)*

**1** There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus, who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit. **2** For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus made me free from the law of sin and of death. **3** For what the law couldn't do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God did, sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin, he condemned sin in the flesh, **4** that the ordinance of the law might be fulfilled in us who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit. **5** For those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh, but those who live according to the Spirit, the things of the Spirit. **6** For the mind of the flesh is death, but the mind of the Spirit is life and peace; **7** because the mind of the flesh is hostile toward God, for it is not subject to God's law, neither indeed can it be. **8** Those who are in the flesh can't please God. **9** But you are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if it is so that the Spirit of God dwells in you. But if any man doesn't have the Spirit of Christ, he is not his. **10** If Christ is in you, the body is dead because of sin, but the spirit is alive because of righteousness. **11** But if the Spirit of him who raised up Jesus from the dead dwells in you, he who raised up Christ Jesus from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies through his Spirit who dwells in you. **12** So then, brothers, we are debtors, not to the flesh, to live after the flesh. **13** For if you live after the flesh, you must die; but if by the Spirit you put to death the deeds of the body, you will live. **14** For as many as are led by the Spirit of God, these are children of God. **15** For you didn't receive the spirit of bondage again to fear, but you received the Spirit of adoption, by whom we cry, "Abba!

Father!” **16** The Spirit himself testifies with our spirit that we are children of God; **17** and if children, then heirs—heirs of God and joint heirs with Christ, if indeed we suffer with him, that we may also be glorified with him. **18** For I consider that the sufferings of this present time are not worthy to be compared with the glory which will be revealed toward us. **19** For the creation waits with eager expectation for the children of God to be revealed. **20** For the creation was subjected to vanity, not of its own will, but because of him who subjected it, in hope **21** that the creation itself also will be delivered from the bondage of decay into the liberty of the glory of the children of God. **22** For we know that the whole creation groans and travails in pain together until now. **23** Not only so, but ourselves also, who have the first fruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting for adoption, the redemption of our body. **24** For we were saved in hope, but hope that is seen is not hope. For who hopes for that which he sees? **25** But if we hope for that which we don’t see, we wait for it with patience. **26** In the same way, the Spirit also helps our weaknesses, for we don’t know how to pray as we ought. But the Spirit himself makes intercession for us with groanings which can’t be uttered. **27** He who searches the hearts knows what is on the Spirit’s mind, because he makes intercession for the saints according to God. **28** We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, for those who are called according to his purpose. **29** For whom he foreknew, he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, that he might be the firstborn among many brothers. **30** Whom he predestined, those he also called. Whom he called, those he also justified. Whom he justified, those he also glorified. **31** What then shall we say about these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? **32** He who didn’t spare his own Son, but delivered him up for us all, how would he not also with him freely give us all things? **33** Who could bring a charge against God’s chosen ones? It is God who justifies. **34** Who is he who condemns? It is Christ who died, yes rather, who was raised from the dead, who is at the right hand of God, who also makes intercession for us. **35** Who shall separate us from the love of Christ? Could oppression, or anguish, or persecution, or famine, or nakedness, or peril, or sword? **36** Even as it is written, “For your sake we are killed all day long. We were accounted as sheep for the slaughter.” **37** No, in all these things we are more than conquerors through him who loved us. **38** For I am persuaded that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor things present, nor things to come, nor powers, **39** nor height, nor depth, nor any other created thing will be able to separate us from God’s love which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

## 1 Corinthians 1:2, 24

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ τοῦ θεοῦ, ἡγιασμένοις ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ, τῇ οὔσῃ ἐν Κορίνθῳ, κλητοῖς ἁγίοις, σὺν πᾶσιν τοῖς ἐπικαλουμένοις τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐν παντὶ τόπῳ αὐτῶν

καὶ ἡμῶν· … **24** αὐτοῖς δὲ τοῖς κλητοῖς, Ἰουδαίοις τε καὶ Ἕλλησιν, Χριστὸν θεοῦ δύναμιν καὶ θεοῦ σοφίαν.

*English (BSB)*

**2** To the church of God in Corinth, to those sanctified in Christ Jesus and called to be holy, together with all those everywhere who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, their Lord and ours: … **24** but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the power of God and the wisdom of God.

*English (WEB)*

**2** to the assembly of God which is at Corinth—those who are sanctified in Christ Jesus, called saints, with all who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ in every place, both theirs and ours: … **24** but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ is the power of God and the wisdom of God;

## 1 Corinthians 9:5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** μὴ οὐκ ἔχομεν ἐξουσίαν ἀδελφὴν γυναῖκα περιάγειν, ὡς καὶ οἱ λοιποὶ ἀπόστολοι καὶ οἱ ἀδελφοὶ τοῦ κυρίου καὶ Κηφᾶς;

*English (BSB)*

**5** Have we no right to take along a believing wife, as do the other apostles and the Lord’s brothers and Cephas?

*English (WEB)*

**5** Have we no right to take along a wife who is a believer, even as the rest of the apostles, and the brothers of the Lord, and Cephas?

## Galatians 1:19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** ἕτερον δὲ τῶν ἀποστόλων οὐκ εἶδον, εἰ μὴ Ἰάκωβον τὸν ἀδελφὸν τοῦ κυρίου.

*English (BSB)*

**19** But I saw none of the other apostles except James, the Lord’s brother.

*English (WEB)*

**19** But of the other apostles I saw no one except James, the Lord’s brother.

## Galatians 2:9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**9** καὶ γνόντες τὴν χάριν τὴν δοθεῖσάν μοι, Ἰάκωβος καὶ Κηφᾶς καὶ Ἰωάννης, οἱ δοκοῦντες στῦλοι εἶναι, δεξιὰς ἔδωκαν ἐμοὶ καὶ Βαρναβᾷ κοινωνίας, ἵνα ἡμεῖς εἰς τὰ ἔθνη, αὐτοὶ δὲ εἰς τὴν περιτομήν·

*English (BSB)*

**9** And recognizing the grace that I had been given, James, Cephas, and John—those reputed to be pillars—gave me and Barnabas the right hand of fellowship, so that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the circumcised.

*English (WEB)*

**9** and when they perceived the grace that was given to me, James and Cephas and John, those who were reputed to be pillars, gave to Barnabas and me the right hand of fellowship, that we should go to the Gentiles, and they to the circumcision.

## Galatians 6:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** καὶ ὅσοι τῷ κανόνι τούτῳ στοιχήσουσιν, εἰρήνη ἐπ᾽ αὐτοὺς καὶ ἔλεος, καὶ ἐπὶ τὸν Ἰσραὴλ τοῦ θεοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**16** Peace and mercy to all who walk by this rule, even to the Israel of God.

*English (WEB)*

**16** As many as walk by this rule, peace and mercy be on them, and on God’s Israel.

## Philippians 2:7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** ἀλλὰ ἑαυτὸν ἐκένωσεν μορφὴν δούλου λαβών, ἐν ὁμοιώματι ἀνθρώπων γενόμενος· καὶ σχήματι εὑρεθεὶς ὡς ἄνθρωπος

*English (BSB)*

**7** but emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in human likeness.

*English (WEB)*

**7** but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men.

## 1 Thessalonians 5:23

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**23** Αὐτὸς δὲ ὁ θεὸς τῆς εἰρήνης ἁγιάσαι ὑμᾶς ὁλοτελεῖς, καὶ ὁλόκληρον ὑμῶν τὸ πνεῦμα καὶ ἡ ψυχὴ καὶ τὸ σῶμα ἀμέμπτως ἐν τῇ παρουσίᾳ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τηρηθείη.

*English (BSB)*

**23** Now may the God of peace Himself sanctify you completely, and may your entire spirit, soul, and body be kept blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.

*English (WEB)*

**23** May the God of peace himself sanctify you completely. May your whole spirit, soul, and body be preserved blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.

## 2 Thessalonians 2:13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** Ἡμεῖς δὲ ὀφείλομεν εὐχαριστεῖν τῷ θεῷ πάντοτε περὶ ὑμῶν, ἀδελφοὶ ἠγαπημένοι ὑπὸ κυρίου, ὅτι εἵλατο ὑμᾶς ὁ θεὸς ἀπαρχὴν εἰς σωτηρίαν ἐν ἁγιασμῷ πνεύματος καὶ πίστει ἀληθείας,

*English (BSB)*

**13** But we should always thank God for you, brothers who are loved by the Lord, because God has chosen you from the beginning to be saved by the sanctification of the Spirit and by faith in the truth.

*English (WEB)*

**13** But we are bound to always give thanks to God for you, brothers loved by the Lord, because God chose you from the beginning for salvation through sanctification of the Spirit and belief in the truth,

## 1 Timothy 1:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** Τιμοθέῳ γνησίῳ τέκνῳ ἐν πίστει· χάρις, ἔλεος, εἰρήνη ἀπὸ θεοῦ πατρὸς καὶ Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**2** To Timothy, my true child in the faith: Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

*English (WEB)*

**2** to Timothy, my true child in faith: Grace, mercy, and peace from God our Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

## 2 Timothy 1:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** Τιμοθέῳ ἀγαπητῷ τέκνῳ· χάρις, ἔλεος, εἰρήνη ἀπὸ θεοῦ πατρὸς καὶ Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**2** To Timothy, my beloved child: Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

*English (WEB)*

**2** to Timothy, my beloved child: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

## 2 Timothy 4:10

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** Δημᾶς γάρ με ἐγκατέλιπεν ἀγαπήσας τὸν νῦν αἰῶνα, καὶ ἐπορεύθη εἰς Θεσσαλονίκην, Κρήσκης εἰς Γαλατίαν, Τίτος εἰς Δαλματίαν·

*English (BSB)*

**10** because Demas, in his love of this world, has deserted me and gone to Thessalonica. Crescens has gone to Galatia, and Titus to Dalmatia.

*English (WEB)*

**10** for Demas left me, having loved this present world, and went to Thessalonica; Crescens to Galatia; and Titus to Dalmatia.

## James 1:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἰάκωβος θεοῦ καὶ κυρίου Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ δοῦλος ταῖς δώδεκα φυλαῖς ταῖς ἐν τῇ διασπορᾷ χαίρειν.

*English (BSB)*

**1** James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, To the twelve tribes of the Dispersion: Greetings.

*English (WEB)*

**1** James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes which are in the Dispersion: Greetings.

## 1 Peter 1:2, 4–5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** κατὰ πρόγνωσιν θεοῦ πατρός, ἐν ἁγιασμῷ πνεύματος, εἰς ὑπακοὴν καὶ ῥαντισμὸν αἵματος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ· χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη. … **4** εἰς κληρονομίαν ἄφθαρτον καὶ ἀμίαντον καὶ ἀμάραντον, τετηρημένην ἐν οὐρανοῖς εἰς ὑμᾶς **5** τοὺς ἐν δυνάμει θεοῦ φρουρουμένους διὰ πίστεως εἰς σωτηρίαν ἑτοίμην ἀποκαλυφθῆναι ἐν καιρῷ ἐσχάτῳ.

*English (BSB)*

**2** according to the foreknowledge of God the Father and sanctified by the Spirit for obedience to Jesus Christ and sprinkling by His blood: Grace and peace be yours in abundance. … **4** and into an inheritance that is imperishable, undefiled, and unfading, reserved in heaven for you, **5** who through faith are shielded by God’s power for the salvation that is ready to be revealed in the last time.

*English (WEB)*

**2** according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, in sanctification of the Spirit, that you may obey Jesus Christ and be sprinkled with his blood: Grace to you and peace be multiplied. … **4** to an incorruptible and undefiled inheritance that doesn’t fade away, reserved in Heaven for you, **5** who by the power of God are guarded through faith for a salvation ready to be revealed in the last time.

## 2 Peter 1:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**2** Grace and peace be multiplied to you through the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord.

*English (WEB)*

**2** Grace to you and peace be multiplied in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord,

## 2 John 3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** ἔσται μεθ᾽ ἡμῶν χάρις ἔλεος εἰρήνη παρὰ θεοῦ πατρός, καὶ παρὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ υἱοῦ τοῦ πατρός, ἐν ἀληθείᾳ καὶ ἀγάπῃ.

*English (BSB)*

**3** Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and from Jesus Christ, the Son of the Father, will be with us in truth and love.

*English (WEB)*

**3** Grace, mercy, and peace will be with us, from God the Father and from the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of the Father, in truth and love.

## Revelation 3:10

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** ὅτι ἐτήρησας τὸν λόγον τῆς ὑπομονῆς μου, κἀγώ σε τηρήσω ἐκ τῆς ὥρας τοῦ πειρασμοῦ τῆς μελλούσης ἔρχεσθαι ἐπὶ τῆς οἰκουμένης ὅλης, πειράσαι τοὺς κατοικοῦντας ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς.

*English (BSB)*

**10** Because you have kept My command to persevere, I will also keep you from the hour of testing that is about to come upon the whole world, to test those who dwell on the earth.

*English (WEB)*

**10** Because you kept my command to endure, I also will keep you from the hour of testing which is to come on the whole world, to test those who dwell on the earth.

## Revelation 17:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** οὗτοι μετὰ τοῦ ἀρνίου πολεμήσουσιν, καὶ τὸ ἀρνίον νικήσει αὐτούς, ὅτι κύριος κυρίων ἐστὶν καὶ βασιλεὺς βασιλέων, καὶ οἱ μετ᾽ αὐτοῦ κλητοὶ καὶ ἐκλεκτοὶ καὶ πιστοί.

*English (BSB)*

**14** They will make war against the Lamb, and the Lamb will triumph over them, because He is Lord of lords and King of kings; and He will be

accompanied by His called and chosen and faithful ones.”

*English (WEB)*

**14** These will war against the Lamb, and the Lamb will overcome them, for he is Lord of lords and King of kings; and those who are with him are called, chosen, and faithful.”

# Chapter 2. The Faith Entrusted Once for All (Jude 3–4)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **3** Ἀγαπητοί, πᾶσαν σπουδὴν ποιούμενος γράφειν ὑμῖν περὶ τῆς κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας ἀνάγκην ἔσχον γράψαι ὑμῖν παρακαλῶν ἐπαγωνίζεσθαι τῇ ἅπαξ παραδοθείσῃ τοῖς ἁγίοις πίστει. **4** παρεισέδυσαν γάρ τινες ἄνθρωποι, οἱ πάλαι προγεγραμμένοι εἰς τοῦτο τὸ κρίμα, ἀσεβεῖς, τὴν τοῦ θεοῦ ἡμῶν χάριτα μετατιθέντες εἰς ἀσέλγειαν καὶ τὸν μόνον δεσπότην καὶ κύριον ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν ἀρνούμενοι.
>
> — Jude 3–4, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript’s first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας | ‘our common salvation’ | P72 A B C 1739 |
| 3 | κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας καὶ ζωῆς | ‘our common salvation and life’ | א Ψ |
| 3 | κοινῆς σωτηρίας | ‘common salvation’ | K L |
| 4 | δεσπότην (καὶ) κύριον | ‘Master and Lord’ | P72 P78 א A B C 1739 |
| 4 | δεσπότην θεὸν καὶ κύριον | ‘Master, God, and Lord’ | Ψ K L |

Notes. v. 3: not extant in P78. v. 4: only partly extant in P78.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

#### Jude 3

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Beloved when I gave all diligence to write vnto you of the commen saluacion: it was nedfull for me to wryte vnto you to exhorte you that ye shuld continually laboure in the fayth which was once geve vnto the sayntes |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | Beloued, when I gaue al diligece to write vnto you of the common saluation, it was needful for me to write vnto you to exhort you, that yee should earnestly contend for the maintenace of ye faith, which was once giuen vnto the Saintes. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Dearly beloved, taking all care to write unto you concerning your common salvation, I was under a necessity to write unto you: to beseech you to contend earnestly for the faith once delivered to the saints. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Beloved, when I gave all diligence to write to you concerning the common salvation, it was needful for me to write to you, and exhort you that ye should earnestly contend for the faith, which was once delivered to the saints. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | Beloved, while giving all diligence to write to you, I found it necessary to write to you concerning the common salvation, exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once delivered to the saints. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Beloved, while I was giving all diligence to write unto you of our common salvation, I was constrained to write unto you exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered unto the saints. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | Beloved, using all diligence to write to you of our common salvation, I have been obliged to write to you exhorting [you] to contend earnestly for the faith once delivered to the saints. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | Beloved, all diligence using to write to you concerning the common salvation, I had necessity to write to you, exhorting to agonize for the faith once delivered to the saints, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Beloved, while I was giving all diligence to write unto you of our common salvation, I was constrained to write unto you exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered unto the saints. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Beloved, while I was very eager to write to you about our common salvation, I was constrained to write to you exhorting you to contend earnestly for the faith which was once for all delivered to the saints. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | You whom I love, I ◄was very eager/very much wanted► to write to you about that which we all ◄share/have in common►, which is how ◄God/Jesus Christ► has saved us. But now I realize that it is necessary for me to write to you in order to exhort you to defend the truth about Christ that we believe. Jesus and his apostles gave that truth once and for all to us who belong to God, and we must not let it be changed {anyone revise/change it}. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | Dear friends, while I was making every effort to write to you about our common salvation, I felt that I must write to you at once to encourage you to fight in defense of the faith that has once for all been entrusted to the keeping of Christ's people. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Beloved, while I was making every effort to write to you about our common salvation, I had to write to you to exhort you to struggle earnestly for the faith that was entrusted once for all to the holy people. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | My friends, I was already looking forward to writing to you about the salvation that we share. But now I need to write urgently to you and encourage you to vigorously defend the truth about God, given once and for all time to God's holy people. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | Beloved, using all diligence to write to you concerning our common salvation, I had necessity to write to you, exhorting [you] to fight for the faith once delivered to the holy ones, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Beloved, although I made every effort to write to you about the salvation we share, I felt it necessary to write and urge you to contend earnestly for the faith entrusted once for all to the saints. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Beloved, although I made every effort to write to you about the salvation we share, I felt it necessary to write and urge you to contend earnestly for the faith entrusted once for all to the saints. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Beloved, although I was quite eager to write to you about our common salvation, I found it necessary to write to you and urge you to contend for the faith that was once for all delivered to the saints. |

### Jude 4

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | For ther are certayne craftely crept in of which it was write afore tyme vnto soche iudgement. They are vngodly and turne the grace of oure God vnto wantannes and denye God the only Lorde and oure Lorde Iesus Christ. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | For there are certaine men crept in, which were before of olde ordeined to this condemnation: vngodly men they are which turne the grace of our God into wantonnesse, and denie God the onely Lord, and our Lord Iesus Christ. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | For certain men are secretly entered in, (who were written of long ago unto this judgment,) ungodly men, turning the grace of our Lord God into riotousness, and denying the only sovereign Ruler, and our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | For certain men have crept in unawares, who were before of old ordained to this condemnation, ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into lasciviousness, and |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | denying the only Lord God, and our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | For there have stealthily crept in certain men who were of old appointed beforehand for this condemnation, ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into wantonness, and denying the only Sovereign, and our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | For there are certain men crept in privily, even they who were of old set forth unto this condemnation, ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into lasciviousness, and denying our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | For certain men have got in unnoticed, they who of old were marked out beforehand to this sentence, ungodly [persons], turning the grace of our God into dissoluteness, and denying our only Master and Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | for there did come in unobserved certain men, long ago having been written beforehand to this judgment, impious, the grace of our God perverting to lasciviousness, and our only Master, God, and Lord — Jesus Christ — denying, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | For there are certain men crept in privily, even they who were of old written of beforehand unto this condemnation, ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into lasciviousness, and denying our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | For there are certain men who crept in secretly, even those who were long ago written about for this condemnation: ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into indecency, and denying our only Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Some people falsely teach that because God kindly does for us what we do not deserve, it ◄does not matter/is all right► if we continue to sin. Those people show by the way that they conduct their lives that they do not want to admit/accept that Jesus Christ is our only Master and Lord. It was written long ago {Someone long ago wrote} that God would condemn ◄such ungodly people/people like that whose lives are |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | displeasing to him►. But some of those people have entered [MET] like crawling snakes into your congregations and oppose the truth about Christ, so you must resist/oppose them. Jude 5-8 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | For there have crept in among you certain godless people, whose sentence has long since been pronounced, and who make the mercy of God an excuse for profligacy, and disown our only lord and master, Jesus Christ. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | For certain men have slipped in secretly among you. These are men who were marked out for condemnation. They are ungodly men who have changed the grace of our God into sensuality, and who deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | For some people have quietly crept in among you. They were written about and condemned a long time ago, for they are wicked people who pervert God's grace, turning it into a license to immorality, while also denying our Lord and master Jesus Christ. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | for there came in certain men stealthily, having been written beforehand to this judgment long ago, impious, perverting the grace of our God to licentiousness, and denying our only Master and Lord—Jesus Christ. |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | For certain men have crept in among you unnoticed—ungodly ones who were designated long ago for condemnation. They turn the grace of our God into a license for immorality, and they deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | For certain men have crept in among you unnoticed—ungodly ones who were designated long ago for condemnation. They turn the grace of our God into a license for immorality, and they deny God our only Master and the Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | For certain men whose condemnation was written about long ago have crept in unnoticed. They are ungodly men who pervert the grace of our God, turning it into a license for sensuality. By doing so, they |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | deny God, who is our only Master, and also the Lord Jesus Christ. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

These two verses give the reason for the letter. Jude had been eager to write to his friends about the salvation they shared. Something forced a change of plan. People had slipped into the community unnoticed, people whose judgment was already on record. They were taking God's grace as permission for immoral living, and in doing so they were denying Jesus Christ, the only Master and Lord. So Jude writes urgently instead, appealing to his readers to contend for the faith that had been handed over to God's people once for all.

Verse 3 states the **purpose** of the letter: an appeal to contend for the faith. Verse 4 states the **occasion**, the intruders. Everything that follows explains and supports these two verses. Verses 5–19 show why the intruders deserve the judgment already "written beforehand," and verses 20–23 show what contending for the faith actually looks like.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### Ἀγαπητοί (*Agapētoi*) — 'beloved'

The address ἀγαπητοί (*agapētoi*) echoes "having been loved" in v. 1 and the wish for "love" in v. 2. It is affectionate, and it is also strategic: Jude uses it three times (vv. 3, 17, 20), each at a point where he turns directly to the readers. Before he tells them about the intruders, he reminds them where they stand. They are beloved by God and by him.

### πᾶσαν σπουδὴν ποιούμενος γράφειν ὑμῖν περὶ τῆς κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας (*pasan spoudēn poioumenos graphein hymin peri tēs koinēs hēmōn sōtērias*) — 'making every effort to write to you about our common salvation'

The Greek phrase πᾶσαν σπουδὴν ποιούμενος (*pasan spoudēn poioumenos*) means "making every effort" or "being very eager." The word σπουδή (*spoudē*) means haste, diligence, or earnestness. Jude had been fully intent on writing a letter of a different kind, and perhaps had already begun one.

Its subject was to be "our common salvation" (περὶ τῆς κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας). The adjective κοινός (*koinos*) means "shared, held in common." It is the word Luke uses of the first believers who "had all things common" (Acts 2:44, LSV), and Paul calls Titus his "true child according to a common faith"

(Titus 1:4, LSV). It does not mean “ordinary.” The salvation Jude wanted to celebrate belongs equally to him and his readers, and perhaps to Jewish and Gentile believers alike. It is the common possession of the whole people of God.

We do not know what that other letter would have contained, or whether Jude ever wrote it. Some readers wish he had. Yet the letter we have is not a departure from the subject of “our common salvation.” It is a defense of it. The salvation he wanted to celebrate is the very thing the intruders threaten.

### ἀνάγκην ἔσχον γράψαι ὑμῖν (*anankēn eschon grapsai hymin*) — ‘I found it necessary to write to you’

The change of plan is expressed with strong language: ἀνάγκην ἔσχον (*anankēn eschon*), “I had necessity,” or “I found it necessary,” “I felt compelled.” Paul uses the same noun when he says that “necessity is laid on me” to proclaim the good news (1 Cor 9:16, LSV). Something had happened that left Jude no choice.

There is also a quiet shift in the verb. The first “to write” (γράφειν, *graphein*) is in the present tense, describing the ongoing project he had in mind. The second (γράψαι, *grapsai*) is aorist, describing this particular letter as a single urgent act. The grammar fits the story: a long-planned general letter, interrupted by an immediate and specific one.

### παρακαλῶν (*parakalōn*) — ‘urging you’

The participle παρακαλῶν (*parakalōn*) means “urging, appealing, exhorting.” It is a warm and pastoral word, from the same family as παράκλητος (*paraklētos*), the title of the Holy Spirit that the LSV renders “Comforter” (John 14:16), and that other versions render ‘Helper’ or ‘Advocate’. Jude does not command his readers like a superior issuing orders. He appeals to them as a brother. The LSV supplies “[you]” because the Greek leaves the object to be understood.

### ἐπαγωνίζεσθαι τῇ … πίστει (*epagōnizesthai tē … pistei*) — ‘to contend for the faith’

Here is the heart of the appeal. The verb ἐπαγωνίζεσθαι (*epagōnizesthai*) occurs nowhere else in the New Testament. It belongs to the family of ἀγών (*agōn*), the word for an athletic contest or struggle, from which English gets “agony.” Paul uses related words for the Christian life: “I have striven the good strife” (2 Tim 4:7, LSV); “Be striving the good strife of the faith” (1 Tim 6:12, LSV). The prefix ἐπ- (*ep-*) may add a sense of “for” or “on behalf of,” and the dative case of “the faith” means “contend *for* the faith.” The faith is what the contest defends, not the weapon used in it.

The LSV's "fight" is vigorous and literal. Other translations have "contend earnestly" (WEB, ASV, BSB) or "earnestly contend" (WBS). The image is of exertion, of a struggle that costs effort. It is not an image of violence. The rest of the letter will show what this struggle involves. The intruders are not to be attacked; they are to be recognized for what they are and resisted. The readers' main task, spelled out in vv. 20–23, is to build themselves up in the faith, to pray, to keep themselves in God's love, and to show mercy to those who waver. Jude's contending is defined by his closing instructions, not by the heat of his warnings.

### τῇ ἅπαξ παραδοθείσῃ τοῖς ἁγίοις (*tē hapax paradotheisē tois hagiois*) — 'handed down once for all to the saints'

Three words in this phrase carry great weight.

**"Once"** translates ἅπαξ (*hapax*), "once, once for all." The same word describes Christ's sacrifice: "now He has been revealed once, at the full end of the ages, for [the] annulling of sin through His sacrifice" (Heb 9:26, LSV); "Christ suffered once for sin—righteous for unrighteous—that He might lead us to God" (1 Pet 3:18, LSV). The faith was handed over on a particular occasion, completely. It does not need supplementing by later revelations, and that is exactly the claim the intruders, with their 'dreams' (v. 8), appear to have made.

**"Delivered"** translates παραδοθείσῃ (*paradotheisē*), from παραδίδωμι (*paradidōmi*), "to hand over, pass on." This is the technical language of tradition. Paul uses it for the most important things he taught: "For I delivered to you as most important what I also received: that Christ died for our sins according to the Writings" (1 Cor 15:3, LSV), and "For I received from the LORD that which I also delivered to you, that the Lord Jesus in the night in which He was delivered up, took bread" (1 Cor 11:23, LSV). Jewish teachers used the same pair of ideas, receiving and handing on, for the transmission of sacred teaching. The Mishnah, compiled around AD 200, opens its tractate *Avot* with a chain of tradition from Moses through Joshua and the elders. Christianity understood itself from the beginning as a message received and passed on through faithful witnesses.

The aorist passive participle presents the delivering as a completed act, with God as the implied giver. The faith did not originate with the church; it was given to the church.

**"The holy ones"** translates τοῖς ἁγίοις (*tois hagiois*), "the saints." The LSV's "holy ones" helps modern readers avoid thinking of a special class of exceptionally virtuous Christians. In the Bible "the holy ones" are God's people as a whole, set apart for him. Daniel foresees that "the saints of the Most High receive the kingdom" (Dan 7:18, LSV), where the Aramaic word behind

“saints” means “holy ones.” The faith was entrusted to the whole community, not to a spiritual elite. That matters, because the intruders, as v. 19 will suggest, seem to have divided the community into ranks.

### παρεισέδυσαν γάρ τινες ἄνθρωποι (*pareisedysan gar tines anthrōpoi*) — ‘for certain people have slipped in’

Verse 4 explains why the appeal was necessary. The verb παρεισέδυσαν (*pareisedysan*) is another word found only here in the New Testament. It means “to slip in secretly, steal in.”[33] It pictures someone entering through a side door, unnoticed. Paul uses related language of the “false brothers brought in unaware, who came in secretly to spy out our liberty” (Gal 2:4, LSV), and 2 Peter of false teachers “who will stealthily bring in destructive sects” (2 Pet 2:1, LSV).

The point is not necessarily that the intruders hid their identity. It is that their arrival was not recognized for what it was. They came as fellow believers, perhaps as traveling teachers welcomed according to the customs of Christian hospitality, and only later did their influence become clear. The phrase “certain men” (τινες ἄνθρωποι, *tines anthrōpoi*) is deliberately vague and somewhat dismissive. Jude never names them.

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33. Abbott-Smith, s.v. παρεισδύω: “to slip in secretly, steal in,” noting the form παρεισεδύησαν read by some editions.↩

### οἱ πάλαι προγεγραμμένοι εἰς τοῦτο τὸ κρίμα (*hoi palai progegrammenoi eis touto to krima*) — ‘written up long ago for this judgment’

This is one of the most debated phrases in the letter. The Greek οἱ πάλαι προγεγραμμένοι εἰς τοῦτο τὸ κρίμα (*hoi palai progegrammenoi eis touto to krima*) means literally “those long ago written-beforehand for this judgment.”

- **προγράφω** (*prographō*) means “to write before” or “to write publicly.”[34] Paul uses it for the scriptures: “as many things as were written before, for our instruction were written before” (Rom 15:4, LSV).
- **πάλαι** (*palai*) means “long ago, of old.”[35]
- **κρίμα** (*krima*) means “judgment” or “condemnation,” the verdict and its sentence.

What does it mean that these people were “written beforehand” for judgment? Three main interpretations have been offered.

1. **Written about in earlier prophecies.** The intruders’ judgment was described in advance in the scriptures and prophecies Jude is about to cite: the wilderness generation, the angels, Sodom, Cain, Balaam, Korah,

and especially Enoch's prophecy against the "impious." "This judgment" points forward to the judgments Jude will describe. On this reading, Jude is saying: *people like these were written about long ago, and what was written about them is about to be read out.* The word "long ago" (πάλαι) fits a prophecy as ancient as Enoch's. This is the interpretation most modern commentators favor, and the structure of the letter supports it.

2. **Written in heavenly books.** Jewish writings of the period speak of heavenly records in which deeds and destinies are inscribed (for example, the "heavenly tablets" of 1 Enoch 81 and 93:2). Jude might mean that the intruders' condemnation was already recorded in heaven.
3. **Predestined to condemnation.** Some theological traditions have read the phrase as a statement of individual reprobation, a divine decree that these persons would be condemned. Clement of Alexandria already addressed this, insisting that the intruders were ordained to judgment "not that they might become impious, but that, being now impious, they were ordained to judgment."[36]

The first interpretation best fits the flow of the letter, which immediately sets out "written" examples of judgment. Nineteenth-century commentators reached the same conclusion. The *Pulpit Commentary* judged that "the Old Testament prophecies, therefore, are probably those referred to," noting "that mention is made by-and-by of Enoch as one of the prophets of old." Alfred Plummer insisted that the phrase "gives no support to extreme predestinarian theories," because "'of old' (παλαι) cannot refer to the eternal counsel and decree of Almighty God, but to something in human history."[37] This book adopts it while acknowledging the others. The phrase is a statement about the certainty of judgment on a certain kind of behavior, not a statement that particular persons were created for damnation. It is also, in context, a word of reassurance. The intruders' arrival had not taken God by surprise.

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34. Abbott-Smith, s.v. προγράφω: "to write before: Ro 15:4, Eph 3:3, Ju 4. to write in public, placard, proclaim … Ga 3:1."↩

35. Abbott-Smith, s.v. πάλαι: "long ago, of old, in time past."↩

36. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 4, ANF 2 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0211.htm).↩

37. *The Pulpit Commentary*, ed. H. D. M. Spence and J. S. Exell, on Jude 4, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/pulpit/jude/1.htm; Alfred Plummer, *The General Epistles of St. James and St. Jude* (Expositor's Bible; London: Hodder & Stoughton, 1891), on Jude 4, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/expositors/jude/1.htm. Both are public domain.↩

### ἀσεβεῖς (*asebeis*) — 'impious'

The single word ἀσεβεῖς (*asebeis*), "ungodly, impious," stands alone in the Greek like a verdict. It is Jude's key term for the intruders. The noun, verb, and adjective of this word family occur six times in the letter, four of them in the quotation from Enoch: "to convict all their impious ones, concerning all their works of impiety that they did impiously, and concerning all the harsh [words] that impious sinners spoke" (v. 15). By calling the intruders "impious" here, Jude labels them with the very word of the prophecy he will quote. The *asebeia* family describes a failure of reverence toward God, a life lived as though God were not to be feared.

### τὴν τοῦ θεοῦ ἡμῶν χάριτα μετατιθέντες εἰς ἀσέλγειαν (*tēn tou theou hēmōn charita metatithentes eis aselgeian*) — 'turning the grace of our God into licentiousness'

This phrase names the intruders' central error. The participle μετατιθέντες (*metatithentes*), from μετατίθημι (*metatithēmi*), means "to transfer, change," and here "to make one thing a pretext for another."[38] The intruders take "the grace of our God" and turn it into **licentiousness**, ἀσέλγεια (*aselgeia*), a word for unrestrained, shameless behavior, often sexual.[39] It appears in the New Testament's vice lists: "adultery, whoredom, uncleanness, licentiousness" (Gal 5:19, LSV).

The error is ancient and recurring. Paul had to answer it: "Will we continue in sin that grace may abound? … Let it not be!" (Rom 6:1–2, LSV); "you were called to freedom, brothers, only the freedom [is] not for an occasion to the flesh" (Gal 5:13, LSV). Peter warns believers not to have "freedom as the cloak of evil" (1 Pet 2:16, LSV). Titus offers the positive counterpart: "the saving grace of God has appeared to all men, teaching us, that denying the impiety and the worldly desires, we may live soberly, and righteously, and piously in the present age" (Titus 2:11–12, LSV). In Titus, grace teaches the denial of impiety. In Jude, the impious deny the Master and use grace as license.

The intruders probably did not see themselves as opponents of grace. They likely saw themselves as its most consistent champions: if God forgives freely, why should conduct matter? Jude's verdict is that such a view does not exalt grace; it perverts it.

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38. Abbott-Smith, s.v. μετατίθημι: "to change … fig., i.e. to make one thing a pretext for another, χάριν εἰς ἀσέλγειαν, Ju 4."↩

39. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀσέλγεια: "licentiousness, wantonness, excess."↩

### καὶ τὸν μόνον δεσπότην καὶ κύριον ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν ἀρνούμενοι (*kai ton monon despotēn kai kyrion hēmōn Iēsoun*

### *Christon arnoumenoi*) — ‘and denying our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ’

The participle ἀρνούμενοι (*arnoumenoi*), “denying,” does not necessarily mean the intruders publicly renounced Christ in words. The New Testament often speaks of denial by conduct: “They profess to know God, but they deny [Him] by their works” (Titus 1:16, LSV). Since the intruders were inside the church, it is likely that they confessed Jesus with their lips while denying his lordship with their lives. To use grace as license is to refuse the authority of the one who gave it.

The titles are striking. **“Master”** translates δεσπότην (*despotēn*), the accusative of δεσπότης (*despotēs*), the word for an owner of slaves and a ruler with absolute authority.[40] In the Septuagint and elsewhere in the New Testament it is used of God (“LORD, You [are] God, who made the heaven, and the earth,” Acts 4:24, LSV; cf. Luke 2:29). Second Peter uses it of Christ, “denying the Master who bought them” (2 Pet 2:1, LSV). **“Only”** (μόνος, *monos*) is the language of Jewish monotheism. In v. 25, Jude will praise “the only … God our Savior.” To call Jesus “our *only* Master and Lord” is to apply to him language that belongs to the God of Israel. Jude, who calls himself Jesus’ *doulos* in v. 1, now calls him the *despotēs* of all believers.

The LSV’s dash (“our only Master and Lord—Jesus Christ”) makes clear that both titles refer to Jesus. In Greek this is signaled by a single article (τόν, *ton*) governing both nouns, a construction in which two singular personal nouns joined by “and” under one article normally refer to the same person.

**A textual note.** The Byzantine tradition and the Textus Receptus add θεόν (*theon*), “God”: “the only Master God and our Lord Jesus Christ.” Webster’s revision, following the older English Bibles, translated this as two persons: “denying the only Lord God, and our Lord Jesus Christ” (WBS). The WEB, translating the same Majority Text, renders it as one person: “denying our only Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ.” The critical editions omit θεόν, and the LSV follows them. On either reading, Jude’s Christology is high.

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40. Abbott-Smith, s.v. δεσπότης: “a master, lord, correlative of δοῦλος”; used “as title of God” and “of Christ, II Pe 2:1, Ju 4.” Abbott-Smith quotes Thayer that δεσπότης “denoted absolute ownership and uncontrolled power.”↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| σπουδή | *spoudē* | haste, diligence, eagerness | “using all diligence” | Eager intent, not anxiety. |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| κοινός | *koinos* | common, shared | “our common salvation” | “Shared,” not “ordinary”; cf. Titus 1:4. |
| ἀνάγκη | *anankē* | necessity, compulsion | “I had necessity” | Strong external pressure; cf. 1 Cor 9:16. |
| παρακαλέω | *parakaleō* | urge, appeal, encourage | “exhorting” | Warm pastoral appeal. |
| ἐπαγωνίζομαι | *epagōnizomai* | contend for | “to fight for” | NT hapax; athletic/agonistic imagery; dative = “for” the faith. Do not overread the prefix. |
| πίστις | *pistis* | faith, trust; the faith | “the faith” | Here the *content* believed (as in Gal 1:23), not the act of believing. |
| ἅπαξ | *hapax* | once, once for all | “once” | Finality and completeness (Heb 9:26; 1 Pet 3:18). |
| παραδίδωμι | *paradidōmi* | hand over, deliver | “delivered” | Technical term for transmitting tradition (1 Cor 11:2, 23; 15:3). |
| ἅγιοι | *hagioi* | holy ones, saints | “the holy ones” | All God’s people. |
| παρεισδύω | *pareisdyō* | slip in secretly | “came in … stealthily” | NT hapax. B and C (followed by WH) have the variant aorist form παρεισεδύησαν, as their INTF transcriptions show. |
| προγράφω | *prographō* | write beforehand; placard | “written beforehand” | Rom 15:4 (“written before”); Gal 3:1 (“publicly portrayed”). |
| πάλαι | *palai* | long ago | “long ago” | Absolute past. |
| κρίμα | *krima* | judgment, sentence | “this judgment” | Points forward to vv. 5–15. |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ἀσεβής | *asebēs* | impious, ungodly | “impious” | Jude’s key word (×6 in the word family). |
| χάρις | *charis* | grace, favor | “the grace of our God” | SBLGNT reads the rarer accusative form χάριτα. |
| μετατίθημι | *metatithēmi* | transfer, change | “perverting” | To turn one thing into a pretext for another. |
| ἀσέλγεια | *aselgeia* | licentiousness, debauchery | “licentiousness” | Shameless excess, often sexual. |
| δεσπότης | *despotēs* | master, owner, sovereign | “Master” | Of God in LXX/NT; here of Christ. |
| ἀρνέομαι | *arneomai* | deny, disown, renounce | “denying” | Can be denial by conduct (Titus 1:16). |

**Two cautions.**

1. *Etymology and ἐπαγωνίζομαι.* Because the word is related to *agōn*, sermons sometimes describe Jude’s readers as athletes “agonizing” in the arena. The word does belong to the language of contest, and the image is fair as far as it goes. But the meaning of a rare compound is best derived from its context, not from a picture assembled from its parts. Here the context says only that the readers should exert themselves on behalf of the faith. Jude defines how in vv. 20–23.
2. *“The faith” vs. “faith.”* With the article and with “once delivered,” *pistis* here means the body of belief, not personal trust. That is not a sign of a “later” Christianity: Paul already speaks this way in Gal 1:23. Equally, Jude does not imagine faith as a mere list of propositions. The faith is “most holy” (v. 20), something believers build themselves up on.

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Traveling teachers and Christian hospitality.** The early churches depended on traveling apostles, prophets, and teachers, and they extended them hospitality. That openness made communities vulnerable. The *Didache*, an early Christian manual of church practice usually dated between the late first and early second century, gives practical tests for visitors. “Whosoever … comes and teaches you all these things that have been said before, receive

him. But if the teacher himself turn and teach another doctrine to the destruction of this, hear him not." An apostle should stay no more than a day or two, and "if he ask money, he is a false prophet." "Not every one that speaks in the Spirit is a prophet; but only if he hold the ways of the Lord. Therefore from their ways shall the false prophet and the prophet be known."[41] These instructions match Jude's concerns closely: teaching measured against what was handed down, character as the test of a claimed spiritual gift, and suspicion of teachers who seek profit (vv. 11, 16). The *Didache* was not written to Jude's readers, and the two documents are independent. It does show that the problem Jude faced was a recognized one in the early churches.

**Contests and the *agōn*.** Athletic games were a major feature of Greco-Roman civic life, and the language of contest (*agōn*, "struggle, competition") was widely used metaphorically by philosophers and moralists for the moral life. Hellenistic Jewish writers also used it of faithfulness under persecution. Jude's word draws on this widely understood world of strenuous, disciplined effort.

**Tradition in Judaism and early Christianity.** Jewish teachers carefully transmitted the interpretation of the Law from teacher to student. Early Christians, many of them Jews, used the same vocabulary of "receiving" and "handing on" for the gospel and for the teachings of Jesus. When Jude speaks of "the faith once delivered," he speaks the language of a community conscious of being entrusted with something it did not invent.

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41. *Didache* 11.1–2, 4–6, 8; 12.1–5, trans. M. B. Riddle, ANF 7 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0714.htm).↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Contending for the faith (Phil 1:27; 1 Tim 6:12; 2 Tim 4:7).** Paul urges the Philippians to stand "with one soul, striving together for the faith of the good news" (Phil 1:27, LSV), using a related compound (συναθλέω, "strive together"). Timothy is told, "Be striving the good strife of the faith" (1 Tim 6:12, LSV), and Paul says of himself, "I have striven the good strife, I have finished the course, I have kept the faith" (2 Tim 4:7, LSV). These are shared themes and vocabulary rather than quotations. Together they show that "contending for the faith" was part of the common moral language of early Christianity.

**Guarding a deposit (1 Tim 6:20; 2 Tim 1:14).** Paul tells Timothy, "guard the thing entrusted" (1 Tim 6:20, LSV) and "guard the good thing committed through the Holy Spirit that is dwelling in us" (2 Tim 1:14, LSV). The image of a deposit held in trust parallels Jude's faith "once delivered."

**Received and delivered (1 Cor 11:23; 15:1–3).** The closest verbal parallels are Paul's statements of tradition. Note especially 1 Cor 15:1–2: "the good news that I proclaimed to you, which you also received, in which you also have stood, through which you are also being saved" (LSV). The gospel is received, stood in, and saving, like Jude's "common salvation."

**Infiltrators (Gal 2:4; 2 Pet 2:1).** Paul's "false brothers brought in unaware, who came in secretly" (Gal 2:4, LSV) offers the nearest Pauline parallel to Jude's "came in … stealthily." The parallel with 2 Pet 2:1 ("stealthily bring in destructive sects, even denying the Master who bought them") is one of the strongest verbal links between Jude and 2 Peter (see Appendix C).

**Grace and license (Rom 6:1–2, 15; Gal 5:13; 1 Pet 2:16; Titus 2:11–12).** Discussed above. These passages show that the abuse of grace was a danger the apostles recognized and resisted in several places.

**Denial by conduct (Titus 1:16; Matt 10:33; 2 Tim 2:12).** Jesus warned, "whoever will deny Me before men, I also will deny him before My Father who is in the heavens" (Matt 10:33, LSV). Jude's charge stands in this line.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Did Jude write the other letter?** Some have suggested that the planned letter about "our common salvation" might survive elsewhere, for example as 2 Peter. There is no evidence for this, and most scholars regard the question as unanswerable.

**2. Is "the faith once delivered" a sign of late authorship?** As noted in the Historical Introduction, some scholars see in "the faith" a fixed body of doctrine typical of later "early catholic" Christianity. Others point out that Paul spoke of "the faith" as content (Gal 1:23) and of delivering traditions (1 Cor 11:2, 23; 15:3) in the 50s. The phrase is compatible with an early date.

**3. What exactly is "the faith"?** Jude does not define it. From the letter itself we can infer that it includes the lordship of Jesus Christ (v. 4), the reality of judgment (vv. 5–15), the grace of God that does not license immorality (v. 4), the apostles' teaching (v. 17), the work of the Holy Spirit (vv. 19–20), the love of God and the mercy of Christ (v. 21), and the hope of eternal life (v. 21). That is, it includes both belief and the shape of life that belief requires. Christian traditions differ on where this "faith once delivered" is now authoritatively found. Many Protestants locate it in Scripture alone. Catholic and Orthodox Christians locate it in Scripture together with the church's living tradition. All agree that it was given, not invented.

**4. What does "written beforehand" imply about predestination?** See the discussion in section C above. The phrase has been read in support of divine

reprobation, but the context points most naturally to *recorded prophecies of judgment*, which Jude proceeds to cite.

**5. Does "only Master" imply that Jesus is God?** Jude does not use the word "God" of Jesus (unless the Byzantine θεόν is original). He does apply to Jesus titles and monotheistic language ("only Master," "Lord") that Jewish usage reserved for God. If the reading "Jesus" in v. 5 is original (see Chapter 3), Jude also attributes to Jesus the exodus deliverance, the defining saving act of Israel's God. Many scholars see Jude as evidence of a very early and very high Christology emerging within Jewish Christianity.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verses 3 and 4 are the hinge on which the letter turns. Verse 3 states the **appeal**: contend for the faith. Verse 4 states the **reason**: intruders have come in. The rest of the letter unfolds both:

- Verses 5–19 expand v. 4. They show from scripture, tradition, and prophecy that the intruders' judgment was indeed "written beforehand," and they describe the intruders' "impious" character in detail.
- Verses 20–23 expand v. 3. They show what "contending for the faith" means in practice: building up, praying, keeping, waiting, and showing mercy.

Jude's frequent use of "impious" (vv. 4, 15, 18) and the word "faith" at both ends of this structure (vv. 3, 20) mark these connections.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*These are suggested applications, distinct from the text's original meaning.*

**Contending without contention.** Jude's call to "fight for the faith" has often been used to justify combativeness, sometimes over matters far removed from the core of the gospel. Jude's own letter shows a different picture. His concern was the lordship of Christ and the moral meaning of grace, not secondary disputes. His instructions for contending (vv. 20–23) are about spiritual formation and mercy, not argument and exclusion. Christians today might ask whether their "contending" looks like Jude's: urgent about what matters most, and practiced through prayer, love, and rescue.

**The faith as gift and trust.** "Once delivered to the holy ones" means the faith belongs to the whole people of God and was entrusted, not invented. For modern believers this may be both humbling and freeing. They do not need to create a faith that fits their moment, and they are responsible for passing on what they received.

**Grace that teaches.** Every generation meets the temptation to treat grace as permission. Jude may help believers see that grace and holiness are not rivals. The grace of God that forgives is the same grace that "teaches" a transformed life (Titus 2:11–12).

**Recognizing infiltration without paranoia.** Jude's intruders "came in … stealthily," and their influence was recognized only over time. Churches today might learn from the early Christian practice of testing teaching by its fidelity to the received faith and testing teachers by their conduct, as the *Didache* advised. They should do this without turning community life into suspicion of every newcomer. Jude's own ending (vv. 22–23) shows that vigilance and mercy belong together.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Jude intended to write about "our common salvation" but felt compelled to write a warning instead. Have you experienced a situation in which encouragement had to give way to correction? How did you decide?
2. What do you think belongs to "the faith once delivered to the holy ones," and what is secondary? How might different Christian traditions answer this question?
3. The intruders likely saw themselves as champions of grace. How can a community distinguish between a genuine emphasis on grace and the "perverting" of grace that Jude describes?
4. Jude says the intruders denied Jesus as Master and Lord, probably by their conduct rather than their words. In what ways can people confess Jesus with their lips while denying him with their lives?
5. If contending for the faith is defined by vv. 20–23, what would it look like for you or your community to "fight for the faith" this week?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT; variant θεόν from the SBLGNT apparatus (RP) and the Textus Receptus; WEB and Webster renderings from the eBible.org editions.
- Lexical data: Abbott-Smith, *Manual Greek Lexicon*, s.vv. παρεισδύω, προγράφω, πάλαι, μετατίθημι, ἀσέλγεια, δεσπότης, ἐπαγωνίζομαι, ἅπαξ.
- *Didache* 11–12, trans. M. B. Riddle, ANF 7.
- Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude, ANF 2.

- Interpretation of “written beforehand” as recorded prophecy: Alfred Plummer, *The General Epistles of St. James and St. Jude* (Expositor’s Bible, 1891), on v. 4; *The Pulpit Commentary*, on v. 4 (both public domain; see n. 4a).

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Daniel 7:18

*Aramaic (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**18** וְיַקַּבְּלוּן מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישֵׁי עֶלְיוֹנִין וְיַחְסְנוּן מַלְכוּתָא עַד־עָלְמָא וְעַד עָלַם עָלְמַיָּא

*English (BSB)*

**18** But the saints of the Most High will receive the kingdom and possess it forever—yes, forever and ever.’

*English (WEB)*

**18** But the saints of the Most High will receive the kingdom, and possess the kingdom forever, even forever and ever.’

### Matthew 10:33

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**33** ὅστις δ’ ἂν ἀρνήσηταί με ἔμπροσθεν τῶν ἀνθρώπων, ἀρνήσομαι κἀγὼ αὐτὸν ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ πατρός μου τοῦ ἐν οὐρανοῖς.

*English (BSB)*

**33** But whoever denies Me before men, I will also deny him before My Father in heaven.

*English (WEB)*

**33** But whoever denies me before men, I will also deny him before my Father who is in heaven.

## Luke 2:29

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**29** Νῦν ἀπολύεις τὸν δοῦλόν σου, δέσποτα, κατὰ τὸ ῥῆμά σου ἐν εἰρήνῃ·

*English (BSB)*

**29** “Sovereign Lord, as You have promised, You now dismiss Your servant in peace.

*English (WEB)*

**29** “Now you are releasing your servant, Master, according to your word, in peace;

## John 14:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** κἀγὼ ἐρωτήσω τὸν πατέρα καὶ ἄλλον παράκλητον δώσει ὑμῖν ἵνα ᾖ μεθ’ ὑμῶν εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα,

*English (BSB)*

**16** And I will ask the Father, and He will give you another Advocate to be with you forever—

*English (WEB)*

**16** I will pray to the Father, and he will give you another Counselor, that he may be with you forever:

## Acts 2:44

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**44** πάντες δὲ οἱ πιστεύοντες ἦσαν ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ καὶ εἶχον ἅπαντα κοινά,

*English (BSB)*

**44** All the believers were together and had everything in common.

*English (WEB)*

**44** All who believed were together, and had all things in common.

## Acts 4:24

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**24** οἱ δὲ ἀκούσαντες ὁμοθυμαδὸν ἦραν φωνὴν πρὸς τὸν θεὸν καὶ εἶπαν· Δέσποτα, σὺ ὁ ποιήσας τὸν οὐρανὸν καὶ τὴν γῆν καὶ τὴν θάλασσαν καὶ πάντα τὰ ἐν αὐτοῖς,

*English (BSB)*

**24** When the believers heard this, they lifted up their voices to God with one accord. “Sovereign Lord,” they said, “You made the heaven and the earth and the sea and everything in them.

*English (WEB)*

**24** When they heard it, they lifted up their voice to God with one accord and said, “O Lord, you are God, who made the sky, the earth, the sea, and all that is in them;

## Romans 6:1–2, 15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Τί οὖν ἐροῦμεν; ἐπιμένωμεν τῇ ἁμαρτίᾳ, ἵνα ἡ χάρις πλεονάσῃ; **2** μὴ γένοιτο· οἵτινες ἀπεθάνομεν τῇ ἁμαρτίᾳ, πῶς ἔτι ζήσομεν ἐν αὐτῇ; … **15** Τί οὖν; ἁμαρτήσωμεν ὅτι οὐκ ἐσμὲν ὑπὸ νόμον ἀλλὰ ὑπὸ χάριν; μὴ γένοιτο·

*English (BSB)*

**1** What then shall we say? Shall we continue in sin so that grace may increase? **2** Certainly not! How can we who died to sin live in it any longer? … **15** What then? Shall we sin because we are not under law, but under grace? Certainly not!

*English (WEB)*

**1** What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound? **2** May it never be! We who died to sin, how could we live in it any longer? … **15** What then? Shall we sin because we are not under law but under grace? May it never be!

## Romans 15:4

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** ὅσα γὰρ προεγράφη, εἰς τὴν ἡμετέραν διδασκαλίαν ἐγράφη, ἵνα διὰ τῆς ὑπομονῆς καὶ διὰ τῆς παρακλήσεως τῶν γραφῶν τὴν ἐλπίδα ἔχωμεν.

*English (BSB)*

**4** For everything that was written in the past was written for our instruction, so that through endurance and the encouragement of the Scriptures, we might have hope.

*English (WEB)*

**4** For whatever things were written before were written for our learning, that through perseverance and through encouragement of the Scriptures we might have hope.

### 1 Corinthians 9:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** ἐὰν γὰρ εὐαγγελίζωμαι, οὐκ ἔστιν μοι καύχημα, ἀνάγκη γάρ μοι ἐπίκειται· οὐαὶ γάρ μοί ἐστιν ἐὰν μὴ εὐαγγελίσωμαι.

*English (BSB)*

**16** Yet when I preach the gospel, I have no reason to boast, because I am obligated to preach. Woe to me if I do not preach the gospel!

*English (WEB)*

**16** For if I preach the Good News, I have nothing to boast about, for necessity is laid on me; but woe is to me if I don’t preach the Good News.

### 1 Corinthians 11:2, 23

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** Ἐπαινῶ δὲ ὑμᾶς ὅτι πάντα μου μέμνησθε καὶ καθὼς παρέδωκα ὑμῖν τὰς παραδόσεις κατέχετε. … **23** Ἐγὼ γὰρ παρέλαβον ἀπὸ τοῦ κυρίου, ὃ καὶ παρέδωκα ὑμῖν, ὅτι ὁ κύριος Ἰησοῦς ἐν τῇ νυκτὶ ᾗ παρεδίδετο ἔλαβεν ἄρτον

*English (BSB)*

**2** Now I commend you for remembering me in everything and for maintaining the traditions, just as I passed them on to you. … **23** For I received from the Lord what I also passed on to you: The Lord Jesus, on the night He was betrayed, took bread,

*English (WEB)*

**2** Now I praise you, brothers, that you remember me in all things, and hold firm the traditions, even as I delivered them to you. … **23** For I received from the Lord that which also I delivered to you, that the Lord Jesus on the night in which he was betrayed took bread.

### 1 Corinthians 15:1–3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Γνωρίζω δὲ ὑμῖν, ἀδελφοί, τὸ εὐαγγέλιον ὃ εὐηγγελισάμην ὑμῖν, ὃ καὶ παρελάβετε, ἐν ᾧ καὶ ἑστήκατε, **2** δι᾽ οὗ καὶ σῴζεσθε, τίνι λόγῳ εὐηγγελισάμην ὑμῖν, εἰ κατέχετε, ἐκτὸς εἰ μὴ εἰκῇ ἐπιστεύσατε. **3** Παρέδωκα γὰρ ὑμῖν ἐν πρώτοις, ὃ καὶ παρέλαβον, ὅτι Χριστὸς ἀπέθανεν ὑπὲρ τῶν ἁμαρτιῶν ἡμῶν κατὰ τὰς γραφάς,

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now, brothers, I want to remind you of the gospel I preached to you, which you received, and in which you stand firm. **2** By this gospel you are saved, if you hold firmly to the word I preached to you. Otherwise, you have believed in vain. **3** For what I received I passed on to you as of first importance: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures,

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now I declare to you, brothers, the Good News which I preached to you, which also you received, in which you also stand, **2** by which also you are saved, if you hold firmly the word which I preached to you—unless you believed in vain. **3** For I delivered to you first of all that which I also received: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures,

## Galatians 1:23

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**23** μόνον δὲ ἀκούοντες ἦσαν ὅτι Ὁ διώκων ἡμᾶς ποτε νῦν εὐαγγελίζεται τὴν πίστιν ἣν ποτε ἐπόρθει,

*English (BSB)*

**23** They only heard the account: “The man who formerly persecuted us is now preaching the faith he once tried to destroy.”

*English (WEB)*

**23** but they only heard, “He who once persecuted us now preaches the faith that he once tried to destroy.”

## Galatians 2:4

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** διὰ δὲ τοὺς παρεισάκτους ψευδαδέλφους, οἵτινες παρεισῆλθον κατασκοπῆσαι τὴν ἐλευθερίαν ἡμῶν ἣν ἔχομεν ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ, ἵνα ἡμᾶς καταδουλώσουσιν—

*English (BSB)*

**4** This issue arose because some false brothers had come in under false pretenses to spy on our freedom in Christ Jesus, in order to enslave us.

*English (WEB)*

**4** This was because of the false brothers secretly brought in, who stole in to spy out our liberty which we have in Christ Jesus, that they might bring us into bondage,

### Galatians 3:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ὦ ἀνόητοι Γαλάται, τίς ὑμᾶς ἐβάσκανεν, οἷς κατ᾽ ὀφθαλμοὺς Ἰησοῦς Χριστὸς προεγράφη ἐσταυρωμένος;

*English (BSB)*

**1** O foolish Galatians! Who has bewitched you? Before your very eyes Jesus Christ was clearly portrayed as crucified.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Foolish Galatians, who has bewitched you not to obey the truth, before whose eyes Jesus Christ was openly portrayed among you as crucified?

### Galatians 5:13, 19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** Ὑμεῖς γὰρ ἐπ᾽ ἐλευθερίᾳ ἐκλήθητε, ἀδελφοί· μόνον μὴ τὴν ἐλευθερίαν εἰς ἀφορμὴν τῇ σαρκί, ἀλλὰ διὰ τῆς ἀγάπης δουλεύετε ἀλλήλοις· … **19** φανερὰ δέ ἐστιν τὰ ἔργα τῆς σαρκός, ἅτινά ἐστιν πορνεία, ἀκαθαρσία, ἀσέλγεια,

*English (BSB)*

**13** For you, brothers, were called to freedom; but do not use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh. Rather, serve one another in love. … **19** The acts of the flesh are obvious: sexual immorality, impurity, and debauchery;

*English (WEB)*

**13** For you, brothers, were called for freedom. Only don’t use your freedom as an opportunity for the flesh, but through love be servants to one another. … **19** Now the deeds of the flesh are obvious, which are: adultery, sexual immorality, uncleanness, lustfulness,

### Ephesians 3:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** κατὰ ἀποκάλυψιν ἐγνωρίσθη μοι τὸ μυστήριον, καθὼς προέγραψα ἐν ὀλίγῳ,

*English (BSB)*

**3** that is, the mystery made known to me by revelation, as I have already written briefly.

*English (WEB)*

**3** how that by revelation the mystery was made known to me, as I wrote before in few words,

## Philippians 1:27

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**27** Μόνον ἀξίως τοῦ εὐαγγελίου τοῦ Χριστοῦ πολιτεύεσθε, ἵνα εἴτε ἐλθὼν καὶ ἰδὼν ὑμᾶς εἴτε ἀπὼν ἀκούω τὰ περὶ ὑμῶν, ὅτι στήκετε ἐν ἑνὶ πνεύματι, μιᾷ ψυχῇ συναθλοῦντες τῇ πίστει τοῦ εὐαγγελίου,

*English (BSB)*

**27** Nevertheless, conduct yourselves in a manner worthy of the gospel of Christ. Then, whether I come and see you or only hear about you in my absence, I will know that you stand firm in one spirit, contending side by side for the faith of the gospel,

*English (WEB)*

**27** Only let your way of life be worthy of the Good News of Christ, that whether I come and see you or am absent, I may hear of your state, that you stand firm in one spirit, with one soul striving for the faith of the Good News;

## 1 Timothy 6:12, 20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**12** ἀγωνίζου τὸν καλὸν ἀγῶνα τῆς πίστεως, ἐπιλαβοῦ τῆς αἰωνίου ζωῆς, εἰς ἣν ἐκλήθης καὶ ὡμολόγησας τὴν καλὴν ὁμολογίαν ἐνώπιον πολλῶν μαρτύρων. … **20** Ὦ Τιμόθεε, τὴν παραθήκην φύλαξον, ἐκτρεπόμενος τὰς βεβήλους κενοφωνίας καὶ ἀντιθέσεις τῆς ψευδωνύμου γνώσεως,

*English (BSB)*

**12** Fight the good fight of the faith. Take hold of the eternal life to which you were called when you made the good confession before many witnesses. … **20** O Timothy, guard what has been entrusted to you. Avoid irreverent, empty chatter and the opposing arguments of so-called “knowledge,”

*English (WEB)*

**12** Fight the good fight of faith. Take hold of the eternal life to which you were called, and you confessed the good confession in the sight of many witnesses. … **20** Timothy, guard that which is committed to you, turning away from the empty chatter and oppositions of what is falsely called knowledge,

### 2 Timothy 1:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** τὴν καλὴν παραθήκην φύλαξον διὰ πνεύματος ἁγίου τοῦ ἐνοικοῦντος ἐν ἡμῖν.

*English (BSB)*

**14** Guard the treasure entrusted to you, with the help of the Holy Spirit who dwells in us.

*English (WEB)*

**14** That good thing which was committed to you, guard through the Holy Spirit who dwells in us.

### 2 Timothy 2:12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**12** εἰ ὑπομένομεν, καὶ συμβασιλεύσομεν· εἰ ἀρνησόμεθα, κἀκεῖνος ἀρνήσεται ἡμᾶς·

*English (BSB)*

**12** if we endure, we will also reign with Him; if we deny Him, He will also deny us;

*English (WEB)*

**12** If we endure, we will also reign with him. If we deny him, he also will deny us.

### 2 Timothy 4:7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** τὸν καλὸν ἀγῶνα ἠγώνισμαι, τὸν δρόμον τετέλεκα, τὴν πίστιν τετήρηκα·

*English (BSB)*

**7** I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith.

*English (WEB)*

**7** I have fought the good fight. I have finished the course. I have kept the faith.

## Titus 1:4, 16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** Τίτῳ γνησίῳ τέκνῳ κατὰ κοινὴν πίστιν· χάρις καὶ εἰρήνη ἀπὸ θεοῦ πατρὸς καὶ Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ σωτῆρος ἡμῶν. … **16** θεὸν ὁμολογοῦσιν εἰδέναι, τοῖς δὲ ἔργοις ἀρνοῦνται, βδελυκτοὶ ὄντες καὶ ἀπειθεῖς καὶ πρὸς πᾶν ἔργον ἀγαθὸν ἀδόκιμοι.

*English (BSB)*

**4** To Titus, my true child in our common faith: Grace and peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Savior. … **16** They profess to know God, but by their actions they deny Him. They are detestable, disobedient, and unfit for any good deed.

*English (WEB)*

**4** to Titus, my true child according to a common faith: Grace, mercy, and peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ our Savior. … **16** They profess that they know God, but by their deeds they deny him, being abominable, disobedient, and unfit for any good work.

## Titus 2:11–12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** Ἐπεφάνη γὰρ ἡ χάρις τοῦ θεοῦ σωτήριος πᾶσιν ἀνθρώποις **12** παιδεύουσα ἡμᾶς, ἵνα ἀρνησάμενοι τὴν ἀσέβειαν καὶ τὰς κοσμικὰς ἐπιθυμίας σωφρόνως καὶ δικαίως καὶ εὐσεβῶς ζήσωμεν ἐν τῷ νῦν αἰῶνι,

*English (BSB)*

**11** For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to everyone. **12** It instructs us to renounce ungodliness and worldly passions, and to live sensible, upright, and godly lives in the present age,

*English (WEB)*

**11** For the grace of God has appeared, bringing salvation to all men, **12** instructing us to the intent that, denying ungodliness and worldly lusts, we would live soberly, righteously, and godly in this present age;

## Hebrews 9:26

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**26** ἐπεὶ ἔδει αὐτὸν πολλάκις παθεῖν ἀπὸ καταβολῆς κόσμου· νυνὶ δὲ ἅπαξ ἐπὶ συντελείᾳ τῶν αἰώνων εἰς ἀθέτησιν ἁμαρτίας διὰ τῆς θυσίας αὐτοῦ πεφανέρωται.

*English (BSB)*

**26** Otherwise, Christ would have had to suffer repeatedly since the foundation of the world. But now He has appeared once for all at the end of the ages to do away with sin by the sacrifice of Himself.

*English (WEB)*

**26** or else he must have suffered often since the foundation of the world. But now once at the end of the ages, he has been revealed to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself.

## 1 Peter 2:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** ὡς ἐλεύθεροι, καὶ μὴ ὡς ἐπικάλυμμα ἔχοντες τῆς κακίας τὴν ἐλευθερίαν, ἀλλ᾽ ὡς θεοῦ δοῦλοι.

*English (BSB)*

**16** Live in freedom, but do not use your freedom as a cover-up for evil; live as servants of God.

*English (WEB)*

**16** Live as free people, yet not using your freedom for a cloak of wickedness, but as bondservants of God.

## 1 Peter 3:18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** ὅτι καὶ Χριστὸς ἅπαξ περὶ ἁμαρτιῶν ἔπαθεν, δίκαιος ὑπὲρ ἀδίκων, ἵνα ὑμᾶς προσαγάγῃ τῷ θεῷ, θανατωθεὶς μὲν σαρκὶ ζῳοποιηθεὶς δὲ πνεύματι·

*English (BSB)*

**18** For Christ also suffered for sins once for all, the righteous for the unrighteous, to bring you to God. He was put to death in the body but made alive in the Spirit,

*English (WEB)*

**18** Because Christ also suffered for sins once, the righteous for the unrighteous, that he might bring you to God, being put to death in the flesh, but made alive in the Spirit,

## 2 Peter 2:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἐγένοντο δὲ καὶ ψευδοπροφῆται ἐν τῷ λαῷ, ὡς καὶ ἐν ὑμῖν ἔσονται ψευδοδιδάσκαλοι, οἵτινες παρεισάξουσιν αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας, καὶ τὸν ἀγοράσαντα αὐτοὺς δεσπότην ἀρνούμενοι, ἐπάγοντες ἑαυτοῖς ταχινὴν ἀπώλειαν·

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now there were also false prophets among the people, just as there will be false teachers among you. They will secretly introduce destructive heresies, even denying the Master who bought them—bringing swift destruction on themselves.

*English (WEB)*

**1** But false prophets also arose among the people, as false teachers will also be among you, who will secretly bring in destructive heresies, denying even the Master who bought them, bringing on themselves swift destruction.

## 1 Enoch 81

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And he said unto me: ‘Observe, Enoch, these heavenly tablets, And read what is written thereon, And mark every individual fact.’ **2** And I observed the heavenly tablets, and read everything which was written (thereon) and understood everything, and read the book of all the deeds of mankind, and of all the children of flesh that shall be upon the earth to the remotest generations. **3** And forthwith I blessed the great Lord the King of glory for ever, in that He has made all the works of the world, And I extolled the Lord because of His patience, And blessed Him because of the children of men. **4** And after that I said: ‘Blessed is the man who dies in righteousness and goodness, Concerning whom there is no book of unrighteousness written, And against whom no day of judgement shall be found.’ **5** And those seven holy ones brought me and placed me on the earth before the door of my house, and said to me: ‘Declare everything to thy son Methuselah, and show to all thy children that no flesh is righteous in the sight of the Lord, for He is their Creator. **6** One year we will leave thee with thy son, till thou givest thy (last) commands, that thou mayst teach thy children and record (it) for them, and testify to all thy children; and in the second year they shall take thee from their midst. **7** Let thy heart be strong, For the good shall announce righteousness to the good; The righteous with the righteous shall rejoice, And shall offer congratulation to one another. **8** But the sinners shall die with the sinners, And the apostate go down with the apostate. **9** And those who practise righteousness shall die on account of the deeds of men, And be taken away on account of the doings of the godless.’ **10** And in those days they ceased to speak to me, and I came to my people, blessing the Lord of the world.

# Chapter 3. Three Ancient Warnings: The Exodus, the Angels, and Sodom (Jude 5–7)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **5** Ὑπομνῆσαι δὲ ὑμᾶς βούλομαι, εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ πάντα, ὅτι Ἰησοῦς λαὸν ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου σώσας τὸ δεύτερον τοὺς μὴ πιστεύσαντας ἀπώλεσεν, **6** ἀγγέλους τε τοὺς μὴ τηρήσαντας τὴν ἑαυτῶν ἀρχὴν ἀλλὰ ἀπολιπόντας τὸ ἴδιον οἰκητήριον εἰς κρίσιν μεγάλης ἡμέρας δεσμοῖς ἀϊδίοις ὑπὸ ζόφον τετήρηκεν· **7** ὡς Σόδομα καὶ Γόμορρα καὶ αἱ περὶ αὐτὰς πόλεις, τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον τούτοις ἐκπορνεύσασαι καὶ ἀπελθοῦσαι ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἑτέρας, πρόκεινται δεῖγμα πυρὸς αἰωνίου δίκην ὑπέχουσαι.
>
> — Jude 5–7, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript's first hand, and $^{\text{corr}}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Ἰησοῦς | 'Jesus' | A B 1739 |
| 5 | (ὁ) κύριος | 'the Lord' | א C* Ψ K L |
| 5 | ὁ θεός | 'God' | $\text{C}^{\text{corr}}$ |
| 5 | θεὸς Χριστός | 'God Christ' | P72 |
| 5 | εἰδότας (ὑμᾶς) ἅπαξ πάντα | 'though you once knew all things' | P72 A B |
| 5 | … πάντα, ὅτι [subject] ἅπαξ λαόν | 'knowing all things, that [the Lord/Jesus] | א C Ψ 1739 |

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| | … | once saved a people’ | |
| 5 | εἰδότας ὑμᾶς τοῦτο ἅπαξ / ἅπαξ τοῦτο | ‘though you once knew this’ | K L |
| 5 | βούλομαι ἀδελφοί | ‘I want, brothers and sisters, (to remind you)’ | P78 |
| 7 | τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον τούτοις | ‘in the same way as these’ | P72 ℵ A B C 1739 |
| 7 | τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον αὐτοῖς | ‘in the same way as they’ | Ψ |
| 7 | τὸν ὅμοιον τούτοις τρόπον | (word order only) | K L |
| 7 | δίκην ὑπέχουσαι | ‘undergoing the penalty’ | P72 B C Ψ K L 1739 |
| 7 | δίκην ἐπέχουσαι | (spelling variant of the same) | P78 |
| 7 | δίκην ὑπερέχουσαι | ‘excelling’ (probably a copying slip) | A |
| 7 | δίκην οὐκ ἔχουσιν | ‘they do not have’ (corrected to ὑπέχουσιν) | ℵ* |

Notes. v. 6: no difference that affects translation (A reads δέ for τε; Ψ reads κατοικητήριον for οἰκητήριον); not extant in P78.

## The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

### Jude 5

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | My mynde is therfore to put you in remebraunce for as moche as ye once knowe this how that the Lorde (after that he had delivered the people out of Egypt) destroyed them which afterwarde beleved not. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | I wil therfore put you in remebrance, forasmuch as ye once knew this, how that the Lord, after that he had deliuered the |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | people out of Egypt, destroied them afterward which beleeued not. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | I will therefore admonish you, though ye once knew all things, that Jesus, having saved the people out of the land of Egypt, did afterwards destroy them that believed not: |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | I will therefore put you in remembrance, though ye once knew this, that the Lord, having saved the people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed them that believed not. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | But I wish to remind you as once knowing it all, that the Lord, having saved the people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who believed not; |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Now I desire to put you in remembrance, though ye know all things once for all, how that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed them that believed not. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | But I would put you in remembrance, you who once knew all things, that the Lord, having saved a people out of [the] land of Egypt, in the second place destroyed those who had not believed. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | and to remind you I intend, you knowing once this, that the Lord, a people out of the land of Egypt having saved, again those who did not believe did destroy; |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Now I desire to put you in remembrance, though ye know all things once for all, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed them that believed not. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Now I desire to remind you, though you already know this, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who didn't believe. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Although you previously knew all these things, there are certain things about which I desire to remind you. Do not forget that although the Lord rescued his people from Egypt, he later destroyed most of those same people, ones who did not believe in him. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | Now I want to remind you – but you already know it all – that, though the Lord delivered the people from Egypt, yet he afterward destroyed those who refused to believe in him; |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Now I wish to remind you—although once you fully knew it—that the Lord saved a people out of the land of Egypt, but that afterward he destroyed those who did not believe. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Even though you already know this, I want to remind you that though the Lord saved his people out of the land of Egypt, later he still destroyed those who disbelieved. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | Now I intend to remind you, you once having known all this, that Jesus, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, He secondly destroyed those not having believed; |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Although you are fully aware of this, I want to remind you that after Jesus had delivered His people out of the land of Egypt, He destroyed those who did not believe. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Although you are fully aware of this, I want to remind you that after the Lord had delivered His people out of the land of Egypt, He destroyed those who did not believe. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Now I want to remind you, although you already know this, that after the Lord saved a people out of the land of Egypt, he subsequently destroyed those who did not believe. |

## Jude 6

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | The angels also which kept not their fyrst estate: but lefte their awne habitacion he hath reserved in everlastinge chaynes vnder darcknes vnto the iudgement of the greate daye: |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | The Angels also which kept not their first estate, but left their owne habitation, hee hath reserued in euerlasting chaines vnder |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | darkenesse vnto the iudgement of the great day. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | And the angels who kept not their principality, but forsook their own habitation, he hath reserved under darkness in everlasting chains, unto the judgment of the great day. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | And the angels who kept not their first state, but left their own habitation, he hath reserved in everlasting chains under darkness to the judgment of the great day. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | and the angels which kept not their principality, but left their own dwelling-place, he hath kept in everlasting chains under darkness unto the judgment of the great day; |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | And angels which kept not their own principality, but left their proper habitation, he hath kept in everlasting bonds under darkness unto the judgment of the great day. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | And angels who had not kept their own original state, but had abandoned their own dwelling, he keeps in eternal chains under gloomy darkness, to [the] judgment of [the] great day; |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | messengers also, those who did not keep their own principality, but did leave their proper dwelling, to a judgment of a great day, in bonds everlasting, under darkness He hath kept, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | And angels that kept not their own principality, but left their proper habitation, he hath kept in everlasting bonds under darkness unto the judgment of the great day. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Angels who didn't keep their first domain, but deserted their own dwelling place, he has kept in everlasting bonds under darkness for the judgment of the great day. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | And there were many angels to whom God assigned/gave positions of authority in heaven. But many did not continue to rule with authority in those positions. Instead, they abandoned the place that God gave them to live in heaven. So God has put those angels in chains forever in the darkness in |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | hell. They will stay there until the great day when God will judge and punish them. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | and that even those angels, who did not keep to their appointed spheres, but left their proper homes, have been kept by him for the judgment of the great day in everlasting chains and black darkness. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Also angels who did not keep to their own position of authority, but who left their proper dwelling place—God has kept them in everlasting chains, in utter darkness, for the judgment on the great day. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Even those angels that were not content with their God-given positions but abandoned their rightful places—he has placed them in eternal chains of darkness until the great Day of Judgment. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | messengers also, those who did not keep their own principality, but left their proper dwelling, He has kept in eternal bonds under darkness until [the] judgment of [the] great day, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | And the angels who did not stay within their own domain but abandoned their proper dwelling—these He has kept in eternal chains under darkness, bound for judgment on that great day. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | And the angels who did not stay within their own domain but abandoned their proper dwelling—these He has kept in eternal chains under darkness, bound for judgment on that great day. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | And the angels who did not keep within their proper domain, but left their own dwelling, he has kept under darkness in everlasting chains for the judgment of the great day. |

### Jude 7

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | even as Sodom and Gomor and the cities aboute them (which in lyke maner defiled them selves with fornicacion and folowed straunge flesshe) are set forth for an ensample and suffre the vengeaunce of eternall fyre. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | As Sodom and Gomorrhe, and the cities about them, which in like maner as they did, committed fornication, and followed strange flesh, are set foorth for an ensample, and suffer the vengeance of eternall fire. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | As Sodom and Gomorrha, and the neighbouring cities, in like manner, having given themselves to fornication, and going after other flesh, were made an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Even as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities about them in like manner, giving themselves over to impurity, and going after strange flesh, are set forth for an example, suffering the vengeance of eternal fire. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | even as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities about them, in like manner with them giving themselves over to fornication, and going away after strange flesh, are set forth for an example, suffering the vengeance of everlasting fire. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Even as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities about them, having in like manner with these given themselves over to fornication, and gone after strange flesh, are set forth as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | as Sodom and Gomorrha, and the cities around them, committing greedily fornication, in like manner with them, and going after other flesh, lie there as an example, undergoing the judgment of eternal fire. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities around them, in like manner to these, having given themselves to whoredom, and gone after other flesh, have been set before — an example, of fire age-during, justice suffering. |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Even as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities about them, having in like manner |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | with these given themselves over to fornication and gone after strange flesh, are set forth as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Even as Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, having in the same way as these given themselves over to sexual immorality and gone after strange flesh, are shown as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Similarly, the people who lived [MTY] in Sodom and Gomorrah cities and the nearby cities committed sexual immorality. They sought all kinds of sexual relations that differ from what God permits. So God destroyed their cities. What happened to those people and those angels shows that God will punish people, such as the ones who teach false doctrine, in the eternal fire of hell. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | Like Sodom and Gomorrah and the towns near them, which gave themselves up to fornication, and fell into unnatural vice, these angels now stand out as a warning, undergoing, as they are, punishment in eternal fire. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | It is just like Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, which also indulged themselves in sexual immorality and pursued unnatural desires. They were displayed as examples of those who suffer the punishment in eternal fire. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | In just the same way, Sodom and Gomorrah and the towns nearby that pursued immorality and perverted sex are provided as an example of those that experience the punishment of eternal fire. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | as Sodom and Gomorrah, and the cities around them, in like manner to these [messengers], having given themselves to whoredom, and having gone after other flesh, have been set before [as] an example, undergoing the justice of continuous fire. |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | In like manner, Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, who indulged in sexual immorality and pursued strange flesh, are on display as an example of those who sustain the punishment of eternal fire. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | In like manner, Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, who indulged in sexual immorality and pursued strange flesh, are on display as an example of those who sustain the punishment of eternal fire. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Likewise, Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, who indulged in fornication and went after strange flesh in a manner similar to those angels, serve as an example by undergoing the punishment of eternal fire. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Jude now begins to show why the intruders' judgment was "written beforehand" (v. 4). He reminds his readers of three well-known examples of God's judgment:

1. **The wilderness generation.** The people whom the Lord saved from Egypt were later destroyed when they refused to trust him (v. 5).
2. **The rebellious angels.** Heavenly beings who abandoned their assigned place are now held in darkness until the final judgment (v. 6).
3. **Sodom and Gomorrah.** The cities that pursued sexual immorality and "other flesh" now stand as a warning example of fiery judgment (v. 7).

Each example concerns people or beings who had a privileged position. Israel had been redeemed, the angels had a heavenly station, and Sodom and its neighbors lived in a fertile, well-watered land (Gen 13:10). Each abandoned that position through unbelief, rebellion, or immorality, and each came under judgment. The implication for the intruders, and for anyone tempted to follow them, is plain. Belonging to God's people does not guarantee safety for those who turn grace into license.

Jude's opening, "I intend to remind you," matters too. He is not telling his readers anything new. He is calling to mind what they already know, in a way that makes its present relevance unmistakable.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### Ὑπομνῆσαι δὲ ὑμᾶς βούλομαι, εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ πάντα (*Hypomnēsai de hymas boulomai, eidotas hymas hapax panta*) — 'I want to remind you, though you once knew all things'

The verb ὑπομνῆσαι (*hypomnēsai*), “to remind,” places Jude in the role of a teacher who refreshes memory rather than introducing novelty. That role fits his claim that the faith was delivered “once” (v. 3). The readers already “know all this,” literally “having known all things once” (εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ πάντα, *eidotas hymas hapax panta*). The participle εἰδότας (*eidotas*), “knowing,” is concessive: *although* you know. Second Peter uses the same courtesy, “I will always be ready to remind you about these things, although you have known [them]” (2 Pet 1:12, LSV).

The word ἅπαξ (*hapax*), “once” or “once for all,” has wandered in the manuscripts. In some it stands with “knowing” (“you who once for all knew all things”). In others it moves into the next clause (“the Lord, having *once* saved a people”). The SBLGNT and NA28 place it with “knowing,” and the LSV follows them: “you once having known all this.” The echo of v. 3 is deliberate: the faith was delivered *once for all*, and the readers *once for all* came to know it. What remains is to remember.

### ὅτι Ἰησοῦς λαὸν ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου σώσας (*hoti Iēsous laon ek gēs Aigyptou sōsas*) — ‘that Jesus, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt’

This is one of the most remarkable phrases in the New Testament, and one of the most debated. The LSV reads **“Jesus.”** Many other translations read **“the Lord”** (WEB, ASV, WBS), while the BSB, like the LSV, reads “Jesus.” The difference is not a translation choice. It reflects a difference in the Greek manuscripts, explored in the deep dive below.

If “Jesus” is original, Jude says that Jesus himself, before his human birth, was the one who delivered Israel from Egypt. That is a striking claim, but not an isolated one. Paul says that the Israelites in the wilderness “were drinking of a spiritual rock following them, and the rock was the Christ” (1 Cor 10:4, LSV), and he warns, “neither may we tempt the Christ, as also certain of them tempted” (1 Cor 10:9, LSV). John says that Isaiah “saw His glory, and spoke of Him” (John 12:41, LSV), referring to Jesus and to Isaiah’s vision of the LORD in the temple. Jude’s reading belongs to the same early Christian conviction that the one revealed in Jesus was already active in Israel’s history.

The verb σώσας (*sōsas*), “having saved,” is the ordinary New Testament word for salvation. Its use here recalls the language of the exodus itself: “YHWH saves Israel out of the hand of the Egyptians in that day” (Exod 14:30, LSV). The exodus was Israel’s defining experience of salvation. Jude’s point depends on this. The people who were later destroyed were not outsiders; they had been *saved*.

### τὸ δεύτερον τοὺς μὴ πιστεύσαντας ἀπώλεσεν (*to deuteron tous mē pisteusantas apōlesen*) — ‘afterward destroyed those who did not believe’

The phrase τὸ δεύτερον (*to deuteron*) literally means “the second time” or “secondly.” It can simply mean “afterward” (WEB: “afterward destroyed”), but its natural sense sets two acts side by side: first salvation, then destruction. The LSV keeps the literal “secondly.”

The reference is to the wilderness generation, which refused to enter the promised land after the report of the spies. God says to Moses, “Until when do they not believe in Me, for all the signs which I have done in its midst?” (Num 14:11, LSV). The sentence follows: “Your carcasses fall in this wilderness … who have murmured against Me” (Num 14:29, LSV). The aorist participle “those not having believed” (τοὺς μὴ πιστεύσαντας, *tous mē pisteusantas*) sums up the whole episode.

The warning in Jude’s first example is the most pointed of the three, because it concerns *God’s own redeemed people*. The intruders are inside the church. They share its meals and claim its grace. Jude’s readers might suppose that being among the saved is protection enough. The wilderness generation shows otherwise. The early church used this example often: Paul in 1 Corinthians 10 and the author of Hebrews (“we see that they were not able to enter in because of unbelief,” Heb 3:19, LSV). Jude uses it first in his series, perhaps for that reason.

### ἀγγέλους τε τοὺς μὴ τηρήσαντας τὴν ἑαυτῶν ἀρχήν (*angelous te tous mē tērēsantas tēn heautōn archēn*) — ‘and the angels who did not keep their own position’

The LSV’s “messengers” translates ἀγγέλους (*angelous*), the ordinary word for “messengers” that, in a heavenly context, means “angels.” The LSV renders it consistently as “messengers,” but the context makes clear that heavenly beings are meant.

These angels “did not keep” (μὴ τηρήσαντας, *mē tērēsantas*) “their own principality” (τὴν ἑαυτῶν ἀρχήν, *tēn heautōn archēn*). The word ἀρχή (*archē*) means “beginning,” “rule,” or “domain.” Here it most likely means the position of authority and the sphere of responsibility God had assigned them. The New Testament can call angelic powers “principalities” (ἀρχαί, *archai*; e.g., Rom 8:38; Eph 6:12). The LSV’s “principality” preserves that link. The WEB has “their first domain,” the ASV “their own principality,” and the BSB “their positions of authority.”

Note the first play on “keep.” The readers have been “kept” (v. 1). These angels did not “keep” what God had given them.

### ἀλλὰ ἀπολιπόντας τὸ ἴδιον οἰκητήριον (*alla apolipontas to idion oikētērion*) — ‘but abandoned their own dwelling’

The angels also “left” or “abandoned” (ἀπολιπόντας, *apolipontas*) “their proper dwelling” (τὸ ἴδιον οἰκητήριον, *to idion oikētērion*). An οἰκητήριον is a habitation, a dwelling place.[42] Paul uses the same rare word for the resurrection body: “our dwelling that is from Heaven” (2 Cor 5:2, LSV). The angels’ proper home was heaven. They left it.

Which angels, and what did they do? Jude assumes his readers know the story. As the deep dive below shows, they almost certainly did: it is the story of the “sons of God” who took human wives in Genesis 6:1–4, as expanded in the Jewish tradition preserved in 1 Enoch.

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42. Abbott-Smith, s.v. οἰκητήριον: “a habitation: Ju 6; trop., II Co 5:2.”↩

### εἰς κρίσιν μεγάλης ἡμέρας δεσμοῖς ἀϊδίοις ὑπὸ ζόφον τετήρηκεν (*eis krisin megalēs hēmeras desmois aidiois hypo zophon tetērēken*) — ‘he has kept in everlasting chains under gloom for the judgment of the great day’

Now comes the second, ironic “keep.” The angels who did not *keep* their position, God “has kept” (τετήρηκεν, *tetērēken*, perfect tense: has kept and still keeps) under guard. Jude’s wordplay states a principle: those who refuse to keep their God-given place are themselves kept, for judgment.

- **“Eternal bonds”** (δεσμοῖς ἀϊδίοις, *desmois aidiois*). The adjective ἀΐδιος (*aidios*), “everlasting,” appears elsewhere in the New Testament only in Rom 1:20, of God’s “eternal power.” The “bonds” are chains of imprisonment.
- **“Under darkness”** (ὑπὸ ζόφον, *hypo zophon*). The word ζόφος (*zophos*) means deep gloom. In Homer it was used of the gloom of the underworld.[43] It appears again in v. 13 (“the gloom of the darkness”) and in the parallel passages of 2 Peter (2:4, 17).
- **“Until [the] judgment of [the] great day”** (εἰς κρίσιν μεγάλης ἡμέρας, *eis krisin megalēs hēmeras*). The imprisonment is not the final penalty. It is custody awaiting trial. The “great day” is the final judgment, the “day of the LORD” of the prophets.

These phrases match the language of 1 Enoch closely, as the deep dive shows.

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43. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ζόφος: “in Hom. the gloom of the under-world; hence, darkness, deep gloom … He 12:18, II Pe 2:4, 17, Ju 6, 13.”↩

### ὡς Σόδομα καὶ Γόμορρα καὶ αἱ περὶ αὐτὰς πόλεις (*hōs Sodoma kai Gomorra kai hai peri autas poleis*) — ‘just as Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them’

The third example, Σόδομα καὶ Γόμορρα (*Sodoma kai Gomorra*), is the most famous. Genesis 19 tells how God “rained on Sodom and on Gomorrah brimstone and fire from YHWH, from the heavens; and He overthrows these cities, and all the circuit” (Gen 19:24–25, LSV). The “cities around them” (αἱ περὶ αὐτὰς πόλεις, *hai peri autas poleis*) are Admah and Zeboim, named in Deut 29:23 and Hos 11:8 as destroyed with Sodom and Gomorrah. (Zoar, the fifth city of the plain, was spared at Lot’s request.)

### τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον τούτοις (*ton homoion tropon toutois*) — ‘in the same way as these’

The Greek τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον τούτοις (*ton homoion tropon toutois*) means “in the same way as these.” Grammatically, “these” (τούτοις, *toutois*) is masculine, so it cannot refer to the cities (πόλεις, *poleis*), which is feminine. It most naturally refers to the nearest masculine plural, the angels of v. 6. The LSV makes this explicit by supplying “[messengers]” in brackets. (Some interpreters have suggested that “these” looks ahead to the intruders of v. 8, but the immediate sense is a comparison between Sodom and the angels.)

So the comparison is this: *the cities sinned in the same way as the angels*. In what way? The next phrases answer.

### ἐκπορνεύσασαι (*ekporneusasai*) — ‘having given themselves over to sexual immorality’

The participle ἐκπορνεύσασαι (*ekporneusasai*) is a strengthened form of the common verb for sexual immorality, πορνεύω (*porneuō*). Its prefix ἐκ- (*ek-*) suggests going to excess, “giving oneself up to fornication.”[44] The word occurs nowhere else in the New Testament. In the Septuagint it often describes Israel’s spiritual unfaithfulness, pictured as prostitution, but here, as the following phrase shows, the sense is literal.

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44. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἐκπορνεύω: “strengthened form of πορνεύω, implying excessive indulgence; mid., to give oneself up to fornication: Ju 7.” ↩

### καὶ ἀπελθοῦσαι ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἑτέρας (*kai apelthousai opisō sarkos heteras*) — ‘and having gone after other flesh’

The phrase ἀπελθοῦσαι ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἑτέρας (*apelthousai opisō sarkos heteras*) means literally “having gone away after other (or different) flesh.” The traditional English rendering goes back to Tyndale’s “straunge flesshe”

(TNT) and survives in Webster's "strange flesh" (WBS) and the WEB's "strange flesh" (WEB). The BSB has "perversion." The LSV keeps the literal "other flesh."

What is "other flesh"? This phrase has become a flashpoint in modern debates about sexuality, and it needs careful handling. The deep dive below sets out the evidence. In brief, the parallel Jude has just drawn with the angels ("in like manner to these") strongly suggests the following: as the angels crossed the boundary between heaven and earth to unite with human women, so the men of Sodom sought sexual relations with beings of a different order, namely the angels who visited Lot (Gen 19:1–5). On this reading, "other flesh" refers above all to the attempted violation of the angelic visitors. Jude's emphasis falls on the transgression of the created order.

### πρόκεινται δεῖγμα (*prokeintai deigma*) — 'are set out as an example'

The verb πρόκεινται (*prokeintai*), "they are set forth, displayed," is in the present tense: the cities *are* still set forth. The noun δεῖγμα (*deigma*), another New Testament hapax, means "a thing shown," a specimen or example, and here a warning example.[45] Second Peter uses the related ὑπόδειγμα (*hypodeigma*): "having set [them as] an example to those about to be impious" (2 Pet 2:6, LSV).

Ancient readers believed they could still see the evidence. The region around the southern end of the Dead Sea, desolate, salty, and sulfurous, was identified with the ruined cities. The Wisdom of Solomon says of them: "even to this day the waste land that smoketh is a testimony, and plants bearing fruit that never come to ripeness: and a standing pillar of salt is a monument of an unbelieving soul" (Wis 10:7, Brenton).[46] Third Maccabees says that God made the Sodomites "an example to after generations" (3 Macc 2:5, Brenton).

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45. Abbott-Smith, s.v. δεῖγμα: "(cl.) a thing shown, a specimen. = cl. παράδ- (cf. ὑπόδ-, II Pe 2:6), an example (a warning): Ju 7."↩

46. Wisdom 10:7 and 3 Maccabees 2:5, in Brenton's English Septuagint (eBible.org). The Greek of 3 Macc 2:5 reads παράδειγμα τοῖς ἐπιγινομένοις καταστήσας ("having established [them as] an example to those coming after").↩

### πυρὸς αἰωνίου δίκην ὑπέχουσαι (*pyros aiōniou dikēn hypechousai*) — 'undergoing the penalty of eternal fire'

The present participle ὑπέχουσαι (*hypechousai*), "undergoing," also unique in the New Testament, means "to undergo, suffer" a penalty.[47] The noun δίκη (*dikē*), "justice," here means the execution of a sentence, punishment. The

phrase πυρὸς αἰωνίου (*pyros aiōniou*) is “eternal fire,” which the LSV renders “continuous fire,” in keeping with its consistent treatment of αἰώνιος (*aiōnios*).

Two senses may be combined. The visible, smoking desolation of the region was understood as an ongoing display of the fire that destroyed the cities. That fire also pointed beyond itself to the “continuous fire that has been prepared for the Devil and his messengers” (Matt 25:41, LSV). The cities are an example *because* their temporal destruction prefigures final judgment. Jesus made the same connection: “it will be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrah in the day of judgment than for that city” (Matt 10:15, LSV).

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47. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ὑπέχω: “to undergo, suffer: δίκην, Ju 7 (Soph., Eur., al.).” ↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ὑπομιμνῄσκω | *hypomimnēskō* | remind | “I intend to remind you” | Calling to mind the known, not teaching the new. |
| εἰδότας | *eidotas* | knowing (perf. ptc. of οἶδα) | “you once having known” | Concessive: “although you know.” |
| ἅπαξ | *hapax* | once, once for all | “once” | Position varies in manuscripts (see deep dive). |
| Ἰησοῦς / κύριος | *Iēsous* / *kyrios* | Jesus / Lord | “Jesus” | Major variant (deep dive). |
| σῴζω | *sōzō* | save, deliver | “having saved” | Exodus salvation. |
| τὸ δεύτερον | *to deuteron* | the second time, afterward | “secondly” | Contrasts salvation and destruction. |
| ἀρχή | *archē* | beginning; rule, domain | “principality” | Assigned position and authority. |
| οἰκητήριον | *oikētērion* | dwelling, habitation | “proper dwelling” | Elsewhere only 2 Cor 5:2. |
| ἀΐδιος | *aidios* | everlasting | “eternal bonds” | Elsewhere only Rom 1:20. In later Greek not sharply distinct from αἰώνιος.[48] |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ζόφος | *zophos* | gloom, deep darkness | “under darkness” | Homeric “gloom of the underworld”; also v. 13; 2 Pet 2:4, 17; Heb 12:18. |
| τηρέω | *tēreō* | keep, guard | “did not keep … has kept” | Wordplay. |
| ἐκπορνεύω | *ekporneuō* | give oneself to fornication | “given themselves to whoredom” | NT hapax; intensive. |
| σὰρξ ἑτέρα | *sarx hetera* | other/different flesh | “other flesh” | See deep dive on Sodom. |
| πρόκειμαι | *prokeimai* | be set forth, displayed | “set before” | Present tense: still displayed. |
| δεῖγμα | *deigma* | specimen, example | “an example” | NT hapax; 2 Pet 2:6 has ὑπόδειγμα. |
| δίκη | *dikē* | justice; penalty | “the justice” | Execution of a sentence. |
| ὑπέχω | *hypechō* | undergo, suffer | “undergoing” | NT hapax; with δίκην = “suffer punishment.” |
| αἰώνιος | *aiōnios* | eternal, age-long | “continuous” | LSV’s consistent rendering. |

**On “eternal” and “continuous.”** The LSV’s “continuous” for αἰώνιος reflects a decision to translate the word by its root, αἰών (*aiōn*, “age”), rather than by the traditional “eternal.” Whether αἰώνιος in the New Testament means “unending” or “belonging to the age to come” has long been discussed, and the word can carry both ideas: the life and judgment of the coming age, which does not end. Readers should not build a doctrine of the duration of judgment on the LSV’s English choice alone, any more than on “eternal.” The theology must be built from the whole biblical witness.

## Deep dive: “Jesus … saved a people out of Egypt” — the text of Jude 5

The Greek manuscripts of Jude 5 are a tangle. The two main points of variation are (a) the name of the one who saved the people and (b) the position of “once.”

**The readings.** According to the SBLGNT apparatus and its updated form citing NA28:[49]

| Edition | Reading of the key words |
|---|---|
| SBLGNT (2010), NA28 (2012) | εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ πάντα ὅτι **Ἰησοῦς** λαὸν… (“knowing all things once, that **Jesus**…”) |
| NA27 (1993) | …πάντα ὅτι **ὁ κύριος ἅπαξ** λαὸν… (“that **the Lord**, having *once* saved…”) |
| Westcott–Hort (1881), Tregelles | …ἅπαξ πάντα ὅτι **κύριος**… (“that **[the] Lord**…”) |
| Robinson–Pierpont (Byzantine), TR | εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ **τοῦτο** ὅτι **ὁ κύριος**… (“once knowing **this**, that **the Lord**…”) |

The great majority of later Byzantine manuscripts read “the Lord.” According to the tallies in one modern edition, the Byzantine wording appears in about 69 percent of manuscripts and the wording with “Jesus” in a fraction of one percent.[50] The earliest manuscripts, however, divide very differently. Here is what the manuscripts themselves read, checked against their published transcriptions:[51]

| Manuscript | Date | Reading at Jude 5 |
|---|---|---|
| P72 (papyrus) | 3rd/4th c. | θ(εὸ)ς χρ(ιστὸ)ς, “God Christ” |
| ℵ 01 Sinaiticus | 4th c. | κ(ύριο)ς, “Lord” (with ἅπαξ after it) |
| B 03 Vaticanus | 4th c. | ι(ησου)ς, “Jesus” |
| A 02 Alexandrinus | 5th c. | ι(ησου)ς, “Jesus” |
| C 04 Ephraemi | 5th c. | ὁ κ(ύριο)ς, “the Lord,” changed by a later corrector to ὁ θ(εὸ)ς, “God” |
| Ψ 044 | 9th/10th c. | κ(ύριο)ς, “Lord” |
| K 018, L 020 | 9th c. | ὁ κ(ύριο)ς, “the Lord” (with τοῦτο) |
| 1739 | 10th c. | ι(ησου)ς, “Jesus” |

The abbreviations are the ancient *nomina sacra*: sacred names written in shortened form with a line above, ΙΣ for Ἰησοῦς and ΚΣ for κύριος.

**How have editors decided?** Westcott and Hort (1881) printed “Lord” but placed “Jesus” in their margin. The Nestle–Aland 27th edition printed “the Lord.” The SBLGNT (2010) and the Nestle–Aland 28th edition (2012) both print “Jesus.”[52] The reading impressed earlier commentators too. Alfred Plummer wrote that “there is very strong evidence in favour of substituting ‘Jesus’ for ‘the Lord;’ a most remarkable reading, showing how, in Christian language, the Man Jesus had become identified with the Eternal Son.” J. E.

Huther reported that the scholar Rudolf Stier called it “without example, and incomprehensibly strange.”[53]

**The arguments.**

*For “Jesus”:*

1. **Strong early attestation** in important manuscripts and early translations.
2. **It is the harder reading.** Scribes were more likely to change a surprising “Jesus” into an unproblematic “the Lord” than the reverse. A scribe copying “Jesus saved a people out of Egypt” might suppose that the historical Jesus was meant, find the statement impossible, and “correct” it.
3. **It explains the other readings.** “Lord,” “God,” and “God Christ” can all be understood as attempts to resolve the difficulty of “Jesus.”
4. **A possible scribal mechanism.** In manuscripts, sacred names were abbreviated: ΙΣ for “Jesus” and ΚΣ for “Lord.” These differ by one letter, so confusion in either direction was possible. This cuts both ways, though, and does not decide the question.

*For “the Lord”:*

1. **“Lord” is Jude’s usual word for God and Christ** (vv. 4, 9, 14, 17, 21, 25). A reading that uses “Jesus” for the pre-existent Christ would be unusual.
2. Some scholars judge that “Jesus” acting in the exodus is so unexpected that it is more likely a scribal slip (ΚΣ to ΙΣ) than an original reading.

Discussion continues. What can be said with confidence is that “Jesus” is now the reading of the most widely used critical editions, of the SBLGNT on which this book is based, and of the LSV, and that it is very well attested.

**What does it mean?** If Jude wrote “Jesus,” he identifies the one who saved Israel from Egypt with Jesus Christ. He does not imply that the man from Nazareth lived in the second millennium BC. Rather, the one who became incarnate as Jesus already existed and acted as Israel’s deliverer. Christian theology calls this the **pre-existence** of Christ. It is affirmed elsewhere in the New Testament (John 1:1–3; 8:58; Phil 2:6–7; Col 1:15–17; Heb 1:2), and 1 Cor 10:4, 9 apply it specifically to the wilderness. Some interpreters connect it further with the mysterious “Messenger” of Exodus who leads Israel and of whom God says, “My Name [is] in His heart” (Exod 23:21, LSV). Jude does not develop the idea. He simply states it, as if it were already familiar to his readers.

If Jude wrote “the Lord,” he almost certainly still meant to evoke the same God whose lordship is now exercised by Jesus. Note that Jude calls Jesus “our only

Master and Lord” in the previous verse (v. 4). On either reading, the warning is the same: the Lord who saves can also judge those who, having been saved, refuse to believe.

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48. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀΐδιος: “The etymological distinction between the meanings of the two words seems not to be retained in late Greek.”↩

49. SBLGNT apparatus for Jude 5 (https://www.sblgnt.com/download/86-Jud-APP.txt) and the eBible.org SBLGNT edition’s updated notes: “Ἰησοῦς NA28 ] κύριος WH Treg; ὁ κύριος NIV RP; ὁ κύριος ἅπαξ NA27.”↩

50. Text-Critical Greek NT notes (eBible.org `grctcgnt`): “υμας απαξ τουτο οτι ο κυριος 69.4% … υμας απαξ παντα οτι ιησους NA SBL 0.2%.” These percentages count manuscripts without weighing them.↩

51. Transcriptions in the INTF New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (Münster), https://ntvmr.uni-muenster.de, © Institut für Neutestamentliche Textforschung, licensed CC BY 4.0. Dates are from the same catalogue. Consulted 7 November 2026.↩

52. SBLGNT apparatus: “Ἰησοῦς Holmes WHmarg ] κύριος WH Treg; ὁ κύριος NIV RP; ὁ κύριος ἅπαξ NA”; eBible.org SBLGNT notes: “Ἰησοῦς NA28.” (“WHmarg” = the margin of Westcott–Hort.)↩

53. Alfred Plummer in *Ellicott’s Commentary for English Readers*, on Jude 5, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/ellicott/jude/1.htm; J. E. Huther, *Critical and Exegetical Handbook to the General Epistles of Peter and Jude*, trans. D. B. Croom (Edinburgh: T&T Clark, 1881), on Jude 5, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/meyer/jude/1.htm. Both public domain.↩

### Deep dive: angels and the judgment traditions

Who were the angels “who did not keep their own principality, but left their proper dwelling”? The Old Testament offers only one story that fits: Genesis 6:1–4.

> **1** And it comes to pass that mankind has begun to multiply on the face of the ground, and daughters have been born to them, **2** and the sons of God see that they, the daughters of men, [are] beautiful, and they take women for themselves of all whom they have chosen. … **4** The giants were in the earth in those days, and even afterward, when sons of God come in to the daughters of men, and they have borne to them those who [were] the mighty from of old, the men of renown.
>
> — Gen 6:1–4, LSV

Genesis does not say that the “sons of God” were punished, or even that they were angels. By the time of Jude, however, an elaborate Jewish tradition had grown up around these verses. Its fullest surviving form is the “Book of the Watchers,” 1 Enoch 1–36, usually dated to the third century BC or earlier. In it, two hundred angels called “Watchers” descend to earth, take human wives,

father the giants, and teach humanity forbidden arts. God then sends his archangels to bind them:

> And again the Lord said to Raphael: ‘Bind Azâzêl hand and foot, and cast him into the darkness: and make an opening in the desert … and cast him therein. And place upon him rough and jagged rocks, and cover him with darkness, and let him abide there for ever, and cover his face that he may not see light. And on the day of the great judgement he shall be cast into the fire.’
>
> — 1 Enoch 10:4–6 (trans. R. H. Charles)[54]

And to Michael:

> ‘Go, bind Semjâzâ and his associates who have united themselves with women so as to have defiled themselves with them in all their uncleanness. And when their sons have slain one another … bind them fast for seventy generations in the valleys of the earth, till the day of their judgement and of their consummation …’
>
> — 1 Enoch 10:11–12 (trans. R. H. Charles)

The correspondences with Jude 6 are close:

| Jude 6 | 1 Enoch |
|---|---|
| “did not keep their own principality, but left their proper dwelling” | The Watchers abandon heaven for earth (1 Enoch 6–7; 12:4; 15:3, 7) |
| “in eternal bonds” | “Bind … hand and foot”; “bind them fast” (10:4, 12) |
| “under darkness” | “cast him into the darkness … cover him with darkness” (10:4–5) |
| “until [the] judgment of [the] great day” | “on the day of the great judgement” (10:6); “till the day of their judgement” (10:12) |

Jude quotes 1 Enoch explicitly in vv. 14–15, so there is little doubt that he knew this tradition and expected his readers to know it. Second Peter’s parallel adds the term “Tartarus,” the Greek name for the deepest prison of the underworld: “God did not spare messengers having sinned, but having cast [them] down to Tartarus with chains of deepest gloom, delivered [them], having been reserved to judgment” (2 Pet 2:4, LSV). First Peter’s mysterious reference to “the spirits in prison, who sometime [ago] disobeyed … in [the] days of Noah” (1 Pet 3:19–20, LSV) probably belongs to the same circle of ideas.

The tradition also appears in other Jewish writings of the period. The *Testament of Naphtali*, discussed below, pairs the Watchers with Sodom exactly as Jude does. Sirach says that God “was not pacified toward the old

giants” (Sir 16:7, Brenton). Third Maccabees recalls that God destroyed “the giants, who trusted in their strength and hardihood” (3 Macc 2:4, Brenton). The fall of the Watchers was a standard example of judgment in Second Temple Judaism, and Jude uses it the way his contemporaries did.

**Other interpretations.** Later Christian interpreters moved away from the angelic reading of Genesis 6. Augustine argued that the “sons of God” were “according to the flesh the sons of Seth” who intermarried with the ungodly line of Cain, and he insisted that angels, being spiritual, could not father children.[55] Many readers have followed him, and others have read Jude 6 as a reference to an original fall of Satan and his angels before creation (cf. Rev 12:7–9), unconnected with Genesis 6. Both views are defensible as readings of Genesis in its own right. They fit Jude less well, because Jude’s vocabulary tracks 1 Enoch’s account of the Watchers, his next verse compares the angels’ sin to Sodom’s sexual sin, and he quotes 1 Enoch a few lines later. Clement of Alexandria, an early commentator, read Jude 6 of angels who “left their own habitation, meaning, that is, the heaven and the stars,” and took the “chains” as “the loss of the honour in which they had stood.”[56]

**What Jude affirms, and what he does not.** Jude affirms that some heavenly beings rebelled, that they are under restraint, and that they await final judgment. He does not provide a full angelology, a description of their prison, or a timetable. He uses a story his readers knew to make a single point: *even angels who abandoned their God-given place did not escape judgment.* How much of the surrounding Enochic narrative Jude believed to be historical is a separate question, taken up in Chapter 8.

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54. R. H. Charles, *The Book of Enoch* (London: SPCK, 1917), 1 Enoch 10:4–6, 11–12; Wikisource transcription. Charles’s typographical marks are omitted.↩

55. Augustine, *City of God* 15.23 (NPNF¹ 2; https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/120115.htm).↩

56. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 6, ANF 2.↩

### Deep dive: Sodom and Gomorrah

Sodom and Gomorrah became the Bible’s standard example of total destruction. Moses warns Israel that disobedience would leave the land “like the overthrow of Sodom and Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboim” (Deut 29:23, LSV). Isaiah calls Jerusalem’s rulers “you rulers of Sodom” (Isa 1:10, LSV). Jesus says the coming of the Son of Man will be like the days of Lot, when “He rained fire and brimstone from the sky, and destroyed all” (Luke 17:29, LSV). Paul and Peter both cite the cities. But what, according to the Bible and early Jewish tradition, was Sodom’s sin?

**The biblical evidence.**

- **Genesis 18–19.** The outcry against Sodom was already great before the angels arrived: “The cry of Sodom and Gomorrah—because great; and their sin—because exceedingly grievous” (Gen 18:20, LSV). The episode in Gen 19:4–5 shows the city’s character in action. The men of the city, “from young even to aged,” surround Lot’s house and demand that the visitors be brought out “and we know them” (LSV), that is, for sexual assault. The scene combines violent sexual aggression, the violation of guests whom hospitality required Lot to protect, and the fact that the guests were angels.
- **Ezekiel 16:49–50.** Ezekiel names the sins of “your sister Sodom” as “Arrogancy, fullness of bread, and quiet ease,” the failure to strengthen “the hand of the afflicted and needy,” and adds, “they are haughty and do abomination before Me” (LSV). Ezekiel’s emphasis is on pride, complacent wealth, and neglect of the poor, with “abomination” as a further charge.
- **Isaiah 1:10** and **Jeremiah 23:14** use Sodom as a byword for injustice and moral corruption in Jerusalem.

**The Second Temple evidence.** Jewish writers of Jude’s era gave the story different emphases:

- **Pride and insolence:** God “abhorred them for their pride” (Sir 16:8, Brenton). God destroyed “the Sodomites, those workers of exceeding iniquity” for their pride and insolence (3 Macc 2:5).
- **Hostility to strangers and sexual practices:** Josephus writes that “the Sodomites grew proud, on account of their riches and great wealth; they became unjust towards men, and impious towards God … they hated strangers, and abused themselves with Sodomitical practices.”[57]
- **Gluttony, debauchery, and same-sex relations:** Philo of Alexandria describes Sodom as “full of innumerable iniquities, and especially of gluttony and debauchery,” and says that its men “not only … went mad after women, and defile[d] the marriage bed of others, but also those who were men lusted after one another.”[58]
- **Changing the order of nature, paired with the Watchers:** The *Testament of Naphtali* urges its readers to recognize the Lord in creation, “that you become not as Sodom, which changed the order of its nature, in like manner also the Watchers changed the order of their nature, whom also the Lord cursed at the flood.”[59]

The last text is especially important for Jude, because it makes exactly Jude’s pairing. **Sodom and the Watchers are linked as two instances of transgressing the order of nature God established.** The Watchers crossed from heaven to earth to unite with human women. Sodom’s men sought to violate heavenly visitors. Jude’s “in like manner to these … having gone after other flesh” fits this pattern precisely.

**What “other flesh” means in Jude.** Three readings are found among interpreters:

1. **Angelic flesh.** “Other” (ἑτέρα, *hetera*) means “of a different kind.” The men of Sodom pursued sexual union with beings who were not human, the counterpart of the angels’ pursuit of human women. This is the reading most modern critical commentators favor, because it makes the best sense of “in like manner to these” and of the Testament of Naphtali parallel.
2. **Same-sex relations.** “Other” means “contrary to nature,” and Jude refers to homosexual acts, which Philo and Josephus associated with Sodom. This reading is traditional in much Christian interpretation.
3. **Sexual immorality in general**, with the angelic and same-sex dimensions both included in the description of the city’s excess.

The first reading best explains Jude’s comparison, and this book adopts it as the primary sense. Two cautions follow from it. First, Jude 7 should not be made to carry more than it says. The phrase’s main reference is to the attempted violation of angels, and Jude does not address modern questions about committed same-sex relationships. Those questions are usually argued from other texts (for example Lev 18:22 and Rom 1:26–27), and readers should weigh those passages on their own terms. Second, the opposite overcorrection is equally mistaken: Jude clearly condemns *sexual immorality* (“having given themselves to whoredom”). Sodom in Jude is not merely a symbol of inhospitality, even though inhospitality and violence were part of its sin. Honest reading lets Jude say what he says and no more.

**Why Sodom fits Jude’s argument.** Jude’s three examples move from God’s people (Israel), to heavenly beings (angels), to pagan cities (Sodom). The circle widens to show that judgment reaches every order of creation. All three share one feature: *they left the place God gave them*. Israel left trust for unbelief, the angels left heaven for earth, and Sodom left the order of creation for the pursuit of “other flesh.” The intruders, Jude will say, do “in like manner” (v. 8).

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57. Josephus, *Antiquities* 1.11.1 (Whiston), Project Gutenberg #2848.↩

58. Philo, *On Abraham* 133–135, trans. C. D. Yonge, https://www.earlyjewishwritings.com/text/philo/book22.html.↩

59. *Testament of Naphtali* 3:4–5, trans. R. Sinker, ANF 8 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0801.htm).↩

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**The exodus in Jewish memory.** The exodus from Egypt was the central saving event of Israel’s story, recited at Passover, celebrated in the Psalms,

and used by the prophets as the pattern for future deliverance. The wilderness generation's failure was equally remembered, as a warning. Psalm 95, sung in synagogue and church, ends with God's oath: "Forty years I am weary of the generation, … Where I swore in My anger" that they would not enter his rest (Ps 95:10–11, LSV). Jude's readers would have known both sides of the story.

**Angels in Second Temple Judaism.** Jewish thought between the Testaments developed a rich angelology: named archangels (Michael, Gabriel, Raphael, Uriel), angelic hierarchies, guardian angels of nations, and fallen angels. The Dead Sea Scrolls, 1 Enoch, Jubilees, and other writings show how widely these ideas were held. Jude's casual reference to rebellious angels and, in v. 9, to Michael the archangel shows that he and his readers shared this world of thought.

**The Dead Sea region.** The southern end of the Dead Sea, with its salt formations, bitumen, and barren landscape, was identified in antiquity with the destroyed cities of the plain. Wisdom 10:7, quoted above, speaks of its "waste land that smoketh" and its pillar of salt. Josephus also describes the region.[60] For Jude's readers, the "example" was not only a story but a place.

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60. Josephus, *Jewish War* 4.8.4 (Whiston): "there are still the remainders of that Divine fire, and the traces [or shadows] of the five cities are still to be seen, as well as the ashes growing in their fruits" (Project Gutenberg #2850). Of Lot's wife's pillar of salt Josephus writes, "I have seen it, and it remains at this day" (*Antiquities* 1.11.4, Gutenberg #2848).↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**1 Corinthians 10:1–11 (close thematic parallel).** Paul's use of the wilderness generation is the closest parallel to Jude 5. All Israel "passed through the sea … and all ate the same spiritual food," yet "in the most of them God was not well pleased, for they were strewn in the wilderness" (1 Cor 10:1, 3, 5, LSV). Paul identifies the rock as "the Christ" (10:4) and warns against tempting "the Christ" (10:9). His conclusion, "these things happened to those persons as types, and they were written for our admonition" (10:11, LSV), is exactly Jude's use of the story. The texts share a tradition of interpretation, but neither is likely quoting the other.

**Hebrews 3:16–19 (close thematic parallel).** "Was it not with those who sinned, whose carcasses fell in the wilderness? … they were not able to enter in because of unbelief" (Heb 3:17, 19, LSV). Hebrews stresses unbelief just as Jude does ("those not having believed").

**2 Peter 2:4–9 (literary parallel).** Peter's version lists angels, the flood, and Sodom, in biblical order. It adds Noah and Lot as examples of the righteous rescued and concludes: "the LORD has known to rescue [the] pious out of

temptation, and to keep [the] unrighteous being punished to [the] day of judgment" (2 Pet 2:9, LSV). The relationship to Jude is discussed in the Introduction and Appendix C.

**Matthew 25:41; Revelation 20:10 (shared theme).** The "continuous fire that has been prepared for the Devil and his messengers" (Matt 25:41, LSV) connects the fate of rebellious angels and the fire of judgment, the same two ideas that Jude 6–7 places side by side.

**Exodus 23:20–21 (possible background).** The Messenger in whom God's Name dwells and who leads Israel through the wilderness has been connected by some interpreters with Jude's "Jesus" in v. 5. This is a suggestive connection, not a demonstrated allusion.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. "Jesus" or "the Lord" in v. 5?** Discussed in the deep dive. The reading "Jesus" is strongly attested and is now printed in the main critical editions, but a minority of scholars still prefers "the Lord."

**2. Can the redeemed be destroyed?** Jude's first example concerns people who were genuinely saved from Egypt and later destroyed for unbelief. Christian traditions read this differently. Some see in it a warning that those who were once part of the redeemed community can fall away. Others see it as a type: physical deliverance from Egypt was real, but not every member of the delivered people had saving faith, and so the warning targets those whose membership in the church is not matched by faith. Jude's purpose is practical rather than systematic. He warns the readers not to trust in privilege, and he assures them that God is able to keep them (v. 24).

**3. Does Jude endorse the Watcher story as history?** Jude certainly uses the tradition, and his argument assumes its point. Whether he regarded every detail of 1 Enoch's narrative as historical cannot be determined from his brief allusion. The question is discussed further in Chapter 8.

**4. What was Sodom's sin?** Discussed in the deep dive. Jude's own emphasis is on sexual immorality and the pursuit of "other flesh," understood in light of the angel parallel. Other biblical texts emphasize pride, wealth, injustice, and inhospitality. A full biblical portrait includes all of these.

**5. "Eternal" or "continuous" fire?** The question of what αἰώνιος means, and of the nature and duration of final judgment, is a larger theological discussion that Jude's verse alone cannot settle. Jude's own point is that Sodom's destruction is a visible, lasting example of judgment that should give the reader pause.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verses 5–7 are the first of Jude's "texts," the evidence that the intruders' condemnation was "written beforehand" (v. 4). The next verse begins "In like manner" (ὁμοίως, *homoiōs*) and applies the examples: "those dreaming indeed defile the flesh, and they disregard lordship, and they speak evil of glorious [ones]" (v. 8). The three sins of v. 8 correspond loosely to the three examples. Defiling the flesh corresponds to Sodom. Disregarding lordship corresponds to the angels who left their place and to Israel's rebellion. Slandering glorious ones prepares for the contrast with Michael in v. 9.

The passage also develops the letter's key word: "keep." The angels "did not keep" and are "kept" (v. 6). The readers, "kept" by God (v. 1), will be urged to "keep" themselves (v. 21). The examples of vv. 5–7 are not only threats against the intruders. They are also mirrors for the readers, showing what it would mean to leave the place God has given.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*These reflections are suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Privilege is not protection.** Jude's first example is directed at people who belong to the community of the saved. Church membership, a dramatic conversion story, or a heritage of faith do not by themselves guarantee faithfulness. Jude's warning may be most needed in communities that feel most secure.

**The goodness of boundaries.** All three examples involve leaving a God-given place. Modern culture often treats limits as obstacles to self-realization. Jude's examples suggest that boundaries such as the place of trust, of creaturely station, and of the created order can be gifts that protect and do not merely restrict. This idea can be misused to justify unjust social hierarchies, which Jude does not address. Applied to the believer's relationship with God, though, it invites reflection on the freedom found in remaining where God has placed us: in his love (v. 21).

**Reading hard texts honestly.** Jude 7 is often quoted in modern debates. Responsible readers will resist both the temptation to make it say more than it does and the temptation to make it say less. That discipline is itself a form of "contending for the faith."

**Christ in the whole story.** If Jude 5 identifies Jesus as Israel's deliverer, Christians may read the Old Testament as the story of the same Lord they know in the Gospels. That conviction has shaped Christian worship and interpretation from the beginning.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Why do you think Jude began his examples with God's own people rather than with pagan Sodom? What effect might that order have had on his readers?
2. What difference does it make to your understanding of Jesus if Jude 5 says that *Jesus* saved Israel from Egypt?
3. The angels "did not keep their own principality" and are now "kept" for judgment. How does this wordplay illuminate the relationship between faithfulness and security?
4. Jude, Ezekiel, Josephus, and Philo describe Sodom's sin differently. Why might different writers emphasize different aspects of the same story? What are the risks of focusing on only one?
5. Jude says his readers already know these things but need reminding. What truths do you know well but most need to be reminded of?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek and variants: SBLGNT and apparatus (with NA28 data); Robinson–Pierpont 2018; TR; manuscript tallies from the Text-Critical Greek NT notes.
- 1 Enoch 10:4–6, 11–12: R. H. Charles, *The Book of Enoch* (1917), via Wikisource.
- Testament of Naphtali 3:3–5: trans. R. Sinker, ANF 8.
- Sirach 16:7–8; Wisdom 10:6–7; 3 Maccabees 2:4–5: Brenton's English Septuagint.
- Josephus, *Antiquities* 1.11.1 (Whiston numbering): Project Gutenberg #2848.
- Philo, *On Abraham* 133–136, trans. C. D. Yonge (1854–55), via earlyjewishwritings.com.
- Augustine, *City of God* 15.23 (NPNF¹ 2).
- Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 6.
- Abbott-Smith, *Manual Greek Lexicon*, s.vv. οἰκητήριον, ζόφος, ἀΐδιος, ἐκπορνεύω, δεῖγμα, ὑπέχω, δίκη.
- Manuscript readings: INTF New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room transcriptions (CC BY 4.0).
- Public-domain commentaries: Plummer in *Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers*; Huther, *Critical and Exegetical Handbook to the General Epistles of Peter and Jude* (1881); J. B. Mayor in *The Expositor's*

*Greek Testament* (1910); *Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges* (Plumptre), on vv. 5–7.

- Josephus, *Jewish War* 4.8.4 and *Antiquities* 1.11.4 (Whiston).

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Genesis 6

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְהִי כִּי־הֵחֵל הָאָדָם לָרֹב עַל־פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה וּבָנוֹת יֻלְּדוּ לָהֶם **2** וַיִּרְאוּ בְנֵי־הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת־בְּנוֹת
הָאָדָם כִּי טֹבֹת הֵנָּה וַיִּקְחוּ לָהֶם נָשִׁים מִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר בָּחָרוּ **3** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה לֹא־יָדוֹן רוּחִי בָאָדָם לְעֹלָם
בְּשַׁגַּם הוּא בָשָׂר וְהָיוּ יָמָיו מֵאָה וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה **4** הַנְּפִלִים הָיוּ בָאָרֶץ בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם וְגַם אַחֲרֵי־כֵן אֲשֶׁר
יָבֹאוּ בְּנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים אֶל־בְּנוֹת הָאָדָם וְיָלְדוּ לָהֶם הַמָּה הַגִּבֹּרִים אֲשֶׁר מֵעוֹלָם אַנְשֵׁי הַשֵּׁם **5** וַיַּרְא יְהוָה
כִּי רַבָּה רָעַת הָאָדָם בָּאָרֶץ וְכָל־יֵצֶר מַחְשְׁבֹת לִבּוֹ רַק רַע כָּל־הַיּוֹם **6** וַיִּנָּחֶם יְהוָה כִּי־עָשָׂה אֶת־
הָאָדָם בָּאָרֶץ וַיִּתְעַצֵּב אֶל־לִבּוֹ **7** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶמְחֶה אֶת־הָאָדָם אֲשֶׁר־בָּרָאתִי מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה
מֵאָדָם עַד־בְּהֵמָה עַד־רֶמֶשׂ וְעַד־עוֹף הַשָּׁמָיִם כִּי נִחַמְתִּי כִּי עֲשִׂיתִם **8** וְנֹחַ מָצָא חֵן בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה **9** אֵלֶּה
תּוֹלְדֹת נֹחַ נֹחַ אִישׁ צַדִּיק תָּמִים הָיָה בְּדֹרֹתָיו אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִים הִתְהַלֶּךְ־נֹחַ **10** וַיּוֹלֶד נֹחַ שְׁלֹשָׁה בָנִים
אֶת־שֵׁם אֶת־חָם וְאֶת־יָפֶת **11** וַתִּשָּׁחֵת הָאָרֶץ לִפְנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים וַתִּמָּלֵא הָאָרֶץ חָמָס **12** וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת־
הָאָרֶץ וְהִנֵּה נִשְׁחָתָה כִּי־הִשְׁחִית כָּל־בָּשָׂר אֶת־דַּרְכּוֹ עַל־הָאָרֶץ **13** וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים לְנֹחַ קֵץ כָּל־בָּשָׂר
בָּא לְפָנַי כִּי־מָלְאָה הָאָרֶץ חָמָס מִפְּנֵיהֶם וְהִנְנִי מַשְׁחִיתָם אֶת־הָאָרֶץ **14** עֲשֵׂה לְךָ תֵּבַת עֲצֵי־גֹפֶר קִנִּים
תַּעֲשֶׂה אֶת־הַתֵּבָה וְכָפַרְתָּ אֹתָהּ מִבַּיִת וּמִחוּץ בַּכֹּפֶר **15** וְזֶה אֲשֶׁר תַּעֲשֶׂה אֹתָהּ שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת אַמָּה אׇרֶךְ
הַתֵּבָה חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה רָחְבָּהּ וּשְׁלֹשִׁים אַמָּה קוֹמָתָהּ **16** צֹהַר תַּעֲשֶׂה לַתֵּבָה וְאֶל־אַמָּה תְּכַלֶּנָּה מִלְמַעְלָה
וּפֶתַח הַתֵּבָה בְּצִדָּהּ תָּשִׂים תַּחְתִּיִּם שְׁנִיִּם וּשְׁלִשִׁים תַּעֲשֶׂהָ **17** וַאֲנִי הִנְנִי מֵבִיא אֶת־הַמַּבּוּל מַיִם עַל־
הָאָרֶץ לְשַׁחֵת כָּל־בָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ רוּחַ חַיִּים מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמָיִם כֹּל אֲשֶׁר־בָּאָרֶץ יִגְוָע **18** וַהֲקִמֹתִי אֶת־
בְּרִיתִי אִתָּךְ וּבָאתָ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה אַתָּה וּבָנֶיךָ וְאִשְׁתְּךָ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנֶיךָ אִתָּךְ **19** וּמִכָּל־הָחַי מִכָּל־בָּשָׂר שְׁנַיִם
מִכֹּל תָּבִיא אֶל־הַתֵּבָה לְהַחֲיֹת אִתָּךְ זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה יִהְיוּ **20** מֵהָעוֹף לְמִינֵהוּ וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ מִכֹּל
רֶמֶשׂ הָאֲדָמָה לְמִינֵהוּ שְׁנַיִם מִכֹּל יָבֹאוּ אֵלֶיךָ לְהַחֲיוֹת **21** וְאַתָּה קַח־לְךָ מִכָּל־מַאֲכָל אֲשֶׁר יֵאָכֵל
וְאָסַפְתָּ אֵלֶיךָ וְהָיָה לְךָ וְלָהֶם לְאָכְלָה **22** וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֹתוֹ אֱלֹהִים כֵּן עָשָׂה

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now when men began to multiply on the face of the earth and daughters were born to them, **2** the sons of God saw that the daughters of men were

beautiful, and they took as wives whomever they chose. **3** So the LORD said, “My Spirit will not contend with man forever, for he is mortal; his days shall be 120 years.” **4** The Nephilim were on the earth in those days—and afterward as well—when the sons of God had relations with the daughters of men. And they bore them children who became the mighty men of old, men of renown. **5** Then the LORD saw that the wickedness of man was great upon the earth, and that every inclination of the thoughts of his heart was altogether evil all the time. **6** And the LORD regretted that He had made man on the earth, and He was grieved in His heart. **7** So the LORD said, “I will blot out man, whom I have created, from the face of the earth—every man and beast and crawling creature and bird of the air—for I am grieved that I have made them.” **8** Noah, however, found favor in the eyes of the LORD. **9** This is the account of Noah. Noah was a righteous man, blameless in his generation; Noah walked with God. **10** And Noah had three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. **11** Now the earth was corrupt in the sight of God, and full of violence. **12** And God looked upon the earth and saw that it was corrupt; for all living creatures on the earth had corrupted their ways. **13** Then God said to Noah, “The end of all living creatures has come before Me, because through them the earth is full of violence. Now behold, I will destroy both them and the earth. **14** Make for yourself an ark of gopher wood; make rooms in the ark and coat it with pitch inside and out. **15** And this is how you are to build it: The ark is to be 300 cubits long, 50 cubits wide, and 30 cubits high. **16** You are to make a roof for the ark, finish its walls a cubit from the top, place a door in the side of the ark, and build lower, middle, and upper decks. **17** And behold, I will bring floodwaters upon the earth to destroy every creature under the heavens that has the breath of life. Everything on the earth will perish. **18** But I will establish My covenant with you, and you will enter the ark—you and your sons and your wife and your sons’ wives with you. **19** And you are to bring two of every living creature into the ark—male and female—to keep them alive with you. **20** Two of every kind of bird and animal and crawling creature will come to you to be kept alive. **21** You are also to take for yourself every kind of food that is eaten and gather it as food for yourselves and for the animals.” **22** So Noah did everything precisely as God had commanded him.

*English (WEB)*

**1** When men began to multiply on the surface of the ground, and daughters were born to them, **2** God’s sons saw that men’s daughters were beautiful, and they took any that they wanted for themselves as wives. **3** The LORD said, “My Spirit will not strive with man forever, because he also is flesh; so his days will be one hundred twenty years.” **4** The Nephilim were on the earth in those days, and also after that, when God’s sons came in to men’s daughters and had children with them. Those were the mighty men who were of old, men of renown. **5** The LORD saw that the wickedness of man was great on the earth, and that every imagination of the thoughts of man’s heart was continually only

evil. **6** The LORD was sorry that he had made man on the earth, and it grieved him in his heart. **7** The LORD said, “I will destroy man whom I have created from the surface of the ground—man, along with animals, creeping things, and birds of the sky—for I am sorry that I have made them.” **8** But Noah found favor in the LORD’s eyes. **9** This is the history of the generations of Noah: Noah was a righteous man, blameless among the people of his time. Noah walked with God. **10** Noah became the father of three sons: Shem, Ham, and Japheth. **11** The earth was corrupt before God, and the earth was filled with violence. **12** God saw the earth, and saw that it was corrupt, for all flesh had corrupted their way on the earth. **13** God said to Noah, “I will bring an end to all flesh, for the earth is filled with violence through them. Behold, I will destroy them and the earth. **14** Make a ship of gopher wood. You shall make rooms in the ship, and shall seal it inside and outside with pitch. **15** This is how you shall make it. The length of the ship shall be three hundred cubits, its width fifty cubits, and its height thirty cubits. **16** You shall make a roof in the ship, and you shall finish it to a cubit upward. You shall set the door of the ship in its side. You shall make it with lower, second, and third levels. **17** I, even I, will bring the flood of waters on this earth, to destroy all flesh having the breath of life from under the sky. Everything that is on the earth will die. **18** But I will establish my covenant with you. You shall come into the ship, you, your sons, your wife, and your sons’ wives with you. **19** Of every living thing of all flesh, you shall bring two of every sort into the ship, to keep them alive with you. They shall be male and female. **20** Of the birds after their kind, of the livestock after their kind, of every creeping thing of the ground after its kind, two of every sort will come to you, to keep them alive. **21** Take with you some of all food that is eaten, and gather it to yourself; and it will be for food for you, and for them.” **22** Thus Noah did. He did all that God commanded him.

## Genesis 13:10

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**10** וַיִּשָּׂא־לוֹט אֶת־עֵינָיו וַיַּרְא אֶת־כָּל־כִּכַּר הַיַּרְדֵּן כִּי כֻלָּהּ מַשְׁקֶה לִפְנֵי שַׁחֵת יְהוָה אֶת־סְדֹם וְאֶת־עֲמֹרָה כְּגַן־יְהוָה כְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בֹּאֲכָה צֹעַר

*English (BSB)*

**10** And Lot looked out and saw that the whole plain of the Jordan, all the way to Zoar, was well watered like the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt. (This was before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah.)

*English (WEB)*

**10** Lot lifted up his eyes, and saw all the plain of the Jordan, that it was well-watered everywhere, before the LORD destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah, like the garden of the LORD, like the land of Egypt, as you go to Zoar.

## Genesis 18

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיֵּרָ֥א אֵלָ֖יו יְהוָ֑ה בְּאֵלֹנֵ֣י מַמְרֵ֔א וְה֥וּא יֹשֵׁ֖ב פֶּ֥תַח־הָאֹ֖הֶל כְּחֹ֥ם הַיּֽוֹם **2** וַיִּשָּׂ֤א עֵינָיו֙ וַיַּ֔רְא וְהִנֵּ֥ה שְׁלֹשָׁ֖ה
אֲנָשִׁ֣ים נִצָּבִ֣ים עָלָ֑יו וַיַּ֗רְא וַיָּ֙רָץ֙ לִקְרָאתָ֔ם מִפֶּ֖תַח הָאֹ֑הֶל וַיִּשְׁתַּ֖חוּ אָ֥רְצָה **3** וַיֹּאמַ֕ר אֲדֹנָ֖י אִם־נָ֣א מָצָ֣אתִי
חֵ֣ן בְּעֵינֶ֔יךָ אַל־נָ֥א תַעֲבֹ֖ר מֵעַ֥ל עַבְדֶּֽךָ **4** יֻקַּח־נָ֣א מְעַט־מַ֔יִם וְרַחֲצ֖וּ רַגְלֵיכֶ֑ם וְהִשָּׁעֲנ֖וּ תַּ֥חַת הָעֵֽץ **5**
וְאֶקְחָ֥ה פַת־לֶ֖חֶם וְסַעֲד֣וּ לִבְּכֶ֑ם אַחַ֥ר תַּעֲבֹ֖רוּ כִּי־עַל־כֵּ֥ן עֲבַרְתֶּ֛ם עַל־עַבְדְּכֶ֖ם וַיֹּאמְר֥וּ כֵּ֛ן תַּעֲשֶׂ֖ה
כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר דִּבַּ֖רְתָּ **6** וַיְמַהֵ֣ר אַבְרָהָ֣ם הָאֹ֔הֱלָה אֶל־שָׂרָ֖ה וַיֹּ֣אמֶר מַהֲרִ֔י שְׁלֹ֥שׁ סְאִ֖ים קֶ֣מַח סֹ֑לֶת לוּשִׁ֖י וְעֻשִׂ֥י
עֻגֽוֹת **7** וְאֶל־הַבָּקָ֖ר רָ֣ץ אַבְרָהָ֑ם וַיִּקַּ֞ח בֶּן־בָּקָ֤ר רַךְ֙ וְטוֹב֙ וַיִּתֵּ֣ן אֶל־הַנַּ֔עַר וַיְמַהֵ֖ר לַעֲשׂ֥וֹת אֹתֽוֹ **8** וַיִּקַּ֞ח
חֶמְאָ֣ה וְחָלָ֗ב וּבֶן־הַבָּקָר֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר עָשָׂ֔ה וַיִּתֵּ֖ן לִפְנֵיהֶ֑ם וְה֣וּא־עֹמֵ֤ד עֲלֵיהֶם֙ תַּ֣חַת הָעֵ֔ץ וַיֹּאכֵֽלוּ **9** וַיֹּ֥אמְרוּ
אֵלָ֖יו אַיֵּ֣ה שָׂרָ֣ה אִשְׁתֶּ֑ךָ וַיֹּ֖אמֶר הִנֵּ֥ה בָאֹֽהֶל **10** וַיֹּ֗אמֶר שׁ֤וֹב אָשׁוּב֙ אֵלֶ֔יךָ כָּעֵ֖ת חַיָּ֑ה וְהִנֵּה־בֵ֥ן לְשָׂרָ֖ה
אִשְׁתֶּ֥ךָ וְשָׂרָ֖ה שֹׁמַ֥עַת פֶּ֛תַח הָאֹ֖הֶל וְה֥וּא אַחֲרָ֑יו **11** וְאַבְרָהָ֣ם וְשָׂרָ֔ה זְקֵנִ֖ים בָּאִ֣ים בַּיָּמִ֑ים חָדַ֕ל לִֽהְיוֹת
לְשָׂרָ֖ה אֹ֥רַח כַּנָּשִֽׁים **12** וַתִּצְחַ֤ק שָׂרָה֙ בְּקִרְבָּ֔הּ לֵאמֹ֕ר אַחֲרֵ֥י בְלֹתִ֖י הָיְתָה־לִּ֣י עֶדְנָ֑ה וַאדֹנִ֖י זָקֵֽן **13**
וַיֹּ֥אמֶר יְהוָ֖ה אֶל־אַבְרָהָ֑ם לָמָּ֣ה זֶּ֗ה צָחֲקָ֤ה שָׂרָה֙ לֵאמֹ֔ר הַאַ֥ף אָמְנָ֖ם אֵלֵ֥ד וַאֲנִ֖י זָקַ֥נְתִּי **14** הֲיִפָּלֵ֥א מֵיְהוָ֖ה
דָּבָ֑ר לַמּוֹעֵד֙ אָשׁ֣וּב אֵלֶ֔יךָ כָּעֵ֖ת חַיָּ֑ה וּלְשָׂרָ֖ה בֵּֽן **15** וַתְּכַחֵ֥שׁ שָׂרָ֖ה לֵאמֹ֑ר לֹ֣א צָחַ֔קְתִּי כִּ֥י יָרֵ֖אָה וַיֹּ֕אמֶר
לֹ֣א כִ֔י צָחַ֖קְתְּ **16** וַיָּקֻ֣מוּ מִשָּׁ֔ם הָאֲנָשִׁ֖ים וַיַּשְׁקִפ֣וּ עַל־פְּנֵ֣י סְדֹ֑ם וְאַבְרָהָ֖ם הֹלֵ֥ךְ עִמָּ֖ם לְשַׁלְּחָֽם **17** וַיהוָ֖ה
אָמָ֑ר הֲמְכַסֶּ֣ה אֲנִ֤י מֵאַבְרָהָם֙ אֲשֶׁ֣ר אֲנִ֣י עֹשֶׂ֔ה **18** וְאַבְרָהָ֥ם הָיוֹ֙ יִהְיֶ֣ה לְגוֹי֔ גָּד֖וֹל וְעָצ֑וּם וְנִבְרְכ֥וּ בוֹ֖ כֹּ֥ל
גּוֹיֵ֥י הָאָֽרֶץ **19** כִּ֣י יְדַעְתִּ֔יו לְמַ֗עַן אֲשֶׁ֤ר יְצַוֶּה֙ אֶת־בָּנָ֣יו וְאֶת־בֵּיתוֹ֮ אַחֲרָיו֒ וְשָׁמְר֣וּ דֶּ֣רֶךְ יְהוָ֔ה לַעֲשׂ֥וֹת
צְדָקָ֖ה וּמִשְׁפָּ֑ט לְמַ֗עַן הָבִ֤יא יְהוָה֙ עַל־אַבְרָהָ֔ם אֵ֥ת אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּ֖ר עָלָֽיו **20** וַיֹּ֥אמֶר יְהוָ֖ה זַעֲקַ֣ת סְדֹ֑ם
וַעֲמֹרָ֖ה כִּי־רָבָ֥ה וְחַטָּאתָ֖ם כִּי כְבָדָ֥ה מְאֹֽד **21** אֵֽרְדָ֣ה־נָּ֔א וְאֶרְאֶ֕ה הַכְּצַעֲקָתָ֥הּ הַבָּאָ֖ה אֵלַ֑י עֲשֶׂ֣ה כָלָ֔ה
וְאִם־לֹ֖א אֵדָ֥עָה **22** וַיִּפְנ֤וּ מִשָּׁם֙ הָאֲנָשִׁ֔ים וַיֵּלְכ֖וּ סְדֹ֑מָה וְאַבְרָהָ֖ם עוֹדֶ֥נּוּ עֹמֵ֖ד לִפְנֵ֥י יְהוָֽה **23** וַיִּגַּ֣שׁ
אַבְרָהָ֔ם וַיֹּ֕אמֶר הַאַ֥ף תִּסְפֶּ֖ה צַדִּ֣יק עִם־רָשָֽׁע **24** אוּלַ֥י יֵ֛שׁ חֲמִשִּׁ֥ים צַדִּיקִ֖ם בְּת֣וֹךְ הָעִ֑יר הַאַ֥ף תִּסְפֶּ֛ה
וְלֹא־תִשָּׂ֥א לַמָּק֖וֹם לְמַ֣עַן חֲמִשִּׁ֣ים הַצַּדִּיקִ֔ם אֲשֶׁ֖ר בְּקִרְבָּֽהּ **25** חָלִ֣לָה לְךָ֔ מֵעֲשֹׂ֖ת כַּדָּבָ֣ר הַזֶּ֑ה לְהָמִ֥ית
צַדִּ֖יק עִם־רָשָׁ֑ע וְהָיָ֤ה כַצַּדִּיק֙ כָּרָשָׁ֔ע חָלִ֥לָה לָ֖ךְ הֲשֹׁפֵ֥ט כָּל־הָאָ֖רֶץ לֹ֥א יַעֲשֶׂ֖ה מִשְׁפָּֽט **26** וַיֹּ֣אמֶר יְהוָ֔ה
אִם־אֶמְצָ֥א בִסְדֹ֛ם חֲמִשִּׁ֥ים צַדִּיקִ֖ם בְּת֣וֹךְ הָעִ֑יר וְנָשָׂ֥אתִי לְכָל־הַמָּק֖וֹם בַּעֲבוּרָֽם **27** וַיַּ֥עַן אַבְרָהָ֖ם
וַיֹּ֣אמֶר הִנֵּה־נָ֗א הוֹאַלְתִּי֙ לְדַבֵּ֣ר אֶל־אֲדֹנָ֔י וְאָנֹכִ֥י עָפָ֖ר וָאֵֽפֶר **28** אוּלַ֣י יַחְסְר֣וּן חֲמִשִּׁ֗ים חֲמִשָּׁה֙
הַֽחֲמִשָּׁ֣ית בַּחֲמִשָּׁ֔ה אֶת־כָּל־הָעִ֖יר וַיֹּ֣אמֶר לֹ֣א אַשְׁחִ֑ית אִם־אֶמְצָ֥א שָׁ֛ם אַרְבָּעִ֥ים וַחֲמִשָּׁ֖ה **29** וַיֹּ֤סֶף עוֹד֙
לְדַבֵּ֣ר אֵלָ֔יו וַיֹּ֖אמֶר אוּלַ֣י יִמָּצְא֑וּן שָׁ֚ם אַרְבָּעִ֔ים וַיֹּ֕אמֶר לֹ֥א אֶעֱשֶׂ֖ה בַּעֲב֥וּר הָאַרְבָּעִֽים **30** וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אַל־
נָ֣א יִחַ֔ר לַאדֹנָ֖י וַאֲדַבֵּ֑רָה אוּלַ֣י יִמָּצְא֔וּן שָׁ֖ם שְׁלֹשִׁ֑ים וַיֹּ֕אמֶר לֹ֥א אֶעֱשֶׂ֖ה אִם־אֶמְצָ֥א שָׁ֖ם שְׁלֹשִֽׁים **31**
וַיֹּ֣אמֶר הִנֵּה־נָ֗א הוֹאַלְתִּי֙ לְדַבֵּ֣ר אֶל־אֲדֹנָ֔י אוּלַ֣י יִמָּצְא֔וּן שָׁ֖ם עֶשְׂרִ֑ים וַיֹּ֕אמֶר לֹ֥א אַשְׁחִ֖ית בַּעֲב֥וּר
הָעֶשְׂרִֽים **32** וַיֹּ֣אמֶר אַל־נָ֣א יִחַ֔ר לַאדֹנָ֖י וַאֲדַבְּרָ֣ה אַ֑ךְ־הַפַּ֣עַם אוּלַ֣י יִמָּצְא֔וּן שָׁ֖ם עֲשָׂרָ֑ה וַיֹּ֕אמֶר לֹ֥א
אַשְׁחִ֖ית בַּעֲב֥וּר הָעֲשָׂרָֽה **33** וַיֵּ֤לֶךְ יְהוָה֙ כַּאֲשֶׁ֣ר כִּלָּ֔ה לְדַבֵּ֖ר אֶל־אַבְרָהָ֑ם וְאַבְרָהָ֖ם שָׁ֥ב לִמְקֹמֽוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the LORD appeared to Abraham by the Oaks of Mamre in the heat of the day, while he was sitting at the entrance of his tent. **2** And Abraham looked up and saw three men standing nearby. When he saw them, he ran from the entrance of his tent to meet them and bowed low to the ground. **3** “My lord,” said Abraham, “if I have found favor in your sight, please do not pass your

servant by. **4** Let a little water be brought, that you may wash your feet and
rest yourselves under the tree. **5** And I will bring a bit of bread so that you
may refresh yourselves. This is why you have passed your servant's way. After
that, you may continue on your way." "Yes," they replied, "you may do as you
have said." **6** So Abraham hurried into the tent and said to Sarah, "Quick!
Prepare three seahs of fine flour, knead it, and bake some bread." **7**
Meanwhile, Abraham ran to the herd, selected a tender and choice calf, and
gave it to a servant, who hurried to prepare it. **8** Then Abraham brought curds
and milk and the calf that had been prepared, and he set them before the men
and stood by them under the tree as they ate. **9** "Where is your wife Sarah?"
they asked. "There, in the tent," he replied. **10** Then the LORD said, "I will
surely return to you at this time next year, and your wife Sarah will have a
son!" Now Sarah was behind him, listening at the entrance to the tent. **11** And
Abraham and Sarah were already old and well along in years; Sarah had
passed the age of childbearing. **12** So she laughed to herself, saying, "After I
am worn out and my master is old, will I now have this pleasure?" **13** And the
LORD asked Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh and say, 'Can I really bear a child
when I am old?' **14** Is anything too difficult for the LORD? At the appointed
time I will return to you—in about a year—and Sarah will have a son." **15** But
Sarah was afraid, so she denied it and said, "I did not laugh." "No," replied the
LORD, "but you did laugh." **16** When the men got up to leave, they looked out
over Sodom, and Abraham walked along with them to see them off. **17** And the
LORD said, "Shall I hide from Abraham what I am about to do? **18** Abraham
will surely become a great and powerful nation, and through him all the
nations of the earth will be blessed. **19** For I have chosen him, so that he will
command his children and his household after him to keep the way of the
LORD by doing what is right and just, in order that the LORD may bring upon
Abraham what He has promised." **20** Then the LORD said, "The outcry against
Sodom and Gomorrah is great. Because their sin is so grievous, **21** I will go
down to see if their actions fully justify the outcry that has reached Me. If not,
I will find out." **22** And the two men turned away and went toward Sodom, but
Abraham remained standing before the LORD. **23** Abraham stepped forward
and said, "Will You really sweep away the righteous with the wicked? **24** What
if there are fifty righteous ones in the city? Will You really sweep it away and
not spare the place for the sake of the fifty righteous ones who are there? **25**
Far be it from You to do such a thing—to kill the righteous with the wicked, so
that the righteous and the wicked are treated alike. Far be it from You! Will
not the Judge of all the earth do what is right?" **26** So the LORD replied, "If I
find fifty righteous ones within the city of Sodom, on their account I will spare
the whole place." **27** Then Abraham answered, "Now that I have ventured to
speak to the Lord—though I am but dust and ashes— **28** suppose the fifty
righteous ones lack five. Will You destroy the whole city for the lack of five?"
He replied, "If I find forty-five there, I will not destroy it." **29** Once again
Abraham spoke to the LORD, "Suppose forty are found there?" He answered,
"On account of the forty, I will not do it." **30** Then Abraham said, "May the

Lord not be angry, but let me speak further. Suppose thirty are found there?" He replied, "If I find thirty there, I will not do it." **31** And Abraham said, "Now that I have ventured to speak to the Lord, suppose twenty are found there?" He answered, "On account of the twenty, I will not destroy it." **32** Finally, Abraham said, "May the Lord not be angry, but let me speak once more. Suppose ten are found there?" And He answered, "On account of the ten, I will not destroy it." **33** When the LORD had finished speaking with Abraham, He departed, and Abraham returned home.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD appeared to him by the oaks of Mamre, as he sat in the tent door in the heat of the day. **2** He lifted up his eyes and looked, and saw that three men stood near him. When he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed himself to the earth, **3** and said, "My lord, if now I have found favor in your sight, please don't go away from your servant. **4** Now let a little water be fetched, wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree. **5** I will get a piece of bread so you can refresh your heart. After that you may go your way, now that you have come to your servant." They said, "Very well, do as you have said." **6** Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah, and said, "Quickly prepare three seahs of fine meal, knead it, and make cakes." **7** Abraham ran to the herd, and fetched a tender and good calf, and gave it to the servant. He hurried to dress it. **8** He took butter, milk, and the calf which he had dressed, and set it before them. He stood by them under the tree, and they ate. **9** They asked him, "Where is Sarah, your wife?" He said, "There, in the tent." **10** He said, "I will certainly return to you at about this time next year; and behold, Sarah your wife will have a son." Sarah heard in the tent door, which was behind him. **11** Now Abraham and Sarah were old, well advanced in age. Sarah had passed the age of childbearing. **12** Sarah laughed within herself, saying, "After I have grown old will I have pleasure, my lord being old also?" **13** The LORD said to Abraham, "Why did Sarah laugh, saying, 'Will I really bear a child when I am old?' **14** Is anything too hard for the LORD? At the set time I will return to you, when the season comes around, and Sarah will have a son." **15** Then Sarah denied it, saying, "I didn't laugh," for she was afraid. He said, "No, but you did laugh." **16** The men rose up from there, and looked toward Sodom. Abraham went with them to see them on their way. **17** The LORD said, "Will I hide from Abraham what I do, **18** since Abraham will surely become a great and mighty nation, and all the nations of the earth will be blessed in him? **19** For I have known him, to the end that he may command his children and his household after him, that they may keep the way of the LORD, to do righteousness and justice; to the end that the LORD may bring on Abraham that which he has spoken of him." **20** The LORD said, "Because the cry of Sodom and Gomorrah is great, and because their sin is very grievous, **21** I will go down now, and see whether their deeds are as bad as the reports which have come to me. If not, I will know." **22** The men turned from there,

and went toward Sodom, but Abraham stood yet before the LORD. **23** Abraham came near, and said, “Will you consume the righteous with the wicked? **24** What if there are fifty righteous within the city? Will you consume and not spare the place for the fifty righteous who are in it? **25** May it be far from you to do things like that, to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous should be like the wicked. May that be far from you. Shouldn’t the Judge of all the earth do right?” **26** The LORD said, “If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, then I will spare the whole place for their sake.” **27** Abraham answered, “See now, I have taken it on myself to speak to the Lord, although I am dust and ashes. **28** What if there will lack five of the fifty righteous? Will you destroy all the city for lack of five?” He said, “I will not destroy it if I find forty-five there.” **29** He spoke to him yet again, and said, “What if there are forty found there?” He said, “I will not do it for the forty’s sake.” **30** He said, “Oh don’t let the Lord be angry, and I will speak. What if there are thirty found there?” He said, “I will not do it if I find thirty there.” **31** He said, “See now, I have taken it on myself to speak to the Lord. What if there are twenty found there?” He said, “I will not destroy it for the twenty’s sake.” **32** He said, “Oh don’t let the Lord be angry, and I will speak just once more. What if ten are found there?” He said, “I will not destroy it for the ten’s sake.” **33** The LORD went his way as soon as he had finished communing with Abraham, and Abraham returned to his place.

### Genesis 19

Printed in full in the Historical Introduction: see Genesis 19.

### Exodus 14:30

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**30** וַיּוֹשַׁע יְהוָה בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל מִיַּד מִצְרָיִם וַיַּרְא יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־מִצְרַיִם מֵת עַל־שְׂפַת הַיָּם

*English (BSB)*

**30** That day the LORD saved Israel from the hand of the Egyptians, and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the shore.

*English (WEB)*

**30** Thus the LORD saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the seashore.

### Exodus 23:20–21

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**20** הִנֵּה אָנֹכִי שֹׁלֵחַ מַלְאָךְ לְפָנֶיךָ לִשְׁמָרְךָ בַּדָּרֶךְ וְלַהֲבִיאֲךָ אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר הֲכִנֹתִי **21** הִשָּׁמֶר מִפָּנָיו
וּשְׁמַע בְּקֹלוֹ אַל־תַּמֵּר בּוֹ כִּי לֹא יִשָּׂא לְפִשְׁעֲכֶם כִּי שְׁמִי בְּקִרְבּוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**20** Behold, I am sending an angel before you to protect you along the way and to bring you to the place I have prepared. **21** Pay attention to him and listen to his voice; do not defy him, for he will not forgive rebellion, since My Name is in him.

*English (WEB)*

**20** “Behold, I send an angel before you, to keep you by the way, and to bring you into the place which I have prepared. **21** Pay attention to him, and listen to his voice. Don’t provoke him, for he will not pardon your disobedience, for my name is in him.

### Leviticus 18:22

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**22** וְאֶת־זָכָר לֹא תִשְׁכַּב מִשְׁכְּבֵי אִשָּׁה תּוֹעֵבָה הִוא

*English (BSB)*

**22** You must not lie with a man as with a woman; that is an abomination.

*English (WEB)*

**22** “’You shall not lie with a man as with a woman. That is detestable.

### Numbers 14:11, 29

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**11** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה עַד־אָנָה יְנַאֲצֵנִי הָעָם הַזֶּה וְעַד־אָנָה לֹא־יַאֲמִינוּ בִי בְּכֹל הָאֹתוֹת אֲשֶׁר
עָשִׂיתִי בְּקִרְבּוֹ … **29** בַּמִּדְבָּר הַזֶּה יִפְּלוּ פִגְרֵיכֶם וְכָל־פְּקֻדֵיכֶם לְכָל־מִסְפַּרְכֶם מִבֶּן עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה
וָמָעְלָה אֲשֶׁר הֲלִינֹתֶם עָלָי

*English (BSB)*

**11** And the LORD said to Moses, “How long will this people treat Me with contempt? How long will they refuse to believe in Me, despite all the signs I have performed among them? … **29** Your bodies will fall in this wilderness—all who were numbered in the census, everyone twenty years of age or older—because you have grumbled against Me.

*English (WEB)*

**11** The LORD said to Moses, “How long will this people despise me? How long will they not believe in me, for all the signs which I have worked among them? … **29** Your dead bodies shall fall in this wilderness; and all who were counted of you, according to your whole number, from twenty years old and upward, who have complained against me,

## Deuteronomy 29:23

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**23 [29:22]** גָּפְרִית וָמֶלַח שְׂרֻפָה כָל־אַרְצָהּ לֹא תִזָּרַע וְלֹא תַצְמִחַ וְלֹא־יַעֲלֶה בָהּ כָּל־עֵשֶׂב כְּמַהְפֵּכַת סְדֹם וַעֲמֹרָה אַדְמָה וּצְבוֹיִם אֲשֶׁר הָפַךְ יְהוָה בְּאַפּוֹ וּבַחֲמָתוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**23** All its soil will be a burning waste of sulfur and salt, unsown and unproductive, with no plant growing on it, just like the destruction of Sodom and Gomorrah, Admah and Zeboiim, which the LORD overthrew in His fierce anger.

*English (WEB)*

**23** that all of its land is sulfur, salt, and burning, that it is not sown, doesn’t produce, nor does any grass grow in it, like the overthrow of Sodom, Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboiim, which the LORD overthrew in his anger, and in his wrath.

## Psalm 95

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** לְכוּ נְרַנְּנָה לַיהוָה נָרִיעָה לְצוּר יִשְׁעֵנוּ **2** נְקַדְּמָה פָנָיו בְּתוֹדָה בִּזְמִרוֹת נָרִיעַ לוֹ **3** כִּי אֵל גָּדוֹל יְהוָה וּמֶלֶךְ גָּדוֹל עַל־כָּל־אֱלֹהִים **4** אֲשֶׁר בְּיָדוֹ מֶחְקְרֵי־אָרֶץ וְתוֹעֲפוֹת הָרִים לוֹ **5** אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ הַיָּם וְהוּא עָשָׂהוּ וְיַבֶּשֶׁת יָדָיו יָצָרוּ **6** בֹּאוּ נִשְׁתַּחֲוֶה וְנִכְרָעָה נְבָרְכָה לִפְנֵי־יְהוָה עֹשֵׂנוּ **7** כִּי הוּא אֱלֹהֵינוּ וַאֲנַחְנוּ עַם מַרְעִיתוֹ וְצֹאן יָדוֹ הַיּוֹם אִם־בְּקֹלוֹ תִשְׁמָעוּ **8** אַל־תַּקְשׁוּ לְבַבְכֶם כִּמְרִיבָה כְּיוֹם מַסָּה בַּמִּדְבָּר **9** אֲשֶׁר נִסּוּנִי אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם בְּחָנוּנִי גַּם־רָאוּ פָּעֳלִי **10** אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה אָקוּט בְּדוֹר וָאֹמַר עַם תֹּעֵי לֵבָב הֵם וְהֵם לֹא־יָדְעוּ דְרָכָי **11** אֲשֶׁר־נִשְׁבַּעְתִּי בְאַפִּי אִם־יְבֹאוּן אֶל־מְנוּחָתִי

*English (BSB)*

**1** Come, let us sing for joy to the LORD; let us shout to the Rock of our salvation! **2** Let us enter His presence with thanksgiving; let us make a joyful noise to Him in song. **3** For the LORD is a great God, a great King above all gods. **4** In His hand are the depths of the earth, and the mountain peaks belong to Him. **5** The sea is His, for He made it, and His hands formed the dry

land. **6** O come, let us worship and bow down; let us kneel before the LORD our Maker. **7** For He is our God, and we are the people of His pasture, the sheep under His care. Today, if you hear His voice, **8** do not harden your hearts as you did at Meribah, in the day at Massah in the wilderness, **9** where your fathers tested and tried Me, though they had seen My work. **10** For forty years I was angry with that generation, and I said, “They are a people whose hearts go astray, and they have not known My ways.” **11** So I swore on oath in My anger, “They shall never enter My rest.”

*English (WEB)*

**1** Oh come, let’s sing to the LORD. Let’s shout aloud to the rock of our salvation! **2** Let’s come before his presence with thanksgiving. Let’s extol him with songs! **3** For the LORD is a great God, a great King above all gods. **4** In his hand are the deep places of the earth. The heights of the mountains are also his. **5** The sea is his, and he made it. His hands formed the dry land. **6** Oh come, let’s worship and bow down. Let’s kneel before the LORD, our Maker, **7** for he is our God. We are the people of his pasture, and the sheep in his care. Today, oh that you would hear his voice! **8** Don’t harden your heart, as at Meribah, as in the day of Massah in the wilderness, **9** when your fathers tempted me, tested me, and saw my work. **10** Forty long years I was grieved with that generation, and said, “They are a people who err in their heart. They have not known my ways.” **11** Therefore I swore in my wrath, “They won’t enter into my rest.”

## Isaiah 1:10

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**10** שִׁמְעוּ דְבַר־יְהוָה קְצִינֵי סְדֹם הַאֲזִינוּ תּוֹרַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ עַם עֲמֹרָה

*English (BSB)*

**10** Hear the word of the LORD, you rulers of Sodom; listen to the instruction of our God, you people of Gomorrah!

*English (WEB)*

**10** Hear the LORD’s word, you rulers of Sodom! Listen to the law of our God, you people of Gomorrah!

## Jeremiah 23:14

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**14** וּבִנְבִאֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם רָאִיתִי שַׁעֲרוּרָה נָאוֹף וְהָלֹךְ בַּשָּׁקֶר וְחִזְּקוּ יְדֵי מְרֵעִים לְבִלְתִּי־שָׁבוּ אִישׁ מֵרָעָתוֹ
הָיוּ־לִי כֻלָּם כִּסְדֹם וְיֹשְׁבֶיהָ כַּעֲמֹרָה

*English (BSB)*

**14** And among the prophets of Jerusalem I have seen a horrible thing: They commit adultery and walk in lies. They strengthen the hands of evildoers, so that no one turns his back on wickedness. They are all like Sodom to Me; the people of Jerusalem are like Gomorrah.”

*English (WEB)*

**14** In the prophets of Jerusalem I have also seen a horrible thing: they commit adultery and walk in lies. They strengthen the hands of evildoers, so that no one returns from his wickedness. They have all become to me as Sodom, and its inhabitants as Gomorrah.”

### Ezekiel 16:49–50

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**49** הִנֵּה־זֶה הָיָה עֲוֹן סְדֹם אֲחוֹתֵךְ גְּאוֹן שִׂבְעַת־לֶחֶם וְשַׁלְוַת הַשְׁקֵט הָיָה לָהּ וְלִבְנוֹתֶיהָ וְיַד־עָנִי
וְאֶבְיוֹן לֹא הֶחֱזִיקָה **50** וַתִּגְבְּהֶינָה וַתַּעֲשֶׂינָה תוֹעֵבָה לְפָנָי וָאָסִיר אֹתָהֶן כַּאֲשֶׁר רָאִיתִי

*English (BSB)*

**49** Now this was the iniquity of your sister Sodom: She and her daughters were arrogant, overfed, and complacent; they did not help the poor and needy. **50** Thus they were haughty and committed abominations before Me. Therefore I removed them, as you have seen.

*English (WEB)*

**49** “’“Behold, this was the iniquity of your sister Sodom: pride, fullness of bread, and prosperous ease was in her and in her daughters. She also didn’t strengthen the hand of the poor and needy. **50** They were arrogant and committed abomination before me. Therefore I took them away when I saw it.

### Hosea 11:8

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** אֵיךְ אֶתֶּנְךָ אֶפְרַיִם אֲמַגֶּנְךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל אֵיךְ אֶתֶּנְךָ כְּאַדְמָה אֲשִׂימְךָ כִּצְבֹאִים נֶהְפַּךְ עָלַי לִבִּי יַחַד נִכְמְרוּ
נִחוּמָי

*English (BSB)*

**8** How could I give you up, O Ephraim? How could I surrender you, O Israel? How could I make you like Admah? How could I treat you like Zeboiim? My heart is turned within Me; My compassion is stirred!

*English (WEB)*

**8** “How can I give you up, Ephraim? How can I hand you over, Israel? How can I make you like Admah? How can I make you like Zeboiim? My heart is turned within me, my compassion is aroused.

### Sirach 16:7–8

*Greek (Septuagint, as printed in Brenton’s edition, public domain)*

**7** Οὐκ ἐξιλάσατο περὶ τῶν ἀρχαίων γιγάντων, οἳ ἀπέστησαν τῇ ἰσχύϊ αὐτῶν. **8** Οὐκ ἐφείσατο περὶ τῆς παροικίας Λὼτ, οὓς ἐβδελύξατο διὰ τὴν ὑπερηφανίαν αὐτῶν.

*English (Brenton, 1844)*

**7** He was not pacified toward the old giants, who fell away in the strength of their foolishness. **8** Neither spared he the place where Lot sojourned, but abhorred them for their pride.

### Wisdom of Solomon 10:7

*Greek (Septuagint, as printed in Brenton’s edition, public domain)*

**7** οἷς ἐτὶ μαρτύριον τῆς πονηρίας καπνιζομένη καθέστηκε χέρσος, καὶ ἀτελέσιν ὥραις καρποφοροῦντα φυτά· ἀπιστοῦσης ψυχῆς μνημεῖον ἑστηκυῖα στήλη ἁλός.

*English (Brenton, 1844)*

**7** Of whose wickedness, even to this day the waste land that smoketh is a testimony, and plants bearing fruit that never come to ripeness: and a standing pillar of salt is a monument of an unbelieving soul.

### 3 Maccabees 2:4–5

*Greek (Septuagint, as printed in Brenton’s edition, public domain)*

**4** Σὺ τοὺς ἔμπροσθεν ἀδικίαν ποιήσαντας, ἐν οἷς καὶ γίγαντες ἦσαν ῥώμῃ καὶ θράσει πεποιθότες, διέφθειρας, ἐπαγαγὼν αὐτοῖς ἀμέτρητον ὕδωρ. **5** Σὺ τοὺς ὑπερηφανίαν ἐργαζομένους Σοδομίτας, αιαδήλους ταῖς κακίαις γενομένους, πυρὶ καὶ θείῳ κατέφλεξας, παράδειγμα τοῖς ἐπιγινομένοις καταστήσας.

*English (Brenton, 1844)*

**4** It was thou who didst destroy the former workers of unrighteousness, among whom were the giants, who trusted in their strength and hardihood, by covering them with a measureless flood. **5** It was thou who didst make the Sodomites, those workers of exceeding iniquity, men notorious for their vices, an example to after generations, when thou didst consume them with fire and brimstone.

## Matthew 10:15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** ἀμὴν λέγω ὑμῖν, ἀνεκτότερον ἔσται γῇ Σοδόμων καὶ Γομόρρων ἐν ἡμέρᾳ κρίσεως ἢ τῇ πόλει ἐκείνῃ.

*English (BSB)*

**15** Truly I tell you, it will be more bearable for Sodom and Gomorrah on the day of judgment than for that town.

*English (WEB)*

**15** Most certainly I tell you, it will be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrah in the day of judgment than for that city.

## Matthew 25:41

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**41** τότε ἐρεῖ καὶ τοῖς ἐξ εὐωνύμων· Πορεύεσθε ἀπ᾽ ἐμοῦ οἱ κατηραμένοι εἰς τὸ πῦρ τὸ αἰώνιον τὸ ἡτοιμασμένον τῷ διαβόλῳ καὶ τοῖς ἀγγέλοις αὐτοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**41** Then He will say to those on His left, ’Depart from Me, you who are cursed, into the eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels.

*English (WEB)*

**41** Then he will say also to those on the left hand, ’Depart from me, you cursed, into the eternal fire which is prepared for the devil and his angels;

## Luke 17:29

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**29** ᾗ δὲ ἡμέρᾳ ἐξῆλθεν Λὼτ ἀπὸ Σοδόμων, ἔβρεξεν πῦρ καὶ θεῖον ἀπ᾽ οὐρανοῦ καὶ ἀπώλεσεν πάντας.

*English (BSB)*

**29** But on the day Lot left Sodom, fire and sulfur rained down from heaven and destroyed them all.

*English (WEB)*

**29** but in the day that Lot went out from Sodom, it rained fire and sulfur from the sky and destroyed them all.

## John 1:1–3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἐν ἀρχῇ ἦν ὁ λόγος, καὶ ὁ λόγος ἦν πρὸς τὸν θεόν, καὶ θεὸς ἦν ὁ λόγος. **2** οὗτος ἦν ἐν ἀρχῇ πρὸς τὸν θεόν. **3** πάντα δι᾽ αὐτοῦ ἐγένετο, καὶ χωρὶς αὐτοῦ ἐγένετο οὐδὲ ἕν. ὃ γέγονεν

*English (BSB)*

**1** In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. **2** He was with God in the beginning. **3** Through Him all things were made, and without Him nothing was made that has been made.

*English (WEB)*

**1** In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. **2** The same was in the beginning with God. **3** All things were made through him. Without him, nothing was made that has been made.

## John 8:58

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**58** εἶπεν αὐτοῖς Ἰησοῦς· Ἀμὴν ἀμὴν λέγω ὑμῖν, πρὶν Ἀβραὰμ γενέσθαι ἐγὼ εἰμί.

*English (BSB)*

**58** “Truly, truly, I tell you,” Jesus declared, “before Abraham was born, I am!”

*English (WEB)*

**58** Jesus said to them, “Most certainly, I tell you, before Abraham came into existence, I AM.”

## John 12:41

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**41** ταῦτα εἶπεν Ἡσαΐας ὅτι εἶδεν τὴν δόξαν αὐτοῦ, καὶ ἐλάλησεν περὶ αὐτοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**41** Isaiah said these things because he saw Jesus’ glory and spoke about Him.

*English (WEB)*

**41** Isaiah said these things when he saw his glory, and spoke of him.

## Romans 1:20, 26–27

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** τὰ γὰρ ἀόρατα αὐτοῦ ἀπὸ κτίσεως κόσμου τοῖς ποιήμασιν νοούμενα καθορᾶται, ἥ τε ἀΐδιος αὐτοῦ δύναμις καὶ θειότης, εἰς τὸ εἶναι αὐτοὺς ἀναπολογήτους, … **26** Διὰ τοῦτο παρέδωκεν αὐτοὺς ὁ θεὸς εἰς πάθη ἀτιμίας· αἵ τε γὰρ θήλειαι αὐτῶν μετήλλαξαν τὴν φυσικὴν χρῆσιν εἰς τὴν παρὰ φύσιν, **27** ὁμοίως τε καὶ οἱ ἄρσενες ἀφέντες τὴν φυσικὴν χρῆσιν τῆς θηλείας ἐξεκαύθησαν ἐν τῇ ὀρέξει αὐτῶν εἰς ἀλλήλους, ἄρσενες ἐν ἄρσεσιν τὴν ἀσχημοσύνην κατεργαζόμενοι καὶ τὴν ἀντιμισθίαν ἣν ἔδει τῆς πλάνης αὐτῶν ἐν ἑαυτοῖς ἀπολαμβάνοντες.

*English (BSB)*

**20** For since the creation of the world God’s invisible qualities, His eternal power and divine nature, have been clearly seen, being understood from His workmanship, so that men are without excuse. … **26** For this reason God gave them over to dishonorable passions. Even their women exchanged natural relations for unnatural ones. **27** Likewise, the men abandoned natural relations with women and burned with lust for one another. Men committed indecent acts with other men, and received in themselves the due penalty for their error.

*English (WEB)*

**20** For the invisible things of him since the creation of the world are clearly seen, being perceived through the things that are made, even his everlasting power and divinity, that they may be without excuse. ... **26** For this reason, God gave them up to vile passions. For their women changed the natural function into that which is against nature. **27** Likewise also the men, leaving the natural function of the woman, burned in their lust toward one another, men doing what is inappropriate with men, and receiving in themselves the due penalty of their error.

## Romans 8:38

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**38** πέπεισμαι γὰρ ὅτι οὔτε θάνατος οὔτε ζωὴ οὔτε ἄγγελοι οὔτε ἀρχαὶ οὔτε ἐνεστῶτα οὔτε μέλλοντα οὔτε δυνάμεις

*English (BSB)*

**38** For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers,

*English (WEB)*

**38** For I am persuaded that neither death, nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor things present, nor things to come, nor powers,

## 1 Corinthians 10:1, 3–5, 9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Οὐ θέλω γὰρ ὑμᾶς ἀγνοεῖν, ἀδελφοί, ὅτι οἱ πατέρες ἡμῶν πάντες ὑπὸ τὴν νεφέλην ἦσαν καὶ πάντες διὰ τῆς θαλάσσης διῆλθον, … **3** καὶ πάντες τὸ αὐτὸ πνευματικὸν βρῶμα ἔφαγον **4** καὶ πάντες τὸ αὐτὸ πνευματικὸν ἔπιον πόμα, ἔπινον γὰρ ἐκ πνευματικῆς ἀκολουθούσης πέτρας, ἡ πέτρα δὲ ἦν ὁ Χριστός· **5** ἀλλ᾽ οὐκ ἐν τοῖς πλείοσιν αὐτῶν ηὐδόκησεν ὁ θεός, κατεστρώθησαν γὰρ ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ. … **9** μηδὲ ἐκπειράζωμεν τὸν Χριστόν, καθώς τινες αὐτῶν ἐπείρασαν, καὶ ὑπὸ τῶν ὄφεων ἀπώλλυντο.

*English (BSB)*

**1** I do not want you to be unaware, brothers, that our forefathers were all under the cloud, and that they all passed through the sea. … **3** They all ate the same spiritual food **4** and drank the same spiritual drink; for they drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ. **5** Nevertheless, God was not pleased with most of them, for they were struck down in the wilderness. … **9** We should not test Christ, as some of them did, and were killed by snakes.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now I would not have you ignorant, brothers, that our fathers were all under the cloud, and all passed through the sea; … **3** and all ate the same spiritual food; **4** and all drank the same spiritual drink. For they drank of a spiritual rock that followed them, and the rock was Christ. **5** However with most of them, God was not well pleased, for they were overthrown in the wilderness. … **9** Let’s not test Christ, as some of them tested, and perished by the serpents.

## 2 Corinthians 5:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** καὶ γὰρ ἐν τούτῳ στενάζομεν, τὸ οἰκητήριον ἡμῶν τὸ ἐξ οὐρανοῦ ἐπενδύσασθαι ἐπιποθοῦντες,

*English (BSB)*

**2** For in this tent we groan, longing to be clothed with our heavenly dwelling,

*English (WEB)*

**2** For most certainly in this we groan, longing to be clothed with our habitation which is from heaven,

## Ephesians 6:12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**12** ὅτι οὐκ ἔστιν ἡμῖν ἡ πάλη πρὸς αἷμα καὶ σάρκα, ἀλλὰ πρὸς τὰς ἀρχάς, πρὸς τὰς ἐξουσίας, πρὸς τοὺς κοσμοκράτορας τοῦ σκότους τούτου, πρὸς τὰ πνευματικὰ τῆς πονηρίας ἐν τοῖς ἐπουρανίοις.

*English (BSB)*

**12** For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this world's darkness, and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms.

*English (WEB)*

**12** For our wrestling is not against flesh and blood, but against the principalities, against the powers, against the world's rulers of the darkness of this age, and against the spiritual forces of wickedness in the heavenly places.

## Philippians 2:6–7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** ὃς ἐν μορφῇ θεοῦ ὑπάρχων οὐχ ἁρπαγμὸν ἡγήσατο τὸ εἶναι ἴσα θεῷ, **7** ἀλλὰ ἑαυτὸν ἐκένωσεν μορφὴν δούλου λαβών, ἐν ὁμοιώματι ἀνθρώπων γενόμενος· καὶ σχήματι εὑρεθεὶς ὡς ἄνθρωπος

*English (BSB)*

**6** Who, existing in the form of God, did not consider equality with God something to be grasped, **7** but emptied Himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in human likeness.

*English (WEB)*

**6** who, existing in the form of God, didn't consider equality with God a thing to be grasped, **7** but emptied himself, taking the form of a servant, being made in the likeness of men.

## Colossians 1:15–17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** ὅς ἐστιν εἰκὼν τοῦ θεοῦ τοῦ ἀοράτου, πρωτότοκος πάσης κτίσεως, **16** ὅτι ἐν αὐτῷ ἐκτίσθη τὰ πάντα ἐν τοῖς οὐρανοῖς καὶ ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς, τὰ ὁρατὰ καὶ τὰ ἀόρατα, εἴτε θρόνοι εἴτε κυριότητες εἴτε ἀρχαὶ εἴτε ἐξουσίαι· τὰ πάντα δι' αὐτοῦ καὶ εἰς αὐτὸν ἔκτισται· **17** καὶ αὐτός ἐστιν πρὸ πάντων καὶ τὰ πάντα ἐν αὐτῷ συνέστηκεν,

*English (BSB)*

**15** The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation. **16** For in Him all things were created, things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities. All things were created through Him and for Him. **17** He is before all things, and in Him all things hold together.

*English (WEB)*

**15** He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn of all creation. **16** For by him all things were created in the heavens and on the earth, visible things and invisible things, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers. All things have been created through him and for him. **17** He is before all things, and in him all things are held together.

## Hebrews 1:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** ἐπ᾽ ἐσχάτου τῶν ἡμερῶν τούτων ἐλάλησεν ἡμῖν ἐν υἱῷ, ὃν ἔθηκεν κληρονόμον πάντων, δι᾽ οὗ καὶ ἐποίησεν τοὺς αἰῶνας·

*English (BSB)*

**2** But in these last days He has spoken to us by His Son, whom He appointed heir of all things, and through whom He made the universe.

*English (WEB)*

**2** has at the end of these days spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed heir of all things, through whom also he made the worlds.

## Hebrews 3:16–19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** τίνες γὰρ ἀκούσαντες παρεπίκραναν; ἀλλ᾽ οὐ πάντες οἱ ἐξελθόντες ἐξ Αἰγύπτου διὰ Μωϋσέως; **17** τίσιν δὲ προσώχθισεν τεσσεράκοντα ἔτη; οὐχὶ τοῖς ἁμαρτήσασιν, ὧν τὰ κῶλα ἔπεσεν ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ; **18** τίσιν δὲ ὤμοσεν μὴ εἰσελεύσεσθαι εἰς τὴν κατάπαυσιν αὐτοῦ εἰ μὴ τοῖς ἀπειθήσασιν; **19** καὶ βλέπομεν ὅτι οὐκ ἠδυνήθησαν εἰσελθεῖν δι᾽ ἀπιστίαν.

*English (BSB)*

**16** For who were the ones who heard and rebelled? Were they not all those Moses led out of Egypt? **17** And with whom was God angry for forty years? Was it not with those who sinned, whose bodies fell in the wilderness? **18** And to whom did He swear that they would never enter His rest? Was it not to those who disobeyed? **19** So we see that it was because of their unbelief that they were unable to enter.

*English (WEB)*

**16** For who, when they heard, rebelled? Wasn't it all those who came out of Egypt led by Moses? **17** With whom was he displeased forty years? Wasn't it with those who sinned, whose bodies fell in the wilderness? **18** To whom did he swear that they wouldn't enter into his rest, but to those who were disobedient? **19** We see that they weren't able to enter in because of unbelief.

### Hebrews 12:18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** Οὐ γὰρ προσεληλύθατε ψηλαφωμένῳ καὶ κεκαυμένῳ πυρὶ καὶ γνόφῳ καὶ ζόφῳ καὶ θυέλλῃ

*English (BSB)*

**18** For you have not come to a mountain that can be touched and that is burning with fire; to darkness, gloom, and storm;

*English (WEB)*

**18** For you have not come to a mountain that might be touched and that burned with fire, and to blackness, darkness, storm,

### 1 Peter 3:19–20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** ἐν ᾧ καὶ τοῖς ἐν φυλακῇ πνεύμασιν πορευθεὶς ἐκήρυξεν, **20** ἀπειθήσασίν ποτε ὅτε ἀπεξεδέχετο ἡ τοῦ θεοῦ μακροθυμία ἐν ἡμέραις Νῶε κατασκευαζομένης κιβωτοῦ εἰς ἣν ὀλίγοι, τοῦτ' ἔστιν ὀκτὼ ψυχαί, διεσώθησαν δι' ὕδατος.

*English (BSB)*

**19** in whom He also went and preached to the spirits in prison **20** who disobeyed long ago when God waited patiently in the days of Noah while the ark was being built. In the ark a few people, only eight souls, were saved through water.

*English (WEB)*

**19** in whom he also went and preached to the spirits in prison, **20** who before were disobedient when God waited patiently in the days of Noah while the ship was being built. In it, few, that is, eight souls, were saved through water.

### 2 Peter 1:12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**12** Διὸ μελλήσω ἀεὶ ὑμᾶς ὑπομιμνῄσκειν περὶ τούτων, καίπερ εἰδότας καὶ ἐστηριγμένους ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ἀληθείᾳ.

*English (BSB)*

**12** Therefore I will always remind you of these things, even though you know them and are established in the truth you now have.

*English (WEB)*

**12** Therefore I will not be negligent to remind you of these things, though you know them and are established in the present truth.

## 2 Peter 2:4, 6, 9, 17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** Εἰ γὰρ ὁ θεὸς ἀγγέλων ἁμαρτησάντων οὐκ ἐφείσατο, ἀλλὰ σειραῖς ζόφου ταρταρώσας παρέδωκεν εἰς κρίσιν τηρουμένους, … **6** καὶ πόλεις Σοδόμων καὶ Γομόρρας τεφρώσας καταστροφῇ κατέκρινεν, ὑπόδειγμα μελλόντων ἀσεβέσιν τεθεικώς, … **9** οἶδεν κύριος εὐσεβεῖς ἐκ πειρασμοῦ ῥύεσθαι, ἀδίκους δὲ εἰς ἡμέραν κρίσεως κολαζομένους τηρεῖν, … **17** Οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται.

*English (BSB)*

**4** For if God did not spare the angels when they sinned, but cast them deep into hell, placing them in chains of darkness to be held for judgment; … **6** if He condemned the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah to destruction, reducing them to ashes as an example of what is coming on the ungodly; … **9** if all this is so, then the Lord knows how to rescue the godly from trials and to hold the unrighteous for punishment on the day of judgment. … **17** These men are springs without water and mists driven by a storm. Blackest darkness is reserved for them.

*English (WEB)*

**4** For if God didn’t spare angels when they sinned, but cast them down to Tartarus, and committed them to pits of darkness to be reserved for judgment; … **6** and turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah into ashes, condemned them to destruction, having made them an example to those who would live in an ungodly way, … **9** then the Lord knows how to deliver the godly out of temptation and to keep the unrighteous under punishment for the day of judgment, … **17** These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

## Revelation 12:7–9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** Καὶ ἐγένετο πόλεμος ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ, ὁ Μιχαὴλ καὶ οἱ ἄγγελοι αὐτοῦ τοῦ πολεμῆσαι μετὰ τοῦ δράκοντος. καὶ ὁ δράκων ἐπολέμησεν καὶ οἱ ἄγγελοι αὐτοῦ, **8** καὶ οὐκ ἴσχυσεν, οὐδὲ τόπος εὑρέθη αὐτῶν ἔτι ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ. **9** καὶ ἐβλήθη ὁ δράκων ὁ μέγας, ὁ ὄφις ὁ ἀρχαῖος, ὁ καλούμενος Διάβολος καὶ ὁ Σατανᾶς, ὁ πλανῶν τὴν οἰκουμένην ὅλην— ἐβλήθη εἰς τὴν γῆν, καὶ οἱ ἄγγελοι αὐτοῦ μετ᾽ αὐτοῦ ἐβλήθησαν.

*English (BSB)*

**7** Then a war broke out in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon, and the dragon and his angels fought back. **8** But the dragon was not strong enough, and no longer was any place found in heaven for him and his angels. **9** And the great dragon was hurled down—that ancient serpent called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world. He was hurled to the earth, and his angels with him.

*English (WEB)*

**7** There was war in the sky. Michael and his angels made war on the dragon. The dragon and his angels made war. **8** They didn’t prevail. No place was found for them any more in heaven. **9** The great dragon was thrown down, the old serpent, he who is called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world. He was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him.

## Revelation 20:10

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** καὶ ὁ διάβολος ὁ πλανῶν αὐτοὺς ἐβλήθη εἰς τὴν λίμνην τοῦ πυρὸς καὶ θείου, ὅπου καὶ τὸ θηρίον καὶ ὁ ψευδοπροφήτης, καὶ βασανισθήσονται ἡμέρας καὶ νυκτὸς εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

*English (BSB)*

**10** And the devil who had deceived them was thrown into the lake of fire and sulfur, into which the beast and the false prophet had already been thrown. There they will be tormented day and night forever and ever.

*English (WEB)*

**10** The devil who deceived them was thrown into the lake of fire and sulfur, where the beast and the false prophet are also. They will be tormented day and night forever and ever.

## 1 Enoch 6

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And it came to pass when the children of men had multiplied that in those days were born unto them beautiful and comely daughters. **2** And the angels, the children of the heaven, saw and lusted after them, and said to one another: 'Come, let us choose us wives from among the children of men and beget us children.' **3** And Semjâzâ, who was their leader, said unto them: 'I fear ye will not indeed agree to do this deed, and I alone shall have to pay the penalty of a great sin.' **4** And they all answered him and said: 'Let us all swear an oath, and all bind ourselves by mutual imprecations not to abandon this plan but to do this thing.' **5** Then sware they all together and bound themselves by mutual imprecations upon it. **6** And they were in all two hundred; who descended in the days of Jared on the summit of Mount Hermon, and they called it Mount Hermon, because they had sworn and bound themselves by mutual imprecations upon it. **7** And these are the names of their leaders: Samîazâz, their leader, Arâkîba, Râmêêl, Kôkabîêl, Tâmîêl, Râmîêl, Dânêl, Êzêqêêl, Barâqîjâl, Asâêl, Armârôs, Batârêl, Anânêl, Zaqîêl, Samsâpêêl, Satarêl, Tûrêl, Jômjâêl, Sariêl. **8** These are their chiefs of tens.

## 1 Enoch 7

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And all the others together with them took unto themselves wives, and each chose for himself one, and they began to go in unto them and to defile themselves with them, and they taught them charms and enchantments, and the cutting of roots, and made them acquainted with plants. **2** And they became pregnant, and they bare great giants, whose height was three thousand ells: **3** Who consumed all the acquisitions of men. **4** And when men could no longer sustain them, the giants turned against them and devoured mankind. **5** And they began to sin against birds, and beasts, and reptiles, and fish, and to devour one another's flesh, and drink the blood. **6** Then the earth laid accusation against the lawless ones.

## 1 Enoch 10:4–6, 11–12

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**4** And again the Lord said to Raphael: 'Bind Azâzêl hand and foot, and cast him into the darkness: and make an opening in the desert, which is in Dûdâêl, and cast him therein. **5** And place upon him rough and jagged rocks, and cover him with darkness, and let him abide there for ever, and cover his face that he may not see light. **6** And on the day of the great judgement he shall be cast into the fire. … **11** And the Lord said unto Michael: 'Go, bind Semjâzâ and his associates who have united themselves with women so as to have defiled themselves with them in all their uncleanness. **12** And when their sons have slain one another, and they have seen the destruction of their beloved ones, bind them fast for seventy generations in the valleys of the earth, till the day of

their judgement and of their consummation, till the judgement that is for ever and ever is consummated.

### 1 Enoch 12:4

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**4** 'Enoch, thou scribe of righteousness, go, declare to the Watchers of the heaven who have left the high heaven, the holy eternal place, and have defiled themselves with women, and have done as the children of earth do, and have taken unto themselves wives:

### 1 Enoch 15:3, 7

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**3** Wherefore have ye left the high, holy, and eternal heaven, and lain with women, and defiled yourselves with the daughters of men and taken to yourselves wives, and done like the children of earth, and begotten giants (as your) sons? ... **7** And therefore I have not appointed wives for you; for as for the spiritual ones of the heaven, in heaven is their dwelling.

### 1 Enoch 1–36

This reference names the Book of the Watchers (36 chapters) as a whole, which is too long to print here. Verses quoted from it in this chapter have their own entries.

# Chapter 4. Dreamers, Authority, and the Archangel’s Restraint (Jude 8–10)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **8** Ὁμοίως μέντοι καὶ οὗτοι ἐνυπνιαζόμενοι σάρκα μὲν μιαίνουσιν, κυριότητα δὲ ἀθετοῦσιν, δόξας δὲ βλασφημοῦσιν. **9** ὁ δὲ Μιχαὴλ ὁ ἀρχάγγελος, ὅτε τῷ διαβόλῳ διακρινόμενος διελέγετο περὶ τοῦ Μωϋσέως σώματος, οὐκ ἐτόλμησεν κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας, ἀλλὰ εἶπεν· Ἐπιτιμήσαι σοι κύριος. **10** οὗτοι δὲ ὅσα μὲν οὐκ οἴδασιν βλασφημοῦσιν, ὅσα δὲ φυσικῶς ὡς τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα ἐπίστανται, ἐν τούτοις φθείρονται.
>
> — Jude 8–10, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript’s first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | κυριότητα | ‘lordship’ | P72 P78 A B C K L 1739 |
| 8 | κυριότητας | ‘lordships’ | א Ψ |
| 8 | δόξας | ‘glorious ones’ | P72 א A B C Ψ K L 1739 |
| 8 | δόξαν | ‘glory’ | P78 |
| 9 | κύριος | ‘the Lord’ | P72 A B C Ψ K L |
| 9 | ὁ θεός | ‘God’ | א* 1739 |

Notes. v. 9: not extant in P78. v. 10: no difference that affects translation (Ψ reads διαφθείρονται for φθείρονται); not extant in P78.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

### Jude 8

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Lykwyse these dremers defyle the flesshe despyse rulars and speake evyll of them that are in auctoritie. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | Likewise notwithstanding these sleepers also defile the flesh, and despise gouernment, and speake euill of them that are in authoritie. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | In like manner these men also defile the flesh, and despise dominion, and blaspheme majesty. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Likewise also these filthy dreamers defile the flesh, despise dominion, and speak evil of dignities. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | Yet in like manner these dreamers defile the flesh, despise dominion, and rail at dignities. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Yet in like manner these also in their dreamings defile the flesh, and set at nought dominion, and rail at dignities. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | Yet in like manner these dreamers also defile [the] flesh, and despise lordship, and speak railingly against dignities. |
| **YLT** Young’s Literal Translation (1898) | In like manner, nevertheless, those dreaming also the flesh indeed do defile, and lordship they put away, and dignities they speak evil of, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Yet in like manner these also in their dreamings defile the flesh, and set at nought dominion, and rail at dignities. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Yet in the same way, these also in their dreaming defile the flesh, despise authority, and slander celestial beings. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Similarly, these ungodly people in your midst also defile their own bodies by living immorally, because they claim/say that God revealed in visions that they should act that way. They refuse to allow anyone to have |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | authority over them, and they ◄revile/speak evil about► God's glorious/wonderful angels. Jude 9-10 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | Yet in the same way these people, too, cherishing vain dreams, pollute our human nature, reject control, and malign the celestial beings. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Yet in the same way, these dreamers also pollute their bodies. They reject authority, and they say slanderous things against the glorious ones. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Likewise these dreamers pollute their bodies, disregard authority, and insult heavenly beings. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | In like manner, nevertheless, those dreaming indeed defile the flesh, and they disregard lordship, and they speak evil of glorious [ones], |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Yet in the same way these dreamers defile their bodies, reject authority, and slander glorious beings. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Yet in the same way these dreamers defile their bodies, reject authority, and slander glorious beings. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | In the same way these ungodly men, relying on their dreams, defile the flesh, reject authority, and revile glorious beings. |

## Jude 9

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Yet Michael the archangell when he strove agaynst the devyll and disputed about the body of Moses durst not geve raylinge sentence but sayde: the Lorde rebuke ye. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | Yet Michael the Archangell, when hee stroue against the deuill, and disputed about the body of Moses, durst not blame him with cursed speaking, but sayd, The Lord rebuke thee. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | When Michael the archangel, disputing with the devil, contended about the body of Moses, he durst not bring against him the judgment of railing speech, but said: The Lord command thee. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Yet Michael the archangel, when contending with the devil he disputed about the body of Moses, durst not bring against him a railing accusation, but said, The Lord rebuke thee. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | Yet Michael the archangel, when contending with the Devil he disputed about the body of Moses, dared not bring against him a railing accusation, but said: The Lord rebuke thee. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | But Michael the archangel, when contending with the devil he disputed about the body of Moses, durst not bring against him a railing judgment, but said, The Lord rebuke thee. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | But Michael the archangel, when disputing with the devil he reasoned about the body of Moses, did not dare to bring a railing judgment against [him], but said, [The] Lord rebuke thee. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | yet Michael, the chief messenger, when, with the devil contending, he was disputing about the body of Moses, did not dare to bring up an evil-speaking judgment, but said, 'The Lord rebuke thee!' |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | But Michael the archangel, when contending with the devil he disputed about the body of Moses, durst not bring against him a railing judgment, but said, The Lord rebuke thee. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | But Michael, the archangel, when contending with the devil and arguing about the body of Moses, dared not bring against him an abusive condemnation, but said, "May the Lord rebuke you!" |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | When ◄the devil/Satan► argued with the chief angel, Michael, about who would take away the body of the prophet Moses to bury it, Michael did not do as these teachers of false doctrine do. Even though Michael has much more authority than they do, he did not disrespectfully ◄revile/say evil things to► Satan and accuse/condemn him. Instead, he only said, "I desire that the Lord God will rebuke you!" |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | Yet even Michael, the archangel, when, in his dispute with the devil, he was arguing about the body of Moses, did not venture to |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | charge him with maligning, but said merely ‘The Lord rebuke you!’ |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | But even Michael the archangel, when he was arguing with the devil and disputing with him about the body of Moses, did not dare to bring a slanderous judgment against him. Instead he said, “May the Lord rebuke you!” |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Even the archangel Michael, when he was arguing with the devil over Moses’ body, didn’t dare to condemn him with a slanderous insult, but said, “May the Lord rebuke you.” |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | yet Michael, the chief messenger, when disputing with the Devil, reasoning about the body of Moses, did not dare to bring against [him] a judgment of slander, but said, “The LORD rebuke you!” |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | But even the archangel Michael, when he disputed with the devil over the body of Moses, did not presume to bring a slanderous charge against him, but said, “The Lord rebuke you!” |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | But even the archangel Michael, when he disputed with the devil over the body of Moses, did not presume to bring a slanderous charge against him, but said, “The Lord rebuke you!” |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | But when Michael the archangel was contending with the devil and disputing about the body of Moses, he did not dare to bring a reviling judgment against him, but said, “May the Lord rebuke you!” |

### Jude 10

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | But these speake evyll of those thinges which they knowe not: and what thinges they knowe naturally as beastes which are without reason in tho thinges they corrupte them selves. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | But these speake euill of those thinges, which they know not: and whatsoeuer things they know naturally, as beasts, which are without reason, in those things they corrupt them selues. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | But these men blaspheme whatever things they know not: and what things soever they naturally know, like dumb beasts, in these they are corrupted. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | But these speak evil of those things which they know not: but what they know naturally, as brute beasts, in those things they corrupt themselves. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | But these rail at the things which they know not; but what things they understand naturally, as brute beasts, in these they corrupt themselves. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | But these rail at whatsoever things they know not: and what they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason, in these things are they destroyed. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | But these, whatever things they know not, they speak railingly against; but what even, as the irrational animals, they understand by mere nature, in these things they corrupt themselves. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | and these, as many things indeed as they have not known, they speak evil of; and as many things as naturally (as the irrational beasts) they understand, in these they are corrupted; |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | But these rail at whatsoever things they know not: and what they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason, in these things are they destroyed. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | But these speak evil of whatever things they don't know. They are destroyed in these things that they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | But the ones in your midst who teach false doctrine ◄revile/speak evil against► the spiritual beings that they do not understand. They also do the evil things that they desire, things that they know about ◄naturally/without needing to think►, things that they just do without considering the consequences/results, like animals. So |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | they destroy themselves. But they will also be punished by God {God will also punish them}. Jude 11-13 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | But these people malign whatever they do not understand; while they use such things as they know by instinct (like the animals that have no reason) for their own corruption. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | But these people slander whatever they do not understand, and what they do understand—what unreasoning animals know by instinct—these are what destroy them. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | But these people ridicule whatever they don't understand; and what they do understand they instinctively follow like unthinking animals—this is what destroys them. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | But these, indeed, whatever [things] they have not known, they speak evil of; and whatever [they know], like the irrational beasts, they understand naturally—in these they are corrupted; |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | These men, however, slander what they do not understand, and like irrational animals, they will be destroyed by the things they do instinctively. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | These men, however, slander what they do not understand, and like irrational animals, they will be destroyed by the things they do instinctively. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Yet these men slander whatever they do not understand, and they are corrupted by what they, like irrational beasts, instinctively comprehend. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Having set out three examples of judgment, Jude now applies them. The intruders behave "in like manner." Relying on their dreams, they do three things: they defile the flesh, they reject authority, and they slander heavenly beings.

To expose the arrogance of the third charge, Jude tells a story his readers evidently knew. When Michael, the greatest of the archangels, disputed with

the Devil over Moses' body, he did not presume to pronounce judgment on his adversary on his own authority. He left that to God: "The LORD rebuke you!"

The intruders show no such restraint. They mock what they do not understand. Meanwhile, the things they do understand, their instincts and appetites, are understood the way animals understand them, and those very things are destroying them.

The passage turns on a contrast between **presumption** and **reverence**. The intruders claim special insight through dreams, yet they are ignorant of spiritual realities and governed by animal instinct. Michael, who stands in the presence of God, knows the limits of his authority.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### Ὁμοίως μέντοι (*Homoiōs mentoi*) — 'yet in the same way'

The opening Ὁμοίως μέντοι καὶ οὗτοι (*Homoiōs mentoi kai houtoi*), literally "In the same way, however, these also," ties the intruders to the examples of vv. 5–7. The particle μέντοι (*mentoi*), "nevertheless, yet," adds a note of surprise or protest. *In spite of* these well-known examples of judgment, the intruders do the same things. This is the first of the letter's "these" applications.

### καὶ οὗτοι ἐνυπνιαζόμενοι (*kai houtoi enypniazomenoi*) — 'these too, dreaming'

The participle ἐνυπνιαζόμενοι (*enypniazomenoi*), "dreaming," stands as the description of the intruders that governs all three of the following verbs. The LSV's "those dreaming indeed defile the flesh" preserves this: the dreaming is the source of the behavior.

What does Jude mean? Some interpreters take it figuratively, as if the intruders lived in a dream world of self-delusion or fantasized about immorality. The background of the word points elsewhere. In the Greek Old Testament, the same verb describes the false prophet of Deuteronomy 13: "When a prophet or a dreamer of a dream arises in your midst … saying, Let us go after other gods … you do not listen to the words of that prophet or to that dreamer of the dream" (Deut 13:1–3, LSV). The Septuagint uses ἐνυπνιαζόμενος, Jude's word, for that "dreamer of a dream."[61] Jeremiah denounces prophets "who prophesy falsehood in My Name, saying, I have dreamed, I have dreamed" (Jer 23:25, LSV), and God says, "I [am] against the prophets of false dreams" (Jer 23:32, LSV).

Dreams were not suspect in themselves. Joel promised that in the last days "Your old men dream dreams" (Joel 2:28, LSV), and Peter announced the fulfillment of that promise at Pentecost (Acts 2:17). The problem was dreams claimed as divine revelation that led people away from God's revealed will. Jude's intruders seem to have claimed visions or revelations that authorized their conduct. That would explain why Jude stresses that the faith was delivered "once" (v. 3). No new revelation can overturn it.

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61. LXX Deut 13:2 (Eng. 13:1): Ἐὰν δὲ ἀναστῇ ἐν σοὶ προφήτης ἢ ἐνυπνιαζόμενος τὸ ἐνύπνιον; also 13:4, 6 (Brenton's Greek Septuagint, eBible.org). The same participle appears in LXX Jer 34:9 (Eng. 27:9) of those who mislead the people.↩

### σάρκα μὲν μιαίνουσιν (*sarka men miainousin*) — 'defile the flesh'

The first of three charges, σάρκα μὲν μιαίνουσιν (*sarka men miainousin*), uses the verb μιαίνω (*miainō*), "to stain, defile, soil," in a moral sense.[62] "The flesh" here means the body. The charge corresponds to Sodom's sexual immorality (v. 7) and to the intruders' turning grace into "licentiousness" (v. 4).

The three charges are linked by the Greek particles μέν … δέ … δέ (*men … de … de*), "on the one hand … on the other … and." The LSV's "indeed … and … and" reflects this. The construction holds the three together as aspects of a single pattern of life.

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62. Abbott-Smith, s.v. μιαίνω: "to stain, defile, soil; in physical sense; in moral sense: Tit 1:15, He 12:15, Ju 8."↩

### κυριότητα δὲ ἀθετοῦσιν (*kyriotēta de athetousin*) — 'reject lordship'

The second charge, κυριότητα δὲ ἀθετοῦσιν (*kyriotēta de athetousin*), uses ἀθετέω (*atheteō*), "to set aside, reject, nullify,"[63] with the object κυριότης (*kyriotēs*), "lordship, dominion." What lordship do they reject?

1. **The lordship of the Lord.** The word is derived from κύριος (*kyrios*, "lord"), and Jude has just said that the intruders deny "our only Master and Lord—Jesus Christ" (v. 4). Rejecting "lordship" would then mean rejecting the authority of Christ. Clement of Alexandria read it this way: "despise dominion … that is, the only Lord, who is truly our Lord, Jesus Christ."[64]
2. **Angelic powers.** In Eph 1:21 and Col 1:16, "lordship" (κυριότης) is one of a list of angelic ranks: "principality, and authority, and might, and lordship" (Eph 1:21, LSV). Since the next charge concerns "glorious [ones]," Jude might mean angelic authorities here too.

3. **Human church leaders.** Some have suggested that the intruders despised the leadership of the community.

The first interpretation fits the immediate context best, since it echoes v. 4. It also fits the contrast with the angels of v. 6, who left their place under God's authority. The singular "lordship," without an article, may also suggest an abstract principle: the intruders reject the very idea of being under authority.

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63. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀθετέω: "properly, to make ἄθετον, or do away with what has been laid down … to reject: … Ju 8."↩

64. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 8, ANF 2. Clement adds: "They speak evil of majesty, that is, of the angels."↩

### δόξας δὲ βλασφημοῦσιν (*doxas de blasphēmousin*) — 'and slander glorious ones'

The third charge is the most puzzling. The verb βλασφημέω (*blasphēmeō*) means "to slander, revile, speak abusively of." The object δόξας (*doxas*), literally "glories," refers to glorious beings, almost certainly angels. The LSV's bracketed "[ones]" signals that the Greek has only the plural noun. Second Peter's parallel confirms the angelic reference: "they are not afraid to speak evil of glorious ones, whereas messengers, being greater in strength and power, do not bear a slanderous judgment against them before the LORD" (2 Pet 2:10–11, LSV).

Why would anyone slander angels? Jude does not say, and scholars have proposed several explanations:

- **Disparaging the angels as guardians of the moral law.** Jewish and early Christian tradition held that the Law of Moses was given "through messengers" (Gal 3:19; Acts 7:53; Heb 2:2). If the intruders taught that grace freed them from the moral law, they might have belittled the angels associated with that law. This is a suggestion drawn from the biblical evidence just cited, not a fact recorded in Jude.[65]
- **Mocking evil powers.** If the "glorious ones" include fallen angels (some argue this from the Michael example, where the slander concerns the Devil), the intruders may have treated spiritual evil with contempt, claiming that their spiritual status put them beyond its reach.
- **General irreverence** toward the whole unseen order of God's creation.

The example that follows, Michael's restraint toward the Devil, suggests that Jude's main point is the intruders' presumption. Whatever beings they slandered, they spoke with an authority they did not possess.

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65. The texts are Gal 3:19; Acts 7:53; Heb 2:2; compare LXX Deut 33:2. Older commentators read the "glories" variously. Clement of Alexandria took them as angels

(*Adumbrationes* on Jude 8). The *Pulpit Commentary* and others discuss both angelic and human authorities (on Jude 8).↩

### ὁ δὲ Μιχαὴλ ὁ ἀρχάγγελος (*ho de Michaēl ho archangelos*) — ‘but Michael the archangel’

Michael is one of only two angels named in the Protestant canon of Scripture; the other is Gabriel. In Daniel he is “Michael, first of the chief heads” and “the great head, who is standing up for the sons of your people” (Dan 10:13; 12:1, LSV), the guardian of Israel. In Revelation, “Michael and his messengers warred against the dragon” (Rev 12:7, LSV). Jude calls him ὁ ἀρχάγγελος (*ho archangelos*), “the archangel,” literally “the chief messenger,” as the LSV renders it. The only other New Testament use of the word is in 1 Thess 4:16, “with the voice of a chief-messenger” (LSV).

The choice of Michael heightens the contrast. If anyone had the standing to condemn the Devil, it was the commander of heaven’s armies.

### ὅτε τῷ διαβόλῳ διακρινόμενος διελέγετο περὶ τοῦ Μωϋσέως σώματος (*hote tō diabolō diakrinomenos dielegeto peri tou Mōuseōs sōmatos*) — ‘when, contending with the devil, he argued about the body of Moses’

Two legal or debating verbs describe the encounter. διακρινόμενος (*diakrinomenos*) means “contending, disputing,” often in a judicial sense. διελέγετο (*dielegeto*) means “was arguing, debating.” The scene is a dispute, perhaps a kind of court case, “about the body of Moses” (περὶ τοῦ Μωϋσέως σώματος, *peri tou Mōyseōs sōmatos*), over who had rights to it.

The Old Testament says only this about Moses’ death: “Moses, servant of the Lord, dies there in the land of Moab, according to the command of YHWH; and He buries him in a valley in the land of Moab, opposite Beth-Peor, and no man has known his burying place to this day” (Deut 34:5–6, LSV). The mysterious burial, done by God himself in an unknown place, invited speculation, and a tradition grew up that angels were involved. Jude’s version, the only surviving ancient form of the story that names a dispute between Michael and the Devil, is explored in the deep dive below.

### οὐκ ἐτόλμησεν κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας (*ouk etolmēsen krisin epenenkein blasphēmias*) — ‘did not dare to bring a slanderous judgment’

The key phrase οὐκ ἐτόλμησεν κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας (*ouk etolmēsen krisin epenenkein blasphēmias*) can be read in two ways.

1. **“He did not dare to pronounce a slanderous (or abusive) judgment against him.”** The genitive βλασφημίας (*blasphēmias*) describes the kind of judgment: an insulting, reviling condemnation. Michael did not abuse the Devil, even though the Devil deserved condemnation. He left judgment to God. This is the traditional reading (“durst not bring against him a railing accusation,” WBS) and the one most translations follow.
2. **“He did not presume to condemn him for slander.”** The genitive names the charge: Michael did not pronounce a verdict of “slander” against the Devil. On this reading, which draws on an ancient Greek fragment preserved in a catena (a chain of excerpts from early commentators) and on the lost ending of the *Testament of Moses* (see the deep dive), the Devil had slandered Moses by calling him a murderer. Michael, though in the right, did not presume to judge the Devil for this slander and appealed to God instead.[66]

Both readings reach the same point. Michael, though an archangel and in the right, recognized that judgment over a fellow spiritual being belonged to God alone. The intruders, mere humans, pass judgment freely on beings far above them.

The verb ἐτόλμησεν (*etolmēsen*), “he dared,” is important. Jude does not say Michael was unable to condemn the Devil, or that the Devil deserved no condemnation. He says Michael *did not dare*. The restraint was reverence, not weakness.

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66. J. B. Mayor, *Expositor’s Greek Testament* (1910), on Jude 9, quoting the catena fragment (see n. 14) and R. H. Charles’s summary in his edition of the *Assumption of Moses* (1897). Public domain; https://biblehub.com/commentaries/egt/jude/1.htm.↩

### ἀλλὰ εἶπεν· Ἐπιτιμήσαι σοι κύριος (*alla eipen: Epitimēsai soi kyrios*) — ‘but said: may the Lord rebuke you’

Michael’s words, Ἐπιτιμήσαι σοι κύριος (*Epitimēsai soi kyrios*), use the **optative** of wish: “May the Lord rebuke you!” This is the second optative in Jude, after “be multiplied” in v. 2. The LSV prints “LORD” in capitals, indicating that the reference is to the God of Israel.

The words echo Zechariah’s vision of Joshua the high priest, accused by Satan before the angel of the LORD: “And YHWH says to Satan: ‘YHWH pushes against you, O Satan, / Indeed, YHWH pushes against you’” (Zech 3:2, LSV). The Greek Septuagint renders the same words as Ἐπιτιμήσαι Κύριος ἐν σοί, διάβολε, “May the Lord rebuke you, O Devil,” nearly identical to Jude.[67] In both scenes, a heavenly figure facing the accuser leaves the rebuke to God.

Zechariah 3 will return in Jude 23: the high priest Joshua is “a brand delivered from fire” and is “clothed with filthy garments” (Zech 3:2–3, LSV), images that

reappear in Jude's call to snatch others "out of fire" and to hate the "coat having been stained from the flesh."

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67. LXX Zech 3:2: Καὶ εἶπε Κύριος πρὸς τὸν διάβολον, Ἐπιτιμήσαι Κύριος ἐν σοὶ διάβολε (Brenton's Greek Septuagint).↩

### οὗτοι δὲ ὅσα μὲν οὐκ οἴδασιν βλασφημοῦσιν (*houtoi de hosa men ouk oidasin blasphēmousin*) — 'but these people slander whatever they do not understand'

Verse 10 returns to the intruders, "these" (οὗτοι, *houtoi*), with a pointed contrast built on two verbs of knowing:

- ὅσα μὲν οὐκ οἴδασιν βλασφημοῦσιν (*hosa men ouk oidasin blasphēmousin*), "whatever they do not know, they slander." The verb οἶδα (*oida*) here refers to knowledge of spiritual realities, the unseen world of angels and authority. Those who claimed revelatory dreams are, in Jude's judgment, ignorant of the very realm they speak about.

### ὅσα δὲ φυσικῶς ὡς τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα ἐπίστανται, ἐν τούτοις φθείρονται (*hosa de physikōs hōs ta aloga zōa epistantai, en toutois phtheirontai*) — 'and what they know by instinct, like irrational animals, is what destroys them'

- ὅσα δὲ φυσικῶς ὡς τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα ἐπίστανται (*hosa de physikōs hōs ta aloga zōa epistantai*), "whatever they understand by instinct, like unreasoning animals." The second verb, ἐπίσταμαι (*epistamai*), means "to understand, know how." The adverb φυσικῶς (*physikōs*), "naturally, by nature,"[68] found only here in the New Testament, describes knowledge that comes from instinct, not reason or revelation. The phrase τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα (*ta aloga zōa*), "the irrational animals," literally "the creatures without *logos*," without reason or speech, was a stock expression for brute beasts.

Then the verdict: ἐν τούτοις φθείρονται (*en toutois phtheirontai*), "by these things they are destroyed" or "in these they are corrupted." The verb φθείρω (*phtheirō*) means both "to corrupt" and "to destroy, ruin," and Jude may intend both: the appetites they follow corrupt them morally and are leading them to destruction.

The irony is sharp. The intruders claim higher knowledge through dreams. In reality they are ignorant of spiritual things, and the only knowledge they truly possess is the instinctive knowledge of appetite, which they share with animals and which is ruining them. Clement of Alexandria paraphrased: "He means that they eat, and drink, and indulge in uncleanness, and says that they do

other things that are common to them with animals, devoid of reason."[69] Paul's description of those whose "god [is] the belly, and whose glory [is] in their shame" (Phil 3:19, LSV) is similar.

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68. Abbott-Smith, s.v. φυσικῶς: "naturally, by nature: Ju 10."↩

69. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 10, ANF 2.↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ὁμοίως | *homoiōs* | likewise, in the same way | "In like manner" | Links to vv. 5–7. |
| μέντοι | *mentoi* | nevertheless, yet | "nevertheless" | Adversative: despite the examples. |
| ἐνυπνιάζομαι | *enypniazomai* | to dream | "those dreaming" | LXX Deut 13:2–6 (Eng. 13:1–5): the false prophet as "dreamer." |
| μιαίνω | *miainō* | stain, defile | "defile" | Moral defilement. |
| ἀθετέω | *atheteō* | set aside, reject | "disregard" | To nullify what is established. |
| κυριότης | *kyriotēs* | lordship, dominion | "lordship" | Christ's lordship, or angelic powers (Eph 1:21; Col 1:16). |
| δόξαι | *doxai* | glories; glorious beings | "glorious [ones]" | Angels (cf. 2 Pet 2:10–11). |
| βλασφημέω / βλασφημία | *blasphēmeō* / *blasphēmia* | slander, revile / slander | "speak evil of" / "slander" | Not only against God; any abusive speech. |
| ἀρχάγγελος | *archangelos* | archangel, chief messenger | "the chief messenger" | NT: only here and 1 Thess 4:16. |
| διάβολος | *diabolos* | slanderer, accuser; the Devil | "the Devil" | The word itself means "slanderer," fitting the theme of slander. |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| διακρίνομαι | *diakrinomai* | dispute, contend; doubt, waver | “disputing” | Same verb as v. 22 (“doubting”). |
| διαλέγομαι | *dialegomai* | argue, discuss | “reasoning” | |
| τολμάω | *tolmaō* | dare, presume | “did not dare” | Restraint as reverence. |
| κρίσις | *krisis* | judgment, verdict | “a judgment” | |
| ἐπιτιμάω | *epitimaō* | rebuke, censure | “rebuke” | Optative of wish; = LXX Zech 3:2. |
| οἶδα / ἐπίσταμαι | *oida* / *epistamai* | know / understand | “known” / “understand” | Two kinds of knowing. |
| φυσικῶς | *physikōs* | naturally, by instinct | “naturally” | NT hapax. |
| ἄλογος | *alogos* | without reason | “irrational” | “Creatures without reason.” |
| φθείρω | *phtheirō* | corrupt; destroy | “corrupted” | Both senses likely. |

**A note on διάβολος.** The Greek word for “Devil” means “slanderer” or “accuser.” There is a quiet irony in the scene. Michael refuses to slander the Slanderer, while the intruders slander even “glorious ones.” The term *diabolos* is used in the Septuagint of Zech 3:1–2 for the accuser (Hebrew *haśśāṭān*, “the adversary”), which strengthens the connection between Jude 9 and Zechariah 3.

**A note on διακρίνομαι.** The verb describing Michael’s dispute will reappear in v. 22 for those who are “doubting” or “wavering.” It is a good example of a word whose sense depends entirely on context: “dispute” in v. 9, “doubt” or “waver” (or perhaps “dispute” again) in v. 22. Chapter 12 explores the possibility that Jude intends a link.

### Deep dive: Michael the archangel and the body of Moses

Jude’s reference to a dispute over Moses’ body is one of the most intriguing puzzles in the New Testament. The Old Testament contains no such story. Where did it come from?

**What the Bible says.** Deuteronomy 34:5–6 records that Moses died “according to the command of YHWH” (literally “at the mouth of YHWH”) and that “He buries him … and no man has known his burying place to this day” (LSV). God himself buried Moses, and the grave was unknown. That

combination of divine burial and hidden grave naturally invited questions. Who carried out the burial? Why was the grave hidden? Was there opposition?

**What early Christians said about Jude's source.** Several early Christian writers connected Jude 9 to a specific Jewish book:

- **Clement of Alexandria** (c. 200), commenting on Jude 9, writes: "Here he confirms the assumption of Moses."[70] The Latin translation preserves the phrase *assumptionem Moysi*, which may refer either to a book (the *Assumption of Moses*) or to the event of Moses' being "taken up."
- **Origen** (c. 230), in *On First Principles*, refers to "the work entitled The Ascension of Moses (a little treatise, of which the Apostle Jude makes mention in his Epistle)," in which "the archangel Michael, when disputing with the devil regarding the body of Moses, says that the serpent, being inspired by the devil, was the cause of Adam and Eve's transgression."[71]
- Later writers also refer to this work. Didymus the Blind (fourth century), in his exposition of Jude, says that some doubted the canonicity of the letter because of this quotation from an apocryphal book. Gelasius of Cyzicus quotes the *Assumption* in a way that later enabled scholars to identify a surviving manuscript.[72]

**What survives.** In the mid-nineteenth century Antonio Ceriani discovered in the Ambrosian Library in Milan a single, incomplete sixth-century Latin manuscript of a Jewish work in which Moses, before his death, prophesies Israel's history to Joshua. Ceriani published it in 1861 and identified it, through its agreement with a quotation in Gelasius, as the *Assumption of Moses*. R. H. Charles later argued that the surviving text is better called the *Testament of Moses*, since it contains Moses' farewell speech but no account of his being taken up, and that the testament and the assumption may originally have been distinct works or parts of a combined one. The manuscript breaks off before Moses' death. The dispute between Michael and the Devil does not appear in what survives, and it may have stood in the lost ending.[73]

**Reconstructing the story.** The most important clue survives in Greek. In a *catena*, a medieval chain of excerpts from early commentators, the story is told this way: when Moses had died on the mountain, "Michael is sent to remove the body; then, when the devil slandered Moses and proclaimed him a murderer because he struck the Egyptian, the angel, not bearing the slander against him, said to the devil, 'May God rebuke you.'" (The Greek reads ὁ Μιχαὴλ ἀποστέλλεται μεταθήσων τὸ σῶμα, εἶτα τοῦ διαβόλου κατὰ τοῦ Μωυσέως βλασφημοῦντος καὶ φονέα ἀναγορεύοντος διὰ τὸ πατάξαι τὸν Αἰγύπτιον, οὐκ ἐνεγκὼν τὴν κατ' αὐτοῦ βλασφημίαν ὁ ἄγγελος, Ἐπιτιμήσαι σοι ὁ Θεός, πρὸς τὸν διάβολον ἔφη.) R. H. Charles summarized the surviving fragments: Michael is commissioned to bury Moses, and Satan opposes the

burial on two grounds. First, he claims to be the lord of matter, so the body belongs to him; Michael answers, “The Lord rebuke thee, for it was God’s spirit which created the world and all mankind.” Second, he brings the charge of murder against Moses, who had killed an Egyptian (Exod 2:11–12).[74] The tenth-century commentator Oecumenius reports a similar tradition.[75] Because the original ending is lost, every reconstruction is provisional. Even the old Cambridge commentary cautioned that such later traditions “may have grown out of the words of St Jude instead of being the foundation on which they rested.”

**How did Jude use the story?** Jude uses it as he uses the examples of vv. 5–7: as a known story with a clear moral point. He assumes his readers know it, mentions only what he needs, and draws a single lesson. He does not quote a book by name or introduce the story as Scripture.

**Did Jude believe the event happened?** Interpreters answer this differently.

- Some hold that Jude, writing under the guidance of the Spirit, affirmed a true event preserved in Jewish tradition. Calvin, for example, judged that since “the Jews at that time had many things from the traditions of the fathers,” it was not unreasonable to say “that Jude referred to what had already been handed down for many ages.”[76]
- Others hold that Jude used a familiar story as an illustration, much as a modern preacher might cite a well-known parable or a classic novel, without endorsing its historicity. On this view the authority lies in the moral point, not in the narrative details.
- Still others think the question cannot be settled and is not essential to understanding Jude’s argument.

All agree on the point Jude draws: *if the archangel Michael did not presume to pronounce judgment on the Devil, how much less should mere humans slander heavenly beings?* Readers may hold different views about the story’s origin and still receive its lesson.

**Why did the story matter in Jude’s world?** A story about angels disputing over Moses’ body would have resonated with Jewish readers for whom Moses was the supreme prophet and lawgiver, and for whom the hidden grave was a sign of his unique relationship with God. In a community debating authority, revelation, and the moral law, a story in which even the great archangel deferred to God’s authority over the body of the lawgiver was a pointed choice.

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70. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 9, ANF 2 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0211.htm).↩

71. Origen, *De principiis* 3.2.1, ANF 4 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/04123.htm).↩

72. On Didymus, see Mayor, *Expositor's Greek Testament*, on Jude 9: "Didymus (In Epist. Judae Enarratio) says that some doubted the canonicity of the Epistle because of this quotation from an apocryphal book." On Gelasius, see "Testament of Moses," *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA). The works of Didymus and Gelasius were not themselves consulted for this edition.↩

73. "Testament of Moses," *Wikipedia* (accessed 7 November 2026), summarizing Ceriani's discovery and Charles's analysis.↩

74. The catena fragment (from J. A. Cramer's *Catenae*, on Jude) and Charles's summary are both quoted by J. B. Mayor, *Expositor's Greek Testament* (1910), on Jude 9, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/egt/jude/1.htm. The English translation of the Greek fragment is this book's.↩

75. *Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges* (E. H. Plumptre), on Jude 9: "Œcumenius indeed, writing in the tenth century, reports a tradition that Michael was appointed to minister at the burial of Moses, and that the devil urged that his murder of the Egyptian (Exodus 2:12) had deprived him of the right of sepulture." https://biblehub.com/commentaries/cambridge/jude/1.htm.↩

76. John Calvin, *Commentaries on the Catholic Epistles*, trans. John Owen (1855), on Jude 9.↩

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Angels and the law.** Jewish tradition held that angels were present at Sinai and mediated the giving of the Law (Deut 33:2 LXX; Jubilees 1:27–29; Acts 7:53; Gal 3:19; Heb 2:2). Stephen speaks of Israel as those "who received the Law by arrangement of messengers" (Acts 7:53, LSV). If the intruders rejected the moral authority of the law of God, it would be natural for them to speak disparagingly of the angels associated with it.

**Dreams and revelation in the ancient world.** Throughout the ancient Mediterranean, dreams were widely regarded as a channel of divine communication. Jewish tradition accepted that God could speak through dreams, as with Joseph and Daniel, but also warned against dreamers who led people astray (Deut 13; Jer 23). Early Christianity valued prophecy and visions while insisting on testing them (1 Cor 14:29; 1 Thess 5:19–21; 1 John 4:1). The *Didache* warned that a prophet's claims were to be judged by his "ways," his conduct.[77] Jude's "dreamers" fall under this kind of judgment.

**Testaments and "assumptions."** Jewish literature of the period included many "testaments," farewell discourses of patriarchs before death (the *Testaments of the Twelve Patriarchs*, the *Testament of Moses*), and stories of figures "taken up" to heaven (Enoch, Elijah, and in some traditions Moses). Jude's references to Moses' body and to Enoch (vv. 14–15) show that he and his readers were at home in this literature.

77. *Didache* 11.8, ANF 7: “from their ways shall the false prophet and the prophet be known.”↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Deuteronomy 13:1–5; Jeremiah 23:25–32 (background for “dreaming”).** The “dreamer of a dream” who leads people to “go after other gods” (Deut 13:1–2, LSV) is the clearest Old Testament background for Jude’s term. The verbal link is strongest in the Greek Old Testament, where Jude’s word appears. This is probably a deliberate echo, though Jude does not quote the passage.

**Zechariah 3:1–4 (direct allusion).** Michael’s words in Jude 9 match the Septuagint of Zech 3:2 almost exactly. Since Zechariah 3 also supplies the imagery of Jude 23, Jude, or his source, seems to have known the whole scene well.

**2 Peter 2:10–12 (literary parallel).** Second Peter generalizes Jude’s example: “messengers, being greater in strength and power, do not bear a slanderous judgment against them before the LORD” (2 Pet 2:11, LSV). It omits the names of Michael and Moses and the specific story, perhaps because the story came from a non-canonical source. It also expands Jude’s comparison to animals: “as irrational natural beasts, made to be caught and destroyed” (2 Pet 2:12, LSV).

**Daniel 10:13, 21; 12:1; Revelation 12:7–9 (Michael).** These passages establish Michael as Israel’s guardian and the leader of the heavenly forces against the dragon. Jude’s portrait of a Michael who refuses to presume is all the more striking against that background.

**Matthew 4:10 (shared theme).** When Jesus dismisses Satan in the wilderness, he does so by appealing to Scripture: “it has been written” (Matt 4:10, LSV). Like Michael, he grounds his response in God’s authority rather than his own.

**Romans 1:22–24; Philippians 3:19 (shared theme).** Paul’s description of those who, “professing to be wise, … were made fools” (Rom 1:22, LSV) and were given up to their desires parallels Jude’s portrait of people who claim higher knowledge yet live by animal appetite.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. What is the source of the Michael story, and what does its use imply?** Discussed in the deep dive. The source is most likely a lost ending of the *Testament* or *Assumption of Moses*. Christians have drawn different

conclusions about what Jude's use of the story implies about its historical truth.

**2. What is "lordship," and who are the "glorious ones"?** Discussed above. The most likely readings are the Lord's authority and angels, respectively. Alternatives are noted.

**3. What does "a judgment of slander" mean?** "A slanderous judgment" (traditional) or "a condemnation for slander" (reconstructed setting). Both lead to the same point.

**4. Should Christians "rebuke the Devil"?** Some modern Christian practices encourage believers to address and rebuke Satan directly in prayer. Jude 9 has been cited on both sides of this question. Some read it as a model, since Michael's words are a form of rebuke spoken in God's name. Others read it as a caution, since Michael refused to pronounce judgment himself and appealed to God. Jude's own point concerns *slander and presumption*, not techniques of spiritual warfare. The verse most clearly teaches humility: whatever believers say about spiritual evil should be said in dependence on God's authority, not their own.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verse 8 is the first application in the letter's alternating pattern of text and application. Verses 5–7 supplied the text, and v. 8 says "In like manner … those dreaming." Verse 9 then introduces a second "text," the Michael story, and v. 10 applies it: "But these…"

The passage also prepares for what follows. The animal comparison of v. 10 anticipates the woe on those who follow Cain, Balaam, and Korah (v. 11). The theme of slanderous speech anticipates the "harsh [words]" of v. 15 and the "swollen words" of v. 16. The phrase "they understand naturally" anticipates the description of the intruders in v. 19 as ψυχικοί (*psychikoi*), "natural" people "not having the Spirit." In Jude's view, the intruders' claimed spirituality is in fact the opposite of spirituality.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Testing claimed revelations.** Movements in every generation claim new revelations, special dreams, or private words from God that set aside the received faith or its moral teaching. Jude, like Deuteronomy and the *Didache*, suggests a test. Does the claimed revelation lead toward the faith "once delivered" and toward holiness, or away from them? Christian traditions differ

on the place of ongoing prophecy in the church. They can agree that no experience authorizes a believer to “defile the flesh” or reject the lordship of Christ.

**Reverence in speech about spiritual realities.** Michael’s restraint may challenge both careless mockery of spiritual realities and presumptuous bravado toward them. Christians may speak about evil truthfully and confidently, yet without contempt or self-reliance, leaving final judgment to God.

**The danger of contempt.** Jude’s charge is that the intruders “speak evil of” what they do not understand. Contempt for what one has not understood is a common failing in religious and political disputes today. Jude’s example invites believers to examine their own speech, including their speech about the people Jude warns against.

**Appetite and identity.** Jude’s picture of people who know their appetites “like the irrational beasts” may prompt reflection on how far modern life is shaped by instinctive desire, often deliberately cultivated by commerce and media, and on how Christian discipleship offers a different kind of knowledge and freedom.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Jude describes the intruders as “dreaming,” probably meaning that they claimed revelations that justified their behavior. How can individuals and communities test claims to spiritual experience today?
2. Why do you think Jude chose a story about Michael and the Devil to make his point about slander? What would be lost if he had simply said, “Do not slander angels”?
3. Michael “did not dare” to pronounce judgment, even on the Devil. What does this suggest about the attitude believers should have toward those they consider enemies of God?
4. Jude contrasts two kinds of knowledge: ignorance of spiritual realities and instinctive knowledge of appetite. Where do you see these two kinds of “knowing” in your own life or culture?
5. How do you respond to the fact that Jude draws on a story not found in the Old Testament? Does it affect how you read the letter? Why or why not?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB;

inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).

- Greek: SBLGNT. LXX Deut 13:2–6 and Zech 3:2: Brenton's Greek Septuagint.
- Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 8–10 (ANF 2); Origen, *De principiis* 3.2.1 (ANF 4); Calvin, *Commentaries on the Catholic Epistles*, on Jude 9.
- On the *Testament/Assumption of Moses*: summary in "Testament of Moses," *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA; accessed 7 November 2026); R. H. Charles's 1897 summary and the catena fragment as quoted by J. B. Mayor, *Expositor's Greek Testament* (1910), on v. 9.
- Public-domain commentaries on vv. 8–10: Mayor (EGT); Plumptre (*Cambridge Bible*); *Pulpit Commentary*; Calvin.
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. μιαίνω, ἀθετέω, κυριότης, φυσικῶς.
- *Didache* 11, ANF 7.

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Exodus 2:11–12

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**11** וַיְהִי בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם וַיִּגְדַּל מֹשֶׁה וַיֵּצֵא אֶל־אֶחָיו וַיַּרְא בְּסִבְלֹתָם וַיַּרְא אִישׁ מִצְרִי מַכֶּה אִישׁ־עִבְרִי
מֵאֶחָיו **12** וַיִּפֶן כֹּה וָכֹה וַיַּרְא כִּי אֵין אִישׁ וַיַּךְ אֶת־הַמִּצְרִי וַיִּטְמְנֵהוּ בַּחוֹל

*English (BSB)*

**11** One day, after Moses had grown up, he went out to his own people and observed their hard labor. He saw an Egyptian beating a Hebrew, one of his own people. **12** After looking this way and that and seeing no one, he struck down the Egyptian and hid his body in the sand.

*English (WEB)*

**11** In those days, when Moses had grown up, he went out to his brothers and saw their burdens. He saw an Egyptian striking a Hebrew, one of his brothers.

**12** He looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no one, he killed the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.

## Deuteronomy 13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**1 [13:2]** כִּי־יָקוּם בְּקִרְבְּךָ נָבִיא אוֹ חֹלֵם חֲלוֹם וְנָתַן אֵלֶיךָ אוֹת אוֹ מוֹפֵת **2 [13:3]** וּבָא הָאוֹת
וְהַמּוֹפֵת אֲשֶׁר־דִּבֶּר אֵלֶיךָ לֵאמֹר נֵלְכָה אֲחֲרֵי אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יְדַעְתָּם וְנָעָבְדֵם **3 [13:4]** לֹא
תִשְׁמַע אֶל־דִּבְרֵי הַנָּבִיא הַהוּא אוֹ אֶל־חוֹלֵם הַחֲלוֹם הַהוּא כִּי מְנַסֶּה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם אֶתְכֶם לָדַעַת
הֲיִשְׁכֶם אֹהֲבִים אֶת־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם בְּכָל־לְבַבְכֶם וּבְכָל־נַפְשְׁכֶם **4 [13:5]** אַחֲרֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם תֵּלֵכוּ
וְאֹתוֹ תִירָאוּ וְאֶת־מִצְוֹתָיו תִּשְׁמֹרוּ וּבְקֹלוֹ תִשְׁמָעוּ וְאֹתוֹ תַעֲבֹדוּ וּבוֹ תִדְבָּקוּן **5 [13:6]** וְהַנָּבִיא הַהוּא
אוֹ חֹלֵם הַחֲלוֹם הַהוּא יוּמָת כִּי דִבֶּר־סָרָה עַל־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם הַמּוֹצִיא אֶתְכֶם מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם וְהַפֹּדְךָ
מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים לְהַדִּיחֲךָ מִן־הַדֶּרֶךְ אֲשֶׁר צִוְּךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לָלֶכֶת בָּהּ וּבִעַרְתָּ הָרָע מִקִּרְבֶּךָ **6 [13:7]**
כִּי יְסִיתְךָ אָחִיךָ בֶּן־אִמֶּךָ אוֹ־בִנְךָ אוֹ־בִתֶּךָ אוֹ אֵשֶׁת חֵיקֶךָ אוֹ רֵעֲךָ אֲשֶׁר כְּנַפְשְׁךָ בַּסֵּתֶר לֵאמֹר נֵלְכָה
וְנַעַבְדָה אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים אֲשֶׁר לֹא יָדַעְתָּ אַתָּה וַאֲבֹתֶיךָ **7 [13:8]** מֵאֱלֹהֵי הָעַמִּים אֲשֶׁר סְבִיבֹתֵיכֶם
הַקְּרֹבִים אֵלֶיךָ אוֹ הָרְחֹקִים מִמְּךָ מִקְצֵה הָאָרֶץ וְעַד־קְצֵה הָאָרֶץ **8 [13:9]** לֹא־תֹאבֶה לוֹ וְלֹא תִשְׁמַע
אֵלָיו וְלֹא־תָחוֹס עֵינְךָ עָלָיו וְלֹא־תַחְמֹל וְלֹא־תְכַסֶּה עָלָיו **9 [13:10]** כִּי הָרֹג תַּהַרְגֶנּוּ יָדְךָ תִּהְיֶה־בּוֹ
בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה לַהֲמִיתוֹ וְיַד כָּל־הָעָם בָּאַחֲרֹנָה **10 [13:11]** וּסְקַלְתּוֹ בָאֲבָנִים וָמֵת כִּי בִקֵּשׁ לְהַדִּיחֲךָ מֵעַל
יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ הַמּוֹצִיאֲךָ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם מִבֵּית עֲבָדִים **11 [13:12]** וְכָל־יִשְׂרָאֵל יִשְׁמְעוּ וְיִרָאוּן וְלֹא־
יוֹסִפוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת כַּדָּבָר הָרָע הַזֶּה בְּקִרְבֶּךָ **12 [13:13]** כִּי־תִשְׁמַע בְּאַחַת עָרֶיךָ אֲשֶׁר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ נֹתֵן
לְךָ לָשָׁבֶת שָׁם לֵאמֹר **13 [13:14]** יָצְאוּ אֲנָשִׁים בְּנֵי־בְלִיַּעַל מִקִּרְבֶּךָ וַיַּדִּיחוּ אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי עִירָם לֵאמֹר
נֵלְכָה וְנַעַבְדָה אֱלֹהִים אֲחֵרִים אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יְדַעְתֶּם **14 [13:15]** וְדָרַשְׁתָּ וְחָקַרְתָּ וְשָׁאַלְתְּ הֵיטֵב וְהִנֵּה
אֱמֶת נָכוֹן הַדָּבָר נֶעֱשְׂתָה הַתּוֹעֵבָה הַזֹּאת בְּקִרְבֶּךָ **15 [13:16]** הַכֵּה תַכֶּה אֶת־יֹשְׁבֵי הָעִיר הַהִוא לְפִי־
חָרֶב הַחֲרֵם אֹתָהּ וְאֶת־כָּל־אֲשֶׁר־בָּהּ וְאֶת־בְּהֶמְתָּהּ לְפִי־חָרֶב **16 [13:17]** וְאֶת־כָּל־שְׁלָלָהּ תִּקְבֹּץ אֶל־
תּוֹךְ רְחֹבָהּ וְשָׂרַפְתָּ בָאֵשׁ אֶת־הָעִיר וְאֶת־כָּל־שְׁלָלָהּ כָּלִיל לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ וְהָיְתָה תֵּל עוֹלָם לֹא תִבָּנֶה
עוֹד **17 [13:18]** וְלֹא־יִדְבַּק בְּיָדְךָ מְאוּמָה מִן־הַחֵרֶם לְמַעַן יָשׁוּב יְהוָה מֵחֲרוֹן אַפּוֹ וְנָתַן־לְךָ רַחֲמִים
וְרִחַמְךָ וְהִרְבֶּךָ כַּאֲשֶׁר נִשְׁבַּע לַאֲבֹתֶיךָ **18 [13:19]** כִּי תִשְׁמַע בְּקוֹל יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לִשְׁמֹר אֶת־כָּל־
מִצְוֹתָיו אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי מְצַוְּךָ הַיּוֹם לַעֲשׂוֹת הַיָּשָׁר בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ

*English (BSB)*

**1** If a prophet or dreamer of dreams arises among you and proclaims a sign or wonder to you, **2** and if the sign or wonder he has spoken to you comes about, but he says, “Let us follow other gods (which you have not known) and let us worship them,” **3** you must not listen to the words of that prophet or dreamer. For the LORD your God is testing you to find out whether you love Him with all your heart and with all your soul. **4** You are to follow the LORD your God and fear Him. Keep His commandments and listen to His voice; serve Him and hold fast to Him. **5** Such a prophet or dreamer must be put to death, because he has advocated rebellion against the LORD your God, who brought you out of

the land of Egypt and redeemed you from the house of slavery; he has tried to turn you from the way in which the LORD your God has commanded you to walk. So you must purge the evil from among you. **6** If your very own brother, or your son or daughter, or the wife you embrace, or your closest friend secretly entices you, saying, “Let us go and worship other gods” (which neither you nor your fathers have known, **7** the gods of the peoples around you, whether near or far, whether from one end of the earth or the other), **8** you must not yield to him or listen to him. Show him no pity, and do not spare him or shield him. **9** Instead, you must surely kill him. Your hand must be the first against him to put him to death, and then the hands of all the people. **10** Stone him to death for trying to turn you away from the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery. **11** Then all Israel will hear and be afraid, and will never again do such a wicked thing among you. **12** If, regarding one of the cities the LORD your God is giving you to inhabit, you hear it said **13** that wicked men have arisen from among you and have led the people of their city astray, saying, “Let us go and serve other gods” (which you have not known), **14** then you must inquire, investigate, and interrogate thoroughly. And if it is established with certainty that this abomination has been committed among you, **15** you must surely put the inhabitants of that city to the sword. Devote to destruction all its people and livestock. **16** And you are to gather all its plunder in the middle of the public square, and completely burn the city and all its plunder as a whole burnt offering to the LORD your God. The city must remain a mound of ruins forever, never to be rebuilt. **17** Nothing devoted to destruction shall cling to your hands, so that the LORD will turn from His fierce anger, grant you mercy, show you compassion, and multiply you as He swore to your fathers, **18** because you obey the LORD your God, keeping all His commandments I am giving you today and doing what is right in the eyes of the LORD your God.

*English (WEB)*

**1** If a prophet or a dreamer of dreams arises among you, and he gives you a sign or a wonder, **2** and the sign or the wonder comes to pass, of which he spoke to you, saying, “Let’s go after other gods” (which you have not known) “and let’s serve them,” **3** you shall not listen to the words of that prophet, or to that dreamer of dreams; for the LORD your God is testing you, to know whether you love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul. **4** You shall walk after the LORD your God, fear him, keep his commandments, and obey his voice. You shall serve him, and cling to him. **5** That prophet, or that dreamer of dreams, shall be put to death, because he has spoken rebellion against the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt and redeemed you out of the house of bondage, to draw you aside out of the way which the LORD your God commanded you to walk in. So you shall remove the evil from among you. **6** If your brother, the son of your mother, or your son, or your daughter, or the wife of your bosom, or your friend who is as

your own soul, entices you secretly, saying, “Let’s go and serve other gods”—
which you have not known, you, nor your fathers; **7** of the gods of the peoples
who are around you, near to you, or far off from you, from the one end of the
earth even to the other end of the earth— **8** you shall not consent to him nor
listen to him; neither shall your eye pity him, neither shall you spare, neither
shall you conceal him; **9** but you shall surely kill him. Your hand shall be first
on him to put him to death, and afterwards the hands of all the people. **10** You
shall stone him to death with stones, because he has sought to draw you away
from the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the
house of bondage. **11** All Israel shall hear, and fear, and shall not do any more
wickedness like this among you. **12** If you hear about one of your cities, which
the LORD your God gives you to dwell there, that **13** certain wicked fellows
have gone out from among you and have drawn away the inhabitants of their
city, saying, “Let’s go and serve other gods,” which you have not known, **14**
then you shall inquire, investigate, and ask diligently. Behold, if it is true, and
the thing certain, that such abomination was done among you, **15** you shall
surely strike the inhabitants of that city with the edge of the sword, destroying
it utterly, with all that is therein and its livestock, with the edge of the sword.
**16** You shall gather all its plunder into the middle of its street, and shall burn
with fire the city, with all of its plunder, to the LORD your God. It shall be a
heap forever. It shall not be built again. **17** Nothing of the devoted thing shall
cling to your hand, that the LORD may turn from the fierceness of his anger
and show you mercy, and have compassion on you and multiply you, as he has
sworn to your fathers, **18** when you listen to the LORD your God’s voice, to
keep all his commandments which I command you today, to do that which is
right in the LORD your God’s eyes.

## Deuteronomy 33:2

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**2** וַיֹּאמַר יְהוָה מִסִּינַי בָּא וְזָרַח מִשֵּׂעִיר לָמוֹ הוֹפִיעַ מֵהַר פָּארָן וְאָתָה מֵרִבְבֹת קֹדֶשׁ מִימִינוֹ אשדת
לָמוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**2** He said: “The LORD came from Sinai and dawned upon us from Seir; He
shone forth from Mount Paran and came with myriads of holy ones, with
flaming fire at His right hand.

*English (WEB)*

**2** He said, “The LORD came from Sinai, and rose from Seir to them. He shone
from Mount Paran. He came from the ten thousands of holy ones. At his right
hand was a fiery law for them.

## Deuteronomy 34:5-6

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**5** וַיָּמָת שָׁם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד־יְהוָה בְּאֶרֶץ מוֹאָב עַל־פִּי יְהוָה **6** וַיִּקְבֹּר אֹתוֹ בַּגַּי בְּאֶרֶץ מוֹאָב מוּל בֵּית
פְּעוֹר וְלֹא־יָדַע אִישׁ אֶת־קְבֻרָתוֹ עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה

*English (BSB)*

**5** So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, as the LORD had said. **6** And He buried him in a valley in the land of Moab facing Beth-peor, and no one to this day knows the location of his grave.

*English (WEB)*

**5** So Moses the servant of the LORD died there in the land of Moab, according to the LORD's word. **6** He buried him in the valley in the land of Moab opposite Beth Peor, but no man knows where his tomb is to this day.

## Jeremiah 23

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** הוֹי רֹעִים מְאַבְּדִים וּמְפִצִים אֶת־צֹאן מַרְעִיתִי נְאֻם־יְהוָה **2** לָכֵן כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל־
הָרֹעִים הָרֹעִים אֶת־עַמִּי אַתֶּם הֲפִצֹתֶם אֶת־צֹאנִי וַתַּדִּחוּם וְלֹא פְקַדְתֶּם אֹתָם הִנְנִי פֹקֵד עֲלֵיכֶם אֶת־
רֹעַ מַעַלְלֵיכֶם נְאֻם־יְהוָה **3** וַאֲנִי אֲקַבֵּץ אֶת־שְׁאֵרִית צֹאנִי מִכֹּל הָאֲרָצוֹת אֲשֶׁר־הִדַּחְתִּי אֹתָם שָׁם
וַהֲשֵׁבֹתִי אֹתָן עַל־נָוֶהָן וּפָרוּ וְרָבוּ **4** וַהֲקִמֹתִי עֲלֵיהֶם רֹעִים וְרָעוּם וְלֹא־יִירְאוּ עוֹד וְלֹא־יֵחַתּוּ וְלֹא
יִפָּקְדוּ נְאֻם־יְהוָה **5** הִנֵּה יָמִים בָּאִים נְאֻם־יְהוָה וַהֲקִמֹתִי לְדָוִד צֶמַח צַדִּיק וּמָלַךְ מֶלֶךְ וְהִשְׂכִּיל
וְעָשָׂה מִשְׁפָּט וּצְדָקָה בָּאָרֶץ **6** בְּיָמָיו תִּוָּשַׁע יְהוּדָה וְיִשְׂרָאֵל יִשְׁכֹּן לָבֶטַח וְזֶה־שְּׁמוֹ אֲשֶׁר־יִקְרָאוֹ יְהוָה
צִדְקֵנוּ **7** לָכֵן הִנֵּה־יָמִים בָּאִים נְאֻם־יְהוָה וְלֹא־יֹאמְרוּ עוֹד חַי־יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר הֶעֱלָה אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל
מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם **8** כִּי אִם־חַי־יְהוָה אֲשֶׁר הֶעֱלָה וַאֲשֶׁר הֵבִיא אֶת־זֶרַע בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֶרֶץ צָפוֹנָה וּמִכֹּל
הָאֲרָצוֹת אֲשֶׁר הִדַּחְתִּים שָׁם וְיָשְׁבוּ עַל־אַדְמָתָם **9** לַנְּבִאִים נִשְׁבַּר לִבִּי בְקִרְבִּי רָחֲפוּ כָּל־עַצְמוֹתָי
הָיִיתִי כְּאִישׁ שִׁכּוֹר וּכְגֶבֶר עֲבָרוֹ יָיִן מִפְּנֵי יְהוָה וּמִפְּנֵי דִּבְרֵי קָדְשׁוֹ **10** כִּי מְנָאֲפִים מָלְאָה הָאָרֶץ כִּי־
מִפְּנֵי אָלָה אָבְלָה הָאָרֶץ יָבְשׁוּ נְאוֹת מִדְבָּר וַתְּהִי מְרוּצָתָם רָעָה וּגְבוּרָתָם לֹא־כֵן **11** כִּי־גַם־נָבִיא
גַּם־כֹּהֵן חָנְפוּ גַּם־בְּבֵיתִי מָצָאתִי רָעָתָם נְאֻם־יְהוָה **12** לָכֵן יִהְיֶה דַרְכָּם לָהֶם כַּחֲלַקְלַקּוֹת בָּאֲפֵלָה
יִדָּחוּ וְנָפְלוּ בָהּ כִּי־אָבִיא עֲלֵיהֶם רָעָה שְׁנַת פְּקֻדָּתָם נְאֻם־יְהוָה **13** וּבִנְבִיאֵי שֹׁמְרוֹן רָאִיתִי תִּפְלָה
הִנָּבְאוּ בַבַּעַל וַיַּתְעוּ אֶת־עַמִּי אֶת־יִשְׂרָאֵל **14** וּבִנְבִאֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם רָאִיתִי שַׁעֲרוּרָה נָאוֹף וְהָלֹךְ בַּשָּׁקֶר
וְחִזְּקוּ יְדֵי מְרֵעִים לְבִלְתִּי־שָׁבוּ אִישׁ מֵרָעָתוֹ הָיוּ־לִי כֻלָּם כִּסְדֹם וְיֹשְׁבֶיהָ כַּעֲמֹרָה **15** לָכֵן כֹּה־אָמַר
יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת עַל־הַנְּבִאִים הִנְנִי מַאֲכִיל אוֹתָם לַעֲנָה וְהִשְׁקִתִים מֵי־רֹאשׁ כִּי מֵאֵת נְבִיאֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם
יָצְאָה חָנֻפָּה לְכָל־הָאָרֶץ **16** כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אַל־תִּשְׁמְעוּ עַל־דִּבְרֵי הַנְּבִאִים הַנִּבְּאִים לָכֶם
מַהְבִלִים הֵמָּה אֶתְכֶם חָזוֹן לִבָּם יְדַבֵּרוּ לֹא מִפִּי יְהוָה **17** אֹמְרִים אָמוֹר לְמְנַאֲצַי דִּבֶּר יְהוָה שָׁלוֹם
יִהְיֶה לָכֶם וְכֹל הֹלֵךְ בִּשְׁרִרוּת לִבּוֹ אָמְרוּ לֹא־תָבוֹא עֲלֵיכֶם רָעָה **18** כִּי מִי עָמַד בְּסוֹד יְהוָה וַיֵּרֶא
וַיִּשְׁמַע אֶת־דְּבָרוֹ מִי־הִקְשִׁיב דְּבָרִי וַיִּשְׁמָע **19** הִנֵּה סַעֲרַת יְהוָה חֵמָה יָצְאָה וְסַעַר מִתְחוֹלֵל עַל רֹאשׁ

רְשָׁעִים יָחוּל **20** לֹא יָשׁוּב אַף־יְהוָה עַד־עֲשֹׂתוֹ וְעַד־הֲקִימוֹ מְזִמּוֹת לִבּוֹ בְּאַחֲרִית הַיָּמִים תִּתְבּוֹנְנוּ בָהּ
בִּינָה **21** לֹא־שָׁלַחְתִּי אֶת־הַנְּבִאִים וְהֵם רָצוּ לֹא־דִבַּרְתִּי אֲלֵיהֶם וְהֵם נִבָּאוּ **22** וְאִם־עָמְדוּ בְּסוֹדִי
וְיַשְׁמִעוּ דְבָרַי אֶת־עַמִּי וישיבום מִדַּרְכָּם הָרָע וּמֵרֹעַ מַעַלְלֵיהֶם **23** הָאֱלֹהֵי מִקָּרֹב אֲנִי נְאֻם־יְהוָה וְלֹא
אֱלֹהֵי מֵרָחֹק **24** אִם־יִסָּתֵר אִישׁ בַּמִּסְתָּרִים וַאֲנִי לֹא־אֶרְאֶנּוּ נְאֻם־יְהוָה הֲלוֹא אֶת־הַשָּׁמַיִם וְאֶת־הָאָרֶץ
אֲנִי מָלֵא נְאֻם־יְהוָה **25** שָׁמַעְתִּי אֵת אֲשֶׁר־אָמְרוּ הַנְּבִאִים הַנִּבְּאִים בִּשְׁמִי שֶׁקֶר לֵאמֹר חָלַמְתִּי חָלָמְתִּי
**26** עַד־מָתַי הֱיֵשׁ בְּלֶב הַנְּבִאִים נִבְּאֵי הַשֶּׁקֶר וּנְבִיאֵי תַרְמִת לִבָּם **27** הַחֹשְׁבִים לְהַשְׁכִּיחַ אֶת־עַמִּי שְׁמִי
בַּחֲלוֹמֹתָם אֲשֶׁר יְסַפְּרוּ אִישׁ לְרֵעֵהוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׁכְחוּ אֲבוֹתָם אֶת־שְׁמִי בַּבַּעַל **28** הַנָּבִיא אֲשֶׁר־אִתּוֹ חֲלוֹם
יְסַפֵּר חָלוֹם וַאֲשֶׁר דְּבָרִי אִתּוֹ יְדַבֵּר דְּבָרִי אֱמֶת מַה־לַּתֶּבֶן אֶת־הַבָּר נְאֻם־יְהוָה **29** הֲלוֹא כֹה דְבָרִי
כָּאֵשׁ נְאֻם־יְהוָה וּכְפַטִּישׁ יְפֹצֵץ סָלַע **30** לָכֵן הִנְנִי עַל־הַנְּבִאִים נְאֻם־יְהוָה מְגַנְּבֵי דְבָרַי אִישׁ מֵאֵת
רֵעֵהוּ **31** הִנְנִי עַל־הַנְּבִיאִם נְאֻם־יְהוָה הַלֹּקְחִים לְשׁוֹנָם וַיִּנְאֲמוּ נְאֻם **32** הִנְנִי עַל־נִבְּאֵי חֲלֹמוֹת שֶׁקֶר
נְאֻם־יְהוָה וַיְסַפְּרוּם וַיַּתְעוּ אֶת־עַמִּי בְּשִׁקְרֵיהֶם וּבְפַחֲזוּתָם וְאָנֹכִי לֹא־שְׁלַחְתִּים וְלֹא צִוִּיתִים וְהוֹעִיל
לֹא־יוֹעִילוּ לָעָם־הַזֶּה נְאֻם־יְהוָה **33** וְכִי־יִשְׁאָלְךָ הָעָם הַזֶּה אוֹ־הַנָּבִיא אוֹ־כֹהֵן לֵאמֹר מַה־מַּשָּׂא יְהוָה
וְאָמַרְתָּ אֲלֵיהֶם אֶת־מַה־מַּשָּׂא וְנָטַשְׁתִּי אֶתְכֶם נְאֻם־יְהוָה **34** וְהַנָּבִיא וְהַכֹּהֵן וְהָעָם אֲשֶׁר יֹאמַר מַשָּׂא
יְהוָה וּפָקַדְתִּי עַל־הָאִישׁ הַהוּא וְעַל־בֵּיתוֹ **35** כֹּה תֹאמְרוּ אִישׁ עַל־רֵעֵהוּ וְאִישׁ אֶל־אָחִיו מָה־עָנָה
יְהוָה וּמַה־דִּבֶּר יְהוָה **36** וּמַשָּׂא יְהוָה לֹא תִזְכְּרוּ־עוֹד כִּי הַמַּשָּׂא יִהְיֶה לְאִישׁ דְּבָרוֹ וַהֲפַכְתֶּם אֶת־
דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אֱלֹהֵינוּ **37** כֹּה תֹאמַר אֶל־הַנָּבִיא מָה־עָנָךְ יְהוָה וּמַה־דִּבֶּר יְהוָה
**38** וְאִם־מַשָּׂא יְהוָה תֹּאמְרוּ לָכֵן כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה יַעַן אֲמָרְכֶם אֶת־הַדָּבָר הַזֶּה מַשָּׂא יְהוָה וָאֶשְׁלַח
אֲלֵיכֶם לֵאמֹר לֹא תֹאמְרוּ מַשָּׂא יְהוָה **39** לָכֵן הִנְנִי וְנָשִׁיתִי אֶתְכֶם נָשֹׂא וְנָטַשְׁתִּי אֶתְכֶם וְאֶת־הָעִיר
אֲשֶׁר נָתַתִּי לָכֶם וְלַאֲבוֹתֵיכֶם מֵעַל פָּנָי **40** וְנָתַתִּי עֲלֵיכֶם חֶרְפַּת עוֹלָם וּכְלִמּוּת עוֹלָם אֲשֶׁר לֹא
תִשָּׁכֵחַ

*English (BSB)*

**1** “Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of My pasture!” declares the LORD. **2** Therefore this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says about the shepherds who tend My people: “You have scattered My flock and driven them away, and have not attended to them. Behold, I will attend to you for the evil of your deeds, declares the LORD. **3** Then I Myself will gather the remnant of My flock from all the lands to which I have banished them, and I will return them to their pasture, where they will be fruitful and multiply. **4** I will raise up shepherds over them who will tend them, and they will no longer be afraid or dismayed, nor will any go missing, declares the LORD. **5** Behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when I will raise up for David a righteous Branch, and He will reign wisely as King and will administer justice and righteousness in the land. **6** In His days Judah will be saved, and Israel will dwell securely. And this is His name by which He will be called: The LORD Our Righteousness. **7** So behold, the days are coming, declares the LORD, when they will no longer say, ‘As surely as the LORD lives, who brought the Israelites up out of the land of Egypt.’ **8** Instead they will say, ‘As surely as the LORD lives, who brought and led the descendants of the house of Israel up out of the land of the north and all the other lands to which He had banished them.’ Then they will dwell once more in their own land.” **9** As for the

prophets: My heart is broken within me, and all my bones tremble. I have become like a drunkard, like a man overcome by wine, because of the LORD, because of His holy words. **10** For the land is full of adulterers— because of the curse, the land mourns and the pastures of the wilderness have dried up— their course is evil and their power is misused. **11** “For both prophet and priest are ungodly; even in My house I have found their wickedness,” declares the LORD. **12** “Therefore their path will become slick; they will be driven away into the darkness and fall into it. For I will bring disaster upon them in the year of their punishment,” declares the LORD. **13** “Among the prophets of Samaria I saw an offensive thing: They prophesied by Baal and led My people Israel astray. **14** And among the prophets of Jerusalem I have seen a horrible thing: They commit adultery and walk in lies. They strengthen the hands of evildoers, so that no one turns his back on wickedness. They are all like Sodom to Me; the people of Jerusalem are like Gomorrah.” **15** Therefore this is what the LORD of Hosts says concerning the prophets: “I will feed them wormwood and give them poisoned water to drink, for from the prophets of Jerusalem ungodliness has spread throughout the land.” **16** This is what the LORD of Hosts says: “Do not listen to the words of the prophets who prophesy to you. They are filling you with false hopes. They speak visions from their own minds, not from the mouth of the LORD. **17** They keep saying to those who despise Me, ‘The LORD says that you will have peace,’ and to everyone who walks in the stubbornness of his own heart, ‘No harm will come to you.’ **18** But which of them has stood in the council of the LORD to see and hear His word? Who has given heed to His word and obeyed it? **19** Behold, the storm of the LORD has gone out with fury, a whirlwind swirling down upon the heads of the wicked. **20** The anger of the LORD will not turn back until He has fully accomplished the purposes of His heart. In the days to come you will understand this clearly. **21** I did not send these prophets, yet they have run with their message; I did not speak to them, yet they have prophesied. **22** But if they had stood in My council, they would have proclaimed My words to My people and turned them back from their evil ways and deeds.” **23** “Am I only a God nearby,” declares the LORD, “and not a God far away?” **24** “Can a man hide in secret places where I cannot see him?” declares the LORD. “Do I not fill the heavens and the earth?” declares the LORD. **25** “I have heard the sayings of the prophets who prophesy lies in My name: ‘I had a dream! I had a dream!’ **26** How long will this continue in the hearts of these prophets who prophesy falsehood, these prophets of the delusion of their own minds? **27** They suppose the dreams that they tell one another will make My people forget My name, just as their fathers forgot My name through the worship of Baal. **28** Let the prophet who has a dream retell it, but let him who has My word speak it truthfully. For what is straw compared to grain?” declares the LORD. **29** “Is not My word like fire,” declares the LORD, “and like a hammer that smashes a rock?” **30** “Therefore behold,” declares the LORD, “I am against the prophets who steal from one another words they attribute to Me.” **31** “Yes,” declares the LORD, “I am against the prophets who wag their own

tongues and proclaim, ‘The LORD declares it.’” **32** “Indeed,” declares the LORD, “I am against those who prophesy false dreams and retell them to lead My people astray with their reckless lies. It was not I who sent them or commanded them, and they are of no benefit at all to these people,” declares the LORD. **33** “Now when this people or a prophet or priest asks you, ‘What is the burden of the LORD?’ you are to say to them, ‘What burden? I will forsake you, declares the LORD.’ **34** As for the prophet or priest or anyone who claims, ‘This is the burden of the LORD,’ I will punish that man and his household. **35** This is what each man is to say to his friend and to his brother: ‘What has the LORD answered?’ or ‘What has the LORD spoken?’ **36** But refer no more to the burden of the LORD, for each man’s word becomes the burden, so that you pervert the words of the living God, the LORD of Hosts, our God. **37** Thus you are to say to the prophet: ‘What has the LORD answered you?’ and ‘What has the LORD spoken?’ **38** But if you claim, ‘This is the burden of the LORD,’ then this is what the LORD says: Because you have said, ‘This is the burden of the LORD,’ and I specifically told you not to make this claim, **39** therefore I will surely forget you and will cast you out of My presence, both you and the city that I gave to you and your fathers. **40** And I will bring upon you everlasting shame and perpetual humiliation that will never be forgotten.”

*English (WEB)*

**1** “Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of my pasture!” says the LORD. **2** Therefore the LORD, the God of Israel, says against the shepherds who feed my people: “You have scattered my flock, driven them away, and have not visited them. Behold, I will visit on you the evil of your doings,” says the LORD. **3** “I will gather the remnant of my flock out of all the countries where I have driven them, and will bring them again to their folds; and they will be fruitful and multiply. **4** I will set up shepherds over them who will feed them. They will no longer be afraid or dismayed, neither will any be lacking,” says the LORD. **5** “Behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that I will raise to David a righteous Branch; and he will reign as king and deal wisely, and will execute justice and righteousness in the land. **6** In his days Judah will be saved, and Israel will dwell safely. This is his name by which he will be called: The LORD our righteousness. **7** “Therefore, behold, the days come,” says the LORD, “that they will no more say, ‘As the LORD lives, who brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;’ **8** but, ‘As the LORD lives, who brought up and who led the offspring of the house of Israel out of the north country, and from all the countries where I had driven them.’ Then they will dwell in their own land.” **9** Concerning the prophets: My heart within me is broken. All my bones shake. I am like a drunken man, and like a man whom wine has overcome, because of the LORD, and because of his holy words. **10** “For the land is full of adulterers; for because of the curse the land mourns. The pastures of the wilderness have dried up. Their course is evil, and their might is not right; **11** for both prophet and priest are profane. Yes, in my

house I have found their wickedness," says the LORD. **12** Therefore their way will be to them as slippery places in the darkness. They will be driven on, and fall therein; for I will bring evil on them, even the year of their visitation," says the LORD. **13** "I have seen folly in the prophets of Samaria. They prophesied by Baal, and caused my people Israel to err. **14** In the prophets of Jerusalem I have also seen a horrible thing: they commit adultery and walk in lies. They strengthen the hands of evildoers, so that no one returns from his wickedness. They have all become to me as Sodom, and its inhabitants as Gomorrah." **15** Therefore the LORD of Armies says concerning the prophets: "Behold, I will feed them with wormwood, and make them drink poisoned water; for from the prophets of Jerusalem ungodliness has gone out into all the land." **16** The LORD of Armies says, "Don't listen to the words of the prophets who prophesy to you. They teach you vanity. They speak a vision of their own heart, and not out of the mouth of the LORD. **17** They say continually to those who despise me, 'The LORD has said, "You will have peace;"' and to everyone who walks in the stubbornness of his own heart they say, 'No evil will come on you.' **18** For who has stood in the council of the LORD, that he should perceive and hear his word? Who has listened to my word, and heard it? **19** Behold, the LORD's storm, his wrath, has gone out. Yes, a whirling storm! It will burst on the head of the wicked. **20** The LORD's anger will not return until he has executed and performed the intents of his heart. In the latter days, you will understand it perfectly. **21** I didn't send these prophets, yet they ran. I didn't speak to them, yet they prophesied. **22** But if they had stood in my council, then they would have caused my people to hear my words, and would have turned them from their evil way, and from the evil of their doings. **23** "Am I a God at hand," says the LORD, "and not a God afar off? **24** Can anyone hide himself in secret places so that I can't see him?" says the LORD. "Don't I fill heaven and earth?" says the LORD. **25** "I have heard what the prophets have said, who prophesy lies in my name, saying, 'I had a dream! I had a dream!' **26** How long will this be in the heart of the prophets who prophesy lies, even the prophets of the deceit of their own heart? **27** They intend to cause my people to forget my name by their dreams which they each tell his neighbor, as their fathers forgot my name because of Baal. **28** The prophet who has a dream, let him tell a dream; and he who has my word, let him speak my word faithfully. What is the straw to the wheat?" says the LORD. **29** "Isn't my word like fire?" says the LORD; "and like a hammer that breaks the rock in pieces? **30** "Therefore behold, I am against the prophets," says the LORD, "who each steal my words from his neighbor. **31** Behold, I am against the prophets," says the LORD, "who use their tongues, and say, 'He says.' **32** Behold, I am against those who prophesy lying dreams," says the LORD, "who tell them, and cause my people to err by their lies, and by their vain boasting; yet I didn't send them or command them. They don't profit this people at all," says the LORD. **33** "When this people, or the prophet, or a priest, asks you, saying, 'What is the message from the LORD?' Then you shall tell them, '"What message? I will cast you off," says the LORD.' **34** As for the prophet, the priest, and the people, who

say, ‘The message from the LORD,’ I will even punish that man and his household. **35** You will say everyone to his neighbor, and everyone to his brother, ‘What has the LORD answered?’ and, ‘What has the LORD said?’ **36** You will mention the message from the LORD no more, for every man’s own word has become his message; for you have perverted the words of the living God, of the LORD of Armies, our God. **37** You will say to the prophet, ‘What has the LORD answered you?’ and, ‘What has the LORD spoken?’ **38** Although you say, ‘The message from the LORD,’ therefore the LORD says: ‘Because you say this word, “The message from the LORD,” and I have sent to you, telling you not to say, “The message from the LORD,” **39** therefore behold, I will utterly forget you, and I will cast you off with the city that I gave to you and to your fathers, away from my presence. **40** I will bring an everlasting reproach on you, and a perpetual shame, which will not be forgotten.’”

## Jeremiah 34:9

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**9** לְשַׁלַּח אִישׁ אֶת־עַבְדּוֹ וְאִישׁ אֶת־שִׁפְחָתוֹ הָעִבְרִי וְהָעִבְרִיָּה חָפְשִׁים לְבִלְתִּי עֲבָד־בָּם בִּיהוּדִי אָחִיהוּ אִישׁ

*English (BSB)*

**9** that each man should free his Hebrew slaves, both male and female, and no one should hold his fellow Jew in bondage.

*English (WEB)*

**9** that every man should let his male servant, and every man his female servant, who is a Hebrew or a Hebrewess, go free, that no one should make bondservants of them, of a Jew his brother.

## Daniel 10:13, 21

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**13** וְשַׂר מַלְכוּת פָּרַס עָמַד לְנֶגְדִּי עֶשְׂרִים וְאֶחָד יוֹם וְהִנֵּה מִיכָאֵל אַחַד הַשָּׂרִים הָרִאשֹׁנִים בָּא לְעָזְרֵנִי וַאֲנִי נוֹתַרְתִּי שָׁם אֵצֶל מַלְכֵי פָּרָס … **21** אֲבָל אַגִּיד לְךָ אֶת־הָרָשׁוּם בִּכְתָב אֱמֶת וְאֵין אָחַד מִתְחַזֵּק עִמִּי עַל־אֵלֶּה כִּי אִם־מִיכָאֵל שַׂרְכֶם

*English (BSB)*

**13** However, the prince of the kingdom of Persia opposed me for twenty-one days. Then Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me, for I had been left there with the kings of Persia. … **21** But first I will tell you what is

inscribed in the Book of Truth. Yet no one has the courage to support me against these, except Michael your prince.

*English (WEB)*

**13** But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me twenty-one days; but, behold, Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me because I remained there with the kings of Persia. … **21** But I will tell you that which is inscribed in the writing of truth. There is no one who holds with me against these but Michael your prince.

## Daniel 12:1

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וּבָעֵת הַהִיא יַעֲמֹד מִיכָאֵל הַשַּׂר הַגָּדוֹל הָעֹמֵד עַל־בְּנֵי עַמֶּךָ וְהָיְתָה עֵת צָרָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא־נִהְיְתָה
מִהְיוֹת גּוֹי עַד הָעֵת הַהִיא וּבָעֵת הַהִיא יִמָּלֵט עַמְּךָ כָּל־הַנִּמְצָא כָּתוּב בַּסֵּפֶר

*English (BSB)*

**1** “At that time Michael, the great prince who stands watch over your people, will rise up. There will be a time of distress, the likes of which will not have occurred from the beginning of nations until that time. But at that time your people—everyone whose name is found written in the book—will be delivered.

*English (WEB)*

**1** “At that time Michael will stand up, the great prince who stands for the children of your people; and there will be a time of trouble, such as never was since there was a nation even to that same time. At that time your people will be delivered, everyone who is found written in the book.

## Joel 2:28

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**28 [3:1]** וְהָיָה אַחֲרֵי־כֵן אֶשְׁפּוֹךְ אֶת־רוּחִי עַל־כָּל־בָּשָׂר וְנִבְּאוּ בְּנֵיכֶם וּבְנוֹתֵיכֶם זְקֵנֵיכֶם חֲלֹמוֹת
יַחֲלֹמוּן בַּחוּרֵיכֶם חָזְיֹנוֹת יִרְאוּ

*English (BSB)*

**28** And afterward, I will pour out My Spirit on all people. Your sons and daughters will prophesy, your old men will dream dreams, your young men will see visions.

*English (WEB)*

**28** “It will happen afterward, that I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh; and your sons and your daughters will prophesy. Your old men will dream dreams. Your young men will see visions.

## Zechariah 3

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיַּרְאֵנִי אֶת־יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל עֹמֵד לִפְנֵי מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה וְהַשָּׂטָן עֹמֵד עַל־יְמִינוֹ לְשִׂטְנוֹ **2** וַיֹּאמֶר
יְהוָה אֶל־הַשָּׂטָן יִגְעַר יְהוָה בְּךָ הַשָּׂטָן וְיִגְעַר יְהוָה בְּךָ הַבֹּחֵר בִּירוּשָׁלִַם הֲלוֹא זֶה אוּד מֻצָּל מֵאֵשׁ **3**
וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ הָיָה לָבֻשׁ בְּגָדִים צוֹאִים וְעֹמֵד לִפְנֵי הַמַּלְאָךְ **4** וַיַּעַן וַיֹּאמֶר אֶל־הָעֹמְדִים לְפָנָיו לֵאמֹר
הָסִירוּ הַבְּגָדִים הַצֹּאִים מֵעָלָיו וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו רְאֵה הֶעֱבַרְתִּי מֵעָלֶיךָ עֲוֹנֶךָ וְהַלְבֵּשׁ אֹתְךָ מַחֲלָצוֹת **5**
וָאֹמַר יָשִׂימוּ צָנִיף טָהוֹר עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ וַיָּשִׂימוּ הַצָּנִיף הַטָּהוֹר עַל־רֹאשׁוֹ וַיַּלְבִּשֻׁהוּ בְּגָדִים וּמַלְאַךְ יְהוָה
עֹמֵד **6** וַיָּעַד מַלְאַךְ יְהוָה בִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ לֵאמֹר **7** כֹּה־אָמַר יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אִם־בִּדְרָכַי תֵּלֵךְ וְאִם אֶת־
מִשְׁמַרְתִּי תִּשְׁמֹר וְגַם־אַתָּה תָּדִין אֶת־בֵּיתִי וְגַם תִּשְׁמֹר אֶת־חֲצָרַי וְנָתַתִּי לְךָ מַהְלְכִים בֵּין הָעֹמְדִים
הָאֵלֶּה **8** שְׁמַע־נָא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל אַתָּה וְרֵעֶיךָ הַיֹּשְׁבִים לְפָנֶיךָ כִּי־אַנְשֵׁי מוֹפֵת הֵמָּה כִּי־הִנְנִי
מֵבִיא אֶת־עַבְדִּי צֶמַח **9** כִּי הִנֵּה הָאֶבֶן אֲשֶׁר נָתַתִּי לִפְנֵי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ עַל־אֶבֶן אַחַת שִׁבְעָה עֵינָיִם הִנְנִי
מְפַתֵּחַ פִּתֻּחָהּ נְאֻם יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת וּמַשְׁתִּי אֶת־עֲוֹן הָאָרֶץ־הַהִיא בְּיוֹם אֶחָד **10** בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא נְאֻם יְהוָה
צְבָאוֹת תִּקְרְאוּ אִישׁ לְרֵעֵהוּ אֶל־תַּחַת גֶּפֶן וְאֶל־תַּחַת תְּאֵנָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the angel showed me Joshua the high priest standing before the angel of the LORD, with Satan standing at his right hand to accuse him. **2** And the LORD said to Satan: “The LORD rebukes you, Satan! Indeed, the LORD, who has chosen Jerusalem, rebukes you! Is not this man a firebrand snatched from the fire?” **3** Now Joshua was dressed in filthy garments as he stood before the angel. **4** So the angel said to those standing before him, “Take off his filthy clothes!” Then he said to Joshua, “See, I have removed your iniquity, and I will clothe you with splendid robes.” **5** Then I said, “Let them put a clean turban on his head.” So a clean turban was placed on his head, and they clothed him, as the angel of the LORD stood by. **6** Then the angel of the LORD gave this charge to Joshua: **7** “This is what the LORD of Hosts says: ‘If you walk in My ways and keep My instructions, then you will govern My house and will also have charge of My courts; and I will give you a place among these who are standing here. **8** Hear now, O high priest Joshua, you and your companions seated before you, who are indeed a sign. For behold, I am going to bring My servant, the Branch. **9** See the stone I have set before Joshua; on that one stone are seven eyes. Behold, I will engrave on it an inscription, declares the LORD of Hosts, and I will remove the iniquity of this land in a single day. **10** On that day, declares the LORD of Hosts, you will each invite your neighbor to sit under your own vine and fig tree.’”

*English (WEB)*

**1** He showed me Joshua the high priest standing before the LORD’s angel, and Satan standing at his right hand to be his adversary. **2** The LORD said to Satan, “The LORD rebuke you, Satan! Yes, the LORD who has chosen Jerusalem rebuke you! Isn’t this a burning stick plucked out of the fire?” **3** Now Joshua was clothed with filthy garments, and was standing before the angel. **4** He answered and spoke to those who stood before him, saying, “Take the filthy garments off him.” To him he said, “Behold, I have caused your iniquity to pass from you, and I will clothe you with rich clothing.” **5** I said, “Let them set a clean turban on his head.” So they set a clean turban on his head, and clothed him; and the LORD’s angel was standing by. **6** The LORD’s angel solemnly assured Joshua, saying, **7** “The LORD of Armies says: ‘If you will walk in my ways, and if you will follow my instructions, then you also shall judge my house, and shall also keep my courts, and I will give you a place of access among these who stand by. **8** Hear now, Joshua the high priest, you and your fellows who sit before you, for they are men who are a sign; for, behold, I will bring out my servant, the Branch. **9** For, behold, the stone that I have set before Joshua: on one stone are seven eyes; behold, I will engrave its inscription,’ says the LORD of Armies, ‘and I will remove the iniquity of that land in one day. **10** In that day,’ says the LORD of Armies, ‘you will invite every man his neighbor under the vine and under the fig tree.’”

### Matthew 4:10

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** τότε λέγει αὐτῷ ὁ Ἰησοῦς· Ὕπαγε, Σατανᾶ· γέγραπται γάρ· Κύριον τὸν θεόν σου προσκυνήσεις καὶ αὐτῷ μόνῳ λατρεύσεις.

*English (BSB)*

**10** “Away from Me, Satan!” Jesus declared. “For it is written: ‘Worship the Lord your God and serve Him only.’”

*English (WEB)*

**10** Then Jesus said to him, “Get behind me, Satan! For it is written, ‘You shall worship the Lord your God, and you shall serve him only.’”

### Acts 2:17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**17** Καὶ ἔσται ἐν ταῖς ἐσχάταις ἡμέραις, λέγει ὁ θεός, ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ πνεύματός μου ἐπὶ πᾶσαν σάρκα, καὶ προφητεύσουσιν οἱ υἱοὶ ὑμῶν καὶ αἱ θυγατέρες ὑμῶν, καὶ οἱ νεανίσκοι ὑμῶν �ράσεις ὄψονται, καὶ οἱ πρεσβύτεροι ὑμῶν ἐνυπνίοις ἐνυπνιασθήσονται·

*English (BSB)*

**17** ’In the last days, God says, I will pour out My Spirit on all people. Your sons and daughters will prophesy, your young men will see visions, your old men will dream dreams.

*English (WEB)*

**17** ’It will be in the last days, says God, that I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh. Your sons and your daughters will prophesy. Your young men will see visions. Your old men will dream dreams.

### Acts 7:53

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**53** οἵτινες ἐλάβετε τὸν νόμον εἰς διαταγὰς ἀγγέλων, καὶ οὐκ ἐφυλάξατε.

*English (BSB)*

**53** you who received the law ordained by angels, yet have not kept it.”

*English (WEB)*

**53** You received the law as it was ordained by angels, and didn’t keep it!”

### Romans 1:22–24

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**22** φάσκοντες εἶναι σοφοὶ ἐμωράνθησαν, **23** καὶ ἤλλαξαν τὴν δόξαν τοῦ ἀφθάρτου θεοῦ ἐν ὁμοιώματι εἰκόνος φθαρτοῦ ἀνθρώπου καὶ πετεινῶν καὶ τετραπόδων καὶ ἑρπετῶν. **24** Διὸ παρέδωκεν αὐτοὺς ὁ θεὸς ἐν ταῖς ἐπιθυμίαις τῶν καρδιῶν αὐτῶν εἰς ἀκαθαρσίαν τοῦ ἀτιμάζεσθαι τὰ σώματα αὐτῶν ἐν αὐτοῖς,

*English (BSB)*

**22** Although they claimed to be wise, they became fools, **23** and exchanged the glory of the immortal God for images of mortal man and birds and animals and reptiles. **24** Therefore God gave them over in the desires of their hearts to impurity for the dishonoring of their bodies with one another.

*English (WEB)*

**22** Professing themselves to be wise, they became fools, **23** and traded the glory of the incorruptible God for the likeness of an image of corruptible man, and of birds, four-footed animals, and creeping things. **24** Therefore God also gave them up in the lusts of their hearts to uncleanness, that their bodies should be dishonored among themselves;

### 1 Corinthians 14:29

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**29** προφῆται δὲ δύο ἢ τρεῖς λαλείτωσαν, καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι διακρινέτωσαν·

*English (BSB)*

**29** Two or three prophets should speak, and the others should weigh carefully what is said.

*English (WEB)*

**29** Let two or three of the prophets speak, and let the others discern.

## Galatians 3:19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** Τί οὖν ὁ νόμος; τῶν παραβάσεων χάριν προσετέθη, ἄχρις οὗ ἔλθῃ τὸ σπέρμα ᾧ ἐπήγγελται, διαταγεὶς δι᾽ ἀγγέλων ἐν χειρὶ μεσίτου·

*English (BSB)*

**19** Why then was the law given? It was added because of transgressions, until the arrival of the seed to whom the promise referred. It was administered through angels by a mediator.

*English (WEB)*

**19** Then why is there the law? It was added because of transgressions, until the offspring should come to whom the promise has been made. It was ordained through angels by the hand of a mediator.

## Ephesians 1:21

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**21** ὑπεράνω πάσης ἀρχῆς καὶ ἐξουσίας καὶ δυνάμεως καὶ κυριότητος καὶ παντὸς ὀνόματος ὀνομαζομένου οὐ μόνον ἐν τῷ αἰῶνι τούτῳ ἀλλὰ καὶ ἐν τῷ μέλλοντι·

*English (BSB)*

**21** far above all rule and authority, power and dominion, and every name that is named, not only in the present age but also in the one to come.

*English (WEB)*

**21** far above all rule, authority, power, dominion, and every name that is named, not only in this age, but also in that which is to come.

## Philippians 3:19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** ὧν τὸ τέλος ἀπώλεια, ὧν ὁ θεὸς ἡ κοιλία καὶ ἡ δόξα ἐν τῇ αἰσχύνῃ αὐτῶν, οἱ τὰ ἐπίγεια φρονοῦντες.

*English (BSB)*

**19** Their end is destruction, their god is their belly, and their glory is in their shame. Their minds are set on earthly things.

*English (WEB)*

**19** whose end is destruction, whose god is the belly, and whose glory is in their shame, who think about earthly things.

## Colossians 1:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** ὅτι ἐν αὐτῷ ἐκτίσθη τὰ πάντα ἐν τοῖς οὐρανοῖς καὶ ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς, τὰ ὁρατὰ καὶ τὰ ἀόρατα, εἴτε θρόνοι εἴτε κυριότητες εἴτε ἀρχαὶ εἴτε ἐξουσίαι· τὰ πάντα δι᾽ αὐτοῦ καὶ εἰς αὐτὸν ἔκτισται·

*English (BSB)*

**16** For in Him all things were created, things in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities. All things were created through Him and for Him.

*English (WEB)*

**16** For by him all things were created in the heavens and on the earth, visible things and invisible things, whether thrones or dominions or principalities or powers. All things have been created through him and for him.

## 1 Thessalonians 4:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** ὅτι αὐτὸς ὁ κύριος ἐν κελεύσματι, ἐν φωνῇ ἀρχαγγέλου καὶ ἐν σάλπιγγι θεοῦ, καταβήσεται ἀπ᾽ οὐρανοῦ, καὶ οἱ νεκροὶ ἐν Χριστῷ ἀναστήσονται πρῶτον,

*English (BSB)*

**16** For the Lord Himself will descend from heaven with a loud command, with the voice of an archangel, and with the trumpet of God, and the dead in Christ will be the first to rise.

*English (WEB)*

**16** For the Lord himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel and with God’s trumpet. The dead in Christ will rise first,

### 1 Thessalonians 5:19–21

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** τὸ πνεῦμα μὴ σβέννυτε, **20** προφητείας μὴ ἐξουθενεῖτε· **21** πάντα δὲ δοκιμάζετε, τὸ καλὸν κατέχετε,

*English (BSB)*

**19** Do not extinguish the Spirit. **20** Do not treat prophecies with contempt, **21** but test all things. Hold fast to what is good.

*English (WEB)*

**19** Don’t quench the Spirit. **20** Don’t despise prophecies. **21** Test all things, and hold firmly that which is good.

### Titus 1:15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** πάντα καθαρὰ τοῖς καθαροῖς· τοῖς δὲ μεμιαμμένοις καὶ ἀπίστοις οὐδὲν καθαρόν, ἀλλὰ μεμίανται αὐτῶν καὶ ὁ νοῦς καὶ ἡ συνείδησις.

*English (BSB)*

**15** To the pure, all things are pure; but to the defiled and unbelieving, nothing is pure. Indeed, both their minds and their consciences are defiled.

*English (WEB)*

**15** To the pure, all things are pure, but to those who are defiled and unbelieving, nothing is pure; but both their mind and their conscience are defiled.

### Hebrews 2:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** εἰ γὰρ ὁ δι’ ἀγγέλων λαληθεὶς λόγος ἐγένετο βέβαιος, καὶ πᾶσα παράβασις καὶ παρακοὴ ἔλαβεν ἔνδικον μισθαποδοσίαν,

*English (BSB)*

**2** For if the message spoken by angels was binding, and every transgression and disobedience received its just punishment,

*English (WEB)*

**2** For if the word spoken through angels proved steadfast, and every transgression and disobedience received a just penalty,

## 2 Peter 2:10–12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** μάλιστα δὲ τοὺς ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ μιασμοῦ πορευομένους καὶ κυριότητος καταφρονοῦντας. Τολμηταί, αὐθάδεις, δόξας οὐ τρέμουσιν, βλασφημοῦντες, **11** ὅπου ἄγγελοι ἰσχύϊ καὶ δυνάμει μείζονες ὄντες οὐ φέρουσιν κατ᾽ αὐτῶν βλάσφημον κρίσιν. **12** οὗτοι δέ, ὡς ἄλογα ζῷα γεγεννημένα φυσικὰ εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν, ἐν οἷς ἀγνοοῦσιν βλασφημοῦντες, ἐν τῇ φθορᾷ αὐτῶν καὶ φθαρήσονται,

*English (BSB)*

**10** Such punishment is specially reserved for those who indulge the corrupt desires of the flesh and despise authority. Bold and self-willed, they are unafraid to slander glorious beings. **11** Yet not even angels, though greater in strength and power, dare to bring such slanderous charges against them before the Lord. **12** These men are like irrational animals, creatures of instinct, born to be captured and destroyed. They blaspheme in matters they do not understand, and like such creatures, they too will be destroyed.

*English (WEB)*

**10** but chiefly those who walk after the flesh in the lust of defilement and despise authority. Daring, self-willed, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignitaries, **11** whereas angels, though greater in might and power, don’t bring a slanderous judgment against them before the Lord. **12** But these, as unreasoning creatures, born natural animals to be taken and destroyed, speaking evil in matters about which they are ignorant, will in their destroying surely be destroyed,

## 1 John 4:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἀγαπητοί, μὴ παντὶ πνεύματι πιστεύετε, ἀλλὰ δοκιμάζετε τὰ πνεύματα εἰ ἐκ τοῦ θεοῦ ἐστιν, ὅτι πολλοὶ ψευδοπροφῆται ἐξεληλύθασιν εἰς τὸν κόσμον.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits to see whether they are from God. For many false prophets have gone out into the world.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Beloved, don’t believe every spirit, but test the spirits, whether they are of God, because many false prophets have gone out into the world.

## Revelation 12:7–9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** Καὶ ἐγένετο πόλεμος ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ, ὁ Μιχαὴλ καὶ οἱ ἄγγελοι αὐτοῦ τοῦ πολεμῆσαι μετὰ τοῦ δράκοντος. καὶ ὁ δράκων ἐπολέμησεν καὶ οἱ ἄγγελοι αὐτοῦ, **8** καὶ οὐκ ἴσχυσεν, οὐδὲ τόπος εὑρέθη αὐτῶν ἔτι ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ. **9** καὶ ἐβλήθη ὁ δράκων ὁ μέγας, ὁ ὄφις ὁ ἀρχαῖος, ὁ καλούμενος Διάβολος καὶ ὁ Σατανᾶς, ὁ πλανῶν τὴν οἰκουμένην ὅλην— ἐβλήθη εἰς τὴν γῆν, καὶ οἱ ἄγγελοι αὐτοῦ μετ᾽ αὐτοῦ ἐβλήθησαν.

*English (BSB)*

**7** Then a war broke out in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon, and the dragon and his angels fought back. **8** But the dragon was not strong enough, and no longer was any place found in heaven for him and his angels. **9** And the great dragon was hurled down—that ancient serpent called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world. He was hurled to the earth, and his angels with him.

*English (WEB)*

**7** There was war in the sky. Michael and his angels made war on the dragon. The dragon and his angels made war. **8** They didn’t prevail. No place was found for them any more in heaven. **9** The great dragon was thrown down, the old serpent, he who is called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world. He was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him.

# Chapter 5. The Way of Cain, the Error of Balaam, the Rebellion of Korah (Jude 11)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **11** οὐαὶ αὐτοῖς, ὅτι τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Κάϊν ἐπορεύθησαν, καὶ τῇ πλάνῃ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ μισθοῦ ἐξεχύθησαν, καὶ τῇ ἀντιλογίᾳ τοῦ Κόρε ἀπώλοντο.
>
> — Jude 11, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript's first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); ℵ = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

Notes. v. 11: no difference that affects translation (P72 spells Balaam's name Βαλαάκ); not extant in P78; only partly extant in C.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

#### Jude 11

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Wo be vnto them for they have folowed the waye of Cayn and are vtterly geven to the erroure of Balam for lukers sake and perysshe in the treason of Core. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | Wo be vnto them: for they haue followed the way of Cain, and are cast away by the deceit of Balaams wages, and perish in the gainsaying of Core. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Woe unto them, for they have gone in the way of Cain: and after the error of Balaam they have for reward poured out themselves, and have perished in the contradiction of Core. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Woe to them! for they have gone in the way of Cain, and run greedily after the error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Core. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | Woe to them! for they have gone in the way of Cain, and rushed on in the error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Korah. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Woe unto them! for they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in the gainsaying of Korah. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | Woe to them! because they have gone in the way of Cain, and given themselves up to the error of Balaam for reward, and perished in the gainsaying of Core. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | woe to them! because in the way of Cain they did go on, and to the deceit of Balaam for reward they did rush, and in the gainsaying of Korah they did perish. |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Woe unto them! for they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in the gainsaying of Korah. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Woe to them! For they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in Korah's rebellion. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | God will do terrible things to those who teach false doctrine! They conduct their lives wickedly like Cain, who murdered his brother because he was ◄jealous/angry because God accepted his brother's sacrifice and did not accept his►. These false teachers ◄devote themselves to [MET] doing wrong things like Balaam, who tried to induce God's people to sin in order to get the money that was offered to him. They will |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | perish like Korah, who rebelled against the authority that God gave to Moses. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | Alas for them! They walk in the steps of Cain; led astray by Balaam's love of gain, they plunge into sin, and meet their ruin through rebellion like Korah. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Woe to them! For they have walked in the way of Cain and have plunged into Balaam's error for profit. They have perished in Korah's rebellion. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | They're in terrible trouble! For they have followed Cain's way. Like Balaam and his delusion, they have abandoned themselves to the profit motive. Like Korah and his rebellion, they have destroyed themselves. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | woe to them! Because they went on in the way of Cain, and they rushed to the deceit of Balaam for reward, and in the controversy of Korah they perished. |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Woe to them! They have traveled the path of Cain; they have rushed headlong into the error of Balaam; they have perished in Korah's rebellion. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Woe to them! They have traveled the path of Cain; they have rushed headlong into the error of Balaam; they have perished in Korah's rebellion. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Woe to them! For they went in the way of Cain, they rushed for reward to the error of Balaam, and they perished in the rebellion of Korah. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Jude now speaks as a prophet. He pronounces a "woe" over the intruders, an announcement of coming judgment mixed with lament. He gives the reason by comparing them to three notorious figures from Israel's scriptures:

- **Cain**, the first murderer, who killed his brother out of envy;
- **Balaam**, the prophet-for-hire, who led Israel into immorality and idolatry for profit;
- **Korah**, the Levite who rebelled against the leadership God had appointed and was swallowed by the earth.

Each figure stands for a kind of sin that Jude sees in the intruders. The three verbs also trace a progression: they *went* in Cain's way, they *abandoned themselves* to Balaam's error, and they *perished* in Korah's rebellion. Jude speaks of their destruction as if it had already happened, because in his view it is as certain as Korah's was.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### οὐαὶ αὐτοῖς (*ouai autois*) — 'woe to them'

The interjection οὐαί (*ouai*), "woe!" or "alas!", is the classic opening of a prophetic oracle of judgment. Isaiah pronounces a series of them: "Woe [to] those saying to evil 'good,' and to good 'evil'" (Isa 5:20, LSV). Habakkuk, Amos, and other prophets use the same form. Jesus pronounced woes on the rich and on the scribes and Pharisees (Luke 6:24–26; Matt 23:13–36). The Epistle of Enoch, part of 1 Enoch that Jude knew, contains long series of woes against sinners: "Woe to those who build unrighteousness and oppression / And lay deceit as a foundation; / For they shall be suddenly overthrown" (1 Enoch 94:6, trans. Charles).[78]

Outside the Gospels and Revelation, the word "woe" appears in the New Testament only twice: in Paul's "woe is to me if I may not proclaim good news" (1 Cor 9:16, LSV) and here.[79] Jude's is the only woe pronounced against others in the New Testament letters. It marks this verse as the emotional and prophetic climax of the first half of his argument.

A woe is not a curse that the speaker wishes on someone. It is a solemn announcement that judgment is coming. It often carries a note of grief. The English "alas" catches some of that tone.

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78. 1 Enoch 94:6, trans. R. H. Charles, *The Book of Enoch* (1917), Wikisource. Woes continue through chs. 94–100.↩

79. Computed from MorphGNT/SBLGNT: οὐαί occurs in Matthew (13), Mark (2), Luke (15), 1 Corinthians (1, at 9:16), Jude (1), and Revelation (14).↩

### ὅτι τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Κάϊν ἐπορεύθησαν (*hoti tē hodō tou Kain eporeuthēsan*) — 'for they went the way of Cain'

The first verb, ἐπορεύθησαν (*eporeuthēsan*), "they went, walked," pictures a course of life, a "way" (ὁδός, *hodos*) followed by choice. To walk in someone's way is to follow that person's example. The phrase τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Κάϊν (*tē hodō tou Kain*), "the way of Cain," does not refer only to one act of murder. It refers to the kind of life Cain represents.

What did Cain represent? Genesis tells the bare story: Cain's offering was not accepted, he became angry, and he killed his brother Abel. When God asked where Abel was, Cain replied, "I have not known; am I my brother's keeper?" (Gen 4:9, LSV). The deep dive below shows how Jewish and Christian interpreters filled out the picture. For Jude's purpose, three features are most likely in view:

- **Envy and hatred of a brother.** First John draws exactly this lesson: "not as Cain—he was of the evil one, and he slew his brother. And for [what] reason did he slay him? Because his works were evil, and those of his brother [were] righteous" (1 John 3:12, LSV). Jude's intruders are divisive (v. 19), and they sit at the love feasts while betraying their meaning (v. 12).
- **Cynicism about judgment.** Jewish tradition remembered Cain as the first person to deny that God judges. In the Targum's retelling, Cain says to Abel, "There is neither judgment nor Judge, nor another world; nor will good reward be given to the righteous, nor vengeance be taken of the wicked."[80] Jude's intruders, the "scoffers" of v. 18, live as if judgment were not real.
- **Corrupting others.** Josephus describes Cain after his exile as one who "excited his acquaintance to procure pleasures and spoils by robbery, and became a great leader of men into wicked courses."[81] Jude's intruders lead others astray.

Jude does not say which aspect he means. He may intend the whole tradition. Cain is the first person in Scripture to turn against God's order and against his brother, the father of a "way" that others follow.

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80. Targum Pseudo-Jonathan on Gen 4:8, trans. J. W. Etheridge, *The Targums of Onkelos and Jonathan ben Uzziel on the Pentateuch* (1862), https://www.targum.info/pj/pjgen1-6.htm. The Jerusalem (Fragment) Targum has a similar exchange.↩

81. Josephus, *Antiquities* 1.2.2 (Whiston), Project Gutenberg #2848.↩

### καὶ τῇ πλάνῃ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ μισθοῦ ἐξεχύθησαν (*kai tē planē tou Balaam misthou exechythēsan*) — 'and for pay they poured themselves into the error of Balaam'

The second verb is vivid. ἐξεχύθησαν (*exechythēsan*) is the passive of ἐκχέω (*ekcheō*), "to pour out." Used of people it means "they were poured out," that is, they gave themselves up wholly or abandoned themselves.[82] The LSV's "rushed" catches the headlong motion. The ASV has "ran riotously" (ASV), Webster "run greedily" (WBS), and the BSB "rushed headlong" (BSB). The intruders did not drift into Balaam's error. They threw themselves into it.

“The deceit of Balaam” translates τῇ πλάνῃ τοῦ Βαλαάμ (*tē planē tou Balaam*). The noun πλάνη (*planē*) means “error, wandering, deception,” the state of going astray and leading others astray. It belongs to the same word family as the “stars going astray” (ἀστέρες πλανῆται, *asteres planētai*) of v. 13.

The phrase μισθοῦ (*misthou*), “for reward” or “for pay,” is a genitive of price: they abandoned themselves to error *for wages*. Balaam was famous for being hired. Moab’s king Balak sent elders “with divinations in their hand,” payment for the seer’s services (Num 22:7, LSV), and promised to honor him greatly (Num 22:17). Deuteronomy remembers that Moab “hired against you Balaam son of Beor … to revile you” (Deut 23:4, LSV). Second Peter summarizes: Balaam “loved a reward of unrighteousness” (2 Pet 2:15, LSV).

Balaam’s “error” was more than greed. According to Numbers, after he failed to curse Israel, it was “through the word of Balaam” that the Israelites were led “to cause a trespass against YHWH in the matter of Peor” (Num 31:16, LSV), the episode in which Israelite men engaged in sexual immorality with Moabite and Midianite women and joined in the worship of their gods (Num 25:1–3). Revelation puts the tradition plainly: Balaam “taught Balak to cast a stumbling-block before the sons of Israel, to eat idol-sacrifices, and to commit whoredom” (Rev 2:14, LSV). For Jude’s readers, Balaam was the prophet who, for profit, taught God’s people that immorality was permissible. The parallel with the intruders, who turn grace into licentiousness (v. 4) and flatter people “for the sake of profit” (v. 16), is exact.

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82. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἐκχέω: “pass., of persons (like Lat. *effundor*), to give oneself up to (RV, ran riotously in): Ju 11.”↩

### καὶ τῇ ἀντιλογίᾳ τοῦ Κόρε ἀπώλοντο (*kai tē antilogia tou Kore apōlonto*) — ‘and perished in the rebellion of Korah’

The third clause turns to rebellion. “Controversy” translates ἀντιλογίᾳ (*antilogia*), literally “speaking against,” hence “contradiction, dispute, rebellion.”[83] The LSV’s “controversy” is literal. Most translations have “rebellion” (WEB, BSB) or “gainsaying” (ASV, WBS).

The word carries an echo that Jude’s Greek-reading audience may have heard. In the Septuagint, ἀντιλογία is the word used for the “water of contention” at Meribah, where Israel quarreled with Moses and God: Τοῦτο τὸ ὕδωρ Ἀντιλογίας, ‘This is the water of Contention’ (Num 20:13 LXX; also Num 27:14; Deut 32:51; 33:8). It is also used for legal disputes brought before judges (Exod 18:16; Deut 17:8; 19:17).[84] The word suggests a challenge to God-given authority.

Korah’s story is told in Numbers 16. A Levite, already privileged to serve at the tabernacle, he led two hundred and fifty leaders of the congregation

against Moses and Aaron. His slogan sounded spiritual and egalitarian: “Enough of you! For all the congregation—all of them [are] holy, and YHWH [is] in their midst; and why do you lift yourselves up above the assembly of YHWH?” (Num 16:3, LSV). Moses saw through it: “is it little to you that the God of Israel has separated you … and you have also sought the priesthood! Therefore, you and all your congregation are meeting against YHWH” (Num 16:9–11, LSV). The judgment was spectacular: “the earth opens her mouth and swallows them … and they go down—they and all that they have—alive to Sheol … and they perish from the midst of the assembly” (Num 16:32–33, LSV), while fire consumed the two hundred and fifty who offered incense (16:35).

The verb ἀπώλοντο (*apōlonto*), “they perished,” is in the aorist, a past tense. Jude speaks of the intruders as if they had *already* perished. Grammarians sometimes call this a “prophetic” use of the past tense: a future event is described as already accomplished because it is so certain. In a sense they perished when they joined Korah’s rebellion, as Korah’s company was doomed the moment it set itself against God. The word ἀπόλλυμι (*apollymi*) also links back to v. 5, where Jesus “destroyed” (ἀπώλεσεν, *apōlesen*) the unbelieving wilderness generation.

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83. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀντιλογία: “[in LXX chiefly for רִיב] gain-saying, strife.”↩

84. Brenton’s Greek Septuagint: Num 20:13; 27:14; Deut 32:51; 33:8 (the “water of contention”); Exod 18:16; Deut 17:8; 19:17; 21:5; 25:1 (legal disputes).↩

### The progression of the three verbs

Read in sequence, the three verbs describe a downward path:

| Verb | Figure | Stage |
|---|---|---|
| ἐπορεύθησαν, “they went” | Cain | Setting out on a way of life |
| ἐξεχύθησαν, “they rushed / abandoned themselves” | Balaam | Throwing oneself into it wholeheartedly |
| ἀπώλοντο, “they perished” | Korah | Reaching its end |

The sins also escalate. Cain’s sin was personal: hatred, murder, and contempt for judgment. Balaam’s sin led others into sin for profit. Korah’s sin openly defied God’s appointed order. The intruders, Jude suggests, embody all three.

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| οὐαί | *ouai* | woe, alas | “woe” | Prophetic oracle of judgment; |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | only woe against others in the NT letters. |
| πορεύομαι | *poreuomai* | go, walk, proceed | “went on” | Way of life; also vv. 16, 18. |
| ὁδός | *hodos* | way, road | “the way of Cain” | Pattern of life. |
| Κάϊν | *Kain* | Cain | “Cain” | |
| ἐκχέω (pass.) | *ekcheō* | pour out; (of persons) abandon oneself | “rushed” | Passive used reflexively. |
| πλάνη | *planē* | error, deception, wandering | “deceit” | Related to πλανῆται (v. 13). |
| Βαλαάμ | *Balaam* | Balaam | “Balaam” | |
| μισθός | *misthos* | wages, reward | “for reward” | Genitive of price. |
| ἀντιλογία | *antilogia* | contradiction, dispute, rebellion | “controversy” | LXX: Meribah “water of contention”; legal disputes. |
| Κόρε | *Kore* | Korah | “Korah” | Only here in the NT. |
| ἀπόλλυμι | *apollymi* | destroy; (mid.) perish | “they perished” | Aorist describing certain doom; links to v. 5. |

**A caution about “prophetic aorist.”** Not every past tense in prophecy is a “prophetic aorist.” Here, though, the context makes the category apt. Jude has just said the intruders’ judgment is “written beforehand” (v. 4) and is about to quote Enoch’s prophecy of judgment in the past tense: “Behold, the LORD has come” (v. 14). The past tense expresses certainty.

## Deep dive: Cain, Balaam, and Korah in Scripture and tradition

The three figures had rich afterlives in Jewish and Christian interpretation, and Jude’s readers would have heard his brief allusions against that background.

**Cain.**

- *In Genesis* (4:1–16), Cain is the firstborn of Adam and Eve and a tiller of the ground. His offering is not accepted. God warns him that sin is

crouching at the door but that he must rule over it (4:7). He kills Abel, denies responsibility, and is sentenced to be "a wanderer, even a trembling one" (4:12, LSV), though God marks him for protection.

- *In the New Testament*, Cain is the archetype of hatred: "not as Cain—he was of the evil one" (1 John 3:12, LSV). Hebrews contrasts Abel's faith with Cain's lack of it: "By faith Abel offered a better sacrifice to God than Cain" (Heb 11:4, LSV). Jesus speaks of "all the righteous blood … from the blood of Abel the righteous" (Matt 23:35, LSV).
- *In Jewish tradition*, Cain became the prototype of several vices. Josephus portrays him as "wholly intent upon getting," the inventor of "measures and weights," who "changed the world into cunning craftiness" and "became a great leader of men into wicked courses."[85] The Palestinian Targums turn the brothers' conversation in the field into a theological argument, with Cain denying that there is "judgment" or a "Judge" or "another world," and Abel affirming them, before Cain kills him.[86] (The Targums as we have them were written down later than Jude, though they preserve older traditions. Their witness here is to a line of interpretation, not proof of what Jude had read.)

Any of these portraits could stand behind Jude's "way of Cain." Jealous hatred fits the divisions in v. 19. Leading others into sin and greed fit vv. 11–12 and 16. Denial of judgment fits the "scoffers" of v. 18. Jude's brevity leaves the allusion open, and that openness allows it to cover the full range of the intruders' behavior.

**Balaam.**

- *In Numbers 22–24*, Balaam is a non-Israelite seer from Pethor on the Euphrates whom Balak, king of Moab, hires to curse Israel. Repeatedly, he insists, "If Balak gives to me the fullness of his house of silver and gold, I am not able to pass over the command of YHWH" (Num 24:13, LSV), and he ends up blessing Israel. His donkey sees the angel that he cannot see and speaks to him (22:21–35). Read by itself, the story is ambiguous. Balaam obeys God's word in the end, but his eagerness to go, and God's anger at his going (22:22), suggest mixed motives.
- *The rest of Scripture* resolves the ambiguity negatively. Numbers 31:16 blames Balaam's counsel for the apostasy at Peor. Deuteronomy, Nehemiah, and Joshua remember him as hired to curse Israel and as "the diviner" killed among Israel's enemies (Deut 23:4–5; Neh 13:2; Josh 13:22). Micah calls Israel to "remember … What Balaam son of Beor answered" Balak (Mic 6:5, LSV).
- *In Jewish tradition*, Josephus has Balaam advise the Midianites to send their most beautiful daughters to the Israelite camp to seduce the young men into abandoning their law and worshipping other gods, "for by this means God will be angry at them."[87]

- *In the New Testament*, Balaam becomes the type of the false teacher who is motivated by money and leads believers into immorality and idolatry (2 Pet 2:15–16; Rev 2:14).

Jude's two words, "error" and "reward," compress this whole tradition. The intruders are teachers who, for personal gain, mislead God's people into sexual immorality while claiming spiritual authority.

**Korah.**

- *In Numbers 16*, Korah, a Levite of the clan of Kohath, joined with the Reubenites Dathan, Abiram, and On to challenge Moses' leadership and Aaron's priesthood. God vindicated Moses: the earth swallowed the rebels, and fire consumed the two hundred and fifty incense-offerers. Afterward, God confirmed Aaron's priesthood by making his rod blossom, so that "the murmurings of the sons of Israel" would cease (Num 17:5, LSV).
- *Elsewhere in Scripture*, Korah's rebellion is remembered as "striving against YHWH" (Num 26:9, LSV) and as envy: "they are envious of Moses in the camp, / Of Aaron, YHWH's holy one" (Ps 106:16, LSV). Ben Sira recalls how "the congregation of Core" maligned Aaron "with fury and wrath" and were "consumed … with the fiery flame" (Sir 45:18–19, Brenton). Remarkably, "the sons of Korah did not die" (Num 26:11, LSV). Their descendants became temple singers, and several psalms bear their name.
- *In Jewish tradition*, Korah became the archetype of the schismatic who challenges legitimate authority under the guise of spiritual equality.

Korah's slogan, "all the congregation—all of them [are] holy," sounds like something the New Testament itself might say, and in a sense it does (1 Pet 2:9). That is what makes him a fitting type for the intruders. Their rejection of authority (v. 8) may have been dressed in the language of spiritual freedom and equality. Korah shows that true statements can be used to justify rebellion against God's order.

**Why these three?** All three are figures who opposed God's purposes while associated in some way with God's people or God's word: a son of Adam, a prophet, and a Levite. All three led others, or tried to lead others, with them. All three met judgment. Together they show that the intruders' danger lies not only in their own sin but in their influence on others.

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85. Josephus, *Antiquities* 1.2.1–2 (Whiston).↩

86. Targum Pseudo-Jonathan and Jerusalem Targum on Gen 4:8 (Etheridge). On the dating of the Targums, see the standard introductions; the traditions they preserve are older than the written texts, but how much older is debated.↩

87. Josephus, *Antiquities* 4.6.6 (Whiston).↩

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Prophetic speech in the early church.** Early Christian communities recognized prophets alongside apostles and teachers (Acts 13:1; 1 Cor 12:28; Eph 4:11). Jude's woe oracle shows him speaking with prophetic authority, in the tradition of Israel's prophets and of Jesus. His opponents, the "dreamers," may also have claimed prophetic gifts. Jude answers prophecy with prophecy, but his prophecy is anchored in Scripture.

**Paid religious teachers.** In the Greco-Roman world, philosophers and religious specialists often taught for fees, and critics of the time routinely mocked them for greed. Early Christians debated how traveling ministers should be supported. Paul defended the right to support but often declined it so as not to burden or mislead (1 Cor 9:3–18; 1 Thess 2:5–9). The *Didache* warns that a traveling apostle who "ask[s] money" is a false prophet.[88] Balaam was a fitting type for teachers whose message bent to their income.

**Interpreting Israel's stories as types.** Jewish and early Christian teachers commonly read figures from Israel's history as patterns (Greek τύποι, *typoi*, "types") for the present. Paul says of the wilderness stories, "these things happened to those persons as types, and they were written for our admonition" (1 Cor 10:11, LSV). Jude's three figures are used in exactly this way.

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88. *Didache* 11.6, ANF 7.↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**1 John 3:11–12 (shared tradition).** John's use of Cain as the antithesis of brotherly love is the closest New Testament parallel to Jude's reference. Both writers assume that their readers know Cain as a type of the person who belongs to the evil one.

**2 Peter 2:15–16 (literary parallel).** Peter expands Jude's Balaam reference, mentioning Balaam's love of "a reward of unrighteousness" and the "mute donkey" that "forbid the madness of the prophet" (LSV). He omits Cain and Korah.

**Revelation 2:14 (shared tradition).** The letter to Pergamum names "those holding the teaching of Balaam," which Revelation defines as eating idol-sacrifices and committing sexual immorality. The parallel shows that Balaam had become a standard type of the antinomian teacher in early Christianity.

**Numbers 16; Psalm 106:16–18; Sirach 45:18–19 (Korah).** The core narrative and its later echoes. The theme of envy in Ps 106:16 parallels the

grumbling of Jude 16.

**Isaiah 5; Luke 6:24–26; Matthew 23 (woes).** The prophetic and dominical woes provide the form of Jude's oracle.

**1 Corinthians 10:1–11 (method).** Paul's typological reading of the wilderness narratives, including the warning "neither murmur, as also some of them murmured, and perished by the destroyer" (1 Cor 10:10, LSV), parallels Jude's method and some of his material.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Which aspect of Cain does Jude intend?** Interpreters differ. Some emphasize hatred and murder (following 1 John), some the corruption of others (following Josephus), and some the denial of judgment (following the Targums). J. B. Mayor noted that for Philo, Cain is "the type of selfishness," and that 1 John names him "as a type of jealous hate."[89] The allusion may be deliberately broad.

**2. Is the aorist "they perished" prophetic?** Most commentators take it so. An alternative view holds that Jude regards the intruders' fate as already sealed by their choice, in the way Korah's company was doomed as soon as it set itself against Moses.

**3. How does Jude's use of Balaam relate to Numbers 22–24?** Numbers 22–24 portrays Balaam ambiguously, and other passages (Num 31; Deut 23; Neh 13; Josh 13) portray him negatively. Jude relies on the latter. This shows that the New Testament writers read individual passages in light of the whole canon and of traditional interpretation.

**4. Is authority itself sacred?** Jude's use of Korah could be misused to defend any human authority against criticism. Moses and Aaron's authority in Numbers 16 was explicitly God-given and confirmed by God. Korah's sin was rebellion against *God's* appointment, not criticism of human leaders as such. The Bible elsewhere honors prophets who challenged corrupt leaders (Nathan, Elijah, Jeremiah). Applying Jude 11 requires discernment about whether authority is truly from God and exercised under God.

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89. J. B. Mayor, *Expositor's Greek Testament* (1910), on Jude 11, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/egt/jude/1.htm.↩

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verse 11 is the climax of the section that began in v. 8. The "dreamers" of v. 8, who slander what they do not understand and are ruled by instinct (v. 10), are

now placed in a line of biblical rebels. The woe also prepares for the dense metaphors of vv. 12–13, which open “These are…” and describe the intruders’ character and fate. The three verbs of v. 11, *went*, *rushed*, and *perished*, recall the movement of the earlier examples, from salvation to destruction (v. 5).

The three figures also connect with later verses. Balaam’s “reward” anticipates the intruders’ flattery “for the sake of profit” (v. 16). Korah’s “murmuring” (Num 16:11; 17:5) anticipates the “discontented grumblers” of v. 16. Cain’s “way” anticipates their “walking according to their own lusts” (vv. 16, 18).

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Three enduring temptations.** Cain, Balaam, and Korah represent temptations that recur in every religious community: resentment and hatred toward fellow believers; using spiritual influence for personal gain; and rejecting God’s order while using spiritual language to justify it. Jude’s woe may invite communities to examine themselves before they examine others.

**Religion and money.** Balaam’s “reward” remains a live issue. Churches and ministries today face questions about how leaders are supported, how money shapes messages, and how marketing can bend teaching. Jude does not condemn all payment for ministry; other New Testament writers defend it. He does condemn error embraced for profit.

**Equality as a cover for rebellion.** Korah’s slogan, “all the congregation—all of them [are] holy,” was true and yet was used to justify defiance of God’s appointment. Believers may need discernment to recognize when good principles are being used for self-promotion, while remaining open to legitimate challenges to leaders who abuse their position.

**The weight of influence.** All three figures harmed others. Teachers, parents, leaders, and anyone with influence may consider that their “way” becomes a path others walk.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Why do you think Jude chose a “woe” rather than a simple warning? How does the form of a prophetic oracle change the effect of his words?
2. Which of the three figures (Cain, Balaam, Korah) seems most relevant to the challenges facing Christians today? Why?
3. Korah’s slogan was that “all the congregation” is holy. How can a community tell the difference between a legitimate challenge to leaders

and a Korah-like rebellion?
4. Balaam's error was embraced "for reward." In what subtle ways can financial or social rewards shape what religious leaders say, or what congregations want to hear?
5. Jude's three verbs describe a downward progression: going, rushing, perishing. Where might a person or community notice the early stages of such a path, and turn back?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT. LXX uses of ἀντιλογία: Brenton's Greek Septuagint.
- 1 Enoch 94:6–8, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.
- Josephus, *Antiquities* 1.2.1–2 (Cain) and 4.6.6 (Balaam), trans. Whiston.
- Targum Pseudo-Jonathan and Jerusalem Targum on Gen 4:8, trans. J. W. Etheridge (1862).
- Sirach 45:18–19, Brenton's English Septuagint.
- *Didache* 11, ANF 7.
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. ἐκχέω, ἀντιλογία.
- Word counts for οὐαί: MorphGNT/SBLGNT.
- Public-domain commentaries on v. 11: Mayor (*Expositor's Greek Testament*); Gill; Plumptre (*Cambridge Bible*).

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Genesis 4:8–9

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** וַיֹּאמֶר קַיִן אֶל־הֶבֶל אָחִיו וַיְהִי בִּהְיוֹתָם בַּשָּׂדֶה וַיָּקָם קַיִן אֶל־הֶבֶל אָחִיו וַיַּהַרְגֵהוּ **9** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה
אֶל־קַיִן אַי הֶבֶל אָחִיךָ וַיֹּאמֶר לֹא יָדַעְתִּי הֲשֹׁמֵר אָחִי אָנֹכִי

*English (BSB)*

**8** Then Cain said to his brother Abel, “Let us go out to the field.” And while they were in the field, Cain rose up against his brother Abel and killed him. **9** And the LORD said to Cain, “Where is your brother Abel?” “I do not know!” he answered. “Am I my brother’s keeper?”

*English (WEB)*

**8** Cain said to Abel, his brother, “Let’s go into the field.” While they were in the field, Cain rose up against Abel, his brother, and killed him. **9** The LORD said to Cain, “Where is Abel, your brother?” He said, “I don’t know. Am I my brother’s keeper?”

### Exodus 18:16

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**16** כִּי־יִהְיֶה לָהֶם דָּבָר בָּא אֵלַי וְשָׁפַטְתִּי בֵּין אִישׁ וּבֵין רֵעֵהוּ וְהוֹדַעְתִּי אֶת־חֻקֵּי הָאֱלֹהִים וְאֶת־תּוֹרֹתָיו

*English (BSB)*

**16** “Whenever they have a dispute, it is brought to me to judge between one man and another, and I make known to them the statutes and laws of God.”

*English (WEB)*

**16** When they have a matter, they come to me, and I judge between a man and his neighbor, and I make them know the statutes of God, and his laws.”

### Numbers 16

Printed in full in the Historical Introduction: see Numbers 16.

### Numbers 17:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**5 [17:20]** וְהָיָה הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר אֶבְחַר־בּוֹ מַטֵּהוּ יִפְרָח וְהִשְׁכֹּתִי מֵעָלַי אֶת־תְּלֻנּוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר הֵם מַלִּינִם עֲלֵיכֶם

*English (BSB)*

**5** The staff belonging to the man I choose will sprout, and I will rid Myself of the constant grumbling of the Israelites against you.”

*English (WEB)*

**5** It shall happen that the rod of the man whom I shall choose shall bud. I will make the murmurings of the children of Israel, which they murmur against you, cease from me."

### Numbers 20:13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**13** הֵ֣מָּה מֵֽי מְרִיבָ֗ה אֲשֶׁר־רָ֤בוּ בְנֵֽי־יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ אֶת־יְהוָ֔ה וַיִּקָּדֵ֖שׁ בָּֽם

*English (BSB)*

**13** These were the waters of Meribah, where the Israelites quarreled with the LORD, and He showed His holiness among them.

*English (WEB)*

**13** These are the waters of Meribah; because the children of Israel strove with the LORD, and he was sanctified in them.

### Numbers 22

Printed in full in the Historical Introduction: see Numbers 22.

### Numbers 23

Printed in full in the Historical Introduction: see Numbers 23.

### Numbers 24

Printed in full in the Historical Introduction: see Numbers 24.

### Numbers 25:1–3

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיֵּ֤שֶׁב יִשְׂרָאֵל֙ בַּשִּׁטִּ֔ים וַיָּ֥חֶל הָעָ֖ם לִזְנ֣וֹת אֶל־בְּנ֑וֹת מוֹאָֽב **2** וַתִּקְרֶ֣אן לָעָ֔ם לְזִבְחֵ֖י אֱלֹהֵיהֶ֑ן וַיֹּ֤אכַל
הָעָם֙ וַיִּשְׁתַּ֣חֲו֔וּ לֵֽאלֹהֵיהֶ֖ן **3** וַיִּצְמֶ֥ד יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל לְבַ֣עַל פְּעֹ֑ור וַיִּֽחַר־אַ֥ף יְהוָ֖ה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵֽל

*English (BSB)*

**1** While Israel was staying in Shittim, the men began to indulge in sexual immorality with the daughters of Moab, **2** who also invited them to the sacrifices for their gods. And the people ate and bowed down to these gods. **3** So Israel joined in worshiping Baal of Peor, and the anger of the LORD burned against them.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Israel stayed in Shittim; and the people began to play the prostitute with the daughters of Moab; **2** for they called the people to the sacrifices of their gods. The people ate and bowed down to their gods. **3** Israel joined himself to Baal Peor, and the LORD's anger burned against Israel.

## Numbers 26:9, 11

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**9** וּבְנֵי אֱלִיאָב נְמוּאֵל וְדָתָן וַאֲבִירָם הוּא־דָתָן וַאֲבִירָם קְרוּאֵי הָעֵדָה אֲשֶׁר הִצּוּ עַל־מֹשֶׁה וְעַל־אַהֲרֹן
בַּעֲדַת־קֹרַח בְּהַצֹּתָם עַל־יְהוָה … **11** וּבְנֵי־קֹרַח לֹא־מֵתוּ

*English (BSB)*

**9** and the sons of Eliab were Nemuel, Dathan, and Abiram. It was Dathan and Abiram, chosen by the congregation, who fought against Moses and Aaron with the followers of Korah who rebelled against the LORD. … **11** However, the line of Korah did not die out.

*English (WEB)*

**9** The sons of Eliab: Nemuel, Dathan, and Abiram. These are that Dathan and Abiram who were called by the congregation, who rebelled against Moses and against Aaron in the company of Korah when they rebelled against the LORD; … **11** Notwithstanding, the sons of Korah didn't die.

## Numbers 27:14

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**14** כַּאֲשֶׁר מְרִיתֶם פִּי בְּמִדְבַּר־צִן בִּמְרִיבַת הָעֵדָה לְהַקְדִּישֵׁנִי בַמַּיִם לְעֵינֵיהֶם הֵם מֵי־מְרִיבַת קָדֵשׁ
מִדְבַּר־צִן

*English (BSB)*

**14** for when the congregation contended in the Wilderness of Zin, both of you rebelled against My command to show My holiness in their sight regarding the waters." Those were the waters of Meribah in Kadesh, in the Wilderness of Zin.

*English (WEB)*

**14** because in the strife of the congregation, you rebelled against my word in the wilderness of Zin, to honor me as holy at the waters before their eyes." (These are the waters of Meribah of Kadesh in the wilderness of Zin.)

## Numbers 31

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵּאמֹר **2** נְקֹם נִקְמַת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאֵת הַמִּדְיָנִים אַחַר תֵּאָסֵף אֶל־עַמֶּיךָ **3**
וַיְדַבֵּר מֹשֶׁה אֶל־הָעָם לֵאמֹר הֵחָלְצוּ מֵאִתְּכֶם אֲנָשִׁים לַצָּבָא וְיִהְיוּ עַל־מִדְיָן לָתֵת נִקְמַת־יְהוָה בְּמִדְיָן
**4** אֶלֶף לַמַּטֶּה אֶלֶף לַמַּטֶּה לְכֹל מַטּוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל תִּשְׁלְחוּ לַצָּבָא **5** וַיִּמָּסְרוּ מֵאַלְפֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶלֶף לַמַּטֶּה
שְׁנֵים־עָשָׂר אֶלֶף חֲלוּצֵי צָבָא **6** וַיִּשְׁלַח אֹתָם מֹשֶׁה אֶלֶף לַמַּטֶּה לַצָּבָא אֹתָם וְאֶת־פִּינְחָס בֶּן־אֶלְעָזָר
הַכֹּהֵן לַצָּבָא וּכְלֵי הַקֹּדֶשׁ וַחֲצֹצְרוֹת הַתְּרוּעָה בְּיָדוֹ **7** וַיִּצְבְּאוּ עַל־מִדְיָן כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה
וַיַּהַרְגוּ כָּל־זָכָר **8** וְאֶת־מַלְכֵי מִדְיָן הָרָגוּ עַל־חַלְלֵיהֶם אֶת־אֱוִי וְאֶת־רֶקֶם וְאֶת־צוּר וְאֶת־חוּר וְאֶת־
רֶבַע חֲמֵשֶׁת מַלְכֵי מִדְיָן וְאֶת בִּלְעָם בֶּן־בְּעוֹר הָרָגוּ בֶּחָרֶב **9** וַיִּשְׁבּוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־נְשֵׁי מִדְיָן וְאֶת־
טַפָּם וְאֶת כָּל־בְּהֶמְתָּם וְאֶת־כָּל־מִקְנֵהֶם וְאֶת־כָּל־חֵילָם בָּזָזוּ **10** וְאֵת כָּל־עָרֵיהֶם בְּמוֹשְׁבֹתָם וְאֵת
כָּל־טִירֹתָם שָׂרְפוּ בָאֵשׁ **11** וַיִּקְחוּ אֶת־כָּל־הַשָּׁלָל וְאֵת כָּל־הַמַּלְקוֹחַ בָּאָדָם וּבַבְּהֵמָה **12** וַיָּבִאוּ אֶל־
מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן וְאֶל־עֲדַת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הַשִּׁבְי וְאֶת־הַמַּלְקוֹחַ וְאֶת־הַשָּׁלָל אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה אֶל־
עַרְבֹת מוֹאָב אֲשֶׁר עַל־יַרְדֵּן יְרֵחוֹ **13** וַיֵּצְאוּ מֹשֶׁה וְאֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן וְכָל־נְשִׂיאֵי הָעֵדָה לִקְרָאתָם אֶל־
מִחוּץ לַמַּחֲנֶה **14** וַיִּקְצֹף מֹשֶׁה עַל פְּקוּדֵי הֶחָיִל שָׂרֵי הָאֲלָפִים וְשָׂרֵי הַמֵּאוֹת הַבָּאִים מִצְּבָא הַמִּלְחָמָה
**15** וַיֹּאמֶר אֲלֵיהֶם מֹשֶׁה הַחִיִּיתֶם כָּל־נְקֵבָה **16** הֵן הֵנָּה הָיוּ לִבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּדְבַר בִּלְעָם לִמְסָר־מַעַל
בַּיהוָה עַל־דִּבְרַ־פְּעוֹר וַתְּהִי הַמַּגֵּפָה בַּעֲדַת יְהוָה **17** וְעַתָּה הִרְגוּ כָל־זָכָר בַּטָּף וְכָל־אִשָּׁה יֹדַעַת אִישׁ
לְמִשְׁכַּב זָכָר הָרֹגוּ **18** וְכֹל הַטַּף בַּנָּשִׁים אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדְעוּ מִשְׁכַּב זָכָר הַחֲיוּ לָכֶם **19** וְאַתֶּם חֲנוּ מִחוּץ
לַמַּחֲנֶה שִׁבְעַת יָמִים כֹּל הֹרֵג נָפֶשׁ וְכֹל נֹגֵעַ בֶּחָלָל תִּתְחַטְּאוּ בַיּוֹם הַשְּׁלִישִׁי וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי אַתֶּם
וּשְׁבִיכֶם **20** וְכָל־בֶּגֶד וְכָל־כְּלִי־עוֹר וְכָל־מַעֲשֵׂה עִזִּים וְכָל־כְּלִי־עֵץ תִּתְחַטָּאוּ **21** וַיֹּאמֶר אֶלְעָזָר
הַכֹּהֵן אֶל־אַנְשֵׁי הַצָּבָא הַבָּאִים לַמִּלְחָמָה זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה **22** אַךְ אֶת־
הַזָּהָב וְאֶת־הַכֶּסֶף אֶת־הַנְּחֹשֶׁת אֶת־הַבַּרְזֶל אֶת־הַבְּדִיל וְאֶת־הָעֹפָרֶת **23** כָּל־דָּבָר אֲשֶׁר־יָבֹא בָאֵשׁ
תַּעֲבִירוּ בָאֵשׁ וְטָהֵר אַךְ בְּמֵי נִדָּה יִתְחַטָּא וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָבֹא בָּאֵשׁ תַּעֲבִירוּ בַמָּיִם **24** וְכִבַּסְתֶּם
בִּגְדֵיכֶם בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וּטְהַרְתֶּם וְאַחַר תָּבֹאוּ אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה **25** וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵּאמֹר **26** שָׂא
אֵת רֹאשׁ מַלְקוֹחַ הַשְּׁבִי בָּאָדָם וּבַבְּהֵמָה אַתָּה וְאֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן וְרָאשֵׁי אָבוֹת הָעֵדָה **27** וְחָצִיתָ אֶת־
הַמַּלְקוֹחַ בֵּין תֹּפְשֵׂי הַמִּלְחָמָה הַיֹּצְאִים לַצָּבָא וּבֵין כָּל־הָעֵדָה **28** וַהֲרִמֹתָ מֶכֶס לַיהוָה מֵאֵת אַנְשֵׁי
הַמִּלְחָמָה הַיֹּצְאִים לַצָּבָא אֶחָד נֶפֶשׁ מֵחֲמֵשׁ הַמֵּאוֹת מִן־הָאָדָם וּמִן־הַבָּקָר וּמִן־הַחֲמֹרִים וּמִן־הַצֹּאן **29**
מִמַּחֲצִיתָם תִּקָּחוּ וְנָתַתָּה לְאֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן תְּרוּמַת יְהוָה **30** וּמִמַּחֲצִת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל תִּקַּח אֶחָד אֲחֻז מִן־
הַחֲמִשִּׁים מִן־הָאָדָם מִן־הַבָּקָר מִן־הַחֲמֹרִים וּמִן־הַצֹּאן מִכֹּל־הַבְּהֵמָה וְנָתַתָּה אֹתָם לַלְוִיִּם שֹׁמְרֵי
מִשְׁמֶרֶת מִשְׁכַּן יְהוָה **31** וַיַּעַשׂ מֹשֶׁה וְאֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה **32** וַיְהִי הַמַּלְקוֹחַ יֶתֶר
הַבַּז אֲשֶׁר בָּזְזוּ עַם הַצָּבָא צֹאן שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת אֶלֶף וְשִׁבְעִים אֶלֶף וַחֲמֵשֶׁת־אֲלָפִים **33** וּבָקָר שְׁנַיִם וְשִׁבְעִים
אָלֶף **34** וַחֲמֹרִים אֶחָד וְשִׁשִּׁים אָלֶף **35** וְנֶפֶשׁ אָדָם מִן־הַנָּשִׁים אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָדְעוּ מִשְׁכַּב זָכָר כָּל־נֶפֶשׁ
שְׁנַיִם וּשְׁלֹשִׁים אָלֶף **36** וַתְּהִי הַמֶּחֱצָה חֵלֶק הַיֹּצְאִים בַּצָּבָא מִסְפַּר הַצֹּאן שְׁלֹשׁ־מֵאוֹת אֶלֶף וּשְׁלֹשִׁים
אֶלֶף וְשִׁבְעַת אֲלָפִים וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת **37** וַיְהִי הַמֶּכֶס לַיהוָה מִן־הַצֹּאן שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת חָמֵשׁ וְשִׁבְעִים **38**
וְהַבָּקָר שִׁשָּׁה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים אָלֶף וּמִכְסָם לַיהוָה שְׁנַיִם וְשִׁבְעִים **39** וַחֲמֹרִים שְׁלֹשִׁים אָלֶף וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת
וּמִכְסָם לַיהוָה אֶחָד וְשִׁשִּׁים **40** וְנֶפֶשׁ אָדָם שִׁשָּׁה עָשָׂר אָלֶף וּמִכְסָם לַיהוָה שְׁנַיִם וּשְׁלֹשִׁים נָפֶשׁ **41**
וַיִּתֵּן מֹשֶׁה אֶת־מֶכֶס תְּרוּמַת יְהוָה לְאֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־מֹשֶׁה **42** וּמִמַּחֲצִית בְּנֵי
יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר חָצָה מֹשֶׁה מִן־הָאֲנָשִׁים הַצֹּבְאִים **43** וַתְּהִי מֶחֱצַת הָעֵדָה מִן־הַצֹּאן שְׁלֹשׁ־מֵאוֹת אֶלֶף
וּשְׁלֹשִׁים אֶלֶף שִׁבְעַת אֲלָפִים וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת **44** וּבָקָר שִׁשָּׁה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים אָלֶף **45** וַחֲמֹרִים שְׁלֹשִׁים אָלֶף

וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת **46** וְנֶפֶשׁ אָדָם שִׁשָּׁה עָשָׂר אָלֶף **47** וַיִּקַּח מֹשֶׁה מִמַּחֲצִת בְּנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הָאֶחָז אֶחָד מִן־
הַחֲמִשִּׁים מִן־הָאָדָם וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה וַיִּתֵּן אֹתָם לַלְוִיִּם שֹׁמְרֵי מִשְׁמֶרֶת מִשְׁכַּן יְהוָה כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה יְהוָה אֶת־
מֹשֶׁה **48** וַיִּקְרְבוּ אֶל־מֹשֶׁה הַפְּקֻדִים אֲשֶׁר לְאַלְפֵי הַצָּבָא שָׂרֵי הָאֲלָפִים וְשָׂרֵי הַמֵּאוֹת **49** וַיֹּאמְרוּ אֶל־
מֹשֶׁה עֲבָדֶיךָ נָשְׂאוּ אֶת־רֹאשׁ אַנְשֵׁי הַמִּלְחָמָה אֲשֶׁר בְּיָדֵנוּ וְלֹא־נִפְקַד מִמֶּנּוּ אִישׁ **50** וַנַּקְרֵב אֶת־קָרְבַּן
יְהוָה אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר מָצָא כְלִי־זָהָב אֶצְעָדָה וְצָמִיד טַבַּעַת עָגִיל וְכוּמָז לְכַפֵּר עַל־נַפְשֹׁתֵינוּ לִפְנֵי יְהוָה
**51** וַיִּקַּח מֹשֶׁה וְאֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַזָּהָב מֵאִתָּם כֹּל כְּלִי מַעֲשֶׂה **52** וַיְהִי כָּל־זְהַב הַתְּרוּמָה אֲשֶׁר
הֵרִימוּ לַיהוָה שִׁשָּׁה עָשָׂר אָלֶף שְׁבַע־מֵאוֹת וַחֲמִשִּׁים שֶׁקֶל מֵאֵת שָׂרֵי הָאֲלָפִים וּמֵאֵת שָׂרֵי הַמֵּאוֹת **53**
אַנְשֵׁי הַצָּבָא בָּזְזוּ אִישׁ לוֹ **54** וַיִּקַּח מֹשֶׁה וְאֶלְעָזָר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַזָּהָב מֵאֵת שָׂרֵי הָאֲלָפִים וְהַמֵּאוֹת וַיָּבִאוּ
אֹתוֹ אֶל־אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד זִכָּרוֹן לִבְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי יְהוָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** And the LORD said to Moses, **2** “Take vengeance on the Midianites for the Israelites. After that, you will be gathered to your people.” **3** So Moses told the people, “Arm some of your men for war, that they may go against the Midianites and execute the LORD’s vengeance on them. **4** Send into battle a thousand men from each tribe of Israel.” **5** So a thousand men were recruited from each tribe of Israel—twelve thousand armed for war. **6** And Moses sent the thousand from each tribe into battle, along with Phinehas son of Eleazar the priest, who took with him the vessels of the sanctuary and the trumpets for signaling. **7** Then they waged war against Midian, as the LORD had commanded Moses, and they killed every male. **8** Among the slain were Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba—the five kings of Midian. They also killed Balaam son of Beor with the sword. **9** The Israelites captured the Midianite women and their children, and they plundered all their herds, flocks, and goods. **10** Then they burned all the cities where the Midianites had lived, as well as all their encampments, **11** and carried away all the plunder and spoils, both people and animals. **12** They brought the captives, spoils, and plunder to Moses, to Eleazar the priest, and to the congregation of Israel at the camp on the plains of Moab, by the Jordan across from Jericho. **13** And Moses, Eleazar the priest, and all the leaders of the congregation went to meet them outside the camp. **14** But Moses was angry with the officers of the army—the commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds—who were returning from the battle. **15** “Have you spared all the women?” he asked them. **16** “Look, these women caused the sons of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to turn unfaithfully against the LORD at Peor, so that the plague struck the congregation of the LORD. **17** So now, kill all the boys, as well as every woman who has had relations with a man, **18** but spare for yourselves every girl who has never had relations with a man. **19** All of you who have killed a person or touched the dead are to remain outside the camp for seven days. On the third day and the seventh day you are to purify both yourselves and your captives. **20** And purify every garment and leather good, everything made of goat’s hair, and every article of wood.” **21** Then Eleazar the priest said to the soldiers who had gone into battle, “This is the statute of the law which the LORD has

commanded Moses: **22** Only the gold, silver, bronze, iron, tin, and lead— **23** everything that can withstand the fire—must be put through the fire, and it will be clean. But it must still be purified with the water of purification. And everything that cannot withstand the fire must pass through the water. **24** On the seventh day you are to wash your clothes, and you will be clean. After that you may enter the camp." **25** The LORD said to Moses, **26** "You and Eleazar the priest and the family heads of the congregation are to take a count of what was captured, both of man and beast. **27** Then divide the captives between the troops who went out to battle and the rest of the congregation. **28** Set aside a tribute for the LORD from what belongs to the soldiers who went into battle: one out of every five hundred, whether persons, cattle, donkeys, or sheep. **29** Take it from their half and give it to Eleazar the priest as an offering to the LORD. **30** From the Israelites' half, take one out of every fifty, whether persons, cattle, donkeys, sheep, or other animals, and give them to the Levites who keep charge of the tabernacle of the LORD." **31** So Moses and Eleazar the priest did as the LORD had commanded Moses, **32** and this plunder remained from the spoils the soldiers had taken: 675,000 sheep, **33** 72,000 cattle, **34** 61,000 donkeys, **35** and 32,000 women who had not slept with a man. **36** This was the half portion for those who had gone to war: 337,500 sheep, **37** including a tribute to the LORD of 675, **38** 36,000 cattle, including a tribute to the LORD of 72, **39** 30,500 donkeys, including a tribute to the LORD of 61, **40** and 16,000 people, including a tribute to the LORD of 32. **41** Moses gave the tribute to Eleazar the priest as an offering for the LORD, as the LORD had commanded Moses. **42** From the Israelites' half, which Moses had set apart from the men who had gone to war, **43** this half belonged to the congregation: 337,500 sheep, **44** 36,000 cattle, **45** 30,500 donkeys, **46** and 16,000 people. **47** From the Israelites' half, Moses took one out of every fifty persons and animals and gave them to the Levites who kept charge of the tabernacle of the LORD, as the LORD had commanded him. **48** Then the officers who were over the units of the army—the commanders of thousands and of hundreds—approached Moses **49** and said, "Your servants have counted the soldiers under our command, and not one of us is missing. **50** So we have brought to the LORD an offering of the gold articles each man acquired—armlets, bracelets, rings, earrings, and necklaces—to make atonement for ourselves before the LORD." **51** So Moses and Eleazar the priest received from them all the articles made out of gold. **52** All the gold that the commanders of thousands and of hundreds presented as an offering to the LORD weighed 16,750 shekels. **53** Each of the soldiers had taken plunder for himself. **54** And Moses and Eleazar the priest received the gold from the commanders of thousands and of hundreds and brought it into the Tent of Meeting as a memorial for the Israelites before the LORD.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **2** “Avenge the children of Israel on the Midianites. Afterward you shall be gathered to your people.” **3** Moses spoke to the people, saying, “Arm men from among you for war, that they may go against Midian, to execute the LORD’s vengeance on Midian. **4** You shall send one thousand out of every tribe, throughout all the tribes of Israel, to the war.” **5** So there were delivered, out of the thousands of Israel, a thousand from every tribe, twelve thousand armed for war. **6** Moses sent them, one thousand of every tribe, to the war with Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, to the war, with the vessels of the sanctuary and the trumpets for the alarm in his hand. **7** They fought against Midian, as the LORD commanded Moses. They killed every male. **8** They killed the kings of Midian with the rest of their slain: Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, the five kings of Midian. They also killed Balaam the son of Beor with the sword. **9** The children of Israel took the women of Midian captive with their little ones; and all their livestock, all their flocks, and all their goods, they took as plunder. **10** All their cities in the places in which they lived, and all their encampments, they burned with fire. **11** They took all the captives, and all the plunder, both of man and of animal. **12** They brought the captives with the prey and the plunder, to Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and to the congregation of the children of Israel, to the camp at the plains of Moab, which are by the Jordan at Jericho. **13** Moses and Eleazar the priest, with all the princes of the congregation, went out to meet them outside of the camp. **14** Moses was angry with the officers of the army, the captains of thousands and the captains of hundreds, who came from the service of the war. **15** Moses said to them, “Have you saved all the women alive? **16** Behold, these caused the children of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to commit trespass against the LORD in the matter of Peor, and so the plague was among the congregation of the LORD. **17** Now therefore kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman who has known man by lying with him. **18** But all the girls, who have not known man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves. **19** “Encamp outside of the camp for seven days. Whoever has killed any person, and whoever has touched any slain, purify yourselves on the third day and on the seventh day, you and your captives. **20** You shall purify every garment, and all that is made of skin, and all work of goats’ hair, and all things made of wood.” **21** Eleazar the priest said to the men of war who went to the battle, “This is the statute of the law which the LORD has commanded Moses. **22** However the gold, and the silver, the bronze, the iron, the tin, and the lead, **23** everything that may withstand the fire, you shall make to go through the fire, and it shall be clean; nevertheless it shall be purified with the water for impurity. All that doesn’t withstand the fire you shall make to go through the water. **24** You shall wash your clothes on the seventh day, and you shall be clean. Afterward you shall come into the camp.” **25** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **26** “Count the plunder that was taken, both of man and of animal, you, and Eleazar the priest, and the heads of the fathers’ households of the congregation; **27** and divide the plunder into two parts: between the men skilled in war, who went out to battle, and all the congregation. **28** Levy a

tribute to the LORD of the men of war who went out to battle: one soul of five hundred; of the persons, of the cattle, of the donkeys, and of the flocks. **29** Take it from their half, and give it to Eleazar the priest, for the LORD's wave offering. **30** Of the children of Israel's half, you shall take one drawn out of every fifty, of the persons, of the cattle, of the donkeys, and of the flocks, of all the livestock, and give them to the Levites, who perform the duty of the LORD's tabernacle." **31** Moses and Eleazar the priest did as the LORD commanded Moses. **32** Now the plunder, over and above the booty which the men of war took, was six hundred seventy-five thousand sheep, **33** seventy-two thousand head of cattle, **34** sixty-one thousand donkeys, **35** and thirty-two thousand persons in all, of the women who had not known man by lying with him. **36** The half, which was the portion of those who went out to war, was in number three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred sheep; **37** and the LORD's tribute of the sheep was six hundred seventy-five. **38** The cattle were thirty-six thousand, of which the LORD's tribute was seventy-two. **39** The donkeys were thirty thousand five hundred, of which the LORD's tribute was sixty-one. **40** The persons were sixteen thousand, of whom the LORD's tribute was thirty-two persons. **41** Moses gave the tribute, which was the LORD's wave offering, to Eleazar the priest, as the LORD commanded Moses. **42** Of the children of Israel's half, which Moses divided off from the men who fought **43** (now the congregation's half was three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred sheep, **44** thirty-six thousand head of cattle, **45** thirty thousand five hundred donkeys, **46** and sixteen thousand persons), **47** even of the children of Israel's half, Moses took one drawn out of every fifty, both of man and of animal, and gave them to the Levites, who performed the duty of the LORD's tabernacle, as the LORD commanded Moses. **48** The officers who were over the thousands of the army, the captains of thousands, and the captains of hundreds, came near to Moses. **49** They said to Moses, "Your servants have taken the sum of the men of war who are under our command, and there lacks not one man of us. **50** We have brought the LORD's offering, what every man found: gold ornaments, armlets, bracelets, signet rings, earrings, and necklaces, to make atonement for our souls before the LORD." **51** Moses and Eleazar the priest took their gold, even all worked jewels. **52** All the gold of the wave offering that they offered up to the LORD, of the captains of thousands, and of the captains of hundreds, was sixteen thousand seven hundred fifty shekels. **53** The men of war had taken booty, every man for himself. **54** Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold of the captains of thousands and of hundreds, and brought it into the Tent of Meeting for a memorial for the children of Israel before the LORD.

## Deuteronomy 17:8

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** כִּי יִפָּלֵא מִמְּךָ דָבָר לַמִּשְׁפָּט בֵּין־דָּם לְדָם בֵּין־דִּין לְדִין וּבֵין נֶגַע לָנֶגַע דִּבְרֵי רִיבֹת בִּשְׁעָרֶיךָ
וְקַמְתָּ וְעָלִיתָ אֶל־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יִבְחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בּוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**8** If a case is too difficult for you to judge, whether the controversy within your gates is regarding bloodshed, lawsuits, or assaults, you must go up to the place the LORD your God will choose.

*English (WEB)*

**8** If there arises a matter too hard for you in judgment, between blood and blood, between plea and plea, and between stroke and stroke, being matters of controversy within your gates, then you shall arise, and go up to the place which the LORD your God chooses.

### Deuteronomy 19:17

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**17** וְעָמְדוּ שְׁנֵי־הָאֲנָשִׁים אֲשֶׁר־לָהֶם הָרִיב לִפְנֵי יְהוָה לִפְנֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים וְהַשֹּׁפְטִים אֲשֶׁר יִהְיוּ בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם

*English (BSB)*

**17** both parties to the dispute must stand in the presence of the LORD, before the priests and judges who are in office at that time.

*English (WEB)*

**17** then both the men, between whom the controversy is, shall stand before the LORD, before the priests and the judges who shall be in those days;

### Deuteronomy 21:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**5** וְנִגְּשׁוּ הַכֹּהֲנִים בְּנֵי לֵוִי כִּי בָם בָּחַר יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְשָׁרְתוֹ וּלְבָרֵךְ בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה וְעַל־פִּיהֶם יִהְיֶה כָּל־
רִיב וְכָל־נָגַע

*English (BSB)*

**5** And the priests, the sons of Levi, shall come forward, for the LORD your God has chosen them to serve Him and pronounce blessings in His name and to give a ruling in every dispute and case of assault.

*English (WEB)*

**5** The priests the sons of Levi shall come near, for them the LORD your God has chosen to minister to him, and to bless in the LORD’s name; and according to their word shall every controversy and every assault be decided.

## Deuteronomy 23

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**1 [23:2]** לֹא־יָבֹא פְצוּעַ־דַּכָּא וּכְרוּת שָׁפְכָה בִּקְהַל יְהוָה **2 [23:3]** לֹא־יָבֹא מַמְזֵר בִּקְהַל יְהוָה גַּם דּוֹר עֲשִׂירִי לֹא־יָבֹא לוֹ בִּקְהַל יְהוָה **3 [23:4]** לֹא־יָבֹא עַמֹּנִי וּמוֹאָבִי בִּקְהַל יְהוָה גַּם דּוֹר עֲשִׂירִי לֹא־יָבֹא לָהֶם בִּקְהַל יְהוָה עַד־עוֹלָם **4 [23:5]** עַל־דְּבַר אֲשֶׁר לֹא־קִדְּמוּ אֶתְכֶם בַּלֶּחֶם וּבַמָּיִם בַּדֶּרֶךְ בְּצֵאתְכֶם מִמִּצְרָיִם וַאֲשֶׁר שָׂכַר עָלֶיךָ אֶת־בִּלְעָם בֶּן־בְּעוֹר מִפְּתוֹר אֲרַם נַהֲרַיִם לְקַלְלֶךָּ **5 [23:6]** וְלֹא־אָבָה יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לִשְׁמֹעַ אֶל־בִּלְעָם וַיַּהֲפֹךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְךָ אֶת־הַקְּלָלָה לִבְרָכָה כִּי אֲהֲבֶךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ **6 [23:7]** לֹא־תִדְרֹשׁ שְׁלֹמָם וְטֹבָתָם כָּל־יָמֶיךָ לְעוֹלָם **7 [23:8]** לֹא־תְתַעֵב אֲדֹמִי כִּי אָחִיךָ הוּא לֹא־תְתַעֵב מִצְרִי כִּי־גֵר הָיִיתָ בְאַרְצוֹ **8 [23:9]** בָּנִים אֲשֶׁר־יִוָּלְדוּ לָהֶם דּוֹר שְׁלִישִׁי יָבֹא לָהֶם בִּקְהַל יְהוָה **9 [23:10]** כִּי־תֵצֵא מַחֲנֶה עַל־אֹיְבֶיךָ וְנִשְׁמַרְתָּ מִכֹּל דָּבָר רָע **10 [23:11]** כִּי־יִהְיֶה בְךָ אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִהְיֶה טָהוֹר מִקְרֵה־לָיְלָה וְיָצָא אֶל־מִחוּץ לַמַּחֲנֶה לֹא יָבֹא אֶל־תּוֹךְ הַמַּחֲנֶה **11 [23:12]** וְהָיָה לִפְנוֹת־עֶרֶב יִרְחַץ בַּמָּיִם וּכְבֹא הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ יָבֹא אֶל־תּוֹךְ הַמַּחֲנֶה **12 [23:13]** וְיָד תִּהְיֶה לְךָ מִחוּץ לַמַּחֲנֶה וְיָצָאתָ שָּׁמָּה חוּץ **13 [23:14]** וְיָתֵד תִּהְיֶה לְךָ עַל־אֲזֵנֶךָ וְהָיָה בְּשִׁבְתְּךָ חוּץ וְחָפַרְתָּה בָהּ וְשַׁבְתָּ וְכִסִּיתָ אֶת־צֵאָתֶךָ **14 [23:15]** כִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ מִתְהַלֵּךְ בְּקֶרֶב מַחֲנֶךָ לְהַצִּילְךָ וְלָתֵת אֹיְבֶיךָ לְפָנֶיךָ וְהָיָה מַחֲנֶיךָ קָדוֹשׁ וְלֹא־יִרְאֶה בְךָ עֶרְוַת דָּבָר וְשָׁב מֵאַחֲרֶיךָ **15 [23:16]** לֹא־תַסְגִּיר עֶבֶד אֶל־אֲדֹנָיו אֲשֶׁר־יִנָּצֵל אֵלֶיךָ מֵעִם אֲדֹנָיו **16 [23:17]** עִמְּךָ יֵשֵׁב בְּקִרְבְּךָ בַּמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־יִבְחַר בְּאַחַד שְׁעָרֶיךָ בַּטּוֹב לוֹ לֹא תוֹנֶנּוּ **17 [23:18]** לֹא־תִהְיֶה קְדֵשָׁה מִבְּנוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל וְלֹא־יִהְיֶה קָדֵשׁ מִבְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **18 [23:19]** לֹא־תָבִיא אֶתְנַן זוֹנָה וּמְחִיר כֶּלֶב בֵּית יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְכָל־נֶדֶר כִּי תוֹעֲבַת יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ גַּם־שְׁנֵיהֶם **19 [23:20]** לֹא־תַשִּׁישׁ לְאָחִיךָ נֶשֶׁךְ כֶּסֶף נֶשֶׁךְ אֹכֶל נֶשֶׁךְ כָּל־דָּבָר אֲשֶׁר יִשָּׁךְ **20 [23:21]** לַנָּכְרִי תַּשִּׁישׁ וּלְאָחִיךָ לֹא תַשִּׁישׁ לְמַעַן יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ בְּכֹל מִשְׁלַח יָדֶךָ עַל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה בָא־שָׁמָּה לְרִשְׁתָּהּ **21 [23:22]** כִּי־תִדֹּר נֶדֶר לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ לֹא תְאַחֵר לְשַׁלְּמוֹ כִּי־דָרֹשׁ יִדְרְשֶׁנּוּ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ מֵעִמָּךְ וְהָיָה בְךָ חֵטְא **22 [23:23]** וְכִי תֶחְדַּל לִנְדֹּר לֹא־יִהְיֶה בְךָ חֵטְא **23 [23:24]** מוֹצָא שְׂפָתֶיךָ תִּשְׁמֹר וְעָשִׂיתָ כַּאֲשֶׁר נָדַרְתָּ לַיהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ נְדָבָה אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתָּ בְּפִיךָ **24 [23:25]** כִּי תָבֹא בְּכֶרֶם רֵעֶךָ וְאָכַלְתָּ עֲנָבִים בְּנַפְשְׁךָ שָׂבְעֶךָ וְאֶל־כֶּלְיְךָ לֹא תִתֵּן **25 [23:26]** כִּי תָבֹא בְּקָמַת רֵעֶךָ וְקָטַפְתָּ מְלִילֹת בְּיָדֶךָ וְחֶרְמֵשׁ לֹא תָנִיף עַל קָמַת רֵעֶךָ

*English (BSB)*

**1** No man with crushed or severed genitals may enter the assembly of the LORD. **2** No one of illegitimate birth may enter the assembly of the LORD, nor may any of his descendants, even to the tenth generation. **3** No Ammonite or Moabite or any of their descendants may enter the assembly of the LORD, even to the tenth generation. **4** For they did not meet you with food and water on your way out of Egypt, and they hired Balaam son of Beor from Pethor in Aram-naharaim to curse you. **5** Yet the LORD your God would not listen to

Balaam, and the LORD your God turned the curse into a blessing for you, because the LORD your God loves you. **6** You are not to seek peace or prosperity from them as long as you live. **7** Do not despise an Edomite, for he is your brother. Do not despise an Egyptian, because you lived as a foreigner in his land. **8** The third generation of children born to them may enter the assembly of the LORD. **9** When you are encamped against your enemies, then you shall keep yourself from every wicked thing. **10** If any man among you becomes unclean because of a nocturnal emission, he must leave the camp and stay outside. **11** When evening approaches, he must wash with water, and when the sun sets he may return to the camp. **12** You must have a place outside the camp to go and relieve yourself. **13** And you must have a digging tool in your equipment so that when you relieve yourself you can dig a hole and cover up your excrement. **14** For the LORD your God walks throughout your camp to protect you and deliver your enemies to you. Your camp must be holy, lest He see anything unclean among you and turn away from you. **15** Do not return a slave to his master if he has taken refuge with you. **16** Let him live among you wherever he chooses, in the town of his pleasing. Do not oppress him. **17** No daughter or son of Israel is to be a shrine prostitute. **18** You must not bring the wages of a prostitute, whether female or male, into the house of the LORD your God to fulfill any vow, because both are detestable to the LORD your God. **19** Do not charge your brother interest on money, food, or any other type of loan. **20** You may charge a foreigner interest, but not your brother, so that the LORD your God may bless you in everything to which you put your hand in the land that you are entering to possess. **21** If you make a vow to the LORD your God, do not be slow to keep it, because He will surely require it of you, and you will be guilty of sin. **22** But if you refrain from making a vow, you will not be guilty of sin. **23** Be careful to follow through on what comes from your lips, because you have freely vowed to the LORD your God with your own mouth. **24** When you enter your neighbor’s vineyard, you may eat your fill of grapes, but you must not put any in your basket. **25** When you enter your neighbor’s grainfield, you may pluck the heads of grain with your hand, but you must not put a sickle to your neighbor’s grain.

*English (WEB)*

**1** He who is emasculated by crushing or cutting shall not enter into the LORD’s assembly. **2** A person born of a forbidden union shall not enter into the LORD’s assembly; even to the tenth generation shall no one of his enter into the LORD’s assembly. **3** An Ammonite or a Moabite shall not enter into the LORD’s assembly; even to the tenth generation shall no one belonging to them enter into the LORD’s assembly forever, **4** because they didn’t meet you with bread and with water on the way when you came out of Egypt, and because they hired against you Balaam the son of Beor from Pethor of Mesopotamia, to curse you. **5** Nevertheless the LORD your God wouldn’t listen to Balaam, but the LORD your God turned the curse into a blessing to you, because the LORD

your God loved you. **6** You shall not seek their peace nor their prosperity all your days forever. **7** You shall not abhor an Edomite, for he is your brother. You shall not abhor an Egyptian, because you lived as a foreigner in his land. **8** The children of the third generation who are born to them may enter into the LORD’s assembly. **9** When you go out and camp against your enemies, then you shall keep yourselves from every evil thing. **10** If there is among you any man who is not clean by reason of that which happens to him by night, then shall he go outside of the camp. He shall not come within the camp; **11** but it shall be, when evening comes, he shall bathe himself in water. When the sun is down, he shall come within the camp. **12** You shall have a place also outside of the camp where you go relieve yourself. **13** You shall have a trowel among your weapons. It shall be, when you relieve yourself, you shall dig with it, and shall turn back and cover your excrement; **14** for the LORD your God walks in the middle of your camp, to deliver you, and to give up your enemies before you. Therefore your camp shall be holy, that he may not see an unclean thing in you, and turn away from you. **15** You shall not deliver to his master a servant who has escaped from his master to you. **16** He shall dwell with you, among you, in the place which he shall choose within one of your gates, where it pleases him best. You shall not oppress him. **17** There shall be no prostitute of the daughters of Israel, neither shall there be a sodomite of the sons of Israel. **18** You shall not bring the hire of a prostitute, or the wages of a male prostitute, into the house of the LORD your God for any vow; for both of these are an abomination to the LORD your God. **19** You shall not lend on interest to your brother: interest of money, interest of food, interest of anything that is lent on interest. **20** You may charge a foreigner interest; but you shall not charge your brother interest, that the LORD your God may bless you in all that you put your hand to, in the land where you go in to possess it. **21** When you vow a vow to the LORD your God, you shall not be slack to pay it, for the LORD your God will surely require it of you; and it would be sin in you. **22** But if you refrain from making a vow, it shall be no sin in you. **23** You shall observe and do that which has gone out of your lips. Whatever you have vowed to the LORD your God as a free will offering, which you have promised with your mouth, you must do. **24** When you come into your neighbor’s vineyard, then you may eat your fill of grapes at your own pleasure; but you shall not put any in your container. **25** When you come into your neighbor’s standing grain, then you may pluck the ears with your hand; but you shall not use a sickle on your neighbor’s standing grain.

## Deuteronomy 25:1

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** כִּי־יִהְיֶה רִיב בֵּין אֲנָשִׁים וְנִגְּשׁוּ אֶל־הַמִּשְׁפָּט וּשְׁפָטוּם וְהִצְדִּיקוּ אֶת־הַצַּדִּיק וְהִרְשִׁיעוּ אֶת־הָרָשָׁע

*English (BSB)*

**1** If there is a dispute between men, they are to go to court to be judged, so that the innocent may be acquitted and the guilty condemned.

*English (WEB)*

**1** If there is a controversy between men, and they come to judgment and the judges judge them, then they shall justify the righteous and condemn the wicked.

## Deuteronomy 32:51

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**51** עַל אֲשֶׁר מְעַלְתֶּם בִּי בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמֵי־מְרִיבַת קָדֵשׁ מִדְבַּר־צִן עַל אֲשֶׁר לֹא־קִדַּשְׁתֶּם אוֹתִי בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

*English (BSB)*

**51** For at the waters of Meribah-kadesh in the Wilderness of Zin, both of you broke faith with Me among the Israelites by failing to treat Me as holy in their presence.

*English (WEB)*

**51** because you trespassed against me among the children of Israel at the waters of Meribah of Kadesh, in the wilderness of Zin; because you didn’t uphold my holiness among the children of Israel.

## Deuteronomy 33:8

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** וּלְלֵוִי אָמַר תֻּמֶּיךָ וְאוּרֶיךָ לְאִישׁ חֲסִידֶךָ אֲשֶׁר נִסִּיתוֹ בְּמַסָּה תְּרִיבֵהוּ עַל־מֵי מְרִיבָה

*English (BSB)*

**8** Concerning Levi he said: “Give Your Thummim to Levi and Your Urim to Your godly one, whom You tested at Massah and contested at the waters of Meribah.

*English (WEB)*

**8** About Levi he said, “Your Thummim and your Urim are with your godly one, whom you proved at Massah, with whom you contended at the waters of Meribah.

## Joshua 13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ זָקֵן בָּא בַּיָּמִים וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֵלָיו אַתָּה זָקַנְתָּה בָּאתָ בַּיָּמִים וְהָאָרֶץ נִשְׁאֲרָה הַרְבֵּה־מְאֹד
לְרִשְׁתָּהּ **2** זֹאת הָאָרֶץ הַנִּשְׁאָרֶת כָּל־גְּלִילוֹת הַפְּלִשְׁתִּים וְכָל־הַגְּשׁוּרִי **3** מִן־הַשִּׁיחוֹר אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי
מִצְרַיִם וְעַד גְּבוּל עֶקְרוֹן צָפוֹנָה לַכְּנַעֲנִי תֵּחָשֵׁב חֲמֻשֶּׁת סַרְנֵי פְלִשְׁתִּים הָעַזָּתִי וְהָאַשְׁדּוֹדִי הָאֶשְׁקְלוֹנִי
הַגִּתִּי וְהָעֶקְרוֹנִי וְהָעַוִּים **4** מִתֵּימָן כָּל־אֶרֶץ הַכְּנַעֲנִי וּמְעָרָה אֲשֶׁר לַצִּידֹנִים עַד־אֲפֵקָה עַד גְּבוּל
הָאֱמֹרִי **5** וְהָאָרֶץ הַגִּבְלִי וְכָל־הַלְּבָנוֹן מִזְרַח הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ מִבַּעַל גָּד תַּחַת הַר־חֶרְמוֹן עַד לְבוֹא חֲמָת **6** כָּל־
יֹשְׁבֵי הָהָר מִן־הַלְּבָנוֹן עַד־מִשְׂרְפֹת מַיִם כָּל־צִידֹנִים אָנֹכִי אוֹרִישֵׁם מִפְּנֵי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל רַק הַפִּלָּהָ
לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּנַחֲלָה כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתִיךָ **7** וְעַתָּה חַלֵּק אֶת־הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת בְּנַחֲלָה לְתִשְׁעַת הַשְּׁבָטִים וַחֲצִי
הַשֵּׁבֶט הַמְנַשֶּׁה **8** עִמּוֹ הָרְאוּבֵנִי וְהַגָּדִי לָקְחוּ נַחֲלָתָם אֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה בְּעֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְרָחָה
כַּאֲשֶׁר נָתַן לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה עֶבֶד יְהוָה **9** מֵעֲרוֹעֵר אֲשֶׁר עַל־שְׂפַת־נַחַל אַרְנוֹן וְהָעִיר אֲשֶׁר בְּתוֹךְ־הַנַּחַל
וְכָל־הַמִּישֹׁר מֵידְבָא עַד־דִּיבוֹן **10** וְכֹל עָרֵי סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן עַד־גְּבוּל בְּנֵי
עַמּוֹן **11** וְהַגִּלְעָד וּגְבוּל הַגְּשׁוּרִי וְהַמַּעֲכָתִי וְכֹל הַר חָרְמוֹן וְכָל־הַבָּשָׁן עַד־סַלְכָה **12** כָּל־מַמְלְכוּת
עוֹג בַּבָּשָׁן אֲשֶׁר־מָלַךְ בְּעַשְׁתָּרוֹת וּבְאֶדְרֶעִי הוּא נִשְׁאַר מִיֶּתֶר הָרְפָאִים וַיַּכֵּם מֹשֶׁה וַיֹּרִשֵׁם **13** וְלֹא
הוֹרִישׁוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת־הַגְּשׁוּרִי וְאֶת־הַמַּעֲכָתִי וַיֵּשֶׁב גְּשׁוּר וּמַעֲכַת בְּקֶרֶב יִשְׂרָאֵל עַד הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה **14**
רַק לְשֵׁבֶט הַלֵּוִי לֹא נָתַן נַחֲלָה אִשֵּׁי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא נַחֲלָתוֹ כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר־לוֹ **15** וַיִּתֵּן מֹשֶׁה
לְמַטֵּה בְנֵי־רְאוּבֵן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם **16** וַיְהִי לָהֶם הַגְּבוּל מֵעֲרוֹעֵר אֲשֶׁר עַל־שְׂפַת־נַחַל אַרְנוֹן וְהָעִיר אֲשֶׁר
בְּתוֹךְ־הַנַּחַל וְכָל־הַמִּישֹׁר עַל־מֵידְבָא **17** חֶשְׁבּוֹן וְכָל־עָרֶיהָ אֲשֶׁר בַּמִּישֹׁר דִּיבוֹן וּבָמוֹת בַּעַל וּבֵית
בַּעַל מְעוֹן **18** וְיָהְצָה וּקְדֵמֹת וּמֵפָעַת **19** וְקִרְיָתַיִם וְשִׂבְמָה וְצֶרֶת הַשַּׁחַר בְּהַר הָעֵמֶק **20** וּבֵית פְּעוֹר
וְאַשְׁדּוֹת הַפִּסְגָּה וּבֵית הַיְשִׁמוֹת **21** וְכֹל עָרֵי הַמִּישֹׁר וְכָל־מַמְלְכוּת סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ הָאֱמֹרִי אֲשֶׁר מָלַךְ
בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן אֲשֶׁר הִכָּה מֹשֶׁה אֹתוֹ וְאֶת־נְשִׂיאֵי מִדְיָן אֶת־אֱוִי וְאֶת־רֶקֶם וְאֶת־צוּר וְאֶת־חוּר וְאֶת־רֶבַע
נְסִיכֵי סִיחוֹן יֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ **22** וְאֶת־בִּלְעָם בֶּן־בְּעוֹר הַקּוֹסֵם הָרְגוּ בְנֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּהֶרֶב אֶל־חַלְלֵיהֶם **23**
וַיְהִי גְּבוּל בְּנֵי רְאוּבֵן הַיַּרְדֵּן וּגְבוּל זֹאת נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי־רְאוּבֵן לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הֶעָרִים וְחַצְרֵיהֶן **24** וַיִּתֵּן
מֹשֶׁה לְמַטֵּה־גָד לִבְנֵי־גָד לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם **25** וַיְהִי לָהֶם הַגְּבוּל יַעְזֵר וְכָל־עָרֵי הַגִּלְעָד וַחֲצִי אֶרֶץ בְּנֵי
עַמּוֹן עַד־עֲרוֹעֵר אֲשֶׁר עַל־פְּנֵי רַבָּה **26** וּמֵחֶשְׁבּוֹן עַד־רָמַת הַמִּצְפֶּה וּבְטֹנִים וּמַחֲנַיִם עַד־גְּבוּל
לִדְבִר **27** וּבָעֵמֶק בֵּית הָרָם וּבֵית נִמְרָה וְסֻכּוֹת וְצָפוֹן יֶתֶר מַמְלְכוּת סִיחוֹן מֶלֶךְ חֶשְׁבּוֹן הַיַּרְדֵּן וּגְבָל
עַד־קְצֵה יָם־כִּנֶּרֶת עֵבֶר הַיַּרְדֵּן מִזְרָחָה **28** זֹאת נַחֲלַת בְּנֵי־גָד לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם הֶעָרִים וְחַצְרֵיהֶם **29** וַיִּתֵּן
מֹשֶׁה לַחֲצִי שֵׁבֶט מְנַשֶּׁה וַיְהִי לַחֲצִי מַטֵּה בְנֵי־מְנַשֶּׁה לְמִשְׁפְּחֹתָם **30** וַיְהִי גְבוּלָם מִמַּחֲנַיִם כָּל־הַבָּשָׁן
כָּל־מַמְלְכוּת עוֹג מֶלֶךְ־הַבָּשָׁן וְכָל־חַוֹּת יָאִיר אֲשֶׁר בַּבָּשָׁן שִׁשִּׁים עִיר **31** וַחֲצִי הַגִּלְעָד וְעַשְׁתָּרוֹת
וְאֶדְרֶעִי עָרֵי מַמְלְכוּת עוֹג בַּבָּשָׁן לִבְנֵי מָכִיר בֶּן־מְנַשֶּׁה לַחֲצִי בְנֵי־מָכִיר לְמִשְׁפְּחוֹתָם **32** אֵלֶּה אֲשֶׁר־
נִחַל מֹשֶׁה בְּעַרְבוֹת מוֹאָב מֵעֵבֶר לְיַרְדֵּן יְרִיחוֹ מִזְרָחָה **33** וּלְשֵׁבֶט הַלֵּוִי לֹא־נָתַן מֹשֶׁה נַחֲלָה יְהוָה
אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא נַחֲלָתָם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר לָהֶם

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now Joshua was old and well along in years, and the LORD said to him, “You are old and well along in years, but very much of the land remains to be possessed. **2** This is the land that remains: All the territory of the Philistines and the Geshurites, **3** from the Shihor east of Egypt to the territory of Ekron on the north (considered to be Canaanite territory)—that of the five Philistine rulers of Gaza, Ashdod, Ashkelon, Gath, and Ekron, as well as that of the

Avvites; **4** to the south, all the land of the Canaanites, from Mearah of the Sidonians to Aphek, as far as the border of the Amorites; **5** the land of the Gebalites; and all Lebanon to the east, from Baal-gad below Mount Hermon to Lebo-hamath. **6** All the inhabitants of the hill country from Lebanon to Misrephoth-maim—all the Sidonians—I Myself will drive out before the Israelites. Be sure to divide it by lot as an inheritance to Israel, as I have commanded you. **7** Now therefore divide this land as an inheritance to the nine tribes and the half-tribe of Manasseh.” **8** The other half of Manasseh, along with the Reubenites and Gadites, had received the inheritance Moses had given them beyond the Jordan to the east, just as Moses the servant of the LORD had assigned to them: **9** The area from Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Valley, along with the city in the middle of the valley, the whole plateau of Medeba as far as Dibon, **10** and all the cities of Sihon king of the Amorites who reigned in Heshbon, as far as the border of the Ammonites; **11** also Gilead and the territory of the Geshurites and Maacathites, all of Mount Hermon, and all Bashan as far as Salecah— **12** the whole kingdom of Og in Bashan, who had reigned in Ashtaroth and Edrei and had remained as a remnant of the Rephaim. Moses had struck them down and dispossessed them, **13** but the Israelites did not drive out the Geshurites or the Maacathites. So Geshur and Maacath dwell among the Israelites to this day. **14** To the tribe of Levi, however, Moses had given no inheritance. The offerings made by fire to the LORD, the God of Israel, are their inheritance, just as He had promised them. **15** This is what Moses had given to the clans of the tribe of Reuben: **16** The territory from Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Valley, along with the city in the middle of the valley, to the whole plateau beyond Medeba, **17** to Heshbon and all its cities on the plateau, including Dibon, Bamoth-baal, Beth-baal-meon, **18** Jahaz, Kedemoth, Mephaath, **19** Kiriathaim, Sibmah, Zereth-shahar on the hill in the valley, **20** Beth-peor, the slopes of Pisgah, and Beth-jeshimoth— **21** all the cities of the plateau and all the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon until Moses killed him and the chiefs of Midian (Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba), the princes of Sihon who lived in the land. **22** The Israelites also killed the diviner Balaam son of Beor along with the others they put to the sword. **23** And the border of the Reubenites was the bank of the Jordan. This was the inheritance of the clans of the Reubenites, including the cities and villages. **24** This is what Moses had given to the clans of the tribe of Gad: **25** The territory of Jazer, all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the Ammonites as far as Aroer, near Rabbah; **26** the territory from Heshbon to Ramath-mizpeh and Betonim, and from Mahanaim to the border of Debir; **27** and in the valley, Beth-haram, Beth-nimrah, Succoth, and Zaphon, with the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon (the territory on the east side of the Jordan up to the edge of the Sea of Chinnereth ). **28** This was the inheritance of the clans of the Gadites, including the cities and villages. **29** This is what Moses had given to the clans of the half-tribe of Manasseh, that is, to half the tribe of the descendants of Manasseh: **30** The territory from Mahanaim through all Bashan—all the kingdom of Og king of Bashan,

including all the towns of Jair that are in Bashan, sixty cities; **31** half of Gilead; and Ashtaroth and Edrei, the royal cities of Og in Bashan. All this was for the clans of the descendants of Machir son of Manasseh, that is, half of the descendants of Machir. **32** These were the portions Moses had given them on the plains of Moab beyond the Jordan, east of Jericho. **33** To the tribe of Levi, however, Moses had given no inheritance. The LORD, the God of Israel, is their inheritance, just as He had promised them.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now Joshua was old and well advanced in years. The LORD said to him, “You are old and advanced in years, and there remains yet very much land to be possessed. **2** “This is the land that still remains: all the regions of the Philistines, and all the Geshurites; **3** from the Shihor, which is before Egypt, even to the border of Ekron northward, which is counted as Canaanite; the five lords of the Philistines; the Gazites, and the Ashdodites, the Ashkelonites, the Gittites, and the Ekronites; also the Avvim, **4** on the south; all the land of the Canaanites, and Mearah that belongs to the Sidonians, to Aphek, to the border of the Amorites; **5** and the land of the Gebalites, and all Lebanon, toward the sunrise, from Baal Gad under Mount Hermon to the entrance of Hamath; **6** all the inhabitants of the hill country from Lebanon to Misrephoth Maim, even all the Sidonians. I will drive them out from before the children of Israel. Just allocate it to Israel for an inheritance, as I have commanded you. **7** Now therefore divide this land for an inheritance to the nine tribes and the half-tribe of Manasseh.” **8** With him the Reubenites and the Gadites received their inheritance, which Moses gave them, beyond the Jordan eastward, even as Moses the servant of the LORD gave them: **9** from Aroer, that is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the middle of the valley, and all the plain of Medeba to Dibon; **10** and all the cities of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, to the border of the children of Ammon; **11** and Gilead, and the border of the Geshurites and Maacathites, and all Mount Hermon, and all Bashan to Salecah; **12** all the kingdom of Og in Bashan, who reigned in Ashtaroth and in Edrei (who was left of the remnant of the Rephaim); for Moses attacked these, and drove them out. **13** Nevertheless the children of Israel didn’t drive out the Geshurites, nor the Maacathites: but Geshur and Maacath live within Israel to this day. **14** Only he gave no inheritance to the tribe of Levi. The offerings of the LORD, the God of Israel, made by fire are his inheritance, as he spoke to him. **15** Moses gave to the tribe of the children of Reuben according to their families. **16** Their border was from Aroer, that is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the middle of the valley, and all the plain by Medeba; **17** Heshbon, and all its cities that are in the plain; Dibon, Bamoth Baal, Beth Baal Meon, **18** Jahaz, Kedemoth, Mephaath, **19** Kiriathaim, Sibmah, Zereth Shahar in the mount of the valley, **20** Beth Peor, the slopes of Pisgah, Beth Jeshimoth, **21** all the cities of the plain, and all the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in

Heshbon, whom Moses struck with the chiefs of Midian, Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, the princes of Sihon, who lived in the land. **22** The children of Israel also killed Balaam the son of Beor, the soothsayer, with the sword, among the rest of their slain. **23** The border of the children of Reuben was the bank of the Jordan. This was the inheritance of the children of Reuben according to their families, the cities and its villages. **24** Moses gave to the tribe of Gad, to the children of Gad, according to their families. **25** Their border was Jazer, and all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the children of Ammon, to Aroer that is near Rabbah; **26** and from Heshbon to Ramath Mizpeh, and Betonim; and from Mahanaim to the border of Debir; **27** and in the valley, Beth Haram, Beth Nimrah, Succoth, and Zaphon, the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon, the Jordan's bank, to the uttermost part of the sea of Chinnereth beyond the Jordan eastward. **28** This is the inheritance of the children of Gad according to their families, the cities and its villages. **29** Moses gave an inheritance to the half-tribe of Manasseh. It was for the half-tribe of the children of Manasseh according to their families. **30** Their border was from Mahanaim, all Bashan, all the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, and all the villages of Jair, which are in Bashan, sixty cities. **31** Half Gilead, Ashtaroth, and Edrei, the cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan, were for the children of Machir the son of Manasseh, even for the half of the children of Machir according to their families. **32** These are the inheritances which Moses distributed in the plains of Moab, beyond the Jordan at Jericho, eastward. **33** But Moses gave no inheritance to the tribe of Levi. The LORD, the God of Israel, is their inheritance, as he spoke to them.

## Nehemiah 13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא נִקְרָא בְּסֵפֶר מֹשֶׁה בְּאָזְנֵי הָעָם וְנִמְצָא כָּתוּב בּוֹ אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יָבוֹא עַמּוֹנִי וּמֹאָבִי בִּקְהַל
הָאֱלֹהִים עַד־עוֹלָם **2** כִּי לֹא קִדְּמוּ אֶת־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בַּלֶּחֶם וּבַמָּיִם וַיִּשְׂכֹּר עָלָיו אֶת־בִּלְעָם לְקַלְלוֹ
וַיַּהֲפֹךְ אֱלֹהֵינוּ הַקְּלָלָה לִבְרָכָה **3** וַיְהִי כְּשָׁמְעָם אֶת־הַתּוֹרָה וַיַּבְדִּילוּ כָּל־עֵרֶב מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **4** וְלִפְנֵי
מִזֶּה אֶלְיָשִׁיב הַכֹּהֵן נָתוּן בְּלִשְׁכַּת בֵּית־אֱלֹהֵינוּ קָרוֹב לְטוֹבִיָּה **5** וַיַּעַשׂ לוֹ לִשְׁכָּה גְדוֹלָה וְשָׁם הָיוּ
לְפָנִים נֹתְנִים אֶת־הַמִּנְחָה הַלְּבוֹנָה וְהַכֵּלִים וּמַעֲשַׂר הַדָּגָן הַתִּירוֹשׁ וְהַיִּצְהָר מִצְוַת הַלְוִיִּם וְהַמְשֹׁרְרִים
וְהַשֹּׁעֲרִים וּתְרוּמַת הַכֹּהֲנִים **6** וּבְכָל־זֶה לֹא הָיִיתִי בִּירוּשָׁלִַם כִּי בִּשְׁנַת שְׁלֹשִׁים וּשְׁתַּיִם לְאַרְתַּחְשַׁסְתְּא
מֶלֶךְ־בָּבֶל בָּאתִי אֶל־הַמֶּלֶךְ וּלְקֵץ יָמִים נִשְׁאַלְתִּי מִן־הַמֶּלֶךְ **7** וָאָבוֹא לִירוּשָׁלִַם וָאָבִינָה בָּרָעָה אֲשֶׁר
עָשָׂה אֶלְיָשִׁיב לְטוֹבִיָּה לַעֲשׂוֹת לוֹ לִשְׁכָּה בְּחַצְרֵי בֵּית הָאֱלֹהִים **8** וַיֵּרַע לִי מְאֹד וָאַשְׁלִיכָה אֶת־כָּל־
כְּלֵי בֵית־טוֹבִיָּה הַחוּץ מִן־הַלִּשְׁכָּה **9** וָאֹמְרָה וַיִּטַהֲרוּ הַלְּשָׁכוֹת וָאָשִׁיבָה שָׁם כְּלֵי בֵית הָאֱלֹהִים אֶת־
הַמִּנְחָה וְהַלְּבוֹנָה **10** וָאֵדְעָה כִּי־מְנָיוֹת הַלְוִיִּם לֹא נִתָּנָה וַיִּבְרְחוּ אִישׁ־לְשָׂדֵהוּ הַלְוִיִּם וְהַמְשֹׁרְרִים
עֹשֵׂי הַמְּלָאכָה **11** וָאָרִיבָה אֶת־הַסְּגָנִים וָאֹמְרָה מַדּוּעַ נֶעֱזַב בֵּית־הָאֱלֹהִים וָאֲקַבְּצֵם וָאַעֲמִדֵם עַל־
עָמְדָם **12** וְכָל־יְהוּדָה הֵבִיאוּ מַעְשַׂר הַדָּגָן וְהַתִּירוֹשׁ וְהַיִּצְהָר לָאוֹצָרוֹת **13** וָאוֹצְרָה עַל־אוֹצָרוֹת
שֶׁלְמְיָה הַכֹּהֵן וְצָדוֹק הַסּוֹפֵר וּפְדָיָה מִן־הַלְוִיִּם וְעַל־יָדָם חָנָן בֶּן־זַכּוּר בֶּן־מַתַּנְיָה כִּי נֶאֱמָנִים נֶחְשָׁבוּ
וַעֲלֵיהֶם לַחֲלֹק לַאֲחֵיהֶם **14** זָכְרָה־לִּי אֱלֹהַי עַל־זֹאת וְאַל־תֶּמַח חֲסָדַי אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי בְּבֵית אֱלֹהַי

וּבְמִשְׁמָרָיו **15** בַּיָּמִים הָהֵמָּה רָאִיתִי בִיהוּדָה דֹּרְכִים־גִּתוֹת בַּשַּׁבָּת וּמְבִיאִים הָעֲרֵמוֹת וְעֹמְסִים עַל־
הַחֲמֹרִים וְאַף־יַיִן עֲנָבִים וּתְאֵנִים וְכָל־מַשָּׂא וּמְבִיאִים יְרוּשָׁלַם בְּיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת וָאָעִיד בְּיוֹם מִכְרָם צָיִד
**16** וְהַצֹּרִים יָשְׁבוּ בָהּ מְבִיאִים דָּאג וְכָל־מָכָר וּמֹכְרִים בַּשַּׁבָּת לִבְנֵי יְהוּדָה וּבִירוּשָׁלָם **17** וָאָרִיבָה
אֶת חֹרֵי יְהוּדָה וָאֹמְרָה לָהֶם מָה־הַדָּבָר הָרָע הַזֶּה אֲשֶׁר אַתֶּם עֹשִׂים וּמְחַלְּלִים אֶת־יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **18**
הֲלוֹא כֹה עָשׂוּ אֲבוֹתֵיכֶם וַיָּבֵא אֱלֹהֵינוּ עָלֵינוּ אֵת כָּל־הָרָעָה הַזֹּאת וְעַל הָעִיר הַזֹּאת וְאַתֶּם מוֹסִיפִים
חָרוֹן עַל־יִשְׂרָאֵל לְחַלֵּל אֶת־הַשַּׁבָּת **19** וַיְהִי כַּאֲשֶׁר צָלְלוּ שַׁעֲרֵי יְרוּשָׁלַם לִפְנֵי הַשַּׁבָּת וָאֹמְרָה וְיִסָּגְרוּ
הַדְּלָתוֹת וְאֹמְרָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִפָּתְחוּם עַד אַחַר הַשַּׁבָּת וּמִנְּעָרַי הֶעֱמַדְתִּי עַל־הַשְּׁעָרִים לֹא־יָבוֹא מַשָּׂא
בְּיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **20** וַיָּלִינוּ הָרֹכְלִים וּמֹכְרֵי כָל־מִמְכָּר מִחוּץ לִירוּשָׁלַם פַּעַם וּשְׁתָּיִם **21** וָאָעִידָה בָהֶם
וָאֹמְרָה אֲלֵיהֶם מַדּוּעַ אַתֶּם לָנִים נֶגֶד הַחוֹמָה אִם־תִּשְׁנוּ יָד אֶשְׁלַח בָּכֶם מִן־הָעֵת הַהִיא לֹא־בָאוּ
בַּשַּׁבָּת **22** וָאֹמְרָה לַלְוִיִּם אֲשֶׁר יִהְיוּ מִטַּהֲרִים וּבָאִים שֹׁמְרִים הַשְּׁעָרִים לְקַדֵּשׁ אֶת־יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת גַּם־זֹאת
זָכְרָה־לִּי אֱלֹהַי וְחוּסָה עָלַי כְּרֹב חַסְדֶּךָ **23** גַּם בַּיָּמִים הָהֵם רָאִיתִי אֶת־הַיְּהוּדִים הֹשִׁיבוּ נָשִׁים
אשדודיות עמוניות מוֹאֲבִיּוֹת **24** וּבְנֵיהֶם חֲצִי מְדַבֵּר אַשְׁדּוֹדִית וְאֵינָם מַכִּירִים לְדַבֵּר יְהוּדִית
וְכִלְשׁוֹן עַם וָעָם **25** וָאָרִיב עִמָּם וָאֲקַלְלֵם וָאַכֶּה מֵהֶם אֲנָשִׁים וָאֶמְרְטֵם וָאַשְׁבִּיעֵם בֵּאלֹהִים אִם־תִּתְּנוּ
בְנֹתֵיכֶם לִבְנֵיהֶם וְאִם־תִּשְׂאוּ מִבְּנֹתֵיהֶם לִבְנֵיכֶם וְלָכֶם **26** הֲלוֹא עַל־אֵלֶּה חָטָא־שְׁלֹמֹה מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל
וּבַגּוֹיִם הָרַבִּים לֹא־הָיָה מֶלֶךְ כָּמֹהוּ וְאָהוּב לֵאלֹהָיו הָיָה וַיִּתְּנֵהוּ אֱלֹהִים מֶלֶךְ עַל־כָּל־יִשְׂרָאֵל גַּם־
אוֹתוֹ הֶחֱטִיאוּ הַנָּשִׁים הַנָּכְרִיּוֹת **27** וְלָכֶם הֲנִשְׁמַע לַעֲשׂת אֵת כָּל־הָרָעָה הַגְּדוֹלָה הַזֹּאת לִמְעֹל
בֵּאלֹהֵינוּ לְהוֹשִׁיב נָשִׁים נָכְרִיּוֹת **28** וּמִבְּנֵי יוֹיָדָע בֶּן־אֶלְיָשִׁיב הַכֹּהֵן הַגָּדוֹל חָתָן לְסַנְבַלַּט הַחֹרֹנִי
וָאַבְרִיחֵהוּ מֵעָלָי **29** זָכְרָה לָהֶם אֱלֹהַי עַל גָּאֲלֵי הַכְּהֻנָּה וּבְרִית הַכְּהֻנָּה וְהַלְוִיִּם **30** וְטִהַרְתִּים מִכָּל־
נֵכָר וָאַעֲמִידָה מִשְׁמָרוֹת לַכֹּהֲנִים וְלַלְוִיִּם אִישׁ בִּמְלַאכְתּוֹ **31** וּלְקָרְבַּן הָעֵצִים בְּעִתִּים מְזֻמָּנוֹת
וְלַבִּכּוּרִים זָכְרָה־לִּי אֱלֹהַי לְטוֹבָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** At that time the Book of Moses was read aloud in the hearing of the people, and in it they found the passage stating that no Ammonite or Moabite should ever enter the assembly of God, **2** because they had not met the Israelites with food and water, but had hired Balaam to call down a curse against them (although our God had turned the curse into a blessing). **3** As soon as the people heard this law, they excluded from Israel all of foreign descent. **4** Now before this, Eliashib the priest, a relative of Tobiah, had been put in charge of the storerooms of the house of our God **5** and had prepared for Tobiah a large room where they had previously stored the grain offerings, the frankincense, the temple articles, and the tithes of grain, new wine, and oil prescribed for the Levites, singers, and gatekeepers, along with the contributions for the priests. **6** While all this was happening, I was not in Jerusalem, because I had returned to Artaxerxes king of Babylon in the thirty-second year of his reign. Some time later I obtained leave from the king **7** to return to Jerusalem. Then I discovered the evil that Eliashib had done on behalf of Tobiah by providing him a room in the courts of the house of God. **8** And I was greatly displeased and threw all of Tobiah’s household goods out of the room. **9** Then I ordered that the rooms be purified, and I had the articles of the house of God restored to them, along with the grain offerings and frankincense. **10** I also learned that

because the portions for the Levites had not been given to them, all the Levites and singers responsible for performing the service had gone back to their own fields. **11** So I rebuked the officials and asked, “Why has the house of God been neglected?” Then I gathered the Levites and singers together and stationed them at their posts, **12** and all Judah brought a tenth of the grain, new wine, and oil into the storerooms. **13** I appointed as treasurers over the storerooms Shelemiah the priest, Zadok the scribe, and Pedaiah of the Levites, with Hanan son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah, to assist them, because they were considered trustworthy. They were responsible for distributing the supplies to their fellow Levites. **14** Remember me for this, O my God, and do not blot out my deeds of loving devotion for the house of my God and for its services. **15** In those days I saw people in Judah treading winepresses on the Sabbath and bringing in grain and loading it on donkeys, along with wine, grapes, and figs. All kinds of goods were being brought into Jerusalem on the Sabbath day. So I warned them against selling food on that day. **16** Additionally, men of Tyre who lived there were importing fish and all kinds of merchandise and selling them on the Sabbath to the people of Judah in Jerusalem. **17** Then I rebuked the nobles of Judah and asked, “What is this evil you are doing—profaning the Sabbath day? **18** Did not your forefathers do the same things, so that our God brought all this disaster on us and on this city? And now you are rekindling His wrath against Israel by profaning the Sabbath!” **19** When the evening shadows began to fall on the gates of Jerusalem, just before the Sabbath, I ordered that the gates be shut and not opened until after the Sabbath. I posted some of my servants at the gates so that no load could enter on the Sabbath day. **20** Once or twice, the merchants and those who sell all kinds of goods camped outside Jerusalem, **21** but I warned them, “Why are you camping in front of the wall? If you do it again, I will lay hands on you.” From that time on, they did not return on the Sabbath. **22** Then I instructed the Levites to purify themselves and guard the gates in order to keep the Sabbath day holy. Remember me for this as well, O my God, and show me mercy according to Your abundant loving devotion. **23** In those days I also saw Jews who had married women from Ashdod, Ammon, and Moab. **24** Half of their children spoke the language of Ashdod or of the other peoples, but could not speak the language of Judah. **25** I rebuked them and called down curses on them. I beat some of these men and pulled out their hair. Then I made them take an oath before God and said, “You must not give your daughters in marriage to their sons or take their daughters as wives for your sons or for yourselves! **26** Did not King Solomon of Israel sin in matters like this? There was not a king like him among many nations, and he was loved by his God, who made him king over all Israel—yet foreign women drew him into sin. **27** Must we now hear that you too are doing all this terrible evil and acting unfaithfully against our God by marrying foreign women?” **28** Even one of the sons of Jehoiada son of Eliashib the high priest had become a son-in-law to Sanballat the Horonite. Therefore I drove him away from me. **29** Remember them, O my God, because they have defiled the priesthood and the covenant of

the priesthood and of the Levites. **30** Thus I purified the priests and Levites from everything foreign, and I assigned specific duties to each of the priests and Levites. **31** I also arranged for contributions of wood at the appointed times, and for the firstfruits. Remember me, O my God, with favor.

*English (WEB)*

**1** On that day they read in the book of Moses in the hearing of the people; and it was found written in it that an Ammonite and a Moabite should not enter into the assembly of God forever, **2** because they didn't meet the children of Israel with bread and with water, but hired Balaam against them to curse them; however, our God turned the curse into a blessing. **3** It came to pass, when they had heard the law, that they separated all the mixed multitude from Israel. **4** Now before this, Eliashib the priest, who was appointed over the rooms of the house of our God, being allied to Tobiah, **5** had prepared for him a great room, where previously they laid the meal offerings, the frankincense, the vessels, and the tithes of the grain, the new wine, and the oil, which were given by commandment to the Levites, the singers, and the gatekeepers; and the wave offerings for the priests. **6** But in all this, I was not at Jerusalem; for in the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon I went to the king; and after some days I asked leave of the king, **7** and I came to Jerusalem, and understood the evil that Eliashib had done for Tobiah, in preparing him a room in the courts of God's house. **8** It grieved me severely. Therefore I threw all Tobiah's household stuff out of the room. **9** Then I commanded, and they cleansed the rooms. I brought into them the vessels of God's house, with the meal offerings and the frankincense again. **10** I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them, so that the Levites and the singers, who did the work, had each fled to his field. **11** Then I contended with the rulers, and said, "Why is God's house forsaken?" I gathered them together, and set them in their place. **12** Then all Judah brought the tithe of the grain, the new wine, and the oil to the treasuries. **13** I made treasurers over the treasuries, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Pedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah; for they were counted faithful, and their business was to distribute to their brothers. **14** Remember me, my God, concerning this, and don't wipe out my good deeds that I have done for the house of my God, and for its observances. **15** In those days I saw some men treading wine presses on the Sabbath in Judah, bringing in sheaves, and loading donkeys with wine, grapes, figs, and all kinds of burdens which they brought into Jerusalem on the Sabbath day; and I testified against them in the day in which they sold food. **16** Some men of Tyre also lived there, who brought in fish and all kinds of wares, and sold on the Sabbath to the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem. **17** Then I contended with the nobles of Judah, and said to them, "What evil thing is this that you do, and profane the Sabbath day? **18** Didn't your fathers do this, and didn't our God bring all this evil on us and on this city? Yet you bring more wrath on Israel by

profaning the Sabbath.” **19** It came to pass that when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the Sabbath, I commanded that the doors should be shut, and commanded that they should not be opened until after the Sabbath. I set some of my servants over the gates, so that no burden should be brought in on the Sabbath day. **20** So the merchants and sellers of all kinds of wares camped outside of Jerusalem once or twice. **21** Then I testified against them, and said to them, “Why do you stay around the wall? If you do so again, I will lay hands on you.” From that time on, they didn’t come on the Sabbath. **22** I commanded the Levites that they should purify themselves, and that they should come and keep the gates, to sanctify the Sabbath day. Remember me for this also, my God, and spare me according to the greatness of your loving kindness. **23** In those days I also saw the Jews who had married women of Ashdod, of Ammon, and of Moab; **24** and their children spoke half in the speech of Ashdod, and could not speak in the Jews’ language, but according to the language of each people. **25** I contended with them, cursed them, struck certain of them, plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, “You shall not give your daughters to their sons, nor take their daughters for your sons, or for yourselves. **26** Didn’t Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? Yet among many nations there was no king like him, and he was loved by his God, and God made him king over all Israel. Nevertheless foreign women caused even him to sin. **27** Shall we then listen to you to do all this great evil, to trespass against our God in marrying foreign women?” **28** One of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was son-in-law to Sanballat the Horonite; therefore I chased him from me. **29** Remember them, my God, because they have defiled the priesthood and the covenant of the priesthood and of the Levites. **30** Thus I cleansed them from all foreigners and appointed duties for the priests and for the Levites, everyone in his work; **31** and for the wood offering, at appointed times, and for the first fruits. Remember me, my God, for good.

## Psalm 106:16–18

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**16** וַיְקַנְאוּ לְמֹשֶׁה בַּמַּחֲנֶה לְאַהֲרֹן קְדוֹשׁ יְהוָה **17** תִּפְתַּח־אֶרֶץ וַתִּבְלַע דָּתָן וְתִכ�special ע עַל־עֲדַת אֲבִירָם
**18** וַתִּבְעַר־אֵשׁ בַּעֲדָתָם לֶהָבָה תְּלַהֵט רְשָׁעִים

*English (BSB)*

**16** In the camp they envied Moses, as well as Aaron, the holy one of the LORD. **17** The earth opened up and swallowed Dathan; it covered the assembly of Abiram. **18** Then fire blazed through their company; flames consumed the wicked.

*English (WEB)*

**16** They envied Moses also in the camp, and Aaron, the LORD’s saint. **17** The earth opened and swallowed up Dathan, and covered the company of Abiram. **18** A fire was kindled in their company. The flame burned up the wicked.

## Isaiah 5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** אָשִׁירָה נָּא לִידִידִי שִׁירַת דּוֹדִי לְכַרְמוֹ כֶּרֶם הָיָה לִידִידִי בְּקֶרֶן בֶּן־שָׁמֶן **2** וַיְעַזְּקֵהוּ וַיְסַקְּלֵהוּ
וַיִּטָּעֵהוּ שֹׂרֵק וַיִּבֶן מִגְדָּל בְּתוֹכוֹ וְגַם־יֶקֶב חָצֵב בּוֹ וַיְקַו לַעֲשׂוֹת עֲנָבִים וַיַּעַשׂ בְּאֻשִׁים **3** וְעַתָּה יוֹשֵׁב
יְרוּשָׁלַ͏ִם וְאִישׁ יְהוּדָה שִׁפְטוּ־נָא בֵּינִי וּבֵין כַּרְמִי **4** מַה־לַּעֲשׂוֹת עוֹד לְכַרְמִי וְלֹא עָשִׂיתִי בּוֹ מַדּוּעַ
קִוֵּיתִי לַעֲשׂוֹת עֲנָבִים וַיַּעַשׂ בְּאֻשִׁים **5** וְעַתָּה אוֹדִיעָה־נָּא אֶתְכֶם אֵת אֲשֶׁר־אֲנִי עֹשֶׂה לְכַרְמִי הָסֵר
מְשׂוּכָתוֹ וְהָיָה לְבָעֵר פָּרֹץ גְּדֵרוֹ וְהָיָה לְמִרְמָס **6** וַאֲשִׁיתֵהוּ בָתָה לֹא יִזָּמֵר וְלֹא יֵעָדֵר וְעָלָה שָׁמִיר
וָשָׁיִת וְעַל הֶעָבִים אֲצַוֶּה מֵהַמְטִיר עָלָיו מָטָר **7** כִּי כֶרֶם יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל וְאִישׁ יְהוּדָה נְטַע
שַׁעֲשׁוּעָיו וַיְקַו לְמִשְׁפָּט וְהִנֵּה מִשְׂפָּח לִצְדָקָה וְהִנֵּה צְעָקָה **8** הוֹי מַגִּיעֵי בַיִת בְּבַיִת שָׂדֶה בְשָׂדֶה
יַקְרִיבוּ עַד אֶפֶס מָקוֹם וְהוּשַׁבְתֶּם לְבַדְּכֶם בְּקֶרֶב הָאָרֶץ **9** בְּאָזְנָי יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת אִם־לֹא בָּתִּים רַבִּים
לְשַׁמָּה יִהְיוּ גְּדֹלִים וְטוֹבִים מֵאֵין יוֹשֵׁב **10** כִּי עֶשֶׂרֶת צִמְדֵּי־כֶרֶם יַעֲשׂוּ בַּת אֶחָת וְזֶרַע חֹמֶר יַעֲשֶׂה
אֵיפָה **11** הוֹי מַשְׁכִּימֵי בַבֹּקֶר שֵׁכָר יִרְדֹּפוּ מְאַחֲרֵי בַנֶּשֶׁף יַיִן יַדְלִיקֵם **12** וְהָיָה כִנּוֹר וָנֶבֶל תֹּף וְחָלִיל
וָיַיִן מִשְׁתֵּיהֶם וְאֵת פֹּעַל יְהוָה לֹא יַבִּיטוּ וּמַעֲשֵׂה יָדָיו לֹא רָאוּ **13** לָכֵן גָּלָה עַמִּי מִבְּלִי־דָעַת וּכְבוֹדוֹ
מְתֵי רָעָב וַהֲמוֹנוֹ צָחֵה צָמָא **14** לָכֵן הִרְחִיבָה שְׁאוֹל נַפְשָׁהּ וּפָעֲרָה פִיהָ לִבְלִי־חֹק וְיָרַד הֲדָרָהּ
וַהֲמוֹנָהּ וּשְׁאוֹנָהּ וְעָלֵז בָּהּ **15** וַיִּשַּׁח אָדָם וַיִּשְׁפַּל־אִישׁ וְעֵינֵי גְבֹהִים תִּשְׁפַּלְנָה **16** וַיִּגְבַּהּ יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת
בַּמִּשְׁפָּט וְהָאֵל הַקָּדוֹשׁ נִקְדַּשׁ בִּצְדָקָה **17** וְרָעוּ כְבָשִׂים כְּדָבָרָם וְחָרְבוֹת מֵחִים גָּרִים יֹאכֵלוּ **18** הוֹי
מֹשְׁכֵי הֶעָוֹן בְּחַבְלֵי הַשָּׁוְא וְכַעֲבוֹת הָעֲגָלָה חַטָּאָה **19** הָאֹמְרִים יְמַהֵר יָחִישָׁה מַעֲשֵׂהוּ לְמַעַן נִרְאֶה
וְתִקְרַב וְתָבוֹאָה עֲצַת קְדוֹשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְנֵדָעָה **20** הוֹי הָאֹמְרִים לָרַע טוֹב וְלַטּוֹב רָע שָׂמִים חֹשֶׁךְ לְאוֹר
וְאוֹר לְחֹשֶׁךְ שָׂמִים מַר לְמָתוֹק וּמָתוֹק לְמָר **21** הוֹי חֲכָמִים בְּעֵינֵיהֶם וְנֶגֶד פְּנֵיהֶם נְבֹנִים **22** הוֹי
גִּבּוֹרִים לִשְׁתּוֹת יָיִן וְאַנְשֵׁי־חַיִל לִמְסֹךְ שֵׁכָר **23** מַצְדִּיקֵי רָשָׁע עֵקֶב שֹׁחַד וְצִדְקַת צַדִּיקִים יָסִירוּ מִמֶּנּוּ
**24** לָכֵן כֶּאֱכֹל קַשׁ לְשׁוֹן אֵשׁ וַחֲשַׁשׁ לֶהָבָה יִרְפָּה שָׁרְשָׁם כַּמָּק יִהְיֶה וּפִרְחָם כָּאָבָק יַעֲלֶה כִּי מָאֲסוּ אֵת
תּוֹרַת יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת וְאֵת אִמְרַת קְדוֹשׁ־יִשְׂרָאֵל נָאֲצוּ **25** עַל־כֵּן חָרָה אַף־יְהוָה בְּעַמּוֹ וַיֵּט יָדוֹ עָלָיו
וַיַּכֵּהוּ וַיִּרְגְּזוּ הֶהָרִים וַתְּהִי נִבְלָתָם כַּסּוּחָה בְּקֶרֶב חוּצוֹת בְּכָל־זֹאת לֹא־שָׁב אַפּוֹ וְעוֹד יָדוֹ נְטוּיָה **26**
וְנָשָׂא־נֵס לַגּוֹיִם מֵרָחוֹק וְשָׁרַק לוֹ מִקְצֵה הָאָרֶץ וְהִנֵּה מְהֵרָה קַל יָבוֹא **27** אֵין־עָיֵף וְאֵין־כּוֹשֵׁל בּוֹ לֹא
יָנוּם וְלֹא יִישָׁן וְלֹא נִפְתַּח אִזּוֹר חֲלָצָיו וְלֹא נִתַּק שְׂרוֹךְ נְעָלָיו **28** אֲשֶׁר חִצָּיו שְׁנוּנִים וְכָל־קַשְׁתֹתָיו
דְּרֻכוֹת פַּרְסוֹת סוּסָיו כַּצֹּר נֶחְשָׁבוּ וְגַלְגְּלָיו כַּסּוּפָה **29** שְׁאָגָה לוֹ כַּלָּבִיא וּשאג כַּכְּפִירִים וְיִנְהֹם
וְיֹאחֵז טָרָף וַיַּפְלִיט וְאֵין מַצִּיל **30** וְיִנְהֹם עָלָיו בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא כִּנְהָמַת־יָם וְנִבַּט לָאָרֶץ וְהִנֵּה־חֹשֶׁךְ צַר
וָאוֹר חָשַׁךְ בַּעֲרִיפֶיהָ

*English (BSB)*

**1** I will sing for my beloved a song of his vineyard: My beloved had a vineyard on a very fertile hill. **2** He dug it up and cleared the stones and planted the finest vines. He built a watchtower in the middle and dug out a winepress as well. He waited for the vineyard to yield good grapes, but the fruit it produced was sour! **3** “And now, O dwellers of Jerusalem and men of Judah, I exhort you

to judge between Me and My vineyard. **4** What more could I have done for My vineyard than I already did for it? Why, when I expected sweet grapes, did it bring forth sour fruit? **5** Now I will tell you what I am about to do to My vineyard: I will take away its hedge, and it will be consumed; I will tear down its wall, and it will be trampled. **6** I will make it a wasteland, neither pruned nor cultivated, and thorns and briers will grow up. I will command the clouds that rain shall not fall on it." **7** For the vineyard of the LORD of Hosts is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah are the plant of His delight. He looked for justice, but saw bloodshed; for righteousness, but heard a cry of distress. **8** Woe to you who add house to house and join field to field until no place is left and you live alone in the land. **9** I heard the LORD of Hosts declare: "Surely many houses will become desolate, great mansions left unoccupied. **10** For ten acres of vineyard will yield but a bath of wine, and a homer of seed only an ephah of grain." **11** Woe to those who rise early in the morning in pursuit of strong drink, who linger into the evening, to be inflamed by wine. **12** At their feasts are the lyre and harp, tambourines and flutes and wine. They disregard the actions of the LORD and fail to see the work of His hands. **13** Therefore My people will go into exile for their lack of understanding; their dignitaries are starving and their masses are parched with thirst. **14** Therefore Sheol enlarges its throat and opens wide its enormous jaws, and down go Zion's nobles and masses, her revelers and carousers! **15** So mankind will be brought low, and each man humbled; the arrogant will lower their eyes. **16** But the LORD of Hosts will be exalted by His justice, and the holy God will show Himself holy in righteousness. **17** Lambs will graze as in their own pastures, and strangers will feed in the ruins of the wealthy. **18** Woe to those who draw iniquity with cords of deceit and pull sin along with cart ropes, **19** to those who say, "Let Him hurry and hasten His work so that we may see it! Let the plan of the Holy One of Israel come so that we may know it!" **20** Woe to those who call evil good and good evil, who turn darkness to light and light to darkness, who replace bitter with sweet and sweet with bitter. **21** Woe to those who are wise in their own eyes and clever in their own sight. **22** Woe to those who are heroes in drinking wine and champions in mixing beer, **23** who acquit the guilty for a bribe and deprive the innocent of justice. **24** Therefore, as a tongue of fire consumes the straw, and as dry grass shrivels in the flame, so their roots will decay and their blossoms will blow away like dust; for they have rejected the instruction of the LORD of Hosts and despised the word of the Holy One of Israel. **25** Therefore the anger of the LORD burns against His people; His hand is raised against them to strike them down. The mountains quake, and the corpses lay like refuse in the streets. Despite all this, His anger is not turned away; His hand is still upraised. **26** He lifts a banner for the distant nations and whistles for those at the ends of the earth. Behold—how speedily and swiftly they come! **27** None of them grows weary or stumbles; no one slumbers or sleeps. No belt is loose and no sandal strap is broken. **28** Their arrows are sharpened, and all their bows are strung. The hooves of their horses are like flint; their chariot wheels are like a whirlwind. **29** Their roaring

is like that of a lion; they roar like young lions. They growl and seize their prey; they carry it away from deliverance. **30** In that day they will roar over it, like the roaring of the sea. If one looks over the land, he will see darkness and distress; even the light will be obscured by clouds.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Let me sing for my well beloved a song of my beloved about his vineyard. My beloved had a vineyard on a very fruitful hill. **2** He dug it up, gathered out its stones, planted it with the choicest vine, built a tower in the middle of it, and also cut out a wine press in it. He looked for it to yield grapes, but it yielded wild grapes. **3** “Now, inhabitants of Jerusalem and men of Judah, please judge between me and my vineyard. **4** What could have been done more to my vineyard, that I have not done in it? Why, when I looked for it to yield grapes, did it yield wild grapes? **5** Now I will tell you what I will do to my vineyard. I will take away its hedge, and it will be eaten up. I will break down its wall, and it will be trampled down. **6** I will lay it a wasteland. It won’t be pruned or hoed, but it will grow briers and thorns. I will also command the clouds that they rain no rain on it.” **7** For the vineyard of the LORD of Armies is the house of Israel, and the men of Judah his pleasant plant. He looked for justice, but behold, oppression, for righteousness, but behold, a cry of distress. **8** Woe to those who join house to house, who lay field to field, until there is no room, and you are made to dwell alone in the middle of the land! **9** In my ears, the LORD of Armies says: “Surely many houses will be desolate, even great and beautiful, unoccupied. **10** For ten acres of vineyard shall yield one bath, and a homer of seed shall yield an ephah.” **11** Woe to those who rise up early in the morning, that they may follow strong drink, who stay late into the night, until wine inflames them! **12** The harp, lyre, tambourine, and flute, with wine, are at their feasts; but they don’t respect the work of the LORD, neither have they considered the operation of his hands. **13** Therefore my people go into captivity for lack of knowledge. Their honorable men are famished, and their multitudes are parched with thirst. **14** Therefore Sheol has enlarged its desire, and opened its mouth without measure; and their glory, their multitude, their pomp, and he who rejoices among them, descend into it. **15** So man is brought low, mankind is humbled, and the eyes of the arrogant ones are humbled; **16** but the LORD of Armies is exalted in justice, and God the Holy One is sanctified in righteousness. **17** Then the lambs will graze as in their pasture, and strangers will eat the ruins of the rich. **18** Woe to those who draw iniquity with cords of falsehood, and wickedness as with cart rope, **19** who say, “Let him make haste, let him hasten his work, that we may see it; let the counsel of the Holy One of Israel draw near and come, that we may know it!” **20** Woe to those who call evil good, and good evil; who put darkness for light, and light for darkness; who put bitter for sweet, and sweet for bitter! **21** Woe to those who are wise in their own eyes, and prudent in their own sight! **22** Woe to those who are mighty to drink wine, and champions at mixing strong drink; **23**

who acquit the guilty for a bribe, but deny justice for the innocent! **24** Therefore as the tongue of fire devours the stubble, and as the dry grass sinks down in the flame, so their root shall be as rottenness, and their blossom shall go up as dust, because they have rejected the law of the LORD of Armies, and despised the word of the Holy One of Israel. **25** Therefore the LORD's anger burns against his people, and he has stretched out his hand against them and has struck them. The mountains tremble, and their dead bodies are as refuse in the middle of the streets. For all this, his anger is not turned away, but his hand is still stretched out. **26** He will lift up a banner to the nations from far away, and he will whistle for them from the end of the earth. Behold, they will come speedily and swiftly. **27** No one shall be weary nor stumble among them; no one shall slumber nor sleep, neither shall the belt of their waist be untied, nor the strap of their sandals be broken, **28** whose arrows are sharp, and all their bows bent. Their horses' hoofs will be like flint, and their wheels like a whirlwind. **29** Their roaring will be like a lioness. They will roar like young lions. Yes, they shall roar, and seize their prey and carry it off, and there will be no one to deliver. **30** They will roar against them in that day like the roaring of the sea. If one looks to the land, behold, darkness and distress. The light is darkened in its clouds.

## Micah 6:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**5** עַמִּי זְכָר־נָא מַה־יָּעַץ בָּלָק מֶלֶךְ מוֹאָב וּמָה־עָנָה אֹתוֹ בִּלְעָם בֶּן־בְּעוֹר מִן־הַשִּׁטִּים עַד־הַגִּלְגָּל
לְמַעַן דַּעַת צִדְקוֹת יְהוָה

*English (BSB)*

**5** My people, remember what Balak king of Moab counseled and what Balaam son of Beor answered. Remember your journey from Shittim to Gilgal, so that you may acknowledge the righteousness of the LORD.'"

*English (WEB)*

**5** My people, remember now what Balak king of Moab devised, and what Balaam the son of Beor answered him from Shittim to Gilgal, that you may know the righteous acts of the LORD."

## Sirach 45:18–19

*Greek (Septuagint, as printed in Brenton's edition, public domain)*

**18** Ἐπισυνέστησαν αὐτῷ ἀλλότριοι, καὶ ἐζήλωσαν αὐτὸν ἐν τῇ ἐρήμῳ, ἄνδρες οἱ περὶ Δαθὰν καὶ Ἀβειρὼν, καὶ ἡ συναγωγὴ Κορὲ ἐν θυμῷ καὶ ὀργῇ. **19** Εἶδε Κύριος καὶ οὐκ εὐδόκησε, καὶ συνετελέσθησαν ἐν θυμῷ ὀργῆς· ἐποίησεν αὐτοῖς τέρατα, καταναλῶσαι ἐν πυρὶ φλογὸς αὐτοῦ.

*English (Brenton, 1844)*

**18** Strangers conspired together against him, and maligned him in the wilderness, even the men that were of Dathan's and Abiron's side, and the congregation of Core, with fury and wrath. **19** This the Lord saw, and it displeased him, and in his wrathful indignation were they consumed: he did wonders upon them, to consume them with the fiery flame.

## Matthew 23

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Τότε ὁ Ἰησοῦς ἐλάλησεν τοῖς ὄχλοις καὶ τοῖς μαθηταῖς αὐτοῦ **2** λέγων· Ἐπὶ τῆς Μωϋσέως καθέδρας ἐκάθισαν οἱ γραμματεῖς καὶ οἱ Φαρισαῖοι. **3** πάντα οὖν ὅσα ἐὰν εἴπωσιν ὑμῖν ποιήσατε καὶ τηρεῖτε, κατὰ δὲ τὰ ἔργα αὐτῶν μὴ ποιεῖτε, λέγουσιν γὰρ καὶ οὐ ποιοῦσιν. **4** δεσμεύουσιν δὲ φορτία βαρέα καὶ ἐπιτιθέασιν ἐπὶ τοὺς ὤμους τῶν ἀνθρώπων, αὐτοὶ δὲ τῷ δακτύλῳ αὐτῶν οὐ θέλουσιν κινῆσαι αὐτά. **5** πάντα δὲ τὰ ἔργα αὐτῶν ποιοῦσιν πρὸς τὸ θεαθῆναι τοῖς ἀνθρώποις· πλατύνουσι γὰρ τὰ φυλακτήρια αὐτῶν καὶ μεγαλύνουσι τὰ κράσπεδα, **6** φιλοῦσι δὲ τὴν πρωτοκλισίαν ἐν τοῖς δείπνοις καὶ τὰς πρωτοκαθεδρίας ἐν ταῖς συναγωγαῖς **7** καὶ τοὺς ἀσπασμοὺς ἐν ταῖς ἀγοραῖς καὶ καλεῖσθαι ὑπὸ τῶν ἀνθρώπων· Ῥαββί. **8** ὑμεῖς δὲ μὴ κληθῆτε· Ῥαββί, εἷς γάρ ἐστιν ὑμῶν ὁ διδάσκαλος, πάντες δὲ ὑμεῖς ἀδελφοί ἐστε· **9** καὶ πατέρα μὴ καλέσητε ὑμῶν ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς, εἷς γάρ ἐστιν ὑμῶν ὁ πατὴρ ὁ οὐράνιος· **10** μηδὲ κληθῆτε καθηγηταί, ὅτι καθηγητὴς ὑμῶν ἐστιν εἷς ὁ χριστός· **11** ὁ δὲ μείζων ὑμῶν ἔσται ὑμῶν διάκονος. **12** ὅστις δὲ ὑψώσει ἑαυτὸν ταπεινωθήσεται, καὶ ὅστις ταπεινώσει ἑαυτὸν ὑψωθήσεται. **13** Οὐαὶ δὲ ὑμῖν, γραμματεῖς καὶ Φαρισαῖοι ὑποκριταί, ὅτι κλείετε τὴν βασιλείαν τῶν οὐρανῶν ἔμπροσθεν τῶν ἀνθρώπων· ὑμεῖς γὰρ οὐκ εἰσέρχεσθε, οὐδὲ τοὺς εἰσερχομένους ἀφίετε εἰσελθεῖν. **15** Οὐαὶ ὑμῖν, γραμματεῖς καὶ Φαρισαῖοι ὑποκριταί, ὅτι περιάγετε τὴν θάλασσαν καὶ τὴν ξηρὰν ποιῆσαι ἕνα προσήλυτον, καὶ ὅταν γένηται ποιεῖτε αὐτὸν υἱὸν γεέννης διπλότερον ὑμῶν. **16** Οὐαὶ ὑμῖν, ὁδηγοὶ τυφλοὶ οἱ λέγοντες· Ὃς ἂν ὀμόσῃ ἐν τῷ ναῷ, οὐδέν ἐστιν, ὃς δ' ἂν ὀμόσῃ ἐν τῷ χρυσῷ τοῦ ναοῦ ὀφείλει. **17** μωροὶ καὶ τυφλοί, τίς γὰρ μείζων ἐστίν, ὁ χρυσὸς ἢ ὁ ναὸς ὁ ἁγιάσας τὸν χρυσόν; **18** καί· Ὃς ἂν ὀμόσῃ ἐν τῷ θυσιαστηρίῳ, οὐδέν ἐστιν, ὃς δ' ἂν ὀμόσῃ ἐν τῷ δώρῳ τῷ ἐπάνω αὐτοῦ ὀφείλει. **19** τυφλοί, τί γὰρ μεῖζον, τὸ δῶρον ἢ τὸ θυσιαστήριον τὸ ἁγιάζον τὸ δῶρον; **20** ὁ οὖν ὀμόσας ἐν τῷ θυσιαστηρίῳ ὀμνύει ἐν αὐτῷ καὶ ἐν πᾶσι τοῖς ἐπάνω αὐτοῦ· **21** καὶ ὁ ὀμόσας ἐν τῷ ναῷ ὀμνύει ἐν αὐτῷ καὶ ἐν τῷ κατοικοῦντι αὐτόν· **22** καὶ ὁ ὀμόσας ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ ὀμνύει ἐν τῷ θρόνῳ τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ ἐν τῷ καθημένῳ ἐπάνω αὐτοῦ. **23** Οὐαὶ ὑμῖν, γραμματεῖς καὶ Φαρισαῖοι ὑποκριταί, ὅτι ἀποδεκατοῦτε τὸ ἡδύοσμον καὶ τὸ ἄνηθον καὶ τὸ κύμινον, καὶ ἀφήκατε τὰ βαρύτερα τοῦ νόμου, τὴν κρίσιν καὶ τὸ ἔλεος καὶ τὴν πίστιν· ταῦτα ἔδει ποιῆσαι κἀκεῖνα μὴ ἀφιέναι. **24** ὁδηγοὶ τυφλοί, οἱ διϋλίζοντες τὸν κώνωπα τὴν δὲ κάμηλον καταπίνοντες. **25** Οὐαὶ ὑμῖν, γραμματεῖς καὶ Φαρισαῖοι ὑποκριταί, ὅτι καθαρίζετε τὸ ἔξωθεν τοῦ ποτηρίου καὶ τῆς παροψίδος, ἔσωθεν δὲ γέμουσιν ἐξ ἁρπαγῆς καὶ ἀκρασίας. **26** Φαρισαῖε τυφλέ, καθάρισον πρῶτον τὸ ἐντὸς τοῦ ποτηρίου καὶ τῆς παροψίδος, ἵνα γένηται καὶ τὸ ἐκτὸς αὐτοῦ καθαρόν. **27** Οὐαὶ ὑμῖν, γραμματεῖς καὶ Φαρισαῖοι ὑποκριταί, ὅτι παρομοιάζετε τάφοις κεκονιαμένοις, οἵτινες ἔξωθεν μὲν φαίνονται ὡραῖοι ἔσωθεν δὲ γέμουσιν ὀστέων νεκρῶν καὶ πάσης ἀκαθαρσίας· **28** οὕτως καὶ ὑμεῖς ἔξωθεν μὲν φαίνεσθε τοῖς ἀνθρώποις δίκαιοι, ἔσωθεν δέ ἐστε μεστοὶ ὑποκρίσεως καὶ ἀνομίας. **29** Οὐαὶ ὑμῖν, γραμματεῖς

καὶ Φαρισαῖοι ὑποκριταί, ὅτι οἰκοδομεῖτε τοὺς τάφους τῶν προφητῶν καὶ κοσμεῖτε τὰ μνημεῖα τῶν δικαίων, **30** καὶ λέγετε· Εἰ ἤμεθα ἐν ταῖς ἡμέραις τῶν πατέρων ἡμῶν, οὐκ ἂν ἤμεθα αὐτῶν κοινωνοὶ ἐν τῷ αἵματι τῶν προφητῶν· **31** ὥστε μαρτυρεῖτε ἑαυτοῖς ὅτι υἱοί ἐστε τῶν φονευσάντων τοὺς προφήτας. **32** καὶ ὑμεῖς πληρώσατε τὸ μέτρον τῶν πατέρων ὑμῶν. **33** ὄφεις γεννήματα ἐχιδνῶν, πῶς φύγητε ἀπὸ τῆς κρίσεως τῆς γεέννης; **34** διὰ τοῦτο ἰδοὺ ἐγὼ ἀποστέλλω πρὸς ὑμᾶς προφήτας καὶ σοφοὺς καὶ γραμματεῖς· ἐξ αὐτῶν ἀποκτενεῖτε καὶ σταυρώσετε, καὶ ἐξ αὐτῶν μαστιγώσετε ἐν ταῖς συναγωγαῖς ὑμῶν καὶ διώξετε ἀπὸ πόλεως εἰς πόλιν· **35** ὅπως ἔλθῃ ἐφ᾽ ὑμᾶς πᾶν αἷμα δίκαιον ἐκχυννόμενον ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς ἀπὸ τοῦ αἵματος Ἄβελ τοῦ δικαίου ἕως τοῦ αἵματος Ζαχαρίου υἱοῦ Βαραχίου, ὃν ἐφονεύσατε μεταξὺ τοῦ ναοῦ καὶ τοῦ θυσιαστηρίου. **36** ἀμὴν λέγω ὑμῖν, ἥξει ταῦτα πάντα ἐπὶ τὴν γενεὰν ταύτην. **37** Ἰερουσαλὴμ Ἰερουσαλήμ, ἡ ἀποκτείνουσα τοὺς προφήτας καὶ λιθοβολοῦσα τοὺς ἀπεσταλμένους πρὸς αὐτήν— ποσάκις ἠθέλησα ἐπισυναγαγεῖν τὰ τέκνα σου, ὃν τρόπον ὄρνις ἐπισυνάγει τὰ νοσσία αὐτῆς ὑπὸ τὰς πτέρυγας, καὶ οὐκ ἠθελήσατε; **38** ἰδοὺ ἀφίεται ὑμῖν ὁ οἶκος ὑμῶν ἔρημος. **39** λέγω γὰρ ὑμῖν, οὐ μή με ἴδητε ἀπ᾽ ἄρτι ἕως ἂν εἴπητε· Εὐλογημένος ὁ ἐρχόμενος ἐν ὀνόματι κυρίου.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then Jesus spoke to the crowds and to His disciples: **2** “The scribes and Pharisees sit in Moses’ seat. **3** So practice and observe everything they tell you. But do not do what they do, for they do not practice what they preach. **4** They tie up heavy, burdensome loads and lay them on men’s shoulders, but they themselves are not willing to lift a finger to move them. **5** All their deeds are done for men to see. They broaden their phylacteries and lengthen their tassels. **6** They love the places of honor at banquets, the chief seats in the synagogues, **7** the greetings in the marketplaces, and the title of ‘Rabbi’ by which they are addressed. **8** But you are not to be called ‘Rabbi,’ for you have one Teacher, and you are all brothers. **9** And do not call anyone on earth your father, for you have one Father, who is in heaven. **10** Nor are you to be called instructors, for you have one Instructor, the Christ. **11** The greatest among you shall be your servant. **12** For whoever exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself will be exalted. **13** Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You shut the kingdom of heaven in men’s faces. You yourselves do not enter, nor will you let in those who wish to enter. **15** Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You traverse land and sea to win a single convert, and when he becomes one, you make him twice as much a son of hell as you are. **16** Woe to you, blind guides! You say, ‘If anyone swears by the temple, it means nothing; but if anyone swears by the gold of the temple, he is bound by his oath.’ **17** You blind fools! Which is greater: the gold, or the temple that makes it sacred? **18** And you say, ‘If anyone swears by the altar, it means nothing; but if anyone swears by the gift on it, he is bound by his oath.’ **19** You blind men! Which is greater: the gift, or the altar that makes it sacred? **20** So then, he who swears by the altar swears by it and by everything on it. **21** And he who swears by the temple swears by it and by the One who dwells in it. **22** And he who swears by heaven swears by God’s throne and by the One

who sits on it. **23** Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You pay tithes of mint, dill, and cumin. But you have disregarded the weightier matters of the law: justice, mercy, and faithfulness. You should have practiced the latter, without neglecting the former. **24** You blind guides! You strain out a gnat but swallow a camel. **25** Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You clean the outside of the cup and dish, but inside they are full of greed and self-indulgence. **26** Blind Pharisee! First clean the inside of the cup and dish, so that the outside may become clean as well. **27** Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You are like whitewashed tombs, which look beautiful on the outside, but on the inside are full of dead men's bones and every kind of impurity. **28** In the same way, on the outside you appear to be righteous, but on the inside you are full of hypocrisy and wickedness. **29** Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, you hypocrites! You build tombs for the prophets and decorate the monuments of the righteous. **30** And you say, 'If we had lived in the days of our fathers, we would not have been partners with them in shedding the blood of the prophets.' **31** So you testify against yourselves that you are the sons of those who murdered the prophets. **32** Fill up, then, the measure of the sin of your fathers. **33** You snakes! You brood of vipers! How will you escape the sentence of hell? **34** Because of this, I am sending you prophets and wise men and teachers. Some of them you will kill and crucify, and others you will flog in your synagogues and persecute in town after town. **35** And so upon you will come all the righteous blood shed on earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zechariah son of Berechiah, whom you murdered between the temple and the altar. **36** Truly I tell you, all these things will come upon this generation. **37** O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the prophets and stones those sent to her, how often I have longed to gather your children together, as a hen gathers her chicks under her wings, but you were unwilling! **38** Look, your house is left to you desolate. **39** For I tell you that you will not see Me again until you say, 'Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord.'"

*English (WEB)*

**1** Then Jesus spoke to the multitudes and to his disciples, **2** saying, "The scribes and the Pharisees sit on Moses' seat. **3** All things therefore whatever they tell you to observe, observe and do, but don't do their works; for they say, and don't do. **4** For they bind heavy burdens that are grievous to be borne, and lay them on men's shoulders; but they themselves will not lift a finger to help them. **5** But they do all their works to be seen by men. They make their phylacteries broad and enlarge the fringes of their garments, **6** and love the place of honor at feasts, the best seats in the synagogues, **7** the salutations in the marketplaces, and to be called 'Rabbi, Rabbi' by men. **8** But you are not to be called 'Rabbi', for one is your teacher, the Christ, and all of you are brothers. **9** Call no man on the earth your father, for one is your Father, he who is in heaven. **10** Neither be called masters, for one is your master, the

Christ. **11** But he who is greatest among you will be your servant. **12** Whoever exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself will be exalted. **13** “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you devour widows’ houses, and as a pretense you make long prayers. Therefore you will receive greater condemnation. **14** “But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! Because you shut up the Kingdom of Heaven against men; for you don’t enter in yourselves, neither do you allow those who are entering in to enter. **15** Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you travel around by sea and land to make one proselyte; and when he becomes one, you make him twice as much a son of Gehenna as yourselves. **16** “Woe to you, you blind guides, who say, ‘Whoever swears by the temple, it is nothing; but whoever swears by the gold of the temple, he is obligated.’ **17** You blind fools! For which is greater, the gold or the temple that sanctifies the gold? **18** And, ‘Whoever swears by the altar, it is nothing; but whoever swears by the gift that is on it, he is obligated.’ **19** You blind fools! For which is greater, the gift, or the altar that sanctifies the gift? **20** He therefore who swears by the altar, swears by it and by everything on it. **21** He who swears by the temple, swears by it and by him who has been living in it. **22** He who swears by heaven, swears by the throne of God and by him who sits on it. **23** “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you tithe mint, dill, and cumin, and have left undone the weightier matters of the law: justice, mercy, and faith. But you ought to have done these, and not to have left the other undone. **24** You blind guides, who strain out a gnat, and swallow a camel! **25** “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you clean the outside of the cup and of the platter, but within they are full of extortion and unrighteousness. **26** You blind Pharisee, first clean the inside of the cup and of the platter, that its outside may become clean also. **27** “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you are like whitened tombs, which outwardly appear beautiful, but inwardly are full of dead men’s bones and of all uncleanness. **28** Even so you also outwardly appear righteous to men, but inwardly you are full of hypocrisy and iniquity. **29** “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! For you build the tombs of the prophets and decorate the tombs of the righteous, **30** and say, ‘If we had lived in the days of our fathers, we wouldn’t have been partakers with them in the blood of the prophets.’ **31** Therefore you testify to yourselves that you are children of those who killed the prophets. **32** Fill up, then, the measure of your fathers. **33** You serpents, you offspring of vipers, how will you escape the judgment of Gehenna? **34** Therefore, behold, I send to you prophets, wise men, and scribes. Some of them you will kill and crucify; and some of them you will scourge in your synagogues and persecute from city to city, **35** that on you may come all the righteous blood shed on the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of Zachariah son of Barachiah, whom you killed between the sanctuary and the altar. **36** Most certainly I tell you, all these things will come upon this generation. **37** “Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the prophets and stones those who are sent to her! How often I would have gathered your children together, even as a hen gathers her chicks under her

wings, and you would not! **38** Behold, your house is left to you desolate. **39** For I tell you, you will not see me from now on, until you say, ‘Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!’”

### Luke 6:24–26

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**24** πλὴν οὐαὶ ὑμῖν τοῖς πλουσίοις, ὅτι ἀπέχετε τὴν παράκλησιν ὑμῶν. **25** οὐαὶ ὑμῖν, οἱ ἐμπεπλησμένοι νῦν, ὅτι πεινάσετε. οὐαί, οἱ γελῶντες νῦν, ὅτι πενθήσετε καὶ κλαύσετε. **26** Οὐαὶ ὅταν καλῶς ὑμᾶς εἴπωσιν πάντες οἱ ἄνθρωποι, κατὰ τὰ αὐτὰ γὰρ ἐποίουν τοῖς ψευδοπροφήταις οἱ πατέρες αὐτῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**24** But woe to you who are rich, for you have already received your comfort. **25** Woe to you who are well fed now, for you will hunger. Woe to you who laugh now, for you will mourn and weep. **26** Woe to you when all men speak well of you, for their fathers treated the false prophets in the same way.

*English (WEB)*

**24** “But woe to you who are rich! For you have received your consolation. **25** Woe to you, you who are full now, for you will be hungry. Woe to you who laugh now, for you will mourn and weep. **26** Woe, when men speak well of you, for their fathers did the same thing to the false prophets.

### Acts 13:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἦσαν δὲ ἐν Ἀντιοχείᾳ κατὰ τὴν οὖσαν ἐκκλησίαν προφῆται καὶ διδάσκαλοι ὅ τε Βαρναβᾶς καὶ Συμεὼν ὁ καλούμενος Νίγερ, καὶ Λούκιος ὁ Κυρηναῖος, Μαναήν τε Ἡρῴδου τοῦ τετραάρχου σύντροφος καὶ Σαῦλος.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now in the church at Antioch there were prophets and teachers: Barnabas, Simeon called Niger, Lucius of Cyrene, Manaen (who had been brought up with Herod the tetrarch), and Saul.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now in the assembly that was at Antioch there were some prophets and teachers: Barnabas, Simeon who was called Niger, Lucius of Cyrene, Manaen the foster brother of Herod the tetrarch, and Saul.

### 1 Corinthians 9:3–18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** Ἡ ἐμὴ ἀπολογία τοῖς ἐμὲ ἀνακρίνουσίν ἐστιν αὕτη. **4** μὴ οὐκ ἔχομεν ἐξουσίαν φαγεῖν καὶ πεῖν; **5** μὴ οὐκ ἔχομεν ἐξουσίαν ἀδελφὴν γυναῖκα περιάγειν, ὡς καὶ οἱ λοιποὶ ἀπόστολοι καὶ οἱ ἀδελφοὶ τοῦ κυρίου καὶ Κηφᾶς; **6** ἢ μόνος ἐγὼ καὶ Βαρναβᾶς οὐκ ἔχομεν ἐξουσίαν μὴ ἐργάζεσθαι; **7** τίς στρατεύεται ἰδίοις ὀψωνίοις ποτέ; τίς φυτεύει ἀμπελῶνα καὶ τὸν καρπὸν αὐτοῦ οὐκ ἐσθίει; τίς ποιμαίνει ποίμνην καὶ ἐκ τοῦ γάλακτος τῆς ποίμνης οὐκ ἐσθίει; **8** Μὴ κατὰ ἄνθρωπον ταῦτα λαλῶ ἢ καὶ ὁ νόμος ταῦτα οὐ λέγει; **9** ἐν γὰρ τῷ Μωϋσέως νόμῳ γέγραπται· Οὐ κημώσεις βοῦν ἀλοῶντα. μὴ τῶν βοῶν μέλει τῷ θεῷ, **10** ἢ δι’ ἡμᾶς πάντως λέγει; δι’ ἡμᾶς γὰρ ἐγράφη, ὅτι ὀφείλει ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι ὁ ἀροτριῶν ἀροτριᾶν, καὶ ὁ ἀλοῶν ἐπ’ ἐλπίδι τοῦ μετέχειν. **11** εἰ ἡμεῖς ὑμῖν τὰ πνευματικὰ ἐσπείραμεν, μέγα εἰ ἡμεῖς ὑμῶν τὰ σαρκικὰ θερίσομεν; **12** εἰ ἄλλοι τῆς ὑμῶν ἐξουσίας μετέχουσιν, οὐ μᾶλλον ἡμεῖς; Ἀλλ’ οὐκ ἐχρησάμεθα τῇ ἐξουσίᾳ ταύτῃ, ἀλλὰ πάντα στέγομεν ἵνα μή τινα ἐγκοπὴν δῶμεν τῷ εὐαγγελίῳ τοῦ Χριστοῦ. **13** οὐκ οἴδατε ὅτι οἱ τὰ ἱερὰ ἐργαζόμενοι τὰ ἐκ τοῦ ἱεροῦ ἐσθίουσιν, οἱ τῷ θυσιαστηρίῳ παρεδρεύοντες τῷ θυσιαστηρίῳ συμμερίζονται; **14** οὕτως καὶ ὁ κύριος διέταξεν τοῖς τὸ εὐαγγέλιον καταγγέλλουσιν ἐκ τοῦ εὐαγγελίου ζῆν. **15** Ἐγὼ δὲ οὐ κέχρημαι οὐδενὶ τούτων. οὐκ ἔγραψα δὲ ταῦτα ἵνα οὕτως γένηται ἐν ἐμοί, καλὸν γάρ μοι μᾶλλον ἀποθανεῖν ἢ— τὸ καύχημά μου οὐδεὶς κενώσει. **16** ἐὰν γὰρ εὐαγγελίζωμαι, οὐκ ἔστιν μοι καύχημα, ἀνάγκη γάρ μοι ἐπίκειται· οὐαὶ γάρ μοί ἐστιν ἐὰν μὴ εὐαγγελίσωμαι. **17** εἰ γὰρ ἑκὼν τοῦτο πράσσω, μισθὸν ἔχω· εἰ δὲ ἄκων, οἰκονομίαν πεπίστευμαι. **18** τίς οὖν μού ἐστιν ὁ μισθός; ἵνα εὐαγγελιζόμενος ἀδάπανον θήσω τὸ εὐαγγέλιον, εἰς τὸ μὴ καταχρήσασθαι τῇ ἐξουσίᾳ μου ἐν τῷ εὐαγγελίῳ.

*English (BSB)*

**3** This is my defense to those who scrutinize me: **4** Have we no right to food and to drink? **5** Have we no right to take along a believing wife, as do the other apostles and the Lord’s brothers and Cephas? **6** Or are Barnabas and I the only apostles who must work for a living? **7** Who serves as a soldier at his own expense? Who plants a vineyard and does not eat of its fruit? Who tends a flock and does not drink of its milk? **8** Do I say this from a human perspective? Doesn’t the Law say the same thing? **9** For it is written in the Law of Moses: “Do not muzzle an ox while it is treading out the grain.” Is it about oxen that God is concerned? **10** Isn’t He actually speaking on our behalf? Indeed, this was written for us, because when the plowman plows and the thresher threshes, they should also expect to share in the harvest. **11** If we have sown spiritual seed among you, is it too much for us to reap a material harvest from you? **12** If others have this right to your support, shouldn’t we have it all the more? But we did not exercise this right. Instead, we put up with anything rather than hinder the gospel of Christ. **13** Do you not know that those who work in the temple eat of its food, and those who serve at the altar partake of its offerings? **14** In the same way, the Lord has prescribed that those who preach the gospel should receive their living from the gospel. **15** But I have not used any of these rights. And I am not writing this to suggest that something be done for me. Indeed, I would rather die than let anyone nullify my boast. **16** Yet when I preach the gospel, I have no reason to boast, because I am obligated to preach. Woe to me if I do not preach the gospel! **17** If my

preaching is voluntary, I have a reward. But if it is not voluntary, I am still entrusted with a responsibility. **18** What then is my reward? That in preaching the gospel I may offer it free of charge, and so not use up my rights in preaching it.

*English (WEB)*

**3** My defense to those who examine me is this: **4** Have we no right to eat and to drink? **5** Have we no right to take along a wife who is a believer, even as the rest of the apostles, and the brothers of the Lord, and Cephas? **6** Or have only Barnabas and I no right to not work? **7** What soldier ever serves at his own expense? Who plants a vineyard, and doesn't eat of its fruit? Or who feeds a flock, and doesn't drink from the flock's milk? **8** Do I speak these things according to the ways of men? Or doesn't the law also say the same thing? **9** For it is written in the law of Moses, "You shall not muzzle an ox while it treads out the grain." Is it for the oxen that God cares, **10** or does he say it assuredly for our sake? Yes, it was written for our sake, because he who plows ought to plow in hope, and he who threshes in hope should partake of his hope. **11** If we sowed to you spiritual things, is it a great thing if we reap your fleshly things? **12** If others partake of this right over you, don't we yet more? Nevertheless we didn't use this right, but we bear all things, that we may cause no hindrance to the Good News of Christ. **13** Don't you know that those who serve around sacred things eat from the things of the temple, and those who wait on the altar have their portion with the altar? **14** Even so the Lord ordained that those who proclaim the Good News should live from the Good News. **15** But I have used none of these things, and I don't write these things that it may be done so in my case; for I would rather die, than that anyone should make my boasting void. **16** For if I preach the Good News, I have nothing to boast about, for necessity is laid on me; but woe is to me if I don't preach the Good News. **17** For if I do this of my own will, I have a reward. But if not of my own will, I have a stewardship entrusted to me. **18** What then is my reward? That when I preach the Good News, I may present the Good News of Christ without charge, so as not to abuse my authority in the Good News.

## 1 Corinthians 10:10–11

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** μηδὲ γογγύζετε, καθάπερ τινὲς αὐτῶν ἐγόγγυσαν, καὶ ἀπώλοντο ὑπὸ τοῦ ὀλοθρευτοῦ. **11** ταῦτα δὲ τυπικῶς συνέβαινεν ἐκείνοις, ἐγράφη δὲ πρὸς νουθεσίαν ἡμῶν, εἰς οὓς τὰ τέλη τῶν αἰώνων κατήντηκεν.

*English (BSB)*

**10** And do not complain, as some of them did, and were killed by the destroying angel. **11** Now these things happened to them as examples and

were written down as warnings for us, on whom the fulfillment of the ages has come.

*English (WEB)*

**10** Don’t grumble, as some of them also grumbled, and perished by the destroyer. **11** Now all these things happened to them by way of example, and they were written for our admonition, on whom the ends of the ages have come.

### 1 Corinthians 12:28

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**28** καὶ οὓς μὲν ἔθετο ὁ θεὸς ἐν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ πρῶτον ἀποστόλους, δεύτερον προφήτας, τρίτον διδασκάλους, ἔπειτα δυνάμεις, ἔπειτα χαρίσματα ἰαμάτων, ἀντιλήμψεις, κυβερνήσεις, γένη γλωσσῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**28** And in the church God has appointed first of all apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then workers of miracles, and those with gifts of healing, helping, administration, and various tongues.

*English (WEB)*

**28** God has set some in the assembly: first apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then miracle workers, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, and various kinds of languages.

### Ephesians 4:11

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** καὶ αὐτὸς ἔδωκεν τοὺς μὲν ἀποστόλους, τοὺς δὲ προφήτας, τοὺς δὲ εὐαγγελιστάς, τοὺς δὲ ποιμένας καὶ διδασκάλους,

*English (BSB)*

**11** And it was He who gave some to be apostles, some to be prophets, some to be evangelists, and some to be pastors and teachers,

*English (WEB)*

**11** He gave some to be apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, shepherds and teachers;

### 1 Thessalonians 2:5–9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** οὔτε γάρ ποτε ἐν λόγῳ κολακείας ἐγενήθημεν, καθὼς οἴδατε, οὔτε ἐν προφάσει πλεονεξίας, θεὸς μάρτυς, **6** οὔτε ζητοῦντες ἐξ ἀνθρώπων δόξαν, οὔτε ἀφ᾽ ὑμῶν οὔτε ἀπ᾽ ἄλλων, **7** δυνάμενοι ἐν βάρει εἶναι ὡς Χριστοῦ ἀπόστολοι· ἀλλὰ ἐγενήθημεν ἤπιοι ἐν μέσῳ ὑμῶν, ὡς ἐὰν τροφὸς θάλπῃ τὰ ἑαυτῆς τέκνα· **8** οὕτως ὁμειρόμενοι ὑμῶν εὐδοκοῦμεν μεταδοῦναι ὑμῖν οὐ μόνον τὸ εὐαγγέλιον τοῦ θεοῦ ἀλλὰ καὶ τὰς ἑαυτῶν ψυχάς, διότι ἀγαπητοὶ ἡμῖν ἐγενήθητε. **9** Μνημονεύετε γάρ, ἀδελφοί, τὸν κόπον ἡμῶν καὶ τὸν μόχθον· νυκτὸς καὶ ἡμέρας ἐργαζόμενοι πρὸς τὸ μὴ ἐπιβαρῆσαί τινα ὑμῶν ἐκηρύξαμεν εἰς ὑμᾶς τὸ εὐαγγέλιον τοῦ θεοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**5** As you know, we never used words of flattery or any pretext for greed. God is our witness! **6** Nor did we seek praise from you or from anyone else, although as apostles of Christ we had authority to demand it. **7** On the contrary, we were gentle among you, like a nursing mother caring for her children. **8** We cared so deeply that we were delighted to share with you not only the gospel of God, but our own lives as well. That is how beloved you have become to us. **9** Surely you recall, brothers, our labor and toil. We worked night and day so that we would not be a burden to anyone while we proclaimed to you the gospel of God.

*English (WEB)*

**5** For neither were we at any time found using words of flattery, as you know, nor a cloak of covetousness (God is witness), **6** nor seeking glory from men (neither from you nor from others), when we might have claimed authority as apostles of Christ. **7** But we were gentle among you, like a nursing mother cherishes her own children. **8** Even so, affectionately longing for you, we were well pleased to impart to you not the Good News of God only, but also our own souls, because you had become very dear to us. **9** For you remember, brothers, our labor and travail; for working night and day, that we might not burden any of you, we preached to you the Good News of God.

## Hebrews 11:4

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** Πίστει πλείονα θυσίαν Ἄβελ παρὰ Κάϊν προσήνεγκεν τῷ θεῷ, δι᾽ ἧς ἐμαρτυρήθη εἶναι δίκαιος, μαρτυροῦντος ἐπὶ τοῖς δώροις αὐτοῦ τοῦ θεοῦ, καὶ δι᾽ αὐτῆς ἀποθανὼν ἔτι λαλεῖ.

*English (BSB)*

**4** By faith Abel offered God a better sacrifice than Cain did. By faith he was commended as righteous when God gave approval to his gifts. And by faith he still speaks, even though he is dead.

*English (WEB)*

**4** By faith Abel offered to God a more excellent sacrifice than Cain, through which he had testimony given to him that he was righteous, God testifying with respect to his gifts; and through it he, being dead, still speaks.

## 1 Peter 2:9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**9** Ὑμεῖς δὲ γένος ἐκλεκτόν, βασίλειον ἱεράτευμα, ἔθνος ἅγιον, λαὸς εἰς περιποίησιν, ὅπως τὰς ἀρετὰς ἐξαγγείλητε τοῦ ἐκ σκότους ὑμᾶς καλέσαντος εἰς τὸ θαυμαστὸν αὐτοῦ φῶς·

*English (BSB)*

**9** But you are a chosen people, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God’s own possession, to proclaim the virtues of Him who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light.

*English (WEB)*

**9** But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God’s own possession, that you may proclaim the excellence of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light.

## 2 Peter 2:15–16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** καταλιπόντες εὐθεῖαν ὁδὸν ἐπλανήθησαν, ἐξακολουθήσαντες τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ ὃς μισθὸν ἀδικίας ἠγάπησεν **16** ἔλεγξιν δὲ ἔσχεν ἰδίας παρανομίας· ὑποζύγιον ἄφωνον ἐν ἀνθρώπου φωνῇ φθεγξάμενον ἐκώλυσεν τὴν τοῦ προφήτου παραφρονίαν.

*English (BSB)*

**15** They have left the straight way and wandered off to follow the way of Balaam son of Beor, who loved the wages of wickedness. **16** But he was rebuked for his transgression by a donkey, otherwise without speech, that spoke with a man’s voice and restrained the prophet’s madness.

*English (WEB)*

**15** Forsaking the right way, they went astray, having followed the way of Balaam the son of Beor, who loved the wages of wrongdoing; **16** but he was rebuked for his own disobedience. A speechless donkey spoke with a man’s voice and stopped the madness of the prophet.

## 1 John 3:11–12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** Ὅτι αὕτη ἐστὶν ἡ ἀγγελία ἣν ἠκούσατε ἀπ᾽ ἀρχῆς, ἵνα ἀγαπῶμεν ἀλλήλους· **12** οὐ καθὼς Κάϊν ἐκ τοῦ πονηροῦ ἦν καὶ ἔσφαξεν τὸν ἀδελφὸν αὐτοῦ· καὶ χάριν τίνος ἔσφαξεν αὐτόν; ὅτι τὰ ἔργα αὐτοῦ πονηρὰ ἦν, τὰ δὲ τοῦ ἀδελφοῦ αὐτοῦ δίκαια.

*English (BSB)*

**11** This is the message you have heard from the beginning: We should love one another. **12** Do not be like Cain, who belonged to the evil one and murdered his brother. And why did Cain slay him? Because his own deeds were evil, while those of his brother were righteous.

*English (WEB)*

**11** For this is the message which you heard from the beginning, that we should love one another— **12** unlike Cain, who was of the evil one and killed his brother. Why did he kill him? Because his deeds were evil, and his brother's righteous.

## Revelation 2:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** ἀλλὰ ἔχω κατὰ σοῦ ὀλίγα, ὅτι ἔχεις ἐκεῖ κρατοῦντας τὴν διδαχὴν Βαλαάμ, ὃς ἐδίδασκεν τῷ Βαλὰκ βαλεῖν σκάνδαλον ἐνώπιον τῶν υἱῶν Ἰσραήλ, φαγεῖν εἰδωλόθυτα καὶ πορνεῦσαι·

*English (BSB)*

**14** But I have a few things against you, because some of you hold to the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak to place a stumbling block before the Israelites so they would eat food sacrificed to idols and commit sexual immorality.

*English (WEB)*

**14** But I have a few things against you, because you have there some who hold the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak to throw a stumbling block before the children of Israel, to eat things sacrificed to idols, and to commit sexual immorality.

## 1 Enoch 94:6–8

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**6** Woe to those who build unrighteousness and oppression And lay deceit as a foundation; For they shall be suddenly overthrown, And they shall have no peace. **7** Woe to those who build their houses with sin; For from all their foundations shall they be overthrown, And by the sword shall they fall. [And those who acquire gold and silver in judgement suddenly shall perish.] **8** Woe

to you, ye rich, for ye have trusted in your riches, And from your riches shall ye depart, Because ye have not remembered the Most High in the days of your riches.

# Chapter 6. Reefs at the Love Feast: Shepherds, Clouds, and Trees (Jude 12)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **12** οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἐν ταῖς ἀγάπαις ὑμῶν σπιλάδες συνευωχούμενοι, ἀφόβως ἑαυτοὺς ποιμαίνοντες, νεφέλαι ἄνυδροι ὑπὸ ἀνέμων παραφερόμεναι, δένδρα φθινοπωρινὰ ἄκαρπα δὶς ἀποθανόντα ἐκριζωθέντα,
>
> — Jude 12, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript's first hand, and $^{\text{corr}}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | ἀγάπαις | 'love feasts' | P72 א B Ψ K L 1739 |
| 12 | ἀπάταις | 'deceptions' | A C |
| 12 | οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἐν ταῖς … | 'these are the ones who … at your …' | P72 A B C Ψ L 1739 |
| 12 | οὗτοί εἰσιν ἐν ταῖς … | 'these are … at your … (without οἱ)' | K |
| 12 | the words of v. 16 (γογγυσταί … πορευόμενοι) also written here | the description of v. 16 repeated in v. 12 | א C$^{\text{corr}}$ |
| 12 | συνευωχούμενοι ὑμῖν | 'feasting with you' | C 1739 |

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | ὑπὸ ἀνέμων | ‘by winds’ | P72 A B C Ψ K L 1739 |
| 12 | παντὶ ἀνέμῳ | ‘by every wind’ | ℵ |

Notes. v. 12: not extant in P78.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

#### Jude 12

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | These are spottes which of youre kindnes feast to gedder with out feare fedynge them selves. Cloudes they are with outen water caried about of wyndes and trees with out frute at gadringe tyme twyse deed and plucked vp by the rotes. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | These are rockes in your feasts of charitie when they feast with you, without al feare, feeding themselues: cloudes they are without water, caried about of windes, corrupt trees and without fruit, twise dead, and plucked vp by ye rootes. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | These are spots in their banquets, feasting together without fear, feeding themselves, clouds without water, which are carried about by winds, trees of the autumn, unfruitful, twice dead, plucked up by the roots, |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | These are spots in your feasts of charity, when they feast with you, feeding themselves without fear: clouds they are without water, carried about by winds; withered autumnal trees, without fruit, twice dead, plucked out by the roots; |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | These are the rocks in your feasts of love, feasting together without fear, feeding only themselves; clouds without water, carried away by winds; trees in late autumn, without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots; |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | These are they who are hidden rocks in your love-feasts when they feast with you, shepherds that without fear feed themselves; clouds without water, carried along by winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots; |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | These are spots in your love-feasts, feasting together [with you] without fear, pasturing themselves; clouds without water, carried along by [the] winds; autumnal trees, without fruit, twice dead, rooted up; |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | These are in your love-feasts craggy rocks; feasting together with you, without fear shepherding themselves; clouds without water, by winds carried about; trees autumnal, without fruit, twice dead, rooted up; |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | These are they who are hidden rocks in your love-feasts when they feast with you, shepherds that without fear feed themselves; clouds without water, carried along by winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots; |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | These are hidden rocky reefs in your love feasts when they feast with you, shepherds who without fear feed themselves; clouds without water, carried along by winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots; |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Those teachers of false doctrine are as dangerous to you as [MET] ◄hidden rocks on a reef/rocks underneath the surface of the ocean► are to a boat. When you gather together to eat the meals that help you believers to love each other more and have a closer relationship with each other, they join you and carouse shamelessly, caring only for themselves and not for others. Because they do not do anything to help others [MET], they are as useless as clouds that are blown along by the wind {that the wind blows along} but that do not produce/give any rain. They are as disappointing as [MET] trees that do not produce fruit in the autumn as we expect them to. They are not only spiritually [MET] dead themselves, but they are not able to cause others to be alive spiritually, just like [MET] trees that have been {that someone |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | has} uprooted and as a result are unable to produce any fruit. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | These are the people who are blots on your ‘love-feasts,’ when they feast together and provide without scruple for themselves alone. They are clouds without rain, driven before the winds; they are leafless trees without a vestige of fruit, dead through and through, torn up by the roots; |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | These are the ones who are hidden reefs in your love feasts, when they feast with you shamelessly—shepherds who only feed themselves. They are clouds without rain, carried along by winds. They are autumn trees without fruit—twice dead, torn up by the roots. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | These people spoil your fellowship meals, for they are selfish shepherds that don’t have the slightest sense of shame—they only take care of themselves. They’re clouds blown along by the wind that bring no rain. They’re bare trees without fruit—twice dead, pulled out by the roots. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | These are stains at your love-feasts, feasting together with you without fear, shepherding themselves; waterless clouds, being carried away by winds; autumnal trees without fruit, having died twice, having been uprooted; |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | These men are hidden reefs in your love feasts, shamelessly feasting with you but shepherding only themselves. They are clouds without water, carried along by the wind; fruitless trees in autumn, twice dead after being uprooted. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | These men are hidden reefs in your love feasts, shamelessly feasting with you but shepherding only themselves. They are clouds without water, carried along by the wind; fruitless trees in autumn, twice dead after being uprooted. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | These men are hidden reefs at your love feasts, feasting among you without fear as shepherds feeding only themselves. They are clouds without water, carried along by winds; fruitless trees in late autumn, twice dead, pulled up by the roots. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

After the woe of v. 11, Jude turns to the intruders again with “These are…” and describes them in a cascade of images. This verse holds the first three; v. 13 adds two more.

1. At the community’s **love feasts**, its shared meals, the intruders are hidden dangers, like reefs beneath the surface (or, on another reading, stains on a garment). They eat with the community without reverence, and they care only for themselves, like shepherds who feed themselves instead of the flock.
2. They are **clouds without water**, promising rain that never comes, blown along by the wind.
3. They are **trees in late autumn**, the season of harvest, yet without fruit. They are dead twice over, pulled up by the roots.

Each image describes a gap between appearance and reality. The meal looks like fellowship but hides danger. The cloud looks like rain but delivers nothing. The tree looks like a fruit tree but bears no fruit and has no life. The intruders look like members, leaders, and teachers of the community, but they are empty and dangerous.

This chapter spends extra time on the first phrase, because the “love feast” opens a window onto the inner life of the earliest Christian communities.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### οὗτοί εἰσιν (*houtoi eisin*) — ‘these are’

Οὗτοί εἰσιν (*Houtoi eisin*), “These are,” introduces the second application in Jude’s pattern of text and interpretation. The woe of v. 11, with its three biblical types, is now applied to the intruders’ present behavior. The same formula opens vv. 16 and 19.

The Greek reads οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἐν ταῖς ἀγάπαις ὑμῶν σπιλάδες συνευωχούμενοι (*houtoi eisin hoi en tais agapais hymōn spilades syneuōchoumenoi*). The article οἱ (*hoi*) is masculine, while σπιλάδες (*spilades*) is feminine. The article therefore goes with the masculine participle “feasting together,” giving the sense “These are the ones who feast with you, [like] reefs at your love feasts.” The Byzantine text omits the article.[90]

90. SBLGNT apparatus: “οἱ WH Treg NIV ] – RP.” The article οἱ is masculine and cannot agree with the feminine σπιλάδες, so it goes with the participle συνευωχούμενοι. Abbott-Smith (s.v. σπιλάς) notes the question of gender in Jude 12 and refers to Mayor.↩

### οἱ ἐν ταῖς ἀγάπαις ὑμῶν σπιλάδες (*hoi en tais agapais hymōn spilades*) — ‘the hidden reefs (or stains) at your love feasts’

The two key words here, “stains” and “love-feasts,” are each explored in a deep dive below.

**σπιλάδες (*spilades*).** The LSV’s “stains” follows one ancient understanding of the word. The more common meaning in Greek literature is “reefs” or “rocks in the sea,” and most modern translations adopt that sense (BSB: “hidden reefs”; WEB: “hidden rocky reefs”; ASV: “hidden rocks”). Webster, following the older English Bibles, has “spots” (WBS). See the deep dive “Hidden reefs versus stains.”

**ἀγάπαις (*agapais*).** The plural of ἀγάπη (*agapē*), “love,” here means “love feasts,” the community’s shared meals. This is the earliest surviving use of the word in this sense.[91] See the deep dive “Agape and the ancient Christian love feast.”

The pronoun “your” (ὑμῶν, *hymōn*) matters. The love feasts belong to the readers. The intruders are guests at a table that is not theirs, though they behave as if it were.

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91. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀγάπη: “In pl., love feasts: Ju 12.”↩

### συνευωχούμενοι ἀφόβως (*syneuōchoumenoi aphobōs*) — ‘feasting with you without reverence’

The participle συνευωχούμενοι (*syneuōchoumenoi*), “feasting together,” comes from a verb meaning “to entertain sumptuously, to feast,” with a prefix meaning “with.” It occurs in the New Testament only here and in the parallel at 2 Pet 2:13.[92] The word does not in itself imply excess, but it suggests a festive, abundant meal.

The adverb ἀφόβως (*aphobōs*), “without fear,” can be read with what precedes (“feasting with you without fear”) or with what follows (“without fear shepherding themselves”). Either way, it describes an absence of reverence. Elsewhere in the New Testament the word can be positive, meaning “without fear” of human threats (Luke 1:74; Phil 1:14). Here it is negative. The intruders have no fear of God. They eat at the Lord’s table as if nothing sacred were happening and no judgment were possible. Paul had warned the Corinthians that eating the Lord’s meal in an unworthy manner brings judgment (1 Cor 11:27–34).

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92. Computed from MorphGNT/SBLGNT: συνευωχέομαι occurs only at Jude 12 and 2 Pet 2:13. Abbott-Smith has no separate entry under the deponent form; see s.v. συνευωχέω.↩

### ἑαυτοὺς ποιμαίνοντες (*heautous poimainontes*) — ‘shepherding themselves’

The phrase ἑαυτοὺς ποιμαίνοντες (*heautous poimainontes*), “shepherding themselves” or “feeding themselves,” alludes to Ezekiel’s indictment of Israel’s leaders: “Woe [to] the shepherds of Israel, / Who have been feeding themselves! Do the shepherds not feed the flock? You eat the fat, and you put on the wool, / You slaughter the fed one, / You do not feed the flock” (Ezek 34:2–3, LSV). The Septuagint’s wording is close to Jude’s: “the shepherds fed themselves” (ἐβόσκησαν οἱ ποιμένες ἑαυτούς, *eboskēsan hoi poimenes heautous*, Ezek 34:8).[93]

The image implies that the intruders held, or claimed, positions of leadership, as teachers or as hosts at the meals. Instead of using their position to nourish others, they used it to nourish themselves. At a meal where food is literally shared, the image is also concrete. See the deep dive “Shepherding as a biblical metaphor.”

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93. LXX Ezek 34:8, Brenton’s Greek Septuagint. LXX Ezek 34:2 reads μὴ βόσκουσι ποιμένες ἑαυτούς; (“Do shepherds feed themselves?”).↩

### νεφέλαι ἄνυδροι ὑπὸ ἀνέμων παραφερόμεναι (*nephelai anydroi hypo anemōn parapheromenai*) — ‘waterless clouds carried along by winds’

The second image moves from the community’s table to the sky. νεφέλαι ἄνυδροι (*nephelai anydroi*), “clouds without water,” and ὑπὸ ἀνέμων παραφερόμεναι (*hypo anemōn parapheromenai*), “carried along by winds.” The verb παραφέρω (*parapherō*) means “to carry aside, carry away.” Hebrews uses it in a warning: “Do not be carried away with strange and manifold teachings” (Heb 13:9, LSV).[94]

The image recalls Proverbs: “Clouds and wind without rain, / [Is] a man boasting himself in a false gift” (Prov 25:14, LSV). It describes people who promise much and deliver nothing. See the deep dive “Clouds without water.”

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94. Abbott-Smith, s.v. παραφέρω: “to take or carry away … pass., seq. ὑπό, Ju 12; metaph., pass., c. dat., He 13:9.”↩

### δένδρα φθινοπωρινὰ ἄκαρπα (*dendra phthinopōrina akarpa*) — ‘fruitless trees in late autumn’

The third image is δένδρα φθινοπωρινὰ ἄκαρπα (*dendra phthinopōrina akarpa*), “late-autumn trees without fruit.” The adjective φθινοπωρινός (*phthinopōrinos*), unique to Jude in the New Testament, derives from

φθινόπωρον (*phthinopōron*), “late autumn,” the end of the harvest season.[95] A tree that has no fruit at harvest time is a failure. Jesus’ cursing of the fig tree comes to mind: “He came to it, and found nothing in it except leaves only” (Matt 21:19, LSV). See the deep dive “Trees twice dead and uprooted.”

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95. Abbott-Smith, s.v. φθινοπωρινός: “(< φθινόπωρον, late autumn), autumnal.”↩

### δὶς ἀποθανόντα ἐκριζωθέντα (*dis apothanonta ekrizōthenta*) — ‘twice dead, uprooted’

The trees are δὶς ἀποθανόντα (*dis apothanonta*), “twice dead,” and ἐκριζωθέντα (*ekrizōthenta*), “uprooted.” A fruitless tree might be thought merely dormant. These trees are dead, and dead beyond any hope of revival, because their roots have been torn out of the ground. “Twice dead” may mean (a) dead in two senses, fruitless and uprooted; (b) dead now and destined for the “second death” of final judgment (Rev 2:11; 20:14); or (c) as Clement of Alexandria suggested, “once … when they sinned by transgressing, and a second time when delivered up to punishment.”[96] Jesus’ saying lies close by: “Every plant that My heavenly Father did not plant will be rooted up” (Matt 15:13, LSV), using the same verb.

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96. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 12, ANF 2.↩

### Deep dive: Agape and the ancient Christian love feast

What exactly was a love feast? This is one of the questions Jude raises most sharply for modern readers, and the evidence allows a fairly full answer, provided we distinguish carefully between what is documented, what is probable, and what belongs to later centuries.

#### 1. Meals at the heart of early Christian life

From the beginning, Christian communities gathered around tables. Luke describes the Jerusalem believers “continuing steadfastly in the teaching of the apostles, and the fellowship, and the breaking of the bread, and the prayers” and “breaking bread at every house, they were partaking of food in gladness and simplicity of heart” (Acts 2:42, 46, LSV). At Troas, “on the first [day] of the weeks, the disciples having been gathered together to break bread,” Paul taught until midnight, and later, “having broken bread, and having tasted,” he continued talking “until daylight” (Acts 20:7, 11, LSV).

Christians met in homes, and the main gathering included a real meal. That was natural in the ancient world. Jewish households marked Sabbaths and festivals with meals, Jesus’ ministry was remembered as a ministry of meals (Mark 2:15–17; Luke 15:1–2), and his last supper with his disciples took place

at a meal. Greek and Roman social life also revolved around the communal dinner (*deipnon* in Greek, *cena* in Latin), whether in a household, a trade guild, a religious society, or a funeral association.

### 2. The Lord's Supper within a meal (1 Corinthians 11)

Our earliest detailed evidence comes from Paul's first letter to Corinth, written in the mid-50s. The Corinthian Christians gathered for what Paul calls "the LORD's Dinner" (κυριακὸν δεῖπνον, *kyriakon deipnon*, 1 Cor 11:20, LSV). It was clearly a full meal, because Paul complains that "each takes his own dinner before in the eating, and one is hungry, and another is drunk" (11:21, LSV). Wealthier members, apparently arriving early or eating separately, consumed their own food while poorer members, perhaps slaves or laborers who arrived late, went hungry. Paul is indignant: "do you despise the Assembly of God, and shame those not having?" (11:22, LSV).

Within this meal, the bread and cup were shared in remembrance of Jesus, and Paul recalls the words of institution (11:23–26). His remedy is not to abolish the meal but to reform it: "so then, my brothers, coming together to eat, wait for one another; and if anyone is hungry, let him eat at home, that you may not come together to judgment" (11:33–34, LSV).

Paul does not call the Corinthian meal an "agape." The situation he describes is the kind of setting in which the word arose: a shared community meal, including the Lord's Supper, meant to express the unity of the body ("we all partake of the one bread," 1 Cor 10:17, LSV), and liable to be spoiled by selfishness and division.

The Corinthian problem has a well-documented cultural background. Roman dinners often reflected social hierarchy, with better food and seating for the honored and worse for the rest. Pliny the Younger describes with disgust a dinner at which the host served "choice dishes to himself and a few, cheap and scraps to the rest," and divided the wine into three grades, one for himself and his guests of rank, one for "lesser friends," and one for freedmen. Pliny himself says he serves everyone alike, "for I invite them to dinner, not to be graded."[97] The Corinthian church seems to have absorbed such customs, and Paul insisted that the Lord's table must not mirror the world's rankings.

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97. Pliny the Younger, *Letters* 2.6.2–3 (Latin text from The Latin Library, https://www.thelatinlibrary.com/pliny.ep2.html): *sibi et paucis opima quaedam, ceteris vilia et minuta ponebat … ad cenam enim, non ad notam invito.* Translation mine.↩

### 3. "Your love-feasts" (Jude 12)

Jude is the first writer known to call these community meals ἀγάπαι (*agapai*), "loves," meaning "love feasts." He does so casually, as if the term were already

familiar to his readers. The name expressed the meal's meaning: it was a practical enactment of the love that bound believers together, rich and poor, Jew and Gentile, at one table.

The parallel in 2 Pet 2:13 shows how the term was understood and transmitted. The best-attested text of 2 Peter reads ἐν ταῖς ἀπάταις αὐτῶν (*en tais apatais autōn*), "in their deceits," and the LSV translates "reveling in their deceits, feasting with you." Some manuscripts read ἀγάπαις, "love feasts," as in Jude.[98] The two Greek words differ by only two letters (ΑΓΑΠΑΙΣ, ΑΠΑΤΑΙΣ), and the variant shows that early scribes connected the passages.

What did a love feast include? Jude does not describe one, but from the New Testament evidence and the sources that follow we can infer that it probably included a shared meal, prayers of thanksgiving, the Lord's Supper (at least in Jude's period), teaching and exhortation, and perhaps singing. It was the occasion at which traveling teachers would be welcomed and heard. That explains why the presence of the intruders at the love feasts was so dangerous: the meal was the setting for teaching as well as fellowship.

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98. SBLGNT apparatus for 2 Pet 2:13: "ἀπάταις WH NIV RP ] ἀγάπαις Treg." ↩

### 4. Second-century evidence

Several sources from the generations after Jude fill out the picture. They come from different regions and should not be blended into a single description, but together they show the love feast as an established Christian institution.

- **Ignatius of Antioch** (c. 110), writing to the church at Smyrna, says: "It is not lawful without the bishop either to baptize or to celebrate a love-feast" (ἀγάπην ποιεῖν, *agapēn poiein*).[99] This is the earliest use of the term after Jude, and it shows the agape as a recognized church gathering under the oversight of leaders. In the same passage, Ignatius speaks of the Eucharist separately, so it is unclear whether he regarded the two as one event or as distinct.
- **The *Didache*** (late first or early second century) gives eucharistic prayers for the cup and the bread and then a thanksgiving to be said "after you are filled."[100] That suggests a real meal surrounding the prayers. It also warns that "every prophet who orders a meal in the Spirit eats not from it, except indeed he be a false prophet,"[101] a striking parallel to Jude's intruders feasting at the community's table.
- **Pliny the Younger** (c. 112), Roman governor of Bithynia, reported to the emperor Trajan what he had learned from former Christians under interrogation. They said they used to meet on a fixed day before dawn, sing a hymn "to Christ as to a god," and bind themselves by oath not to commit crimes. "When this was done, it was their custom to depart and to

assemble again to take food—ordinary, however, and harmless food." They had stopped doing even this after Pliny's edict banning associations (*hetaeriae*).[102] Pliny's "ordinary and harmless" answers popular rumors that Christian meals involved cannibalism or immorality. His account is the earliest non-Christian description of a Christian meal, and it shows two separate gatherings: worship at dawn and a meal later in the day.

- **Tertullian** (c. 197), defending Christianity to Roman officials, describes the love feast in detail: "Our feast explains itself by its name. The Greeks call it agapè, i.e., affection." Its cost is gain, "since with the good things of the feast we benefit the needy." "The participants, before reclining, taste first of prayer to God. As much is eaten as satisfies the cravings of hunger; as much is drunk as befits the chaste." After washing and lighting the lamps, "each is asked to stand forth and sing, as he can, a hymn to God." "As the feast commenced with prayer, so with prayer it is closed."[103] Tertullian presents the agape as a charitable, orderly meal in which the poor were fed.
- **Clement of Alexandria** (c. 200) complains about people who "dare to apply the name agape, to pitiful suppers, redolent of savour and sauces," and insists that "the supper is made for love, but the supper is not love (agape); only a proof of mutual and reciprocal kindly feeling."[104] The problem Jude addressed, the love feast corrupted by self-indulgence, was still alive more than a century later.

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99. Ignatius, *To the Smyrnaeans* 8.2, ANF 1 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0109.htm).↩

100. *Didache* 10.1, ANF 7 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0714.htm).↩

101. *Didache* 11.9, ANF 7.↩

102. Pliny the Younger, *Letters* 10.96.7 (Latin text from The Latin Library, https://www.thelatinlibrary.com/pliny.ep10.html): *quibus peractis morem sibi discedendi fuisse rursusque coeundi ad capiendum cibum, promiscuum tamen et innoxium; quod ipsum facere desisse post edictum meum, quo secundum mandata tua hetaerias esse vetueram.* Translation mine.↩

103. Tertullian, *Apology* 39, ANF 3 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0301.htm).↩

104. Clement of Alexandria, *Paedagogus* 2.1, ANF 2 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/02092.htm).↩

### 5. What we can and cannot say

**Documented:** Early Christians gathered for shared meals. In Corinth in the 50s, the Lord's Supper was celebrated within such a meal. By the time of Jude, at least some communities called these meals "love feasts." In the second century, the love feast was an established practice, associated with prayer, charity to the poor, and the oversight of church leaders.

**Probable:** In Jude's time, the love feast and the Lord's Supper were not yet clearly separated, and the bread and cup were shared in the context of the meal. The love feast was an occasion for teaching and for receiving visitors.

**Later development:** Over the following centuries, the Eucharist and the agape gradually separated in most churches. The Eucharist became a liturgical rite, often celebrated in the morning, and the agape survived for a time as a charitable meal before largely disappearing or being restricted. Some modern Christian groups have revived love feasts in various forms, among them Moravians, Methodists, Church of the Brethren and related Brethren communities, and others. Those revivals are modern practices and should not be read back into Jude.

**Speculative and to be avoided:** Detailed reconstructions of a fixed "order of service" for first-century love feasts, or claims that every church observed them in the same way, go beyond the evidence.

### 6. Why the love feast mattered to Jude

The love feast was where the community's life was most visible: rich and poor eating together, believers giving thanks together, the body of Christ made concrete around a table. For intruders to "feast" there "without fear" while "shepherding themselves" was a profound violation. They turned the table of love into an occasion for self-indulgence. Because the meal was also the setting for teaching, they turned it into a platform for their influence. That is why Jude's image for them at the love feast is so stark. They are not merely blemishes but hidden reefs on which the community might founder.

## Deep dive: Hidden reefs versus stains

The word σπιλάδες (*spilades*) has two possible senses, and the choice affects the image.

**"Reefs" or "hidden rocks."** In Greek literature, σπιλάς (*spilas*) normally means "a rock or reef over which the sea dashes." It is used in this sense by the poets, by the historian Polybius, and by Josephus.[105] Sailors dreaded such rocks because they lay just below the surface, invisible in calm water and fatal to an unwary ship. Most modern translations adopt this sense (BSB: "hidden reefs"; WEB and ASV: "hidden rocks").

**"Stains" or "spots."** In later Greek, σπιλάς was sometimes used as an equivalent of σπίλος (*spilos*), "a spot, stain."[106] The parallel in 2 Pet 2:13 has σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι (*spiloi kai mōmoi*), "spots and blemishes" (LSV), and the same word family appears in Jude 23 ("the coat having been stained," ἐσπιλωμένον, *espilōmenon*). Webster ("spots," WBS) and the LSV ("stains") follow this sense.

**Weighing the options.**

- In favor of “reefs”: it is the established meaning of σπιλάς. It fits the danger Jude describes, a hidden hazard that can wreck the community. It also prepares for the sea imagery of v. 13 (“wild waves of a sea”). Paul uses a related image when he speaks of those who “made shipwreck concerning the faith” (1 Tim 1:19, LSV).
- In favor of “stains”: it matches 2 Peter’s interpretation, which may be the earliest commentary on Jude, and the stained garment of v. 23. Abbott-Smith’s lexicon notes that the stain sense is attested in late writers and cites J. B. Mayor’s discussion.
- A third possibility: Jude may intend a deliberate double meaning, playing on the sound of σπιλάς and σπίλος. In that case the intruders are both hidden reefs and stains.

On balance, “hidden reefs” is the more probable primary sense, and this book follows it. The LSV’s “stains” is a defensible rendering with ancient support, and readers of the LSV should be aware of the alternative. Either way, the point is that the intruders’ presence at the love feasts is not harmless. Whether as unseen hazards or as defiling blemishes, they endanger the community’s life.

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105. Abbott-Smith, s.v. σπιλάς: “poët. in cl., a rock or reef over which the sea dashes (Polyb., FlJ, al.).” (“FlJ” is Abbott-Smith’s abbreviation for Flavius Josephus.)↩

106. Abbott-Smith, s.v. σπιλάς: “In late writers = σπίλος (q.v.), a spot, stain; metaph., Ju, l.c., R, mg. (cf. Mayor, 41…).” See also s.v. σπίλος.↩

### Deep dive: Shepherding as a biblical metaphor

In the ancient Near East, kings and gods were often called shepherds of their people. Israel’s scriptures take up the image. The LORD is the shepherd of Israel (Ps 23; 80:1), and its leaders are under-shepherds, accountable to him. Moses and David were shepherds before they were leaders.

Ezekiel 34 is the classic indictment of bad shepherds. They feed themselves rather than the flock, take the wool and the fat, fail to strengthen the weak, heal the sick, or seek the lost, and have “ruled them with might and with rigor” (Ezek 34:4, LSV). The result is a scattered flock, prey to wild beasts. God’s response is to promise that he himself will shepherd his sheep, and that he will set over them “one shepherd,” “My servant David” (Ezek 34:23).

The New Testament sees that promise fulfilled in Jesus: “I AM the good shepherd; the good shepherd lays His life down for the sheep” (John 10:11, LSV). Jesus contrasts himself with “the hired worker,” who flees when the wolf comes “because he is a hired worker, and is not caring for the sheep” (John 10:12–13, LSV). The apostles applied the image to church leaders. Peter says,

“feed the flock of God that [is] among you, overseeing not by compulsion, but willingly, neither for shameful gain, but eagerly, neither as exercising lordship over the heritages, but becoming patterns for the flock” (1 Pet 5:2–3, LSV). Paul tells the Ephesian elders to “feed the Assembly of God” and warns that “there will enter in, after my departing, grievous wolves to you, not sparing the flock” (Acts 20:28–29, LSV).

Jude’s phrase “shepherding themselves” places the intruders in the line of Ezekiel’s false shepherds and Jesus’ hired hands. They exercise leadership, but for their own benefit. At the love feast, where the shepherd’s role was literally to see that all were fed, their self-feeding was both a spiritual failure and a visible one.

### Deep dive: Clouds without water

In the land of Israel, life depended on the rains. The rainy season ran from about October to April, with the “early rain” in autumn softening the ground for plowing and sowing and the “latter rain” in spring bringing the crops to maturity. Joel promised: “He … causes a shower to come down to you, / Early rain and spring rain [as] in the beginning” (Joel 2:23, LSV). Rain clouds came from the west, off the Mediterranean. Jesus remarked, “When you may see the cloud rising from the west, immediately you say, A shower comes, and it is so” (Luke 12:54, LSV). Elijah’s servant saw “a little thickness as the palm of a man … coming up out of the sea,” and soon “the heavens have become black—thick clouds and wind—and the shower is great” (1 Kgs 18:44–45, LSV).

A cloud that rolled in from the sea, darkened the sky, raised the farmer’s hopes, and then drifted past without dropping rain was a bitter disappointment. Proverbs uses exactly this image for the empty promiser: “Clouds and wind without rain, / [Is] a man boasting himself in a false gift” (Prov 25:14, LSV). Hosea uses a related image for Israel’s fleeting loyalty: “Your goodness [is] as a cloud of the morning, / And as dew rising early—going” (Hos 6:4, LSV).

Jude’s “waterless clouds, being carried away by winds” combines the two ideas of empty promise and instability. The intruders promise spiritual refreshment, perhaps through their claimed revelations, but provide none. They are also driven by every wind. Ephesians speaks of believers who are “carried around by every wind of the teaching” (Eph 4:14, LSV). The intruders are not merely victims of such winds. They are clouds moved by them, with nothing of their own to give.

There may also be an echo of 1 Enoch, where the obedience of nature contrasts with the disobedience of sinners, and where in the days of sinners “the rain shall be kept back / And the heaven shall withhold (it)” (1 Enoch 80:2, trans. Charles).[107] That connection is explored in Chapter 7.

107. 1 Enoch 80:2, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.↩

### Deep dive: Trees twice dead and uprooted

The fruit tree is one of Scripture's favorite images for a life before God. The righteous person "has been as a tree, / Planted by streams of water, / That gives its fruit in its season" (Ps 1:3, LSV). John the Baptist warned that "every tree not bearing good fruit is cut down, and is cast into fire" (Matt 3:10, LSV), and Jesus taught that "every good tree yields good fruits, but the bad tree yields evil fruits" (Matt 7:17, LSV). In his parable of the fig tree, the owner says, "three years I come seeking fruit in this fig tree, and do not find [it], cut it off" (Luke 13:7, LSV).

Jude's description is cumulative, and each term deepens the judgment:

1. **"Autumnal"** (φθινοπωρινά). The trees are seen in late autumn, at the end of the harvest season, when fruit is expected. Abbott-Smith explains the phrase as "autumn trees (said to be without fruit therefore at a time when fruit might be expected)," and refers to J. B. Mayor's "elaborate note" on the word.[108] Some interpreters think instead of trees in late autumn after the fruit is gone and the leaves have fallen, bare and lifeless-looking. The first sense fits the next word better.
2. **"Without fruit"** (ἄκαρπα). At the very season of fruit, they have none. The intruders bear no fruit of the Spirit (cf. v. 19, "not having the Spirit").
3. **"Having died twice"** (δὶς ἀποθανόντα). A fruitless tree may still be alive. These are dead, and "twice" dead. The phrase may mean dead in two ways, barren and rootless; dead now and destined for the "second death" (Rev 20:14); or, as Clement read it, dead first in sin and then in judgment. The language of a "second death" was current in Jewish as well as Christian circles, and the allusion may be intended.
4. **"Having been uprooted"** (ἐκριζωθέντα). The final image is of trees torn up by the roots, beyond any hope of recovery. "Every plant that My heavenly Father did not plant will be rooted up" (Matt 15:13, LSV); "God breaks you down forever, / … And He has uprooted you / Out of the land of the living" (Ps 52:5, LSV).

The sequence moves from disappointment to death to destruction. Like the cloud, the tree holds out a promise that it cannot keep. Unlike the cloud, which drifts on, the tree's end is fixed: uprooted.

108. Abbott-Smith, s.v. φθινοπωρινός, referring to J. B. Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude and the Second Epistle of St. Peter* (London: Macmillan, 1907), 55–59.↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| σπιλάς | *spilas* | reef, rock in the sea; (late) stain | “stains” (LSV) / “hidden reefs” | NT hapax; see deep dive. |
| ἀγάπη (pl.) | *agapai* | love feasts | “love-feasts” | First attested use for the meal. |
| συνευωχέομαι | *syneuōcheomai* | feast together | “feasting together with you” | Only here and 2 Pet 2:13. |
| ἀφόβως | *aphobōs* | without fear | “without fear” | Here: without reverence. |
| ποιμαίνω | *poimainō* | shepherd, tend, feed | “shepherding” | Cf. LXX Ezek 34:8 (βόσκω). |
| νεφέλη | *nephelē* | cloud | “clouds” | |
| ἄνυδρος | *anydros* | waterless | “waterless” | 2 Pet 2:17 has “wells without water.” |
| παραφέρω | *parapherō* | carry away, carry aside | “being carried away” | Heb 13:9: “Do not be carried away.” Byzantine variant περιφερόμεναι, “carried around.” |
| φθινοπωρινός | *phthinopōrinos* | of late autumn | “autumnal” | NT hapax. |
| ἄκαρπος | *akarpos* | fruitless | “without fruit” | |
| δίς | *dis* | twice | “twice” | |
| ἀποθνῄσκω | *apothnēskō* | die | “having died” | |
| ἐκριζόω | *ekrizoō* | uproot | “having been uprooted” | Matt 15:13; Luke 17:6. |

**A caution on “agape.”** Because the meal was called “agape,” some teachers have treated the love feast as proof that the early church understood *agapē* as a technical term for a uniquely Christian kind of love. The word’s use for the meal shows how central love was to Christian identity. It does not show that the word *agapē* by itself carried a special meaning. Its significance came from the love of God in Christ that the meal celebrated.

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Banquets and associations.** In the Greco-Roman world, voluntary associations (trade guilds, religious societies, burial clubs) met regularly for common meals, often with rules about seating, contributions, and behavior.

Roman authorities were sometimes suspicious of such associations as potential centers of political unrest. Pliny's ban on *hetaeriae* in Bithynia, which led Christians there to stop their common meal, shows that Christian meals could be seen as one more association's dinner.[109] Within this culture, Christian love feasts stood out because they brought together people of different classes and backgrounds and because they fed the poor.

**Hospitality to traveling teachers.** As noted in Chapter 2, early Christian communities welcomed traveling apostles and prophets, who would naturally be invited to the community's meals. The *Didache*'s warning about prophets who order meals "in the Spirit" and eat from them suggests that some visitors exploited this hospitality.[110]

**The agricultural year.** Jude's readers lived close to the land. Hegesippus's account of Jude's grandsons as farmers suggests that Jude's own family did too. Images of clouds and rain, fruit trees and harvest, were part of daily experience, and the failure of either meant hardship.

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109. Pliny, *Letters* 10.96.7 (see n. 13).↩

110. *Didache* 11.9, ANF 7.↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Ezekiel 34 (allusion).** "Shepherding themselves" closely echoes Ezek 34:2, 8. This is probably a deliberate allusion.

**Proverbs 25:14 (probable allusion).** "Clouds and wind without rain" is the nearest Old Testament parallel to Jude's waterless clouds, and the shared context of empty boasting strengthens the connection. As noted in the Introduction, the Septuagint version of this proverb differs from the Hebrew, so Jude's image matches the Hebrew more closely.

**Matthew 15:13; Luke 13:6–9; Matthew 21:19 (shared imagery).** Jesus' sayings about uprooted plants and fruitless trees share Jude's imagery and moral logic.

**1 Corinthians 11:17–34 (background).** Paul's correction of the Corinthian meal is the best evidence for the setting in which love feasts were abused.

**2 Peter 2:13, 17 (literary parallel).** Peter has "spots and blemishes, reveling in their deceits, feasting with you" and "wells without water, and clouds driven by a storm" (LSV). His version supports the "stains" interpretation of σπιλάδες and shows that the cloud image was a fixed part of the tradition.

**John 10:11–13; 1 Peter 5:2–3; Acts 20:28–29 (shared theme).** These texts give the positive model of shepherding against which Jude's intruders are measured.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. "Reefs" or "stains"?** Discussed in the deep dive. Most modern scholars favor "reefs," while noting the support for "stains" in 2 Peter and in later Greek usage.

**2. Were the love feast and the Lord's Supper the same event in Jude's day?** Probably they were not yet separated, but the evidence is indirect. In 1 Corinthians the Lord's Supper occurs within a meal. In Ignatius and the *Didache*, the relationship is ambiguous. In Pliny, the meal appears to be separate from the dawn worship. Practices likely varied between regions and changed over time. Christian traditions today differ in how they understand the relationship of meal, fellowship, and sacrament, and readers may bring those differences to this verse. Jude's own concern is the conduct of people at the community's table.

**3. Were the intruders leaders?** "Shepherding themselves" suggests that they held or claimed some leadership role. They may have been traveling teachers, local leaders who had adopted their teaching, or hosts in whose homes the meals took place. Jude does not specify.

**4. What does "twice dead" mean?** See the deep dive. The options are not mutually exclusive.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verse 12 begins the longest application in the letter (vv. 12–13), which interprets the woe of v. 11 in five images. The images move through the natural world: the sea (reefs), the sky (clouds), the earth (trees), and in v. 13 the sea again (waves) and the heavens (stars). As Chapter 7 will show, this sweep through creation probably reflects 1 Enoch's contrast between the obedience of nature and the disobedience of sinners.

The love feast is the most concrete detail in Jude's description of the intruders. It shows that they were not distant heretics but people sitting at the same table as the readers, which makes Jude's later call to mercy and rescue (vv. 22–23) all the more pointed. The danger is not "out there," and neither are the people who need rescue.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**The table as a test of community.** For the early Christians, the shared meal was where love was enacted or betrayed. Communities today might ask what their tables, whether in the Lord's Supper, fellowship meals, or hospitality, reveal about their love. Do they mirror the world's rankings, as at Corinth, or overcome them? Who is fed, and who goes hungry?

**Leadership that feeds others.** Jude's charge, "shepherding themselves," remains a searching test for anyone with influence. Leaders can ask whether their position mainly serves others or serves themselves, and communities can ask whether their structures reward self-serving leadership.

**Promises and fruit.** The waterless clouds and fruitless trees invite reflection on the difference between appearance and substance, between impressive promises and actual fruit. Jesus' teaching that a tree is known by its fruit (Matt 7:16–20) gives believers a way to evaluate teachers and movements, and themselves.

**Hidden dangers in familiar places.** Hidden reefs are dangerous because they are unseen in calm water. Communities may need to recognize that the gravest dangers often arise within, at the very places where trust is greatest. This awareness should lead to wisdom and care, not paranoia.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. What did you know about "love feasts" before reading this chapter? What surprised you most about the early Christian practice of shared meals?
2. Paul, Jude, and Clement of Alexandria all address abuses of the community meal. Why do you think shared meals are so vulnerable to selfishness and division? Where do you see similar dynamics today?
3. Does the image of "hidden reefs" or of "stains" seem more fitting to you? How does each image shape your understanding of the danger Jude describes?
4. Jude's images of clouds without rain and trees without fruit describe a gap between promise and delivery. Where do you see this gap in religious life today, and how can it be recognized?
5. If the love feast was where Christian love became visible, what practices in your community serve a similar purpose? How could they be strengthened?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org);

section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT and apparatus; 2 Pet 2:13 apparatus; Robinson–Pierpont; TR.
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. σπιλάς, σπίλος, σπιλόω, ἀγάπη, φθινοπωρινός, ἄκαρπος, ἄνυδρος, παραφέρω, ἐκριζόω, ἀφόβως.
- Ignatius, *To the Smyrnaeans* 8.2 (ANF 1); *Didache* 9–11 (ANF 7); Pliny the Younger, *Letters* 10.96.7 and 2.6 (Latin text, The Latin Library; translations mine); Tertullian, *Apology* 39 (ANF 3); Clement of Alexandria, *Paedagogus* 2.1 (ANF 2); Clement, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 12.
- LXX Ezek 34:8 (Brenton's Greek Septuagint).
- 1 Enoch 80:2, trans. R. H. Charles (1917).
- Mayor, *The Epistle of St. Jude*, on v. 12 (cited via Abbott-Smith).

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### 1 Kings 18:44–45

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**44** וַיְהִי בַּשְּׁבִעִית וַיֹּאמֶר הִנֵּה־עָב קְטַנָּה כְּכַף־אִישׁ עֹלָה מַיִם וַיֹּאמֶר עֲלֵה אֱמֹר אֶל־אַחְאָב אֱסֹר וָרֵד
וְלֹא יַעַצָרְכָה הַגֶּשֶׁם **45** וַיְהִי עַד־כֹּה וְעַד־כֹּה וְהַשָּׁמַיִם הִתְקַדְּרוּ עָבִים וְרוּחַ וַיְהִי גֶּשֶׁם גָּדוֹל וַיִּרְכַּב
אַחְאָב וַיֵּלֶךְ יִזְרְעֶאלָה

*English (BSB)*

**44** On the seventh time the servant reported, "There is a cloud as small as a man's hand rising from the sea." And Elijah replied, "Go and tell Ahab, 'Prepare your chariot and go down before the rain stops you.'" **45** Meanwhile, the sky grew dark with clouds and wind, and a heavy rain began to fall. So Ahab rode away and went to Jezreel.

*English (WEB)*

**44** On the seventh time, he said, "Behold, a small cloud, like a man's hand, is rising out of the sea." He said, "Go up, tell Ahab, 'Get ready and go down, so

that the rain doesn’t stop you.’” **45** In a little while, the sky grew black with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain. Ahab rode, and went to Jezreel.

## Psalm 1:3

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**3** וְהָיָה כְּעֵץ שָׁתוּל עַל־פַּלְגֵי מָיִם אֲשֶׁר פִּרְיוֹ יִתֵּן בְּעִתּוֹ וְעָלֵהוּ לֹא־יִבּוֹל וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־יַעֲשֶׂה יַצְלִיחַ

*English (BSB)*

**3** He is like a tree planted by streams of water, yielding its fruit in season, whose leaf does not wither, and who prospers in all he does.

*English (WEB)*

**3** He will be like a tree planted by the streams of water, that produces its fruit in its season, whose leaf also does not wither. Whatever he does shall prosper.

## Psalm 23

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** מִזְמוֹר לְדָוִד יְהוָה רֹעִי לֹא אֶחְסָר **2** בִּנְאוֹת דֶּשֶׁא יַרְבִּיצֵנִי עַל־מֵי מְנֻחוֹת יְנַהֲלֵנִי **3** נַפְשִׁי יְשׁוֹבֵב
יַנְחֵנִי בְמַעְגְּלֵי־צֶדֶק לְמַעַן שְׁמוֹ **4** גַּם כִּי־אֵלֵךְ בְּגֵיא צַלְמָוֶת לֹא־אִירָא רָע כִּי־אַתָּה עִמָּדִי שִׁבְטְךָ
וּמִשְׁעַנְתֶּךָ הֵמָּה יְנַחֲמֻנִי **5** תַּעֲרֹךְ לְפָנַי שֻׁלְחָן נֶגֶד צֹרְרָי דִּשַּׁנְתָּ בַשֶּׁמֶן רֹאשִׁי כּוֹסִי רְוָיָה **6** אַךְ טוֹב
וָחֶסֶד יִרְדְּפוּנִי כָּל־יְמֵי חַיָּי וְשַׁבְתִּי בְּבֵית־יְהוָה לְאֹרֶךְ יָמִים

*English (BSB)*

**1** The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want. **2** He makes me lie down in green pastures; He leads me beside quiet waters. **3** He restores my soul; He guides me in the paths of righteousness for the sake of His name. **4** Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for You are with me; Your rod and Your staff, they comfort me. **5** You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies. You anoint my head with oil; my cup overflows. **6** Surely goodness and mercy will follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the house of the LORD forever.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD is my shepherd; I shall lack nothing. **2** He makes me lie down in green pastures. He leads me beside still waters. **3** He restores my soul. He guides me in the paths of righteousness for his name’s sake. **4** Even though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death, I will fear no evil, for you are with me. Your rod and your staff, they comfort me. **5** You prepare a table before me in the presence of my enemies. You anoint my head with oil. My cup

runs over. **6** Surely goodness and loving kindness shall follow me all the days of my life, and I will dwell in the LORD’s house forever.

### Psalm 52:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**5 [52:7]** גַּם־אֵ֤ל יִתֶּצְךָ֨ לָנֶ֜צַח יַחְתְּךָ֗ וְיִסָּחֲךָ֥ מֵאֹ֑הֶל וְשֶׁרְשְׁךָ֥ מֵאֶ֝רֶץ חַיִּ֗ים סֶֽלָה

*English (BSB)*

**5** Surely God will bring you down to everlasting ruin; He will snatch you up and tear you away from your tent; He will uproot you from the land of the living. Selah

*English (WEB)*

**5** God will likewise destroy you forever. He will take you up, and pluck you out of your tent, and root you out of the land of the living. Selah.

### Psalm 80:1

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**1 [80:2]** רֹ֘עֵ֤ה יִשְׂרָ֨אֵ֜ל הַאֲזִ֗ינָה נֹהֵ֣ג כַּצֹּ֣אן יוֹסֵ֑ף יֹשֵׁ֥ב הַ֝כְּרוּבִ֗ים הוֹפִֽיעָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** Hear us, O Shepherd of Israel, who leads Joseph like a flock; You who sit enthroned between the cherubim, shine forth

*English (WEB)*

**1** Hear us, Shepherd of Israel, you who lead Joseph like a flock, you who sit above the cherubim, shine out.

### Proverbs 25:14

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**14** נְשִׂיאִ֥ים וְרוּחַ֮ וְגֶ֪שֶׁם אָ֫יִן אִ֥ישׁ מִתְהַלֵּ֥ל בְּמַתַּת־שָֽׁקֶר

*English (BSB)*

**14** Like clouds and wind without rain is the man who boasts of gifts never given.

*English (WEB)*

**14** As clouds and wind without rain, so is he who boasts of gifts deceptively.

## Ezekiel 34

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְהִי דְבַר־יְהוָה אֵלַי לֵאמֹר **2** בֶּן־אָדָם הִנָּבֵא עַל־רֹועֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הִנָּבֵא וְאָמַרְתָּ אֲלֵיהֶם לָרֹעִים כֹּה
אָמַר אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה הוֹי רֹעֵי־יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר הָיוּ רֹעִים אוֹתָם הֲלוֹא הַצֹּאן יִרְעוּ הָרֹעִים **3** אֶת־הַחֵלֶב
תֹּאכֵלוּ וְאֶת־הַצֶּמֶר תִּלְבָּשׁוּ הַבְּרִיאָה תִזְבָּחוּ הַצֹּאן לֹא תִרְעוּ **4** אֶת־הַנַּחְלוֹת לֹא חִזַּקְתֶּם וְאֶת־הַחוֹלָה
לֹא־רִפֵּאתֶם וְלַנִּשְׁבֶּרֶת לֹא חֲבַשְׁתֶּם וְאֶת־הַנִּדַּחַת לֹא הֲשֵׁבֹתֶם וְאֶת־הָאֹבֶדֶת לֹא בִקַּשְׁתֶּם וּבְחָזְקָה
רְדִיתֶם אֹתָם וּבְפָרֶךְ **5** וַתְּפוּצֶינָה מִבְּלִי רֹעֶה וַתִּהְיֶינָה לְאָכְלָה לְכָל־חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה וַתְּפוּצֶינָה **6** יִשְׁגּוּ
צֹאנִי בְּכָל־הֶהָרִים וְעַל כָּל־גִּבְעָה רָמָה וְעַל כָּל־פְּנֵי הָאָרֶץ נָפֹצוּ צֹאנִי וְאֵין דּוֹרֵשׁ וְאֵין מְבַקֵּשׁ **7**
לָכֵן רֹעִים שִׁמְעוּ אֶת־דְּבַר יְהוָה **8** חַי־אֲנִי נְאֻם אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה אִם־לֹא יַעַן הֱיוֹת־צֹאנִי לָבַז וַתִּהְיֶינָה
צֹאנִי לְאָכְלָה לְכָל־חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה מֵאֵין רֹעֶה וְלֹא־דָרְשׁוּ רֹעַי אֶת־צֹאנִי וַיִּרְעוּ הָרֹעִים אוֹתָם וְאֶת־צֹאנִי
לֹא רָעוּ **9** לָכֵן הָרֹעִים שִׁמְעוּ דְּבַר־יְהוָה **10** כֹּה־אָמַר אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה הִנְנִי אֶל־הָרֹעִים וְדָרַשְׁתִּי אֶת־צֹאנִי
מִיָּדָם וְהִשְׁבַּתִּים מֵרְעוֹת צֹאן וְלֹא־יִרְעוּ עוֹד הָרֹעִים אוֹתָם וְהִצַּלְתִּי צֹאנִי מִפִּיהֶם וְלֹא־תִהְיֶיןָ לָהֶם
לְאָכְלָה **11** כִּי כֹה אָמַר אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה הִנְנִי־אֲנִי וְדָרַשְׁתִּי אֶת־צֹאנִי וּבִקַּרְתִּים **12** כְּבַקֶּרֶת רֹעֶה עֶדְרוֹ
בְּיוֹם־הֱיוֹתוֹ בְתוֹךְ־צֹאנוֹ נְפֻרָשׁוֹת כֵּן אֲבַקֵּר אֶת־צֹאנִי וְהִצַּלְתִּי אֶתְהֶם מִכֹּל־הַמְּקוֹמֹת אֲשֶׁר נָפֹצוּ שָׁם
בְּיוֹם עָנָן וַעֲרָפֶל **13** וְהוֹצֵאתִים מִן־הָעַמִּים וְקִבַּצְתִּים מִן־הָאֲרָצוֹת וַהֲבִיאֹתִים אֶל־אַדְמָתָם וּרְעִיתִים
אֶל־הָרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּאֲפִיקִים וּבְכֹל מוֹשְׁבֵי הָאָרֶץ **14** בְּמִרְעֶה־טוֹב אִרְעֵם וּבְהָרֵי מְרוֹם־יִשְׂרָאֵל
יִהְיֶה נָוֵהֶם שָׁם תִּרְבַּצְנָה בְּנָוֶה טוֹב וּמִרְעֶה שָׁמֵן תִּרְעֶינָה אֶל־הָרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **15** אֲנִי אֶרְעֶה צֹאנִי וַאֲנִי
אַרְבִּיצֵם נְאֻם אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה **16** אֶת־הָאֹבֶדֶת אְבַקֵּשׁ וְאֶת־הַנִּדַּחַת אָשִׁיב וְלַנִּשְׁבֶּרֶת אֲחֹבֵשׁ וְאֶת־הַחוֹלָה
אֲחַזֵּק וְאֶת־הַשְּׁמֵנָה וְאֶת־הַחֲזָקָה אַשְׁמִיד אֶרְעֶנָּה בְּמִשְׁפָּט **17** וְאַתֶּנָה צֹאנִי כֹּה אָמַר אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה הִנְנִי
שֹׁפֵט בֵּין־שֶׂה לָשֶׂה לָאֵילִים וְלָעַתּוּדִים **18** הַמְעַט מִכֶּם הַמִּרְעֶה הַטּוֹב תִּרְעוּ וְיֶתֶר מִרְעֵיכֶם תִּרְמְסוּ
בְּרַגְלֵיכֶם וּמִשְׁקַע־מַיִם תִּשְׁתּוּ וְאֶת הַנּוֹתָרִים בְּרַגְלֵיכֶם תִּרְפְּשׁוּן **19** וְצֹאנִי מִרְמַס רַגְלֵיכֶם תִּרְעֶינָה
וּמִרְפַּשׂ רַגְלֵיכֶם תִּשְׁתֶּינָה **20** לָכֵן כֹּה אָמַר אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה אֲלֵיהֶם הִנְנִי־אֲנִי וְשָׁפַטְתִּי בֵּין שֶׂה בְרָיָה וּבֵין
שֶׂה רָזֶה **21** יַעַן בְּצַד וּבְכָתֵף תָּהֹדּוּפוּ וּבְקַרְנֵיכֶם תְּנַגְּחוּ כָּל־הַנַּחְלוֹת עַד אֲשֶׁר הֲפִיצוֹתָם אוֹתָנָה אֶל־
הַחוּצָה **22** וְהוֹשַׁעְתִּי לְצֹאנִי וְלֹא־תִהְיֶינָה עוֹד לָבַז וְשָׁפַטְתִּי בֵּין שֶׂה לָשֶׂה **23** וַהֲקִמֹתִי עֲלֵיהֶם רֹעֶה
אֶחָד וְרָעָה אֹתָן אֵת עַבְדִּי דָוִד הוּא יִרְעֶה אֹתָם וְהוּא־יִהְיֶה לָהֶן לְרֹעֶה **24** וַאֲנִי יְהוָה אֶהְיֶה לָהֶם
לֵאלֹהִים וְעַבְדִּי דָוִד נָשִׂיא בְתוֹכָם אֲנִי יְהוָה דִּבַּרְתִּי **25** וְכָרַתִּי לָהֶם בְּרִית שָׁלוֹם וְהִשְׁבַּתִּי חַיָּה־רָעָה
מִן־הָאָרֶץ וְיָשְׁבוּ בַמִּדְבָּר לָבֶטַח וְיָשְׁנוּ בַּיְּעָרִים **26** וְנָתַתִּי אוֹתָם וְסָבִיבוֹת גִּבְעָתִי בְּרָכָה וְהוֹרַדְתִּי
הַגֶּשֶׁם בְּעִתּוֹ גִּשְׁמֵי בְרָכָה יִהְיוּ **27** וְנָתַן עֵץ הַשָּׂדֶה אֶת־פִּרְיוֹ וְהָאָרֶץ תִּתֵּן יְבוּלָהּ וְהָיוּ עַל־אַדְמָתָם
לָבֶטַח וְיָדְעוּ כִּי־אֲנִי יְהוָה בְּשִׁבְרִי אֶת־מֹטוֹת עֻלָּם וְהִצַּלְתִּים מִיַּד הָעֹבְדִים בָּהֶם **28** וְלֹא־יִהְיוּ עוֹד
בַּז לַגּוֹיִם וְחַיַּת הָאָרֶץ לֹא תֹאכְלֵם וְיָשְׁבוּ לָבֶטַח וְאֵין מַחֲרִיד **29** וַהֲקִמֹתִי לָהֶם מַטָּע לְשֵׁם וְלֹא־יִהְיוּ
עוֹד אֲסֻפֵי רָעָב בָּאָרֶץ וְלֹא־יִשְׂאוּ עוֹד כְּלִמַּת הַגּוֹיִם **30** וְיָדְעוּ כִּי אֲנִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיהֶם אִתָּם וְהֵמָּה
עַמִּי בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל נְאֻם אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה **31** וְאַתֶּן צֹאנִי צֹאן מַרְעִיתִי אָדָם אַתֶּם אֲנִי אֱלֹהֵיכֶם נְאֻם אֲדֹנָי
יְהוִה

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the word of the LORD came to me, saying, **2** “Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy and tell them that this is what the Lord GOD says: ‘Woe to the shepherds of Israel, who only feed themselves! Should not the shepherds feed their flock? **3** You eat the fat, wear the wool, and butcher the fattened sheep, but you do not feed the flock. **4** You have not strengthened the weak, healed the sick, bound up the injured, brought back the strays, or searched for the lost. Instead, you have ruled them with violence and cruelty. **5** They were scattered for lack of a shepherd, and when they were scattered they became food for all the wild beasts. **6** My flock went astray on all the mountains and every high hill. They were scattered over the face of all the earth, with no one to search for them or seek them out.’ **7** Therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of the LORD: **8** ‘As surely as I live, declares the Lord GOD, because My flock lacks a shepherd and has become prey and food for every wild beast, and because My shepherds did not search for My flock but fed themselves instead, **9** therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of the LORD!’ **10** This is what the Lord GOD says: ‘Behold, I am against the shepherds, and I will demand from them My flock and remove them from tending the flock, so that they can no longer feed themselves. For I will deliver My flock from their mouths, and it will no longer be food for them.’ **11** For this is what the Lord GOD says: ‘Behold, I Myself will search for My flock and seek them out. **12** As a shepherd looks for his scattered sheep when he is among the flock, so I will look for My flock. I will rescue them from all the places to which they were scattered on a day of clouds and darkness. **13** I will bring them out from the peoples, gather them from the countries, and bring them into their own land. I will feed them on the mountains of Israel, in the ravines, and in all the settlements of the land. **14** I will feed them in good pasture, and the lofty mountains of Israel will be their grazing land. There they will lie down in a good grazing land; they will feed in rich pasture on the mountains of Israel. **15** I will tend My flock and make them lie down, declares the Lord GOD. **16** I will seek the lost, bring back the strays, bind up the broken, and strengthen the weak; but the sleek and strong I will destroy. I will shepherd them with justice.’ **17** This is what the Lord GOD says to you, My flock: ‘I will judge between one sheep and another, between the rams and the goats. **18** Is it not enough for you to feed on the good pasture? Must you also trample the rest of the pasture with your feet? Is it not enough for you to drink the clear waters? Must you also muddy the rest with your feet? **19** Why must My flock feed on what your feet have trampled, and drink what your feet have muddied?’ **20** Therefore this is what the Lord GOD says to them: ‘Behold, I Myself will judge between the fat sheep and the lean sheep. **21** Since you shove with flank and shoulder, butting all the weak ones with your horns until you have scattered them abroad, **22** I will save My flock, and they will no longer be prey. I will judge between one sheep and another. **23** I will appoint over them one shepherd, My servant David, and he will feed them. He will feed them and be their shepherd. **24** I, the LORD, will be their God, and My servant David will be a prince among them. I, the LORD, have spoken. **25** I will make

with them a covenant of peace and rid the land of wild animals, so that they may dwell securely in the wilderness and sleep in the forest. **26** I will make them and the places around My hill a blessing. I will send down showers in season—showers of blessing. **27** The trees of the field will give their fruit, and the land will yield its produce; My flock will be secure in their land. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I have broken the bars of their yoke and delivered them from the hands that enslaved them. **28** They will no longer be prey for the nations, and the beasts of the earth will not consume them. They will dwell securely, and no one will frighten them. **29** And I will raise up for them a garden of renown, and they will no longer be victims of famine in the land or bear the scorn of the nations. **30** Then they will know that I, the LORD their God, am with them, and that they, the house of Israel, are My people,' declares the Lord GOD. **31** 'You are My flock, the sheep of My pasture, My people, and I am your God,' declares the Lord GOD."

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD's word came to me, saying, **2** "Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy, and tell them, even the shepherds, 'The Lord GOD says: "Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Shouldn't the shepherds feed the sheep? **3** You eat the fat. You clothe yourself with the wool. You kill the fatlings, but you don't feed the sheep. **4** You haven't strengthened the diseased. You haven't healed that which was sick. You haven't bound up that which was broken. You haven't brought back that which was driven away. You haven't sought that which was lost, but you have ruled over them with force and with rigor. **5** They were scattered, because there was no shepherd. They became food to all the animals of the field, and were scattered. **6** My sheep wandered through all the mountains and on every high hill. Yes, my sheep were scattered on all the surface of the earth. There was no one who searched or sought." **7** "'Therefore, you shepherds, hear the LORD's word: **8** "As I live," says the Lord GOD, "surely because my sheep became a prey, and my sheep became food to all the animals of the field, because there was no shepherd, and my shepherds didn't search for my sheep, but the shepherds fed themselves, and didn't feed my sheep, **9** therefore, you shepherds, hear the LORD's word!" **10** The Lord GOD says: "Behold, I am against the shepherds. I will require my sheep at their hand, and cause them to cease from feeding the sheep. The shepherds won't feed themselves any more. I will deliver my sheep from their mouth, that they may not be food for them." **11** "'For the Lord GOD says: "Behold, I myself, even I, will search for my sheep, and will seek them out. **12** As a shepherd seeks out his flock in the day that he is among his sheep that are scattered abroad, so I will seek out my sheep. I will deliver them out of all places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day. **13** I will bring them out from the peoples, and gather them from the countries, and will bring them into their own land. I will feed them on the mountains of Israel, by the watercourses, and in all the inhabited

places of the country. **14** I will feed them with good pasture, and their fold will be on the mountains of the height of Israel. There they will lie down in a good fold. They will feed on rich pasture on the mountains of Israel. **15** I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep, and I will cause them to lie down," says the Lord GOD. **16** "I will seek that which was lost, and will bring back that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken, and will strengthen that which was sick; but I will destroy the fat and the strong. I will feed them in justice."' **17** "As for you, O my flock, the Lord GOD says: 'Behold, I judge between sheep and sheep, the rams and the male goats. **18** Does it seem a small thing to you to have fed on the good pasture, but you must tread down with your feet the residue of your pasture? And to have drunk of the clear waters, but must you foul the residue with your feet? **19** As for my sheep, they eat that which you have trodden with your feet, and they drink that which you have fouled with your feet.' **20** "Therefore the Lord GOD says to them: 'Behold, I, even I, will judge between the fat sheep and the lean sheep. **21** Because you thrust with side and with shoulder, and push all the diseased with your horns, until you have scattered them abroad, **22** therefore I will save my flock, and they will no more be a prey. I will judge between sheep and sheep. **23** I will set up one shepherd over them, and he will feed them, even my servant David. He will feed them, and he will be their shepherd. **24** I, the LORD, will be their God, and my servant David prince among them. I, the LORD, have spoken it. **25** "'I will make with them a covenant of peace, and will cause evil animals to cease out of the land. They will dwell securely in the wilderness and sleep in the woods. **26** I will make them and the places around my hill a blessing. I will cause the shower to come down in its season. There will be showers of blessing. **27** The tree of the field will yield its fruit, and the earth will yield its increase, and they will be secure in their land. Then they will know that I am the LORD, when I have broken the bars of their yoke, and have delivered them out of the hand of those who made slaves of them. **28** They will no more be a prey to the nations, neither will the animals of the earth devour them; but they will dwell securely, and no one will make them afraid. **29** I will raise up to them a plantation for renown, and they will no more be consumed with famine in the land, and not bear the shame of the nations any more. **30** They will know that I, the LORD, their God am with them, and that they, the house of Israel, are my people, says the Lord GOD. **31** You my sheep, the sheep of my pasture, are men, and I am your God,' says the Lord GOD."

## Hosea 6:4

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**4** מָה אֶעֱשֶׂה־לְּךָ אֶפְרַיִם מָה אֶעֱשֶׂה־לָּךְ יְהוּדָה וַחַסְדְּכֶם כַּעֲנַן־בֹּקֶר וְכַטַּל מַשְׁכִּים הֹלֵךְ

*English (BSB)*

**4** What shall I do with you, O Ephraim ? What shall I do with you, O Judah? For your loyalty is like a morning mist, like the early dew that vanishes.

*English (WEB)*

**4** “Ephraim, what shall I do to you? Judah, what shall I do to you? For your love is like a morning cloud, and like the dew that disappears early.

## Joel 2:23

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**23** וּבְנֵי צִיּוֹן גִּילוּ וְשִׂמְחוּ בַּיהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם כִּי־נָתַן לָכֶם אֶת־הַמּוֹרֶה לִצְדָקָה וַיּוֹרֶד לָכֶם גֶּשֶׁם מוֹרֶה
וּמַלְקוֹשׁ בָּרִאשׁוֹן

*English (BSB)*

**23** Be glad, O children of Zion, and rejoice in the LORD your God, for He has given you the autumn rains for your vindication. He sends you showers, both autumn and spring rains, as before.

*English (WEB)*

**23** “Be glad then, you children of Zion, and rejoice in the LORD, your God; for he gives you the early rain in just measure, and he causes the rain to come down for you, the early rain and the latter rain, as before.

## Matthew 3:10

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** ἤδη δὲ ἡ ἀξίνη πρὸς τὴν ῥίζαν τῶν δένδρων κεῖται· πᾶν οὖν δένδρον μὴ ποιοῦν καρπὸν
καλὸν ἐκκόπτεται καὶ εἰς πῦρ βάλλεται.

*English (BSB)*

**10** The axe lies ready at the root of the trees, and every tree that does not produce good fruit will be cut down and thrown into the fire.

*English (WEB)*

**10** Even now the ax lies at the root of the trees. Therefore every tree that doesn’t produce good fruit is cut down, and cast into the fire.

## Matthew 7:16–20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** ἀπὸ τῶν καρπῶν αὐτῶν ἐπιγνώσεσθε αὐτούς. μήτι συλλέγουσιν ἀπὸ ἀκανθῶν σταφυλὰς ἢ ἀπὸ τριβόλων σῦκα; **17** οὕτως πᾶν δένδρον ἀγαθὸν καρποὺς καλοὺς ποιεῖ, τὸ δὲ σαπρὸν δένδρον καρποὺς πονηροὺς ποιεῖ· **18** οὐ δύναται δένδρον ἀγαθὸν καρποὺς πονηροὺς ποιεῖν, οὐδὲ δένδρον σαπρὸν καρποὺς καλοὺς ποιεῖν. **19** πᾶν δένδρον μὴ ποιοῦν καρπὸν καλὸν ἐκκόπτεται καὶ εἰς πῦρ βάλλεται. **20** ἄρα γε ἀπὸ τῶν καρπῶν αὐτῶν ἐπιγνώσεσθε αὐτούς.

*English (BSB)*

**16** By their fruit you will recognize them. Are grapes gathered from thornbushes, or figs from thistles? **17** Likewise, every good tree bears good fruit, but a bad tree bears bad fruit. **18** A good tree cannot bear bad fruit, and a bad tree cannot bear good fruit. **19** Every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire. **20** So then, by their fruit you will recognize them.

*English (WEB)*

**16** By their fruits you will know them. Do you gather grapes from thorns or figs from thistles? **17** Even so, every good tree produces good fruit, but the corrupt tree produces evil fruit. **18** A good tree can't produce evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree produce good fruit. **19** Every tree that doesn't grow good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire. **20** Therefore by their fruits you will know them.

## Matthew 15:13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** ὁ δὲ ἀποκριθεὶς εἶπεν· Πᾶσα φυτεία ἣν οὐκ ἐφύτευσεν ὁ πατήρ μου ὁ οὐράνιος ἐκριζωθήσεται.

*English (BSB)*

**13** But Jesus replied, "Every plant that My heavenly Father has not planted will be pulled up by its roots.

*English (WEB)*

**13** But he answered, "Every plant which my heavenly Father didn't plant will be uprooted.

## Matthew 21:19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** καὶ ἰδὼν συκῆν μίαν ἐπὶ τῆς ὁδοῦ ἦλθεν ἐπ᾽ αὐτήν, καὶ οὐδὲν εὗρεν ἐν αὐτῇ εἰ μὴ φύλλα μόνον, καὶ λέγει αὐτῇ· Μηκέτι ἐκ σοῦ καρπὸς γένηται εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα· καὶ ἐξηράνθη παραχρῆμα ἡ συκῆ.

*English (BSB)*

**19** Seeing a fig tree by the road, He went up to it but found nothing on it except leaves. “May you never bear fruit again!” He said. And immediately the tree withered.

*English (WEB)*

**19** Seeing a fig tree by the road, he came to it and found nothing on it but leaves. He said to it, “Let there be no fruit from you forever!” Immediately the fig tree withered away.

## Mark 2:15–17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** Καὶ γίνεται κατακεῖσθαι αὐτὸν ἐν τῇ οἰκίᾳ αὐτοῦ, καὶ πολλοὶ τελῶναι καὶ ἁμαρτωλοὶ συνανέκειντο τῷ Ἰησοῦ καὶ τοῖς μαθηταῖς αὐτοῦ, ἦσαν γὰρ πολλοὶ καὶ ἠκολούθουν αὐτῷ. **16** καὶ οἱ γραμματεῖς τῶν Φαρισαίων ἰδόντες ὅτι ἐσθίει μετὰ τῶν ἁμαρτωλῶν καὶ τελωνῶν ἔλεγον τοῖς μαθηταῖς αὐτοῦ· Ὅτι μετὰ τῶν τελωνῶν καὶ ἁμαρτωλῶν ἐσθίει; **17** καὶ ἀκούσας ὁ Ἰησοῦς λέγει αὐτοῖς ὅτι Οὐ χρείαν ἔχουσιν οἱ ἰσχύοντες ἰατροῦ ἀλλ᾽ οἱ κακῶς ἔχοντες· οὐκ ἦλθον καλέσαι δικαίους ἀλλὰ ἁμαρτωλούς.

*English (BSB)*

**15** While Jesus was dining at Levi’s house, many tax collectors and sinners were eating with Him and His disciples—for there were many who followed Him. **16** When the scribes who were Pharisees saw Jesus eating with these people, they asked His disciples, “Why does He eat with tax collectors and sinners?” **17** On hearing this, Jesus told them, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick. I have not come to call the righteous, but sinners.”

*English (WEB)*

**15** He was reclining at the table in his house, and many tax collectors and sinners sat down with Jesus and his disciples, for there were many, and they followed him. **16** The scribes and the Pharisees, when they saw that he was eating with the sinners and tax collectors, said to his disciples, “Why is it that he eats and drinks with tax collectors and sinners?” **17** When Jesus heard it, he said to them, “Those who are healthy have no need for a physician, but those who are sick. I came not to call the righteous, but sinners to repentance.”

## Luke 1:74

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**74** ἀφόβως ἐκ χειρὸς ἐχθρῶν ῥυσθέντας λατρεύειν αὐτῷ

*English (BSB)*

**74** deliverance from hostile hands, that we may serve Him without fear,

*English (WEB)*

**74** to grant to us that we, being delivered out of the hand of our enemies,
should serve him without fear,

## Luke 12:54

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**54** Ἔλεγεν δὲ καὶ τοῖς ὄχλοις· Ὅταν ἴδητε νεφέλην ἀνατέλλουσαν ἐπὶ δυσμῶν, εὐθέως λέγετε
ὅτι Ὄμβρος ἔρχεται, καὶ γίνεται οὕτως·

*English (BSB)*

**54** Then Jesus said to the crowds, “As soon as you see a cloud rising in the
west, you say, ‘A shower is coming,’ and that is what happens.

*English (WEB)*

**54** He said to the multitudes also, “When you see a cloud rising from the west,
immediately you say, ‘A shower is coming,’ and so it happens.

## Luke 13:6–9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** Ἔλεγεν δὲ ταύτην τὴν παραβολήν. Συκῆν εἶχέν τις πεφυτευμένην ἐν τῷ ἀμπελῶνι αὐτοῦ, καὶ
ἦλθεν ζητῶν καρπὸν ἐν αὐτῇ καὶ οὐχ εὗρεν. **7** εἶπεν δὲ πρὸς τὸν ἀμπελουργόν· Ἰδοὺ τρία ἔτη
ἀφ’ οὗ ἔρχομαι ζητῶν καρπὸν ἐν τῇ συκῇ ταύτῃ καὶ οὐχ εὑρίσκω· ἔκκοψον αὐτήν· ἱνατί καὶ τὴν
γῆν καταργεῖ; **8** ὁ δὲ ἀποκριθεὶς λέγει αὐτῷ· Κύριε, ἄφες αὐτὴν καὶ τοῦτο τὸ ἔτος, ἕως ὅτου
σκάψω περὶ αὐτὴν καὶ βάλω κόπρια· **9** κἂν μὲν ποιήσῃ καρπὸν εἰς τὸ μέλλον— εἰ δὲ μήγε,
ἐκκόψεις αὐτήν.

*English (BSB)*

**6** Then Jesus told this parable: “A man had a fig tree that was planted in his
vineyard. He went to look for fruit on it, but did not find any. **7** So he said to
the keeper of the vineyard, ‘Look, for the past three years I have come to
search for fruit on this fig tree and haven’t found any. Therefore cut it down!
Why should it use up the soil?’ **8** ‘Sir,’ the man replied, ‘leave it alone again
this year, until I dig around it and fertilize it. **9** If it bears fruit next year, fine.
But if not, you can cut it down.’”

*English (WEB)*

**6** He spoke this parable. “A certain man had a fig tree planted in his vineyard, and he came seeking fruit on it and found none. **7** He said to the vine dresser, ‘Behold, these three years I have come looking for fruit on this fig tree, and found none. Cut it down! Why does it waste the soil?’ **8** He answered, ‘Lord, leave it alone this year also, until I dig around it and fertilize it. **9** If it bears fruit, fine; but if not, after that, you can cut it down.’”

## Luke 15:1–2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἦσαν δὲ αὐτῷ ἐγγίζοντες πάντες οἱ τελῶναι καὶ οἱ ἁμαρτωλοὶ ἀκούειν αὐτοῦ. **2** καὶ διεγόγγυζον οἵ τε Φαρισαῖοι καὶ οἱ γραμματεῖς λέγοντες ὅτι Οὗτος ἁμαρτωλοὺς προσδέχεται καὶ συνεσθίει αὐτοῖς.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now all the tax collectors and sinners were gathering around to listen to Jesus. **2** So the Pharisees and scribes began to grumble: “This man welcomes sinners and eats with them.”

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now all the tax collectors and sinners were coming close to him to hear him. **2** The Pharisees and the scribes murmured, saying, “This man welcomes sinners, and eats with them.”

## Luke 17:6

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** εἶπεν δὲ ὁ κύριος· Εἰ ἔχετε πίστιν ὡς κόκκον σινάπεως, ἐλέγετε ἂν τῇ συκαμίνῳ ταύτῃ· Ἐκριζώθητι καὶ φυτεύθητι ἐν τῇ θαλάσσῃ· καὶ ὑπήκουσεν ἂν ὑμῖν.

*English (BSB)*

**6** And the Lord answered, “If you have faith the size of a mustard seed, you can say to this mulberry tree, ‘Be uprooted and planted in the sea,’ and it will obey you.

*English (WEB)*

**6** The Lord said, “If you had faith like a grain of mustard seed, you would tell this sycamore tree, ‘Be uprooted and be planted in the sea,’ and it would obey you.

## John 10:11–13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** Ἐγώ εἰμι ὁ ποιμὴν ὁ καλός· ὁ ποιμὴν ὁ καλὸς τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ τίθησιν ὑπὲρ τῶν προβάτων· **12** ὁ μισθωτὸς καὶ οὐκ ὢν ποιμήν, οὗ οὐκ ἔστιν τὰ πρόβατα ἴδια, θεωρεῖ τὸν λύκον ἐρχόμενον καὶ ἀφίησιν τὰ πρόβατα καὶ φεύγει— καὶ ὁ λύκος ἁρπάζει αὐτὰ καὶ σκορπίζει— **13** ὅτι μισθωτός ἐστιν καὶ οὐ μέλει αὐτῷ περὶ τῶν προβάτων.

*English (BSB)*

**11** I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down His life for the sheep. **12** The hired hand is not the shepherd, and the sheep are not his own. When he sees the wolf coming, he abandons the sheep and runs away. Then the wolf pounces on them and scatters the flock. **13** The man runs away because he is a hired servant and is unconcerned for the sheep.

*English (WEB)*

**11** “I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep. **12** He who is a hired hand, and not a shepherd, who doesn’t own the sheep, sees the wolf coming, leaves the sheep, and flees. The wolf snatches the sheep and scatters them. **13** The hired hand flees because he is a hired hand and doesn’t care for the sheep.

## Acts 2:42, 46

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**42** ἦσαν δὲ προσκαρτεροῦντες τῇ διδαχῇ τῶν ἀποστόλων καὶ τῇ κοινωνίᾳ, τῇ κλάσει τοῦ ἄρτου καὶ ταῖς προσευχαῖς. … **46** καθ’ ἡμέραν τε προσκαρτεροῦντες ὁμοθυμαδὸν ἐν τῷ ἱερῷ, κλῶντές τε κατ’ οἶκον ἄρτον, μετελάμβανον τροφῆς ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει καὶ ἀφελότητι καρδίας,

*English (BSB)*

**42** They devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching and to the fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer. … **46** With one accord they continued to meet daily in the temple courts and to break bread from house to house, sharing their meals with gladness and sincerity of heart,

*English (WEB)*

**42** They continued steadfastly in the apostles’ teaching and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and prayer. … **46** Day by day, continuing steadfastly with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread at home, they took their food with gladness and singleness of heart,

## Acts 20:7, 11, 28–29

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** Ἐν δὲ τῇ μιᾷ τῶν σαββάτων συνηγμένων ἡμῶν κλάσαι ἄρτον ὁ Παῦλος διελέγετο αὐτοῖς, μέλλων ἐξιέναι τῇ ἐπαύριον, παρέτεινέν τε τὸν λόγον μέχρι μεσονυκτίου. … **11** ἀναβὰς δὲ καὶ κλάσας τὸν ἄρτον καὶ γευσάμενος ἐφ᾽ ἱκανόν τε ὁμιλήσας ἄχρι αὐγῆς, οὕτως ἐξῆλθεν. … **28** προσέχετε ἑαυτοῖς καὶ παντὶ τῷ ποιμνίῳ, ἐν ᾧ ὑμᾶς τὸ πνεῦμα τὸ ἅγιον ἔθετο ἐπισκόπους, ποιμαίνειν τὴν ἐκκλησίαν τοῦ θεοῦ, ἣν περιεποιήσατο διὰ τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ ἰδίου. **29** ἐγὼ οἶδα ὅτι εἰσελεύσονται μετὰ τὴν ἄφιξίν μου λύκοι βαρεῖς εἰς ὑμᾶς μὴ φειδόμενοι τοῦ ποιμνίου,

*English (BSB)*

**7** On the first day of the week we came together to break bread. Since Paul was ready to leave the next day, he talked to them and kept on speaking until midnight. … **11** Then Paul went back upstairs, broke bread, and ate. And after speaking until daybreak, he departed. … **28** Keep watch over yourselves and the entire flock of which the Holy Spirit has made you overseers. Be shepherds of the church of God, which He purchased with His own blood. **29** I know that after my departure, savage wolves will come in among you and will not spare the flock.

*English (WEB)*

**7** On the first day of the week, when the disciples were gathered together to break bread, Paul talked with them, intending to depart on the next day; and continued his speech until midnight. … **11** When he had gone up, had broken bread and eaten, and had talked with them a long while, even until break of day, he departed. … **28** Take heed, therefore, to yourselves and to all the flock, in which the Holy Spirit has made you overseers, to shepherd the assembly of the Lord and God which he purchased with his own blood. **29** For I know that after my departure, vicious wolves will enter in among you, not sparing the flock.

## 1 Corinthians 10:17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**17** ὅτι εἷς ἄρτος, ἓν σῶμα οἱ πολλοί ἐσμεν, οἱ γὰρ πάντες ἐκ τοῦ ἑνὸς ἄρτου μετέχομεν.

*English (BSB)*

**17** Because there is one loaf, we who are many are one body; for we all partake of the one loaf.

*English (WEB)*

**17** Because there is one loaf of bread, we, who are many, are one body; for we all partake of the one loaf of bread.

## 1 Corinthians 11:20, 27–34

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** συνερχομένων οὖν ὑμῶν ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ οὐκ ἔστιν κυριακὸν δεῖπνον φαγεῖν, … **27** Ὥστε ὃς ἂν ἐσθίῃ τὸν ἄρτον ἢ πίνῃ τὸ ποτήριον τοῦ κυρίου ἀναξίως, ἔνοχος ἔσται τοῦ σώματος καὶ τοῦ αἵματος τοῦ κυρίου. **28** δοκιμαζέτω δὲ ἄνθρωπος ἑαυτόν, καὶ οὕτως ἐκ τοῦ ἄρτου ἐσθιέτω καὶ ἐκ τοῦ ποτηρίου πινέτω· **29** ὁ γὰρ ἐσθίων καὶ πίνων κρίμα ἑαυτῷ ἐσθίει καὶ πίνει μὴ διακρίνων τὸ σῶμα. **30** διὰ τοῦτο ἐν ὑμῖν πολλοὶ ἀσθενεῖς καὶ ἄρρωστοι καὶ κοιμῶνται ἱκανοί. **31** εἰ δὲ ἑαυτοὺς διεκρίνομεν, οὐκ ἂν ἐκρινόμεθα· **32** κρινόμενοι δὲ ὑπὸ κυρίου παιδευόμεθα, ἵνα μὴ σὺν τῷ κόσμῳ κατακριθῶμεν. **33** Ὥστε, ἀδελφοί μου, συνερχόμενοι εἰς τὸ φαγεῖν ἀλλήλους ἐκδέχεσθε. **34** εἴ τις πεινᾷ, ἐν οἴκῳ ἐσθιέτω, ἵνα μὴ εἰς κρίμα συνέρχησθε. Τὰ δὲ λοιπὰ ὡς ἂν ἔλθω διατάξομαι.

*English (BSB)*

**20** Now then, when you come together, it is not the Lord’s Supper you eat. … **27** Therefore, whoever eats the bread or drinks the cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner will be guilty of sinning against the body and blood of the Lord. **28** Each one must examine himself before he eats of the bread and drinks of the cup. **29** For anyone who eats and drinks without recognizing the body eats and drinks judgment on himself. **30** That is why many among you are weak and sick, and a number of you have fallen asleep. **31** Now if we judged ourselves properly, we would not come under judgment. **32** But when we are judged by the Lord, we are being disciplined so that we will not be condemned with the world. **33** So, my brothers, when you come together to eat, wait for one another. **34** If anyone is hungry, he should eat at home, so that when you come together it will not result in judgment. And when I come, I will give instructions about the remaining matters.

*English (WEB)*

**20** When therefore you assemble yourselves together, it is not the Lord’s supper that you eat. … **27** Therefore whoever eats this bread or drinks the Lord’s cup in a way unworthy of the Lord will be guilty of the body and the blood of the Lord. **28** But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of the bread and drink of the cup. **29** For he who eats and drinks in an unworthy way eats and drinks judgment to himself if he doesn’t discern the Lord’s body. **30** For this cause many among you are weak and sickly, and not a few sleep. **31** For if we discerned ourselves, we wouldn’t be judged. **32** But when we are judged, we are disciplined by the Lord, that we may not be condemned with the world. **33** Therefore, my brothers, when you come together to eat, wait for one another. **34** But if anyone is hungry, let him eat at home, lest your coming together be for judgment. The rest I will set in order whenever I come.

## Ephesians 4:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** ἵνα μηκέτι ὦμεν νήπιοι, κλυδωνιζόμενοι καὶ περιφερόμενοι παντὶ ἀνέμῳ τῆς διδασκαλίας ἐν τῇ κυβείᾳ τῶν ἀνθρώπων ἐν πανουργίᾳ πρὸς τὴν μεθοδείαν τῆς πλάνης,

*English (BSB)*

**14** Then we will no longer be infants, tossed about by the waves and carried around by every wind of teaching and by the clever cunning of men in their deceitful scheming.

*English (WEB)*

**14** that we may no longer be children, tossed back and forth and carried about with every wind of doctrine, by the trickery of men, in craftiness, after the wiles of error;

## Philippians 1:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** καὶ τοὺς πλείονας τῶν ἀδελφῶν ἐν κυρίῳ πεποιθότας τοῖς δεσμοῖς μου περισσοτέρως τολμᾶν ἀφόβως τὸν λόγον λαλεῖν.

*English (BSB)*

**14** And most of the brothers, confident in the Lord by my chains, now dare more greatly to speak the word without fear.

*English (WEB)*

**14** and that most of the brothers in the Lord, being confident through my bonds, are more abundantly bold to speak the word of God without fear.

## 1 Timothy 1:19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** ἔχων πίστιν καὶ ἀγαθὴν συνείδησιν, ἣν τινες ἀπωσάμενοι περὶ τὴν πίστιν ἐναυάγησαν·

*English (BSB)*

**19** holding on to faith and a good conscience, which some have rejected and thereby shipwrecked their faith.

*English (WEB)*

**19** holding faith and a good conscience, which some having thrust away made a shipwreck concerning the faith,

## Hebrews 13:9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**9** διδαχαῖς ποικίλαις καὶ ξέναις μὴ παραφέρεσθε· καλὸν γὰρ χάριτι βεβαιοῦσθαι τὴν καρδίαν, οὐ βρώμασιν, ἐν οἷς οὐκ ὠφελήθησαν οἱ περιπατοῦντες.

*English (BSB)*

**9** Do not be carried away by all kinds of strange teachings, for it is good for the heart to be strengthened by grace and not by foods of no value to those devoted to them.

*English (WEB)*

**9** Don’t be carried away by various and strange teachings, for it is good that the heart be established by grace, not by foods, through which those who were so occupied were not benefited.

## 1 Peter 5:2–3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** ποιμάνατε τὸ ἐν ὑμῖν ποίμνιον τοῦ θεοῦ, ἐπισκοποῦντες μὴ ἀναγκαστῶς ἀλλὰ ἑκουσίως κατὰ θεόν, μηδὲ αἰσχροκερδῶς ἀλλὰ προθύμως, **3** μηδ’ ὡς κατακυριεύοντες τῶν κλήρων ἀλλὰ τύποι γινόμενοι τοῦ ποιμνίου·

*English (BSB)*

**2** Be shepherds of God’s flock that is among you, watching over them not out of compulsion, but because it is God’s will; not out of greed, but out of eagerness; **3** not lording it over those entrusted to you, but being examples to the flock.

*English (WEB)*

**2** shepherd the flock of God which is among you, exercising the oversight, not under compulsion, but voluntarily; not for dishonest gain, but willingly; **3** not as lording it over those entrusted to you, but making yourselves examples to the flock.

## 2 Peter 2:13, 17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** ἀδικούμενοι μισθὸν ἀδικίας· ἡδονὴν ἡγούμενοι τὴν ἐν ἡμέρᾳ τρυφήν, σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι ἐντρυφῶντες ἐν ταῖς ἀπάταις αὐτῶν συνευωχούμενοι ὑμῖν, … **17** Οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται.

*English (BSB)*

**13** The harm they will suffer is the wages of their wickedness. They consider it a pleasure to carouse in broad daylight. They are blots and blemishes, reveling in their deception as they feast with you. … **17** These men are springs without water and mists driven by a storm. Blackest darkness is reserved for them.

*English (WEB)*

**13** receiving the wages of unrighteousness; people who count it pleasure to revel in the daytime, spots and defects, reveling in their deceit while they feast with you; … **17** These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

### Revelation 2:11

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** ὁ ἔχων οὖς ἀκουσάτω τί τὸ πνεῦμα λέγει ταῖς ἐκκλησίαις. ὁ νικῶν οὐ μὴ ἀδικηθῇ ἐκ τοῦ θανάτου τοῦ δευτέρου.

*English (BSB)*

**11** He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches. The one who overcomes will not be harmed by the second death.

*English (WEB)*

**11** He who has an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the assemblies. He who overcomes won’t be harmed by the second death.

### Revelation 20:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** καὶ ὁ θάνατος καὶ ὁ ᾅδης ἐβλήθησαν εἰς τὴν λίμνην τοῦ πυρός. οὗτος ὁ θάνατος ὁ δεύτερός ἐστιν, ἡ λίμνη τοῦ πυρός.

*English (BSB)*

**14** Then Death and Hades were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death—the lake of fire.

*English (WEB)*

**14** Death and Hades were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death, the lake of fire.

### 1 Enoch 80:2

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**2** And in the days of the sinners the years shall be shortened, And their seed shall be tardy on their lands and fields, And all things on the earth shall alter, And shall not appear in their time: And the rain shall be kept back And the heaven shall withhold (it).

# Chapter 7. Wild Waves and Wandering Stars (Jude 13)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **13** κύματα ἄγρια θαλάσσης ἐπαφρίζοντα τὰς ἑαυτῶν αἰσχύνας, ἀστέρες πλανῆται οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους εἰς αἰῶνα τετήρηται.
>
> — Jude 13, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript's first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | εἰς αἰῶνα | 'forever' | P72 א A B C L 1739 |
| 13 | εἰς αἰῶνας | 'forever (plural)' | Ψ |
| 13 | εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα | 'forever' | K |

Notes. v. 13: not extant in P78.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

**Jude 13**

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | They are the ragynge waves of the see fominge out their awne shame. They are wandrynge starres to whom is reserved the myst of darcknes for ever. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | They are the raging waues of the sea, foming out their owne shame: they are wandring starres, to whome is reserued the blackenesse of darkenesse for euer. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own confusion; wandering stars, to whom the storm of darkness is reserved for ever. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, to whom is reserved the blackness of darkness for ever. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom is reserved the blackness of darkness for ever. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness hath been reserved for ever. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | raging waves of the sea, foaming out their own shames; wandering stars, to whom has been reserved the gloom of darkness for eternity. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | wild waves of a sea, foaming out their own shames; stars going astray, to whom the gloom of the darkness to the age hath been kept. |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness hath been reserved for ever. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | They are restless [MET], like the pounding waves of the ocean. Just like waves produce foul-smelling foam on the shore, those teachers of false doctrine do shameful [MTY] deeds. We cannot depend/rely on them to show us how to conduct our lives [MET], just like we cannot depend/rely on ◄meteors/falling stars► to show us the way when we travel. God has reserved intense |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | darkness for them forever in hell. Jude 14-16 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | they are wild sea waves, foaming with their own shame; they are ‘wandering stars,’ for which the blackest darkness has been reserved for ever. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | They are violent waves in the sea, foaming out their own shame. They are wandering stars, for whom the gloom of thick darkness has been reserved forever. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | They’re violent ocean waves, foaming in their own disgrace. They’re false stars, doomed forever to utter darkness. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | wild waves of a sea, foaming up their own shameful [deeds]; stars going astray, for whom the gloom of the darkness throughout the age has been kept. |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | They are wild waves of the sea, foaming up their own shame; wandering stars, for whom blackest darkness has been reserved forever. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | They are wild waves of the sea, foaming up their own shame; wandering stars, for whom blackest darkness has been reserved forever. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | They are wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shameful deeds; wayward stars, for whom the thick gloom of darkness has been reserved forever. They perished in the rebellion of Korah.\|src=“26 Jude 1_11.png” size=“span” copy=“Public Domain (Gustave Doré)” ref=“1:11” |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Jude completes his series of images with two more, drawn from the sea and the sky. The intruders are like **wild waves** that throw up foam and scum on the shore, except that what they throw up is their own shameful conduct. They are also like **wandering stars**, heavenly bodies that have left their proper courses and for whom the deepest darkness has been reserved forever.

Together with the clouds and trees of v. 12, these images complete a tour of the created world: the air, the earth, the sea, and the heavens. In each region Jude finds a picture of disorder: clouds that do not rain, trees that do not bear, waves that cannot rest, stars that do not keep their paths. Jewish readers

familiar with 1 Enoch would have recognized the pattern. In the natural world, everything obeys God's order. Only sinners do not.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### κύματα ἄγρια θαλάσσης (*kymata agria thalassēs*) — 'wild waves of the sea'

The Greek κύματα ἄγρια θαλάσσης (*kymata agria thalassēs*) means "wild waves of the sea." The adjective ἄγριος (*agrios*) is used of wild animals and uncultivated land. Here it describes the untamed, restless violence of a stormy sea.

For the people of the Bible, the sea was not a place of recreation. It was the great image of chaos and danger. In the beginning "darkness [was] on the face of the deep" (Gen 1:2, LSV), and God's power is shown in setting limits to the sea: "Who has made sand the border of the sea, / A perpetual limit, and it does not pass over it, / They shake themselves, and they are not able" (Jer 5:22, LSV). In Job, God says to the sea, "To here you come, and no more, / And a command is placed / On the pride of your billows" (Job 38:11, LSV). The Psalms praise God as "ruler over the pride of the sea" (Ps 89:9, LSV). The sea is powerful, but in Scripture it is held in check by God's command.

### ἐπαφρίζοντα τὰς ἑαυτῶν αἰσχύνας (*epaphrizonta tas heautōn aischynas*) — 'foaming up their own shameful deeds'

The participle ἐπαφρίζοντα (*epaphrizonta*), "foaming up," another word found only here in the New Testament, comes from ἀφρός (*aphros*), "foam."[111] The image is of breakers that heave up foam, weed, and debris and leave them on the shore.

What the waves throw up is τὰς ἑαυτῶν αἰσχύνας (*tas heautōn aischynas*), "their own shames," a plural meaning "shameful deeds" or "disgraceful things." The LSV supplies "[deeds]" to make the sense clear.

The image almost certainly draws on Isaiah: "And the wicked [are] as the driven out sea, / For it is not able to rest, / And its waters cast out filth and mire. 'There is no peace,' said my God, 'for the wicked!'" (Isa 57:20–21, LSV). As noted in the Introduction, the Greek Septuagint version of this verse lacks the "filth and mire," while the Hebrew includes it. Jude's image matches the Hebrew.[112]

The point is twofold. First, the intruders are restless and agitated, never at peace, always churning, like the sea of Isaiah that "is not able to rest." Second, their activity produces only filth. As a storm leaves a beach strewn

with foam and debris, their teaching and conduct leave behind visible shame. Paul's description of those "whose glory [is] in their shame" (Phil 3:19, LSV) is a close parallel. The intruders may have boasted of their freedom, but what they produced was disgraceful.

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111. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἐπαφρίζω: "to foam up: metaph., τ. αἰσχύνας, Ju 13."↩

112. LXX Isa 57:20: Οἱ δὲ ἄδικοι κλυδωνισθήσονται, καὶ ἀναπαύσασθαι οὐ δυνήσονται ("the unrighteous will be tossed like waves and will not be able to rest"), Brenton's Greek Septuagint; translation mine.↩

### ἀστέρες πλανῆται (*asteres planētai*) — 'wandering stars'

The final image is ἀστέρες πλανῆται (*asteres planētai*), "wandering stars." The LSV's "stars going astray" brings out the moral sense of πλανάω (*planaō*), "to lead astray, wander." The noun πλανήτης (*planētēs*), "wanderer," unique in the New Testament to this verse, is the source of the English word "planet."[113] Greek astronomers called the planets "wandering stars" because, unlike the fixed stars, they moved across the sky along irregular-seeming paths. The word also links back to "the deceit (πλάνη, *planē*) of Balaam" in v. 11. The intruders wander, and they lead others to wander.

What did Jude's readers picture? Several possibilities have been suggested, and they are not mutually exclusive:

1. **Planets.** The ordinary meaning of the phrase. To an observer, the planets seemed to break the regular order of the heavens.
2. **Shooting stars or meteors.** Stars that appear to fall from their places and vanish into darkness. This fits "for whom the gloom of the darkness … has been kept," but the word πλανῆται does not usually mean meteors.
3. **Stars as angels.** In Jewish and early Christian thought, stars were often associated with angels (Rev 1:20; 9:1; Job 38:7). In 1 Enoch, as the deep dive shows, disobedient stars are punished in a place of darkness and fire. On this reading, the intruders are compared to the rebellious heavenly beings of v. 6.

The third possibility is the strongest, because of Jude's evident use of 1 Enoch. It combines naturally with the first. To an ancient Jewish observer, a "wandering" star might be precisely a star that had transgressed its appointed course.

There may also be a practical image here. Ancient sailors navigated by the stars. A star that did not keep its place would lead travelers astray, just as the intruders' teaching misled the community. That fits the nautical imagery of the reefs (v. 12) and the sea (v. 13).

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113. Abbott-Smith, s.v. πλανήτης: “a wanderer: ἀστέρες π. (cl. planets), wandering stars, Ju 13.”↩

### οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους εἰς αἰῶνα τετήρηται (*hois ho zophos tou skotous eis aiōna tetērētai*) — ‘for whom the gloom of darkness has been kept forever’

The final clause, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους εἰς αἰῶνα τετήρηται (*hois ho zophos tou skotous eis aiōna tetērētai*), “for whom the gloom of darkness has been reserved forever,” announces the destiny of the wandering stars. It repeats two key terms:

- **ζόφος** (*zophos*), “gloom,” used in v. 6 for the darkness in which the rebellious angels are held. The repetition binds the intruders’ fate to the angels’.
- **τετήρηται** (*tetērētai*), “has been kept,” the perfect passive of τηρέω (*tēreō*). This is the fourth occurrence of “keep” in the letter. The readers have been kept for Jesus Christ (v. 1). The angels did not keep their position and are kept in bonds (v. 6). Now darkness is kept for the intruders.

The phrase “the gloom of the darkness” (ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους) doubles the idea of darkness, which is something like “the blackness of darkness” (WBS) or “blackest darkness” (BSB). The LSV’s “throughout the age” renders εἰς αἰῶνα (*eis aiōna*), literally “into the age,” a common biblical idiom for “forever.” Some manuscripts read εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα with the article. The meaning is unchanged.[114]

For a star, whose nature is to shine, the ultimate judgment is darkness. The image recalls Jesus’ sayings about “the outer darkness—there will be the weeping and the gnashing of the teeth” (Matt 8:12, LSV). Second Peter uses Jude’s phrase almost word for word: “to whom the deepest gloom of darkness has been kept throughout the age” (2 Pet 2:17, LSV).

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114. The Text-Critical Greek NT notes (eBible.org) give εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα in about 37% of manuscripts and εἰς αἰῶνα (the reading of SBLGNT and RP) in about 55%.↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| κῦμα | *kyma* | wave | “waves” | |
| ἄγριος | *agrios* | wild, fierce | “wild” | Used of untamed animals. |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| θάλασσα | *thalassa* | sea | “a sea” | Biblical symbol of chaos restrained by God. |
| ἐπαφρίζω | *epaphrizō* | foam up | “foaming up” | NT hapax; from ἀφρός, foam. |
| αἰσχύνη | *aischynē* | shame, disgrace | “shameful [deeds]” | Plural: shameful acts. |
| ἀστήρ | *astēr* | star | “stars” | |
| πλανήτης | *planētēs* | wanderer | “going astray” | NT hapax; source of “planet”; cf. πλάνη (v. 11). |
| ζόφος | *zophos* | gloom, deep darkness | “the gloom” | Also v. 6. |
| σκότος | *skotos* | darkness | “the darkness” | |
| αἰών | *aiōn* | age; (εἰς αἰῶνα) forever | “throughout the age” | |
| τηρέω | *tēreō* | keep, reserve | “has been kept” | Perfect passive; fourth use in Jude. |

**A caution on “planet.”** It is tempting to read modern astronomy into Jude’s “wandering stars,” as though Jude were making a scientific observation about planetary orbits. Jude uses the ancient observational category, lights in the sky that do not keep the regular pattern of the fixed stars, and gives it a moral and theological meaning. The image works because, to his readers, the heavens normally displayed perfect order.

### Deep dive: Wandering stars and ancient cosmological imagery

To understand Jude’s last image, it helps to step into the ancient view of the heavens.

**Order in the heavens.** For ancient peoples, the night sky was the supreme picture of order. The fixed stars wheeled in the same patterns year after year, and the calendar, agriculture, and navigation depended on them. Scripture celebrates this order: “Praise Him, sun and moon, / Praise Him, all stars of light. … He gave a statute, and they do not pass over” (Ps 148:3, 6, LSV). Jeremiah speaks of God as the one “giving the sun for a light by day, / The statutes of moon and stars for a light by night” (Jer 31:35, LSV). The Jewish *Testament of Naphtali* draws the moral lesson: “Sun and moon and stars change not their order; so also you shall not change the law of God in the disorderliness of your doings.”[115]

**Disorder as rebellion.** Against this background, a heavenly body that did not keep its course was a picture of rebellion. 1 Enoch develops this idea vividly. Enoch, on his heavenly journey, sees “seven stars like great burning mountains,” and the angel explains: “This place is the end of heaven and earth: this has become a prison for the stars and the host of heaven. And the stars which roll over the fire are they which have transgressed the commandment of the Lord in the beginning of their rising, because they did not come forth at their appointed times. And He was wroth with them, and bound them” (1 Enoch 18:13–16, trans. Charles).[116] Later he sees “seven stars of the heaven bound together,” and is told: “These are of the number of the stars [of heaven], which have transgressed the commandment of the Lord, and are bound here” (21:3, 6).

In 1 Enoch these stars are closely linked with the fallen angels. Their “prison” is described in the same terms as the angels’ prison (21:10: “This place is the prison of the angels”). Clement of Alexandria read Jude 13 in this way: “Wandering stars,—that is, he means those who err and are apostates are of that kind of stars which fell from the seats of the angels—to whom, for their apostasy, the blackness of darkness is reserved forever.”[117]

**The four regions of nature.** The pattern goes further. 1 Enoch opens, immediately after the prophecy Jude quotes in vv. 14–15, with a call to observe the obedience of nature:

> Observe ye everything that takes place in the heaven, how they do not change their orbits, [and] the luminaries which are in the heaven, how they all rise and set in order each in its season, and transgress not against their appointed order. … Behold the summer and the winter, how the whole earth is filled with water, and clouds and dew and rain lie upon it.
>
> — 1 Enoch 2:1, 3 (trans. Charles)

It goes on to the trees (“how the trees cover themselves with green leaves and bear fruit,” 5:1) and the sea (“how the sea and the rivers in like manner accomplish and change not their tasks,” 5:3). Then it turns to the sinners: “But ye—ye have not been steadfast, nor done the commandments of the Lord, But ye have turned away and spoken proud and hard words With your impure mouths against His greatness” (5:4).[118]

Later, 1 Enoch describes how, “in the days of the sinners,” nature itself will fall into disorder: “the rain shall be kept back,” “the fruits of the trees shall be withheld in their time,” and “many chiefs of the stars shall transgress the order (prescribed)” (1 Enoch 80:2–3, 6).[119]

Compare Jude’s four nature images:

| Jude 12–13 | Region | 1 Enoch 2–5: obedient nature | 1 Enoch 80: disorder in the days of sinners |
|---|---|---|---|
| “waterless clouds” | air/sky | “clouds and dew and rain lie upon it” (2:3) | “the rain shall be kept back” (80:2) |
| “autumnal trees without fruit” | earth | “the trees … bear fruit” (5:1) | “the fruits of the trees shall be withheld” (80:3) |
| “wild waves of a sea” | sea | “the sea and the rivers … change not their tasks” (5:3) | — |
| “stars going astray” | heavens | luminaries “transgress not against their appointed order” (2:1) | “many chiefs of the stars shall transgress the order” (80:6) |

The correspondence is striking enough to suggest that Jude had these passages of 1 Enoch in mind. J. B. Mayor drew the same connection for the last image: “ἀστέρες πλανῆται. This is borrowed from Enoch,” citing 1 Enoch 80, “In the days of the sinners, many chiefs of the stars will err, and will alter their orbits and tasks.”[120] Each part of creation has its God-given task: clouds give rain, trees bear fruit, the sea keeps its bounds, and stars keep their courses. The intruders are like nature gone wrong. They fail their purpose as surely as a rainless cloud, a fruitless tree, a sea that will not rest, or a star that leaves its path.

The parallel also explains why Jude’s images move straight into the quotation from Enoch (vv. 14–15). 1 Enoch 1:9, which Jude quotes, stands just before the call to “observe” nature in chapters 2–5. Jude may be moving through a passage he knew well: the nature contrast first, then the prophecy that precedes it in the book.

**What Jude adds.** Jude does not simply repeat 1 Enoch. He applies its cosmic images to people *within* the Christian community, which turns a description of the wicked in general into a warning about leaders the readers know. He also connects the stars’ fate with the language of “keeping” that runs through his letter.

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115. *Testament of Naphtali* 3:2, trans. R. Sinker, ANF 8.↩

116. 1 Enoch 18:13–16; 21:3, 6, 10, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource. Charles’s editorial brackets (⌈ ⌉) are retained where quoted.↩

117. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 13, ANF 2.↩

118. 1 Enoch 2:1, 3; 5:1, 3–4, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource; Charles’s editorial brackets omitted in the block quotation.↩

119. 1 Enoch 80:2–3, 6–7, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.↩

120. J. B. Mayor, *Expositor's Greek Testament* (1910), on Jude 13, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/egt/jude/1.htm. The fourfold correspondence in the table is this book's observation, checked against Charles's translation of 1 Enoch.↩

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**The sea in the ancient Near East.** In the myths of Israel's neighbors, the sea was a chaotic divine power that the storm god had to defeat. Israel's scriptures echo this imagery but transform it. The sea is a creature, powerful but subject to the LORD (Ps 93:3–4). For people who lived mostly inland and knew the sea from the coastline or from dangerous voyages, its restless waves and debris-strewn beaches were familiar images of turmoil.

**Astronomy and astrology.** Educated people in the Greco-Roman world knew the five visible planets (Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn) as "wanderers." Many also believed that the stars and planets influenced human affairs, and astrology was widespread. Jewish and Christian writers generally rejected astrological fatalism. 1 Enoch even warns that sinners will "err and take them to be gods" (80:7). Jude uses the image of wandering stars to describe people who have left their place, not to say anything about the influence of the heavens.

**Darkness and judgment.** In both Jewish and Greek thought, the realm of the dead and the place of punishment were associated with darkness, ζόφος in Homer, "outer darkness" in Jesus' sayings, and the dark prison of the angels in 1 Enoch. Jude draws on this shared imagery.

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Isaiah 57:20–21 (probable allusion).** "The wicked [are] as the driven out sea, / For it is not able to rest, / And its waters cast out filth and mire" (LSV). Jude's image of waves foaming up shame matches the Hebrew of this verse closely.

**Job 38:8–11; Psalm 89:9; Jeremiah 5:22 (shared theme).** God's restraint of the sea's "pride" provides the background against which "wild waves" appear as rebellion.

**James 1:6 (verbal and thematic link).** James compares "he who is doubting" to "a wave of the sea, driven by wind and tossed" (LSV). The verb translated "doubting" (διακρίνομαι, *diakrinomai*) is the same verb Jude uses of those who are "doubting" in v. 22. The restless sea is an image of instability both in James and in Jude.

**Revelation 1:20; 8:10; 9:1; Isaiah 14:12 (shared imagery).** Stars as angels, and fallen stars as images of judgment or of rebellious powers, appear across Scripture. Isaiah's taunt against the king of Babylon, "How you have fallen from the heavens, / O shining one, son of the dawn!" (Isa 14:12, LSV), was later read by many Christian interpreters as a description of Satan's fall.

**Daniel 12:3; Philippians 2:15 (contrast).** The faithful are pictured as stars that shine: "those justifying the multitude as stars for all time and forever" (Dan 12:3, LSV); believers "appear as luminaries in the world" (Phil 2:15, LSV). The wandering stars of Jude 13 are their dark opposite.

**2 Peter 2:17 (literary parallel).** Peter keeps the "gloom of darkness" but applies it to "wells without water, and clouds driven by a storm" (LSV), and drops the waves and stars.

**1 Enoch 2–5; 18; 21; 80 (source tradition).** See the deep dive.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Do the images reflect 1 Enoch?** Many scholars think so, given the correspondence of the four regions of nature and Jude's explicit use of 1 Enoch in the next verses. Others regard the images as drawn more generally from common Jewish and biblical imagery. The parallels with 1 Enoch 2–5 and 80 are strong enough to make the connection probable, though not certain.

**2. What are the "wandering stars"?** Planets, meteors, or stars identified with fallen angels. The Enochic background favors the last, without excluding the ordinary meaning "planets."

**3. Does "forever" imply eternal punishment?** The phrase "has been kept … throughout the age" (εἰς αἰῶνα) uses standard biblical language for permanence. As with "continuous fire" in v. 7, questions about the nature and duration of final judgment belong to the wider biblical and theological discussion. Jude's own concern is to stress the seriousness and finality of the intruders' destiny, in contrast with the readers, who await "continuous life" (v. 21).

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verse 13 completes the application begun in v. 12. The five images (reefs, clouds, trees, waves, stars) have moved from the community's table outward through creation, and they end in darkness. The repetition of "gloom" (ζόφος) from v. 6 and of "kept" (τηρέω) from vv. 1 and 6 ties this conclusion to the beginning of Jude's argument. The intruders' fate is the fate of the rebel angels.

The verse also sets up the next section. The nature imagery of 1 Enoch 2–5 leads naturally to the prophecy of 1 Enoch 1:9, quoted in vv. 14–15, which announces the coming of the Lord to judge “all the impious.” Jude moves from images to prophecy, from picture to proclamation.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Restlessness and peace.** Isaiah’s sea “is not able to rest,” and “There is no peace … for the wicked.” Jude’s wild waves may prompt reflection on how a life without God’s order can be restless, churning, and productive mainly of debris. In contrast, Jude wishes his readers peace (v. 2).

**Order as gift.** The ancient view of the heavens saw order as beautiful and good. Modern readers who value freedom from constraint may find it fruitful to consider how faithfulness to God’s order can be compared to a star keeping its course: not a cage, but the condition of shining.

**Guides who lead astray.** Wandering stars were useless, and dangerous, to navigators. Believers might consider whom they look to for guidance, and how to tell a reliable guide from one who has left the path. They might also consider whether their own lives are guides others can safely follow.

**The beauty of creation’s obedience.** 1 Enoch, and probably Jude, invited readers to observe nature’s faithfulness: rain in its season, fruit in its time, the sea within its bounds, the stars on their courses. In an age of ecological disruption, that invitation may take on new resonance. Though ancient writers did not imagine modern environmental science, the conviction that human sin and creation’s disorder are connected runs through Scripture (Gen 3:17–18; Rom 8:19–22). The application must be made carefully, but it is not foreign to the biblical vision.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Why do you think Jude used images from nature (clouds, trees, sea, stars) to describe people? What do these images communicate that plain description could not?
2. Read 1 Enoch 2:1–5:4 and 80:2–8 (or the excerpts in this chapter). Do you find the connection with Jude 12–13 convincing? What difference does it make to your reading?
3. Isaiah says the wicked are like a sea that “is not able to rest.” What forms of restlessness do you observe in contemporary life, and what might Jude’s image suggest about their source?

4. Daniel pictures the faithful as stars that shine forever, and Jude pictures the intruders as stars headed for darkness. What do you think it means for a believer to “keep course” like a star?
5. How might the ancient conviction that creation displays God’s order shape the way Christians relate to the natural world today?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT; Text-Critical Greek NT notes on εἰς (τὸν) αἰῶνα.
- 1 Enoch 2:1–3; 5:1–4; 18:13–16; 21:1–10; 80:2–8, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.
- *Testament of Naphtali* 3:2, ANF 8.
- Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 13, ANF 2.
- LXX Isa 57:20 (Brenton’s Greek Septuagint).
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. ἐπαφρίζω, πλανήτης, ζόφος.
- J. B. Mayor, *Expositor’s Greek Testament* (1910), on v. 13 (public domain).

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Genesis 1:2

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**2** וְהָאָרֶץ הָיְתָה תֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ וְחֹשֶׁךְ עַל־פְּנֵי תְהוֹם וְרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים מְרַחֶפֶת עַל־פְּנֵי הַמָּיִם

*English (BSB)*

**2** Now the earth was formless and void, and darkness was over the surface of the deep. And the Spirit of God was hovering over the surface of the waters.

*English (WEB)*

**2** The earth was formless and empty. Darkness was on the surface of the deep and God’s Spirit was hovering over the surface of the waters.

### Genesis 3:17–18

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**17** וּלְאָדָם אָמַר כִּי־שָׁמַעְתָּ לְקוֹל אִשְׁתֶּךָ וַתֹּאכַל מִן־הָעֵץ אֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתִיךָ לֵאמֹר לֹא תֹאכַל מִמֶּנּוּ
אֲרוּרָה הָאֲדָמָה בַּעֲבוּרֶךָ בְּעִצָּבוֹן תֹּאכְלֶנָּה כֹּל יְמֵי חַיֶּיךָ **18** וְקוֹץ וְדַרְדַּר תַּצְמִיחַ לָךְ וְאָכַלְתָּ אֶת־
עֵשֶׂב הַשָּׂדֶה

*English (BSB)*

**17** And to Adam He said: “Because you have listened to the voice of your wife and have eaten from the tree of which I commanded you not to eat, cursed is the ground because of you; through toil you will eat of it all the days of your life. **18** Both thorns and thistles it will yield for you, and you will eat the plants of the field.

*English (WEB)*

**17** To Adam he said, “Because you have listened to your wife’s voice, and have eaten from the tree, about which I commanded you, saying, ‘You shall not eat of it,’ the ground is cursed for your sake. You will eat from it with much labor all the days of your life. **18** It will yield thorns and thistles to you; and you will eat the herb of the field.

### Job 38:7–11

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**7** בְּרָן־יַחַד כּוֹכְבֵי בֹקֶר וַיָּרִיעוּ כָּל־בְּנֵי אֱלֹהִים **8** וַיָּסֶךְ בְּדָלָתַיִם יָם בְּגִיחוֹ מֵרֶחֶם יֵצֵא **9** בְּשׂוּמִי עָנָן
לְבֻשׁוֹ וַעֲרָפֶל חֲתֻלָּתוֹ **10** וָאֶשְׁבֹּר עָלָיו חֻקִּי וָאָשִׂים בְּרִיחַ וּדְלָתָיִם **11** וָאֹמַר עַד־פֹּה תָּבוֹא וְלֹא
תֹסִיף וּפֹא־יָשִׁית בִּגְאוֹן גַּלֶּיךָ

*English (BSB)*

**7** while the morning stars sang together and all the sons of God shouted for joy? **8** Who enclosed the sea behind doors when it burst forth from the womb, **9** when I made the clouds its garment and thick darkness its blanket, **10** when I fixed its boundaries and set in place its bars and doors, **11** and I declared: ‘You may come this far, but no farther; here your proud waves must stop’?

*English (WEB)*

**7** when the morning stars sang together, and all the sons of God shouted for joy? **8** “Or who shut up the sea with doors, when it broke out of the womb, **9**

when I made clouds its garment, and wrapped it in thick darkness, **10** marked out for it my bound, set bars and doors, **11** and said, ‘You may come here, but no further. Your proud waves shall be stopped here’?

### Psalm 89:9

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**9 [89:10]** אַתָּה מוֹשֵׁל בִּגְאוּת הַיָּם בְּשׂוֹא גַלָּיו אַתָּה תְּשַׁבְּחֵם

*English (BSB)*

**9** You rule the raging sea; when its waves mount up, You still them.

*English (WEB)*

**9** You rule the pride of the sea. When its waves rise up, you calm them.

### Psalm 93:3–4

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**3** נָשְׂאוּ נְהָרוֹת יְהוָה נָשְׂאוּ נְהָרוֹת קוֹלָם יִשְׂאוּ נְהָרוֹת דָּכְיָם **4** מִקֹּלוֹת מַיִם רַבִּים אַדִּירִים מִשְׁבְּרֵי־יָם
אַדִּיר בַּמָּרוֹם יְהוָה

*English (BSB)*

**3** The floodwaters have risen, O LORD; the rivers have raised their voice; the seas lift up their pounding waves. **4** Above the roar of many waters— the mighty breakers of the sea— the LORD on high is majestic.

*English (WEB)*

**3** The floods have lifted up, LORD, the floods have lifted up their voice. The floods lift up their waves. **4** Above the voices of many waters, the mighty breakers of the sea, the LORD on high is mighty.

### Psalm 148:3, 6

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**3** הַלְלוּהוּ שֶׁמֶשׁ וְיָרֵחַ הַלְלוּהוּ כָּל־כּוֹכְבֵי אוֹר … **6** וַיַּעֲמִידֵם לָעַד לְעוֹלָם חָק־נָתַן וְלֹא יַעֲבוֹר

*English (BSB)*

**3** Praise Him, O sun and moon; praise Him, all you shining stars. … **6** He established them forever and ever; He issued a decree that will never pass

away.

*English (WEB)*

**3** Praise him, sun and moon! Praise him, all you shining stars! … **6** He has also established them forever and ever. He has made a decree which will not pass away.

### Isaiah 14:12

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**12** אֵיךְ נָפַלְתָּ מִשָּׁמַיִם הֵילֵל בֶּן־שָׁחַר נִגְדַּעְתָּ לָאָרֶץ חוֹלֵשׁ עַל־גּוֹיִם

*English (BSB)*

**12** How you have fallen from heaven, O day star, son of the dawn! You have been cut down to the ground, O destroyer of nations.

*English (WEB)*

**12** How you have fallen from heaven, shining one, son of the dawn! How you are cut down to the ground, who laid the nations low!

### Isaiah 57:20–21

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**20** וְהָרְשָׁעִים כַּיָּם נִגָּרֵשׁ כִּי הַשָּׁקֵט לֹא יוּכָל וַיִּגְרְשׁוּ מַיָּמָיו רֶפֶשׁ וָטִיט **21** אֵין שָׁלוֹם אָמַר אֱלֹהַי לָרְשָׁעִים

*English (BSB)*

**20** But the wicked are like the storm-tossed sea, for it cannot be still, and its waves churn up mire and muck. **21** “There is no peace,” says my God, “for the wicked.”

*English (WEB)*

**20** But the wicked are like the troubled sea; for it can’t rest and its waters cast up mire and mud. **21** “There is no peace”, says my God, “for the wicked.”

### Jeremiah 5:22

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**22** הַאוֹתִי לֹא־תִירָאוּ נְאֻם־יְהוָה אִם מִפָּנַי לֹא תָחִילוּ אֲשֶׁר־שַׂמְתִּי חוֹל גְּבוּל לַיָּם חָק־עוֹלָם וְלֹא יַעַבְרֶנְהוּ וַיִּתְגָּעֲשׁוּ וְלֹא יוּכָלוּ וְהָמוּ גַלָּיו וְלֹא יַעַבְרֶנְהוּ

*English (BSB)*

**22** Do you not fear Me?” declares the LORD. “Do you not tremble before Me, the One who set the sand as the boundary for the sea, an enduring barrier it cannot cross? The waves surge, but they cannot prevail. They roar but cannot cross it.

*English (WEB)*

**22** Don’t you fear me?’ says the LORD; ‘Won’t you tremble at my presence, who have placed the sand for the bound of the sea by a perpetual decree, that it can’t pass it? Though its waves toss themselves, yet they can’t prevail. Though they roar, they still can’t pass over it.’

## Jeremiah 31:35

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**35** כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה נֹתֵן שֶׁמֶשׁ לְאוֹר יוֹמָם חֻקּוֹת יָרֵחַ וְכוֹכָבִים לְאוֹר לָיְלָה רֹגַע הַיָּם וַיֶּהֱמוּ גַּלָּיו יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת שְׁמוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**35** Thus says the LORD, who gives the sun for light by day, who sets in order the moon and stars for light by night, who stirs up the sea so that its waves roar—the LORD of Hosts is His name:

*English (WEB)*

**35** The LORD, who gives the sun for a light by day, and the ordinances of the moon and of the stars for a light by night, who stirs up the sea, so that its waves roar— the LORD of Armies is his name, says:

## Daniel 12:3

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**3** וְהַמַּשְׂכִּלִים יַזְהִרוּ כְּזֹהַר הָרָקִיעַ וּמַצְדִּיקֵי הָרַבִּים כַּכּוֹכָבִים לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד

*English (BSB)*

**3** Then the wise will shine like the brightness of the heavens, and those who lead many to righteousness will shine like the stars forever and ever.

*English (WEB)*

**3** Those who are wise will shine as the brightness of the expanse. Those who turn many to righteousness will shine as the stars forever and ever.

## Matthew 8:12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**12** οἱ δὲ υἱοὶ τῆς βασιλείας ἐκβληθήσονται εἰς τὸ σκότος τὸ ἐξώτερον· ἐκεῖ ἔσται ὁ κλαυθμὸς καὶ ὁ βρυγμὸς τῶν ὀδόντων.

*English (BSB)*

**12** But the sons of the kingdom will be thrown into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

*English (WEB)*

**12** but the children of the Kingdom will be thrown out into the outer darkness. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.”

## Romans 8:19–22

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** ἡ γὰρ ἀποκαραδοκία τῆς κτίσεως τὴν ἀποκάλυψιν τῶν υἱῶν τοῦ θεοῦ ἀπεκδέχεται· **20** τῇ γὰρ ματαιότητι ἡ κτίσις ὑπετάγη, οὐχ ἑκοῦσα ἀλλὰ διὰ τὸν ὑποτάξαντα, ἐφ’ ἐλπίδι **21** ὅτι καὶ αὐτὴ ἡ κτίσις ἐλευθερωθήσεται ἀπὸ τῆς δουλείας τῆς φθορᾶς εἰς τὴν ἐλευθερίαν τῆς δόξης τῶν τέκνων τοῦ θεοῦ. **22** οἴδαμεν γὰρ ὅτι πᾶσα ἡ κτίσις συστενάζει καὶ συνωδίνει ἄχρι τοῦ νῦν·

*English (BSB)*

**19** The creation waits in eager expectation for the revelation of the sons of God. **20** For the creation was subjected to futility, not by its own will, but because of the One who subjected it, in hope **21** that the creation itself will be set free from its bondage to decay and brought into the glorious freedom of the children of God. **22** We know that the whole creation has been groaning together in the pains of childbirth until the present time.

*English (WEB)*

**19** For the creation waits with eager expectation for the children of God to be revealed. **20** For the creation was subjected to vanity, not of its own will, but because of him who subjected it, in hope **21** that the creation itself also will be delivered from the bondage of decay into the liberty of the glory of the children of God. **22** For we know that the whole creation groans and travails in pain together until now.

## Philippians 2:15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** ἵνα γένησθε ἄμεμπτοι καὶ ἀκέραιοι, τέκνα θεοῦ ἄμωμα μέσον γενεᾶς σκολιᾶς καὶ διεστραμμένης, ἐν οἷς φαίνεσθε ὡς φωστῆρες ἐν κόσμῳ

*English (BSB)*

**15** so that you may be blameless and pure, children of God without fault in a crooked and perverse generation, in which you shine as lights in the world

*English (WEB)*

**15** that you may become blameless and harmless, children of God without defect in the middle of a crooked and perverse generation, among whom you are seen as lights in the world,

## Philippians 3:19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** ὧν τὸ τέλος ἀπώλεια, ὧν ὁ θεὸς ἡ κοιλία καὶ ἡ δόξα ἐν τῇ αἰσχύνῃ αὐτῶν, οἱ τὰ ἐπίγεια φρονοῦντες.

*English (BSB)*

**19** Their end is destruction, their god is their belly, and their glory is in their shame. Their minds are set on earthly things.

*English (WEB)*

**19** whose end is destruction, whose god is the belly, and whose glory is in their shame, who think about earthly things.

## James 1:6

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** αἰτείτω δὲ ἐν πίστει, μηδὲν διακρινόμενος, ὁ γὰρ διακρινόμενος ἔοικεν κλύδωνι θαλάσσης ἀνεμιζομένῳ καὶ ῥιπιζομένῳ·

*English (BSB)*

**6** But he must ask in faith, without doubting, because he who doubts is like a wave of the sea, blown and tossed by the wind.

*English (WEB)*

**6** But let him ask in faith, without any doubting, for he who doubts is like a wave of the sea, driven by the wind and tossed.

## 2 Peter 2:17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**17** Οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται.

*English (BSB)*

**17** These men are springs without water and mists driven by a storm. Blackest darkness is reserved for them.

*English (WEB)*

**17** These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

## Revelation 1:20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** τὸ μυστήριον τῶν ἑπτὰ ἀστέρων οὓς εἶδες ἐπὶ τῆς δεξιᾶς μου, καὶ τὰς ἑπτὰ λυχνίας τὰς χρυσᾶς· οἱ ἑπτὰ ἀστέρες ἄγγελοι τῶν ἑπτὰ ἐκκλησιῶν εἰσίν, καὶ αἱ λυχνίαι αἱ ἑπτὰ ἑπτὰ ἐκκλησίαι εἰσίν.

*English (BSB)*

**20** This is the mystery of the seven stars you saw in My right hand and of the seven golden lampstands: The seven stars are the angels of the seven churches, and the seven lampstands are the seven churches.

*English (WEB)*

**20** The mystery of the seven stars which you saw in my right hand, and the seven golden lamp stands is this: The seven stars are the angels of the seven assemblies. The seven lamp stands are seven assemblies.

## Revelation 8:10

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** Καὶ ὁ τρίτος ἄγγελος ἐσάλπισεν· καὶ ἔπεσεν ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ ἀστὴρ μέγας καιόμενος ὡς λαμπάς, καὶ ἔπεσεν ἐπὶ τὸ τρίτον τῶν ποταμῶν καὶ ἐπὶ τὰς πηγὰς τῶν ὑδάτων.

*English (BSB)*

**10** Then the third angel sounded his trumpet, and a great star burning like a torch fell from heaven and landed on a third of the rivers and on the springs of water.

*English (WEB)*

**10** The third angel sounded, and a great star fell from the sky, burning like a torch, and it fell on one third of the rivers, and on the springs of water.

### Revelation 9:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Καὶ ὁ πέμπτος ἄγγελος ἐσάλπισεν· καὶ εἶδον ἀστέρα ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ πεπτωκότα εἰς τὴν γῆν, καὶ ἐδόθη αὐτῷ ἡ κλεὶς τοῦ φρέατος τῆς ἀβύσσου·

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the fifth angel sounded his trumpet, and I saw a star that had fallen from heaven to earth, and it was given the key to the pit of the Abyss.

*English (WEB)*

**1** The fifth angel sounded, and I saw a star from the sky which had fallen to the earth. The key to the pit of the abyss was given to him.

### 1 Enoch 1:9

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**9** And behold! He cometh with ten thousands of His holy ones To execute judgement upon all, And to destroy all the ungodly: And to convict all flesh Of all the works of their ungodliness which they have ungodly committed, And of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against Him.

### 1 Enoch 2

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** Observe ye everything that takes place in the heaven, how they do not change their orbits, and the luminaries which are in the heaven, how they all rise and set in order each in its season, and transgress not against their appointed order. **2** Behold ye the earth, and give heed to the things which take place upon it from first to last, how steadfast they are, how none of the things upon earth change, but all the works of God appear to you. **3** Behold the summer and the winter, how the whole earth is filled with water, and clouds and dew and rain lie upon it.

### 1 Enoch 3

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** Observe and see how (in the winter) all the trees seem as though they had withered and shed all their leaves, except fourteen trees, which do not lose

their foliage but retain the old foliage from two to three years till the new comes.

## 1 Enoch 4

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And again, observe ye the days of summer how the sun is above the earth over against it. And you seek shade and shelter by reason of the heat of the sun, and the earth also burns with growing heat, and so you cannot tread on the earth, or on a rock by reason of its heat.

## 1 Enoch 5

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** Observe ye how the trees cover themselves with green leaves and bear fruit: wherefore give ye heed and know with regard to all His works, and recognize how He that liveth for ever hath made them so. **2** And all His works go on thus from year to year for ever, and all the tasks which they accomplish for Him, and their tasks change not, but according as God hath ordained so is it done. **3** And behold how the sea and the rivers in like manner accomplish and change not their tasks from His commandments. **4** But ye—ye have not been steadfast, nor done the commandments of the Lord, But ye have turned away and spoken proud and hard words With your impure mouths against His greatness. Oh, ye hard-hearted, ye shall find no peace. **5** Therefore shall ye execrate your days, And the years of your life shall perish, And the years of your destruction shall be multiplied in eternal execration, And ye shall find no mercy. **6** In those days ye shall make your names an eternal execration unto all the righteous, b. And by you shall all who curse, curse, And all the sinners and godless shall imprecate by you, And all the . . . shall rejoice, e. And there shall be forgiveness of sins, f. And every mercy and peace and forbearance: g. There shall be salvation unto them, a goodly light. i. And for all of you sinners there shall be no salvation, j. But on you all shall abide a curse. **7** And for you the godless there shall be a curse. But for the elect there shall be light and joy and peace, b. And they shall inherit the earth. **8** And then there shall be bestowed upon the elect wisdom, And they shall all live and never again sin, Either through ungodliness or through pride: But they who are wise shall be humble. **9** And they shall not again transgress, Nor shall they sin all the days of their life, Nor shall they die of (the divine) anger or wrath, But they shall complete the number of the days of their life. And their lives shall be increased in peace, And the years of their joy shall be multiplied, In eternal gladness and peace, All the days of their life.

## 1 Enoch 18

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** I saw the treasuries of all the winds: I saw how He had furnished with them the whole creation and the firm foundations of the earth. **2** And I saw the corner-stone of the earth: I saw the four winds which bear [the earth and] the firmament of the heaven. **3** And I saw how the winds stretch out the vaults of heaven, and have their station between heaven and earth: these are the pillars of the heaven. **4** I saw the winds of heaven which turn and bring the circumference of the sun and all the stars to their setting. **5** I saw the winds on the earth carrying the clouds: I saw the paths of the angels. I saw at the end of the earth the firmament of the heaven above. **6** And I proceeded and saw a place which burns day and night, where there are seven mountains of magnificent stones, three towards the east, and three towards the south. **7** And as for those towards the east, one was of coloured stone, and one of pearl, and one of jacinth, and those towards the south of red stone. **8** But the middle one reached to heaven like the throne of God, of alabaster, and the summit of the throne was of sapphire. **9** And I saw a flaming fire. **10** And beyond these mountains Is a region the end of the great earth: there the heavens were completed. **11** And I saw a deep abyss, with columns of heavenly fire, and among them I saw columns of fire fall, which were beyond measure alike towards the height and towards the depth. **12** And beyond that abyss I saw a place which had no firmament of the heaven above, and no firmly founded earth beneath it: there was no water upon it, and no birds, but it was a waste and horrible place. **13** I saw there seven stars like great burning mountains, and to me, when I inquired regarding them, **14** The angel said: 'This place is the end of heaven and earth: this has become a prison for the stars and the host of heaven. **15** And the stars which roll over the fire are they which have transgressed the commandment of the Lord in the beginning of their rising, because they did not come forth at their appointed times. **16** And He was wroth with them, and bound them till the time when their guilt should be consummated (even) for ten thousand years.'

## 1 Enoch 21

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And I proceeded to where things were chaotic. **2** And I saw there something horrible: I saw neither a heaven above nor a firmly founded earth, but a place chaotic and horrible. **3** And there I saw seven stars of the heaven bound together in it, like great mountains and burning with fire. **4** Then I said: 'For what sin are they bound, and on what account have they been cast in hither?' **5** Then said Uriel, one of the holy angels, who was with me, and was chief over them, and said: 'Enoch, why dost thou ask, and why art thou eager for the truth? **6** These are of the number of the stars of heaven, which have transgressed the commandment of the Lord, and are bound here till ten

thousand years, the time entailed by their sins, are consummated.' **7** And from thence I went to another place, which was still more horrible than the former, and I saw a horrible thing: a great fire there which burnt and blazed, and the place was cleft as far as the abyss, being full of great descending columns of fire: neither its extent or magnitude could I see, nor could I conjecture. **8** Then I said: 'How fearful is the place and how terrible to look upon!' **9** Then Uriel answered me, one of the holy angels who was with me, and said unto me: 'Enoch, why hast thou such fear and affright?' And I answered: 'Because of this fearful place, and because of the spectacle of the pain.' **10** And he said unto me: 'This place is the prison of the angels, and here they will be imprisoned for ever.'

## 1 Enoch 80

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And in those days the angel Uriel answered and said to me: 'Behold, I have shown thee everything, Enoch, and I have revealed everything to thee that thou shouldst see this sun and this moon, and the leaders of the stars of the heaven and all those who turn them, their tasks and times and departures. **2** And in the days of the sinners the years shall be shortened, And their seed shall be tardy on their lands and fields, And all things on the earth shall alter, And shall not appear in their time: And the rain shall be kept back And the heaven shall withhold (it). **3** And in those times the fruits of the earth shall be backward, And shall not grow in their time, And the fruits of the trees shall be withheld in their time. **4** And the moon shall alter her order, And not appear at her time. **5** [And in those days the sun shall be seen and he shall journey in the evening on the extremity of the great chariot in the west] And shall shine more brightly than accords with the order of light. **6** And many chiefs of the stars shall transgress the order (prescribed). And these shall alter their orbits and tasks, And not appear at the seasons prescribed to them. **7** And the whole order of the stars shall be concealed from the sinners, And the thoughts of those on the earth shall err concerning them, [And they shall be altered from all their ways], Yea, they shall err and take them to be gods. **8** And evil shall be multiplied upon them, And punishment shall come upon them So as to destroy all.'

# Chapter 8. Enoch, the Seventh from Adam (Jude 14–15)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **14** Προεφήτευσεν δὲ καὶ τούτοις ἕβδομος ἀπὸ Ἀδὰμ Ἐνὼχ λέγων· Ἰδοὺ ἦλθεν κύριος ἐν ἁγίαις μυριάσιν αὐτοῦ, **15** ποιῆσαι κρίσιν κατὰ πάντων καὶ ἐλέγξαι πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς περὶ πάντων τῶν ἔργων ἀσεβείας αὐτῶν ὧν ἠσέβησαν καὶ περὶ πάντων τῶν σκληρῶν ὧν ἐλάλησαν κατ’ αὐτοῦ ἁμαρτωλοὶ ἀσεβεῖς.
>
> — Jude 14–15, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript’s first hand, and $^{\text{corr}}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | ἐν ἁγίαις μυριάσιν αὐτοῦ | ‘with his holy myriads’ | A B K L |
| 14 | ἐν μυριάσιν ἁγίαις αὐτοῦ | (word order only) | C 1739 |
| 14 | ἐν ἁγίων ἀγγέλων μυριάσιν | ‘with myriads of holy angels’ | P72 |
| 14 | ἐν μυριάσιν ἁγίων ἀγγέλων | ‘with myriads of holy angels’ | א |
| 14 | ἐν ἁγίαις μυριάσιν ἀγγέλων | ‘with holy myriads of angels’ | Ψ |
| 15 | πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς | ‘all the impious’ | A B C Ψ |

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 15 | πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς αὐτῶν | ‘all their impious ones’ | K L |
| 15 | πάντας ἀσεβεῖς | ‘all impious people’ | 1739 |
| 15 | πᾶσαν ψυχήν | ‘every soul’ | P72 ℵ |
| 15 | τῶν ἔργων ἀσεβείας αὐτῶν | ‘their impious deeds’ | A B K L |
| 15 | τῶν ἔργων αὐτῶν | ‘their deeds’ | C |
| 15 | τῶν ἔργων | ‘the deeds’ | ℵ 1739 |
| 15 | the whole clause “concerning all their impious deeds … and” is absent | | P72 |
| 15 | τῶν σκληρῶν | ‘the harsh things’ | P72 A B Ψ K L |
| 15 | τῶν σκληρῶν λόγων | ‘the harsh words’ | ℵ C 1739 |

Notes. v. 14: not extant in P78. v. 15: not extant in P78.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

#### Jude 14

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Enoch the seventh from Adam prophesied before of suche saying: Beholde the lorde shall come with thousandes of sayntes |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | And Enoch also the seuenth from Adam, prophecied of such, saying, Beholde, the Lord commeth with thousands of his Saints, |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Now of these Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying: Behold, the Lord cometh with thousands of his saints, |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | And Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied of these, saying, Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints, |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | Yea, and against these Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying, “Behold, the Lord cometh in the midst of his holy myriads, |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | And to these also Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying, Behold, the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones, |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | And Enoch, [the] seventh from Adam, prophesied also as to these, saying, Behold, [the] Lord has come amidst his holy myriads, |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | And prophesy also to these did the seventh from Adam — Enoch — saying, 'Lo, the Lord did come in His saintly myriads, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | And to these also Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying, Behold, the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones, |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | About these also Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied, saying, "Behold, the Lord came with ten thousands of his holy ones, |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Enoch, the sixth person in the line of people who descended from Adam, prophesied this about those teachers of false doctrine: "Listen carefully to this: The Lord will certainly come with a countless number of his holy angels in order |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | To these people, as to others, Enoch, the seventh in descent from Adam, declared – 'See! The Lord has come with his hosts of holy ones around him, |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied about them, saying, "Look! The Lord is coming with thousands and thousands of his holy ones. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Enoch, seven generations on from Adam, spoke prophetically about these people: "Look! The Lord is coming, together with thousands and thousands of his holy ones |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | And Enoch, the seventh from Adam, also prophesied to these, saying, "Behold, the LORD has come with myriads of His holy ones, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Enoch, the seventh from Adam, also prophesied about them: "Behold, the Lord is coming with myriads of His holy ones |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Enoch, the seventh from Adam, also prophesied about them: "Behold, the Lord is coming with myriads of His holy ones |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Enoch, in the seventh generation from Adam, prophesied about these men, saying, “Behold, the Lord is coming with thousands upon thousands of his holy ones |

### Jude 15

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | to geve iudgement agaynst all men and to rebuke all that are vngodly amonge them of all their vngodly dedes which they have vngodly committed and of all their cruell speakynges which vngodly sinners have spoken agaynst him. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | To giue iudgement against al men, and to rebuke all the vngodly among them of all their wicked deeds, which they haue vngodly committed, and of all their cruel speakings, which wicked sinners haue spoken against him. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | To execute judgment upon all, and to reprove all the ungodly for all the works of their ungodliness, whereby they have done ungodly, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against God. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | To execute judgment upon all, and to convict all that are ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have impiously committed, and of all their hard speeches which ungodly sinners have spoken against him. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | to execute judgment upon all, and to convict all the ungodly among them of all the deeds of their ungodliness which they committed; and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners spoke against him.” |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | to execute judgment upon all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their works of ungodliness which they have ungodly wrought, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | to execute judgment against all; and to convict all the ungodly of them of all their works of ungodliness, which they have wrought ungodlily, and of all the hard [things] which ungodly sinners have spoken against him. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | to do judgment against all, and to convict all their impious ones, concerning all their works of impiety that they did impiously, and concerning all the stiff things that speak against Him did impious sinners.' |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | to execute judgment upon all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their works of ungodliness which they have ungodly wrought, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | to execute judgment on all, and to convict all the ungodly of all their works of ungodliness which they have done in an ungodly way, and of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against him." |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | to judge everyone, and to punish all wicked and ◄ungodly people/people whose lives are displeasing to God► for all the ◄ungodly things/things that displease God► that they did in ◄an ungodly way/a way that displeases God►, and for all the harsh things that ungodly sinful people have spoken against him." |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | to execute judgment on all people, and to convict all godless people of all their godless acts, which in their ungodliness they have committed, and of all the harsh words which they have spoken against him, godless sinners that they are!' |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | He is coming to execute judgment on everyone. He is coming to convict all the ungodly of all the works they have done in an ungodly way, and of all the harsh words that ungodly sinners have spoken against him." |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | to judge everyone, to reveal all the wicked things people have done, and all the terrible things hostile sinners have said against him." |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | to do judgment against all, and to convict all their impious ones, concerning all their works of impiety that they did impiously, and concerning all the harsh [words] that impious sinners spoke against Him." |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | to execute judgment on everyone, and to convict all the ungodly of every ungodly act |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | of wickedness and every harsh word spoken against Him by ungodly sinners.” |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | to execute judgment on everyone, and to convict all the ungodly among them of every ungodly act of wickedness and every harsh word spoken against Him by ungodly sinners.” |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | to execute judgment against all, and to convict all the ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds that they have done in an ungodly way, and to convict ungodly sinners of all the harsh words they have spoken against him.” |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Jude now quotes a prophecy attributed to Enoch, the ancient patriarch who “habitually walks with God, and he is not, for God has taken him” (Gen 5:24, LSV). The prophecy announces that the Lord comes with countless holy angels to judge everyone and to convict the ungodly of all their ungodly deeds and of all the harsh words they have spoken against him. Jude says that Enoch prophesied “to,” or about, “these,” the intruders. He sees the ancient prophecy as describing people in his own community.

The quotation comes from the opening chapter of the book known today as **1 Enoch**, a Jewish writing composed in stages over the last centuries before Christ. This is the only explicit quotation in Jude, and the clearest case in the New Testament of a Jewish writing from outside the Hebrew Bible being quoted and introduced as prophecy. It has raised questions from the second century to the present: Did Jude regard 1 Enoch as Scripture? What does his quotation imply about the book’s authority? This chapter looks first at what the quotation says and how Jude uses it, and then turns to the questions of canon.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### ἕβδομος ἀπὸ Ἀδὰμ Ἑνώχ (*hebdomos apo Adam Henōch*) — ‘Enoch, the seventh from Adam’

Genesis 5 lists the generations from Adam to Noah: Adam, Seth, Enosh, Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared, Enoch (cf. 1 Chr 1:1–3). Counting Adam as the first, as ancient counting usually did, Enoch is the seventh: ἕβδομος ἀπὸ Ἀδάμ (*hebdomos apo Adam*), “seventh from Adam.” The phrase appears in 1 Enoch itself, where Noah refers to his great-grandfather as “taken up, the seventh

from Adam, the first man whom the Lord of Spirits created" (1 Enoch 60:8), and where Enoch says, "I was born the seventh in the first week" (1 Enoch 93:3).[121]

The description does three things:

1. **It identifies him.** There was another Enoch, Cain's son, after whom Cain named a city (Gen 4:17). Jude means the righteous Enoch of Seth's line.
2. **It stresses antiquity.** Enoch lived before the flood, in the seventh generation of humanity. His prophecy is among the oldest words of God imaginable. Calvin saw this as Jude's purpose: "he says expressly that he was the seventh from Adam, in order to commend the antiquity of the prophecy, because it existed in the world before the flood."[122]
3. **It may suggest completeness.** Seven was a number of fullness and perfection in Jewish thought. The "seventh" from Adam was a person of special standing, the one who "walks with God" and was taken by God. Jude does not draw attention to the symbolism, but his readers may have felt it.

Genesis says that Enoch "habitually walks with God" and that "God has taken him" (Gen 5:24, LSV). Hebrews adds: "By faith Enoch was translated—not to see death … for before his translation he had been testified to—that he had pleased God well" (Heb 11:5, LSV). A man so close to God and taken from the earth without dying was an ideal recipient of revelation, and Jewish tradition attributed to him visions of heaven, of the secrets of the cosmos, and of the final judgment.

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121. 1 Enoch 60:8; 93:3, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.↩

122. John Calvin, *Commentaries on the Catholic Epistles*, trans. John Owen (1855), on Jude 14.↩

### Προεφήτευσεν δὲ καὶ τούτοις (*Proephēteusen de kai toutois*) — 'prophesied also about these'

The verb προεφήτευσεν (*proephēteusen*), "prophesied," is significant. Jude does not say that Enoch "wrote" or that "it is written." He says that Enoch prophesied. The word "also" (καί, *kai*) links this prophecy to the other evidence Jude has presented: Israel's history, the angels, Sodom, Michael, Cain, Balaam, and Korah all testify against the intruders, and so does Enoch.

The dative τούτοις (*toutois*), "to these," is best understood as "about these" or "with reference to these." Jude does not claim that Enoch foresaw these particular individuals by name. He claims that the people Enoch described, the "impious" whom the Lord will judge, are people like these. This is the same way of reading prophecy found in the Dead Sea Scrolls and elsewhere in the

New Testament: ancient words are understood as speaking to the reader's own time.

### λέγων· Ἰδοὺ ἦλθεν κύριος (*legōn: Idou ēlthen kyrios*) — 'saying: see, the Lord has come'

The quotation opens with Ἰδού (*Idou*), "Behold!" or "Look!", a prophetic call to attention.

"The LORD" translates κύριος (*kyrios*). The LSV prints it in capitals because the reference is to the God of Israel. In 1 Enoch, the subject is God: "And behold! He cometh with ten thousands of His holy ones" (1 Enoch 1:9, trans. Charles). In Jude, however, "Lord" most often refers to Jesus (vv. 4, 17, 21; also, on some readings, v. 5). Many interpreters think Jude understands the coming Lord of Enoch's prophecy to be Jesus Christ at his return. That would be a further instance of the pattern seen in v. 5 and v. 4: language about the God of Israel applied to Jesus. The New Testament repeatedly pictures Jesus coming "with all His holy ones" (1 Thess 3:13, LSV) and "with messengers of His power" (2 Thess 1:7, LSV).

The verb ἦλθεν (*ēlthen*) is in the aorist, "came" (LSV: "has come"). In the context of a prophecy of future judgment, the past tense expresses certainty. Hebrew prophets often spoke of future events in the perfect tense, as though already accomplished, and Jude's Greek reproduces the effect. Some interpreters suggest that the past tense reflects the Aramaic or Greek form of Enoch that Jude knew.

### ἐν ἁγίαις μυριάσιν αὐτοῦ (*en hagiais myriasin autou*) — 'with his holy myriads'

The phrase ἐν ἁγίαις μυριάσιν αὐτοῦ (*en hagiais myriasin autou*), "with his holy myriads," means "with tens of thousands of his holy ones." A μυριάς (*myrias*) is ten thousand, and the plural means "countless thousands." The "holy ones" are angels, the heavenly army that accompanies God in his appearing.

The image goes back to the theophany at Sinai, as described in Moses' blessing: "YHWH has come from Sinai, / And has risen from Seir for them; He has shone from Mount Paran, / And has come [with] myriads of holy ones" (Deut 33:2, LSV). 1 Enoch's opening deliberately echoes this. It describes God coming to "tread upon the earth, (even) on Mount Sinai" (1 Enoch 1:4).[123] Zechariah also foresees the day when "my God YHWH has come in, / All holy ones [are] with You" (Zech 14:5, LSV). Jesus speaks of the Son of Man coming "in His glory, and all the holy messengers with Him" (Matt 25:31, LSV).

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123. 1 Enoch 1:3–4, trans. R. H. Charles (1917): “The Holy Great One will come forth from His dwelling, And the eternal God will tread upon the earth, (even) on Mount Sinai.”↩

### ποιῆσαι κρίσιν κατὰ πάντων (*poiēsai krisin kata pantōn*) — ‘to execute judgment on all’

The purpose of the coming is ποιῆσαι κρίσιν κατὰ πάντων (*poiēsai krisin kata pantōn*), “to execute judgment against all.” The word “all” (πᾶς, *pas*) is repeated four times in the quotation: judgment on all, convicting all, concerning all their works, concerning all the harsh words. The judgment is universal and complete. Nothing escapes.

### καὶ ἐλέγξαι πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς (*kai elenxai pantas tous asebeis*) — ‘and to convict all the impious’

The verb ἐλέγξαι (*elenxai*) means “to expose, convict, prove guilty.” It is the language of a courtroom in which guilt is demonstrated. Jesus says that the Spirit “will convict the world concerning sin, and concerning righteousness, and concerning judgment” (John 16:8, LSV).

**A textual note.** The object of “convict” varies in the manuscripts:

| Edition | Reading | Translation |
|---|---|---|
| SBLGNT, WH, Tregelles | πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς | “all the impious” |
| Robinson–Pierpont (Byzantine), TR | πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς αὐτῶν | “all their impious ones” (LSV) |
| NA28 | πᾶσαν ψυχήν | “every soul” |

The NA28 reading, “every soul,” corresponds more closely to the wording of 1 Enoch 1:9, “to convict all flesh” in Charles’s translation, and the NA28 editors judged it original. The SBLGNT editors preferred “all the impious,” which fits Jude’s emphasis on the word “impious.” The LSV follows the Byzantine reading with “their.” The difference does not affect the sense of the passage: on any reading, the ungodly are convicted.[124] (The TR also reads ἐξελέγξαι, a strengthened form of the verb.)

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124. SBLGNT apparatus and eBible.org SBLGNT notes: “πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς WH Treg NIV ] + αὐτῶν RP; πᾶσαν ψυχὴν NA28.” The Text-Critical Greek NT notes give the Byzantine reading in about 80% of manuscripts and πᾶσαν ψυχήν in under 1%; such counts do not determine originality.↩

### περὶ πάντων τῶν ἔργων ἀσεβείας αὐτῶν ὧν ἠσέβησαν (*peri pantōn tōn ergōn asebeias autōn hōn ēsebēsan*) — ‘for all the impious deeds they committed impiously’

Here the quotation reaches its most emphatic point. The Greek περὶ πάντων τῶν ἔργων ἀσεβείας αὐτῶν ὧν ἠσέβησαν (*peri pantōn tōn ergōn asebeias autōn hōn ēsebēsan*) uses the root ἀσεβ- (*aseb-*), "ungodly," twice in quick succession: "their ungodly works which they ungodly did." With "impious" earlier and "impious sinners" at the end, the word family appears four times in a single sentence. The verb ἠσέβησαν (*ēsebēsan*), "they acted impiously," occurs nowhere else in the New Testament.

The repetition is deliberate. Jude introduced the intruders as ἀσεβεῖς, "impious," in v. 4. Now, in the words of the ancient prophecy, the same word rings out four times. Jude's earlier description of them was not merely his own opinion. It was the language of prophecy.

### καὶ περὶ πάντων τῶν σκληρῶν ὧν ἐλάλησαν κατ' αὐτοῦ ἁμαρτωλοὶ ἀσεβεῖς (*kai peri pantōn tōn sklērōn hōn elalēsan kat' autou hamartōloi asebeis*) — 'and for all the harsh things impious sinners have spoken against him'

The last clause shifts from deeds to words: περὶ πάντων τῶν σκληρῶν ὧν ἐλάλησαν κατ' αὐτοῦ ἁμαρτωλοὶ ἀσεβεῖς (*peri pantōn tōn sklērōn hōn elalēsan kat' autou hamartōloi asebeis*), "concerning all the hard things that ungodly sinners spoke against him." The adjective σκληρός (*sklēros*) means "hard, harsh, rough." In context it means defiant, insolent speech against God.

1 Enoch returns to this theme repeatedly. Immediately after the prophecy, it accuses sinners: "ye have turned away and spoken proud and hard words / With your impure mouths against His greatness" (1 Enoch 5:4). It speaks of a valley of judgment for those "who utter with their lips against the Lord unseemly words and of His glory speak hard things" (27:2), and it charges, "ye spake proud and insolent words against His righteousness" (101:3).[125]

The emphasis on speech connects the quotation with Jude's charges. The intruders "speak evil of glorious [ones]" (v. 8) and of "whatever [things] they have not known" (v. 10). In the next verse Jude will add that "their mouth speaks swollen words" (v. 16), and the apostles foretold "scoffers" (v. 18). Sins of speech run through the letter.

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125. 1 Enoch 5:4; 27:2; 101:3, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.↩

## Comparing Jude 14–15 with 1 Enoch 1:9

Placing Jude's quotation beside R. H. Charles's translation of 1 Enoch 1:9 (which Charles made from the Ethiopic, compared with the Greek) shows both close agreement and some differences:

| Jude 14–15 (LSV) | 1 Enoch 1:9 (trans. Charles) |
|---|---|
| “Behold, the LORD has come” | “And behold! He cometh” |
| “with myriads of His holy ones,” | “with ten thousands of [His] holy ones” |
| “to do judgment against all,” | “To execute judgement upon all,” |
| — | “And to destroy [all] the ungodly:” |
| “and to convict all their impious ones,” | “And to convict all flesh” |
| “concerning all their works of impiety that they did impiously,” | “Of all the works [of their ungodliness] which they have ungodly committed,” |
| “and concerning all the harsh [words] that impious sinners spoke against Him.” | “[And of all the hard things which] ungodly sinners [have spoken] against Him.” |

The differences are of three kinds:

1. **Jude names “the Lord”** where 1 Enoch has “He.” This may be Jude’s clarification, and it opens the way to applying the prophecy to Christ.
2. **Jude lacks the line “And to destroy all the ungodly,”** found in the Ethiopic and Greek of 1 Enoch. 3. **“All flesh” vs. “the impious.”** The NA28 reading, “every soul,” is close to 1 Enoch’s “all flesh,” which is one reason the NA28 editors adopted it.

The Aramaic original of 1 Enoch survives only in fragments from Qumran Cave 4. The complete book survives only in Ge’ez, and a Greek translation of chapters 1–32 survives in a manuscript found at Akhmim in Egypt.[126] How exactly Jude’s wording relates to these versions is debated, and this book does not try to settle it. Earlier commentators already weighed the evidence. Alfred Plummer noted that the Book of Enoch has a counterpart to “the hard things which sinners have spoken against God,” and judged this “almost conclusive” against the theory that a later writer copied the prophecy from Jude into Enoch: “If so, why did he not copy it exactly?” The Cambridge commentary judged it “more natural to suppose that he quoted here, as in previous instances, what he thought edifying” than to adopt theories of an independent tradition or a special inspiration.[127] What is clear is that Jude quotes a form of the text very close to the one we know, adapting it to his purpose.

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126. “Book of Enoch,” *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA; accessed 7 November 2026): Aramaic fragments 4Q201–4Q212 from Qumran Cave 4; the Akhmim (Panopolitanus) Greek manuscript of chapters 1–32, published in 1892; the complete text only in Ge’ez.↩

127. Alfred Plummer, *The General Epistles of St. James and St. Jude* (Expositor’s Bible, 1891), on Jude 14–15, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/expositors/jude/1.htm; *Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges* (Plumptre), on Jude 14, https://biblehub.com/commentaries/cambridge/jude/1.htm. Both public domain.↩

### Deep dive: The Book of Enoch and the biblical canon

Jude's quotation of Enoch raises one of the most interesting questions in the history of the Bible: what does it mean when a biblical writer quotes a book that is not itself in most Bibles?

### 1. What is 1 Enoch?

"1 Enoch" (also called "Ethiopic Enoch") is a collection of five main sections, written by Jewish authors at different times between roughly the third century BC and the turn of the era:

| Section | Chapters | Content | Approximate date |
|---|---|---|---|
| Book of the Watchers | 1–36 | Coming judgment; fall of the Watchers; Enoch's journeys | 3rd century BC or earlier |
| Book of Parables (Similitudes) | 37–71 | Visions of the "Son of Man" / "Elect One" and judgment | 1st century BC–1st century AD (debated) |
| Astronomical Book | 72–82 | Movements of sun, moon, and stars; calendar | 3rd century BC or earlier |
| Book of Dreams | 83–90 | Visions of the flood and of Israel's history (the "Animal Apocalypse") | 2nd century BC |
| Epistle of Enoch | 91–108 | Exhortations, woes, the "Apocalypse of Weeks" | 2nd century BC |

The quotation in Jude comes from the opening of the Book of the Watchers, one of the oldest parts.[128]

**How the text survives.** Aramaic fragments of most parts of 1 Enoch were found among the Dead Sea Scrolls in Qumran Cave 4 (manuscripts known as 4Q201–4Q212). The oldest are dated by their handwriting to the early second century BC. The Book of Parables is not represented at Qumran, which is one reason it is often dated later. A Greek manuscript of chapters 1–32, found at Akhmim (ancient Panopolis) in Egypt and published in 1892, preserves the Greek translation, and other Greek fragments survive. The complete book survives only in **Ge'ez**, the classical language of Ethiopia, in which it has been transmitted as part of the Bible.[129]

**Canonical status today.** 1 Enoch is part of the Old Testament in the **Ethiopian Orthodox Tewahedo Church** and the **Eritrean Orthodox Tewahedo Church**. It is used by the Beta Israel (Ethiopian Jewish) community. It is not part of the canon of Rabbinic Judaism or of other Christian

churches, whether Catholic, Eastern Orthodox, Oriental Orthodox outside Ethiopia and Eritrea, or Protestant.[130]

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128. The division and approximate dating follow the consensus summarized in "Book of Enoch," *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA). Dates for individual sections, especially the Book of Parables, remain debated. Nineteenth-century estimates varied widely; the *Cambridge Bible* (on Jude 14) records Ewald's date of 144–120 BC and Dillmann's of 110 BC for the main book.↩

129. "Book of Enoch," *Wikipedia* (accessed 7 November 2026): Aramaic fragments 4Q201–4Q212; Akhmim Greek codex of chapters 1–32 published in 1892; complete text only in Ge'ez.↩

130. Ibid.↩

### 2. How did early Christians respond to Jude's quotation?

The ancient church took up the question directly, and its answers diverged:

- **Tertullian** (c. 200) argued that the Book of Enoch should be accepted. He acknowledged that "the Scripture of Enoch … is not received by some, because it is not admitted into the Jewish canon either," but he insisted that "Enoch possesses a testimony in the Apostle Jude."[131] For Tertullian, Jude's quotation proved Enoch's authority.
- **Jerome** (late fourth century) reported the opposite effect: "because in it he quotes from the apocryphal Book of Enoch it is rejected by many. Nevertheless by age and use it has gained authority and is reckoned among the Holy Scriptures."[132] For some, Jude's quotation of Enoch counted against Jude.
- **Augustine** (early fifth century) took a middle position: "We cannot deny that Enoch, the seventh from Adam, left some divine writings, for this is asserted by the Apostle Jude in his canonical epistle. But it is not without reason that these writings have no place in that canon of Scripture which was preserved in the temple of the Hebrew people." He explained that such books are excluded because of their "obscure origin" and because "though there is some truth in these apocryphal writings, yet they contain so many false statements."[133]
- **John Calvin** (sixteenth century) suggested that Jude might not have taken the prophecy from a book at all: "I rather think that this prophecy was unwritten, than that it was taken from an apocryphal book; for it may have been delivered down by memory to posterity by the ancients."[134]

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131. Tertullian, *De cultu feminarum* 1.3, ANF 4 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0402.htm).↩

132. Jerome, *De viris illustribus* 4, NPNF² 3 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/2708.htm).↩

133. Augustine, *City of God* 15.23, NPNF¹ 2 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/120115.htm).↩

134. Calvin, *Commentaries on the Catholic Epistles*, on Jude 14.↩

### 3. How can Jude's use be understood?

Modern interpreters generally take one of the following views. They are presented here with their strengths and weaknesses.

**(a) Jude regarded 1 Enoch as Scripture.** On this view, Jude, like some Jews of his time (the Qumran community preserved many copies of Enoch), treated 1 Enoch as authoritative revelation.

- *Strength:* Jude calls the passage prophecy and uses it as decisive evidence.
- *Weakness:* Jude does not use the formulas by which New Testament writers usually introduce Scripture ("it is written," "the Scripture says"). And the book was not, as far as we know, part of the scriptures generally recognized in the synagogues.

**(b) Jude regarded this prophecy as a genuine word of Enoch, without endorsing the whole book.** On this view, Jude believed that the historical Enoch spoke these words, which had been preserved in tradition and recorded in the Enochic literature, without implying that everything in 1 Enoch was inspired.

- *Strength:* This view takes Jude's "Enoch … prophesied" seriously and matches Augustine's position.
- *Weakness:* Modern historical study regards 1 Enoch as written many centuries after any historical Enoch. Those who hold this view must either dispute that conclusion or argue that the book preserves an ancient tradition. Both are possible but hard to demonstrate.

**(c) Jude quoted a respected text that his readers knew, as true in what it says, without making a claim about its authorship or canonical status.** On this view, "prophesied" means that the passage speaks truly about the future judgment, as indeed the Old Testament does in many places (Deut 33:2; Zech 14:5; Dan 7:10). Jude quotes it because it was familiar and authoritative *to his readers*, and possibly to the intruders themselves, if they appealed to visionary literature.

- *Strength:* The New Testament elsewhere quotes non-biblical sources for true statements without implying their inspiration. Paul quotes a Greek poet at Athens: "as certain of your poets have also said: For we are also His offspring" (Acts 17:28, LSV). Writing to Titus, he even calls the Cretan poet Epimenides "a prophet of their own" before quoting him and adding, "This testimony is true" (Titus 1:12–13, LSV). He quotes a

proverb found in the Greek playwright Menander: “evil communications corrupt good manners” (1 Cor 15:33, LSV). Second Timothy names Moses’ opponents “Jannes and Jambres” (2 Tim 3:8, LSV), names known from Jewish tradition and not from the Old Testament.

- *Weakness:* Jude’s language is stronger than these parallels. He says Enoch “prophesied,” and he treats the prophecy as applying directly to the intruders.

**4. Principles worth holding**

Whatever view one takes, several principles help readers think clearly:

1. **Quotation is not canonization.** That a biblical author quotes a book does not make that book Scripture. Paul’s quotations of pagan poets do not make those poets canonical. The question of Jude’s view of Enoch must be decided on its own evidence.
2. **The quoted statement can be true without endorsing everything in the source.** Jude affirms that the Lord will come with his holy ones in judgment, a truth taught throughout Scripture. Nothing in his quotation requires readers to accept the astronomical calendar of 1 Enoch 72–82 or every detail of its angelology.
3. **Jude’s own authority does not depend on the answer.** The church accepted Jude into its canon in full knowledge that Jude quoted Enoch, as Tertullian, Jerome, and Augustine show. Christians who accept Jude as Scripture can hold different views of 1 Enoch. 4. **The study of 1 Enoch illuminates the New Testament.** Whatever its canonical status, 1 Enoch helps modern readers understand ideas that were current in Jude’s world: the Watchers, the judgment of fallen angels, the “Son of Man,” and the coming of God with holy myriads. Reading it is no threat to faith. It is a way of hearing the New Testament in its own historical accent.
4. **Respect for other traditions.** For Ethiopian and Eritrean Orthodox Christians, 1 Enoch is Scripture. Other Christians can respect that tradition while explaining their own canon, and can recognize that the boundaries of the canon were not settled in the same way or at the same time everywhere.

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ἕβδομος | *hebdomos* | seventh | “the seventh from Adam” | Inclusive counting; 1 Enoch 60:8; 93:3. |
| προφητεύω | *prophēteuō* | prophesy | “prophesied” | Not “wrote” or “it is written.” |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| τούτοις | *toutois* | to/about these | “to these” | Dative of reference. |
| ἰδού | *idou* | behold, look | “Behold” | Prophetic call to attention. |
| ἦλθεν | *ēlthen* | came | “has come” | Aorist expressing certainty. |
| μυριάς | *myrias* | ten thousand | “myriads” | Countless angelic host. |
| ἅγιος | *hagios* | holy | “holy ones” | Angels (Deut 33:2; Zech 14:5). |
| κρίσις | *krisis* | judgment | “judgment” | |
| ἐλέγχω | *elenchō* | expose, convict | “to convict” | TR: ἐξελέγχω. |
| ἀσεβής / ἀσέβεια / ἀσεβέω | *asebēs* / *asebeia* / *asebeō* | impious / impiety / act impiously | “impious … impiety … did impiously” | Fourfold repetition; ἀσεβέω is an NT hapax. |
| σκληρός | *sklēros* | hard, harsh | “harsh [words]” | Insolent speech; cf. 1 Enoch 5:4; 27:2. |
| ἁμαρτωλός | *hamartōlos* | sinner | “sinners” | |
| πᾶσαν ψυχήν | *pasan psychēn* | every soul | (NA28 reading) | Alternative to “all the impious.” |

**On “prophesied.”** The verb προφητεύω has a range of uses in the New Testament: foretelling (Matt 15:7), speaking God’s message (1 Cor 14:1–5), and even mocking demands to “prophesy” (Mark 14:65). In Jude, it clearly means that Enoch’s words convey a true message about the future judgment of the ungodly. Whether it also implies a judgment about the book’s authorship and authority is the question discussed in the deep dive.

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Enoch traditions in Judaism.** Enoch fascinated Jewish writers of the Second Temple period. Apart from 1 Enoch, he appears in *Jubilees*, in the Dead Sea Scrolls, and in later works such as *2 Enoch* (preserved in Slavonic) and *3 Enoch* (Hebrew). He was celebrated as a scribe, a sage, a recipient of heavenly secrets, and a witness to the coming judgment. Jude’s readers, who knew the Watcher story (v. 6) and probably the nature images of 1 Enoch (vv. 12–13), evidently regarded Enoch as a significant voice.

**Fluid boundaries.** In Jude's day, the boundaries of the Jewish scriptures were not settled in every detail, especially at the margins of the "Writings." The Qumran community preserved many copies of 1 Enoch and Jubilees alongside biblical books. Other Jewish groups, and later the rabbinic tradition, did not treat these books as Scripture. Early Christians inherited this situation, and their own canonical lists took several centuries to stabilize. Jude's quotation should be read against that background, not anachronistically against later definitions.

**Prophecy as present-tense interpretation.** Jewish interpreters of the period frequently read ancient prophecies as referring to their own time. The Dead Sea Scrolls' commentaries (the *pesharim*) quote a prophetic text and then explain its "interpretation" in terms of the community's experience. Jude's "Enoch ... prophesied to these" is the same kind of reading.

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Genesis 5:21–24; Hebrews 11:5 (Enoch).** The biblical basis for Enoch's reputation. Hebrews celebrates his faith and translation.

**Deuteronomy 33:2 (source of the imagery).** The coming of the LORD "[with] myriads of holy ones" at Sinai is the ultimate source of the picture in 1 Enoch 1:9 and Jude 14.

**Zechariah 14:5; Daniel 7:10 (shared theme).** The coming of God with his holy ones to judge.

**Matthew 25:31; Mark 8:38; 1 Thessalonians 3:13; 2 Thessalonians 1:7 (shared theme).** The return of Jesus with his angels. If Jude understands "the Lord" in the quotation to be Jesus, these texts are his closest New Testament parallels.

**Acts 17:28; Titus 1:12–13; 1 Corinthians 15:33; 2 Timothy 3:8 (method).** New Testament quotations of, and allusions to, non-biblical sources. These help frame the question of what Jude's quotation implies.

**John 16:8 (vocabulary).** The Spirit "will convict" (ἐλέγξει, *elenxei*) the world, the same verb as Jude's "to convict."

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Did Jude regard 1 Enoch as Scripture?** Discussed in the deep dive. Interpreters remain divided. The most cautious conclusion is that Jude regarded this prophecy as a true word of God about judgment, and that his readers recognized it as authoritative. The question of what Jude thought about the book as a whole cannot be answered from his single quotation.

**2. Who is "the Lord" in v. 14?** God in 1 Enoch. Most likely Jesus in Jude's application, given Jude's usage elsewhere and the New Testament's expectation of Christ's coming with his angels.

**3. Which text did Jude use?** Probably a Greek or Aramaic form of 1 Enoch close to the ones we know, perhaps with his own adaptations. The exact relationship is debated.

**4. Which reading is original in v. 15?** "All the impious" (SBLGNT), "all their impious ones" (Byzantine), or "every soul" (NA28). The meaning is the same in substance.

**5. Does Jude's use of Enoch undermine his authority?** Some early Christians thought so. The church as a whole concluded otherwise. Modern readers who share the church's acceptance of Jude can read his quotation as an example of how the Spirit used the literature and traditions of the time to speak a true word, without thereby endorsing everything in that literature.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

The Enoch quotation is the centerpiece of Jude's case. It supplies the clearest example of the judgment "written beforehand" (v. 4), and its fourfold "impious" confirms that Jude's description of the intruders was the language of prophecy. It is followed by another application ("These are…," v. 16), which applies the prophecy's charge of "harsh words" to the intruders' grumbling and arrogant speech.

The quotation also provides the letter's main picture of the future: the Lord coming with his holy ones. The readers, by contrast, are told to wait for "the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ" (v. 21) and are promised that God will set them "in the presence of His glory unblemished" (v. 24). The same coming that brings judgment on the impious brings mercy and joy to those who have been kept.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Reading Scripture with its world.** Jude's quotation of Enoch shows that the New Testament was written in conversation with the literature and traditions of its time. Modern readers may find their understanding enriched, not threatened, by learning about that world: the Dead Sea Scrolls, the Jewish writings of the Second Temple period, and the history of the canon.

**Humility about the canon.** Christians today hold different views about which books belong in the Old Testament (Protestant, Catholic, Orthodox, and

Ethiopian canons differ). Jude's quotation of Enoch, and the varied responses of Tertullian, Jerome, Augustine, and Calvin, may encourage both conviction about one's own tradition and charity toward others.

**Words matter to God.** Enoch's prophecy convicts sinners not only of their deeds but of "the harsh [words]" they have spoken against God. Jude's letter is full of concern about speech: slander, harsh words, grumbling, boasting, scoffing. In an age of easy and often harsh public speech, the passage may prompt reflection on accountability for words.

**The coming of the Lord.** The picture of the Lord coming with countless holy ones is both a warning and a comfort. It warns that injustice and ungodliness will not have the last word. It comforts those who wait for "the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ" (v. 21).

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. How did you react to learning that Jude quotes a book not found in most Bibles? Did it raise questions for you, and how would you begin to answer them?
2. Compare Jude's use of Enoch with Paul's quotations of Greek poets (Acts 17:28; Titus 1:12; 1 Cor 15:33). What similarities and differences do you see?
3. Tertullian, Jerome, Augustine, and Calvin each responded differently to Jude's quotation. Which response do you find most persuasive, and why?
4. Enoch's prophecy emphasizes "harsh [words] … spoken against Him." Why might speech be singled out alongside deeds in a description of ungodliness?
5. How does the picture of the Lord coming "with myriads of His holy ones" shape your hope and your sense of responsibility?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT and apparatus (with NA28 data); Robinson–Pierpont; TR.
- 1 Enoch 1:1–9; 5:4; 27:2; 60:8; 93:3; 101:3, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.
- Tertullian, *De cultu feminarum* 1.3 (ANF 4); Jerome, *De viris illustribus* 4 (NPNF² 3); Augustine, *City of God* 15.23 (NPNF¹ 2); Calvin, *Commentaries on the Catholic Epistles*, on Jude 14.

- On the text and canonical status of 1 Enoch: “Book of Enoch,” *Wikipedia* (CC BY-SA; accessed 7 November 2026).
- Public-domain commentaries on vv. 14–15: Plummer (Expositor’s Bible, 1891); Plumptre (*Cambridge Bible*); *Pulpit Commentary*; Calvin.

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Genesis 4:17

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**17** וַיֵּדַע קַיִן אֶת־אִשְׁתּוֹ וַתַּהַר וַתֵּלֶד אֶת־חֲנוֹךְ וַיְהִי בֹּנֶה עִיר וַיִּקְרָא שֵׁם הָעִיר כְּשֵׁם בְּנוֹ חֲנוֹךְ

*English (BSB)*

**17** And Cain had relations with his wife, and she conceived and gave birth to Enoch. Then Cain built a city and named it after his son Enoch.

*English (WEB)*

**17** Cain knew his wife. She conceived, and gave birth to Enoch. He built a city, and named the city after the name of his son, Enoch.

### Genesis 5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** זֶה סֵפֶר תּוֹלְדֹת אָדָם בְּיוֹם בְּרֹא אֱלֹהִים אָדָם בִּדְמוּת אֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה אֹתוֹ **2** זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה בְּרָאָם
וַיְבָרֶךְ אֹתָם וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָם אָדָם בְּיוֹם הִבָּרְאָם **3** וַיְחִי אָדָם שְׁלֹשִׁים וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בִּדְמוּתוֹ
כְּצַלְמוֹ וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ שֵׁת **4** וַיִּהְיוּ יְמֵי־אָדָם אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־שֵׁת שְׁמֹנֶה מֵאֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים
וּבָנוֹת **5** וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי אָדָם אֲשֶׁר־חַי תְּשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת **6** וַיְחִי־שֵׁת חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים
וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־אֱנוֹשׁ **7** וַיְחִי־שֵׁת אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־אֱנוֹשׁ שֶׁבַע שָׁנִים וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד
בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **8** וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי־שֵׁת שְׁתֵּים עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת **9** וַיְחִי אֱנוֹשׁ תִּשְׁעִים שָׁנָה
וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־קֵינָן **10** וַיְחִי אֱנוֹשׁ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־קֵינָן חָמֵשׁ עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד
בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **11** וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי אֱנוֹשׁ חָמֵשׁ שָׁנִים וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת **12** וַיְחִי קֵינָן שִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה
וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־מַהֲלַלְאֵל **13** וַיְחִי קֵינָן אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־מַהֲלַלְאֵל אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה
וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **14** וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי קֵינָן עֶשֶׂר שָׁנִים וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת **15** וַיְחִי מַהֲלַלְאֵל חָמֵשׁ

שָׁנִים וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־יָרֶד **16** וַיְחִי מַהֲלַלְאֵל אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־יָרֶד שְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה
מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **17** וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי מַהֲלַלְאֵל חָמֵשׁ וְתִשְׁעִים שָׁנָה וּשְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה
וַיָּמֹת **18** וַיְחִי־יֶרֶד שְׁתַּיִם וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־חֲנוֹךְ **19** וַיְחִי־יֶרֶד אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־
חֲנוֹךְ שְׁמֹנֶה מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **20** וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי־יֶרֶד שְׁתַּיִם וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת
שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת **21** וַיְחִי חֲנוֹךְ חָמֵשׁ וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־מְתוּשָׁלַח **22** וַיִּתְהַלֵּךְ חֲנוֹךְ אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִים אַחֲרֵי
הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־מְתוּשֶׁלַח שְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **23** וַיְהִי כָּל־יְמֵי חֲנוֹךְ חָמֵשׁ וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה
וּשְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה **24** וַיִּתְהַלֵּךְ חֲנוֹךְ אֶת־הָאֱלֹהִים וְאֵינֶנּוּ כִּי־לָקַח אֹתוֹ אֱלֹהִים **25** וַיְחִי מְתוּשֶׁלַח שֶׁבַע
וּשְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד אֶת־לָמֶךְ **26** וַיְחִי מְתוּשֶׁלַח אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־לֶמֶךְ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁמֹנִים
שָׁנָה וּשְׁבַע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **27** וַיִּהְיוּ כָּל־יְמֵי מְתוּשֶׁלַח תֵּשַׁע וְשִׁשִּׁים שָׁנָה וּתְשַׁע מֵאוֹת
שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת **28** וַיְחִי־לֶמֶךְ שְׁתַּיִם וּשְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וּמְאַת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בֵּן **29** וַיִּקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמוֹ נֹחַ לֵאמֹר זֶה
יְנַחֲמֵנוּ מִמַּעֲשֵׂנוּ וּמֵעִצְּבוֹן יָדֵינוּ מִן־הָאֲדָמָה אֲשֶׁר אֵרְרָהּ יְהוָה **30** וַיְחִי־לֶמֶךְ אַחֲרֵי הוֹלִידוֹ אֶת־נֹחַ
חָמֵשׁ וְתִשְׁעִים שָׁנָה וַחֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד בָּנִים וּבָנוֹת **31** וַיְהִי כָּל־יְמֵי־לֶמֶךְ שֶׁבַע וְשִׁבְעִים שָׁנָה
וּשְׁבַע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיָּמֹת **32** וַיְהִי־נֹחַ בֶּן־חֲמֵשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וַיּוֹלֶד נֹחַ אֶת־שֵׁם אֶת־חָם וְאֶת־יָפֶת

*English (BSB)*

**1** This is the book of the generations of Adam. In the day that God created man, He made him in His own likeness. **2** Male and female He created them, and He blessed them. And in the day they were created, He called them “man.” **3** When Adam was 130 years old, he had a son in his own likeness, after his own image; and he named him Seth. **4** And after he had become the father of Seth, Adam lived 800 years and had other sons and daughters. **5** So Adam lived a total of 930 years, and then he died. **6** When Seth was 105 years old, he became the father of Enosh. **7** And after he had become the father of Enosh, Seth lived 807 years and had other sons and daughters. **8** So Seth lived a total of 912 years, and then he died. **9** When Enosh was 90 years old, he became the father of Kenan. **10** And after he had become the father of Kenan, Enosh lived 815 years and had other sons and daughters. **11** So Enosh lived a total of 905 years, and then he died. **12** When Kenan was 70 years old, he became the father of Mahalalel. **13** And after he had become the father of Mahalalel, Kenan lived 840 years and had other sons and daughters. **14** So Kenan lived a total of 910 years, and then he died. **15** When Mahalalel was 65 years old, he became the father of Jared. **16** And after he had become the father of Jared, Mahalalel lived 830 years and had other sons and daughters. **17** So Mahalalel lived a total of 895 years, and then he died. **18** When Jared was 162 years old, he became the father of Enoch. **19** And after he had become the father of Enoch, Jared lived 800 years and had other sons and daughters. **20** So Jared lived a total of 962 years, and then he died. **21** When Enoch was 65 years old, he became the father of Methuselah. **22** And after he had become the father of Methuselah, Enoch walked with God 300 years and had other sons and daughters. **23** So Enoch lived a total of 365 years. **24** Enoch walked with God, and then he was no more, because God had taken him away. **25** When Methuselah was 187 years old, he became the father of

Lamech. **26** And after he had become the father of Lamech, Methuselah lived 782 years and had other sons and daughters. **27** So Methuselah lived a total of 969 years, and then he died. **28** When Lamech was 182 years old, he had a son. **29** And he named him Noah, saying, “May this one comfort us in the labor and toil of our hands caused by the ground that the LORD has cursed.” **30** And after he had become the father of Noah, Lamech lived 595 years and had other sons and daughters. **31** So Lamech lived a total of 777 years, and then he died. **32** After Noah was 500 years old, he became the father of Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

*English (WEB)*

**1** This is the book of the generations of Adam. In the day that God created man, he made him in God’s likeness. **2** He created them male and female, and blessed them. On the day they were created, he named them Adam. **3** Adam lived one hundred thirty years, and became the father of a son in his own likeness, after his image, and named him Seth. **4** The days of Adam after he became the father of Seth were eight hundred years, and he became the father of other sons and daughters. **5** All the days that Adam lived were nine hundred thirty years, then he died. **6** Seth lived one hundred five years, then became the father of Enosh. **7** Seth lived after he became the father of Enosh eight hundred seven years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. **8** All of the days of Seth were nine hundred twelve years, then he died. **9** Enosh lived ninety years, and became the father of Kenan. **10** Enosh lived after he became the father of Kenan eight hundred fifteen years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. **11** All of the days of Enosh were nine hundred five years, then he died. **12** Kenan lived seventy years, then became the father of Mahalalel. **13** Kenan lived after he became the father of Mahalalel eight hundred forty years, and became the father of other sons and daughters **14** and all of the days of Kenan were nine hundred ten years, then he died. **15** Mahalalel lived sixty-five years, then became the father of Jared. **16** Mahalalel lived after he became the father of Jared eight hundred thirty years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. **17** All of the days of Mahalalel were eight hundred ninety-five years, then he died. **18** Jared lived one hundred sixty-two years, then became the father of Enoch. **19** Jared lived after he became the father of Enoch eight hundred years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. **20** All of the days of Jared were nine hundred sixty-two years, then he died. **21** Enoch lived sixty-five years, then became the father of Methuselah. **22** After Methuselah’s birth, Enoch walked with God for three hundred years, and became the father of more sons and daughters. **23** All the days of Enoch were three hundred sixty-five years. **24** Enoch walked with God, and he was not found, for God took him. **25** Methuselah lived one hundred eighty-seven years, then became the father of Lamech. **26** Methuselah lived after he became the father of Lamech seven hundred eighty-two years, and became the father of other sons and daughters.

**27** All the days of Methuselah were nine hundred sixty-nine years, then he died. **28** Lamech lived one hundred eighty-two years, then became the father of a son. **29** He named him Noah, saying, “This one will comfort us in our work and in the toil of our hands, caused by the ground which the LORD has cursed.” **30** Lamech lived after he became the father of Noah five hundred ninety-five years, and became the father of other sons and daughters. **31** All the days of Lamech were seven hundred seventy-seven years, then he died. **32** Noah was five hundred years old, then Noah became the father of Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

## Deuteronomy 33:2

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**2** וַיֹּאמַר יְהוָה מִסִּינַי בָּא וְזָרַח מִשֵּׂעִיר לָמוֹ הוֹפִיעַ מֵהַר פָּארָן וְאָתָה מֵרִבְבֹת קֹדֶשׁ מִימִינוֹ אשדת
לָמוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**2** He said: “The LORD came from Sinai and dawned upon us from Seir; He shone forth from Mount Paran and came with myriads of holy ones, with flaming fire at His right hand.

*English (WEB)*

**2** He said, “The LORD came from Sinai, and rose from Seir to them. He shone from Mount Paran. He came from the ten thousands of holy ones. At his right hand was a fiery law for them.

## 1 Chronicles 1:1–3

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** אָדָם שֵׁת אֱנוֹשׁ **2** קֵינָן מַהֲלַלְאֵל יָרֶד **3** חֲנוֹךְ מְתוּשֶׁלַח לָמֶךְ

*English (BSB)*

**1** Adam, Seth, Enosh, **2** Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared, **3** Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Adam, Seth, Enosh, **2** Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared, **3** Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech,

## Daniel 7:10

*Aramaic (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**10** נְהַר דִּי־נוּר נָגֵד וְנָפֵק מִן־קֳדָמוֹהִי אֶלֶף אלפים יְשַׁמְּשׁוּנֵּהּ וְרִבּוֹ רבון קֳדָמוֹהִי יְקוּמוּן דִּינָא יְתִב וְסִפְרִין פְּתִיחוּ

*English (BSB)*

**10** A river of fire was flowing, coming out from His presence. Thousands upon thousands attended Him, and myriads upon myriads stood before Him. The court was convened, and the books were opened.

*English (WEB)*

**10** A fiery stream issued and came out from before him. Thousands of thousands ministered to him. Ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him. The judgment was set. The books were opened.

## Zechariah 14:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**5** וְנַסְתֶּם גֵּיא־הָרַי כִּי־יַגִּיעַ גֵּי־הָרִים אֶל־אָצַל וְנַסְתֶּם כַּאֲשֶׁר נַסְתֶּם מִפְּנֵי הָרַעַשׁ בִּימֵי עֻזִּיָּה מֶלֶךְ־יְהוּדָה וּבָא יְהוָה אֱלֹהַי כָּל־קְדֹשִׁים עִמָּךְ

*English (BSB)*

**5** You will flee by My mountain valley, for it will extend to Azal. You will flee as you fled from the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king of Judah. Then the LORD my God will come, and all the holy ones with Him.

*English (WEB)*

**5** You shall flee by the valley of my mountains, for the valley of the mountains shall reach to Azel. Yes, you shall flee, just like you fled from before the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king of Judah. The LORD my God will come, and all the holy ones with you.

## Matthew 15:7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** ὑποκριταί, καλῶς ἐπροφήτευσεν περὶ ὑμῶν Ἡσαΐας λέγων·

*English (BSB)*

**7** You hypocrites! Isaiah prophesied correctly about you:

*English (WEB)*

**7** You hypocrites! Well did Isaiah prophesy of you, saying,

## Matthew 25:31

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**31** Ὅταν δὲ ἔλθῃ ὁ υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου ἐν τῇ δόξῃ αὐτοῦ καὶ πάντες οἱ ἄγγελοι μετ᾽ αὐτοῦ, τότε καθίσει ἐπὶ θρόνου δόξης αὐτοῦ·

*English (BSB)*

**31** When the Son of Man comes in His glory, and all the angels with Him, He will sit on His glorious throne.

*English (WEB)*

**31** “But when the Son of Man comes in his glory, and all the holy angels with him, then he will sit on the throne of his glory.

## Mark 8:38

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**38** ὃς γὰρ ἐὰν ἐπαισχυνθῇ με καὶ τοὺς ἐμοὺς λόγους ἐν τῇ γενεᾷ ταύτῃ τῇ μοιχαλίδι καὶ ἁμαρτωλῷ, καὶ ὁ υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου ἐπαισχυνθήσεται αὐτὸν ὅταν ἔλθῃ ἐν τῇ δόξῃ τοῦ πατρὸς αὐτοῦ μετὰ τῶν ἀγγέλων τῶν ἁγίων.

*English (BSB)*

**38** If anyone is ashamed of Me and My words in this adulterous and sinful generation, the Son of Man will also be ashamed of him when He comes in His Father’s glory with the holy angels.”

*English (WEB)*

**38** For whoever will be ashamed of me and of my words in this adulterous and sinful generation, the Son of Man also will be ashamed of him when he comes in his Father’s glory with the holy angels.”

## Mark 14:65

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**65** καὶ ἤρξαντό τινες ἐμπτύειν αὐτῷ καὶ περικαλύπτειν αὐτοῦ τὸ πρόσωπον καὶ κολαφίζειν αὐτὸν καὶ λέγειν αὐτῷ· Προφήτευσον, καὶ οἱ ὑπηρέται ῥαπίσμασιν αὐτὸν ἔλαβον.

*English (BSB)*

**65** Then some of them began to spit on Him. They blindfolded Him, struck Him with their fists, and said to Him, “Prophesy!” And the officers received Him with slaps in His face.

*English (WEB)*

**65** Some began to spit on him, and to cover his face, and to beat him with fists, and to tell him, “Prophesy!” The officers struck him with the palms of their hands.

## John 16:8

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**8** καὶ ἐλθὼν ἐκεῖνος ἐλέγξει τὸν κόσμον περὶ ἁμαρτίας καὶ περὶ δικαιοσύνης καὶ περὶ κρίσεως·

*English (BSB)*

**8** And when He comes, He will convict the world in regard to sin and righteousness and judgment:

*English (WEB)*

**8** When he has come, he will convict the world about sin, about righteousness, and about judgment;

## Acts 17:28

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**28** ἐν αὐτῷ γὰρ ζῶμεν καὶ κινούμεθα καὶ ἐσμέν, ὡς καί τινες τῶν καθ’ ὑμᾶς ποιητῶν εἰρήκασιν· Τοῦ γὰρ καὶ γένος ἐσμέν.

*English (BSB)*

**28** ‘For in Him we live and move and have our being.’ As some of your own poets have said, ‘We are His offspring.’

*English (WEB)*

**28** ‘For in him we live, move, and have our being.’ As some of your own poets have said, ‘For we are also his offspring.’

## 1 Corinthians 14:1–5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Διώκετε τὴν ἀγάπην, ζηλοῦτε δὲ τὰ πνευματικά, μᾶλλον δὲ ἵνα προφητεύητε. **2** ὁ γὰρ λαλῶν γλώσσῃ οὐκ ἀνθρώποις λαλεῖ ἀλλὰ θεῷ, οὐδεὶς γὰρ ἀκούει, πνεύματι δὲ λαλεῖ μυστήρια· **3** ὁ δὲ προφητεύων ἀνθρώποις λαλεῖ οἰκοδομὴν καὶ παράκλησιν καὶ παραμυθίαν. **4** ὁ λαλῶν γλώσσῃ ἑαυτὸν οἰκοδομεῖ· ὁ δὲ προφητεύων ἐκκλησίαν οἰκοδομεῖ. **5** θέλω δὲ πάντας ὑμᾶς λαλεῖν γλώσσαις, μᾶλλον δὲ ἵνα προφητεύητε· μείζων δὲ ὁ προφητεύων ἢ ὁ λαλῶν γλώσσαις, ἐκτὸς εἰ μὴ διερμηνεύῃ, ἵνα ἡ ἐκκλησία οἰκοδομὴν λάβῃ.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Earnestly pursue love and eagerly desire spiritual gifts, especially the gift of prophecy. **2** For he who speaks in a tongue does not speak to men, but to God. Indeed, no one understands him; he utters mysteries in the Spirit. **3** But he who prophesies speaks to men for their edification, encouragement, and comfort. **4** The one who speaks in a tongue edifies himself, but the one who prophesies edifies the church. **5** I wish that all of you could speak in tongues, but I would rather have you prophesy. He who prophesies is greater than one who speaks in tongues, unless he interprets so that the church may be edified.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Follow after love and earnestly desire spiritual gifts, but especially that you may prophesy. **2** For he who speaks in another language speaks not to men, but to God, for no one understands, but in the Spirit he speaks mysteries. **3** But he who prophesies speaks to men for their edification, exhortation, and consolation. **4** He who speaks in another language edifies himself, but he who prophesies edifies the assembly. **5** Now I desire to have you all speak with other languages, but even more that you would prophesy. For he is greater who prophesies than he who speaks with other languages, unless he interprets, that the assembly may be built up.

## 1 Corinthians 15:33

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**33** μὴ πλανᾶσθε· φθείρουσιν ἤθη χρηστὰ ὁμιλίαι κακαί.

*English (BSB)*

**33** Do not be deceived: “Bad company corrupts good character.”

*English (WEB)*

**33** Don’t be deceived! “Evil companionships corrupt good morals.”

## 1 Thessalonians 3:13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** εἰς τὸ στηρίξαι ὑμῶν τὰς καρδίας ἀμέμπτους ἐν ἁγιωσύνῃ ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ πατρὸς ἡμῶν ἐν τῇ παρουσίᾳ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ μετὰ πάντων τῶν ἁγίων αὐτοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**13** so that He may establish your hearts in blamelessness and holiness before our God and Father at the coming of our Lord Jesus with all His saints. Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**13** to the end he may establish your hearts blameless in holiness before our God and Father at the coming of our Lord Jesus with all his saints.

### 2 Thessalonians 1:7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** καὶ ὑμῖν τοῖς θλιβομένοις ἄνεσιν μεθ᾽ ἡμῶν ἐν τῇ ἀποκαλύψει τοῦ κυρίου Ἰησοῦ ἀπ᾽ οὐρανοῦ μετ᾽ ἀγγέλων δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ

*English (BSB)*

**7** and to grant relief to you who are oppressed and to us as well. This will take place when the Lord Jesus is revealed from heaven with His mighty angels

*English (WEB)*

**7** and to give relief to you who are afflicted with us when the Lord Jesus is revealed from heaven with his mighty angels in flaming fire,

### 2 Timothy 3:8

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**8** ὃν τρόπον δὲ Ἰάννης καὶ Ἰαμβρῆς ἀντέστησαν Μωϋσεῖ, οὕτως καὶ οὗτοι ἀνθίστανται τῇ ἀληθείᾳ, ἄνθρωποι κατεφθαρμένοι τὸν νοῦν, ἀδόκιμοι περὶ τὴν πίστιν.

*English (BSB)*

**8** Just as Jannes and Jambres opposed Moses, so also these men oppose the truth. They are depraved in mind and disqualified from the faith.

*English (WEB)*

**8** Even as Jannes and Jambres opposed Moses, so these also oppose the truth, men corrupted in mind, who concerning the faith are rejected.

### Titus 1:12–13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**12** εἶπέν τις ἐξ αὐτῶν, ἴδιος αὐτῶν προφήτης, Κρῆτες ἀεὶ ψεῦσται, κακὰ θηρία, γαστέρες ἀργαί· **13** ἡ μαρτυρία αὕτη ἐστὶν ἀληθής. δι᾽ ἣν αἰτίαν ἔλεγχε αὐτοὺς ἀποτόμως, ἵνα ὑγιαίνωσιν ἐν τῇ πίστει,

*English (BSB)*

**12** As one of their own prophets has said, “Cretans are always liars, evil beasts, lazy gluttons.” **13** This testimony is true. Therefore rebuke them sternly, so that they will be sound in the faith

*English (WEB)*

**12** One of them, a prophet of their own, said, “Cretans are always liars, evil beasts, and idle gluttons.” **13** This testimony is true. For this cause, reprove them sharply, that they may be sound in the faith,

## Hebrews 11:5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** Πίστει Ἐνὼχ μετετέθη τοῦ μὴ ἰδεῖν θάνατον, καὶ οὐχ ηὑρίσκετο διότι μετέθηκεν αὐτὸν ὁ θεός· πρὸ γὰρ τῆς μεταθέσεως μεμαρτύρηται εὐαρεστηκέναι τῷ θεῷ,

*English (BSB)*

**5** By faith Enoch was taken up so that he did not see death: “He could not be found, because God had taken him away.” For before he was taken, he was commended as one who pleased God.

*English (WEB)*

**5** By faith Enoch was taken away, so that he wouldn’t see death, and he was not found, because God translated him. For he has had testimony given to him that before his translation he had been well pleasing to God.

## 1 Enoch 1:1–9

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** The words of the blessing of Enoch, wherewith he blessed the elect and righteous, who will be living in the day of tribulation, when all the wicked and godless are to be removed. **2** And he took up his parable and said—Enoch a righteous man, whose eyes were opened by God, saw the vision of the Holy One in the heavens, which the angels showed me, and from them I heard everything, and from them I understood as I saw, but not for this generation, but for a remote one which is for to come. **3** Concerning the elect I said, and took up my parable concerning them: The Holy Great One will come forth from His dwelling, **4** And the eternal God will tread upon the earth, (even) on Mount Sinai, [And appear from His camp] And appear in the strength of His might from the heaven of heavens. **5** And all shall be smitten with fear, And the Watchers shall quake, And great fear and trembling shall seize them unto the ends of the earth. **6** And the high mountains shall be shaken, And the high hills shall be made low, And shall melt like wax before the flame. **7** And the earth shall be wholly rent in sunder, And all that is upon the earth shall perish, And

there shall be a judgement upon all (men). **8** But with the righteous He will make peace. And will protect the elect, And mercy shall be upon them. And they shall all belong to God, And they shall be prospered, And they shall all be blessed. And He will help them all, And light shall appear unto them, And He will make peace with them. **9** And behold! He cometh with ten thousands of His holy ones To execute judgement upon all, And to destroy all the ungodly: And to convict all flesh Of all the works of their ungodliness which they have ungodly committed, And of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against Him.

## 1 Enoch 3

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** Observe and see how (in the winter) all the trees seem as though they had withered and shed all their leaves, except fourteen trees, which do not lose their foliage but retain the old foliage from two to three years till the new comes.

## 1 Enoch 4

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And again, observe ye the days of summer how the sun is above the earth over against it. And you seek shade and shelter by reason of the heat of the sun, and the earth also burns with growing heat, and so you cannot tread on the earth, or on a rock by reason of its heat.

## 1 Enoch 5:4

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**4** But ye—ye have not been steadfast, nor done the commandments of the Lord, But ye have turned away and spoken proud and hard words With your impure mouths against His greatness. Oh, ye hard-hearted, ye shall find no peace.

## 1 Enoch 27:2

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**2** Then Uriel, one of the holy angels who was with me, answered and said: 'This accursed valley is for those who are accursed for ever: Here shall all the accursed be gathered together who utter with their lips against the Lord unseemly words and of His glory speak hard things.

## 1 Enoch 60:8

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**8** But the male is named Behemoth, who occupied with his breast a waste wilderness named Dûidâin, on the east of the garden where the elect and righteous dwell, where my grandfather was taken up, the seventh from Adam, the first man whom the Lord of Spirits created.

### 1 Enoch 93:3

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**3** And Enoch began to recount from the books and said: 'I was born the seventh in the first week, While judgement and righteousness still endured.

### 1 Enoch 101:3

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**3** And if He sends His anger upon you because of your deeds, ye cannot petition Him; for ye spake proud and insolent words against His righteousness: therefore ye shall have no peace.

### 1 Enoch 72–82

This reference names the Astronomical Book (11 chapters) as a whole, which is too long to print here. Verses quoted from it in this chapter have their own entries.

# Chapter 9. Grumblers, Fault-Finders, and Flatterers (Jude 16)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **16** οὗτοί εἰσιν γογγυσταί, μεμψίμοιροι, κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι, καὶ τὸ στόμα αὐτῶν λαλεῖ ὑπέρογκα, θαυμάζοντες πρόσωπα ὠφελείας χάριν.
>
> — Jude 16, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript's first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); ℵ = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 16 | κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν | 'by their desires' | ℵ A B Ψ K |
| 16 | κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας ἑαυτῶν | 'by their own desires' | P72$^{corr}$ C L 1739 |

Notes. v. 16: not extant in P78.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

#### Jude 16

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | These are murmurers complayners walkynge after their awne lustes whose mouthes speake proude thynges. They have men in greate reverence be cause of a vauntage. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their owne lustes: Whose mouthes speake proud things, hauing mens persons in admiration, because of aduantage. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | These are murmurers, full of complaints, walking according to their own desires, and their mouth speaketh proud things, admiring persons for gain's sake. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their own lusts; and their mouth speaketh great swelling words , having men's persons in admiration because of advantage. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | These are murmurers, complaining of their lot, walking according to their own lusts; and their mouth speaketh great swelling words; admiring men's persons, for the sake of profit. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their lusts (and their mouth speaketh great swelling words), shewing respect of persons for the sake of advantage. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their lusts; and their mouth speaks swelling words, admiring persons for the sake of profit. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | These are murmurers, repiners; according to their desires walking, and their mouth doth speak great swellings, giving admiration to persons for the sake of profit; |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | These are murmurers, complainers, walking after their lusts (and their mouth speaketh great swelling words), showing respect of persons for the sake of advantage. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | These are murmurers and complainers, walking after their lusts—and their mouth speaks proud things—showing respect of persons to gain advantage. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Those teachers of false doctrine grumble about the things that God does. They complain about what happens to them. They |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | do the sinful things that their bodies desire. They talk boastfully. They ◄flatter/say nice things to► people, only in order to get those people to give them the things that they want. Jude 17-19 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | These people are always murmuring, and complaining of their lot; they follow where their passions lead them; they have arrogant words on their lips; and they flatter others for the sake of what they can get from them. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | These are grumblers, complainers, who follow their evil desires. They are loud boasters, who, for their own advantage, flatter others. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Such people are grumblers, always complaining. They follow their own evil desires, speaking boastfully about themselves, and flattering others to get what they want. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | These are discontented grumblers, walking according to their own lusts; and their mouth speaks swollen words, giving admiration to persons for the sake of profit; |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | These men are discontented grumblers, following after their own lusts; their mouths spew arrogance; they flatter others for their own advantage. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | These men are discontented grumblers, following after their own lusts; their mouths spew arrogance; they flatter others for their own advantage. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | These men are grumblers and complainers, walking according to their own lusts. They speak bombastic words with their mouths, flattering others for their own advantage. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

After Enoch's prophecy, Jude applies it once more: "These are…" Enoch's prophecy ended with "the harsh [words] that impious sinners spoke against Him." Jude now shows how the intruders' speech fits that description. They **grumble**, complaining against God and their circumstances. They **blame their lot**, always dissatisfied. They **follow their own desires**. They **speak**

**arrogant words**, boastful and grandiose. And they **flatter people** when there is something to be gained.

The portrait is psychologically sharp. The same people who complain about God and boast about themselves are servile toward anyone who can benefit them. Their speech moves between resentment, arrogance, and flattery, and self-interest drives all three.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### οὗτοί εἰσιν γογγυσταί, μεμψίμοιροι (*houtoi eisin gongystai, mempsimoiroi*) — 'these are grumblers, complaining of their lot'

The verse opens with the formula Οὗτοί εἰσιν (*Houtoi eisin*), "These are," which marks the third application in the letter (vv. 8, 10, 12, 16, 19). The LSV's "discontented grumblers" combines two Greek words, each found nowhere else in the New Testament.

**γογγυσταί (*gongystai*), "grumblers, murmurers."** The noun comes from the verb γογγύζω (*gongyzō*), "to grumble, mutter," whose sound imitates low, discontented muttering. The noun itself is rare, and in the Greek Old Testament it appears only in later revisions.[135] The verb and its related noun γογγυσμός (*gongysmos*), however, are the standard Septuagint terms for **Israel's murmuring in the wilderness**. "In YHWH's hearing your murmurings, which you are murmuring against Him … Your murmurings [are] not against us, but against YHWH" (Exod 16:8, LSV). After the spies' report, "all the sons of Israel murmur against Moses and against Aaron" (Num 14:2, LSV), and God says, "The murmurings of the sons of Israel, which they are murmuring against Me, I have heard" (Num 14:27, LSV). The murmuring led to the death of that generation in the wilderness, the very event Jude recalled in v. 5. Korah's rebellion, too, was a "murmuring" against Aaron (Num 16:11; 17:5).

Paul draws the same lesson for the church: "neither murmur, as also some of them murmured, and perished by the destroyer" (1 Cor 10:10, LSV). He urges the Philippians, "Do all things without murmurings and deliberations" (Phil 2:14, LSV). For Jude's readers, "grumblers" would have called up the whole wilderness story: people delivered by God who complained against him and perished.

**μεμψίμοιροι (*mempsimoiroi*), "fault-finders, complaining of their lot."** This word combines μέμφομαι (*memphomai*, "to blame, find fault") and μοῖρα (*moira*, "lot, portion, fate"). Its sense is "blaming one's lot," "querulous," and it describes a person perpetually dissatisfied with what life, or God, has given.[136] It was a recognized character type in Greek moral writing. The

philosopher Theophrastus (fourth century BC) included “the Grumbler” (Μεμψιμοιρία, *Mempsimoiria*) among his thirty sketches of human types. His grumbler receives a gift of food from a friend’s table and complains, “He grudged me a dish of soup and a cup of wine, I suppose, and so couldn’t invite me to dinner.”[137] Jude’s readers would have recognized the type, a person whose ingratitude turns every blessing into a grievance.

Put together, the two words describe people whose fundamental posture toward God is complaint. They are the opposite of the thankful, contented trust that the faith produces (Phil 4:11–12; 1 Tim 6:6–8).

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135. Abbott-Smith, s.v. γογγυστής: “[in Sm.: Pr 26:22, Is 29:24; Th.: Pr 26:20] a murmurer: Ju 16” (i.e., found in the later Greek versions of Symmachus and Theodotion, not in the main Septuagint).↩

136. Abbott-Smith, s.v. μεμψίμοιρος: “(< μέμφομαι, + μοῖρα, fate, lot), complaining of one’s fate, querulous: Ju 16.”↩

137. Theophrastus, *Characters* 17, as rendered in Charles E. Bennett and William A. Hammond, *The Characters of Theophrastus* (New York: Longmans, Green, 1902), Project Gutenberg #58242. Bennett and Hammond title the sketch “The Thankless Man.” The Greek title is Μεμψιμοιρία.↩

### κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι (*kata tas epithymias autōn poreuomenoi*) — ‘living by their own desires’

The phrase κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι (*kata tas epithymias autōn poreuomenoi*), “going according to their desires,” describes a whole way of life governed by craving. The verb πορεύομαι (*poreuomai*), “to go, walk,” repeats the “went” of v. 11 (“they went on in the way of Cain”), and it will return in v. 18 (“following after their own lusts of impieties”). The noun ἐπιθυμία (*epithymia*), “desire, craving,” is neutral in itself but in this context means disordered desire. The intruders’ grumbling and their self-indulgence are two sides of the same thing. Those whose desires rule them will always complain that their desires are not met.

**A textual note.** The SBLGNT and the Byzantine text read αὐτῶν (*autōn*), “their,” while NA28 reads ἑαυτῶν (*heautōn*), “their own.” The difference is minimal. The LSV’s “their own” matches the sense of either.[138]

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138. eBible.org SBLGNT notes: “αὐτῶν WH Treg RP ] ἑαυτῶν NA28.”↩

### καὶ τὸ στόμα αὐτῶν λαλεῖ ὑπέρογκα (*kai to stoma autōn lalei hyperonka*) — ‘and their mouth speaks inflated words’

The Greek τὸ στόμα αὐτῶν λαλεῖ ὑπέρογκα (*to stoma autōn lalei hyperonka*) means literally “their mouth speaks swollen things.” The adjective ὑπέρογκος

(*hyperonkos*), from ὑπέρ (*hyper*, “over”) and ὄγκος (*onkos*, “bulk, mass”), means “excessively large, immoderate,” and in later Greek it was used of arrogant, bombastic speech.[139] The LSV’s “swollen words” is vivid and accurate. The ASV’s “great swelling words” and the BSB’s “arrogantly” capture the sense.

The phrase has a striking biblical precedent. In the Greek version of Daniel, the arrogant king of the end time “shall speak swollen things” (λαλήσει ὑπέρογκα, *lalēsei hyperonka*) against the God of gods (Dan 11:36, Theodotion).[140] The Hebrew behind it says he “speaks wonderful things against the God of gods” (Dan 11:36, LSV). Daniel also describes the little horn with “a mouth speaking great things” (Dan 7:8, LSV). 1 Enoch, which Jude has just quoted, accuses sinners of speaking “proud and hard words / With your impure mouths against His greatness” (1 Enoch 5:4) and “proud and insolent words against His righteousness” (101:3).[141] Jude’s phrase places the intruders’ boasting in this line of arrogant speech against God.

What did their “swollen words” sound like? Perhaps grand claims about their visions (v. 8), their freedom (v. 4), or their spiritual superiority (v. 19). Second Peter’s parallel adds content: “speaking swollen words of vanity, they entice in desires of the flesh” (2 Pet 2:18, LSV). Their impressive talk was a means of luring others into their way of life.

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139. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ὑπέρογκος: “of excessive weight or size; metaph., excessive, immoderate, in late writers, of arrogant speech (v. Mayor on Ju, l.c.): n. pl., II Pe 2:18, Ju 16.”↩

140. Greek Daniel (Theodotion) 11:36: καὶ λαλήσει ὑπέρογκα (Brenton’s Greek Septuagint, eBible.org).↩

141. 1 Enoch 5:4; 101:3, trans. R. H. Charles (1917), Wikisource.↩

### θαυμάζοντες πρόσωπα (*thaumazontes prosōpa*) — ‘flattering people (literally, admiring faces)’

The phrase θαυμάζοντες πρόσωπα (*thaumazontes prosōpa*) means literally “admiring faces.” It is not natural Greek. It is a Hebrew idiom rendered word for word in the Greek Old Testament. The Hebrew expression “to lift up the face” of someone (*nāśā’ pānîm*) means to show favor or partiality, especially to the powerful. The Septuagint often translated it as θαυμάζειν πρόσωπον, “to admire a face.”[142] For example:

- “you do not lift up the face of the poor, nor honor the face of the great” (Lev 19:15, LSV), where the Septuagint has “you shall not admire the face of the powerful”;
- “your God YHWH … who does not accept by appearances, nor takes a bribe” (Deut 10:17, LSV), where the Septuagint has “who does not admire

a face”;
- “[It] is not good to discern faces” (Prov 28:21, LSV);
- and, strikingly, in the Sodom narrative itself, the angel’s words to Lot, “Behold, I have also accepted your face for this thing” (Gen 19:21, LSV), where the Septuagint has ἐθαύμασά σου τὸ πρόσωπον, “I have admired your face,” meaning “I have granted your request.”

The New Testament uses a related compound for the same vice: “do not hold the faith of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ in favor by appearance” (Jas 2:1, LSV); “if you favor by appearance, you work sin” (Jas 2:9, LSV). Peter at Cornelius’s house declares that “God is not favoring by appearance” (Acts 10:34, LSV).

The intruders, then, show favoritism. They flatter and court people of influence.

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142. Brenton’s Greek Septuagint: Gen 19:21 (ἐθαύμασά σου τὸ πρόσωπον); Lev 19:15 (οὐδὲ μὴ θαυμάσῃς πρόσωπον δυνάστου); Deut 10:17 (οὐ θαυμάζει πρόσωπον); 2 Chr 19:7; Job 13:10; 22:8; 32:22; Prov 18:5; Isa 9:15 (versification varies).↩

### ὠφελείας χάριν (*ōpheleias charin*) — ‘for the sake of advantage’

The reason for their flattery is ὠφελείας χάριν (*ōpheleias charin*), “for the sake of advantage” or “for profit.” The noun ὠφέλεια (*ōpheleia*) means “help, benefit, advantage.”[143] The word χάριν (*charin*), used here as a preposition meaning “for the sake of,” is in origin the accusative of χάρις (*charis*), “grace.” It is tempting to see an irony: the intruders, who turned the *grace* (χάρις) of God into license (v. 4), now flatter people *for the sake of* (χάριν) profit. Whether Jude intended the echo is uncertain, since χάριν was an everyday preposition, but attentive readers may have heard it.

The combination is telling. Those who grumble against God and speak arrogantly against him are servile toward people who can reward them. Paul describes similar figures: “such do not serve our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly; and through the good word and fair speech they deceive the hearts of the harmless” (Rom 16:18, LSV). Paul contrasts his own ministry: “at no time did we come with speech of flattery … nor in a pretext for covetousness” (1 Thess 2:5, LSV). Balaam’s “reward” (v. 11) and the self-feeding shepherds (v. 12) find their counterpart here. The intruders’ speech, like their leadership, serves their own advantage.

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143. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ὠφέλεια: “profit, advantage, benefit: Ro 3:1, Ju 16.”↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| γογγυστής | *gongystēs* | grumbler, murmurer | “grumblers” | NT hapax; cf. γογγύζω, LXX wilderness murmuring. |
| μεμψίμοιρος | *mempsimoiros* | complaining of one’s lot, querulous | “discontented” | NT hapax; Theophrastus’s “Grumbler” type. |
| ἐπιθυμία | *epithymia* | desire, craving | “lusts” | Also v. 18. |
| πορεύομαι | *poreuomai* | go, walk | “walking” | Echoes v. 11; anticipates v. 18. |
| στόμα | *stoma* | mouth | “their mouth” | Semitic expression. |
| ὑπέρογκος | *hyperonkos* | excessive, swollen; arrogant | “swollen words” | Dan 11:36 Theod.; 2 Pet 2:18. |
| θαυμάζω πρόσωπον | *thaumazō prosōpon* | “admire a face” = show partiality | “giving admiration to persons” | LXX idiom for Heb. *nāśā’ pānîm*. |
| ὠφέλεια | *ōpheleia* | advantage, profit | “profit” | |
| χάριν | *charin* | for the sake of | “for the sake of” | Preposition (from χάρις). |

**A caution about the “admiring faces” idiom.** Because θαυμάζω normally means “to marvel, wonder at,” a reader without the Septuagint background might think the intruders were simply impressed by people. The phrase is a fixed idiom for partiality and favoritism. Here, as often, the Greek of the New Testament makes sense only against the Greek of the Old Testament.

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Patronage and flattery.** The Greco-Roman world was structured by patronage. Wealthy patrons supported clients, who repaid them with loyalty, public praise, and services. Flattery was the lubricant of the system, and moralists from Theophrastus to Plutarch wrote about how to tell a flatterer from a friend. Early Christian communities, which met in the homes of wealthier members and depended on their hospitality, were not immune to these dynamics. James warns against honoring the rich man in fine clothes and dishonoring the poor man (Jas 2:1–9). Jude’s intruders seem to have courted influential members of the community, perhaps the hosts of the love feasts, for their own advantage.

**Moral character types.** Greek moral writers catalogued human vices in sketches of recognizable types, including the flatterer, the grumbler, the boaster, and the toady. Jude's string of vivid descriptors resembles such sketches, though his categories are shaped by Scripture: the murmurers of the wilderness, the arrogant speakers of Daniel and Enoch, the partial judges condemned by the Law.

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Exodus 16; Numbers 14; 1 Corinthians 10:10 (background).** The wilderness murmuring is the main background for "grumblers." Jude's readers would connect v. 16 with v. 5: those who murmured perished.

**Numbers 16:11; 17:5 (Korah).** Korah's rebellion was a "murmuring." The grumblers of v. 16 walk in Korah's "controversy" (v. 11).

**Daniel 7:8; 11:36 (verbal parallel).** The arrogant king who "speaks wonderful things," Greek "swollen things," against God provides the closest biblical parallel to "swollen words."

**Leviticus 19:15; Deuteronomy 10:17; James 2:1–9; Acts 10:34 (idiom and theme).** Partiality is condemned in the Law, and God himself is the model of impartiality.

**Romans 16:17–18; 1 Thessalonians 2:5 (shared theme).** Paul's warnings against those who serve their own appetites with "fair speech," and his own refusal of flattery, parallel Jude's charge.

**2 Peter 2:18 (literary parallel).** "Swollen words of vanity" used to entice others.

**1 Enoch 5:4; 101:3 (source tradition).** Proud and hard words against God.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. How does v. 16 relate to the Enoch quotation?** Most interpreters see v. 16 as the application of the quotation, especially of its final phrase about "harsh [words] … against Him." The intruders' grumbling, boasting, and flattery are the "harsh words" of the prophecy in present form.

**2. Whom did the intruders flatter?** Jude does not say. Suggestions include wealthy members who hosted the community, people who might become followers and supporters, and church leaders whose approval they sought. The general point, that they cultivated people for gain, does not depend on a specific identification.

**3. Is all complaint sinful?** Scripture contains many complaints addressed to God, the laments of the Psalms, of Job, and of Jeremiah, which are not condemned. The difference lies in the posture. Lament brings pain *to* God in trust. Grumbling speaks *against* God in resentment and unbelief. The wilderness murmuring that Jude recalls was a refusal to trust the God who had delivered them (Num 14:11). Jude's word μεμψίμοιροι, "blaming one's lot," captures this spirit of grievance against God's providence.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verse 16 completes the third "text and application" unit (vv. 14–16), applying Enoch's prophecy to the intruders. It also gathers threads from earlier in the letter: the murmuring of the wilderness generation (v. 5), the slander of glorious ones (vv. 8, 10), Korah's rebellion (v. 11), and Balaam's greed (v. 11). And it prepares for v. 18, where the apostles' prediction of "scoffers, following after their own lusts" repeats the phrase about walking according to lusts.

Throughout this middle section, speech is a recurring concern: slander (vv. 8–10), harsh words (v. 15), grumbling and swollen words (v. 16), and scoffing (v. 18). By contrast, the readers' speech is to be prayer "in the Holy Spirit" (v. 20) and the letter ends in praise (vv. 24–25).

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Gratitude as resistance.** Grumbling can become a habit of mind that colors every blessing with grievance, as in Theophrastus's grumbler who received a gift and complained he had not been invited to dinner. Jude's portrait may invite believers to examine their own speech about God, their circumstances, and their communities, and to cultivate thankfulness as a spiritual discipline.

**Lament vs. grumbling.** Christians sometimes suppress honest lament out of fear that it is "grumbling." Scripture's laments show that bringing pain to God in faith is not the sin Jude describes. The question is whether complaint is addressed to God in trust or spoken against God in resentment.

**Flattery and influence.** In churches as in every institution, there are temptations to court those with money, status, or power. James and Jude both condemn partiality. Communities may consider whether they treat wealthy or influential members differently, and whether their leaders' speech is shaped by the desire for advantage.

**Inflated speech.** "Swollen words" are common in religious marketing, political rhetoric, and online self-presentation. Jude's phrase may prompt

reflection on the difference between speech that serves truth and speech that serves the speaker’s image.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Why do you think grumbling was treated so seriously in the wilderness narratives and in Jude? What does grumbling reveal about a person’s relationship with God?
2. How would you distinguish biblical lament from the grumbling Jude condemns? Can you think of examples from Scripture or experience?
3. Jude describes people who are arrogant toward God and flattering toward people. Why do you think these two traits often go together?
4. Where do you see the temptation to “admire faces,” to show favoritism for advantage, in your church, workplace, or community?
5. What practices might help cultivate contentment and gratitude in a culture that often encourages complaint?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT and apparatus (NA28 data). LXX: Brenton’s Greek Septuagint (Lev 19:15; Deut 10:17; Gen 19:21; Job 13:10; Prov 18:5; Dan 11:36 Theodotion).
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. γογγυστής, μεμψίμοιρος, ὑπέρογκος, ὠφέλεια.
- Theophrastus, *Characters* 17 (“The Thankless Man”/“Grumbler”), trans. C. E. Bennett and W. A. Hammond (1902), Project Gutenberg #58242.
- 1 Enoch 5:4; 101:3, trans. R. H. Charles (1917).

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Genesis 19:21

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**21** וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו הִנֵּה נָשָׂאתִי פָנֶיךָ גַּם לַדָּבָר הַזֶּה לְבִלְתִּי הָפְכִּי אֶת־הָעִיר אֲשֶׁר דִּבַּרְתָּ

*English (BSB)*

**21** “Very well,” he answered, “I will grant this request as well, and will not demolish the town you indicate.

*English (WEB)*

**21** He said to him, “Behold, I have granted your request concerning this thing also, that I will not overthrow the city of which you have spoken.

### Exodus 16

Printed in full in the Historical Introduction: see Exodus 16.

### Leviticus 19:15

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**15** לֹא־תַעֲשׂוּ עָוֶל בַּמִּשְׁפָּט לֹא־תִשָּׂא פְנֵי־דָל וְלֹא תֶהְדַּר פְּנֵי גָדוֹל בְּצֶדֶק תִּשְׁפֹּט עֲמִיתֶךָ

*English (BSB)*

**15** You must not pervert justice; you must not show partiality to the poor or favoritism to the rich; you are to judge your neighbor fairly.

*English (WEB)*

**15** “’You shall do no injustice in judgment. You shall not be partial to the poor, nor show favoritism to the great; but you shall judge your neighbor in righteousness.

### Numbers 14

Printed in full in the Historical Introduction: see Numbers 14.

### Numbers 16:11

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**11** לָכֵן אַתָּה וְכָל־עֲדָתְךָ הַנֹּעָדִים עַל־יְהוָה וְאַהֲרֹן מַה־הוּא כִּי תלונו עָלָיו

*English (BSB)*

**11** Therefore, it is you and all your followers who have conspired against the LORD! As for Aaron, who is he that you should grumble against him?”

*English (WEB)*

**11** Therefore you and all your company have gathered together against the LORD! What is Aaron that you complain against him?”

### Numbers 17:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**5 [17:20]** וְהָיָה הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר אֶבְחַר־בּוֹ מַטֵּהוּ יִפְרָח וְהַשְׁכֹּתִי מֵעָלַי אֶת־תְּלֻנּוֹת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֲשֶׁר הֵם מַלִּינִם עֲלֵיכֶם

*English (BSB)*

**5** The staff belonging to the man I choose will sprout, and I will rid Myself of the constant grumbling of the Israelites against you.”

*English (WEB)*

**5** It shall happen that the rod of the man whom I shall choose shall bud. I will make the murmurings of the children of Israel, which they murmur against you, cease from me.”

### Deuteronomy 10:17

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**17** כִּי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵיכֶם הוּא אֱלֹהֵי הָאֱלֹהִים וַאֲדֹנֵי הָאֲדֹנִים הָאֵל הַגָּדֹל הַגִּבֹּר וְהַנּוֹרָא אֲשֶׁר לֹא־יִשָּׂא פָנִים וְלֹא יִקַּח שֹׁחַד

*English (BSB)*

**17** For the LORD your God is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great, mighty, and awesome God, showing no partiality and accepting no bribe.

*English (WEB)*

**17** For the LORD your God, he is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great God, the mighty, and the awesome, who doesn’t respect persons or take bribes.

### 2 Chronicles 19:7

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**7** וְעַתָּה יְהִי פַּחַד־יְהוָה עֲלֵיכֶם שִׁמְרוּ וַעֲשׂוּ כִּי־אֵין עִם־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵינוּ עַוְלָה וּמַשָּׂא פָּנִים וּמִקַּח־שֹׁחַד

*English (BSB)*

**7** And now, may the fear of the LORD be upon you. Be careful what you do, for with the LORD our God there is no injustice or partiality or bribery.”

*English (WEB)*

**7** Now therefore let the fear of the LORD be on you. Take heed and do it; for there is no iniquity with the LORD our God, nor respect of persons, nor taking of bribes.”

## Job 13:10

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**10** הוֹכֵחַ יוֹכִיחַ אֶתְכֶם אִם־בַּסֵּתֶר פָּנִים תִּשָּׂאוּן

*English (BSB)*

**10** Surely He would rebuke you if you secretly showed partiality.

*English (WEB)*

**10** He will surely reprove you if you secretly show partiality.

## Job 22:8

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** וְאִישׁ זְרוֹעַ לוֹ הָאָרֶץ וּנְשׂוּא פָנִים יֵשֵׁב בָּהּ

*English (BSB)*

**8** while the land belonged to a mighty man, and a man of honor lived on it.

*English (WEB)*

**8** But as for the mighty man, he had the earth. The honorable man, he lived in it.

## Job 32:22

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**22** כִּי לֹא יָדַעְתִּי אֲכַנֶּה כִּמְעַט יִשָּׂאֵנִי עֹשֵׂנִי

*English (BSB)*

**22** For I do not know how to flatter, or my Maker would remove me in an instant.

*English (WEB)*

**22** For I don’t know how to give flattering titles, or else my Maker would soon take me away.

### Proverbs 18:5

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**5** שְׂאֵ֣ת פְּנֵי־רָ֭שָׁע לֹא־טֹ֑וב לְהַטּ֥וֹת צַ֝דִּ֗יק בַּמִּשְׁפָּֽט

*English (BSB)*

**5** Showing partiality to the wicked is not good, nor is depriving the innocent of justice.

*English (WEB)*

**5** To be partial to the faces of the wicked is not good, nor to deprive the innocent of justice.

### Proverbs 28:21

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**21** הַכֵּר־פָּנִים לֹא־טֹ֑וב וְעַל־פַּת־לֶ֝חֶם יִפְשַׁע־גָּֽבֶר

*English (BSB)*

**21** To show partiality is not good, yet a man will do wrong for a piece of bread.

*English (WEB)*

**21** To show partiality is not good, yet a man will do wrong for a piece of bread.

### Isaiah 9:15

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**15 [9:14]** זָקֵן וּנְשׂוּא־פָנִים הוּא רֹאשׁ וְנָבִיא מוֹרֵה־שֶׁקֶר הוּא הַזָּנָב

*English (BSB)*

**15** The head is the elder and honorable man, and the tail is the prophet who teaches lies.

*English (WEB)*

**15** The elder and the honorable man is the head, and the prophet who teaches lies is the tail.

### Daniel 7:8

*Aramaic (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** מְשַׂתַּכַּל הֲוֵית בְּקַרְנַיָּא וַאֲלוּ קֶרֶן אָחֳרִי זְעֵירָה סְלִקַת בֵּינֵיהוֹן וּתְלָת מִן־קַדְמָיְתָא אִתעקרו
מִן־קֳדָמַיהּ וַאֲלוּ עֵינִין כְּעֵינֵי אֱנָשָׁא בְּקַרְנָא־דָא וּפֻם מְמַלֵּל רַבְרְבָן

*English (BSB)*

**8** While I was contemplating the horns, suddenly another horn, a little one, came up among them, and three of the first horns were uprooted before it. This horn had eyes like those of a man and a mouth that spoke words of arrogance.

*English (WEB)*

**8** “I considered the horns, and behold, there came up among them another horn, a little one, before which three of the first horns were plucked up by the roots; and behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of a man, and a mouth speaking arrogantly.

### Daniel 11:36

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**36** וְעָשָׂה כִרְצוֹנוֹ הַמֶּלֶךְ וְיִתְרוֹמֵם וְיִתְגַּדֵּל עַל־כָּל־אֵל וְעַל אֵל אֵלִים יְדַבֵּר נִפְלָאוֹת וְהִצְלִיחַ עַד־
כָּלָה זַעַם כִּי נֶחֱרָצָה נֶעֱשָׂתָה

*English (BSB)*

**36** Then the king will do as he pleases and will exalt and magnify himself above every god, and he will speak monstrous things against the God of gods. He will be successful until the time of wrath is completed, for what has been decreed must be accomplished.

*English (WEB)*

**36** “The king will do according to his will. He will exalt himself and magnify himself above every god, and will speak marvelous things against the God of gods. He will prosper until the indignation is accomplished, for that which is determined will be done.

### Acts 10:34

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**34** Ἀνοίξας δὲ Πέτρος τὸ στόμα εἶπεν· Ἐπ᾽ ἀληθείας καταλαμβάνομαι ὅτι οὐκ ἔστιν προσωπολήμπτης ὁ θεός,

*English (BSB)*

**34** Then Peter began to speak: “I now truly understand that God does not show favoritism,

*English (WEB)*

**34** Peter opened his mouth and said, “Truly I perceive that God doesn’t show favoritism;

## Romans 16:17–18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**17** Παρακαλῶ δὲ ὑμᾶς, ἀδελφοί, σκοπεῖν τοὺς τὰς διχοστασίας καὶ τὰ σκάνδαλα παρὰ τὴν διδαχὴν ἣν ὑμεῖς ἐμάθετε ποιοῦντας, καὶ ἐκκλίνετε ἀπ᾽ αὐτῶν· **18** οἱ γὰρ τοιοῦτοι τῷ κυρίῳ ἡμῶν Χριστῷ οὐ δουλεύουσιν ἀλλὰ τῇ ἑαυτῶν κοιλίᾳ, καὶ διὰ τῆς χρηστολογίας καὶ εὐλογίας ἐξαπατῶσι τὰς καρδίας τῶν ἀκάκων.

*English (BSB)*

**17** Now I urge you, brothers, to watch out for those who create divisions and obstacles that are contrary to the teaching you have learned. Turn away from them. **18** For such people are not serving our Lord Christ, but their own appetites. By smooth talk and flattery they deceive the hearts of the naive.

*English (WEB)*

**17** Now I beg you, brothers, look out for those who are causing the divisions and occasions of stumbling, contrary to the doctrine which you learned, and turn away from them. **18** For those who are such don’t serve our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly; and by their smooth and flattering speech they deceive the hearts of the innocent.

## 1 Corinthians 10:10

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** μηδὲ γογγύζετε, καθάπερ τινὲς αὐτῶν ἐγόγγυσαν, καὶ ἀπώλοντο ὑπὸ τοῦ ὀλοθρευτοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**10** And do not complain, as some of them did, and were killed by the destroying angel.

*English (WEB)*

**10** Don’t grumble, as some of them also grumbled, and perished by the destroyer.

### Philippians 2:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** Πάντα ποιεῖτε χωρὶς γογγυσμῶν καὶ διαλογισμῶν,

*English (BSB)*

**14** Do everything without complaining or arguing,

*English (WEB)*

**14** Do all things without complaining and arguing,

### Philippians 4:11–12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** οὐχ ὅτι καθ᾽ ὑστέρησιν λέγω, ἐγὼ γὰρ ἔμαθον ἐν οἷς εἰμι αὐτάρκης εἶναι· **12** οἶδα καὶ ταπεινοῦσθαι, οἶδα καὶ περισσεύειν· ἐν παντὶ καὶ ἐν πᾶσιν μεμύημαι, καὶ χορτάζεσθαι καὶ πεινᾶν, καὶ περισσεύειν καὶ ὑστερεῖσθαι·

*English (BSB)*

**11** I am not saying this out of need, for I have learned to be content regardless of my circumstances. **12** I know how to live humbly, and I know how to abound. I am accustomed to any and every situation—to being filled and being hungry, to having plenty and having need.

*English (WEB)*

**11** Not that I speak because of lack, for I have learned in whatever state I am, to be content in it. **12** I know how to be humbled, and I also know how to abound. In any and all circumstances I have learned the secret both to be filled and to be hungry, both to abound and to be in need.

### 1 Thessalonians 2:5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** οὔτε γάρ ποτε ἐν λόγῳ κολακείας ἐγενήθημεν, καθὼς οἴδατε, οὔτε ἐν προφάσει πλεονεξίας, θεὸς μάρτυς,

*English (BSB)*

**5** As you know, we never used words of flattery or any pretext for greed. God is our witness!

*English (WEB)*

**5** For neither were we at any time found using words of flattery, as you know, nor a cloak of covetousness (God is witness),

## 1 Timothy 6:6–8

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** ἔστιν δὲ πορισμὸς μέγας ἡ εὐσέβεια μετὰ αὐταρκείας· **7** οὐδὲν γὰρ εἰσηνέγκαμεν εἰς τὸν κόσμον, ὅτι οὐδὲ ἐξενεγκεῖν τι δυνάμεθα· **8** ἔχοντες δὲ διατροφὰς καὶ σκεπάσματα, τούτοις ἀρκεσθησόμεθα.

*English (BSB)*

**6** Of course, godliness with contentment is great gain. **7** For we brought nothing into the world, so we cannot carry anything out of it. **8** But if we have food and clothing, we will be content with these.

*English (WEB)*

**6** But godliness with contentment is great gain. **7** For we brought nothing into the world, and we certainly can’t carry anything out. **8** But having food and clothing, we will be content with that.

## James 2:1–9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἀδελφοί μου, μὴ ἐν προσωπολημψίαις ἔχετε τὴν πίστιν τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τῆς δόξης; **2** ἐὰν γὰρ εἰσέλθῃ εἰς συναγωγὴν ὑμῶν ἀνὴρ χρυσοδακτύλιος ἐν ἐσθῆτι λαμπρᾷ, εἰσέλθῃ δὲ καὶ πτωχὸς ἐν ῥυπαρᾷ ἐσθῆτι, **3** ἐπιβλέψητε δὲ ἐπὶ τὸν φοροῦντα τὴν ἐσθῆτα τὴν λαμπρὰν καὶ εἴπητε· Σὺ κάθου ὧδε καλῶς, καὶ τῷ πτωχῷ εἴπητε· Σὺ στῆθι ἢ κάθου ἐκεῖ ὑπὸ τὸ ὑποπόδιόν μου, **4** οὐ διεκρίθητε ἐν ἑαυτοῖς καὶ ἐγένεσθε κριταὶ διαλογισμῶν πονηρῶν; **5** ἀκούσατε, ἀδελφοί μου ἀγαπητοί. οὐχ ὁ θεὸς ἐξελέξατο τοὺς πτωχοὺς τῷ κόσμῳ πλουσίους ἐν πίστει καὶ κληρονόμους τῆς βασιλείας ἧς ἐπηγγείλατο τοῖς ἀγαπῶσιν αὐτόν; **6** ὑμεῖς δὲ ἠτιμάσατε τὸν πτωχόν. οὐχ οἱ πλούσιοι καταδυναστεύουσιν ὑμῶν, καὶ αὐτοὶ ἕλκουσιν ὑμᾶς εἰς κριτήρια; **7** οὐκ αὐτοὶ βλασφημοῦσιν τὸ καλὸν ὄνομα τὸ ἐπικληθὲν ἐφ᾽ ὑμᾶς; **8** Εἰ μέντοι νόμον τελεῖτε βασιλικὸν κατὰ τὴν γραφήν Ἀγαπήσεις τὸν πλησίον σου ὡς σεαυτόν, καλῶς ποιεῖτε· **9** εἰ δὲ προσωπολημπτεῖτε, ἁμαρτίαν ἐργάζεσθε, ἐλεγχόμενοι ὑπὸ τοῦ νόμου ὡς παραβάται.

*English (BSB)*

**1** My brothers, as you hold out your faith in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, do not show favoritism. **2** Suppose a man comes into your meeting wearing a gold ring and fine clothes, and a poor man in shabby clothes also comes in. **3** If you lavish attention on the man in fine clothes and say, “Here is a seat of honor,” but say to the poor man, “You must stand” or “Sit at my feet,” **4** have you not

discriminated among yourselves and become judges with evil thoughts? **5** Listen, my beloved brothers: Has not God chosen the poor of this world to be rich in faith and to inherit the kingdom He promised those who love Him? **6** But you have dishonored the poor. Is it not the rich who oppress you and drag you into court? **7** Are they not the ones who blaspheme the noble name by which you have been called? **8** If you really fulfill the royal law stated in Scripture, “Love your neighbor as yourself,” you are doing well. **9** But if you show favoritism, you sin and are convicted by the law as transgressors.

*English (WEB)*

**1** My brothers, don’t hold the faith of our glorious Lord Jesus Christ with partiality. **2** For if a man with a gold ring, in fine clothing, comes into your synagogue, and a poor man in filthy clothing also comes in, **3** and you pay special attention to him who wears the fine clothing and say, “Sit here in a good place;” and you tell the poor man, “Stand there,” or “Sit by my footstool” **4** haven’t you shown partiality among yourselves, and become judges with evil thoughts? **5** Listen, my beloved brothers. Didn’t God choose those who are poor in this world to be rich in faith and heirs of the Kingdom which he promised to those who love him? **6** But you have dishonored the poor man. Don’t the rich oppress you and personally drag you before the courts? **7** Don’t they blaspheme the honorable name by which you are called? **8** However, if you fulfill the royal law according to the Scripture, “You shall love your neighbor as yourself,” you do well. **9** But if you show partiality, you commit sin, being convicted by the law as transgressors.

## 2 Peter 2:18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** ὑπέρογκα γὰρ ματαιότητος φθεγγόμενοι δελεάζουσιν ἐν ἐπιθυμίαις σαρκὸς ἀσελγείαις τοὺς ὀλίγως ἀποφεύγοντας τοὺς ἐν πλάνῃ ἀναστρεφομένους,

*English (BSB)*

**18** With lofty but empty words, they appeal to the sensual passions of the flesh and entice those who are just escaping from others who live in error.

*English (WEB)*

**18** For, uttering great swelling words of emptiness, they entice in the lusts of the flesh, by licentiousness, those who are indeed escaping from those who live in error;

## 1 Enoch 5:4

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**4** But ye—ye have not been steadfast, nor done the commandments of the Lord, But ye have turned away and spoken proud and hard words With your impure mouths against His greatness. Oh, ye hard-hearted, ye shall find no peace.

## 1 Enoch 101:3

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**3** And if He sends His anger upon you because of your deeds, ye cannot petition Him; for ye spake proud and insolent words against His righteousness: therefore ye shall have no peace.

# Chapter 10. Remember What the Apostles Said (Jude 17–19)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **17** Ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί, μνήσθητε τῶν ῥημάτων τῶν προειρημένων ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ· **18** ὅτι ἔλεγον ὑμῖν· Ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου ἔσονται ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἑαυτῶν ἐπιθυμίας πορευόμενοι τῶν ἀσεβειῶν. **19** οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες, ψυχικοί, πνεῦμα μὴ ἔχοντες.
>
> — Jude 17–19, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript’s first hand, and $^{\text{corr}}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | ἔσονται | ‘there will be’ | P72 א* B C* K L |
| 18 | ἐλεύσονται | ‘there will come’ | א$^{\text{corr}}$ A C$^{\text{corr}}$ 1739 |
| 18 | ἀναστήσονται | ‘there will arise’ | Ψ |
| 18 | ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου | ‘in the last time’ | P72 B C Ψ |
| 18 | ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου τοῦ χρόνου | ‘at the last of the time’ | א A |
| 18 | ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου τῶν χρόνων | ‘at the last of the times’ | 1739 |
| 18 | ἐν ἐσχάτῳ χρόνῳ | ‘in the last time’ | K L |

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες | ‘those who cause divisions’ | P72 ℵ A B Ψ K L 1739* |
| 19 | οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες ἑαυτούς | ‘those who separate themselves’ | C 1739$^{corr}$ |

Notes. v. 17: no difference that affects translation (A and 1739 place προειρημένων before ῥημάτων; 1739 reads μνημονεύετε, ‘remember’); not extant in P78. v. 18: not extant in P78. v. 19: not extant in P78.

## The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

### Jude 17

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | But ye beloved remember the wordes which were spoken before of the Apostles of oure lorde Iesus Christ |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | But, yee beloued, remember the wordes which were spoken before of the Apostles of our Lord Iesus Christ, |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | But you, my dearly beloved, be mindful of the words which have been spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ, |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | But, beloved, remember ye the words which were spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ; |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | But do ye, beloved, remember the words which were before spoken by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ; |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | But ye, beloved, remember ye the words which have been spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ; |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | But ye, beloved, remember the words spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ, |
| **YLT** Young’s Literal Translation (1898) | and ye, beloved, remember ye the sayings spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ: |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | But ye, beloved, remember ye the words which have been spoken before by the |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ; |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | But you, beloved, remember the words which have been spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | But you people whom I love need to remember the things that were predicted by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ {that the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ said would happen}. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | But you should, dear friends, recall what was foretold by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ; |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | But you, beloved, remember the words that were spoken in the past by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | But you, my dear friends, please remember what you were told by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | but you, beloved, remember the sayings spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | But you, beloved, remember what was foretold by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | But you, beloved, remember what was foretold by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | But you, beloved, must remember what the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ foretold, |

### Jude 18

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | how that they tolde you that ther shulde be begylers in the last tyme which shuld walke after ther awne vngodly lustes. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | How that they told you that there should be mockers in ye last time, which should walke after their owne vngodly lustes. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Who told you, that in the last time there should come mockers, walking according to their own desires in ungodlinesses. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | That they told you there would be mockers in the last time, who would walk after their |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | own ungodly lusts. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | that they told you that at the last time there would be scoffers, walking according to their own ungodly lusts. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | how that they said to you, In the last time there shall be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | that they said to you, that at [the] end of the time there should be mockers, walking after their own lusts of ungodlinesses. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | that they said to you, that in the last time there shall be scoffers, after their own desires of impieties going on, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | that they said to you, In the last time there shall be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | They said to you, "In the last time there will be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts." |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | They told you, "In the final period of time in which we are now living there will be people who will laugh at the truths that God has revealed. They will do the ◄ungodly things/things that are displeasing to God► that their bodies desire." |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | how they used to say to you – 'As time draws to an end, there will be scoffers, who will be led by their godless passions.' |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | They said to you, "In the last time there will be mockers who will follow their own ungodly desires." |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | They explained to you that in the last times mockers would come, following their own wicked desires. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | that they said to you, that in the last time there will be scoffers, following after their own lusts of impieties, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | when they said to you, "In the last times there will be scoffers who will follow after their own ungodly desires." |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | when they said to you, "In the last times there will be scoffers who will follow after their own ungodly desires." |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | how they said to you, "In the end times there will be scoffers who walk according to |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | their own ungodly lusts.” |

### Jude 19

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | These are makers of sectes fleshlie havynge no sprete. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | These are they that separate them selues from other, naturall, hauing not the Spirit. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | These are they, who separate themselves, sensual men, having not the Spirit. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | These are they who separate themselves, sensual, having not the Spirit. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | These are they that separate themselves, sensual, not having the Spirit. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | These are they who make separations, sensual, having not the Spirit. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | These are they who set [themselves] apart, natural [men], not having [the] Spirit. |
| **YLT** Young’s Literal Translation (1898) | these are those setting themselves apart, natural men, the Spirit not having. |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | These are they who make separations, sensual, having not the Spirit. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | These are those who cause divisions and are sensual, not having the Spirit. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | That describes the teachers of false doctrine well, because they are the ones who cause divisions among believers. They do what their own minds tell them to do. The Spirit of God does not live within them. Jude 20-21 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | These are the people – animal and unspiritual – who cause divisions. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | It is these who cause divisions; they are worldly and they do not have the Spirit. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | They cause divisions; they are worldly people who don’t have the Spirit. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | these are those causing divisions, natural men, not having the Spirit. |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | These are the ones who cause divisions, who are worldly and devoid of the Spirit. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | These are the ones who cause divisions, who are worldly and devoid of the Spirit. |

| Translation | Text |
| --- | --- |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | These people cause divisions; they are worldly and do not have the Spirit. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

With “but you, beloved,” Jude turns from the intruders to his readers. He has been building his case from ancient sources: Israel’s history, angelic traditions, the stories of Cain, Balaam, and Korah, and Enoch’s prophecy. Now he brings it close to home. The readers themselves had heard the apostles warn that in the last days there would be scoffers, driven by ungodly desires. The intruders fulfill that prediction. In Jude’s final description of them, they are people who create divisions, who are merely “natural” in their outlook, and who do not have the Spirit.

This is the last “text and application” unit in the letter. Its text is not an ancient prophecy but the recent teaching of the apostles, and its application is the most theologically pointed charge of all: the people who claim spiritual revelation do not have the Spirit.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### Ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί (*Hymeis de, agapētoi*) — ‘but you, beloved’

The Greek Ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί (*Hymeis de, agapētoi*) places the pronoun “you” first for emphasis: “*But you*, beloved.” It marks a sharp contrast with the repeated “these” (οὗτοι, *houtoi*) of the previous verses. This is the second of Jude’s three addresses to the “beloved” (vv. 3, 17, 20), and it begins the turn toward the readers that will carry through to the end of the letter.

### μνήσθητε (*mnēsthēte*) — ‘remember’

The aorist imperative μνήσθητε (*mnēsthēte*), “remember,” is Jude’s first direct command to his readers. In the Bible, remembering is never merely recalling information. It means calling the past into the present so that it shapes action. Moses tells Israel, “you have remembered all the way which your God YHWH has caused you to go these forty years in the wilderness, in order to humble you” (Deut 8:2, LSV). Paul writes, “Remember Jesus Christ, raised out of the dead” (2 Tim 2:8, LSV). Jude began the main body of his letter with “I intend to remind you” (v. 5). Now he asks his readers to do their own remembering.

### τῶν ῥημάτων τῶν προειρημένων ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ (*tōn rhēmatōn tōn proeirēmenōn hypo tōn apostolōn tou kyriou hēmōn Iēsou Christou*) — ‘the

### words spoken beforehand by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ’

The readers are to remember τῶν ῥημάτων τῶν προειρημένων ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων (*tōn rhēmatōn tōn proeirēmenōn hypo tōn apostolōn*), “the words spoken beforehand by the apostles.” The perfect participle προειρημένων (*proeirēmenōn*), “spoken before” or “foretold,” stresses that the warning was given in advance and still stands.

Two observations follow:

1. **Jude distinguishes himself from “the apostles.”** He does not say “we apostles.” This fits the author’s modest self-description in v. 1 and is one of the reasons for thinking that the author did not claim apostolic status. Some scholars have read the phrase as evidence that the apostles belonged to a past generation and that the letter is therefore late. The next verse suggests otherwise: the apostles had spoken “to you,” to the readers themselves.
2. **The apostles’ words are placed alongside the prophets.** Jude has cited Israel’s history and Enoch’s prophecy. Now he adds the apostles’ teaching as a further authority. Second Peter’s parallel makes the pairing explicit: “to be mindful of the sayings said before by the holy prophets, and of the command of us the apostles of the LORD and Savior” (2 Pet 3:2, LSV). For the early church, the prophets and the apostles together were the foundation of the faith (Eph 2:20).

### ὅτι ἔλεγον ὑμῖν (*hoti elegon hymin*) — ‘for they kept telling you’

The imperfect ἔλεγον (*elegon*), “they were saying” or “they used to say,” suggests repeated teaching rather than a single statement. The warning about scoffers was a regular part of apostolic instruction. And it was said ὑμῖν (*hymin*), “to you.” Jude’s readers had heard it firsthand, probably from the missionaries who founded their community. That detail points to a date within the first generation or so of the church. It also makes Jude’s appeal personal. He is not citing a distant authority. He is reminding them of what they themselves heard.

What did the apostles say? The New Testament preserves several such warnings. Paul told the Ephesian elders: “there will enter in, after my departing, grievous wolves to you, not sparing the flock, and there will arise men of your own selves, speaking perverse things, to draw away the disciples after them” (Acts 20:29–30, LSV). He told Timothy that “in latter times some will depart from the faith” (1 Tim 4:1, LSV) and that “in the last days there will come perilous times, for men will be lovers of themselves, lovers of money, boasters, proud, slanderous … unthankful … lovers of pleasure more than lovers of God, having a form of piety, but having denied its power” (2 Tim 3:1–

5, LSV). Jesus himself had warned: “many false prophets will arise, and will lead many astray” (Matt 24:11, LSV); “behold, I have foretold you all things” (Mark 13:23, LSV). Jude’s summary does not quote any of these passages directly, but it reflects the same tradition of prophetic warning.

### Ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου ἔσονται ἐμπαῖκται (*Ep’ eschatou chronou esontai empaiktai*) — ‘in the last time there will be scoffers’

The phrase ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου (*ep’ eschatou chronou*), “at the last time,” reflects the conviction, shared by the whole New Testament, that the coming of Christ inaugurated the “last days.” Hebrews says God has spoken “in these last days … in [His] Son” (Heb 1:2, LSV). Peter at Pentecost quoted Joel’s promise of what would happen “in the last days” (Acts 2:17). John says, “Little youths, it is the last hour” (1 John 2:18, LSV). The “last time” is not a distant future. It is the period in which the church lives, between Christ’s first coming and his return.

**A textual note.** The manuscripts differ in the wording of this phrase. The Byzantine text and TR read ἐν ἐσχάτῳ χρόνῳ (*en eschatō chronō*), “in the last time.” NA27 read ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου τοῦ χρόνου, with the article. SBLGNT and NA28 read ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου. Some manuscripts also add a second ὅτι (“that”) before the quotation. The sense is unaffected.[144]

The **scoffers** (ἐμπαῖκται, *empaiktai*) are “mockers,” people who ridicule. The word appears in the New Testament only here and in 2 Pet 3:3.[145] In 2 Peter the scoffers mock the promise of Christ’s return: “Where is the promise of His coming? For since the fathers fell asleep, all things so remain from the beginning of the creation” (2 Pet 3:4, LSV). Jude does not specify the object of their mockery. In the context of his letter it is most naturally the moral demands of the faith and the warning of judgment. The intruders treat God’s judgment as a joke, and their way of life follows from it. The “scorner” of Israel’s wisdom literature is a similar figure: “O the blessedness of that one, … And has not sat in the seat of scorners” (Ps 1:1, LSV). Proverbs adds, “Do not reprove a scorner, lest he hate you” (Prov 9:8, LSV).

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144. SBLGNT apparatus and eBible.org SBLGNT notes: “ὑμῖν WH NA28 ] + ὅτι Treg NA27 RP • Ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου WH Treg NA28 ] Ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου τοῦ χρόνου NA27; ἐν ἐσχάτῳ χρόνῳ RP.” ↩

145. Computed from MorphGNT/SBLGNT. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἐμπαίκτης: “a mocker: II Pe 3:3, Ju 18,” noting one LXX occurrence (Isa 3:4). ↩

### κατὰ τὰς ἑαυτῶν ἐπιθυμίας πορευόμενοι τῶν ἀσεβειῶν (*kata tas heautōn epithymias poreuomenoi tōn asebeiōn*) — ‘living by their own impious desires’

The scoffers are κατὰ τὰς ἐαυτῶν ἐπιθυμίας πορευόμενοι τῶν ἀσεβειῶν (*kata tas heautōn epithymias poreuomenoi tōn asebeiōn*), literally "going according to their own desires of ungodlinesses." The genitive "of impieties" describes the kind of desires: ungodly desires. The phrase echoes v. 16 almost word for word ("walking according to their own lusts") and adds Jude's key word one last time: ἀσέβεια, "impiety." From v. 4, through the fourfold repetition in the Enoch quotation (v. 15), to here, the intruders are consistently the "ungodly."

### οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες (*houtoi eisin hoi apodiorizontes*) — 'these are the ones who cause divisions'

The final application begins with the familiar formula, Οὗτοί εἰσιν (*Houtoi eisin*), "These are." The first description is οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες (*hoi apodiorizontes*). The verb, found only here in the New Testament, means "to mark off, separate, make distinctions."[146] It is built from ὅρος (*horos*, "boundary") with prefixes meaning "away" and "through." The intruders draw lines through the community.

Two senses are possible:

1. **"Those who cause divisions."** The intruders create factions, separating their followers from the rest of the community. Paul warns against "those who are causing the divisions and the stumbling-blocks, contrary to the teaching that you learned" (Rom 16:17, LSV), and lists "dissensions, sects" among the works of the flesh (Gal 5:20, LSV).
2. **"Those who make distinctions."** The intruders classify people into spiritual ranks, regarding themselves as the truly "spiritual" and others as inferior. This reading fits the next word, ψυχικοί, especially if that was a term the intruders used for others.

The two senses overlap. Drawing distinctions of spiritual rank is a way of dividing a community. The Textus Receptus adds ἑαυτούς (*heautous*), "themselves," which gives Webster's "These are they who separate themselves" (WBS), as though the intruders withdrew from the community. Most manuscripts and the critical editions lack the word.[147] Jude's picture is not of people who have left but of people who divide from within. They still sit at the love feasts (v. 12).

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146. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀποδιορίζω: "to mark off, hence metaph. to make separations: Ju 19."↩

147. The TR (Scrivener) reads οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες ἑαυτούς. The Text-Critical Greek NT notes give the reading with ἑαυτούς in about 21% of manuscripts. Clement of Alexandria paraphrased: "Those, he says, separating the faithful from the unfaithful" (*Adumbrationes* on Jude 19, ANF 2).↩

### ψυχικοί (*psychikoi*) — ‘unspiritual, merely natural people’

The adjective ψυχικοί (*psychikoi*) is difficult to translate. It derives from ψυχή (*psychē*), “soul, life,” and describes what belongs to ordinary, natural human life as opposed to what belongs to the Spirit of God.[148] The LSV has “natural men,” the WEB and Webster “sensual” (WEB, WBS), and the BSB “worldly” (BSB).

Paul uses the word in a similar contrast: “the natural man does not receive the things of the Spirit of God, for they are foolishness to him … and he who is spiritual, indeed discerns all things” (1 Cor 2:14–15, LSV). He also contrasts the “natural body” with the “spiritual body” of the resurrection (1 Cor 15:44). James describes a false wisdom as “earthly, physical, demon-like” (Jas 3:15, LSV), where “physical” translates the same Greek word.

The term carries a sharp irony. If the intruders claimed spiritual superiority through their dreams and visions, and perhaps used “natural” (*psychikoi*) as a label for less enlightened believers, Jude turns their own category back on them. *They* are the merely natural ones. A century later, some Gnostic groups divided humanity into “spiritual,” “natural” (*psychikoi*), and “material” classes. Jude’s opponents were not second-century Gnostics, and it would be anachronistic to read that system into the letter. The Corinthian correspondence shows, however, that the contrast between “natural” and “spiritual” people was already being used in early Christian disputes about status.

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148. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ψυχικός: “of the ψυχή (as the lower part of the immaterial in man), EV, natural: opp. to πνευματικός, I Co 2:14 15:44, 46; πνεῦμα μὴ ἔχοντες … Ju 19.”↩

### πνεῦμα μὴ ἔχοντες (*pneuma mē echontes*) — ‘not having the Spirit’

The final phrase, πνεῦμα μὴ ἔχοντες (*pneuma mē echontes*), “not having the Spirit,” is the most serious charge in the letter. In the New Testament, possessing the Holy Spirit is the mark of belonging to Christ. Paul writes: “if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ—this one is not His” (Rom 8:9, LSV), and “in one Spirit we were all immersed into one body” (1 Cor 12:13, LSV).

The intruders, who appear to have claimed special spiritual experiences, are in Jude’s judgment devoid of the Spirit. Their dreams (v. 8) were not the Spirit’s gift. Their conduct, with its immorality, greed, grumbling, arrogance, and divisiveness, is the opposite of the fruit of the Spirit. The very next verse urges the readers to pray “in the Holy Spirit” (v. 20). Jude’s contrast is complete: the intruders lack the Spirit, while the readers pray in the Spirit.

(The Greek word πνεῦμα has no article here and could in principle mean "spirit" in a general sense: "not having a spirit," that is, being merely soulish and lacking a spiritual dimension. Given the New Testament usage and the contrast with v. 20, most interpreters take it as the Holy Spirit.)

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ὑμεῖς δέ | *hymeis de* | but you | "but you" | Emphatic contrast with "these." |
| μιμνήσκομαι | *mimnēskomai* | remember | "remember" | Aorist imperative. |
| ῥῆμα | *rhēma* | word, saying | "the sayings" | |
| προλέγω | *prolegō* | say beforehand, foretell | "spoken before" | Perfect passive participle. |
| ἀπόστολος | *apostolos* | apostle, sent one | "the apostles" | Jude does not include himself. |
| ἔλεγον | *elegon* | they were saying | "they said" | Imperfect: repeated teaching. |
| ἔσχατος χρόνος | *eschatos chronos* | last time | "the last time" | Variants in wording. |
| ἐμπαίκτης | *empaiktēs* | mocker, scoffer | "scoffers" | Only here and 2 Pet 3:3. |
| ἐπιθυμία | *epithymia* | desire | "lusts" | Repeats v. 16. |
| ἀσέβεια | *asebeia* | impiety | "impieties" | Final use of the key word. |
| ἀποδιορίζω | *apodiorizō* | mark off, make divisions | "causing divisions" | NT hapax. TR adds ἑαυτούς. |
| ψυχικός | *psychikos* | natural, soulish, unspiritual | "natural men" | 1 Cor 2:14; 15:44; Jas 3:15. |
| πνεῦμα | *pneuma* | spirit, Spirit | "the Spirit" | The Holy Spirit (cf. v. 20). |

**A caution about ψυχικός.** It is tempting to build a doctrine of human nature, body, soul, and spirit, on words like ψυχικός. That is not Jude's purpose, nor Paul's in 1 Corinthians. The word describes an *orientation*: life lived on the level of ordinary human impulses, without the transforming presence of God's Spirit. It does not mean that the soul is bad or that the Spirit replaces human nature.

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Apostolic teaching and its transmission.** In the first decades of the church, the apostles and their associates traveled among the churches teaching, and their teaching was passed on orally before and alongside written letters. Jude's readers had heard apostolic warnings "said to you." The phrase gives a glimpse of the early process by which communities received, remembered, and relied on the apostles' words, the same process that eventually led to the collection of the New Testament writings.

**Factions and spiritual elitism.** The churches of the first century were small communities in which differences of background, status, and spiritual experience could easily harden into factions. The Corinthian church divided around favored teachers ("I, indeed, am of Paul," 1 Cor 3:4, LSV) and around spiritual gifts (1 Cor 12–14). Jude's intruders seem to have created a similar division, with their followers presented as the truly spiritual.

**"Last days" expectation.** Jewish apocalyptic thought expected a period of intensified evil and apostasy before God's final intervention. Early Christians believed that this period had begun with Christ, and they interpreted false teaching and moral collapse within the church as signs of it (1 John 2:18–19; 2 Tim 3:1–5). Jude shares that outlook.

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**2 Peter 3:1–4 (literary parallel).** Peter's version of this passage pairs the prophets and the apostles and specifies that the scoffers mock the promise of Christ's coming. The relationship between the two letters is especially close here.

**Acts 20:29–30; 1 Timothy 4:1; 2 Timothy 3:1–5; 4:3–4 (apostolic predictions).** These passages illustrate the kind of warning Jude's readers had heard. Note especially 2 Tim 4:3: people "will heap up teachers according to their own desires" (LSV).

**Matthew 24:11, 24; Mark 13:22–23 (dominical predictions).** Jesus' warnings about false prophets in the last days are the root of the apostolic tradition.

**1 John 2:18–19 (shared situation).** John's opponents "went forth out of us, but they were not of us" (1 John 2:19, LSV). Jude's intruders, by contrast, are still within the community, causing division from inside.

**1 Corinthians 2:14–15; 15:44–46; James 3:15 (vocabulary).** The contrast between the "natural" and the "spiritual."

**Romans 8:9; 1 Corinthians 12:13 (theology of the Spirit).** Having the Spirit is the mark of belonging to Christ.

**Romans 16:17; 1 Corinthians 1:10; 3:3–4; Galatians 5:20 (divisions).** Paul's warnings against division illuminate Jude's charge.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Does v. 17 show that Jude is late?** Some argue that the reference to "the apostles" as a group whose words are remembered implies a post-apostolic date. Others point out that v. 18 says the apostles spoke "to you," the readers, which places the letter within the lifetime of people who had heard the apostles. The verse is compatible with an early or a later date, but it does not require a late one.

**2. Which apostles?** Jude does not name them. The readers may have been evangelized by Paul, by Peter, or by other apostles and missionaries. Since the warning is generic, the question cannot be settled.

**3. Did the intruders use the term ψυχικοί?** It is an attractive hypothesis, especially given the parallel in 1 Corinthians, but it cannot be proven from Jude alone. What is certain is that Jude uses the term to deny the intruders' spiritual claims.

**4. Can someone in the church "not have the Spirit"?** Jude's judgment raises a pastoral and theological question. Christian traditions differ on how to understand people who are outwardly part of the church but show no evidence of the Spirit's work. Some understand them as never having been truly regenerate. Others see them as having fallen away, and others again allow for degrees of unfaithfulness. Jude does not offer a theory. His purpose is to warn his readers not to mistake the intruders' claims for spiritual reality. Notably, he still holds out hope of rescue for those influenced by them (vv. 22–23).

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verses 17–19 complete the long central section that began in v. 5. They form the fifth "text and application" unit, and the pattern of the whole section is now visible:

| Text | Application |
|---|---|
| Three examples of judgment (vv. 5–7) | "those dreaming…" (v. 8) |
| Michael and the Devil (v. 9) | "these … speak evil" (v. 10) |
| Cain, Balaam, Korah (v. 11) | "These are stains…" (vv. 12–13) |
| Enoch's prophecy (vv. 14–15) | "These are … grumblers" (v. 16) |

| Text | Application |
|---|---|
| The apostles' prediction (vv. 17–18) | "these are those causing divisions" (v. 19) |

The texts move from the distant past to the recent past, from the exodus to the readers' own memory of the apostles. The last application is the climax: the intruders lack the Spirit. That sets up the contrast with which the next section opens: "But you, beloved, … praying in the Holy Spirit" (v. 20).

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**The discipline of remembering.** Jude does not tell his readers to figure out new strategies. He tells them to remember. Christian communities today may find stability in recalling what they have received, in Scripture, creeds, and the teaching of faithful predecessors, rather than in perpetual novelty.

**Warnings as gifts.** The apostles warned their converts about future false teachers. Warning is an act of love. Leaders and parents who prepare others for difficulty are doing apostolic work.

**Spiritual elitism.** The intruders seem to have divided the community into the spiritual and the merely natural. Every era has its versions: groups that claim superior experience, knowledge, or holiness and look down on ordinary believers. Jude's verdict, that such dividers may themselves be "natural" and "not having the Spirit," is a warning against spiritual pride in every form, including in those who oppose the intruders.

**The evidence of the Spirit.** Jude's charge that the intruders lack the Spirit invites a question for every believer: what is the evidence of the Spirit's presence? The New Testament answers with love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control (Gal 5:22–23), unity (Eph 4:3), and prayer (Jude 20), rather than with dramatic experiences alone.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Jude tells his readers to "remember." What specific teachings or warnings do you think Christians today most need to remember?
2. The apostles warned that "scoffers" would come. What forms does scoffing at faith take today, both outside and inside the church?
3. How can a community distinguish between healthy diversity and divisive factionalism?
4. What does it mean to "have the Spirit"? How would you recognize the Spirit's presence in a person or community?

5. Spiritual elitism divided Jude’s community. Where might spiritual pride show up in your own context, perhaps even among those who consider themselves defenders of the faith?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT and apparatus (NA27/NA28 data); TR (ἑαυτούς in v. 19).
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. ἐμπαίκτης, ἀποδιορίζω, ψυχικός.
- Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 19, ANF 2.
- Word counts: MorphGNT/SBLGNT.

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Deuteronomy 8:2

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**2** וְזָכַרְתָּ֞ אֶת־כָּל־הַדֶּ֣רֶךְ אֲשֶׁר֩ הֹלִיכֲךָ֨ יְהוָ֜ה אֱלֹהֶ֗יךָ זֶ֣ה אַרְבָּעִ֤ים שָׁנָה֙ בַּמִּדְבָּ֔ר לְמַ֨עַן עַנֹּתְךָ֔ לְנַסֹּתְךָ֖ לָדַ֣עַת אֶת־אֲשֶׁ֤ר בִּלְבָבְךָ֙ הֲתִשְׁמֹ֣ר מצותו אִם־לֹֽא

*English (BSB)*

**2** Remember that these forty years the LORD your God led you all the way in the wilderness, so that He might humble you and test you in order to know what was in your heart, whether or not you would keep His commandments.

*English (WEB)*

**2** You shall remember all the way which the LORD your God has led you these forty years in the wilderness, that he might humble you, to test you, to know what was in your heart, whether you would keep his commandments or not.

### Psalm 1:1

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** אַשְׁרֵי־הָאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר לֹא הָלַךְ בַּעֲצַת רְשָׁעִים וּבְדֶרֶךְ חַטָּאִים לֹא עָמָד וּבְמוֹשַׁב לֵצִים לֹא יָשָׁב

*English (BSB)*

**1** Blessed is the man who does not walk in the counsel of the wicked, or set foot on the path of sinners, or sit in the seat of mockers.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Blessed is the man who doesn’t walk in the counsel of the wicked, nor stand on the path of sinners, nor sit in the seat of scoffers;

### Proverbs 9:8

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** אַל־תּוֹכַח לֵץ פֶּן־יִשְׂנָאֶךָּ הוֹכַח לְחָכָם וְיֶאֱהָבֶךָּ

*English (BSB)*

**8** Do not rebuke a mocker, or he will hate you; rebuke a wise man, and he will love you.

*English (WEB)*

**8** Don’t reprove a scoffer, lest he hate you. Reprove a wise person, and he will love you.

### Isaiah 3:4

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**4** וְנָתַתִּי נְעָרִים שָׂרֵיהֶם וְתַעֲלוּלִים יִמְשְׁלוּ־בָם

*English (BSB)*

**4** “I will make mere lads their leaders, and children will rule over them.”

*English (WEB)*

**4** I will give boys to be their princes, and children shall rule over them.

### Matthew 24:11, 24

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** καὶ πολλοὶ ψευδοπροφῆται ἐγερθήσονται καὶ πλανήσουσιν πολλούς· … **24** ἐγερθήσονται γὰρ ψευδόχριστοι καὶ ψευδοπροφῆται, καὶ δώσουσιν σημεῖα μεγάλα καὶ τέρατα ὥστε πλανῆσαι εἰ δυνατὸν καὶ τοὺς ἐκλεκτούς·

*English (BSB)*

**11** and many false prophets will arise and mislead many. … **24** For false Christs and false prophets will appear and perform great signs and wonders that would deceive even the elect, if that were possible.

*English (WEB)*

**11** Many false prophets will arise and will lead many astray. … **24** For false christs and false prophets will arise, and they will show great signs and wonders, so as to lead astray, if possible, even the chosen ones.

### Mark 13:22–23

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**22** ἐγερθήσονται γὰρ ψευδόχριστοι καὶ ψευδοπροφῆται καὶ δώσουσιν σημεῖα καὶ τέρατα πρὸς τὸ ἀποπλανᾶν εἰ δυνατὸν τοὺς ἐκλεκτούς· **23** ὑμεῖς δὲ βλέπετε· προείρηκα ὑμῖν πάντα.

*English (BSB)*

**22** For false Christs and false prophets will appear and perform signs and wonders that would deceive even the elect, if that were possible. **23** So be on your guard; I have told you everything in advance.

*English (WEB)*

**22** For false christs and false prophets will arise and will show signs and wonders, that they may lead astray, if possible, even the chosen ones. **23** But you watch. “Behold, I have told you all things beforehand.

### Acts 2:17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**17** Καὶ ἔσται ἐν ταῖς ἐσχάταις ἡμέραις, λέγει ὁ θεός, ἐκχεῶ ἀπὸ τοῦ πνεύματός μου ἐπὶ πᾶσαν σάρκα, καὶ προφητεύσουσιν οἱ υἱοὶ ὑμῶν καὶ αἱ θυγατέρες ὑμῶν, καὶ οἱ νεανίσκοι ὑμῶν ὁράσεις ὄψονται, καὶ οἱ πρεσβύτεροι ὑμῶν ἐνυπνίοις ἐνυπνιασθήσονται·

*English (BSB)*

**17** ’In the last days, God says, I will pour out My Spirit on all people. Your sons and daughters will prophesy, your young men will see visions, your old men will dream dreams.

*English (WEB)*

**17** ‘It will be in the last days, says God, that I will pour out my Spirit on all flesh. Your sons and your daughters will prophesy. Your young men will see visions. Your old men will dream dreams.

## Acts 20:29–30

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**29** ἐγὼ οἶδα ὅτι εἰσελεύσονται μετὰ τὴν ἄφιξίν μου λύκοι βαρεῖς εἰς ὑμᾶς μὴ φειδόμενοι τοῦ ποιμνίου, **30** καὶ ἐξ ὑμῶν αὐτῶν ἀναστήσονται ἄνδρες λαλοῦντες διεστραμμένα τοῦ ἀποσπᾶν τοὺς μαθητὰς ὀπίσω ἑαυτῶν·

*English (BSB)*

**29** I know that after my departure, savage wolves will come in among you and will not spare the flock. **30** Even from your own number, men will rise up and distort the truth to draw away disciples after them.

*English (WEB)*

**29** For I know that after my departure, vicious wolves will enter in among you, not sparing the flock. **30** Men will arise from among your own selves, speaking perverse things, to draw away the disciples after them.

## Romans 8:9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**9** Ὑμεῖς δὲ οὐκ ἐστὲ ἐν σαρκὶ ἀλλὰ ἐν πνεύματι, εἴπερ πνεῦμα θεοῦ οἰκεῖ ἐν ὑμῖν. εἰ δέ τις πνεῦμα Χριστοῦ οὐκ ἔχει, οὗτος οὐκ ἔστιν αὐτοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**9** You, however, are controlled not by the flesh, but by the Spirit, if the Spirit of God lives in you. And if anyone does not have the Spirit of Christ, he does not belong to Christ.

*English (WEB)*

**9** But you are not in the flesh but in the Spirit, if it is so that the Spirit of God dwells in you. But if any man doesn’t have the Spirit of Christ, he is not his.

## Romans 16:17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**17** Παρακαλῶ δὲ ὑμᾶς, ἀδελφοί, σκοπεῖν τοὺς τὰς διχοστασίας καὶ τὰ σκάνδαλα παρὰ τὴν διδαχὴν ἣν ὑμεῖς ἐμάθετε ποιοῦντας, καὶ ἐκκλίνετε ἀπ᾽ αὐτῶν·

*English (BSB)*

**17** Now I urge you, brothers, to watch out for those who create divisions and obstacles that are contrary to the teaching you have learned. Turn away from them.

*English (WEB)*

**17** Now I beg you, brothers, look out for those who are causing the divisions and occasions of stumbling, contrary to the doctrine which you learned, and turn away from them.

## 1 Corinthians 2:14–15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** Ψυχικὸς δὲ ἄνθρωπος οὐ δέχεται τὰ τοῦ πνεύματος τοῦ θεοῦ, μωρία γὰρ αὐτῷ ἐστίν, καὶ οὐ δύναται γνῶναι, ὅτι πνευματικῶς ἀνακρίνεται· **15** ὁ δὲ πνευματικὸς ἀνακρίνει τὰ πάντα, αὐτὸς δὲ ὑπ᾽ οὐδενὸς ἀνακρίνεται.

*English (BSB)*

**14** The natural man does not accept the things that come from the Spirit of God. For they are foolishness to him, and he cannot understand them, because they are spiritually discerned. **15** The spiritual man judges all things, but he himself is not subject to anyone’s judgment.

*English (WEB)*

**14** Now the natural man doesn’t receive the things of God’s Spirit, for they are foolishness to him; and he can’t know them, because they are spiritually discerned. **15** But he who is spiritual discerns all things, and he himself is to be judged by no one.

## 1 Corinthians 3:4

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** ὅταν γὰρ λέγῃ τις· Ἐγὼ μέν εἰμι Παύλου, ἕτερος δέ· Ἐγὼ Ἀπολλῶ, οὐκ ἄνθρωποί ἐστε;

*English (BSB)*

**4** For when one of you says, “I follow Paul,” and another, “I follow Apollos,” are you not mere men?

*English (WEB)*

**4** For when one says, “I follow Paul,” and another, “I follow Apollos,” aren’t you fleshly?

## 1 Corinthians 12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Περὶ δὲ τῶν πνευματικῶν, ἀδελφοί, οὐ θέλω ὑμᾶς ἀγνοεῖν. **2** οἴδατε ὅτι ὅτε ἔθνη ἦτε πρὸς τὰ εἴδωλα τὰ ἄφωνα ὡς ἂν ἤγεσθε ἀπαγόμενοι. **3** διὸ γνωρίζω ὑμῖν ὅτι οὐδεὶς ἐν πνεύματι θεοῦ λαλῶν λέγει· Ἀνάθεμα Ἰησοῦς, καὶ οὐδεὶς δύναται εἰπεῖν· Κύριος Ἰησοῦς εἰ μὴ ἐν πνεύματι ἁγίῳ. **4** Διαιρέσεις δὲ χαρισμάτων εἰσίν, τὸ δὲ αὐτὸ πνεῦμα· **5** καὶ διαιρέσεις διακονιῶν εἰσιν, καὶ ὁ αὐτὸς κύριος· **6** καὶ διαιρέσεις ἐνεργημάτων εἰσίν, ὁ δὲ αὐτὸς θεός, ὁ ἐνεργῶν τὰ πάντα ἐν πᾶσιν. **7** ἑκάστῳ δὲ δίδοται ἡ φανέρωσις τοῦ πνεύματος πρὸς τὸ συμφέρον. **8** ᾧ μὲν γὰρ διὰ τοῦ πνεύματος δίδοται λόγος σοφίας, ἄλλῳ δὲ λόγος γνώσεως κατὰ τὸ αὐτὸ πνεῦμα, **9** ἑτέρῳ πίστις ἐν τῷ αὐτῷ πνεύματι, ἄλλῳ χαρίσματα ἰαμάτων ἐν τῷ ἑνὶ πνεύματι, **10** ἄλλῳ ἐνεργήματα δυνάμεων, ἄλλῳ προφητεία, 1ἄλλῳ διακρίσεις πνευμάτων, ἑτέρῳ γένη γλωσσῶν, 2ἄλλῳ ἑρμηνεία γλωσσῶν· **11** πάντα δὲ ταῦτα ἐνεργεῖ τὸ ἓν καὶ τὸ αὐτὸ πνεῦμα, διαιροῦν ἰδίᾳ ἑκάστῳ καθὼς βούλεται. **12** Καθάπερ γὰρ τὸ σῶμα ἕν ἐστιν καὶ μέλη πολλὰ ἔχει, πάντα δὲ τὰ μέλη τοῦ σώματος πολλὰ ὄντα ἕν ἐστιν σῶμα, οὕτως καὶ ὁ Χριστός· **13** καὶ γὰρ ἐν ἑνὶ πνεύματι ἡμεῖς πάντες εἰς ἓν σῶμα ἐβαπτίσθημεν, εἴτε Ἰουδαῖοι εἴτε Ἕλληνες, εἴτε δοῦλοι εἴτε ἐλεύθεροι, καὶ πάντες ἓν πνεῦμα ἐποτίσθημεν. **14** Καὶ γὰρ τὸ σῶμα οὐκ ἔστιν ἓν μέλος ἀλλὰ πολλά. **15** ἐὰν εἴπῃ ὁ πούς· Ὅτι οὐκ εἰμὶ χείρ, οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ σώματος, οὐ παρὰ τοῦτο οὐκ ἔστιν ἐκ τοῦ σώματος; **16** καὶ ἐὰν εἴπῃ τὸ οὖς· Ὅτι οὐκ εἰμὶ ὀφθαλμός, οὐκ εἰμὶ ἐκ τοῦ σώματος, οὐ παρὰ τοῦτο οὐκ ἔστιν ἐκ τοῦ σώματος· **17** εἰ ὅλον τὸ σῶμα ὀφθαλμός, ποῦ ἡ ἀκοή; εἰ ὅλον ἀκοή, ποῦ ἡ ὄσφρησις; **18** νυνὶ δὲ ὁ θεὸς ἔθετο τὰ μέλη, ἓν ἕκαστον αὐτῶν, ἐν τῷ σώματι καθὼς ἠθέλησεν. **19** εἰ δὲ ἦν τὰ πάντα ἓν μέλος, ποῦ τὸ σῶμα; **20** νῦν δὲ πολλὰ μὲν μέλη, ἓν δὲ σῶμα. **21** οὐ δύναται δὲ ὁ ὀφθαλμὸς εἰπεῖν τῇ χειρί· Χρείαν σου οὐκ ἔχω, ἢ πάλιν ἡ κεφαλὴ τοῖς ποσίν· Χρείαν ὑμῶν οὐκ ἔχω· **22** ἀλλὰ πολλῷ μᾶλλον τὰ δοκοῦντα μέλη τοῦ σώματος ἀσθενέστερα ὑπάρχειν ἀναγκαῖά ἐστιν, **23** καὶ ἃ δοκοῦμεν ἀτιμότερα εἶναι τοῦ σώματος, τούτοις τιμὴν περισσοτέραν περιτίθεμεν, καὶ τὰ ἀσχήμονα ἡμῶν εὐσχημοσύνην περισσοτέραν ἔχει, **24** τὰ δὲ εὐσχήμονα ἡμῶν οὐ χρείαν ἔχει. ἀλλὰ ὁ θεὸς συνεκέρασεν τὸ σῶμα, τῷ ὑστεροῦντι περισσοτέραν δοὺς τιμήν, **25** ἵνα μὴ ᾖ σχίσμα ἐν τῷ σώματι, ἀλλὰ τὸ αὐτὸ ὑπὲρ ἀλλήλων μεριμνῶσι τὰ μέλη. **26** καὶ εἴτε πάσχει ἓν μέλος, συμπάσχει πάντα τὰ μέλη· εἴτε δοξάζεται μέλος, συγχαίρει πάντα τὰ μέλη. **27** Ὑμεῖς δέ ἐστε σῶμα Χριστοῦ καὶ μέλη ἐκ μέρους. **28** καὶ οὓς μὲν ἔθετο ὁ θεὸς ἐν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ πρῶτον ἀποστόλους, δεύτερον προφήτας, τρίτον διδασκάλους, ἔπειτα δυνάμεις, ἔπειτα χαρίσματα ἰαμάτων, ἀντιλήμψεις, κυβερνήσεις, γένη γλωσσῶν. **29** μὴ πάντες ἀπόστολοι; μὴ πάντες προφῆται; μὴ πάντες διδάσκαλοι; μὴ πάντες δυνάμεις; **30** μὴ πάντες χαρίσματα ἔχουσιν ἰαμάτων; μὴ πάντες γλώσσαις λαλοῦσιν; μὴ πάντες διερμηνεύουσιν; **31** ζηλοῦτε δὲ τὰ χαρίσματα τὰ μείζονα. καὶ ἔτι καθ’ ὑπερβολὴν ὁδὸν ὑμῖν δείκνυμι.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now about spiritual gifts, brothers, I do not want you to be uninformed. **2** You know that when you were pagans, you were influenced and led astray to mute idols. **3** Therefore I inform you that no one who is speaking by the Spirit

of God says, “Jesus be cursed,” and no one can say, “Jesus is Lord,” except by the Holy Spirit. **4** There are different gifts, but the same Spirit. **5** There are different ministries, but the same Lord. **6** There are different ways of working, but the same God works all things in all people. **7** Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good. **8** To one there is given through the Spirit the message of wisdom, to another the message of knowledge by the same Spirit, **9** to another faith by the same Spirit, to another gifts of healing by that one Spirit, **10** to another the working of miracles, to another prophecy, to another distinguishing between spirits, to another speaking in various tongues, and to still another the interpretation of tongues. **11** All these are the work of one and the same Spirit, who apportions them to each one as He determines. **12** The body is a unit, though it is composed of many parts. And although its parts are many, they all form one body. So it is with Christ. **13** For in one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, slave or free, and we were all given one Spirit to drink. **14** For the body does not consist of one part, but of many. **15** If the foot should say, “Because I am not a hand, I do not belong to the body,” that would not make it any less a part of the body. **16** And if the ear should say, “Because I am not an eye, I do not belong to the body,” that would not make it any less a part of the body. **17** If the whole body were an eye, where would the sense of hearing be? If the whole body were an ear, where would the sense of smell be? **18** But in fact, God has arranged the members of the body, every one of them, according to His design. **19** If they were all one part, where would the body be? **20** As it is, there are many parts, but one body. **21** The eye cannot say to the hand, “I do not need you.” Nor can the head say to the feet, “I do not need you.” **22** On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, **23** and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor. And our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty, **24** whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God has composed the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it, **25** so that there should be no division in the body, but that its members should have mutual concern for one another. **26** If one part suffers, every part suffers with it; if one part is honored, every part rejoices with it. **27** Now you are the body of Christ, and each of you is a member of it. **28** And in the church God has appointed first of all apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then workers of miracles, and those with gifts of healing, helping, administration, and various tongues. **29** Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Do all work miracles? **30** Do all have gifts of healing? Do all speak in tongues? Do all interpret? **31** But eagerly desire the greater gifts. And now I will show you the most excellent way.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now concerning spiritual things, brothers, I don’t want you to be ignorant. **2** You know that when you were heathen, you were led away to those mute idols,

however you might be led. **3** Therefore I make known to you that no man
speaking by God's Spirit says, "Jesus is accursed." No one can say, "Jesus is
Lord," but by the Holy Spirit. **4** Now there are various kinds of gifts, but the
same Spirit. **5** There are various kinds of service, and the same Lord. **6** There
are various kinds of workings, but the same God who works all things in all. **7**
But to each one is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the profit of all. **8**
For to one is given through the Spirit the word of wisdom, and to another the
word of knowledge according to the same Spirit, **9** to another faith by the
same Spirit, and to another gifts of healings by the same Spirit, **10** and to
another workings of miracles, and to another prophecy, and to another
discerning of spirits, to another different kinds of languages, and to another
the interpretation of languages. **11** But the one and the same Spirit produces
all of these, distributing to each one separately as he desires. **12** For as the
body is one and has many members, and all the members of the body, being
many, are one body; so also is Christ. **13** For in one Spirit we were all baptized
into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, whether bond or free; and were all
given to drink into one Spirit. **14** For the body is not one member, but many.
**15** If the foot would say, "Because I'm not the hand, I'm not part of the body,"
it is not therefore not part of the body. **16** If the ear would say, "Because I'm
not the eye, I'm not part of the body," it's not therefore not part of the body. **17**
If the whole body were an eye, where would the hearing be? If the whole were
hearing, where would the smelling be? **18** But now God has set the members,
each one of them, in the body, just as he desired. **19** If they were all one
member, where would the body be? **20** But now they are many members, but
one body. **21** The eye can't tell the hand, "I have no need for you," or again the
head to the feet, "I have no need for you." **22** No, much rather, those members
of the body which seem to be weaker are necessary. **23** Those parts of the
body which we think to be less honorable, on those we bestow more abundant
honor; and our unpresentable parts have more abundant modesty, **24** while
our presentable parts have no such need. But God composed the body
together, giving more abundant honor to the inferior part, **25** that there should
be no division in the body, but that the members should have the same care for
one another. **26** When one member suffers, all the members suffer with it.
When one member is honored, all the members rejoice with it. **27** Now you are
the body of Christ, and members individually. **28** God has set some in the
assembly: first apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then miracle
workers, then gifts of healings, helps, governments, and various kinds of
languages. **29** Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Are all
miracle workers? **30** Do all have gifts of healings? Do all speak with various
languages? Do all interpret? **31** But earnestly desire the best gifts. Moreover, I
show a most excellent way to you.

## 1 Corinthians 13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἐὰν ταῖς γλώσσαις τῶν ἀνθρώπων λαλῶ καὶ τῶν ἀγγέλων, ἀγάπην δὲ μὴ ἔχω, γέγονα χαλκὸς ἠχῶν ἢ κύμβαλον ἀλαλάζον. **2** καὶ ἐὰν ἔχω προφητείαν καὶ εἰδῶ τὰ μυστήρια πάντα καὶ πᾶσαν τὴν γνῶσιν, καὶ ἐὰν ἔχω πᾶσαν τὴν πίστιν ὥστε ὄρη μεθιστάναι, ἀγάπην δὲ μὴ ἔχω, οὐθέν εἰμι. **3** καὶ ἐὰν ψωμίσω πάντα τὰ ὑπάρχοντά μου, καὶ ἐὰν παραδῶ τὸ σῶμά μου, ἵνα καυθήσομαι, ἀγάπην δὲ μὴ ἔχω, οὐδὲν ὠφελοῦμαι. **4** Ἡ ἀγάπη μακροθυμεῖ, χρηστεύεται ἡ ἀγάπη, οὐ ζηλοῖ ἡ ἀγάπη, οὐ περπερεύεται, οὐ φυσιοῦται, **5** οὐκ ἀσχημονεῖ, οὐ ζητεῖ τὰ ἑαυτῆς, οὐ παροξύνεται, οὐ λογίζεται τὸ κακόν, **6** οὐ χαίρει ἐπὶ τῇ ἀδικίᾳ, συγχαίρει δὲ τῇ ἀληθείᾳ· **7** πάντα στέγει, πάντα πιστεύει, πάντα ἐλπίζει, πάντα ὑπομένει. **8** Ἡ ἀγάπη οὐδέποτε πίπτει. εἴτε δὲ προφητεῖαι, καταργηθήσονται· εἴτε γλῶσσαι, παύσονται· εἴτε γνῶσις, καταργηθήσεται. **9** ἐκ μέρους γὰρ γινώσκομεν καὶ ἐκ μέρους προφητεύομεν· **10** ὅταν δὲ ἔλθῃ τὸ τέλειον, τὸ ἐκ μέρους καταργηθήσεται. **11** ὅτε ἤμην νήπιος, ἐλάλουν ὡς νήπιος, ἐφρόνουν ὡς νήπιος, ἐλογιζόμην ὡς νήπιος· ὅτε γέγονα ἀνήρ, κατήργηκα τὰ τοῦ νηπίου. **12** βλέπομεν γὰρ ἄρτι δι᾽ ἐσόπτρου ἐν αἰνίγματι, τότε δὲ πρόσωπον πρὸς πρόσωπον· ἄρτι γινώσκω ἐκ μέρους, τότε δὲ ἐπιγνώσομαι καθὼς καὶ ἐπεγνώσθην. **13** νυνὶ δὲ μένει πίστις, ἐλπίς, ἀγάπη· τὰ τρία ταῦτα, μείζων δὲ τούτων ἡ ἀγάπη.

*English (BSB)*

**1** If I speak in the tongues of men and of angels, but have not love, I am only a ringing gong or a clanging cymbal. **2** If I have the gift of prophecy and can fathom all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have absolute faith so as to move mountains, but have not love, I am nothing. **3** If I give all I possess to the poor and exult in the surrender of my body, but have not love, I gain nothing. **4** Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud. **5** It is not rude, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no account of wrongs. **6** Love takes no pleasure in evil, but rejoices in the truth. **7** It bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things. **8** Love never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will cease; where there are tongues, they will be restrained; where there is knowledge, it will be dismissed. **9** For we know in part and we prophesy in part, **10** but when the perfect comes, the partial passes away. **11** When I was a child, I talked like a child, I thought like a child, I reasoned like a child. When I became a man, I set aside childish ways. **12** Now we see but a dim reflection as in a mirror; then we shall see face to face. Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I am fully known. **13** And now these three remain: faith, hope, and love; but the greatest of these is love.

*English (WEB)*

**1** If I speak with the languages of men and of angels, but don’t have love, I have become sounding brass or a clanging cymbal. **2** If I have the gift of prophecy, and know all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have all faith, so as to remove mountains, but don’t have love, I am nothing. **3** If I give away all my goods to feed the poor, and if I give my body to be burned, but don’t have love, it profits me nothing. **4** Love is patient and is kind. Love doesn’t envy. Love doesn’t brag, is not proud, **5** doesn’t behave itself inappropriately,

doesn’t seek its own way, is not provoked, takes no account of evil; **6** doesn’t rejoice in unrighteousness, but rejoices with the truth; **7** bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, and endures all things. **8** Love never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will be done away with. Where there are various languages, they will cease. Where there is knowledge, it will be done away with. **9** For we know in part and we prophesy in part; **10** but when that which is complete has come, then that which is partial will be done away with. **11** When I was a child, I spoke as a child, I felt as a child, I thought as a child. Now that I have become a man, I have put away childish things. **12** For now we see in a mirror, dimly, but then face to face. Now I know in part, but then I will know fully, even as I was also fully known. **13** But now faith, hope, and love remain—these three. The greatest of these is love.

## 1 Corinthians 14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Διώκετε τὴν ἀγάπην, ζηλοῦτε δὲ τὰ πνευματικά, μᾶλλον δὲ ἵνα προφητεύητε. **2** ὁ γὰρ λαλῶν γλώσσῃ οὐκ ἀνθρώποις λαλεῖ ἀλλὰ θεῷ, οὐδεὶς γὰρ ἀκούει, πνεύματι δὲ λαλεῖ μυστήρια· **3** ὁ δὲ προφητεύων ἀνθρώποις λαλεῖ οἰκοδομὴν καὶ παράκλησιν καὶ παραμυθίαν. **4** ὁ λαλῶν γλώσσῃ ἑαυτὸν οἰκοδομεῖ· ὁ δὲ προφητεύων ἐκκλησίαν οἰκοδομεῖ. **5** θέλω δὲ πάντας ὑμᾶς λαλεῖν γλώσσαις, μᾶλλον δὲ ἵνα προφητεύητε· μείζων δὲ ὁ προφητεύων ἢ ὁ λαλῶν γλώσσαις, ἐκτὸς εἰ μὴ διερμηνεύῃ, ἵνα ἡ ἐκκλησία οἰκοδομὴν λάβῃ. **6** Νῦν δέ, ἀδελφοί, ἐὰν ἔλθω πρὸς ὑμᾶς γλώσσαις λαλῶν, τί ὑμᾶς ὠφελήσω, ἐὰν μὴ ὑμῖν λαλήσω ἢ ἐν ἀποκαλύψει ἢ ἐν γνώσει ἢ ἐν προφητείᾳ ἢ ἐν διδαχῇ; **7** ὅμως τὰ ἄψυχα φωνὴν διδόντα, εἴτε αὐλὸς εἴτε κιθάρα, ἐὰν διαστολὴν τοῖς φθόγγοις μὴ δῷ, πῶς γνωσθήσεται τὸ αὐλούμενον ἢ τὸ κιθαριζόμενον; **8** καὶ γὰρ ἐὰν ἄδηλον φωνὴν σάλπιγξ δῷ, τίς παρασκευάσεται εἰς πόλεμον; **9** οὕτως καὶ ὑμεῖς διὰ τῆς γλώσσης ἐὰν μὴ εὔσημον λόγον δῶτε, πῶς γνωσθήσεται τὸ λαλούμενον; ἔσεσθε γὰρ εἰς ἀέρα λαλοῦντες. **10** τοσαῦτα εἰ τύχοι γένη φωνῶν εἰσιν ἐν κόσμῳ, καὶ οὐδὲν ἄφωνον· **11** ἐὰν οὖν μὴ εἰδῶ τὴν δύναμιν τῆς φωνῆς, ἔσομαι τῷ λαλοῦντι βάρβαρος καὶ ὁ λαλῶν ἐν ἐμοὶ βάρβαρος. **12** οὕτως καὶ ὑμεῖς, ἐπεὶ ζηλωταί ἐστε πνευμάτων, πρὸς τὴν οἰκοδομὴν τῆς ἐκκλησίας ζητεῖτε ἵνα περισσεύητε. **13** Διὸ ὁ λαλῶν γλώσσῃ προσευχέσθω ἵνα διερμηνεύῃ. **14** ἐὰν γὰρ προσεύχωμαι γλώσσῃ, τὸ πνεῦμά μου προσεύχεται, ὁ δὲ νοῦς μου ἄκαρπός ἐστιν. **15** τί οὖν ἐστιν; προσεύξομαι τῷ πνεύματι, προσεύξομαι δὲ καὶ τῷ νοΐ· ψαλῶ τῷ πνεύματι, ψαλῶ δὲ καὶ τῷ νοΐ· **16** ἐπεὶ ἐὰν εὐλογῇς πνεύματι, ὁ ἀναπληρῶν τὸν τόπον τοῦ ἰδιώτου πῶς ἐρεῖ τὸ Ἀμήν ἐπὶ τῇ σῇ εὐχαριστίᾳ; ἐπειδὴ τί λέγεις οὐκ οἶδεν· **17** σὺ μὲν γὰρ καλῶς εὐχαριστεῖς, ἀλλ’ ὁ ἕτερος οὐκ οἰκοδομεῖται. **18** εὐχαριστῶ τῷ θεῷ, πάντων ὑμῶν μᾶλλον γλώσσαις λαλῶ· **19** ἀλλὰ ἐν ἐκκλησίᾳ θέλω πέντε λόγους τῷ νοΐ μου λαλῆσαι, ἵνα καὶ ἄλλους κατηχήσω, ἢ μυρίους λόγους ἐν γλώσσῃ. **20** Ἀδελφοί, μὴ παιδία γίνεσθε ταῖς φρεσίν, ἀλλὰ τῇ κακίᾳ νηπιάζετε, ταῖς δὲ φρεσὶν τέλειοι γίνεσθε. **21** ἐν τῷ νόμῳ γέγραπται ὅτι Ἐν ἑτερογλώσσοις καὶ ἐν χείλεσιν ἑτέρων λαλήσω τῷ λαῷ τούτῳ, καὶ οὐδ’ οὕτως εἰσακούσονταί μου, λέγει κύριος. **22** ὥστε αἱ γλῶσσαι εἰς σημεῖόν εἰσιν οὐ τοῖς πιστεύουσιν ἀλλὰ τοῖς ἀπίστοις, ἡ δὲ προφητεία οὐ τοῖς ἀπίστοις ἀλλὰ τοῖς πιστεύουσιν. **23** ἐὰν οὖν συνέλθῃ ἡ ἐκκλησία ὅλη ἐπὶ τὸ αὐτὸ καὶ πάντες λαλῶσιν γλώσσαις, εἰσέλθωσιν δὲ ἰδιῶται ἢ ἄπιστοι, οὐκ ἐροῦσιν ὅτι μαίνεσθε; **24** ἐὰν δὲ πάντες προφητεύωσιν, εἰσέλθῃ δέ τις ἄπιστος ἢ ἰδιώτης, ἐλέγχεται ὑπὸ πάντων, ἀνακρίνεται

ὑπὸ πάντων, **25** τὰ κρυπτὰ τῆς καρδίας αὐτοῦ φανερὰ γίνεται, καὶ οὕτως πεσὼν ἐπὶ πρόσωπον προσκυνήσει τῷ θεῷ, ἀπαγγέλλων ὅτι Ὄντως ὁ θεὸς ἐν ὑμῖν ἐστιν. **26** Τί οὖν ἐστιν, ἀδελφοί; ὅταν συνέρχησθε, ἕκαστος ψαλμὸν ἔχει, διδαχὴν ἔχει, ἀποκάλυψιν ἔχει, γλῶσσαν ἔχει, ἑρμηνείαν ἔχει· πάντα πρὸς οἰκοδομὴν γινέσθω. **27** εἴτε γλώσσῃ τις λαλεῖ, κατὰ δύο ἢ τὸ πλεῖστον τρεῖς, καὶ ἀνὰ μέρος, καὶ εἷς διερμηνευέτω· **28** ἐὰν δὲ μὴ ᾖ διερμηνευτής, σιγάτω ἐν ἐκκλησίᾳ, ἑαυτῷ δὲ λαλείτω καὶ τῷ θεῷ. **29** προφῆται δὲ δύο ἢ τρεῖς λαλείτωσαν, καὶ οἱ ἄλλοι διακρινέτωσαν· **30** ἐὰν δὲ ἄλλῳ ἀποκαλυφθῇ καθημένῳ, ὁ πρῶτος σιγάτω. **31** δύνασθε γὰρ καθ' ἕνα πάντες προφητεύειν, ἵνα πάντες μανθάνωσιν καὶ πάντες παρακαλῶνται **32** (καὶ πνεύματα προφητῶν προφήταις ὑποτάσσεται, **33** οὐ γάρ ἐστιν ἀκαταστασίας ὁ θεὸς ἀλλὰ εἰρήνης), ὡς ἐν πάσαις ταῖς ἐκκλησίαις τῶν ἁγίων. **34** Αἱ γυναῖκες ἐν ταῖς ἐκκλησίαις σιγάτωσαν, οὐ γὰρ ἐπιτρέπεται αὐταῖς λαλεῖν· ἀλλὰ ὑποτασσέσθωσαν, καθὼς καὶ ὁ νόμος λέγει. **35** εἰ δέ τι μαθεῖν θέλουσιν, ἐν οἴκῳ τοὺς ἰδίους ἄνδρας ἐπερωτάτωσαν, αἰσχρὸν γάρ ἐστιν γυναικὶ λαλεῖν ἐν ἐκκλησίᾳ. **36** ἢ ἀφ' ὑμῶν ὁ λόγος τοῦ θεοῦ ἐξῆλθεν, ἢ εἰς ὑμᾶς μόνους κατήντησεν; **37** Εἴ τις δοκεῖ προφήτης εἶναι ἢ πνευματικός, ἐπιγινωσκέτω ἃ γράφω ὑμῖν ὅτι κυρίου ἐστίν· **38** εἰ δέ τις ἀγνοεῖ, ἀγνοεῖται. **39** ὥστε, ἀδελφοί μου, ζηλοῦτε τὸ προφητεύειν, καὶ τὸ λαλεῖν μὴ κωλύετε γλώσσαις· **40** πάντα δὲ εὐσχημόνως καὶ κατὰ τάξιν γινέσθω.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Earnestly pursue love and eagerly desire spiritual gifts, especially the gift of prophecy. **2** For he who speaks in a tongue does not speak to men, but to God. Indeed, no one understands him; he utters mysteries in the Spirit. **3** But he who prophesies speaks to men for their edification, encouragement, and comfort. **4** The one who speaks in a tongue edifies himself, but the one who prophesies edifies the church. **5** I wish that all of you could speak in tongues, but I would rather have you prophesy. He who prophesies is greater than one who speaks in tongues, unless he interprets so that the church may be edified. **6** Now, brothers, if I come to you speaking in tongues, how will I benefit you, unless I bring you some revelation or knowledge or prophecy or teaching? **7** Even in the case of lifeless instruments, such as the flute or harp, how will anyone recognize the tune they are playing unless the notes are distinct? **8** Again, if the trumpet sounds a muffled call, who will prepare for battle? **9** So it is with you. Unless you speak intelligible words with your tongue, how will anyone know what you are saying? You will just be speaking into the air. **10** Assuredly, there are many different languages in the world, yet none of them is without meaning. **11** If, then, I do not know the meaning of someone's language, I am a foreigner to the speaker, and he is a foreigner to me. **12** It is the same with you. Since you are eager to have spiritual gifts, strive to excel in gifts that build up the church. **13** Therefore, the one who speaks in a tongue should pray that he may interpret. **14** For if I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays, but my mind is unfruitful. **15** What then shall I do? I will pray with my spirit, but I will also pray with my mind. I will sing with my spirit, but I will also sing with my mind. **16** Otherwise, if you speak a blessing in spirit, how can someone who is uninstructed say "Amen" to your thanksgiving, since he does not know what you are saying? **17** You may be giving thanks well enough, but

the other one is not edified. **18** I thank God that I speak in tongues more than all of you. **19** But in the church, I would rather speak five coherent words to instruct others than ten thousand words in a tongue. **20** Brothers, stop thinking like children. In regard to evil be infants, but in your thinking be mature. **21** It is written in the Law: “By strange tongues and foreign lips I will speak to this people, but even then they will not listen to Me, says the Lord.” **22** Tongues, then, are a sign, not for believers, but for unbelievers. Prophecy, however, is for believers, not for unbelievers. **23** So if the whole church comes together and everyone speaks in tongues, and some who are uninstructed or some unbelievers come in, will they not say that you are out of your minds? **24** But if an unbeliever or uninstructed person comes in while everyone is prophesying, he will be convicted and called to account by all, **25** and the secrets of his heart will be made known. So he will fall facedown and worship God, proclaiming, “God is truly among you!” **26** What then shall we say, brothers? When you come together, everyone has a psalm or a teaching, a revelation, a tongue, or an interpretation. All of these must be done to build up the church. **27** If anyone speaks in a tongue, two, or at most three, should speak in turn, and someone must interpret. **28** But if there is no interpreter, he should remain silent in the church and speak only to himself and God. **29** Two or three prophets should speak, and the others should weigh carefully what is said. **30** And if a revelation comes to someone who is seated, the first speaker should stop. **31** For you can all prophesy in turn so that everyone may be instructed and encouraged. **32** The spirits of prophets are subject to prophets. **33** For God is not a God of disorder, but of peace—as in all the churches of the saints. **34** Women are to be silent in the churches. They are not permitted to speak, but must be in submission, as the law says. **35** If they wish to inquire about something, they are to ask their own husbands at home; for it is dishonorable for a woman to speak in the church. **36** Did the word of God originate with you? Or are you the only ones it has reached? **37** If anyone considers himself a prophet or spiritual person, let him acknowledge that what I am writing you is the Lord’s command. **38** But if anyone ignores this, he himself will be ignored. **39** So, my brothers, be eager to prophesy, and do not forbid speaking in tongues. **40** But everything must be done in a proper and orderly manner.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Follow after love and earnestly desire spiritual gifts, but especially that you may prophesy. **2** For he who speaks in another language speaks not to men, but to God, for no one understands, but in the Spirit he speaks mysteries. **3** But he who prophesies speaks to men for their edification, exhortation, and consolation. **4** He who speaks in another language edifies himself, but he who prophesies edifies the assembly. **5** Now I desire to have you all speak with other languages, but even more that you would prophesy. For he is greater who prophesies than he who speaks with other languages, unless he

interprets, that the assembly may be built up. **6** But now, brothers, if I come to you speaking with other languages, what would I profit you unless I speak to you either by way of revelation, or of knowledge, or of prophesying, or of teaching? **7** Even lifeless things that make a sound, whether pipe or harp, if they didn't give a distinction in the sounds, how would it be known what is piped or harped? **8** For if the trumpet gave an uncertain sound, who would prepare himself for war? **9** So also you, unless you uttered by the tongue words easy to understand, how would it be known what is spoken? For you would be speaking into the air. **10** There are, it may be, so many kinds of languages in the world, and none of them is without meaning. **11** If then I don't know the meaning of the language, I would be to him who speaks a foreigner, and he who speaks would be a foreigner to me. **12** So also you, since you are zealous for spiritual gifts, seek that you may abound to the building up of the assembly. **13** Therefore let him who speaks in another language pray that he may interpret. **14** For if I pray in another language, my spirit prays, but my understanding is unfruitful. **15** What should I do? I will pray with the spirit, and I will pray with the understanding also. I will sing with the spirit, and I will sing with the understanding also. **16** Otherwise, if you bless with the spirit, how will he who fills the place of the unlearned say the "Amen" at your giving of thanks, seeing he doesn't know what you say? **17** For you most certainly give thanks well, but the other person is not built up. **18** I thank my God, I speak with other languages more than you all. **19** However, in the assembly I would rather speak five words with my understanding, that I might instruct others also, than ten thousand words in another language. **20** Brothers, don't be children in thoughts, yet in malice be babies, but in thoughts be mature. **21** In the law it is written, "By men of strange languages and by the lips of strangers I will speak to this people. They won't even listen to me that way, says the Lord." **22** Therefore other languages are for a sign, not to those who believe, but to the unbelieving; but prophesying is for a sign, not to the unbelieving, but to those who believe. **23** If therefore the whole assembly is assembled together and all speak with other languages, and unlearned or unbelieving people come in, won't they say that you are crazy? **24** But if all prophesy, and someone unbelieving or unlearned comes in, he is reproved by all, and he is judged by all. **25** And thus the secrets of his heart are revealed. So he will fall down on his face and worship God, declaring that God is among you indeed. **26** What is it then, brothers? When you come together, each one of you has a psalm, has a teaching, has a revelation, has another language, or has an interpretation. Let all things be done to build each other up. **27** If any man speaks in another language, let there be two, or at the most three, and in turn; and let one interpret. **28** But if there is no interpreter, let him keep silent in the assembly, and let him speak to himself and to God. **29** Let two or three of the prophets speak, and let the others discern. **30** But if a revelation is made to another sitting by, let the first keep silent. **31** For you all can prophesy one by one, that all may learn and all may be exhorted. **32** The spirits of the prophets are subject to the prophets, **33** for God is not a God

of confusion but of peace, as in all the assemblies of the saints. **34** Let the wives be quiet in the assemblies, for it has not been permitted for them to be talking except in submission, as the law also says, **35** if they desire to learn anything. “Let them ask their own husbands at home, for it is shameful for a wife to be talking in the assembly.” **36** What!? Was it from you that the word of God went out? Or did it come to you alone? **37** If any man thinks himself to be a prophet or spiritual, let him recognize the things which I write to you, that they are the commandment of the Lord. **38** But if anyone is ignorant, let him be ignorant. **39** Therefore, brothers, desire earnestly to prophesy, and don’t forbid speaking with other languages. **40** Let all things be done decently and in order.

## 1 Corinthians 15:44

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**44** σπείρεται σῶμα ψυχικόν, ἐγείρεται σῶμα πνευματικόν. Εἰ ἔστιν σῶμα ψυχικόν, ἔστιν καὶ πνευματικόν.

*English (BSB)*

**44** It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body.

*English (WEB)*

**44** It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body and there is also a spiritual body.

## Galatians 5:20, 22–23

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** εἰδωλολατρία, φαρμακεία, ἔχθραι, ἔρις, ζῆλος, θυμοί, ἐριθεῖαι, διχοστασίαι, αἱρέσεις, … **22** Ὁ δὲ καρπὸς τοῦ πνεύματός ἐστιν ἀγάπη, χαρά, εἰρήνη, μακροθυμία, χρηστότης, ἀγαθωσύνη, πίστις, **23** πραΰτης, ἐγκράτεια· κατὰ τῶν τοιούτων οὐκ ἔστιν νόμος.

*English (BSB)*

**20** idolatry and sorcery; hatred, discord, jealousy, and rage; rivalries, divisions, factions, … **22** But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, **23** gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law.

*English (WEB)*

**20** idolatry, sorcery, hatred, strife, jealousies, outbursts of anger, rivalries, divisions, heresies, … **22** But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience,

kindness, goodness, faith, **23** gentleness, and self-control. Against such things there is no law.

### Ephesians 2:20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** ἐποικοδομηθέντες ἐπὶ τῷ θεμελίῳ τῶν ἀποστόλων καὶ προφητῶν, ὄντος ἀκρογωνιαίου αὐτοῦ Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ,

*English (BSB)*

**20** built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus Himself as the cornerstone.

*English (WEB)*

**20** being built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus himself being the chief cornerstone;

### Ephesians 4:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** σπουδάζοντες τηρεῖν τὴν ἑνότητα τοῦ πνεύματος ἐν τῷ συνδέσμῳ τῆς εἰρήνης·

*English (BSB)*

**3** and with diligence to preserve the unity of the Spirit through the bond of peace.

*English (WEB)*

**3** being eager to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.

### 1 Timothy 4:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Τὸ δὲ πνεῦμα ῥητῶς λέγει ὅτι ἐν ὑστέροις καιροῖς ἀποστήσονταί τινες τῆς πίστεως, προσέχοντες πνεύμασι πλάνοις καὶ διδασκαλίαις δαιμονίων

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now the Spirit expressly states that in later times some will abandon the faith to follow deceitful spirits and the teachings of demons,

*English (WEB)*

**1** But the Spirit says expressly that in later times some will fall away from the faith, paying attention to seducing spirits and doctrines of demons,

## 2 Timothy 2:8

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**8** Μνημόνευε Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν ἐγηγερμένον ἐκ νεκρῶν, ἐκ σπέρματος Δαυίδ, κατὰ τὸ εὐαγγέλιόν μου·

*English (BSB)*

**8** Remember Jesus Christ, raised from the dead, descended from David, as proclaimed by my gospel,

*English (WEB)*

**8** Remember Jesus Christ, risen from the dead, of the offspring of David, according to my Good News,

## 2 Timothy 3:1–5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Τοῦτο δὲ γίνωσκε ὅτι ἐν ἐσχάταις ἡμέραις ἐνστήσονται καιροὶ χαλεποί· **2** ἔσονται γὰρ οἱ ἄνθρωποι φίλαυτοι, φιλάργυροι, ἀλαζόνες, ὑπερήφανοι, βλάσφημοι, γονεῦσιν ἀπειθεῖς, ἀχάριστοι, ἀνόσιοι, **3** ἄστοργοι, ἄσπονδοι, διάβολοι, ἀκρατεῖς, ἀνήμεροι, ἀφιλάγαθοι, **4** προδόται, προπετεῖς, τετυφωμένοι, φιλήδονοι μᾶλλον ἢ φιλόθεοι, **5** ἔχοντες μόρφωσιν εὐσεβείας τὴν δὲ δύναμιν αὐτῆς ἠρνημένοι· καὶ τούτους ἀποτρέπου.

*English (BSB)*

**1** But understand this: In the last days terrible times will come. **2** For men will be lovers of themselves, lovers of money, boastful, arrogant, abusive, disobedient to their parents, ungrateful, unholy, **3** unloving, unforgiving, slanderous, without self-control, brutal, without love of good, **4** traitorous, reckless, conceited, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God, **5** having a form of godliness but denying its power. Turn away from such as these!

*English (WEB)*

**1** But know this: that in the last days, grievous times will come. **2** For men will be lovers of self, lovers of money, boastful, arrogant, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy, **3** without natural affection, unforgiving, slanderers, without self-control, fierce, not lovers of good, **4** traitors, headstrong, conceited, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God, **5** holding a form of godliness but having denied its power. Turn away from these, also.

## 2 Timothy 4:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** ἔσται γὰρ καιρὸς ὅτε τῆς ὑγιαινούσης διδασκαλίας οὐκ ἀνέξονται, ἀλλὰ κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας ἑαυτοῖς ἐπισωρεύσουσιν διδασκάλους κνηθόμενοι τὴν ἀκοήν,

*English (BSB)*

**3** For the time will come when men will not tolerate sound doctrine, but with itching ears they will gather around themselves teachers to suit their own desires.

*English (WEB)*

**3** For the time will come when they will not listen to the sound doctrine, but having itching ears, will heap up for themselves teachers after their own lusts,

## Hebrews 1:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** ἐπ᾽ ἐσχάτου τῶν ἡμερῶν τούτων ἐλάλησεν ἡμῖν ἐν υἱῷ, ὃν ἔθηκεν κληρονόμον πάντων, δι᾽ οὗ καὶ ἐποίησεν τοὺς αἰῶνας·

*English (BSB)*

**2** But in these last days He has spoken to us by His Son, whom He appointed heir of all things, and through whom He made the universe.

*English (WEB)*

**2** has at the end of these days spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed heir of all things, through whom also he made the worlds.

## James 3:15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** οὐκ ἔστιν αὕτη ἡ σοφία ἄνωθεν κατερχομένη, ἀλλὰ ἐπίγειος, ψυχική, δαιμονιώδης·

*English (BSB)*

**15** Such wisdom does not come from above, but is earthly, unspiritual, demonic.

*English (WEB)*

**15** This wisdom is not that which comes down from above, but is earthly, sensual, and demonic.

## 2 Peter 3:2–4

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** μνησθῆναι τῶν προειρημένων ῥημάτων ὑπὸ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν καὶ τῆς τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν ἐντολῆς τοῦ κυρίου καὶ σωτῆρος, **3** τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες ὅτι ἐλεύσονται ἐπ᾽ ἐσχάτων τῶν ἡμερῶν ἐν ἐμπαιγμονῇ ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι **4** καὶ λέγοντες· Ποῦ ἐστιν ἡ ἐπαγγελία τῆς παρουσίας αὐτοῦ; ἀφ᾽ ἧς γὰρ οἱ πατέρες ἐκοιμήθησαν, πάντα οὕτως διαμένει ἀπ᾽ ἀρχῆς κτίσεως.

*English (BSB)*

**2** by recalling what was foretold by the holy prophets and commanded by our Lord and Savior through your apostles. **3** Most importantly, you must understand that in the last days scoffers will come, scoffing and following their own evil desires. **4** “Where is the promise of His coming?” they will ask. “Ever since our fathers fell asleep, everything continues as it has from the beginning of creation.”

*English (WEB)*

**2** that you should remember the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets and the commandment of us, the apostles of the Lord and Savior, **3** knowing this first, that in the last days mockers will come, walking after their own lusts **4** and saying, “Where is the promise of his coming? For, from the day that the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation.”

## 1 John 2:18–19

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** Παιδία, ἐσχάτη ὥρα ἐστίν, καὶ καθὼς ἠκούσατε ὅτι ἀντίχριστος ἔρχεται, καὶ νῦν ἀντίχριστοι πολλοὶ γεγόνασιν· ὅθεν γινώσκομεν ὅτι ἐσχάτη ὥρα ἐστίν. **19** ἐξ ἡμῶν ἐξῆλθαν, ἀλλ᾽ οὐκ ἦσαν ἐξ ἡμῶν· εἰ γὰρ ἐξ ἡμῶν ἦσαν, μεμενήκεισαν ἂν μεθ᾽ ἡμῶν· ἀλλ᾽ ἵνα φανερωθῶσιν ὅτι οὐκ εἰσὶν πάντες ἐξ ἡμῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**18** Children, it is the last hour; and just as you have heard that the antichrist is coming, so now many antichrists have appeared. This is how we know it is the last hour. **19** They went out from us, but they did not belong to us. For if they had belonged to us, they would have remained with us. But their departure made it clear that none of them belonged to us.

*English (WEB)*

**18** Little children, these are the end times, and as you heard that the Antichrist is coming, even now many antichrists have arisen. By this we know that it is the final hour. **19** They went out from us, but they didn’t belong to us; for if they had belonged to us, they would have continued with us. But they left, that they might be revealed that none of them belong to us.

# Chapter 11. Building, Praying, Keeping, Waiting (Jude 20–21)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **20** ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί, ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει, ἐν πνεύματι ἁγίῳ προσευχόμενοι, **21** ἑαυτοὺς ἐν ἀγάπῃ θεοῦ τηρήσατε προσδεχόμενοι τὸ ἔλεος τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον.
>
> — Jude 20–21, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript’s first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 20 | ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει | ‘building yourselves up on your most holy faith’ | א A B Ψ |
| 20 | ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ἡμῶν πίστει | ‘… on our most holy faith’ | C 1739 |
| 20 | τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτούς | (word order only) | K L |
| 20 | τῇ ἑαυτῶν ἁγιότητι πίστει ἀνοικοδομεῖσθε | a different wording: ‘be built up by your | P72 |

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | own holiness, by faith’ | |
| 21 | τηρήσατε | ‘keep (a command)’ | ℵ A K L 1739 |
| 21 | τηρήσωμεν | ‘let us keep’ | P72 B C* Ψ |
| 21 | τηρήσητε | (that) you may keep | C$^{corr}$ |

Notes. v. 20: not extant in P78. v. 21: not extant in P78.

### The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

#### Jude 20

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | But ye derlye beloved edyfie yovre selves in youre most holy fayth prayinge in the holy goost |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | But, yee beloued, edifie your selues in your most holy faith, praying in the holy Ghost, |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | But you, my beloved, building yourselves upon your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Ghost, |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | But ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying by the Holy Spirit, |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | But do ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit, |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | But ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit, |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | But ye, beloved, building yourselves up on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit, |
| **YLT** Young’s Literal Translation (1898) | And ye, beloved, on your most holy faith building yourselves up, in the Holy Spirit praying, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | But ye, beloved, building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit, |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | But you, beloved, keep building up yourselves on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | But you people whom I love, ◄hold/continue to trust► firmly to the very sacred truths that you believe. Pray by letting the Holy Spirit enable/empower you. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | But you must, dear friends, build up your characters on the foundation of your most holy faith, pray under the guidance of the Holy Spirit, |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | But you, beloved, build yourselves up in your most holy faith, and pray in the Holy Spirit. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | But you, my friends, are to build yourselves up through your trust in God. Pray in the Holy Spirit, |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | But you, beloved, building yourselves up on your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | But you, beloved, by building yourselves up in your most holy faith and praying in the Holy Spirit, |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | But you, beloved, by building yourselves up in your most holy faith and praying in the Holy Spirit, |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | But you, beloved, by building yourselves up in your most holy faith and praying in the Holy Spirit, |

### Jude 21

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | and kepe youre selves in the love of God lokinge for the mercy of oure lorde Iesus Christ vnto eternall lyfe. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | And keepe your selues in the loue of God, looking for the mercie of our Lord Iesus Christ, vnto eternall life. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Keep yourselves in the love of God, waiting for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ, unto life everlasting. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | keep yourselves in the love of God, awaiting the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | yourselves in the love of God keep ye, waiting for the kindness of our Lord Jesus Christ — to life age-during; |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | keep yourselves in the love of God, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Keep yourselves in God's love, looking for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to eternal life. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Keep conducting your lives in a way that is appropriate for those whom God loves. Keep constantly expecting that our Lord Jesus Christ will act mercifully toward you. Keep expecting that until the time when we begin living eternally with him. Jude 22-23 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | and keep within the love of God, while waiting for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ, to bring you to eternal life. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Keep yourselves in God's love, and wait for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ that brings you eternal life. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | keep yourselves safe in God's love, and wait for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ who brings eternal life. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | keep yourselves in the love of God, waiting for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ [resulting] in continuous life; |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | keep yourselves in the love of God as you await the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to bring you eternal life. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | keep yourselves in the love of God as you await the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to bring you eternal life. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | must keep yourselves in the love of God as you wait for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ that leads to eternal life. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

After the long exposure of the intruders, Jude finally tells his readers what to do. He began by urging them to "fight for the faith" (v. 3). Here is what that fight consists of. It is not, first of all, an attack on the intruders. It is a way of life:

- **building** one another up on the foundation of the holy faith;
- **praying** in the power of the Holy Spirit;
- **keeping** themselves in God's love;
- **waiting** with hope for the mercy of Jesus Christ that leads to eternal life.

The grammar shows what matters most. There is one main command, "keep yourselves in the love of God," and three supporting activities expressed as participles: building, praying, and waiting. These are the means by which believers remain in the love that God has already shown them (v. 1).

The passage also has a striking shape. It mentions the Holy Spirit, God (the Father), and the Lord Jesus Christ, and it gathers faith, love, and hope, the three great Christian virtues. In two verses Jude sketches the whole Christian life.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί (*hymeis de, agapētoi*) — 'but you, beloved'

For the third and last time, Jude addresses his readers as "beloved" (vv. 3, 17, 20). The emphatic Ὑμεῖς δέ (*Hymeis de*), "But you," repeats the turn of v. 17 and sets the readers against the intruders just described. The intruders are "not having the Spirit" (v. 19). The readers pray "in the Holy Spirit" (v. 20). The contrast could hardly be sharper.

### ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει (*epoikodomountes heautous tē hagiōtatē hymōn pistei*) — 'building yourselves up on your most holy faith'

The participle ἐποικοδομοῦντες (*epoikodomountes*), "building up on," comes from the language of construction: οἰκοδομέω (*oikodomeō*), "to build a house," with the prefix ἐπί (*epi*), "upon." The New Testament uses this image often for

the growth of believers and of the church. Paul writes: “I have laid a foundation, and another builds on [it], for no one is able to lay another foundation except that which is laid, which is Jesus the Christ” (1 Cor 3:10–11, LSV). Believers are “built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ Himself being chief corner-[stone]” (Eph 2:20, LSV), and are to be “rooted and built up in Him, and confirmed in the faith” (Col 2:7, LSV).

**“Yourselves”** (ἑαυτούς, *heautous*) is a reflexive pronoun. In the plural it often has a reciprocal sense, “one another.” Paul uses the same pronoun when he tells the Colossians to be “teaching and admonishing each other” (νουθετοῦντες ἑαυτούς, Col 3:16, LSV), and the Ephesians to be “forgiving one another” (χαριζόμενοι ἑαυτοῖς, Eph 4:32, LSV).[149] Jude is not describing private self-improvement. He is describing a community building each other up: “build up one another, as also you do” (1 Thess 5:11, LSV).

**“On your most holy faith”** (τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει, *tē hagiōtatē hymōn pistei*). The foundation is “the faith,” the same faith “once delivered to the holy ones” that Jude urged his readers to contend for in v. 3. The phrase “your most holy faith” ties the end of the letter to its beginning. Contending for the faith (v. 3) and building on the faith (v. 20) are the same activity seen from two sides.

The adjective ἁγιωτάτῃ (*hagiōtatē*), “most holy,” is the superlative of ἅγιος (*hagios*), “holy.” It is the only superlative of that adjective in the New Testament.[150] Jude chooses the strongest possible word. The faith is not a human tradition to be adjusted to taste. It is “most holy,” set apart by God and belonging to him. The intruders have turned grace into licentiousness (v. 4). The readers build on a faith that is holy through and through.

The Byzantine text puts the words in a different order, “on your most holy faith building yourselves up,” but the meaning is the same.[151]

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149. SBLGNT Col 3:16: διδάσκοντες καὶ νουθετοῦντες ἑαυτούς; Eph 4:32: χαριζόμενοι ἑαυτοῖς. The LSV renders these “teaching and admonishing each other” and “forgiving one another.”↩

150. Computed from MorphGNT/SBLGNT: the only superlative form of ἅγιος in the New Testament is ἁγιωτάτῃ in Jude 20.↩

151. SBLGNT apparatus: “ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει WH Treg NIV ] τῇ ἁγιωτάτῃ ὑμῶν πίστει ἐποικοδομοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς RP.”↩

### ἐν πνεύματι ἁγίῳ προσευχόμενοι (*en pneumati hagiō proseuchomenoi*) — ‘praying in the Holy Spirit’

The second participle, προσευχόμενοι (*proseuchomenoi*), “praying,” is qualified by ἐν πνεύματι ἁγίῳ (*en pneumati hagiō*), “in the Holy Spirit.” See

the deep dive below. In brief, it describes prayer that the Holy Spirit inspires, empowers, and guides. That is the opposite of the intruders, who are "not having the Spirit" (v. 19), and of their "dreaming" (v. 8), which Jude regards as false spirituality.

### ἑαυτοὺς ἐν ἀγάπῃ θεοῦ τηρήσατε (*heautous en agapē theou tērēsate*) — 'keep yourselves in the love of God'

Here is the main verb of the sentence and the central command of the letter: ἑαυτοὺς ἐν ἀγάπῃ θεοῦ τηρήσατε (*heautous en agapē theou tērēsate*), "keep yourselves in the love of God." The aorist imperative τηρήσατε (*tērēsate*) is the fifth and final use of τηρέω, "keep," the word that runs through the whole letter:

- the readers "having been kept in Jesus Christ" (v. 1);
- the angels who "did not keep" their place (v. 6);
- the angels whom God "has kept" in bonds (v. 6);
- the darkness that "has been kept" for the wandering stars (v. 13);
- and now, "keep yourselves" (v. 21).

The readers have been kept by God, and now they are to keep themselves. The angels did not keep their position. The readers must keep theirs. See the deep dive below.

**"The love of God"** (ἀγάπῃ θεοῦ, *agapē theou*) could grammatically mean either God's love for us or our love for God. In Jude, the first is clearly primary. The readers are "having been loved in God [the] Father" (v. 1). To "keep yourselves in the love of God" is to remain in the place where God's love has put you. Jesus said: "According as the Father loved Me, I also loved you, remain in My love; if you may keep My commands, you will remain in My love" (John 15:9–10, LSV). Responding love for God is implied, but the foundation is God's love.

### προσδεχόμενοι τὸ ἔλεος τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ (*prosdechomenoi to eleos tou kyriou hēmōn Iēsou Christou*) — 'waiting for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ'

The third participle is προσδεχόμενοι (*prosdechomenoi*), "waiting for, expecting." It is the word used of Simeon, who was "looking for the comforting of Israel" (Luke 2:25, LSV), and of believers "waiting for the blessed hope and appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ" (Titus 2:13, LSV). It describes active, eager expectation, not passive delay.

What the readers wait for is "the mercy (ἔλεος, *eleos*) of our Lord Jesus Christ." Mercy was the first gift Jude wished his readers (v. 2). Here it is the mercy they will receive at Christ's coming, when he comes to judge (vv. 14–

15). Paul prays for a friend, “may the LORD give to him to find kindness from the LORD in that day” (2 Tim 1:18, LSV), using the same Greek word, ἔλεος. The coming that means judgment for the ungodly (vv. 14–15) means mercy for those who wait for it.

### εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον (*eis zōēn aiōnion*) — ‘leading to eternal life’

The final phrase, εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον (*eis zōēn aiōnion*), “into eternal life,” names the goal of the waiting. The LSV supplies “[resulting]” to show that the Greek preposition εἰς expresses direction or result. Christ’s mercy leads to eternal life. The LSV’s “continuous life” reflects its consistent rendering of αἰώνιος (*aiōnios*). In New Testament usage the phrase means both life without end and the life that belongs to the age to come.

The contrast with the intruders’ destiny is deliberate. For them, “the gloom of the darkness throughout the age has been kept” (v. 13) and “continuous fire” is the example (v. 7). For the readers, the same word αἰώνιος describes life. Two destinies are set before the readers, and Jude’s command is to remain in the love that leads to life.

### The shape of vv. 20–21

The sentence has a clear structure:

| Element | Greek | Relation |
|---|---|---|
| building yourselves up on your most holy faith | ἐποικοδομοῦντες | participle (means) |
| praying in the Holy Spirit | προσευχόμενοι | participle (means) |
| **keep yourselves in the love of God** | **τηρήσατε** | **main imperative** |
| waiting for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ | προσδεχόμενοι | participle (accompanying attitude) |
| into eternal life | εἰς ζωὴν αἰώνιον | goal |

Two further patterns appear:

- **A Trinitarian pattern:** the Holy Spirit (v. 20), the love of God the Father (v. 21), and the mercy of the Lord Jesus Christ (v. 21). Jude does not offer a doctrine of the Trinity, but he speaks naturally of Spirit, Father, and Son as together the source of the Christian’s life. Paul does the same in 2 Cor 13:14.
- **A pattern of faith, love, and hope:** “your most holy faith” (v. 20), “the love of God” (v. 21), and “waiting” for mercy and eternal life (v. 21), which is hope. Paul’s famous triad is “faith, hope, love—these three” (1 Cor 13:13, LSV). He also speaks of “your work of faith, and the labor of the

love, and the endurance of the hope" (1 Thess 1:3, LSV). Jude's version may reflect a shared early Christian pattern.

### Deep dive: Praying in the Holy Spirit

What does it mean to pray "in the Holy Spirit"? The phrase ἐν πνεύματι ἁγίῳ can be read in several ways, and Christian traditions have emphasized different aspects.

**The New Testament background.** The closest parallel is Eph 6:18: "praying at all times in the Spirit, and in this, watching in all perseverance and supplication for all the holy ones" (LSV). Paul also describes the Spirit's role in prayer:

- The Spirit enables the most basic Christian prayer, the cry to God as Father: "you received [the] Spirit of adoption in which we cry, 'Abba! Father!'" (Rom 8:15, LSV); "God sent forth the Spirit of His Son into your hearts, crying, 'Abba! Father!'" (Gal 4:6, LSV).
- The Spirit helps believers in their weakness: "the Spirit helps our weaknesses; for what we may pray for, as it is necessary, we have not known, but [this] One—the Spirit—makes intercession for us with unutterable groanings" (Rom 8:26, LSV).
- In 1 Corinthians, Paul speaks of praying "in an [unknown] tongue" and says, "I will pray [in] the spirit, and I will also pray [with] understanding" (1 Cor 14:14–15, LSV).

Jesus speaks of worship "in spirit and truth" (John 4:23–24), and Paul of "serving God by the Spirit" (Phil 3:3, LSV).

**Interpretations.**

1. **Prayer inspired and guided by the Spirit.** Most interpreters understand Jude to mean prayer that is prompted, empowered, and shaped by the Holy Spirit, prayer that flows from the Spirit's presence in the believer and the community. On this reading, the phrase describes all genuine Christian prayer, including the "Abba, Father" of adoption and the Spirit's help in weakness.
2. **Charismatic or ecstatic prayer.** Some interpreters, especially in Pentecostal and charismatic traditions, see in Jude 20 a reference to Spirit-inspired prayer of the kind described in 1 Corinthians 14, including prayer in tongues. That is a possible reading, since Jude's communities, like Paul's, were probably familiar with such phenomena. Nothing in Jude's wording, however, requires it.
3. **Prayer within the sphere of the Spirit**, as opposed to the "natural" sphere of v. 19. This reading emphasizes the contrast with the intruders.

> Whatever the intruders' spiritual claims, true prayer happens in the realm of the Holy Spirit.

These readings are not exclusive. What is clear from the context is Jude's contrast. The intruders appealed to "dreams" and claimed spiritual superiority, but in Jude's judgment they were "not having the Spirit." The readers' answer is not to reject spiritual experience but to pray in the Spirit, inside the community, on the foundation of the faith, and in the love of God. In Jude's view, genuine spirituality is marked by prayer, holiness, love, and humility, not by private revelations that license sin.

**Prayer as part of contending.** It is significant that prayer is one of the means by which believers "fight for the faith" (v. 3). Jude does not imagine that false teaching can be met only with arguments. A praying community, dependent on the Spirit, is itself a defense of the faith.

### Deep dive: Keeping oneself in the love of God

Jude's central command, "keep yourselves in the love of God," raises a question that runs through the whole letter: how does the believer's keeping relate to God's keeping?

**God's keeping comes first.** The letter opens by describing the readers as "having been kept in Jesus Christ" (v. 1), or, as the Greek dative may also mean, kept *for* him. The perfect participle describes a settled state. It closes with praise to "Him who is able to guard you without stumbling" (v. 24). The readers' security rests on God's action, which frames the whole letter.

**The believer's keeping is real.** Between those two statements stands the command of v. 21: "keep yourselves." It is not a suggestion. The negative examples in the letter show what failure to keep looks like: the wilderness generation that did not believe (v. 5) and the angels who "did not keep their own principality" (v. 6).

**How the two fit together.** Jude does not explain the relationship theoretically, but the structure of vv. 20–21 suggests a practical answer. The believer keeps himself or herself in God's love not by heroic effort but by staying where God's love is found: building on the faith, praying in the Spirit, and waiting for Christ's mercy. These are not ways of earning God's love. They are ways of remaining in it. Jesus' words in John 15 offer a parallel: "remain in My love; if you may keep My commands, you will remain in My love" (John 15:9–10, LSV). The love comes first, and obedience is the way of abiding in it.

An image may help. The love of God is like a sheltered harbor. God has brought the readers into it (v. 1), and God is able to keep them there (v. 24). The command "keep yourselves in the love of God" means: do not sail out of

the harbor. Build up the community, pray, wait for the Lord, and you will remain where you have been placed.

**Different traditions, one command.** As noted in Chapter 1, Christian traditions explain the relationship between divine preservation and human perseverance differently. All can agree on Jude's practical point: the command to keep oneself in God's love is meant seriously, and the means of obeying it are building, praying, and waiting.

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ἐποικοδομέω | *epoikodomeō* | build upon | "building yourselves up" | Construction image (1 Cor 3:10–14; Eph 2:20; Col 2:7). |
| ἑαυτούς | *heautous* | yourselves; one another | "yourselves" | Plural reflexive can be reciprocal (Col 3:16; Eph 4:32). |
| ἁγιώτατος | *hagiōtatos* | most holy | "most holy" | Only superlative of ἅγιος in the NT. |
| πίστις | *pistis* | faith | "faith" | The faith of v. 3. |
| προσεύχομαι | *proseuchomai* | pray | "praying" | |
| ἐν πνεύματι ἁγίῳ | *en pneumati hagiō* | in the Holy Spirit | "in the Holy Spirit" | See deep dive. |
| τηρέω | *tēreō* | keep | "keep" | Aorist imperative; fifth use. |
| ἀγάπη θεοῦ | *agapē theou* | love of God | "the love of God" | Primarily God's love for believers. |
| προσδέχομαι | *prosdechomai* | wait for, expect | "waiting for" | Eager expectation (Luke 2:25; Titus 2:13). |
| ἔλεος | *eleos* | mercy | "the mercy" | Echoes v. 2. |
| ζωὴ αἰώνιος | *zōē aiōnios* | eternal life | "continuous life" | Life of the age to come. |

**A grammatical note on the participles.** Greek participles that accompany an imperative often take on some of its force. Many translations therefore render vv. 20–21 as a series of commands: 'build yourselves up … pray … keep yourselves … wait' (compare the WEB and BSB). That is legitimate. It is still

worth seeing that Jude subordinates building, praying, and waiting to the single command to keep oneself in God's love. They are not three extra tasks. They are how the one task is done.

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Prayer in early Christian gatherings.** From the beginning, prayer was central to Christian community life. The Jerusalem believers were "continuing steadfastly in … the prayers" (Acts 2:42, LSV). Paul's letters are full of prayer reports and requests. The *Didache* provides texts of thanksgiving prayers and instructs believers to pray the Lord's Prayer three times a day.[152] Jude's call to pray in the Spirit belongs to this common practice. Since the love feasts were also occasions of prayer, the instruction may have had a communal setting in mind.

**Waiting for the Lord.** The early Christians lived in expectation of Christ's return. The Aramaic prayer *Maranatha*, usually understood as 'Our Lord, come!' (1 Cor 16:22; *Didache* 10.6), preserved this hope in the language of the earliest Palestinian believers. (The LSV renders it "The LORD has come!" in 1 Cor 16:22, reflecting a different way of dividing the Aramaic words.)[153] Jude's "waiting for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ" expresses the same expectation, colored by the judgment scene he has just quoted.

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152. *Didache* 8.2–3 (the Lord's Prayer, "Thrice in the day thus pray") and 9–10 (thanksgiving prayers), ANF 7 (https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/0714.htm). The citation of chapter 8 is from the same New Advent text consulted for chapters 9–12.↩

153. *Didache* 10.6 in the original Greek reads μαρανα θά. The New Advent (ANF) translation renders the passage; the Aramaic term itself is also found at 1 Cor 16:22.↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**1 Corinthians 3:10–11; Ephesians 2:20–22; Colossians 2:7; Acts 20:32 (building imagery).** The church as a building on the foundation of Christ and the apostolic faith. Jude's "building yourselves up on your most holy faith" belongs to this family of images.

**Ephesians 6:18; Romans 8:15–16, 26–27; Galatians 4:6 (prayer in the Spirit).** The closest parallels to Jude's "praying in the Holy Spirit."

**John 15:9–10; 1 John 4:16 (remaining in love).** "God is love, and he who is remaining in love, remains in God, and God in him" (1 John 4:16, LSV). The Johannine language of "remaining" in God's love parallels Jude's "keep yourselves in the love of God."

**Romans 5:5; 8:39 (the love of God).** “The love of God has been poured forth in our hearts through the Holy Spirit” (Rom 5:5, LSV). Paul, like Jude, connects God’s love and the Spirit.

**Titus 2:13; Luke 2:25 (waiting).** The same verb of eager expectation.

**1 Corinthians 13:13; 1 Thessalonians 1:3; 5:8 (faith, love, hope).** The triad that Jude’s vv. 20–21 seem to echo.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Is the reference to the Holy Spirit Trinitarian?** Jude’s mention of the Holy Spirit, God, and the Lord Jesus Christ in two verses is often noted as an early example of the threefold pattern that later Christian theology articulated as the doctrine of the Trinity. Jude does not reflect on the relationship among the three. His language reflects the experience of early Christians, who knew God as Father, Jesus as Lord, and the Spirit as present power.

**2. What kind of prayer is “in the Holy Spirit”?** See the deep dive. Interpretations range from all Spirit-led prayer to specifically charismatic forms.

**3. Is “the love of God” God’s love or our love?** God’s love is primary (v. 1), though a responding love is implied.

**4. Is the “mercy” of v. 21 present or future?** It is future, the mercy shown at Christ’s coming and judgment. The waiting has present effects: it shapes how believers live now.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verses 20–21 are the positive counterpart to the whole central section. Each element answers something in the description of the intruders:

| The intruders | The readers |
|---|---|
| pervert grace into license (v. 4) | build on the most holy faith (v. 20) |
| “dreaming” (v. 8); “not having the Spirit” (v. 19) | praying in the Holy Spirit (v. 20) |
| stains (or reefs) at the love feasts (v. 12) | keep themselves in the love of God (v. 21) |
| darkness kept for them forever (v. 13) | waiting for mercy leading to eternal life (v. 21) |

The passage also completes the frame that began in vv. 1–2. Love, keeping, mercy, God, and Jesus Christ all return. Verse 3’s call to contend for the faith is now explained: contending means building, praying, keeping, and waiting.

Finally, vv. 20–21 prepare for vv. 22–23. Those who are kept in God's love and wait for Christ's mercy are the ones who can show mercy to others. The movement is from receiving mercy to extending it.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**The positive shape of faithfulness.** When Christians face false teaching or moral confusion, it is easy to define faithfulness only by what one opposes. Jude's instructions are almost entirely positive: build, pray, keep, wait. Communities under pressure may find that their best defense is a deep, positive spiritual life rather than constant vigilance against enemies.

**Community, not isolation.** "Building yourselves up" is communal. Jude assumes that believers grow together, through shared teaching, worship, encouragement, and accountability. Modern individualism can make faith a private project. Jude's grammar resists that.

**Prayer as spiritual defense.** Prayer in the Spirit is part of contending for the faith. Churches facing division or confusion might give prayer, honest and dependent, a central place in their response, not merely a ceremonial one.

**Living from love toward hope.** The passage moves from the love of God, already given, to the mercy of Christ, still awaited. The Christian life is lived between those two points, secure in love and leaning toward hope. That orientation may help believers handle both complacency and anxiety.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Jude's response to false teaching is mostly positive: build, pray, keep, wait. Why might that be more effective than a purely defensive strategy?
2. How do you understand "praying in the Holy Spirit"? How has your tradition shaped your understanding?
3. What practices help you, or your community, "keep" yourselves in the love of God? Which of Jude's three activities (building, praying, waiting) is most neglected in your experience?
4. Jude speaks of the faith as "most holy." What does it mean to treat the faith as holy rather than as a human tradition to be adjusted?
5. How does waiting for "the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ" shape the way you think about the future and live in the present?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT and apparatus (RP word order). Greek of Col 3:16 and Eph 4:32 from SBLGNT/MorphGNT.
- Superlative count: MorphGNT/SBLGNT.
- *Didache* 8; 10, ANF 7.
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. τηρέω, ἔλεος.

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Luke 2:25

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**25** Καὶ ἰδοὺ ἄνθρωπος ἦν ἐν Ἰερουσαλὴμ ᾧ ὄνομα Συμεών, καὶ ὁ ἄνθρωπος οὗτος δίκαιος καὶ εὐλαβής, προσδεχόμενος παράκλησιν τοῦ Ἰσραήλ, καὶ πνεῦμα ἦν ἅγιον ἐπ᾽ αὐτόν·

*English (BSB)*

**25** Now there was a man in Jerusalem named Simeon, who was righteous and devout. He was waiting for the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was upon him.

*English (WEB)*

**25** Behold, there was a man in Jerusalem whose name was Simeon. This man was righteous and devout, looking for the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was on him.

### John 4:23–24

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**23** ἀλλὰ ἔρχεται ὥρα καὶ νῦν ἐστιν, ὅτε οἱ ἀληθινοὶ προσκυνηταὶ προσκυνήσουσιν τῷ πατρὶ ἐν πνεύματι καὶ ἀληθείᾳ, καὶ γὰρ ὁ πατὴρ τοιούτους ζητεῖ τοὺς προσκυνοῦντας αὐτόν· **24** πνεῦμα ὁ θεός, καὶ τοὺς προσκυνοῦντας αὐτὸν ἐν πνεύματι καὶ ἀληθείᾳ δεῖ προσκυνεῖν.

*English (BSB)*

**23** But a time is coming and has now come when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and in truth, for the Father is seeking such as these to worship Him. **24** God is Spirit, and His worshipers must worship Him in spirit and in truth.”

*English (WEB)*

**23** But the hour comes, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for the Father seeks such to be his worshipers. **24** God is spirit, and those who worship him must worship in spirit and truth.”

## John 15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ἄμπελος ἡ ἀληθινή, καὶ ὁ πατήρ μου ὁ γεωργός ἐστιν· **2** πᾶν κλῆμα ἐν ἐμοὶ μὴ φέρον καρπὸν αἴρει αὐτό, καὶ πᾶν τὸ καρπὸν φέρον καθαίρει αὐτὸ ἵνα καρπὸν πλείονα φέρῃ. **3** ἤδη ὑμεῖς καθαροί ἐστε διὰ τὸν λόγον ὃν λελάληκα ὑμῖν· **4** μείνατε ἐν ἐμοί, κἀγὼ ἐν ὑμῖν. καθὼς τὸ κλῆμα οὐ δύναται καρπὸν φέρειν ἀφ’ ἑαυτοῦ ἐὰν μὴ μένῃ ἐν τῇ ἀμπέλῳ, οὕτως οὐδὲ ὑμεῖς ἐὰν μὴ ἐν ἐμοὶ μένητε. **5** ἐγώ εἰμι ἡ ἄμπελος, ὑμεῖς τὰ κλήματα. ὁ μένων ἐν ἐμοὶ κἀγὼ ἐν αὐτῷ οὗτος φέρει καρπὸν πολύν, ὅτι χωρὶς ἐμοῦ οὐ δύνασθε ποιεῖν οὐδέν. **6** ἐὰν μή τις μένῃ ἐν ἐμοί, ἐβλήθη ἔξω ὡς τὸ κλῆμα καὶ ἐξηράνθη, καὶ συνάγουσιν αὐτὰ καὶ εἰς τὸ πῦρ βάλλουσιν καὶ καίεται. **7** ἐὰν μείνητε ἐν ἐμοὶ καὶ τὰ ῥήματά μου ἐν ὑμῖν μείνῃ, ὃ ἐὰν θέλητε αἰτήσασθε καὶ γενήσεται ὑμῖν· **8** ἐν τούτῳ ἐδοξάσθη ὁ πατήρ μου ἵνα καρπὸν πολὺν φέρητε καὶ γένησθε ἐμοὶ μαθηταί. **9** καθὼς ἠγάπησέν με ὁ πατήρ, κἀγὼ ὑμᾶς ἠγάπησα, μείνατε ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ τῇ ἐμῇ. **10** ἐὰν τὰς ἐντολάς μου τηρήσητε, μενεῖτε ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ μου, καθὼς ἐγὼ τὰς ἐντολὰς τοῦ πατρός μου τετήρηκα καὶ μένω αὐτοῦ ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ. **11** ταῦτα λελάληκα ὑμῖν ἵνα ἡ χαρὰ ἡ ἐμὴ ἐν ὑμῖν ᾖ καὶ ἡ χαρὰ ὑμῶν πληρωθῇ. **12** Αὕτη ἐστὶν ἡ ἐντολὴ ἡ ἐμὴ ἵνα ἀγαπᾶτε ἀλλήλους καθὼς ἠγάπησα ὑμᾶς· **13** μείζονα ταύτης ἀγάπην οὐδεὶς ἔχει, ἵνα τις τὴν ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ θῇ ὑπὲρ τῶν φίλων αὐτοῦ. **14** ὑμεῖς φίλοι μού ἐστε ἐὰν ποιῆτε ἃ ἐγὼ ἐντέλλομαι ὑμῖν. **15** οὐκέτι λέγω ὑμᾶς δούλους, ὅτι ὁ δοῦλος οὐκ οἶδεν τί ποιεῖ αὐτοῦ ὁ κύριος· ὑμᾶς δὲ εἴρηκα φίλους, ὅτι πάντα ἃ ἤκουσα παρὰ τοῦ πατρός μου ἐγνώρισα ὑμῖν. **16** οὐχ ὑμεῖς με ἐξελέξασθε, ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ ἐξελεξάμην ὑμᾶς, καὶ ἔθηκα ὑμᾶς ἵνα ὑμεῖς ὑπάγητε καὶ καρπὸν φέρητε καὶ ὁ καρπὸς ὑμῶν μένῃ, ἵνα ὅ τι ἂν αἰτήσητε τὸν πατέρα ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί μου δῷ ὑμῖν. **17** ταῦτα ἐντέλλομαι ὑμῖν ἵνα ἀγαπᾶτε ἀλλήλους. **18** Εἰ ὁ κόσμος ὑμᾶς μισεῖ, γινώσκετε ὅτι ἐμὲ πρῶτον ὑμῶν μεμίσηκεν. **19** εἰ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου ἦτε, ὁ κόσμος ἂν τὸ ἴδιον ἐφίλει· ὅτι δὲ ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου οὐκ ἐστέ, ἀλλ’ ἐγὼ ἐξελεξάμην ὑμᾶς ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου, διὰ τοῦτο μισεῖ ὑμᾶς ὁ κόσμος. **20** μνημονεύετε τοῦ λόγου οὗ ἐγὼ εἶπον ὑμῖν· Οὐκ ἔστιν δοῦλος μείζων τοῦ κυρίου αὐτοῦ· εἰ ἐμὲ ἐδίωξαν, καὶ ὑμᾶς διώξουσιν· εἰ τὸν λόγον μου ἐτήρησαν, καὶ τὸν ὑμέτερον τηρήσουσιν. **21** ἀλλὰ ταῦτα πάντα ποιήσουσιν εἰς ὑμᾶς διὰ τὸ ὄνομά μου, ὅτι οὐκ οἴδασιν τὸν πέμψαντά με. **22** εἰ μὴ ἦλθον καὶ ἐλάλησα αὐτοῖς, ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ εἴχοσαν· νῦν δὲ πρόφασιν οὐκ ἔχουσιν περὶ τῆς ἁμαρτίας αὐτῶν. **23** ὁ ἐμὲ μισῶν καὶ τὸν πατέρα μου μισεῖ. **24** εἰ τὰ ἔργα μὴ ἐποίησα ἐν αὐτοῖς ἃ οὐδεὶς ἄλλος ἐποίησεν, ἁμαρτίαν οὐκ εἴχοσαν· νῦν δὲ καὶ ἑωράκασιν καὶ μεμισήκασιν καὶ ἐμὲ καὶ τὸν πατέρα μου. **25** ἀλλ’ ἵνα πληρωθῇ ὁ λόγος ὁ ἐν τῷ νόμῳ αὐτῶν γεγραμμένος ὅτι Ἐμίσησάν με δωρεάν. **26** Ὅταν

ἔλθῃ ὁ παράκλητος ὃν ἐγὼ πέμψω ὑμῖν παρὰ τοῦ πατρός, τὸ πνεῦμα τῆς ἀληθείας ὃ παρὰ τοῦ πατρὸς ἐκπορεύεται, ἐκεῖνος μαρτυρήσει περὶ ἐμοῦ· **27** καὶ ὑμεῖς δὲ μαρτυρεῖτε, ὅτι ἀπ᾽ ἀρχῆς μετ᾽ ἐμοῦ ἐστε.

*English (BSB)*

**1** “I am the true vine, and My Father is the keeper of the vineyard. **2** He cuts off every branch in Me that bears no fruit, and every branch that does bear fruit, He prunes to make it even more fruitful. **3** You are already clean because of the word I have spoken to you. **4** Remain in Me, and I will remain in you. Just as no branch can bear fruit by itself unless it remains in the vine, neither can you bear fruit unless you remain in Me. **5** I am the vine and you are the branches. The one who remains in Me, and I in him, will bear much fruit. For apart from Me you can do nothing. **6** If anyone does not remain in Me, he is like a branch that is thrown away and withers. Such branches are gathered up, thrown into the fire, and burned. **7** If you remain in Me and My words remain in you, ask whatever you wish, and it will be done for you. **8** This is to My Father’s glory, that you bear much fruit, proving yourselves to be My disciples. **9** As the Father has loved Me, so have I loved you. Remain in My love. **10** If you keep My commandments, you will remain in My love, just as I have kept My Father’s commandments and remain in His love. **11** I have told you these things so that My joy may be in you and your joy may be complete. **12** This is My commandment, that you love one another as I have loved you. **13** Greater love has no one than this, that he lay down his life for his friends. **14** You are My friends if you do what I command you. **15** No longer do I call you servants, for a servant does not understand what his master is doing. But I have called you friends, because everything I have learned from My Father I have made known to you. **16** You did not choose Me, but I chose you. And I appointed you to go and bear fruit—fruit that will remain—so that whatever you ask the Father in My name, He will give you. **17** This is My command to you: Love one another. **18** If the world hates you, understand that it hated Me first. **19** If you were of the world, it would love you as its own. Instead, the world hates you, because you are not of the world, but I have chosen you out of the world. **20** Remember the word that I spoke to you: ‘No servant is greater than his master.’ If they persecuted Me, they will persecute you as well; if they kept My word, they will keep yours as well. **21** But they will treat you like this because of My name, since they do not know the One who sent Me. **22** If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not be guilty of sin. Now, however, they have no excuse for their sin. **23** Whoever hates Me hates My Father as well. **24** If I had not done among them the works that no one else did, they would not be guilty of sin; but now they have seen and hated both Me and My Father. **25** But this is to fulfill what is written in their Law: ‘They hated Me without reason.’ **26** When the Advocate comes, whom I will send to you from the Father—the Spirit of truth who proceeds from the Father—He will testify about

Me. **27** And you also must testify, because you have been with Me from the beginning.

*English (WEB)*

**1** “I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer. **2** Every branch in me that doesn’t bear fruit, he takes away. Every branch that bears fruit, he prunes, that it may bear more fruit. **3** You are already pruned clean because of the word which I have spoken to you. **4** Remain in me, and I in you. As the branch can’t bear fruit by itself unless it remains in the vine, so neither can you, unless you remain in me. **5** I am the vine. You are the branches. He who remains in me and I in him bears much fruit, for apart from me you can do nothing. **6** If a man doesn’t remain in me, he is thrown out as a branch and is withered; and they gather them, throw them into the fire, and they are burned. **7** If you remain in me, and my words remain in you, you will ask whatever you desire, and it will be done for you. **8** “In this my Father is glorified, that you bear much fruit; and so you will be my disciples. **9** Even as the Father has loved me, I also have loved you. Remain in my love. **10** If you keep my commandments, you will remain in my love, even as I have kept my Father’s commandments and remain in his love. **11** I have spoken these things to you, that my joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be made full. **12** “This is my commandment, that you love one another, even as I have loved you. **13** Greater love has no one than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends. **14** You are my friends if you do whatever I command you. **15** No longer do I call you servants, for the servant doesn’t know what his lord does. But I have called you friends, for everything that I heard from my Father, I have made known to you. **16** You didn’t choose me, but I chose you and appointed you, that you should go and bear fruit, and that your fruit should remain; that whatever you will ask of the Father in my name, he may give it to you. **17** “I command these things to you, that you may love one another. **18** If the world hates you, you know that it has hated me before it hated you. **19** If you were of the world, the world would love its own. But because you are not of the world, since I chose you out of the world, therefore the world hates you. **20** Remember the word that I said to you: ‘A servant is not greater than his lord.’ If they persecuted me, they will also persecute you. If they kept my word, they will also keep yours. **21** But they will do all these things to you for my name’s sake, because they don’t know him who sent me. **22** If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have had sin; but now they have no excuse for their sin. **23** He who hates me, hates my Father also. **24** If I hadn’t done among them the works which no one else did, they wouldn’t have had sin. But now they have seen and also hated both me and my Father. **25** But this happened so that the word may be fulfilled which was written in their law, ‘They hated me without a cause.’ **26** “When the Counselor has come, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the

Father, he will testify about me. **27** You will also testify, because you have been with me from the beginning.

### Acts 2:42

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**42** ἦσαν δὲ προσκαρτεροῦντες τῇ διδαχῇ τῶν ἀποστόλων καὶ τῇ κοινωνίᾳ, τῇ κλάσει τοῦ ἄρτου καὶ ταῖς προσευχαῖς.

*English (BSB)*

**42** They devoted themselves to the apostles’ teaching and to the fellowship, to the breaking of bread and to prayer.

*English (WEB)*

**42** They continued steadfastly in the apostles’ teaching and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and prayer.

### Acts 20:32

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**32** καὶ τὰ νῦν παρατίθεμαι ὑμᾶς τῷ θεῷ καὶ τῷ λόγῳ τῆς χάριτος αὐτοῦ, τῷ δυναμένῳ οἰκοδομῆσαι καὶ δοῦναι τὴν κληρονομίαν ἐν τοῖς ἡγιασμένοις πᾶσιν.

*English (BSB)*

**32** And now I commit you to God and to the word of His grace, which can build you up and give you an inheritance among all who are sanctified.

*English (WEB)*

**32** Now, brothers, I entrust you to God and to the word of his grace, which is able to build up and to give you the inheritance among all those who are sanctified.

### Romans 5:5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** ἡ δὲ ἐλπὶς οὐ καταισχύνει· ὅτι ἡ ἀγάπη τοῦ θεοῦ ἐκκέχυται ἐν ταῖς καρδίαις ἡμῶν διὰ πνεύματος ἁγίου τοῦ δοθέντος ἡμῖν.

*English (BSB)*

**5** And hope does not disappoint us, because God has poured out His love into our hearts through the Holy Spirit, whom He has given us.

*English (WEB)*

**5** and hope doesn't disappoint us, because God's love has been poured into our hearts through the Holy Spirit who was given to us.

## Romans 8:15–16, 26–27, 39

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**15** οὐ γὰρ ἐλάβετε πνεῦμα δουλείας πάλιν εἰς φόβον, ἀλλὰ ἐλάβετε πνεῦμα υἱοθεσίας ἐν ᾧ κράζομεν· Αββα ὁ πατήρ· **16** αὐτὸ τὸ πνεῦμα συμμαρτυρεῖ τῷ πνεύματι ἡμῶν ὅτι ἐσμὲν τέκνα θεοῦ. … **26** Ὡσαύτως δὲ καὶ τὸ πνεῦμα συναντιλαμβάνεται τῇ ἀσθενείᾳ ἡμῶν· τὸ γὰρ τί προσευξώμεθα καθὸ δεῖ οὐκ οἴδαμεν, ἀλλὰ αὐτὸ τὸ πνεῦμα ὑπερεντυγχάνει στεναγμοῖς ἀλαλήτοις, **27** ὁ δὲ ἐραυνῶν τὰς καρδίας οἶδεν τί τὸ φρόνημα τοῦ πνεύματος, ὅτι κατὰ θεὸν ἐντυγχάνει ὑπὲρ ἁγίων. … **39** οὔτε ὕψωμα οὔτε βάθος οὔτε τις κτίσις ἑτέρα δυνήσεται ἡμᾶς χωρίσαι ἀπὸ τῆς ἀγάπης τοῦ θεοῦ τῆς ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ τῷ κυρίῳ ἡμῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**15** For you did not receive a spirit of slavery that returns you to fear, but you received the Spirit of sonship, by whom we cry, "Abba! Father!" **16** The Spirit Himself testifies with our spirit that we are God's children. … **26** In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words. **27** And He who searches our hearts knows the mind of the Spirit, because the Spirit intercedes for the saints according to the will of God. … **39** neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

*English (WEB)*

**15** For you didn't receive the spirit of bondage again to fear, but you received the Spirit of adoption, by whom we cry, "Abba! Father!" **16** The Spirit himself testifies with our spirit that we are children of God; … **26** In the same way, the Spirit also helps our weaknesses, for we don't know how to pray as we ought. But the Spirit himself makes intercession for us with groanings which can't be uttered. **27** He who searches the hearts knows what is on the Spirit's mind, because he makes intercession for the saints according to God. … **39** nor height, nor depth, nor any other created thing will be able to separate us from God's love which is in Christ Jesus our Lord.

## 1 Corinthians 3:10–14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**10** Κατὰ τὴν χάριν τοῦ θεοῦ τὴν δοθεῖσάν μοι ὡς σοφὸς ἀρχιτέκτων θεμέλιον ἔθηκα, ἄλλος δὲ ἐποικοδομεῖ. ἕκαστος δὲ βλεπέτω πῶς ἐποικοδομεῖ· **11** θεμέλιον γὰρ ἄλλον οὐδεὶς δύναται

θεῖναι παρὰ τὸν κείμενον, ὅς ἐστιν Ἰησοῦς Χριστός· **12** εἰ δέ τις ἐποικοδομεῖ ἐπὶ τὸν θεμέλιον χρυσόν, ἄργυρον, λίθους τιμίους, ξύλα, χόρτον, καλάμην, **13** ἑκάστου τὸ ἔργον φανερὸν γενήσεται, ἡ γὰρ ἡμέρα δηλώσει· ὅτι ἐν πυρὶ ἀποκαλύπτεται, καὶ ἑκάστου τὸ ἔργον ὁποῖόν ἐστιν τὸ πῦρ αὐτὸ δοκιμάσει. **14** εἴ τινος τὸ ἔργον μενεῖ ὃ ἐποικοδόμησεν, μισθὸν λήμψεται·

*English (BSB)*

**10** By the grace God has given me, I laid a foundation as an expert builder, and someone else is building on it. But each one must be careful how he builds. **11** For no one can lay a foundation other than the one already laid, which is Jesus Christ. **12** If anyone builds on this foundation using gold, silver, precious stones, wood, hay, or straw, **13** his workmanship will be evident, because the Day will bring it to light. It will be revealed with fire, and the fire will prove the quality of each man’s work. **14** If what he has built survives, he will receive a reward.

*English (WEB)*

**10** According to the grace of God which was given to me, as a wise master builder I laid a foundation, and another builds on it. But let each man be careful how he builds on it. **11** For no one can lay any other foundation than that which has been laid, which is Jesus Christ. **12** But if anyone builds on the foundation with gold, silver, costly stones, wood, hay, or straw, **13** each man’s work will be revealed. For the Day will declare it, because it is revealed in fire; and the fire itself will test what sort of work each man’s work is. **14** If any man’s work remains which he built on it, he will receive a reward.

## 1 Corinthians 13:13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** νυνὶ δὲ μένει πίστις, ἐλπίς, ἀγάπη· τὰ τρία ταῦτα, μείζων δὲ τούτων ἡ ἀγάπη.

*English (BSB)*

**13** And now these three remain: faith, hope, and love; but the greatest of these is love.

*English (WEB)*

**13** But now faith, hope, and love remain—these three. The greatest of these is love.

## 1 Corinthians 14:14–15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** ἐὰν γὰρ προσεύχωμαι γλώσσῃ, τὸ πνεῦμά μου προσεύχεται, ὁ δὲ νοῦς μου ἄκαρπός ἐστιν.
**15** τί οὖν ἐστιν; προσεύξομαι τῷ πνεύματι, προσεύξομαι δὲ καὶ τῷ νοΐ· ψαλῶ τῷ πνεύματι, ψαλῶ δὲ καὶ τῷ νοΐ·

*English (BSB)*

**14** For if I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays, but my mind is unfruitful. **15** What then shall I do? I will pray with my spirit, but I will also pray with my mind. I will sing with my spirit, but I will also sing with my mind.

*English (WEB)*

**14** For if I pray in another language, my spirit prays, but my understanding is unfruitful. **15** What should I do? I will pray with the spirit, and I will pray with the understanding also. I will sing with the spirit, and I will sing with the understanding also.

## 1 Corinthians 16:22

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**22** εἴ τις οὐ φιλεῖ τὸν κύριον, ἤτω ἀνάθεμα. Μαράνα θά.

*English (BSB)*

**22** If anyone does not love the Lord, let him be under a curse. Come, O Lord!

*English (WEB)*

**22** If any man doesn’t love the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be cursed. Come, Lord!

## 2 Corinthians 13:14

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

*English (BSB)*

**14** The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with all of you.

*English (WEB)*

**14** The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, God’s love, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all. Amen.

## Galatians 4:6

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** ὅτι δέ ἐστε υἱοί, ἐξαπέστειλεν ὁ θεὸς τὸ πνεῦμα τοῦ υἱοῦ αὐτοῦ εἰς τὰς καρδίας ἡμῶν, κρᾶζον· Αββα ὁ πατήρ.

*English (BSB)*

**6** And because you are sons, God sent the Spirit of His Son into our hearts, crying out, “Abba, Father!”

*English (WEB)*

**6** And because you are children, God sent out the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, “Abba, Father!”

## Ephesians 2:20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** ἐποικοδομηθέντες ἐπὶ τῷ θεμελίῳ τῶν ἀποστόλων καὶ προφητῶν, ὄντος ἀκρογωνιαίου αὐτοῦ Χριστοῦ Ἰησοῦ,

*English (BSB)*

**20** built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus Himself as the cornerstone.

*English (WEB)*

**20** being built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus himself being the chief cornerstone;

## Ephesians 4:32

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**32** γίνεσθε εἰς ἀλλήλους χρηστοί, εὔσπλαγχνοι, χαριζόμενοι ἑαυτοῖς καθὼς καὶ ὁ θεὸς ἐν Χριστῷ ἐχαρίσατο ὑμῖν.

*English (BSB)*

**32** Be kind and tenderhearted to one another, forgiving each other just as in Christ God forgave you.

*English (WEB)*

**32** And be kind to one another, tender hearted, forgiving each other, just as God also in Christ forgave you.

## Ephesians 6:18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** διὰ πάσης προσευχῆς καὶ δεήσεως, προσευχόμενοι ἐν παντὶ καιρῷ ἐν πνεύματι, καὶ εἰς αὐτὸ ἀγρυπνοῦντες ἐν πάσῃ προσκαρτερήσει καὶ δεήσει περὶ πάντων τῶν ἁγίων,

*English (BSB)*

**18** Pray in the Spirit at all times, with every kind of prayer and petition. To this end, stay alert with all perseverance in your prayers for all the saints.

*English (WEB)*

**18** with all prayer and requests, praying at all times in the Spirit, and being watchful to this end in all perseverance and requests for all the saints.

### Philippians 3:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** ἡμεῖς γάρ ἐσμεν ἡ περιτομή, οἱ πνεύματι θεοῦ λατρεύοντες καὶ καυχώμενοι ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ καὶ οὐκ ἐν σαρκὶ πεποιθότες,

*English (BSB)*

**3** For it is we who are the circumcision, we who worship by the Spirit of God, who glory in Christ Jesus, and who put no confidence in the flesh—

*English (WEB)*

**3** For we are the circumcision, who worship God in the Spirit, and rejoice in Christ Jesus, and have no confidence in the flesh;

### Colossians 2:7

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**7** ἐρριζωμένοι καὶ ἐποικοδομούμενοι ἐν αὐτῷ καὶ βεβαιούμενοι τῇ πίστει καθὼς ἐδιδάχθητε, περισσεύοντες ἐν εὐχαριστίᾳ.

*English (BSB)*

**7** rooted and built up in Him, established in the faith as you were taught, and overflowing with thankfulness.

*English (WEB)*

**7** rooted and built up in him and established in the faith, even as you were taught, abounding in it in thanksgiving.

### Colossians 3:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** ὁ λόγος τοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐνοικείτω ἐν ὑμῖν πλουσίως ἐν πάσῃ σοφίᾳ· διδάσκοντες καὶ νουθετοῦντες ἑαυτοὺς ψαλμοῖς, ὕμνοις, ᾠδαῖς πνευματικαῖς ἐν χάριτι, ᾄδοντες ἐν ταῖς καρδίαις ὑμῶν τῷ θεῷ·

*English (BSB)*

**16** Let the word of Christ richly dwell within you as you teach and admonish one another with all wisdom, and as you sing psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs with gratitude in your hearts to God.

*English (WEB)*

**16** Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly; in all wisdom teaching and admonishing one another with psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your heart to the Lord.

## 1 Thessalonians 1:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** μνημονεύοντες ὑμῶν τοῦ ἔργου τῆς πίστεως καὶ τοῦ κόπου τῆς ἀγάπης καὶ τῆς ὑπομονῆς τῆς ἐλπίδος τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ πατρὸς ἡμῶν,

*English (BSB)*

**3** and continually recalling before our God and Father your work of faith, your labor of love, and your enduring hope in our Lord Jesus Christ.

*English (WEB)*

**3** remembering without ceasing your work of faith and labor of love and perseverance of hope in our Lord Jesus Christ, before our God and Father.

## 1 Thessalonians 5:11

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** διὸ παρακαλεῖτε ἀλλήλους καὶ οἰκοδομεῖτε εἷς τὸν ἕνα, καθὼς καὶ ποιεῖτε.

*English (BSB)*

**11** Therefore encourage and build one another up, just as you are already doing.

*English (WEB)*

**11** Therefore exhort one another, and build each other up, even as you also do.

## 2 Timothy 1:18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** δῴη αὐτῷ ὁ κύριος εὑρεῖν ἔλεος παρὰ κυρίου ἐν ἐκείνῃ τῇ ἡμέρᾳ— καὶ ὅσα ἐν Ἐφέσῳ διηκόνησεν, βέλτιον σὺ γινώσκεις.

*English (BSB)*

**18** May the Lord grant Onesiphorus His mercy on that day. You know very well how much he ministered to me in Ephesus.

*English (WEB)*

**18** (the Lord grant to him to find the Lord’s mercy in that day); and in how many things he served at Ephesus, you know very well.

## Titus 2:13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** προσδεχόμενοι τὴν μακαρίαν ἐλπίδα καὶ ἐπιφάνειαν τῆς δόξης τοῦ μεγάλου θεοῦ καὶ σωτῆρος ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ,

*English (BSB)*

**13** as we await the blessed hope and glorious appearance of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ.

*English (WEB)*

**13** looking for the blessed hope and appearing of the glory of our great God and Savior, Jesus Christ,

## 1 John 4:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** καὶ ἡμεῖς ἐγνώκαμεν καὶ πεπιστεύκαμεν τὴν ἀγάπην ἣν ἔχει ὁ θεὸς ἐν ἡμῖν. Ὁ θεὸς ἀγάπη ἐστίν, καὶ ὁ μένων ἐν τῇ ἀγάπῃ ἐν τῷ θεῷ μένει καὶ ὁ θεὸς ἐν αὐτῷ μένει.

*English (BSB)*

**16** And we have come to know and believe the love that God has for us. God is love; whoever abides in love abides in God, and God in him.

*English (WEB)*

**16** We know and have believed the love which God has for us. God is love, and he who remains in love remains in God, and God remains in him.

# Chapter 12. Mercy for the Wavering, Rescue from the Fire (Jude 22–23)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **22** καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεᾶτε διακρινομένους, **23** οὓς δὲ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ, μισοῦντες καὶ τὸν ἀπὸ τῆς σαρκὸς ἐσπιλωμένον χιτῶνα.
>
> — Jude 22–23, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript’s first hand, and $^{\text{corr}}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 22–23 | καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεᾶτε διακρινομένους, οὓς δὲ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ | three clauses: have mercy on some who doubt; save others, snatching them from fire; have mercy on others with fear | א Ψ |
| 22–23 | καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλέγχετε διακρινομένους, οὓς δὲ σῴζετε …, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ | three clauses, the first ‘refute some who dispute’ | A 1739 |
| 22–23 | καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεᾶτε διακρινομένους σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ | two clauses: have mercy on some who doubt, saving them by snatching them from fire; have | B |

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | mercy on others with fear | |
| 22–23 | καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλέγχετε διακρινομένους, οὓς δὲ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες ἐν φόβῳ | two clauses: refute some who dispute; save others with fear, snatching them from fire (a corrector changed ἐλέγχετε to ἐλεᾶτε) | C |
| 22–23 | καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεεῖτε διακρινόμενοι, οὓς δὲ ἐν φόβῳ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες | two clauses: have mercy on some, making a distinction; save others with fear, snatching them from fire | K L |
| 22–23 | οὓς μὲν ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάσατε, διακρινομένους δὲ ἐλεεῖτε ἐν φόβῳ | two clauses: snatch some from fire; on those who dispute have mercy with fear | P72 |

Notes. v. 22: not extant in P78. v. 23: not extant in P78.

## The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

### Jude 22

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | And have compassion on some separatynge them: |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | And haue compassion of some, in putting difference: |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | And some indeed reprove, being judged: |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | And of some have compassion, making a difference: |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | And some rebuke when they contend; and others save, snatching them out of the fire; and on others have compassion |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | And on some have mercy, who are in doubt; |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | And of some have compassion, making a difference, |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | and to some be kind, judging thoroughly, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | And on some have mercy, who are in doubt; |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | On some have compassion, making a distinction, |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Mercifully help those who are not certain what teaching they should believe. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | To some show pity, because they are in doubt. 'Drag them out of the fire,' and save them. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Be merciful to those who doubt. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Show kindness to those who doubt. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | and, indeed, show mercy to those who are doubting, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | And indeed, have mercy on those who doubt; |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | And indeed, have mercy on some, making a distinction; |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Have mercy on some, using discernment; |

### Jude 23

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | and other save with feare pullinge them out of the fyre and hate the fylthy vesture of the flesshe. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | And other saue with feare, pulling them out of the fire, and hate euen that garment which is spotted by the flesh. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | But others save, pulling them out of the fire. And on others have mercy, in fear, hating also the spotted garment which is carnal. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | And others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | with fear, hating even the garment spotted by the flesh. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | and some save, snatching them out of the fire; and on some have mercy with fear; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | but others save with fear, snatching [them] out of the fire; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | and some in fear save ye, out of the fire snatching, hating even the coat from the flesh spotted. |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | and some save, snatching them out of the fire; and on some have mercy with fear; hating even the garment spotted by the flesh. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | and some save, snatching them out of the fire with fear, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh. |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | Rescue others from the influence of those who teach what is false [MET], as you would rescue things by snatching them from a fire. Pity those whom the teachers of false doctrine have completely convinced, but beware that you yourselves are not influenced by them {that they do not influence you}. Detest doing or even thinking about the sins that those people commit, just like you would detest [MET] touching not only filthy things but the clothes that were stained by those things {that those things stained}. Jude 24-25 |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | To others show pity, but with caution, hating the clothing polluted by their touch. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Save others by snatching them out of the fire. To others be merciful with fear. Hate even the garment stained by the flesh. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Save those you can by snatching them out of the fire. Show mercy—but with great care, hating even the "clothing" that is contaminated by sinful human nature. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | and rescue others by snatching [them] out of fire; but show mercy to others in fear, hating even the coat having been stained from the flesh. |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | save others by snatching them from the fire; and to still others show mercy tempered with fear, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | save others with fear by snatching them from the fire, hating even the clothing stained by the flesh. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | and others save with fear by snatching them out of the fire, hating even the garment that is stained by the flesh. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Jude's last instructions turn from the readers' own spiritual life (vv. 20–21) to their responsibility toward others. Those who have been kept in God's love and who wait for Christ's mercy must now show mercy themselves. Jude names three kinds of people (on the most widely accepted reading of the text):

1. **Those who are wavering**, unsettled by the intruders' influence. Show them mercy.
2. **Those in immediate danger**, already near the fire of judgment. Snatch them out.
3. **Others who are deeply compromised.** Show them mercy too, but with fear, hating even the clothing stained by their sin.

These two verses transform the letter. After so much warning and condemnation, Jude's last practical word is mercy. The readers are not to write off everyone touched by the intruders. They are to distinguish between people in different situations and to act toward each with compassion, urgency, and wisdom. Contending for the faith (v. 3) ends in rescue.

The Greek text of these verses is one of the most complicated in the New Testament. The manuscripts preserve two-clause and three-clause versions with different verbs. This chapter follows the three-clause text printed in the LSV, the SBLGNT, and NA28, and explains the alternatives in a deep dive.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεᾶτε (*kai hous men eleate*) — 'and have mercy on some'

The command ἐλεᾶτε (*eleate*), "show mercy, have mercy," is a present imperative of ἐλεάω (*eleaō*), a variant form of the more common ἐλεέω (*eleeō*). The Byzantine manuscripts read ἐλεεῖτε, the more familiar form.[154] The word picks up the theme of mercy that frames the letter. Jude wished his readers mercy (v. 2), and they wait for Christ's mercy (v. 21). Now they are to show mercy. Mercy received becomes mercy given.

The construction καὶ οὓς μὲν … οὓς δὲ … οὓς δὲ (*kai hous men … hous de … hous de*), "and some … others … others," divides the people in view into

groups. The LSV's "and, indeed, … others … others" reflects it.

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154. SBLGNT apparatus for Jude 22–23: "ἐλεᾶτε WH NIV ] ἐλεεῖτε RP; ἐλέγχετε Treg."↩

### διακρινομένους (*diakrinomenous*) — 'who are doubting'

The participle διακρινομένους (*diakrinomenous*) comes from διακρίνω (*diakrinō*), a verb with a wide range: "to separate, distinguish, judge," and in the middle voice "to dispute" or "to doubt, waver." Jude used the same verb in v. 9 for Michael "disputing" with the Devil. Here two meanings are possible:

1. **"Those who doubt" or "waver."** This is the sense the verb usually has in the New Testament when it describes a person's inner state. Jesus says, "if you may have faith, and may not doubt" (Matt 21:21, LSV). James writes, "let him ask in faith, doubting nothing, for he who is doubting has been like a wave of the sea, driven by wind and tossed" (Jas 1:6, LSV). On this reading, Jude refers to believers who have been unsettled by the intruders and are uncertain whom to believe. They need mercy, patient and compassionate help, not condemnation.
2. **"Those who dispute."** This sense matches Jude's own use in v. 9. It would refer to people who argue, perhaps those who have taken the intruders' side. Some manuscripts read "convict" or "refute" (ἐλέγχετε, *elenchete*) instead of "show mercy" in this clause, which would give "refute those who dispute."

Most translations and commentators prefer "doubt" or "waver." The image in James of the doubter as "a wave of the sea" offers an interesting echo of Jude's "wild waves" (v. 13). The intruders are wild waves, and those they unsettle are tossed by them. The wavering are not the enemy. They are the ones at risk.

The Byzantine text reads the nominative διακρινόμενοι (*diakrinomenoi*), which makes the participle describe the readers rather than the people they help. Webster's revision of the traditional English Bible translates it "And of some have compassion, making a difference" (WBS), meaning that the readers should show compassion while discerning between cases. That reading also has a good sense, but the accusative form, referring to those who doubt, has stronger early support and is printed in the critical editions.[155]

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155. The Text-Critical Greek NT notes (eBible.org) record ἐλεεῖτε διακρινόμενοι in about 88% of manuscripts, ἐλέγχετε διακρινομένους in about 7% (including the reading of the Tyndale House GNT, marked "TH"), and ἐλεᾶτε διακρινομένους (NA28, SBLGNT, WH) in about 2%. Manuscript counts do not determine originality; the critical editions weigh the age and quality of witnesses.↩

### οὓς δὲ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες (*hous de sōzete ek pyros harpazontes*) — 'save others, snatching them out of the fire'

The second group is in more urgent danger. The command σῴζετε (*sōzete*), “save, rescue,” is accompanied by the participle ἁρπάζοντες (*harpazontes*), “snatching, seizing.” The verb ἁρπάζω (*harpazō*) means “to seize by force, to grab.” Jesus uses it when he says that “no one will snatch them out of My hand” (John 10:28, LSV). Here it describes a rescuer pulling someone out of a burning building, an act of urgent, physical intervention.

The “fire” (πῦρ, *pyr*) recalls the “continuous fire” of Sodom (v. 7), the fire of judgment. These people are already, so to speak, in the flames, close to the fate of the intruders. They cannot be helped by gentle persuasion alone. They need decisive action.

The image comes from the prophets. In Zechariah’s vision, the LORD says of Joshua the high priest: “Is this not a brand delivered from fire?” (Zech 3:2, LSV), a burning stick pulled out of the fire before it is consumed. The Septuagint’s wording, δαλὸς ἐξεσπασμένος ἐκ πυρός (*dalos exespasmenos ek pyros*), “a brand snatched out of fire,” is close to Jude’s ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες (*ek pyros harpazontes*).[156] Amos uses the same image in a passage that also recalls Sodom and Gomorrah: “I have overturned among you, / Like the overturn by God of Sodom and Gomorrah, / And you are as a brand delivered from a burning” (Amos 4:11, LSV). Jude’s readers, who have just heard about Sodom’s fire (v. 7), are called to be the hands that pull people from it.

Notice where this allusion comes from. Zechariah 3 also stood behind Michael’s words in v. 9: “The LORD rebuke you!” In that chapter, the accuser stands against Joshua, the LORD rebukes the accuser, Joshua is called “a brand delivered from fire,” and his filthy garments are removed (Zech 3:1–4). Jude draws on the same scene twice. In v. 9 it shows the restraint of the heavenly defender. In v. 23 it shows the rescue of the one accused.

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156. LXX Zech 3:2: οὐκ ἰδοὺ τοῦτο ὡς δαλὸς ἐξεσπασμένος ἐκ πυρός; (Brenton’s Greek Septuagint).↩

### οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ (*hous de eleate en phobō*) — ‘and on others have mercy with fear’

The third group also receives mercy, ἐλεᾶτε again, but now ἐν φόβῳ (*en phobō*), “in fear” or “with fear.” What kind of fear?

1. **Fear of God.** Mercy must be shown with reverent awareness of God’s holiness and judgment. The readers must not treat sin lightly while showing mercy to sinners. Paul writes, “having known, therefore, the fear of the LORD, we persuade men” (2 Cor 5:11, LSV), and Hebrews calls believers to serve God “with reverence and fear, for our God [is] also a consuming fire” (Heb 12:28–29, LSV).

2. **Caution about contamination.** Those who help people deeply involved in sin must take care not to be drawn into it themselves. Paul gives the same caution: “you who [are] spiritual restore such a one in a spirit of meekness, considering yourself—lest you also may be tempted” (Gal 6:1, LSV).

The two senses go together, and the next phrase explains the second.

### μισοῦντες καὶ τὸν ἀπὸ τῆς σαρκὸς ἐσπιλωμένον χιτῶνα (*misountes kai ton apo tēs sarkos espilōmenon chitōna*) — ‘hating even the tunic stained by the flesh’

The final phrase is vivid: μισοῦντες καὶ τὸν ἀπὸ τῆς σαρκὸς ἐσπιλωμένον χιτῶνα (*misountes kai ton apo tēs sarkos espilōmenon chitōna*), “hating even the tunic stained by the flesh.”

- The **χιτών** (*chitōn*) was the basic garment of the ancient world, a tunic worn next to the skin under the outer cloak.
- **ἐσπιλωμένον** (*espilōmenon*), “stained, spotted,” is the perfect passive participle of σπιλόω (*spiloō*), “to stain, defile.”[157] It belongs to the same family as σπίλος, “stain,” and, on one reading, as the σπιλάδες of v. 12. If Jude intended the link, the intruders who were “stains” at the love feasts (LSV) have stained the garments of those they influenced.
- **“From the flesh”** (ἀπὸ τῆς σαρκός, *apo tēs sarkos*) points to the source of the stain: sinful human nature, and especially the sexual sins Jude has repeatedly mentioned (vv. 4, 7–8).

The image is deliberately strong. The undergarment touched the body directly. To hate “even the coat” is to want nothing to do with the sin, not even with what has been in contact with it, while still reaching out to the person. Again Zechariah 3 is in the background: “Joshua was clothed with filthy garments,” and the LORD says, “Turn aside the filthy garments from off him. … See, I have caused your iniquity to pass away from off you, so as to clothe you with costly apparel” (Zech 3:3–4, LSV). The garment is not the person. The garment can be removed, and the person can be clothed afresh.

The phrase holds together two attitudes that are easily separated: mercy toward people and hatred of sin. Christians have often summarized the balance in the slogan “love the sinner, hate the sin.” Jude gives a more demanding picture. The mercy is real, but it is shown “in fear,” and the hatred of sin is strong enough to recoil from its slightest trace.

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157. Abbott-Smith, s.v. σπιλόω: “to stain, spot, defile: c. acc., Ja 3:6, Ju 23.” ↩

### Deep dive: Showing mercy to those who doubt

Jude's instruction to "show mercy to those who are doubting" is one of the most pastorally significant sentences in the letter, and it deserves reflection.

**Who are the doubters?** In Jude's situation, they were probably believers who had been exposed to the intruders' teaching and conduct and had become unsure. Perhaps the intruders' visions impressed them, or their freedom seemed attractive. Perhaps they could not see why Jude and the other leaders objected. Such people were not yet committed to the intruders' way of life, but they were wavering.

**Why mercy?** Jude could have told his readers to rebuke or exclude the doubters. Instead he tells them to show mercy. Several reasons emerge from the letter:

- **They have received mercy themselves** (vv. 2, 21). Those who wait for Christ's mercy cannot withhold mercy from others.
- **Doubt is not the same as rebellion.** The intruders deliberately turn grace into license and reject authority. The doubters are uncertain. To treat uncertainty as rebellion would push the wavering toward the very people Jude warns against.
- **The goal is restoration.** Jude's whole letter aims to keep people in God's love. Mercy toward the wavering serves that goal.

**What does mercy look like?** Jude does not spell it out, but the New Testament offers many models. Paul urges, "receive him who is weak in the faith—not to determinations of reasonings" (Rom 14:1, LSV). The Lord's servant "must not quarrel, but to be gentle to all, apt to teach, patient under evil, instructing those opposing in meekness—if perhaps God may give to them conversion" (2 Tim 2:24–25, LSV). James promises that "he who turned back a sinner from the straying of his way will save a soul from death" (Jas 5:20, LSV). Jesus' parable of the shepherd who leaves the ninety-nine to seek the one gone astray ends, "it is not [the] will in [the] presence of your Father who is in the heavens that one of these little ones may perish" (Matt 18:14, LSV). Mercy to the doubting likely includes patience, gentle instruction, prayer, presence, and the steady testimony of a community that is building itself up in the faith (v. 20).

**Discernment.** Jude's threefold distinction shows that mercy is not uniform. The wavering need patient compassion. Those near the fire need urgent rescue. The deeply compromised need mercy mixed with caution. Wise pastoral care pays attention to the person's situation.

**Doubt today.** The word "doubt" covers many experiences: intellectual questions, emotional struggles, confusion caused by conflicting teachers, disappointment with the church. Not all of them are what Jude had in mind. His instruction, though, suggests a general principle. Communities that hold firmly to "the faith once delivered" should be the most merciful toward those

who struggle to hold it. Firmness and mercy are not opposites in Jude. Both flow from being kept in God's love.

### Deep dive: The text of Jude 22–23

Few New Testament passages survive in as many forms as these two verses. The main forms can be grouped as follows (Greek simplified):[158]

| Witness | Text | Structure |
|---|---|---|
| SBLGNT, NA28, Tregelles, NIV Greek text; LSV | καὶ οὓς μὲν **ἐλεᾶτε** διακρινομένους, οὓς δὲ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ… | Three groups: show mercy to the doubting / save others, snatching from fire / show mercy to others in fear |
| Tregelles (first verb), Tyndale House GNT (as reported) | καὶ οὓς μὲν **ἐλέγχετε** διακρινομένους… | Three groups, but the first is "refute (or convict) those who dispute" |
| Westcott–Hort | καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεᾶτε διακρινομένους σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ… | Two groups: "have mercy on some who doubt, saving them by snatching them from fire; and on others have mercy in fear" |
| Robinson–Pierpont, TR | καὶ οὓς μὲν ἐλεεῖτε διακρινόμενοι, οὓς δὲ ἐν φόβῳ σῴζετε ἐκ (τοῦ) πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες… | Two groups: "on some have compassion, making a difference; others save with fear, pulling them out of the fire" |
| P72 (early papyrus) | οὓς μὲν ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάσατε, διακρινομένους δὲ ἐλεεῖτε ἐν φόβῳ… | Two groups: "snatch some from the fire, but on those who doubt have mercy in fear" |

The manuscripts themselves show the same spread. In the transcriptions of the earliest copies:[159]

| Manuscript | Date | Form of vv. 22–23 |
|---|---|---|
| P72 | 3rd/4th c. | two clauses: οὓς μὲν ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάσατε, διακρινομένους δὲ ἐλεεῖτε ἐν φόβῳ ('snatch some from fire, but on those who doubt have mercy in fear') |
| ℵ 01 Sinaiticus | 4th c. | three clauses with ἐλεᾶτε … σῴζετε … ἐλεᾶτε (as SBLGNT) |
| B 03 Vaticanus | 4th c. | two clauses: ἐλεᾶτε διακρινομένους σῴζετε ἐκ |

| Manuscript | Date | Form of vv. 22–23 |
|---|---|---|
| | | πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες, οὓς δὲ ἐλεᾶτε ἐν φόβῳ |
| A 02 Alexandrinus | 5th c. | three clauses, beginning ἐλέγχετε (‘convict’) |
| C 04 Ephraemi | 5th c. | ἐλέγχετε (corrected to ἐλεᾶτε) διακρινομένους, οὓς δὲ σῴζετε ἐκ πυρὸς ἁρπάζοντες ἐν φόβῳ (two clauses) |
| Ψ 044 | 9th/10th c. | three clauses with ἐλεᾶτε |
| 1739 | 10th c. | three clauses, beginning ἐλέγχετε |
| K 018, L 020 | 9th c. | Byzantine two-clause form: ἐλεεῖτε διακρινόμενοι, οὓς δὲ ἐν φόβῳ σῴζετε… |

Early Christian writers knew different forms too. Clement of Alexandria paraphrased a two-part text: “But some, he says, save, plucking them from the fire; but of some have compassion in fear.”[160]

**Why so many forms?** The repetition of similar words (two forms of “show mercy,” and the series οὓς μὲν … οὓς δέ) made the passage easy to miscopy. Scribes may have dropped a clause by accident when the eye skipped from one οὓς δέ to the next, or they may have smoothed a difficult text. The verb διακρίνω, which can mean “doubt” or “dispute,” also invited different interpretations and therefore different verbs (“show mercy” or “refute”).

**Which is original?** Interpreters are divided. The three-clause text printed in the SBLGNT and NA28 is supported by Sinaiticus, Alexandrinus (with “convict”), Ψ, and 1739, and it can explain the two-clause forms as accidental omissions. The two-clause forms are supported by the oldest witness, P72, and by Vaticanus, in different shapes. A good case can therefore be made that a shorter text is original and that the three-clause text grew by expansion. Nineteenth-century commentators already struggled with the passage. The Cambridge commentary observed that “the MSS. present a strange variety of readings” and that those “of most authority give, Some rebuke (or convict) … when they debate with you.” Plummer, in Ellicott’s commentary, thought “the evidence is very strong in favour of” the reading “some indeed convict.” J. B. Mayor gave the problem one of the longest notes in his commentary.[161]

**Does it matter?** The core of the passage is the same in all forms: mercy toward some, urgent rescue of others from the fire, and caution about the defilement of sin. The differences affect how many groups Jude distinguishes and whether the first group receives mercy or rebuke. This book follows the

three-clause text of the LSV and SBLGNT, while recognizing that certainty is not possible.

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158. Readings for the editions are from the SBLGNT apparatus and the eBible.org SBLGNT notes (NA28). The Tyndale House reading is as reported in the Text-Critical Greek NT notes. The P72 reading was checked against its INTF transcription (see n. 5b).↩

159. INTF New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room transcriptions, https://ntvmr.uni-muenster.de, CC BY 4.0; consulted 7 November 2026.↩

160. Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 22–23, ANF 2.↩

161. *Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges* (Plumptre), on Jude 22; Plummer in *Ellicott's Commentary for English Readers*, on Jude 22; J. B. Mayor, *Expositor's Greek Testament*, on Jude 22–23. All public domain; see https://biblehub.com/commentaries/jude/1-22.htm.↩

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ἐλεάω / ἐλεέω | *eleaō* / *eleeō* | show mercy | "show mercy" | Present imperative; variant ἐλέγχετε, "convict." |
| διακρίνομαι | *diakrinomai* | dispute; doubt, waver | "those who are doubting" | Same verb as v. 9; Jas 1:6. |
| σῴζω | *sōzō* | save, rescue | "rescue" | |
| ἁρπάζω | *harpazō* | seize, snatch | "snatching" | Urgent action; John 10:28. |
| πῦρ | *pyr* | fire | "fire" | Judgment fire (v. 7); Zech 3:2; Amos 4:11. |
| φόβος | *phobos* | fear, reverence | "in fear" | Fear of God and caution. |
| μισέω | *miseō* | hate | "hating" | |
| χιτών | *chitōn* | tunic, undergarment | "the coat" | Garment worn next to the skin. |
| σπιλόω | *spiloō* | stain, defile | "stained" | Perfect passive participle; cf. σπιλάδες (v. 12). |
| σάρξ | *sarx* | flesh | "the flesh" | Sinful human nature; cf. vv. 7–8. |

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Clothing and purity.** In the Jewish world, garments could become ritually impure through contact with bodily discharges or with unclean things (Lev 13–15), and purification involved washing clothes. The image of a defiled garment would have carried both ritual and moral overtones. Zechariah's vision of the high priest's filthy garments, which are removed and replaced with clean ones, provided a powerful picture of forgiveness and restoration.

**Fire as judgment.** In Jewish and early Christian thought, fire was the most common image of divine judgment: the fire of Sodom, the fire of Gehenna, the "continuous fire" of the final judgment. To snatch someone from the fire was to rescue them from judgment, by persuasion, intervention, or prayer, before it was too late.

**Church discipline and restoration.** Early Christian communities practiced various forms of discipline toward members who fell into serious sin (Matt 18:15–17; 1 Cor 5; 2 Thess 3:14–15). The goal was always restoration: "do not count as an enemy, but admonish as a brother" (2 Thess 3:15, LSV). Jude's instructions belong to this pastoral tradition, though they do not describe formal procedures.

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Zechariah 3:1–5 (allusion).** The brand snatched from the fire and the filthy garments removed. This is the most important background for both images in v. 23, and the same chapter stands behind Michael's words in v. 9.

**Amos 4:11 (shared image).** "A brand delivered from a burning," in a passage that also mentions Sodom and Gomorrah.

**James 1:6; 5:19–20 (shared themes).** The doubter as a wave of the sea, and the saving of a sinner from death. James's closing verses resemble Jude's in spirit: both letters end by urging readers to restore those who wander.

**Galatians 6:1; 2 Timothy 2:24–26; Romans 14:1 (pastoral care).** Gentle restoration with awareness of one's own vulnerability.

**Matthew 18:12–14 (the lost sheep).** God's will that none of the little ones perish.

**Revelation 3:4; 2 Corinthians 7:1 (defiled garments; cleansing).** "a few names even in Sardis who did not defile their garments" (Rev 3:4, LSV); "may we cleanse ourselves from every defilement of flesh and spirit, perfecting sanctification in the fear of God" (2 Cor 7:1, LSV). Paul joins cleansing from

defilement of the flesh with “the fear of God,” as Jude joins mercy “in fear” with hatred of the garment “stained from the flesh.”

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Two groups or three?** See the deep dive.

**2. “Doubt” or “dispute”?** Most interpreters prefer “doubt” or “waver,” following New Testament usage and the logic of showing mercy. The alternative (“dispute,” with “refute” or “convict”) has some manuscript support and matches Jude’s use of the verb in v. 9.

**3. Who is in the fire?** Probably people who have gone further than the doubters, adopting the intruders’ practices. Some interpreters think the intruders themselves might be included among those who could still be snatched from the fire. Jude’s harsh descriptions in vv. 4–19 do not encourage that reading, but his structure leaves the door open in a way that is worth noting.

**4. What does “in fear” mean?** Fear of God, caution about contamination, or both.

**5. How do vv. 22–23 relate to the rest of the letter?** Some readers find the shift from condemnation to mercy abrupt. It is better understood as the goal of the letter. Jude exposes the intruders in order to protect the community and rescue those at risk. The warnings serve the mercy.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

Verses 22–23 complete the exhortation that began in v. 20. The readers who keep themselves in God’s love (v. 21) now extend that love to others. The letter’s three great themes come together here:

- **Mercy:** wished for the readers (v. 2), awaited from Christ (v. 21), shown to others (vv. 22–23).
- **Fire and judgment:** the fire of Sodom (v. 7), the coming judgment (vv. 14–15), and the fire from which people must be snatched (v. 23).
- **Defilement:** the flesh defiled by the intruders (v. 8), the stains at the love feasts (v. 12), and the garment stained by the flesh (v. 23).

The passage also prepares for the doxology. The readers who rescue others from stumbling into the fire will themselves be kept “without stumbling” by the God who is able (v. 24).

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Mercy as the end of contending.** Jude's letter shows that contending for the faith does not end in triumph over opponents but in mercy toward the wavering and rescue of the endangered. Christians who are passionate about truth might ask whether their passion leads to the same place.

**Differentiated care.** Jude distinguishes among people in different situations. Pastoral care today might likewise distinguish between honest questioners, people in crisis, and people deeply entangled in harmful patterns, responding to each with appropriate compassion, urgency, and wisdom.

**Mercy without naïveté.** Showing mercy "in fear" and "hating even the coat" suggests that mercy does not mean ignoring danger. Those who help others out of destructive situations, whether addiction, abuse, or spiritual manipulation, often need to set boundaries and protect themselves. That is not a failure of mercy but part of it.

**The garment can be changed.** Zechariah's vision, behind Jude's words, ends with new clothes. Those who have been stained can be cleansed. Christians who show mercy do so in the hope that God will "turn aside the filthy garments" and clothe people afresh.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. Why do you think Jude ends his practical instructions with mercy rather than with further warnings? How does this change your reading of the whole letter?
2. Think of people you know who are "wavering" in faith. What would it look like to show them mercy, in practical terms?
3. Jude speaks of "snatching" some from the fire. Are there situations in which urgent intervention is more loving than patient waiting? How can one tell?
4. What does it mean to show mercy "in fear"? How can believers help others without being drawn into the same patterns?
5. The garment imagery comes from Zechariah 3, where filthy garments are removed and replaced. How does this picture of cleansing shape the way you think about people who have fallen into sin?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB;

inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).

- Greek: SBLGNT and apparatus (WH, Treg, NIV, RP, NA28 data); Text-Critical Greek NT notes (eBible.org); TR.
- LXX Zech 3:2 (Brenton's Greek Septuagint).
- Clement of Alexandria, *Adumbrationes* on Jude 22–23, ANF 2.
- Abbott-Smith, s.v. σπιλόω.
- Manuscript transcriptions: INTF New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (CC BY 4.0).
- Public-domain commentaries on vv. 22–23: Plumptre (*Cambridge Bible*); Plummer (*Ellicott's Commentary*); Mayor (*Expositor's Greek Testament*), who also notes that the garment image may draw on Isa 30:22, Lev 15:17, and Zech 3:4.

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Leviticus 13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן לֵאמֹר **2** אָדָם כִּי־יִהְיֶה בְעוֹר־בְּשָׂרוֹ שְׂאֵת אוֹ־סַפַּחַת אוֹ בַהֶרֶת
וְהָיָה בְעוֹר־בְּשָׂרוֹ לְנֶגַע צָרָעַת וְהוּבָא אֶל־אַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן אוֹ אֶל־אַחַד מִבָּנָיו הַכֹּהֲנִים **3** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן
אֶת־הַנֶּגַע בְּעוֹר־הַבָּשָׂר וְשֵׂעָר בַּנֶּגַע הָפַךְ לָבָן וּמַרְאֵה הַנֶּגַע עָמֹק מֵעוֹר בְּשָׂרוֹ נֶגַע צָרַעַת הוּא וְרָאָהוּ
הַכֹּהֵן וְטִמֵּא אֹתוֹ **4** וְאִם־בַּהֶרֶת לְבָנָה הִוא בְּעוֹר בְּשָׂרוֹ וְעָמֹק אֵין־מַרְאֶהָ מִן־הָעוֹר וּשְׂעָרָה לֹא־הָפַךְ
לָבָן וְהִסְגִּיר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַנֶּגַע שִׁבְעַת יָמִים **5** וְרָאָהוּ הַכֹּהֵן בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְהִנֵּה הַנֶּגַע עָמַד בְּעֵינָיו לֹא־
פָשָׂה הַנֶּגַע בָּעוֹר וְהִסְגִּירוֹ הַכֹּהֵן שִׁבְעַת יָמִים שֵׁנִית **6** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן אֹתוֹ בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שֵׁנִית וְהִנֵּה
כֵּהָה הַנֶּגַע וְלֹא־פָשָׂה הַנֶּגַע בָּעוֹר וְטִהֲרוֹ הַכֹּהֵן מִסְפַּחַת הִיא וְכִבֶּס בְּגָדָיו וְטָהֵר **7** וְאִם־פָּשֹׂה תִפְשֶׂה
הַמִּסְפַּחַת בָּעוֹר אַחֲרֵי הֵרָאֹתוֹ אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן לְטָהֳרָתוֹ וְנִרְאָה שֵׁנִית אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן **8** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה פָּשְׂתָה
הַמִּסְפַּחַת בָּעוֹר וְטִמְּאוֹ הַכֹּהֵן צָרַעַת הִוא **9** נֶגַע צָרַעַת כִּי תִהְיֶה בְּאָדָם וְהוּבָא אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן **10** וְרָאָה
הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה שְׂאֵת־לְבָנָה בָּעוֹר וְהִיא הָפְכָה שֵׂעָר לָבָן וּמִחְיַת בָּשָׂר חַי בַּשְּׂאֵת **11** צָרַעַת נוֹשֶׁנֶת הִוא
בְּעוֹר בְּשָׂרוֹ וְטִמְּאוֹ הַכֹּהֵן לֹא יַסְגִּרֶנּוּ כִּי טָמֵא הוּא **12** וְאִם־פָּרֹחַ תִּפְרַח הַצָּרַעַת בָּעוֹר וְכִסְתָה
הַצָּרַעַת אֵת כָּל־עוֹר הַנֶּגַע מֵרֹאשׁוֹ וְעַד־רַגְלָיו לְכֹל־מַרְאֵה עֵינֵי הַכֹּהֵן **13** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה כִסְתָה
הַצָּרַעַת אֶת־כָּל־בְּשָׂרוֹ וְטִהַר אֶת־הַנֶּגַע כֻּלּוֹ הָפַךְ לָבָן טָהוֹר הוּא **14** וּבְיוֹם הֵרָאוֹת בּוֹ בָּשָׂר חַי
יִטְמָא **15** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַבָּשָׂר הַחַי וְטִמְּאוֹ הַבָּשָׂר הַחַי טָמֵא הוּא צָרַעַת הוּא **16** אוֹ כִי יָשׁוּב

הַבָּשָׂר חַיִּי וְנֶחְפַּךְ לְלָבָן וּבָא אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן **17** וְרָאָהוּ הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה נֶהְפַּךְ הַנֶּגַע לְלָבָן וְטִהַר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־ הַנֶּגַע טָהוֹר הוּא **18** וּבָשָׂר כִּי־יִהְיֶה בוֹ־בְּעֹרוֹ שְׁחִין וְנִרְפָּא **19** וְהָיָה בִּמְקוֹם הַשְּׁחִין שְׂאֵת לְבָנָה אוֹ בַהֶרֶת לְבָנָה אֲדַמְדֶּמֶת וְנִרְאָה אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן **20** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה מַרְאֶהָ שָׁפָל מִן־הָעוֹר וּשְׂעָרָהּ הָפַךְ לָבָן וְטִמְּאוֹ הַכֹּהֵן נֶגַע־צָרַעַת הוּא בַּשְּׁחִין פָּרָחָה **21** וְאִם יִרְאֶנָּה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה אֵין־בָּהּ שֵׂעָר לָבָן וּשְׁפָלָה אֵינֶנָּה מִן־הָעוֹר וְהִיא כֵּהָה וְהִסְגִּירוֹ הַכֹּהֵן שִׁבְעַת יָמִים **22** וְאִם־פָּשֹׂה תִּפְשֶׂה בָּעוֹר וְטִמֵּא הַכֹּהֵן אֹתוֹ נֶגַע הוּא **23** וְאִם־תַּחְתֶּיהָ תַּעֲמֹד הַבַּהֶרֶת לֹא פָשְׂתָה צָרֶבֶת הַשְּׁחִין הוּא וְטִהֲרוֹ הַכֹּהֵן **24** אוֹ בָשָׂר כִּי־יִהְיֶה בְעֹרוֹ מִכְוַת־אֵשׁ וְהָיְתָה מִחְיַת הַמִּכְוָה בַּהֶרֶת לְבָנָה אֲדַמְדֶּמֶת אוֹ לְבָנָה **25** וְרָאָה אֹתָהּ הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה נֶהְפַּךְ שֵׂעָר לָבָן בַּבַּהֶרֶת וּמַרְאֶהָ עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר צָרַעַת הִוא בַּמִּכְוָה פָּרָחָה וְטִמֵּא אֹתוֹ הַכֹּהֵן נֶגַע צָרַעַת הִוא **26** וְאִם יִרְאֶנָּה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה אֵין־בַּבַּהֶרֶת שֵׂעָר לָבָן וּשְׁפָלָה אֵינֶנָּה מִן־ הָעוֹר וְהִוא כֵּהָה וְהִסְגִּירוֹ הַכֹּהֵן שִׁבְעַת יָמִים **27** וְרָאָהוּ הַכֹּהֵן בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי אִם־פָּשֹׂה תִּפְשֶׂה בָּעוֹר וְטִמֵּא הַכֹּהֵן אֹתוֹ נֶגַע צָרַעַת הוּא **28** וְאִם־תַּחְתֶּיהָ תַּעֲמֹד הַבַּהֶרֶת לֹא־פָשְׂתָה בָּעוֹר וְהִוא כֵּהָה שְׂאֵת הַמִּכְוָה הִוא וְטִהֲרוֹ הַכֹּהֵן כִּי־צָרֶבֶת הַמִּכְוָה הִוא **29** וְאִישׁ אוֹ אִשָּׁה כִּי־יִהְיֶה בוֹ נֶגַע בְּרֹאשׁ אוֹ בְזָקָן **30** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַנֶּגַע וְהִנֵּה מַרְאֵהוּ עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר וּבוֹ שֵׂעָר צָהֹב דָּק וְטִמֵּא אֹתוֹ הַכֹּהֵן נֶתֶק הוּא צָרַעַת הָרֹאשׁ אוֹ הַזָּקָן הוּא **31** וְכִי־יִרְאֶה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־נֶגַע הַנֶּתֶק וְהִנֵּה אֵין־מַרְאֵהוּ עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר וְשֵׂעָר שָׁחֹר אֵין בּוֹ וְהִסְגִּיר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־נֶגַע הַנֶּתֶק שִׁבְעַת יָמִים **32** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַנֶּגַע בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְהִנֵּה לֹא־פָשָׂה הַנֶּתֶק וְלֹא־הָיָה בּוֹ שֵׂעָר צָהֹב וּמַרְאֵה הַנֶּתֶק אֵין עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר **33** וְהִתְגַּלָּח וְאֶת־ הַנֶּתֶק לֹא יְגַלֵּחַ וְהִסְגִּיר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַנֶּתֶק שִׁבְעַת יָמִים שֵׁנִית **34** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַנֶּתֶק בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְהִנֵּה לֹא־פָשָׂה הַנֶּתֶק בָּעוֹר וּמַרְאֵהוּ אֵינֶנּוּ עָמֹק מִן־הָעוֹר וְטִהַר אֹתוֹ הַכֹּהֵן וְכִבֶּס בְּגָדָיו וְטָהֵר **35** וְאִם־פָּשֹׂה תִּפְשֶׂה הַנֶּתֶק בָּעוֹר אַחֲרֵי טָהֳרָתוֹ **36** וְרָאָהוּ הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה פָּשָׂה הַנֶּתֶק בָּעוֹר לֹא־יְבַקֵּר הַכֹּהֵן לַשֵּׂעָר הַצָּהֹב טָמֵא הוּא **37** וְאִם־בְּעֵינָיו עָמַד הַנֶּתֶק וְשֵׂעָר שָׁחֹר צָמַח־בּוֹ נִרְפָּא הַנֶּתֶק טָהוֹר הוּא וְטִהֲרוֹ הַכֹּהֵן **38** וְאִישׁ אוֹ־אִשָּׁה כִּי־יִהְיֶה בְעוֹר־בְּשָׂרָם בָּהֶרֶת בָּהֶרֶת לְבָנֹת **39** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה בְעוֹר־בְּשָׂרָם בָּהֶרֶת כֵּהוֹת לְבָנֹת בֹּהַק הוּא פָּרַח בָּעוֹר טָהוֹר הוּא **40** וְאִישׁ כִּי יִמָּרֵט רֹאשׁוֹ קֵרֵחַ הוּא טָהוֹר הוּא **41** וְאִם מִפְּאַת פָּנָיו יִמָּרֵט רֹאשׁוֹ גִּבֵּחַ הוּא טָהוֹר הוּא **42** וְכִי־יִהְיֶה בַקָּרַחַת אוֹ בַגַּבַּחַת נֶגַע לָבָן אֲדַמְדֶּם צָרַעַת פֹּרַחַת הוּא בְּקָרַחְתּוֹ אוֹ בְגַבַּחְתּוֹ **43** וְרָאָה אֹתוֹ הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה שְׂאֵת־הַנֶּגַע לְבָנָה אֲדַמְדֶּמֶת בְּקָרַחְתּוֹ אוֹ בְגַבַּחְתּוֹ כְּמַרְאֵה צָרַעַת עוֹר בָּשָׂר **44** אִישׁ־צָרוּעַ הוּא טָמֵא הוּא טַמֵּא יְטַמְּאֶנּוּ הַכֹּהֵן בְּרֹאשׁוֹ נִגְעוֹ **45** וְהַצָּרוּעַ אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ הַנֶּגַע בְּגָדָיו יִהְיוּ פְרֻמִים וְרֹאשׁוֹ יִהְיֶה פָרוּעַ וְעַל־ שָׂפָם יַעְטֶה וְטָמֵא טָמֵא יִקְרָא **46** כָּל־יְמֵי אֲשֶׁר הַנֶּגַע בּוֹ יִטְמָא טָמֵא הוּא בָּדָד יֵשֵׁב מִחוּץ לַמַּחֲנֶה מוֹשָׁבוֹ **47** וְהַבֶּגֶד כִּי־יִהְיֶה בוֹ נֶגַע צָרַעַת בְּבֶגֶד צֶמֶר אוֹ בְּבֶגֶד פִּשְׁתִּים **48** אוֹ בְשְׁתִי אוֹ בְעֵרֶב לַפִּשְׁתִּים וְלַצָּמֶר אוֹ בְעוֹר אוֹ בְכָל־מְלֶאכֶת עוֹר **49** וְהָיָה הַנֶּגַע יְרַקְרַק אוֹ אֲדַמְדַּם בַּבֶּגֶד אוֹ בָעוֹר אוֹ־בַשְּׁתִי אוֹ־בָעֵרֶב אוֹ בְכָל־כְּלִי־עוֹר נֶגַע צָרַעַת הוּא וְהָרְאָה אֶת־הַכֹּהֵן **50** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַנֶּגַע וְהִסְגִּיר אֶת־הַנֶּגַע שִׁבְעַת יָמִים **51** וְרָאָה אֶת־הַנֶּגַע בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי כִּי־פָשָׂה הַנֶּגַע בַּבֶּגֶד אוֹ־בַשְּׁתִי אוֹ־ בָעֵרֶב אוֹ בָעוֹר לְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־יֵעָשֶׂה הָעוֹר לִמְלָאכָה צָרַעַת מַמְאֶרֶת הַנֶּגַע טָמֵא הוּא **52** וְשָׂרַף אֶת־ הַבֶּגֶד אוֹ אֶת־הַשְּׁתִי אוֹ אֶת־הָעֵרֶב בַּצֶּמֶר אוֹ בַפִּשְׁתִּים אוֹ אֶת־כָּל־כְּלִי הָעוֹר אֲשֶׁר־יִהְיֶה בוֹ הַנֶּגַע כִּי־ צָרַעַת מַמְאֶרֶת הַנֶּגַע טָמֵא תִּשָּׂרֵף **53** וְאִם יִרְאֶה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה לֹא־פָשָׂה הַנֶּגַע בַּבֶּגֶד אוֹ בַשְּׁתִי אוֹ בָעֵרֶב אוֹ בְכָל־כְּלִי־עוֹר **54** וְצִוָּה הַכֹּהֵן וְכִבְּסוּ אֵת אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ הַנֶּגַע וְהִסְגִּירוֹ שִׁבְעַת־יָמִים שֵׁנִית **55** וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן אַחֲרֵי הֻכַּבֵּס אֶת־הַנֶּגַע וְהִנֵּה לֹא־הָפַךְ הַנֶּגַע אֶת־עֵינוֹ וְהַנֶּגַע לֹא־פָשָׂה טָמֵא הוּא בָּאֵשׁ תִּשְׂרְפֶנּוּ פְּחֶתֶת הִוא בְּקָרַחְתּוֹ אוֹ בְגַבַּחְתּוֹ **56** וְאִם רָאָה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה כֵּהָה הַנֶּגַע אַחֲרֵי הֻכַּבֵּס אֹתוֹ וְקָרַע אֹתוֹ מִן־הַבֶּגֶד אוֹ מִן־הָעוֹר אוֹ מִן־הַשְּׁתִי אוֹ מִן־הָעֵרֶב **57** וְאִם־תֵּרָאֶה עוֹד בַּבֶּגֶד אוֹ־בַשְּׁתִי אוֹ־בָעֵרֶב אוֹ בְכָל־כְּלִי־עוֹר פֹּרַחַת הִוא בָּאֵשׁ תִּשְׂרְפֶנּוּ אֵת אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ הַנֶּגַע **58** וְהַבֶּגֶד אוֹ־הַשְּׁתִי אוֹ־הָעֵרֶב אוֹ־כָל־

כְּלִי הָעוֹר אֲשֶׁר תְּכַבֶּס וְסָר מֵהֶם הַנֶּגַע וְכֻבַּס שֵׁנִית וְטָהֵר **59** זֹאת תּוֹרַת נֶגַע־צָרַעַת בֶּגֶד הַצֶּמֶר אוֹ הַפִּשְׁתִּים אוֹ הַשְּׁתִי אוֹ הָעֵרֶב אוֹ כָּל־כְּלִי־עוֹר לְטַהֲרוֹ אוֹ לְטַמְּאוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, **2** “When someone has a swelling or rash or bright spot on his skin that could become an infectious skin disease, he must be brought to Aaron the priest or to one of his sons who is a priest. **3** The priest is to examine the infection on his skin, and if the hair in the infection has turned white and the sore appears to be deeper than the skin, it is a skin disease. After the priest examines him, he must pronounce him unclean. **4** If, however, the spot on his skin is white and does not appear to be deeper than the skin, and the hair in it has not turned white, the priest shall isolate the infected person for seven days. **5** On the seventh day the priest is to reexamine him, and if he sees that the infection is unchanged and has not spread on the skin, the priest must isolate him for another seven days. **6** The priest will examine him again on the seventh day, and if the sore has faded and has not spread on the skin, the priest shall pronounce him clean; it is a rash. The person must wash his clothes and be clean. **7** But if the rash spreads further on his skin after he has shown himself to the priest for his cleansing, he must present himself again to the priest. **8** The priest will reexamine him, and if the rash has spread on the skin, the priest must pronounce him unclean; he has a skin disease. **9** When anyone develops a skin disease, he must be brought to the priest. **10** The priest will examine him, and if there is a white swelling on the skin that has turned the hair white, and there is raw flesh in the swelling, **11** it is a chronic skin disease and the priest must pronounce him unclean. He need not isolate him, for he is unclean. **12** But if the skin disease breaks out all over his skin so that it covers all the skin of the infected person from head to foot, as far as the priest can see, **13** the priest shall examine him, and if the disease has covered his entire body, he is to pronounce the infected person clean. Since it has all turned white, he is clean. **14** But whenever raw flesh appears on someone, he will be unclean. **15** When the priest sees the raw flesh, he must pronounce him unclean. The raw flesh is unclean; it is a skin disease. **16** But if the raw flesh changes and turns white, he must go to the priest. **17** The priest will reexamine him, and if the infection has turned white, the priest is to pronounce the infected person clean; then he is clean. **18** When a boil appears on someone’s skin and it heals, **19** and a white swelling or a reddish-white spot develops where the boil was, he must present himself to the priest. **20** The priest shall examine it, and if it appears to be beneath the skin and the hair in it has turned white, the priest shall pronounce him unclean; it is a diseased infection that has broken out in the boil. **21** But when the priest examines it, if there is no white hair in it, and it is not beneath the skin and has faded, the priest shall isolate him for seven days. **22** If it spreads any further on the skin, the priest must pronounce him unclean; it is an infection. **23** But if the spot remains unchanged and does not spread, it is only

the scar from the boil, and the priest shall pronounce him clean. **24** When there is a burn on someone's skin and the raw area of the burn becomes reddish-white or white, **25** the priest must examine it. If the hair in the spot has turned white and the spot appears to be deeper than the skin, it is a disease that has broken out in the burn. The priest must pronounce him unclean; it is a diseased infection. **26** But if the priest examines it and there is no white hair in the spot, and it is not beneath the skin but has faded, the priest shall isolate him for seven days. **27** On the seventh day the priest is to reexamine him, and if it has spread further on the skin, the priest must pronounce him unclean; it is a diseased infection. **28** But if the spot is unchanged and has not spread on the skin but has faded, it is a swelling from the burn, and the priest is to pronounce him clean; for it is only the scar from the burn. **29** If a man or woman has an infection on the head or chin, **30** the priest shall examine the infection, and if it appears to be deeper than the skin and the hair in it is yellow and thin, the priest must pronounce him unclean; it is a scaly outbreak, an infectious disease of the head or chin. **31** But if the priest examines the scaly infection and it does not appear to be deeper than the skin, and there is no black hair in it, the priest shall isolate the infected person for seven days. **32** On the seventh day the priest is to reexamine the infection, and if the scaly outbreak has not spread and there is no yellow hair in it, and it does not appear to be deeper than the skin, **33** then the person must shave himself except for the scaly area. Then the priest shall isolate him for another seven days. **34** On the seventh day the priest shall examine the scaly outbreak, and if it has not spread on the skin and does not appear to be deeper than the skin, the priest is to pronounce him clean. He must wash his clothes, and he will be clean. **35** If, however, the scaly outbreak spreads further on the skin after his cleansing, **36** the priest is to examine him, and if the scaly outbreak has spread on the skin, the priest need not look for yellow hair; the person is unclean. **37** If, however, in his sight the scaly outbreak is unchanged and black hair has grown in it, then it has healed. He is clean, and the priest is to pronounce him clean. **38** When a man or a woman has white spots on the skin, **39** the priest shall examine them, and if the spots are dull white, it is a harmless rash that has broken out on the skin; the person is clean. **40** Now if a man loses his hair and is bald, he is still clean. **41** Or if his hairline recedes and he is bald on his forehead, he is still clean. **42** But if there is a reddish-white sore on the bald head or forehead, it is an infectious disease breaking out on it. **43** The priest is to examine him, and if the swelling of the infection on his bald head or forehead is reddish-white like a skin disease, **44** the man is diseased; he is unclean. The priest must pronounce him unclean because of the infection on his head. **45** A diseased person must wear torn clothes and let his hair hang loose, and he must cover his mouth and cry out, 'Unclean, unclean!' **46** As long as he has the infection, he remains unclean. He must live alone in a place outside the camp. **47** If any fabric is contaminated with mildew —any wool or linen garment, **48** any weave or knit of linen or wool, or any article of leather— **49** and if the mark in the fabric, leather,

weave, knit, or leather article is green or red, then it is contaminated with mildew and must be shown to the priest. **50** And the priest is to examine the mildew and isolate the contaminated fabric for seven days. **51** On the seventh day the priest shall reexamine it, and if the mildew has spread in the fabric, weave, knit, or leather, then regardless of how it is used, it is a harmful mildew; the article is unclean. **52** He is to burn the fabric, weave, or knit, whether the contaminated item is wool or linen or leather. Since the mildew is harmful, the article must be burned up. **53** But when the priest reexamines it, if the mildew has not spread in the fabric, weave, knit, or leather article, **54** the priest is to order the contaminated article to be washed and isolated for another seven days. **55** After it has been washed, the priest is to reexamine it, and if the mildewed article has not changed in appearance, it is unclean. Even though the mildew has not spread, you must burn it, whether the rot is on the front or back. **56** If the priest examines it and the mildew has faded after it has been washed, he must cut the contaminated section out of the fabric, leather, weave, or knit. **57** But if it reappears in the fabric, weave, or knit, or on any leather article, it is spreading. You must burn the contaminated article. **58** If the mildew disappears from the fabric, weave, or knit, or any leather article after washing, then it is to be washed again, and it will be clean. **59** This is the law concerning a mildew contamination in wool or linen fabric, weave, or knit, or any leather article, for pronouncing it clean or unclean.”

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, **2** “When a man shall have a swelling in his body’s skin, or a scab, or a bright spot, and it becomes in the skin of his body the plague of leprosy, then he shall be brought to Aaron the priest or to one of his sons, the priests. **3** The priest shall examine the plague in the skin of the body. If the hair in the plague has turned white, and the appearance of the plague is deeper than the body’s skin, it is the plague of leprosy; so the priest shall examine him and pronounce him unclean. **4** If the bright spot is white in the skin of his body, and its appearance isn’t deeper than the skin, and its hair hasn’t turned white, then the priest shall isolate the infected person for seven days. **5** The priest shall examine him on the seventh day. Behold, if in his eyes the plague is arrested and the plague hasn’t spread in the skin, then the priest shall isolate him for seven more days. **6** The priest shall examine him again on the seventh day. Behold, if the plague has faded and the plague hasn’t spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him clean. It is a scab. He shall wash his clothes, and be clean. **7** But if the scab spreads on the skin after he has shown himself to the priest for his cleansing, he shall show himself to the priest again. **8** The priest shall examine him; and behold, if the scab has spread on the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is leprosy. **9** “When the plague of leprosy is in a man, then he shall be brought to the priest; **10** and the priest shall examine him. Behold, if there is a white swelling in the skin, and it has turned the hair white, and there is

raw flesh in the swelling, **11** it is a chronic leprosy in the skin of his body, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean. He shall not isolate him, for he is already unclean. **12** “If the leprosy breaks out all over the skin, and the leprosy covers all the skin of the infected person from his head even to his feet, as far as it appears to the priest, **13** then the priest shall examine him. Behold, if the leprosy has covered all his flesh, he shall pronounce him clean of the plague. It has all turned white: he is clean. **14** But whenever raw flesh appears in him, he shall be unclean. **15** The priest shall examine the raw flesh, and pronounce him unclean: the raw flesh is unclean. It is leprosy. **16** Or if the raw flesh turns again, and is changed to white, then he shall come to the priest. **17** The priest shall examine him. Behold, if the plague has turned white, then the priest shall pronounce him clean of the plague. He is clean. **18** “When the body has a boil on its skin, and it has healed, **19** and in the place of the boil there is a white swelling, or a bright spot, reddish-white, then it shall be shown to the priest. **20** The priest shall examine it. Behold, if its appearance is deeper than the skin, and its hair has turned white, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy. It has broken out in the boil. **21** But if the priest examines it, and behold, there are no white hairs in it, and it isn’t deeper than the skin, but is dim, then the priest shall isolate him seven days. **22** If it spreads in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is a plague. **23** But if the bright spot stays in its place, and hasn’t spread, it is the scar from the boil; and the priest shall pronounce him clean. **24** “Or when the body has a burn from fire on its skin, and the raw flesh of the burn becomes a bright spot, reddish-white, or white, **25** then the priest shall examine it; and behold, if the hair in the bright spot has turned white, and its appearance is deeper than the skin, it is leprosy. It has broken out in the burning, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy. **26** But if the priest examines it, and behold, there is no white hair in the bright spot, and it isn’t deeper than the skin, but has faded, then the priest shall isolate him seven days. **27** The priest shall examine him on the seventh day. If it has spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy. **28** If the bright spot stays in its place, and hasn’t spread in the skin, but is faded, it is the swelling from the burn, and the priest shall pronounce him clean, for it is the scar from the burn. **29** “When a man or woman has a plague on the head or on the beard, **30** then the priest shall examine the plague; and behold, if its appearance is deeper than the skin, and the hair in it is yellow and thin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is an itch. It is leprosy of the head or of the beard. **31** If the priest examines the plague of itching, and behold, its appearance isn’t deeper than the skin, and there is no black hair in it, then the priest shall isolate the person infected with itching seven days. **32** On the seventh day the priest shall examine the plague; and behold, if the itch hasn’t spread, and there is no yellow hair in it, and the appearance of the itch isn’t deeper than the skin, **33** then he shall be shaved, but he shall not shave the itch. Then the priest shall isolate the one who has the itch seven more days. **34** On the

seventh day, the priest shall examine the itch; and behold, if the itch hasn't spread in the skin, and its appearance isn't deeper than the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him clean. He shall wash his clothes and be clean. **35** But if the itch spreads in the skin after his cleansing, **36** then the priest shall examine him; and behold, if the itch has spread in the skin, the priest shall not look for the yellow hair; he is unclean. **37** But if in his eyes the itch is arrested and black hair has grown in it, then the itch is healed. He is clean. The priest shall pronounce him clean. **38** "When a man or a woman has bright spots in the skin of the body, even white bright spots, **39** then the priest shall examine them. Behold, if the bright spots on the skin of their body are a dull white, it is a harmless rash. It has broken out in the skin. He is clean. **40** "If a man's hair has fallen from his head, he is bald. He is clean. **41** If his hair has fallen off from the front part of his head, his forehead is bald. He is clean. **42** But if a reddish-white plague is in the bald head or the bald forehead, it is leprosy breaking out in his bald head or his bald forehead. **43** Then the priest shall examine him. Behold, if the swelling of the plague is reddish-white in his bald head, or in his bald forehead, like the appearance of leprosy in the skin of the body, **44** he is a leprous man. He is unclean. The priest shall surely pronounce him unclean. His plague is on his head. **45** "The leper in whom the plague is shall wear torn clothes, and the hair of his head shall hang loose. He shall cover his upper lip, and shall cry, 'Unclean! Unclean!' **46** All the days in which the plague is in him he shall be unclean. He is unclean. He shall dwell alone. His dwelling shall be outside of the camp. **47** "The garment also that the plague of leprosy is in, whether it is a woolen garment, or a linen garment; **48** whether it is in warp or woof; of linen or of wool; whether in leather, or in anything made of leather; **49** if the plague is greenish or reddish in the garment, or in the leather, or in the warp, or in the woof, or in anything made of leather; it is the plague of leprosy, and shall be shown to the priest. **50** The priest shall examine the plague, and isolate the plague seven days. **51** He shall examine the plague on the seventh day. If the plague has spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in the skin, whatever use the skin is used for, the plague is a destructive mildew. It is unclean. **52** He shall burn the garment, whether the warp or the woof, in wool or in linen, or anything of leather, in which the plague is, for it is a destructive mildew. It shall be burned in the fire. **53** "If the priest examines it, and behold, the plague hasn't spread in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in anything of skin; **54** then the priest shall command that they wash the thing that the plague is in, and he shall isolate it seven more days. **55** Then the priest shall examine it, after the plague is washed; and behold, if the plague hasn't changed its color, and the plague hasn't spread, it is unclean; you shall burn it in the fire. It is a mildewed spot, whether the bareness is inside or outside. **56** If the priest looks, and behold, the plague has faded after it is washed, then he shall tear it out of the garment, or out of the skin, or out of the warp, or out of the woof; **57** and if it appears again in the garment, either in the warp, or in the woof, or in anything of skin, it is spreading. You shall

burn what the plague is in with fire. **58** The garment, either the warp, or the woof, or whatever thing of skin it is, which you shall wash, if the plague has departed from them, then it shall be washed the second time, and it will be clean.” **59** This is the law of the plague of mildew in a garment of wool or linen, either in the warp, or the woof, or in anything of skin, to pronounce it clean, or to pronounce it unclean.

## Leviticus 14

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה לֵּאמֹר **2** זֹאת תִּהְיֶה תּוֹרַת הַמְצֹרָע בְּיוֹם טָהֳרָתוֹ וְהוּבָא אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן **3** וְיָצָא
הַכֹּהֵן אֶל־מִחוּץ לַמַּחֲנֶה וְרָאָה הַכֹּהֵן וְהִנֵּה נִרְפָּא נֶגַע־הַצָּרַעַת מִן־הַצָּרוּעַ **4** וְצִוָּה הַכֹּהֵן וְלָקַח
לַמִּטַּהֵר שְׁתֵּי־צִפֳּרִים חַיּוֹת טְהֹרוֹת וְעֵץ אֶרֶז וּשְׁנִי תוֹלַעַת וְאֵזֹב **5** וְצִוָּה הַכֹּהֵן וְשָׁחַט אֶת־הַצִּפּוֹר
הָאֶחָת אֶל־כְּלִי־חֶרֶשׂ עַל־מַיִם חַיִּים **6** אֶת־הַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה יִקַּח אֹתָהּ וְאֶת־עֵץ הָאֶרֶז וְאֶת־שְׁנִי הַתּוֹלַעַת
וְאֶת־הָאֵזֹב וְטָבַל אוֹתָם וְאֶת הַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה בְּדַם הַצִּפֹּר הַשְּׁחֻטָה עַל הַמַּיִם הַחַיִּים **7** וְהִזָּה עַל הַמִּטַּהֵר
מִן־הַצָּרַעַת שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים וְטִהֲרוֹ וְשִׁלַּח אֶת־הַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה עַל־פְּנֵי הַשָּׂדֶה **8** וְכִבֶּס הַמִּטַּהֵר אֶת־בְּגָדָיו
וְגִלַּח אֶת־כָּל־שְׂעָרוֹ וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָהֵר וְאַחַר יָבוֹא אֶל־הַמַּחֲנֶה וְיָשַׁב מִחוּץ לְאָהֳלוֹ שִׁבְעַת יָמִים **9**
וְהָיָה בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי יְגַלַּח אֶת־כָּל־שְׂעָרוֹ אֶת־רֹאשׁוֹ וְאֶת־זְקָנוֹ וְאֵת גַּבֹּת עֵינָיו וְאֶת־כָּל־שְׂעָרוֹ יְגַלֵּחַ
וְכִבֶּס אֶת־בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ אֶת־בְּשָׂרוֹ בַּמַּיִם וְטָהֵר **10** וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי יִקַּח שְׁנֵי־כְבָשִׂים תְּמִימִם וְכַבְשָׂה
אַחַת בַּת־שְׁנָתָהּ תְּמִימָה וּשְׁלֹשָׁה עֶשְׂרֹנִים סֹלֶת מִנְחָה בְּלוּלָה בַשָּׁמֶן וְלוֹג אֶחָד שָׁמֶן **11** וְהֶעֱמִיד הַכֹּהֵן
הַמְטַהֵר אֵת הָאִישׁ הַמִּטַּהֵר וְאֹתָם לִפְנֵי יְהוָה פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד **12** וְלָקַח הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַכֶּבֶשׂ הָאֶחָד
וְהִקְרִיב אֹתוֹ לְאָשָׁם וְאֶת־לוֹג הַשָּׁמֶן וְהֵנִיף אֹתָם תְּנוּפָה לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **13** וְשָׁחַט אֶת־הַכֶּבֶשׂ בִּמְקוֹם אֲשֶׁר
יִשְׁחַט אֶת־הַחַטָּאת וְאֶת־הָעֹלָה בִּמְקוֹם הַקֹּדֶשׁ כִּי כַּחַטָּאת הָאָשָׁם הוּא לַכֹּהֵן קֹדֶשׁ קָדָשִׁים הוּא **14**
וְלָקַח הַכֹּהֵן מִדַּם הָאָשָׁם וְנָתַן הַכֹּהֵן עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן הַמִּטַּהֵר הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן
רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית **15** וְלָקַח הַכֹּהֵן מִלּוֹג הַשָּׁמֶן וְיָצַק עַל־כַּף הַכֹּהֵן הַשְּׂמָאלִית **16** וְטָבַל הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־אֶצְבָּעוֹ
הַיְמָנִית מִן־הַשָּׁמֶן אֲשֶׁר עַל־כַּפּוֹ הַשְּׂמָאלִית וְהִזָּה מִן־הַשֶּׁמֶן בְּאֶצְבָּעוֹ שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **17**
וּמִיֶּתֶר הַשֶּׁמֶן אֲשֶׁר עַל־כַּפּוֹ יִתֵּן הַכֹּהֵן עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן הַמִּטַּהֵר הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן
רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית עַל דַּם הָאָשָׁם **18** וְהַנּוֹתָר בַּשֶּׁמֶן אֲשֶׁר עַל־כַּף הַכֹּהֵן יִתֵּן עַל־רֹאשׁ הַמִּטַּהֵר וְכִפֶּר עָלָיו
הַכֹּהֵן לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **19** וְעָשָׂה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַחַטָּאת וְכִפֶּר עַל־הַמִּטַּהֵר מִטֻּמְאָתוֹ וְאַחַר יִשְׁחַט אֶת־הָעֹלָה
**20** וְהֶעֱלָה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הָעֹלָה וְאֶת־הַמִּנְחָה הַמִּזְבֵּחָה וְכִפֶּר עָלָיו הַכֹּהֵן וְטָהֵר **21** וְאִם־דַּל הוּא וְאֵין
יָדוֹ מַשָּׂגֶת וְלָקַח כֶּבֶשׂ אֶחָד אָשָׁם לִתְנוּפָה לְכַפֵּר עָלָיו וְעִשָּׂרוֹן סֹלֶת אֶחָד בָּלוּל בַּשָּׁמֶן לְמִנְחָה וְלוֹג
שָׁמֶן **22** וּשְׁתֵּי תֹרִים אוֹ שְׁנֵי בְּנֵי יוֹנָה אֲשֶׁר תַּשִּׂיג יָדוֹ וְהָיָה אֶחָד חַטָּאת וְהָאֶחָד עֹלָה **23** וְהֵבִיא אֹתָם
בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי לְטָהֳרָתוֹ אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל־מוֹעֵד לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **24** וְלָקַח הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־כֶּבֶשׂ הָאָשָׁם
וְאֶת־לוֹג הַשָּׁמֶן וְהֵנִיף אֹתָם הַכֹּהֵן תְּנוּפָה לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **25** וְשָׁחַט אֶת־כֶּבֶשׂ הָאָשָׁם וְלָקַח הַכֹּהֵן מִדַּם
הָאָשָׁם וְנָתַן עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן־הַמִּטַּהֵר הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית **26** וּמִן־
הַשֶּׁמֶן יִצֹק הַכֹּהֵן עַל־כַּף הַכֹּהֵן הַשְּׂמָאלִית **27** וְהִזָּה הַכֹּהֵן בְּאֶצְבָּעוֹ הַיְמָנִית מִן־הַשֶּׁמֶן אֲשֶׁר עַל־כַּפּוֹ
הַשְּׂמָאלִית שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **28** וְנָתַן הַכֹּהֵן מִן־הַשֶּׁמֶן אֲשֶׁר עַל־כַּפּוֹ עַל־תְּנוּךְ אֹזֶן הַמִּטַּהֵר
הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן יָדוֹ הַיְמָנִית וְעַל־בֹּהֶן רַגְלוֹ הַיְמָנִית עַל־מְקוֹם דַּם הָאָשָׁם **29** וְהַנּוֹתָר מִן־הַשֶּׁמֶן
אֲשֶׁר עַל־כַּף הַכֹּהֵן יִתֵּן עַל־רֹאשׁ הַמִּטַּהֵר לְכַפֵּר עָלָיו לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **30** וְעָשָׂה אֶת־הָאֶחָד מִן־הַתֹּרִים אוֹ

מִן־בְּנֵי הַיּוֹנָה מֵאֲשֶׁר תַּשִּׂיג יָדוֹ **31** אֵת אֲשֶׁר־תַּשִּׂיג יָדוֹ אֶת־הָאֶחָד חַטָּאת וְאֶת־הָאֶחָד עֹלָה עַל־
הַמִּנְחָה וְכִפֶּר הַכֹּהֵן עַל הַמִּטַהֵר לִפְנֵי יְהוָה **32** זֹאת תּוֹרַת אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ נֶגַע צָרָעַת אֲשֶׁר לֹא־תַשִּׂיג יָדוֹ
בְּטָהֳרָתוֹ **33** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן לֵאמֹר **34** כִּי תָבֹאוּ אֶל־אֶרֶץ כְּנַעַן אֲשֶׁר אֲנִי נֹתֵן לָכֶם
לַאֲחֻזָּה וְנָתַתִּי נֶגַע צָרַעַת בְּבֵית אֶרֶץ אֲחֻזַּתְכֶם **35** וּבָא אֲשֶׁר־לוֹ הַבַּיִת וְהִגִּיד לַכֹּהֵן לֵאמֹר כְּנֶגַע
נִרְאָה לִי בַּבָּיִת **36** וְצִוָּה הַכֹּהֵן וּפִנּוּ אֶת־הַבַּיִת בְּטֶרֶם יָבֹא הַכֹּהֵן לִרְאוֹת אֶת־הַנָּגַע וְלֹא יִטְמָא כָּל־
אֲשֶׁר בַּבַּיִת וְאַחַר כֵּן יָבֹא הַכֹּהֵן לִרְאוֹת אֶת־הַבָּיִת **37** וְרָאָה אֶת־הַנָּגַע וְהִנֵּה הַנֶּגַע בְּקִירֹת הַבַּיִת
שְׂקַעֲרוּרֹת יְרַקְרַקֹּת אוֹ אֲדַמְדְּמֹת וּמַרְאֵיהֶן שָׁפֵל מִן־הַקִּיר **38** וְיָצָא הַכֹּהֵן מִן־הַבַּיִת אֶל־פֶּתַח הַבָּיִת
וְהִסְגִּיר אֶת־הַבַּיִת שִׁבְעַת יָמִים **39** וְשָׁב הַכֹּהֵן בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְרָאָה וְהִנֵּה פָּשָׂה הַנֶּגַע בְּקִירֹת הַבָּיִת **40**
וְצִוָּה הַכֹּהֵן וְחִלְּצוּ אֶת־הָאֲבָנִים אֲשֶׁר בָּהֵן הַנֶּגַע וְהִשְׁלִיכוּ אֹתָהֶן אֶל־מְחוּץ לָעִיר אֶל־מָקוֹם טָמֵא **41**
וְאֶת־הַבַּיִת יַקְצַע מִבַּיִת סָבִיב וְשָׁפְכוּ אֶת־הֶעָפָר אֲשֶׁר הִקְצוּ אֶל־מְחוּץ לָעִיר אֶל־מָקוֹם טָמֵא **42**
וְלָקְחוּ אֲבָנִים אֲחֵרוֹת וְהֵבִיאוּ אֶל־תַּחַת הָאֲבָנִים וְעָפָר אַחֵר יִקַּח וְטָח אֶת־הַבָּיִת **43** וְאִם־יָשׁוּב הַנֶּגַע
וּפָרַח בַּבַּיִת אַחַר חִלַּץ אֶת־הָאֲבָנִים וְאַחֲרֵי הִקְצוֹת אֶת־הַבַּיִת וְאַחֲרֵי הָטוֹחַ **44** וּבָא הַכֹּהֵן וְרָאָה
וְהִנֵּה פָּשָׂה הַנֶּגַע בַּבַּיִת צָרַעַת מַמְאֶרֶת הִוא בַּבַּיִת טָמֵא הוּא **45** וְנָתַץ אֶת־הַבַּיִת אֶת־אֲבָנָיו וְאֶת־עֵצָיו
וְאֵת כָּל־עֲפַר הַבָּיִת וְהוֹצִיא אֶל־מְחוּץ לָעִיר אֶל־מָקוֹם טָמֵא **46** וְהַבָּא אֶל־הַבַּיִת כָּל־יְמֵי הִסְגִּיר
אֹתוֹ יִטְמָא עַד־הָעָרֶב **47** וְהַשֹּׁכֵב בַּבַּיִת יְכַבֵּס אֶת־בְּגָדָיו וְהָאֹכֵל בַּבַּיִת יְכַבֵּס אֶת־בְּגָדָיו **48** וְאִם־בֹּא
יָבֹא הַכֹּהֵן וְרָאָה וְהִנֵּה לֹא־פָשָׂה הַנֶּגַע בַּבַּיִת אַחֲרֵי הִטֹּחַ אֶת־הַבַּיִת וְטִהַר הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־הַבַּיִת כִּי נִרְפָּא
הַנָּגַע **49** וְלָקַח לְחַטֵּא אֶת־הַבַּיִת שְׁתֵּי צִפֳּרִים וְעֵץ אֶרֶז וּשְׁנִי תוֹלַעַת וְאֵזוֹב **50** וְשָׁחַט אֶת־הַצִּפֹּר
הָאֶחָת אֶל־כְּלִי־חֶרֶשׂ עַל־מַיִם חַיִּים **51** וְלָקַח אֶת־עֵץ־הָאֶרֶז וְאֶת־הָאֵזוֹב וְאֵת שְׁנִי הַתּוֹלַעַת וְאֵת
הַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה וְטָבַל אֹתָם בְּדַם הַצִּפֹּר הַשְּׁחוּטָה וּבַמַּיִם הַחַיִּים וְהִזָּה אֶל־הַבַּיִת שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים **52** וְחִטֵּא
אֶת־הַבַּיִת בְּדַם הַצִּפּוֹר וּבַמַּיִם הַחַיִּים וּבַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה וּבְעֵץ הָאֶרֶז וּבָאֵזוֹב וּבִשְׁנִי הַתּוֹלַעַת **53** וְשִׁלַּח
אֶת־הַצִּפֹּר הַחַיָּה אֶל־מְחוּץ לָעִיר אֶל־פְּנֵי הַשָּׂדֶה וְכִפֶּר עַל־הַבַּיִת וְטָהֵר **54** זֹאת הַתּוֹרָה לְכָל־נֶגַע
הַצָּרַעַת וְלַנָּתֶק **55** וּלְצָרַעַת הַבָּגֶד וְלַבָּיִת **56** וְלַשְּׂאֵת וְלַסַּפַּחַת וְלַבָּהָרֶת **57** לְהוֹרֹת בְּיוֹם הַטָּמֵא
וּבְיוֹם הַטָּהֹר זֹאת תּוֹרַת הַצָּרָעַת

*English (BSB)*

**1** Then the LORD said to Moses, **2** “This is the law for the one afflicted with a skin disease on the day of his cleansing, when he is brought to the priest. **3** The priest is to go outside the camp to examine him, and if the skin disease of the afflicted person has healed, **4** the priest shall order that two live clean birds, cedar wood, scarlet yarn, and hyssop be brought for the one to be cleansed. **5** Then the priest shall command that one of the birds be slaughtered over fresh water in a clay pot. **6** And he is to take the live bird together with the cedar wood, scarlet yarn, and hyssop, and dip them into the blood of the bird that was slaughtered over the fresh water. **7** Seven times he shall sprinkle the one to be cleansed of the skin disease. Then he shall pronounce him clean and release the live bird into the open field. **8** The one being cleansed must wash his clothes, shave off all his hair, and bathe with water; then he will be ceremonially clean. Afterward, he may enter the camp, but he must remain outside his tent for seven days. **9** On the seventh day he must shave off all his hair—his head, his beard, his eyebrows, and the rest of his hair. He must wash his clothes and bathe himself with water, and he will be

clean. **10** On the eighth day he is to bring two unblemished male lambs, an unblemished ewe lamb a year old, a grain offering of three-tenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with olive oil, and one log of olive oil. **11** The priest who performs the cleansing shall present the one to be cleansed, together with these offerings, before the LORD at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. **12** Then the priest is to take one of the male lambs and present it as a guilt offering, along with the log of olive oil; and he must wave them as a wave offering before the LORD. **13** Then he is to slaughter the lamb in the sanctuary area where the sin offering and burnt offering are slaughtered. Like the sin offering, the guilt offering belongs to the priest; it is most holy. **14** The priest is to take some of the blood from the guilt offering and put it on the right earlobe of the one to be cleansed, on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot. **15** Then the priest shall take some of the log of olive oil, pour it into his left palm, **16** dip his right forefinger into the oil in his left palm, and sprinkle some of the oil with his finger seven times before the LORD. **17** And the priest is to put some of the oil remaining in his palm on the right earlobe of the one to be cleansed, on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot, on top of the blood of the guilt offering. **18** The rest of the oil in his palm, the priest is to put on the head of the one to be cleansed, to make atonement for him before the LORD. **19** Then the priest is to sacrifice the sin offering and make atonement for the one to be cleansed from his uncleanness. After that, the priest shall slaughter the burnt offering **20** and offer it on the altar, with the grain offering, to make atonement for him, and he will be clean. **21** If, however, the person is poor and cannot afford these offerings, he is to take one male lamb as a guilt offering to be waved to make atonement for him, along with a tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with olive oil for a grain offering, a log of olive oil, **22** and two turtledoves or two young pigeons, whichever he can afford, one to be a sin offering and the other a burnt offering. **23** On the eighth day he is to bring them for his cleansing to the priest at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting before the LORD. **24** The priest shall take the lamb for the guilt offering, along with the log of olive oil, and wave them as a wave offering before the LORD. **25** And after he slaughters the lamb for the guilt offering, the priest is to take some of the blood of the guilt offering and put it on the right earlobe of the one to be cleansed, on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot. **26** Then the priest is to pour some of the oil into his left palm **27** and sprinkle with his right forefinger some of the oil in his left palm seven times before the LORD. **28** The priest shall also put some of the oil in his palm on the right earlobe of the one to be cleansed, on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot—on the same places as the blood of the guilt offering. **29** The rest of the oil in his palm, the priest is to put on the head of the one to be cleansed, to make atonement for him before the LORD. **30** Then he must sacrifice the turtledoves or young pigeons, whichever he can afford, **31** one as a sin offering and the other as a burnt offering, together with the grain offering. In this way the priest will make atonement before the LORD for the one to be cleansed. **32**

This is the law for someone who has a skin disease and cannot afford the cost of his cleansing.” **33** Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, **34** “When you enter the land of Canaan, which I am giving you as your possession, and I put a contamination of mildew into a house in that land, **35** the owner of the house shall come and tell the priest, ‘Something like mildew has appeared in my house.’ **36** The priest must order that the house be cleared before he enters it to examine the mildew, so that nothing in the house will become unclean. After this, the priest shall go in to inspect the house. **37** He is to examine the house, and if the mildew on the walls consists of green or red depressions that appear to be beneath the surface of the wall, **38** the priest shall go outside the doorway of the house and close it up for seven days. **39** On the seventh day the priest is to return and inspect the house. If the mildew has spread on the walls, **40** he must order that the contaminated stones be pulled out and thrown into an unclean place outside the city. **41** And he shall have the inside of the house scraped completely and the plaster that is scraped off dumped into an unclean place outside the city. **42** So different stones must be obtained to replace the contaminated ones, as well as additional mortar to replaster the house. **43** If the mildew reappears in the house after the stones have been torn out and the house has been scraped and replastered, **44** the priest must come and inspect it. If the mildew has spread in the house, it is a destructive mildew; the house is unclean. **45** It must be torn down with its stones, its timbers, and all its plaster, and taken outside the city to an unclean place. **46** Anyone who enters the house during any of the days that it is closed up will be unclean until evening. **47** And anyone who sleeps in the house or eats in it must wash his clothes. **48** If, however, the priest comes and inspects it, and the mildew has not spread after the house has been replastered, he shall pronounce the house clean, because the mildew is gone. **49** He is to take two birds, cedar wood, scarlet yarn, and hyssop to purify the house; **50** and he shall slaughter one of the birds over fresh water in a clay pot. **51** Then he shall take the cedar wood, the hyssop, the scarlet yarn, and the live bird, dip them in the blood of the slaughtered bird and the fresh water, and sprinkle the house seven times. **52** And he shall cleanse the house with the bird’s blood, the fresh water, the live bird, the cedar wood, the hyssop, and the scarlet yarn. **53** Finally, he is to release the live bird into the open fields outside the city. In this way he will make atonement for the house, and it will be clean. **54** This is the law for any infectious skin disease, for a scaly outbreak, **55** for mildew in clothing or in a house, **56** and for a swelling, rash, or spot, **57** to determine when something is clean or unclean. This is the law regarding skin diseases and mildew.”

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD spoke to Moses, saying, **2** “This shall be the law of the leper in the day of his cleansing: He shall be brought to the priest, **3** and the priest shall go out of the camp. The priest shall examine him. Behold, if the plague of

leprosy is healed in the leper, **4** then the priest shall command them to take for him who is to be cleansed two living clean birds, cedar wood, scarlet, and hyssop. **5** The priest shall command them to kill one of the birds in an earthen vessel over running water. **6** As for the living bird, he shall take it, the cedar wood, the scarlet, and the hyssop, and shall dip them and the living bird in the blood of the bird that was killed over the running water. **7** He shall sprinkle on him who is to be cleansed from the leprosy seven times, and shall pronounce him clean, and shall let the living bird go into the open field. **8** "He who is to be cleansed shall wash his clothes, and shave off all his hair, and bathe himself in water; and he shall be clean. After that he shall come into the camp, but shall dwell outside his tent seven days. **9** It shall be on the seventh day, that he shall shave all his hair off his head and his beard and his eyebrows. He shall shave off all his hair. He shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his body in water. Then he shall be clean. **10** "On the eighth day he shall take two male lambs without defect, one ewe lamb a year old without defect, three tenths of an ephah of fine flour for a meal offering, mixed with oil, and one log of oil. **11** The priest who cleanses him shall set the man who is to be cleansed, and those things, before the LORD, at the door of the Tent of Meeting. **12** "The priest shall take one of the male lambs, and offer him for a trespass offering, with the log of oil, and wave them for a wave offering before the LORD. **13** He shall kill the male lamb in the place where they kill the sin offering and the burnt offering, in the place of the sanctuary; for as the sin offering is the priest's, so is the trespass offering. It is most holy. **14** The priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and the priest shall put it on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot. **15** The priest shall take some of the log of oil, and pour it into the palm of his own left hand. **16** The priest shall dip his right finger in the oil that is in his left hand, and shall sprinkle some of the oil with his finger seven times before the LORD. **17** The priest shall put some of the rest of the oil that is in his hand on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot, upon the blood of the trespass offering. **18** The rest of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall put on the head of him who is to be cleansed, and the priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD. **19** "The priest shall offer the sin offering, and make atonement for him who is to be cleansed because of his uncleanness. Afterward he shall kill the burnt offering; **20** then the priest shall offer the burnt offering and the meal offering on the altar. The priest shall make atonement for him, and he shall be clean. **21** "If he is poor, and can't afford so much, then he shall take one male lamb for a trespass offering to be waved, to make atonement for him, and one tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering, and a log of oil; **22** and two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, such as he is able to afford; and the one shall be a sin offering, and the other a burnt offering. **23** "On the eighth day he shall bring them for his cleansing to the priest, to the door of the Tent of Meeting, before the LORD. **24** The priest shall take the lamb of the trespass

offering, and the log of oil, and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before the LORD. **25** He shall kill the lamb of the trespass offering. The priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering and put it on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot. **26** The priest shall pour some of the oil into the palm of his own left hand; **27** and the priest shall sprinkle with his right finger some of the oil that is in his left hand seven times before the LORD. **28** Then the priest shall put some of the oil that is in his hand on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot, on the place of the blood of the trespass offering. **29** The rest of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall put on the head of him who is to be cleansed, to make atonement for him before the LORD. **30** He shall offer one of the turtledoves, or of the young pigeons, which ever he is able to afford, **31** of the kind he is able to afford, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering, with the meal offering. The priest shall make atonement for him who is to be cleansed before the LORD." **32** This is the law for him in whom is the plague of leprosy, who is not able to afford the sacrifice for his cleansing. **33** The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, **34** "When you have come into the land of Canaan, which I give to you for a possession, and I put a spreading mildew in a house in the land of your possession, **35** then he who owns the house shall come and tell the priest, saying, 'There seems to me to be some sort of plague in the house.' **36** The priest shall command that they empty the house, before the priest goes in to examine the plague, that all that is in the house not be made unclean. Afterward the priest shall go in to inspect the house. **37** He shall examine the plague; and behold, if the plague is in the walls of the house with hollow streaks, greenish or reddish, and it appears to be deeper than the wall, **38** then the priest shall go out of the house to the door of the house, and shut up the house seven days. **39** The priest shall come again on the seventh day, and look. If the plague has spread in the walls of the house, **40** then the priest shall command that they take out the stones in which is the plague, and cast them into an unclean place outside of the city. **41** He shall cause the inside of the house to be scraped all over. They shall pour out the mortar that they scraped off outside of the city into an unclean place. **42** They shall take other stones, and put them in the place of those stones; and he shall take other mortar, and shall plaster the house. **43** "If the plague comes again, and breaks out in the house after he has taken out the stones, and after he has scraped the house, and after it was plastered, **44** then the priest shall come in and look; and behold, if the plague has spread in the house, it is a destructive mildew in the house. It is unclean. **45** He shall break down the house, its stones, and its timber, and all the house's mortar. He shall carry them out of the city into an unclean place. **46** "Moreover he who goes into the house while it is shut up shall be unclean until the evening. **47** He who lies down in the house shall wash his clothes; and he who eats in the house shall wash his clothes. **48** "If the priest shall come in, and examine it, and behold, the plague

hasn’t spread in the house, after the house was plastered, then the priest shall pronounce the house clean, because the plague is healed. **49** To cleanse the house he shall take two birds, cedar wood, scarlet, and hyssop. **50** He shall kill one of the birds in an earthen vessel over running water. **51** He shall take the cedar wood, the hyssop, the scarlet, and the living bird, and dip them in the blood of the slain bird, and in the running water, and sprinkle the house seven times. **52** He shall cleanse the house with the blood of the bird, and with the running water, with the living bird, with the cedar wood, with the hyssop, and with the scarlet; **53** but he shall let the living bird go out of the city into the open field. So shall he make atonement for the house; and it shall be clean.” **54** This is the law for any plague of leprosy, and for an itch, **55** and for the destructive mildew of a garment, and for a house, **56** and for a swelling, and for a scab, and for a bright spot; **57** to teach when it is unclean, and when it is clean. This is the law of leprosy.

## Leviticus 15

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** וַיְדַבֵּר יְהוָה אֶל־מֹשֶׁה וְאֶל־אַהֲרֹן לֵאמֹר **2** דַּבְּרוּ אֶל־בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וַאֲמַרְתֶּם אֲלֵהֶם אִישׁ אִישׁ כִּי
יִהְיֶה זָב מִבְּשָׂרוֹ זוֹבוֹ טָמֵא הוּא **3** וְזֹאת תִּהְיֶה טֻמְאָתוֹ בְּזוֹבוֹ רָר בְּשָׂרוֹ אֶת־זוֹבוֹ אוֹ־חָתַם בְּשָׂרוֹ
מִזּוֹבוֹ טֻמְאָתוֹ הִוא **4** כָּל־הַמִּשְׁכָּב אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב עָלָיו הַזָּב יִטְמָא וְכָל־הַכְּלִי אֲשֶׁר־יֵשֵׁב עָלָיו יִטְמָא **5**
וְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִגַּע בְּמִשְׁכָּבוֹ יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **6** וְהַיֹּשֵׁב עַל־הַכְּלִי אֲשֶׁר־יֵשֵׁב
עָלָיו הַזָּב יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **7** וְהַנֹּגֵעַ בִּבְשַׂר הַזָּב יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם
וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **8** וְכִי־יָרֹק הַזָּב בַּטָּהוֹר וְכִבֶּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **9** וְכָל־הַמֶּרְכָּב
אֲשֶׁר יִרְכַּב עָלָיו הַזָּב יִטְמָא **10** וְכָל־הַנֹּגֵעַ בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִהְיֶה תַּחְתָּיו יִטְמָא עַד־הָעָרֶב וְהַנּוֹשֵׂא אוֹתָם
יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **11** וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִגַּע־בּוֹ הַזָּב וְיָדָיו לֹא־שָׁטַף בַּמַּיִם וְכִבֶּס
בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **12** וּכְלִי־חֶרֶשׂ אֲשֶׁר־יִגַּע־בּוֹ הַזָּב יִשָּׁבֵר וְכָל־כְּלִי־עֵץ יִשְׁטַף
בַּמָּיִם **13** וְכִי־יִטְהַר הַזָּב מִזּוֹבוֹ וְסָפַר לוֹ שִׁבְעַת יָמִים לְטָהֳרָתוֹ וְכִבֶּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בְּשָׂרוֹ בְּמַיִם
חַיִּים וְטָהֵר **14** וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי יִקַּח־לוֹ שְׁתֵּי תֹרִים אוֹ שְׁנֵי בְנֵי יוֹנָה וּבָא לִפְנֵי יְהוָה אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל
מוֹעֵד וּנְתָנָם אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן **15** וְעָשָׂה אֹתָם הַכֹּהֵן אֶחָד חַטָּאת וְהָאֶחָד עֹלָה וְכִפֶּר עָלָיו הַכֹּהֵן לִפְנֵי יְהוָה
מִזּוֹבוֹ **16** וְאִישׁ כִּי־תֵצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ שִׁכְבַת־זָרַע וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם אֶת־כָּל־בְּשָׂרוֹ וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **17** וְכָל־בֶּגֶד
וְכָל־עוֹר אֲשֶׁר־יִהְיֶה עָלָיו שִׁכְבַת־זָרַע וְכֻבַּס בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **18** וְאִשָּׁה אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁכַּב אִישׁ אֹתָהּ
שִׁכְבַת־זֶרַע וְרָחֲצוּ בַמַּיִם וְטָמְאוּ עַד־הָעָרֶב **19** וְאִשָּׁה כִּי־תִהְיֶה זָבָה דָּם יִהְיֶה זֹבָהּ בִּבְשָׂרָהּ שִׁבְעַת
יָמִים תִּהְיֶה בְנִדָּתָהּ וְכָל־הַנֹּגֵעַ בָּהּ יִטְמָא עַד־הָעָרֶב **20** וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר תִּשְׁכַּב עָלָיו בְּנִדָּתָהּ יִטְמָא וְכֹל
אֲשֶׁר־תֵּשֵׁב עָלָיו יִטְמָא **21** וְכָל־הַנֹּגֵעַ בְּמִשְׁכָּבָהּ יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **22** וְכָל־
הַנֹּגֵעַ בְּכָל־כְּלִי אֲשֶׁר־תֵּשֵׁב עָלָיו יְכַבֵּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא עַד־הָעָרֶב **23** וְאִם עַל־הַמִּשְׁכָּב
הוּא אוֹ עַל־הַכְּלִי אֲשֶׁר־הִוא יֹשֶׁבֶת־עָלָיו בְּנָגְעוֹ־בוֹ יִטְמָא עַד־הָעָרֶב **24** וְאִם שָׁכֹב יִשְׁכַּב אִישׁ אֹתָהּ
וּתְהִי נִדָּתָהּ עָלָיו וְטָמֵא שִׁבְעַת יָמִים וְכָל־הַמִּשְׁכָּב אֲשֶׁר־יִשְׁכַּב עָלָיו יִטְמָא **25** וְאִשָּׁה כִּי־יָזוּב זוֹב
דָּמָהּ יָמִים רַבִּים בְּלֹא עֶת־נִדָּתָהּ אוֹ כִי־תָזוּב עַל־נִדָּתָהּ כָּל־יְמֵי זוֹב טֻמְאָתָהּ כִּימֵי נִדָּתָהּ תִּהְיֶה
טְמֵאָה הִוא **26** כָּל־הַמִּשְׁכָּב אֲשֶׁר־תִּשְׁכַּב עָלָיו כָּל־יְמֵי זוֹבָהּ כְּמִשְׁכַּב נִדָּתָהּ יִהְיֶה־לָּהּ וְכָל־הַכְּלִי
אֲשֶׁר תֵּשֵׁב עָלָיו טָמֵא יִהְיֶה כְּטֻמְאַת נִדָּתָהּ **27** וְכָל־הַנּוֹגֵעַ בָּם יִטְמָא וְכִבֶּס בְּגָדָיו וְרָחַץ בַּמַּיִם וְטָמֵא

עַד־הָעֶרֶב **28** וְאִם־טָהֲרָה מִזּוֹבָהּ וְסָפְרָה לָהּ שִׁבְעַת יָמִים וְאַחַר תִּטְהָר **29** וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁמִינִי תִּקַּח־לָהּ
שְׁתֵּי תֹרִים אוֹ שְׁנֵי בְנֵי יוֹנָה וְהֵבִיאָה אוֹתָם אֶל־הַכֹּהֵן אֶל־פֶּתַח אֹהֶל מוֹעֵד **30** וְעָשָׂה הַכֹּהֵן אֶת־
הָאֶחָד חַטָּאת וְאֶת־הָאֶחָד עֹלָה וְכִפֶּר עָלֶיהָ הַכֹּהֵן לִפְנֵי יְהוָה מִזּוֹב טֻמְאָתָהּ **31** וְהִזַּרְתֶּם אֶת־בְּנֵי־
יִשְׂרָאֵל מִטֻּמְאָתָם וְלֹא יָמֻתוּ בְּטֻמְאָתָם בְּטַמְּאָם אֶת־מִשְׁכָּנִי אֲשֶׁר בְּתוֹכָם **32** זֹאת תּוֹרַת הַזָּב וַאֲשֶׁר
תֵּצֵא מִמֶּנּוּ שִׁכְבַת־זָרַע לְטָמְאָה־בָהּ **33** וְהַדָּוָה בְּנִדָּתָהּ וְהַזָּב אֶת־זוֹבוֹ לַזָּכָר וְלַנְּקֵבָה וּלְאִישׁ אֲשֶׁר
יִשְׁכַּב עִם־טְמֵאָה

*English (BSB)*

**1** And the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, **2** “Say to the Israelites, ‘When any man has a bodily discharge, the discharge is unclean. **3** This uncleanness is from his discharge, whether his body allows the discharge to flow or blocks it. So his discharge will bring about uncleanness. **4** Any bed on which the man with the discharge lies will be unclean, and any furniture on which he sits will be unclean. **5** Anyone who touches his bed must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **6** Whoever sits on furniture on which the man with the discharge was sitting must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **7** Whoever touches the body of the man with a discharge must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **8** If the man with the discharge spits on one who is clean, that person must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **9** Any saddle on which the man with the discharge rides will be unclean. **10** Whoever touches anything that was under him will be unclean until evening, and whoever carries such things must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **11** If the man with the discharge touches anyone without first rinsing his hands with water, the one who was touched must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **12** Any clay pot that the man with the discharge touches must be broken, and any wooden utensil must be rinsed with water. **13** When the man has been cleansed from his discharge, he must count off seven days for his cleansing, wash his clothes, and bathe himself in fresh water, and he shall be clean. **14** On the eighth day he is to take two turtledoves or two young pigeons, come before the LORD at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, and give them to the priest. **15** The priest is to sacrifice them, one as a sin offering and the other as a burnt offering. In this way the priest will make atonement for the man before the LORD because of his discharge. **16** When a man has an emission of semen, he must bathe his whole body with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **17** Any clothing or leather on which there is an emission of semen must be washed with water, and it will remain unclean until evening. **18** If a man lies with a woman and there is an emission of semen, both must bathe with water, and they will remain unclean until evening. **19** When a woman has a discharge consisting of blood from her body, she will be unclean due to her menstruation for seven days, and anyone who touches her will be unclean until evening. **20** Anything

on which she lies or sits during her menstruation will be unclean, **21** and anyone who touches her bed must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **22** Whoever touches any furniture on which she was sitting must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **23** And whether it is a bed or furniture on which she was sitting, whoever touches it will be unclean until evening. **24** If a man lies with her and her menstrual flow touches him, he will be unclean for seven days, and any bed on which he lies will become unclean. **25** When a woman has a discharge of her blood for many days at a time other than her menstrual period, or if it continues beyond her period, she will be unclean all the days of her unclean discharge, just as she is during the days of her menstruation. **26** Any bed on which she lies or any furniture on which she sits during the days of her discharge will be unclean, like her bed during her menstrual period. **27** Anyone who touches these things will be unclean; he must wash his clothes and bathe with water, and he will be unclean until evening. **28** When a woman is cleansed of her discharge, she must count off seven days, and after that she will be ceremonially clean. **29** On the eighth day she is to take two turtledoves or two young pigeons and bring them to the priest at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. **30** The priest is to sacrifice one as a sin offering and the other as a burnt offering. In this way the priest will make atonement for her before the LORD for her unclean discharge. **31** You must keep the children of Israel separate from their uncleanness, so that they do not die by defiling My tabernacle, which is among them. **32** This is the law of him who has a discharge, of the man who has an emission of semen whereby he is unclean, **33** of a woman in her menstrual period, of any male or female who has a discharge, and of a man who lies with an unclean woman.’”

*English (WEB)*

**1** The LORD spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying, **2** “Speak to the children of Israel, and tell them, ’When any man has a discharge from his body, because of his discharge he is unclean. **3** This shall be his uncleanness in his discharge: whether his body runs with his discharge, or his body has stopped from his discharge, it is his uncleanness. **4** “’Every bed on which he who has the discharge lies shall be unclean; and everything he sits on shall be unclean. **5** Whoever touches his bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **6** He who sits on anything on which the man who has the discharge sat shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **7** “’He who touches the body of him who has the discharge shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **8** “’If he who has the discharge spits on him who is clean, then he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **9** “’Whatever saddle he who has the discharge rides on shall be unclean. **10** Whoever touches anything that was under him shall be unclean until the evening. He who carries those things shall wash his clothes,

and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **11** “’Whomever he who has the discharge touches, without having rinsed his hands in water, he shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **12** “’The earthen vessel, which he who has the discharge touches, shall be broken; and every vessel of wood shall be rinsed in water. **13** “’When he who has a discharge is cleansed of his discharge, then he shall count to himself seven days for his cleansing, and wash his clothes; and he shall bathe his flesh in running water, and shall be clean. **14** “’On the eighth day he shall take two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and come before the LORD to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and give them to the priest. **15** The priest shall offer them, the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering. The priest shall make atonement for him before the LORD for his discharge. **16** “’If any man has an emission of semen, then he shall bathe all his flesh in water, and be unclean until the evening. **17** Every garment and every skin which the semen is on shall be washed with water, and be unclean until the evening. **18** If a man lies with a woman and there is an emission of semen, they shall both bathe themselves in water, and be unclean until the evening. **19** “’If a woman has a discharge, and her discharge in her flesh is blood, she shall be in her impurity seven days. Whoever touches her shall be unclean until the evening. **20** “’Everything that she lies on in her impurity shall be unclean. Everything also that she sits on shall be unclean. **21** Whoever touches her bed shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **22** Whoever touches anything that she sits on shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **23** If it is on the bed, or on anything she sits on, when he touches it, he shall be unclean until the evening. **24** “’If any man lies with her, and her monthly flow is on him, he shall be unclean seven days; and every bed he lies on shall be unclean. **25** “’If a woman has a discharge of her blood many days not in the time of her period, or if she has a discharge beyond the time of her period, all the days of the discharge of her uncleanness shall be as in the days of her period. She is unclean. **26** Every bed she lies on all the days of her discharge shall be to her as the bed of her period. Everything she sits on shall be unclean, as the uncleanness of her period. **27** Whoever touches these things shall be unclean, and shall wash his clothes and bathe himself in water, and be unclean until the evening. **28** “’But if she is cleansed of her discharge, then she shall count to herself seven days, and after that she shall be clean. **29** On the eighth day she shall take two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and bring them to the priest, to the door of the Tent of Meeting. **30** The priest shall offer the one for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt offering; and the priest shall make atonement for her before the LORD for the uncleanness of her discharge. **31** “’Thus you shall separate the children of Israel from their uncleanness, so they will not die in their uncleanness when they defile my tabernacle that is among them.’” **32** This is the law of him who has a discharge, and of him who has an emission of semen, so that he is unclean by it; **33** and of her who has her period, and of a man or woman who has a discharge, and of him who lies with her who is unclean.

### Isaiah 30:22

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**22** וְטִמֵּאתֶם אֶת־צִפּוּי פְּסִילֵי כַסְפֶּךָ וְאֶת־אֲפֻדַּת מַסֵּכַת זְהָבֶךָ תְּזָרֵם כְּמוֹ דָוָה צֵא תֹּאמַר לוֹ

*English (BSB)*

**22** So you will desecrate your silver-plated idols and your gold-plated images. You will throw them away like menstrual cloths, saying to them, “Be gone!”

*English (WEB)*

**22** You shall defile the overlaying of your engraved images of silver, and the plating of your molten images of gold. You shall cast them away as an unclean thing. You shall tell it, “Go away!”

### Amos 4:11

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**11** הָפַכְתִּי בָכֶם כְּמַהְפֵּכַת אֱלֹהִים אֶת־סְדֹם וְאֶת־עֲמֹרָה וַתִּהְיוּ כְּאוּד מֻצָּל מִשְּׂרֵפָה וְלֹא־שַׁבְתֶּם עָדַי נְאֻם־יְהוָה

*English (BSB)*

**11** “Some of you I overthrew as I overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and you were like a firebrand snatched from a blaze, yet you did not return to Me,” declares the LORD.

*English (WEB)*

**11** “I have overthrown some of you, as when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah, and you were like a burning stick plucked out of the fire; yet you haven’t returned to me,” says the LORD.

### Zechariah 3

Printed in full in Chapter 4: see Zechariah 3.

### Matthew 18:12–17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**12** τί ὑμῖν δοκεῖ; ἐὰν γένηταί τινι ἀνθρώπῳ ἑκατὸν πρόβατα καὶ πλανηθῇ ἓν ἐξ αὐτῶν, οὐχὶ ἀφήσει τὰ ἐνενήκοντα ἐννέα ἐπὶ τὰ ὄρη καὶ πορευθεὶς ζητεῖ τὸ πλανώμενον; **13** καὶ ἐὰν γένηται εὑρεῖν αὐτό, ἀμὴν λέγω ὑμῖν ὅτι χαίρει ἐπ᾽ αὐτῷ μᾶλλον ἢ ἐπὶ τοῖς ἐνενήκοντα ἐννέα τοῖς μὴ πεπλανημένοις. **14** οὕτως οὐκ ἔστιν θέλημα ἔμπροσθεν τοῦ πατρὸς ὑμῶν τοῦ ἐν οὐρανοῖς ἵνα

ἀπόληται ἓν τῶν μικρῶν τούτων. **15** Ἐὰν δὲ ἁμαρτήσῃ εἰς σὲ ὁ ἀδελφός σου, ὕπαγε ἔλεγξον αὐτὸν μεταξὺ σοῦ καὶ αὐτοῦ μόνου. ἐάν σου ἀκούσῃ, ἐκέρδησας τὸν ἀδελφόν σου· **16** ἐὰν δὲ μὴ ἀκούσῃ, παράλαβε μετὰ σοῦ ἔτι ἕνα ἢ δύο, ἵνα ἐπὶ στόματος δύο μαρτύρων ἢ τριῶν σταθῇ πᾶν ῥῆμα· **17** ἐὰν δὲ παρακούσῃ αὐτῶν, εἰπὸν τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ· ἐὰν δὲ καὶ τῆς ἐκκλησίας παρακούσῃ, ἔστω σοι ὥσπερ ὁ ἐθνικὸς καὶ ὁ τελώνης.

*English (BSB)*

**12** What do you think? If a man has a hundred sheep and one of them goes astray, will he not leave the ninety-nine on the hills and go out to search for the one that is lost? **13** And if he finds it, truly I tell you, he rejoices more over that one sheep than over the ninety-nine that did not go astray. **14** In the same way, your Father in heaven is not willing that any of these little ones should perish. **15** If your brother sins against you, go and confront him privately. If he listens to you, you have won your brother over. **16** But if he will not listen, take one or two others along, so that ‘every matter may be established by the testimony of two or three witnesses.’ **17** If he refuses to listen to them, tell it to the church. And if he refuses to listen even to the church, regard him as you would a pagan or a tax collector.

*English (WEB)*

**12** “What do you think? If a man has one hundred sheep, and one of them goes astray, doesn’t he leave the ninety-nine, go to the mountains, and seek that which has gone astray? **13** If he finds it, most certainly I tell you, he rejoices over it more than over the ninety-nine which have not gone astray. **14** Even so it is not the will of your Father who is in heaven that one of these little ones should perish. **15** “If your brother sins against you, go, show him his fault between you and him alone. If he listens to you, you have gained back your brother. **16** But if he doesn’t listen, take one or two more with you, that at the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may be established. **17** If he refuses to listen to them, tell it to the assembly. If he refuses to hear the assembly also, let him be to you as a Gentile or a tax collector.

## Matthew 21:21

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**21** ἀποκριθεὶς δὲ ὁ Ἰησοῦς εἶπεν αὐτοῖς· Ἀμὴν λέγω ὑμῖν, ἐὰν ἔχητε πίστιν καὶ μὴ διακριθῆτε, οὐ μόνον τὸ τῆς συκῆς ποιήσετε, ἀλλὰ κἂν τῷ ὄρει τούτῳ εἴπητε· Ἄρθητι καὶ βλήθητι εἰς τὴν θάλασσαν, γενήσεται·

*English (BSB)*

**21** “Truly I tell you,” Jesus replied, “if you have faith and do not doubt, not only will you do what was done to the fig tree, but even if you say to this mountain, ‘Be lifted up and thrown into the sea,’ it will happen.

*English (WEB)*

**21** Jesus answered them, “Most certainly I tell you, if you have faith and don’t doubt, you will not only do what was done to the fig tree, but even if you told this mountain, ‘Be taken up and cast into the sea,’ it would be done.

## John 10:28

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**28** κἀγὼ δίδωμι αὐτοῖς ζωὴν αἰώνιον, καὶ οὐ μὴ ἀπόλωνται εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα, καὶ οὐχ ἁρπάσει τις αὐτὰ ἐκ τῆς χειρός μου.

*English (BSB)*

**28** I give them eternal life, and they will never perish. No one can snatch them out of My hand.

*English (WEB)*

**28** I give eternal life to them. They will never perish, and no one will snatch them out of my hand.

## Romans 14:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Τὸν δὲ ἀσθενοῦντα τῇ πίστει προσλαμβάνεσθε, μὴ εἰς διακρίσεις διαλογισμῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Accept him whose faith is weak, without passing judgment on his opinions.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now accept one who is weak in faith, but not for disputes over opinions.

## 1 Corinthians 5

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ὅλως ἀκούεται ἐν ὑμῖν πορνεία, καὶ τοιαύτη πορνεία ἥτις οὐδὲ ἐν τοῖς ἔθνεσιν, ὥστε γυναῖκά τινα τοῦ πατρὸς ἔχειν. **2** καὶ ὑμεῖς πεφυσιωμένοι ἐστέ, καὶ οὐχὶ μᾶλλον ἐπενθήσατε, ἵνα ἀρθῇ ἐκ μέσου ὑμῶν ὁ τὸ ἔργον τοῦτο ποιήσας; **3** Ἐγὼ μὲν γάρ, ἀπὼν τῷ σώματι παρὼν δὲ τῷ πνεύματι, ἤδη κέκρικα ὡς παρὼν τὸν οὕτως τοῦτο κατεργασάμενον **4** ἐν τῷ ὀνόματι τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ, συναχθέντων ὑμῶν καὶ τοῦ ἐμοῦ πνεύματος σὺν τῇ δυνάμει τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ, **5** παραδοῦναι τὸν τοιοῦτον τῷ Σατανᾷ εἰς ὄλεθρον τῆς σαρκός, ἵνα τὸ πνεῦμα σωθῇ ἐν τῇ ἡμέρᾳ τοῦ κυρίου. **6** Οὐ καλὸν τὸ καύχημα ὑμῶν. οὐκ οἴδατε ὅτι μικρὰ ζύμη ὅλον τὸ φύραμα ζυμοῖ; **7** ἐκκαθάρατε τὴν παλαιὰν ζύμην, ἵνα ἦτε νέον φύραμα, καθώς ἐστε ἄζυμοι.

καὶ γὰρ τὸ πάσχα ἡμῶν ἐτύθη Χριστός· **8** ὥστε ἑορτάζωμεν, μὴ ἐν ζύμῃ παλαιᾷ μηδὲ ἐν ζύμῃ κακίας καὶ πονηρίας, ἀλλ᾽ ἐν ἀζύμοις εἰλικρινείας καὶ ἀληθείας. **9** Ἔγραψα ὑμῖν ἐν τῇ ἐπιστολῇ μὴ συναναμίγνυσθαι πόρνοις, **10** οὐ πάντως τοῖς πόρνοις τοῦ κόσμου τούτου ἢ τοῖς πλεονέκταις καὶ ἅρπαξιν ἢ εἰδωλολάτραις, ἐπεὶ ὠφείλετε ἄρα ἐκ τοῦ κόσμου ἐξελθεῖν. **11** νῦν δὲ ἔγραψα ὑμῖν μὴ συναναμίγνυσθαι ἐάν τις ἀδελφὸς ὀνομαζόμενος ᾖ πόρνος ἢ πλεονέκτης ἢ εἰδωλολάτρης ἢ λοίδορος ἢ μέθυσος ἢ ἅρπαξ, τῷ τοιούτῳ μηδὲ συνεσθίειν. **12** τί γάρ μοι τοὺς ἔξω κρίνειν; οὐχὶ τοὺς ἔσω ὑμεῖς κρίνετε, **13** τοὺς δὲ ἔξω ὁ θεὸς κρίνει; ἐξάρατε τὸν πονηρὸν ἐξ ὑμῶν αὐτῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**1** It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and of a kind that is intolerable even among pagans: A man has his father’s wife. **2** And you are proud! Shouldn’t you rather have been stricken with grief and have removed from your fellowship the man who did this? **3** Although I am absent from you in body, I am present with you in spirit, and I have already pronounced judgment on the one who did this, just as if I were present. **4** When you are assembled in the name of our Lord Jesus and I am with you in spirit, along with the power of the Lord Jesus, **5** hand this man over to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, so that his spirit may be saved on the Day of the Lord. **6** Your boasting is not good. Do you not know that a little leaven works through the whole batch of dough? **7** Get rid of the old leaven, that you may be a new unleavened batch, as you really are. For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed. **8** Therefore let us keep the feast, not with the old bread, leavened with malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and of truth. **9** I wrote you in my letter not to associate with sexually immoral people. **10** I was not including the sexually immoral of this world, or the greedy and swindlers, or idolaters. In that case you would have to leave this world. **11** But now I am writing you not to associate with anyone who claims to be a brother but is sexually immoral or greedy, an idolater or a verbal abuser, a drunkard or a swindler. With such a man do not even eat. **12** What business of mine is it to judge those outside the church? Are you not to judge those inside? **13** God will judge those outside. “Expel the wicked man from among you.”

*English (WEB)*

**1** It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and such sexual immorality as is not even named among the Gentiles, that one has his father’s wife. **2** You are arrogant, and didn’t mourn instead, that he who had done this deed might be removed from among you. **3** For I most certainly, as being absent in body but present in spirit, have already, as though I were present, judged him who has done this thing. **4** In the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, when you are gathered together with my spirit with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ, **5** you are to deliver such a one to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus. **6** Your

boasting is not good. Don’t you know that a little yeast leavens the whole lump? **7** Purge out the old yeast, that you may be a new lump, even as you are unleavened. For indeed Christ, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place. **8** Therefore let’s keep the feast, not with old yeast, neither with the yeast of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth. **9** I wrote to you in my letter to have no company with sexual sinners; **10** yet not at all meaning with the sexual sinners of this world, or with the covetous and extortionists, or with idolaters, for then you would have to leave the world. **11** But as it is, I wrote to you not to associate with anyone who is called a brother who is a sexual sinner, or covetous, or an idolater, or a slanderer, or a drunkard, or an extortionist. Don’t even eat with such a person. **12** For what do I have to do with also judging those who are outside? Don’t you judge those who are within? **13** But those who are outside, God judges. “Put away the wicked man from among yourselves.”

## 2 Corinthians 5:11

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** Εἰδότες οὖν τὸν φόβον τοῦ κυρίου ἀνθρώπους πείθομεν, θεῷ δὲ πεφανερώμεθα· ἐλπίζω δὲ καὶ ἐν ταῖς συνειδήσεσιν ὑμῶν πεφανερῶσθαι.

*English (BSB)*

**11** Therefore, since we know what it means to fear the Lord, we try to persuade men. What we are is clear to God, and I hope it is clear to your conscience as well.

*English (WEB)*

**11** Knowing therefore the fear of the Lord, we persuade men, but we are revealed to God, and I hope that we are revealed also in your consciences.

## 2 Corinthians 7:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** ταύτας οὖν ἔχοντες τὰς ἐπαγγελίας, ἀγαπητοί, καθαρίσωμεν ἑαυτοὺς ἀπὸ παντὸς μολυσμοῦ σαρκὸς καὶ πνεύματος, ἐπιτελοῦντες ἁγιωσύνην ἐν φόβῳ θεοῦ.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Therefore, beloved, since we have these promises, let us cleanse ourselves from everything that defiles body and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Having therefore these promises, beloved, let’s cleanse ourselves from all defilement of flesh and spirit, perfecting holiness in the fear of God.

## Galatians 6:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἀδελφοί, ἐὰν καὶ προλημφθῇ ἄνθρωπος ἔν τινι παραπτώματι, ὑμεῖς οἱ πνευματικοὶ καταρτίζετε τὸν τοιοῦτον ἐν πνεύματι πραΰτητος, σκοπῶν σεαυτόν, μὴ καὶ σὺ πειρασθῇς.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Brothers, if someone is caught in a trespass, you who are spiritual should restore him with a spirit of gentleness. But watch yourself, or you also may be tempted.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Brothers, even if a man is caught in some fault, you who are spiritual must restore such a one in a spirit of gentleness, looking to yourself so that you also aren’t tempted.

## 2 Thessalonians 3:14–15

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**14** Εἰ δέ τις οὐχ ὑπακούει τῷ λόγῳ ἡμῶν διὰ τῆς ἐπιστολῆς, τοῦτον σημειοῦσθε, μὴ συναναμίγνυσθαι αὐτῷ, ἵνα ἐντραπῇ· **15** καὶ μὴ ὡς ἐχθρὸν ἡγεῖσθε, ἀλλὰ νουθετεῖτε ὡς ἀδελφόν.

*English (BSB)*

**14** Take note of anyone who does not obey the instructions we have given in this letter. Do not associate with him, so that he may be ashamed. **15** Yet do not regard him as an enemy, but warn him as a brother.

*English (WEB)*

**14** If any man doesn’t obey our word in this letter, note that man and have no company with him, to the end that he may be ashamed. **15** Don’t count him as an enemy, but admonish him as a brother.

## 2 Timothy 2:24–25

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**24** δοῦλον δὲ κυρίου οὐ δεῖ μάχεσθαι, ἀλλὰ ἤπιον εἶναι πρὸς πάντας, διδακτικόν, ἀνεξίκακον, **25** ἐν πραΰτητι παιδεύοντα τοὺς ἀντιδιατιθεμένους, μήποτε δώῃ αὐτοῖς ὁ θεὸς μετάνοιαν εἰς ἐπίγνωσιν ἀληθείας,

*English (BSB)*

**24** And a servant of the Lord must not be quarrelsome, but must be kind to everyone, able to teach, and forbearing. **25** He must gently reprove those who oppose him, in the hope that God may grant them repentance leading to a knowledge of the truth.

*English (WEB)*

**24** The Lord's servant must not quarrel, but be gentle toward all, able to teach, patient, **25** in gentleness correcting those who oppose him. Perhaps God may give them repentance leading to a full knowledge of the truth,

### Hebrews 12:28–29

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**28** διὸ βασιλείαν ἀσάλευτον παραλαμβάνοντες ἔχωμεν χάριν, δι' ἧς λατρεύωμεν εὐαρέστως τῷ θεῷ μετὰ εὐλαβείας καὶ δέους, **29** καὶ γὰρ ὁ θεὸς ἡμῶν πῦρ καταναλίσκον.

*English (BSB)*

**28** Therefore, since we are receiving an unshakable kingdom, let us be filled with gratitude, and so worship God acceptably with reverence and awe. **29** "For our God is a consuming fire."

*English (WEB)*

**28** Therefore, receiving a Kingdom that can't be shaken, let's have grace, through which we serve God acceptably, with reverence and awe, **29** for our God is a consuming fire.

### James 1:6

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** αἰτείτω δὲ ἐν πίστει, μηδὲν διακρινόμενος, ὁ γὰρ διακρινόμενος ἔοικεν κλύδωνι θαλάσσης ἀνεμιζομένῳ καὶ ῥιπιζομένῳ·

*English (BSB)*

**6** But he must ask in faith, without doubting, because he who doubts is like a wave of the sea, blown and tossed by the wind.

*English (WEB)*

**6** But let him ask in faith, without any doubting, for he who doubts is like a wave of the sea, driven by the wind and tossed.

## James 5:19–20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**19** Ἀδελφοί μου, ἐάν τις ἐν ὑμῖν πλανηθῇ ἀπὸ τῆς ἀληθείας καὶ ἐπιστρέψῃ τις αὐτόν, **20** γινωσκέτω ὅτι ὁ ἐπιστρέψας ἁμαρτωλὸν ἐκ πλάνης ὁδοῦ αὐτοῦ σώσει ψυχὴν αὐτοῦ ἐκ θανάτου καὶ καλύψει πλῆθος ἁμαρτιῶν.

*English (BSB)*

**19** My brothers, if one of you should wander from the truth and someone should bring him back, **20** consider this: Whoever turns a sinner from the error of his way will save his soul from death and cover over a multitude of sins.

*English (WEB)*

**19** Brothers, if any among you wanders from the truth and someone turns him back, **20** let him know that he who turns a sinner from the error of his way will save a soul from death and will cover a multitude of sins.

## Revelation 3:4

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** ἀλλὰ ἔχεις ὀλίγα ὀνόματα ἐν Σάρδεσιν ἃ οὐκ ἐμόλυναν τὰ ἱμάτια αὐτῶν, καὶ περιπατήσουσιν μετ᾽ ἐμοῦ ἐν λευκοῖς, ὅτι ἄξιοί εἰσιν.

*English (BSB)*

**4** But you do have a few people in Sardis who have not soiled their garments, and because they are worthy, they will walk with Me in white.

*English (WEB)*

**4** Nevertheless you have a few names in Sardis that didn’t defile their garments. They will walk with me in white, for they are worthy.

# Chapter 13. To Him Who Is Able: Kept from Stumbling (Jude 24–25)

## A. The Text

### The Greek text

> **24** Τῷ δὲ δυναμένῳ φυλάξαι ὑμᾶς ἀπταίστους καὶ στῆσαι κατενώπιον τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ ἀμώμους ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει **25** μόνῳ θεῷ σωτῆρι ἡμῶν διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν δόξα μεγαλωσύνη κράτος καὶ ἐξουσία πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς πάντας τοὺς αἰῶνας· ἀμήν.
>
> — Jude 24–25, SBLGNT

### What the earliest manuscripts read

Where the manuscripts differ in a way that affects translation, the table gives each reading and the manuscripts that have it. Readings are taken from the transcriptions in the New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room of the Institute for New Testament Textual Research (INTF), Münster (CC BY 4.0), and every manuscript listed has been checked against those transcriptions. Differences of spelling are not listed. An asterisk marks a manuscript's first hand, and $^{corr}$ a later corrector. Manuscripts: P72 and P78 (papyri, 3rd/4th c.); א = 01 Sinaiticus (4th c.); A = 02 Alexandrinus (5th c.); B = 03 Vaticanus (4th c.); C = 04 Ephraemi Rescriptus (5th c.); Ψ = 044 (9th/10th c.); K = 018 (9th c.); L = 020 (9th c.); 1739 (10th c.).

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| 24 | φυλάξαι ὑμᾶς | 'to guard you' | א B C Ψ L 1739 |
| 24 | φυλάξαι ἡμᾶς | 'to guard us' | A |
| 24 | φυλάξαι αὐτούς | 'to guard them' | K |
| 24 | ἀπταίστους καὶ στῆσαι | 'from stumbling, and to make (you) stand' | א A B Ψ K L |
| 24 | ἀπταίστους καὶ ἀσπίλους … στῆσαι | 'from stumbling and spotless, … to make (you) stand' | C 1739 |
| 24 | στηρίξαι ἀσπίλους ἀμώμους | 'to establish (you) spotless, blameless, | P72 |

| v. | Reading | Meaning | Manuscripts |
|---|---|---|---|
| | ἁγνευομένους ἀπέναντι τῆς δόξης | purified, before his glory’ | |
| 24 | ἀμώμους | ‘without blemish’ | P72 ℵ B C Ψ K L 1739 |
| 24 | ἀμέμπτους | ‘blameless’ | A |
| 25 | μόνῳ θεῷ σωτῆρι ἡμῶν | ‘to the only God our Savior’ | ℵ A B C Ψ 1739 |
| 25 | μόνῳ σοφῷ θεῷ σωτῆρι ἡμῶν | ‘to the only wise God our Savior’ | K L |
| 25 | μόνῳ θεῷ ἡμῶν | ‘to our only God’ | P72 |
| 25 | διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν | ‘through Jesus Christ our Lord’ | P72 ℵ A B C Ψ L 1739 |
| 25 | (absent) | | K |
| 25 | πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος | ‘before all time’ | ℵ A B C Ψ L |
| 25 | πρὸ παντὸς αἰῶνος | ‘before every age’ | 1739 |
| 25 | (absent) | | P72 K |

Notes. v. 24: not extant in P78. v. 25: not extant in P78.

## The verses in eighteen free English translations

No translation is given priority. The translations are listed in order of first publication and quoted exactly from their eBible.org editions; all are in the public domain or under a free license (see the Copyright and Licensing page).

### Jude 24

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | Vnto him that is able to kepe you that ye faule not and to present you fautlesse before the presence of his glory with ioye |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | Nowe vnto him that is able to keepe you, that ye fall not, and to present you faultlesse before the presence of his glorie with ioy, |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | Now to him who is able to preserve you without sin, and to present you spotless before the presence of his glory with exceeding joy, in the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | Now to him that is able to keep you from falling, and to present you faultless before |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| | the presence of his glory with exceeding joy, |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | But to him that is able to keep them from falling, and to present them faultless before the presence of his glory with exceeding joy, |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | Now unto him that is able to guard you from stumbling, and to set you before the presence of his glory without blemish in exceeding joy, |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | But to him that is able to keep you without stumbling, and to set [you] with exultation blameless before his glory, |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | And to Him who is able to guard you not stumbling, and to set [you] in the presence of His glory unblemished, in gladness, |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | Now unto him that is able to guard you from stumbling, and to set you before the presence of his glory without blemish in exceeding joy, |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | Now to him who is able to keep them from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory in great joy, |
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | God is able to keep you from ceasing to trust in him (OR, from sinning), and he is able to bring you into his glorious presence. As you stand before him, there will be nothing for which you will be condemned {he can condemn you}, and you will be rejoicing greatly. |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | To him who is able to guard you from falling, and to bring you into his glorious presence, blameless and rejoicing – |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | Now to the one who is able to keep you from stumbling and to cause you to stand before his glorious presence without blemish and with great joy, |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | Now to him who can keep you from falling, and who can bring you into his glorious presence without fault, and with great joy, |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | And to Him who is able to guard you without stumbling, and to set [you] in the presence of His glory unblemished, in gladness, |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling and to present you unblemished in His glorious presence, with great joy— |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | Now to Him who is able to keep them from stumbling and to present them unblemished in His glorious presence, with great joy— |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | Now to him who is able to keep them from falling and to make them stand unblemished in the presence of his glory with great joy, |

## Jude 25

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **TNT** Tyndale New Testament (1534) | that is to saye to God oure saveour which only is wyse be glory maiestie dominion and power now and for ever. Amen. |
| **GNV** Geneva Bible (1560; 1599 ed.) | That is, to God only wise, our Sauiour, be glorie, and maiestie, and dominion, and power, both nowe and for euer, Amen. |
| **DRA** Douay-Rheims (1582; 1899 ed.) | To the only God our Saviour through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory and magnificence, empire and power, before all ages, and now, and for all ages of ages. Amen. |
| **WBS** Webster Bible (1833) | To God the only wise, our Savior, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and ever. Amen. |
| **NOY** Noyes Bible (1869) | to the only God our Saviour, through Jesus Christ our Lord, is glory, majesty, dominion and power, before all time, and now, and for ever. Amen. |
| **RV** Revised Version (1881) | to the only God our Saviour, through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty, dominion and power, before all time, and now, and for evermore. Amen. |
| **DBY** Darby Translation (1890) | to the only God our Saviour, through Jesus Christ our Lord, [be] glory, majesty, might, and authority, from before the whole age, and now, and to all the ages. Amen. |
| **YLT** Young's Literal Translation (1898) | to the only wise God our Saviour, [is] glory and greatness, power and authority, both now and to all the ages! Amen. |
| **ASV** American Standard Version (1901) | to the only God our Saviour, through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty, dominion and power, before all time, and now, and for evermore. Amen. |
| **WEB** World English Bible (2000; 2020 ed.) | to God our Savior, who alone is wise, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forever. Amen. |

| Translation | Text |
|---|---|
| **T4T** Translation for Translators (2008–2017) | He is the only true God. He has saved us as a result of what Jesus Christ our Lord did for us. God was glorious and great and mighty and he ruled with great authority before time began. He is still like that, and he will remain like that forever!<br>◄Amen!/That is true!► |
| **OEB** Open English Bible (2010) | to the one God, our Savior, be ascribed, through Jesus Christ, our Lord, glory, majesty, power, and dominion, as it was before time began, is now, and will be for all time to come. Amen. |
| **ULB** Unlocked Literal Bible (2017) | to the only God our Savior through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty, dominion, and power, before all time, now, and forevermore. Amen. |
| **FBV** Free Bible Version (2018) | to the only God our Savior, through Jesus Christ our Lord, be glory, majesty, power, and authority, before all time, now, and forever. Amen. |
| **LSV** Literal Standard Version (2020) | to the only wise God our Savior, [is] glory and greatness, power and authority, both now and forever! Amen. |
| **BSB** Berean Standard Bible (2022) | to the only God our Savior be glory, majesty, dominion, and authority through Jesus Christ our Lord before all time, and now, and for all eternity. Amen. |
| **MSB** Majority Standard Bible (2022) | to the only wise God our Savior be glory, majesty, dominion and authority both now and for all eternity. Amen. |
| **TCENT** Text-Critical English New Testament (2022) | to the only wise God our Savior, be glory and majesty, power and authority, both now and forevermore. |

## B. Plain-English Orientation

Jude ends his letter not with greetings or travel plans but with praise. Having warned his readers of danger, urged them to keep themselves in God’s love, and told them to rescue others, he turns their eyes to God. God is able to keep them from stumbling. God will bring them into his glorious presence, blameless and full of joy. To this God, the only God and Savior, belong glory, majesty, power, and authority, through Jesus Christ, before all time, now, and forever.

This doxology is one of the most beloved in Scripture and is often used to close Christian worship. In the context of Jude it is also the letter's final word on its central theme. The readers have been kept (v. 1) and must keep themselves (v. 21), and now they are assured that God is able to guard them. The danger of stumbling is real, but the one who holds them is stronger.

**A note on the text.** The LSV's wording of v. 25 follows the Byzantine tradition and the Textus Receptus: "to the only wise God our Savior … both now and forever." The SBLGNT and NA28 have a longer text: "to the only God our Savior, **through Jesus Christ our Lord**, [be] glory, majesty, power, and authority **before all time** and now and forever." This chapter discusses both, since the differences are theologically interesting.

## C. Phrase-by-Phrase Exploration

### Τῷ δὲ δυναμένῳ (*Tō de dynamenō*) — 'now to the one who is able'

The doxology begins with a dative, Τῷ δὲ δυναμένῳ (*Tō de dynamenō*), "Now to the one who is able." Its main clause comes only at the end: "to Him … [is] glory." Paul's letters close in a similar way: "And to Him who is able to establish you" (Rom 16:25, LSV); "and to Him who is able to do exceedingly [and] abundantly above all things that we ask or think" (Eph 3:20, LSV).

The emphasis falls on God's **ability**. Throughout the letter Jude has described powers that threaten the readers: intruders who slip in unnoticed, persuasive dreamers, slanderers, reefs, wild waves. Now he names the power that is greater. Everything depends not on the readers' strength but on God's.

### φυλάξαι ὑμᾶς ἀπταίστους (*phylaxai hymas aptaistous*) — 'to guard you from stumbling'

The infinitive φυλάξαι (*phylaxai*), "to guard," comes from φυλάσσω (*phylassō*), a near synonym of τηρέω (*tēreō*), "keep," the word that has run through the whole letter. φυλάσσω carries the idea of a guard posted to protect, "implying custody and protection."[162] Jesus used it in his prayer: "I guarded those whom You have given to Me, and none of them were destroyed" (John 17:12, LSV).

**A textual note.** The SBLGNT, NA28, and TR read ὑμᾶς (*hymas*), "you," and the LSV follows them. The Robinson–Pierpont text, following most Byzantine manuscripts, reads αὐτούς (*autous*), "them," which shifts the focus slightly.[163]

**"Without stumbling"** translates ἀπταίστους (*aptaistous*), an adjective found nowhere else in the New Testament. It is formed from πταίω (*ptaiō*), "to stumble, trip," with the negative prefix ἀ-, and means "not stumbling, sure-

footed.”[164] It is used in the Greek Bible only once elsewhere, in 3 Maccabees, where God rescues the Jews of Egypt “unharmed” from destruction (ἀπταίστους, 3 Macc 6:39).[165] See the deep dive below.

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162. Abbott-Smith, s.v. τηρέω, synonym note: “φυλάσσω, implying custody and protection: τ. expresses the idea of watchful care and ‘may mark the result of which φ. is the means’ (Thayer s.v.).”↩

163. SBLGNT apparatus: “ὑμᾶς WH Treg NIV ] αὐτούς RP.” The Text-Critical Greek NT notes give αὐτοὺς ἀπταίστους in about 63% of manuscripts and ὑμᾶς ἀπταίστους in about 22%, with a further variant adding καὶ ἀσπίλους (“and spotless”) in about 7%.↩

164. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἄπταιστος: “(< πταίω) … without stumbling, sure-footed: metaph. … Ju 24.”↩

165. 3 Macc 6:39: ἀπταίστους αὐτοὺς ἐῤῥύσατο ὁμοθυμαδόν (“he rescued them all together, unharmed”), Brenton’s Greek Septuagint; translation mine. Abbott-Smith lists this as the only LXX occurrence.↩

### καὶ στῆσαι κατενώπιον τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ ἀμώμους ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει (*kai stēsai katenōpion tēs doxēs autou amōmous en agalliasei*) — ‘and to make you stand before his glory without blemish, with great joy’

God’s ability extends beyond protection along the way to the destination. He is able στῆσαι κατενώπιον τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ (*stēsai katenōpion tēs doxēs autou*), “to make [you] stand before his glory.” The verb ἵστημι (*histēmi*), “to set, make stand,” suggests standing upright in the presence of a king or judge. The adverb κατενώπιον (*katenōpion*) means “before, in the presence of.”[166] “His glory” is the radiant presence of God, the glory that Moses longed to see and that the prophets described. The scene is the final judgment, the same judgment described in vv. 14–15. For the ungodly it means conviction. For those kept by God it means standing before his glory.

They will stand **“unblemished”** (ἀμώμους, *amōmous*). The word was originally used of sacrificial animals “without blemish,” and then morally of people who are “faultless.”[167] Paul uses it of the goal of God’s work: “to present you holy, and unblemished, and unblameable before Himself” (Col 1:22, LSV); “that He might present the Assembly to Himself in glory, having no spot or wrinkle … but that it may be holy and unblemished” (Eph 5:27, LSV). In Jude the word stands in deliberate contrast to the intruders, who were “stains” (v. 12) and whose garments were “stained” by the flesh (v. 23). The readers will be presented without stain.

And they will stand **“in gladness”** (ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει, *en agalliasei*). The noun means “exultation, exuberant joy.”[168] It is the joy of celebration, of a festival or a wedding. Peter uses the related verb: “rejoice, that you may also rejoice in

the revelation of His glory—exulting" (1 Pet 4:13, LSV). After so much darkness, Jude's letter ends with the picture of believers standing before God's glory, faultless and overflowing with joy.

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166. Abbott-Smith, s.v. κατενώπιον: "over against, before: c. gen., τ. δόξης, Ju 24."↩

167. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἄμωμος: "of sacrificial victims, without blemish … ethically, unblemished, faultless: Eph 1:4 5:27, Phl 2:15, Col 1:22, Ju 24, Re 14:5."↩

168. Abbott-Smith, s.v. ἀγαλλίασις: "exultation, exuberant joy."↩

### μόνῳ θεῷ σωτῆρι ἡμῶν (*monō theō sōtēri hēmōn*) — 'to the only God our Savior'

The God who can do all this is "the only God our Savior." The LSV, following the TR and Byzantine text, reads "only **wise** God" (μόνῳ σοφῷ θεῷ, *monō sophō theō*). The critical texts lack "wise." Most likely a scribe added it under the influence of Paul's doxology, "to the only wise God, through Jesus Christ, to Him [be] glory for all ages" (Rom 16:27, LSV; cf. 1 Tim 1:17).[169] On either reading, the emphasis falls on "only." There is one God. Earlier, Jude called Jesus Christ "our only Master and Lord" (v. 4). The two "only"s stand side by side without contradiction. For Jude, confessing Jesus as the only Master does not compromise the confession of one God.

**"Our Savior"** (σωτῆρι ἡμῶν, *sōtēri hēmōn*) gives God the title σωτήρ, "Savior, deliverer." In the Greco-Roman world the title was commonly given to kings and emperors.[170] In the Bible it belongs to God, who saved Israel from Egypt (v. 5) and who saves now. The letter that began with "our common salvation" (v. 3) ends by naming God "our Savior."

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169. SBLGNT apparatus: "μόνῳ WH Treg NIV ] + σοφῷ RP." The Text-Critical Greek NT notes give σοφῷ θεῷ in about 82% of manuscripts and θεῷ alone (the critical text) in about 7%.↩

170. Abbott-Smith, s.v. σωτήρ: "a freq. epithet of kings in the Ptolemaic and Rom. periods."↩

### διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν (*dia Iēsou Christou tou kyriou hēmōn*) — 'through Jesus Christ our Lord'

The critical texts include the phrase διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν (*dia Iēsou Christou tou kyriou hēmōn*), "through Jesus Christ our Lord." The phrase is absent from the Byzantine text, the TR, and therefore the LSV. It is well attested in early manuscripts, and most scholars regard it as original.[171]

If original, it says something important. Glory is given to God *through* Jesus Christ. That may mean that God's glory is revealed and exercised through

Christ, or that believers give glory to God through Christ, or both. Paul's doxology in Romans has the same pattern ("to the only wise God, through Jesus Christ"). So does Peter's: "so that in all things God may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom is the glory and the power through the ages of the ages" (1 Pet 4:11, LSV). The doxology, like the whole letter, holds God and Jesus Christ together.

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171. SBLGNT apparatus: "διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν WH Treg NIV ] – RP." The Text-Critical Greek NT notes give the phrase in about 21% of manuscripts. Its presence in the critical editions reflects the judgment that the earliest witnesses include it.↩

### δόξα μεγαλωσύνη κράτος καὶ ἐξουσία (*doxa megalōsynē kratos kai exousia*) — 'glory, majesty, power, and authority'

Four attributes are ascribed to God:

- **Glory** (δόξα, *doxa*): God's radiant splendor and honor. This is the "glory" before which believers will stand (v. 24).
- **Greatness** or **majesty** (μεγαλωσύνη, *megalōsynē*): a word of the Greek Bible, used in Hebrews of God as "the Greatness in the highest" (Heb 1:3, LSV).[172]
- **Power** or **dominion** (κράτος, *kratos*): might and sovereign rule, common in New Testament doxologies (1 Tim 6:16; 1 Pet 4:11; 5:11; Rev 1:6).[173]
- **Authority** (ἐξουσία, *exousia*): the right to rule.

The list recalls David's prayer: "To You, O YHWH, [is] the greatness, and the might, and the beauty, and the victory, and the splendor … to You, O YHWH, [is] the kingdom" (1 Chr 29:11, LSV). The intruders "disregard lordship" (v. 8) and slander glorious beings (v. 8). The doxology declares where true glory, majesty, and authority lie.

**"Is" or "be"?** The Greek has no verb. Translators must supply one. The LSV supplies "[is]," making the doxology a declaration: glory *is* God's. Most translations supply "be," making it a wish or prayer: glory *be* to God. Both are grammatically possible. In 1 Pet 4:11 a verb is expressed ("to whom *is* the glory," ᾧ ἐστιν ἡ δόξα), which shows that the declarative sense was natural to early Christians. Perhaps the best understanding holds both: glory belongs to God, and the worshiping community gladly acknowledges it.

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172. Abbott-Smith, s.v. μεγαλωσύνη: "greatness, majesty: He 1:3 8:1, Ju 25 (elsewhere Eccl. only)."↩

173. Abbott-Smith, s.v. κράτος: "in doxologies, I Ti 6:16, I Pe 4:11 5:11, Ju 25, Re 1:6 5:13."↩

### πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς πάντας τοὺς αἰῶνας (*pro pantos tou aiōnos kai nyn kai eis pantas tous aiōnas*) — ‘before all time, and now, and to all the ages’

The critical text has a magnificent triple expression of time: πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς πάντας τοὺς αἰῶνας (*pro pantos tou aiōnos kai nyn kai eis pantas tous aiōnas*), “before all the age, and now, and into all the ages.” God’s glory reaches back before creation, fills the present, and extends without end into the future. The phrase “before all time” is absent from the Byzantine text and the LSV, which reads “both now and forever.”[174]

The longer form is unusual in New Testament doxologies. It is the only one that explicitly includes the eternity *before* time. It fits the letter’s sweep, which ranges from the ancient past (Enoch, the angels, the exodus), through the present (the intruders and the readers), to the future (the coming of the Lord, eternal life). The God who was glorious before all ages is the God who keeps his people now and will present them in glory forever.

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174. SBLGNT apparatus: “δόξα WH Treg NIV ] + καὶ RP • πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος WH Treg NIV ] – RP.”↩

### ἀμήν (*amēn*) — ‘amen’

The final word, ἀμήν (*amēn*), is a Hebrew word meaning “truly, so be it.” It was the congregation’s response to prayer and praise in the synagogue. Early Christians kept it in its Hebrew form. When Jude’s letter was read aloud in the community, the people would likely have answered “Amen,” making his doxology their own.

### Deep dive: Being kept from stumbling

Jude’s last promise, that God is able to guard his readers “without stumbling,” gathers up the letter’s central theme.

**Stumbling in the Bible.** The image of the foot that slips is common in Scripture, especially in the Psalms. “He does not permit your foot to be moved, / He who is preserving you does not slumber” (Ps 121:3, LSV). “You have delivered my soul from death, / Do You not [keep] my feet from falling?” (Ps 56:13, LSV). “You have delivered my soul from death, / My eyes from tears, my feet from overthrowing” (Ps 116:8, LSV). In Psalm 73 the writer confesses, “As nothing, my steps have slipped, / For I have been envious of the boastful” (Ps 73:2, LSV). His stumbling began with envy of the arrogant, the kind of people Jude has described.

**What stumbling means in Jude.** In the context of the letter, to stumble is to fall away from “the faith once delivered” (v. 3). It means following the

intruders into their perversion of grace, being swept along by wild waves, leaving the place God has given as the angels did (v. 6), or failing to believe as the wilderness generation did (v. 5). The letter has shown how real that danger is.

**The guard who does not sleep.** Against this danger stands the God who is "able." The verb φυλάσσω, "guard," suggests a sentry who keeps watch through the night. The Psalmist's "He who is preserving you does not slumber" captures the image (Ps 121:3, LSV). God's guarding does not depend on the believer's alertness. It is God's own vigilance.

**The relationship with v. 21.** How does God's guarding relate to the command "keep yourselves in the love of God" (v. 21)? Jude places both side by side without tension. God's ability to guard is the ground of the believer's confidence. The believer's keeping is the way that confidence is lived. The doxology does not cancel the command. It makes it possible. A believer who builds up, prays, and waits (vv. 20–21) does so in the assurance that God is able to finish what he began.

**Not perfection, but preservation.** "Without stumbling" does not mean that believers will never sin or struggle. The New Testament is honest about believers' failures ("we all make many stumbles," Jas 3:2, LSV). The promise is that God will keep them from the stumbling that leads to ruin, from falling away from him. The goal is to "set [you] in the presence of His glory unblemished," and that blamelessness is God's gift, not the reader's achievement.

**A word for the wavering.** Jude has just told his readers to show mercy to "those who are doubting" (v. 22). The doxology is good news for them too. The strength that keeps believers from stumbling is not their own certainty but God's ability. Those who waver may find their footing not by trying harder to be sure but by trusting the one who is able.

## D. Original-Language Investigation

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| δύναμαι | *dynamai* | be able | "Him who is able" | Doxology opening (Rom 16:25; Eph 3:20). |
| φυλάσσω | *phylassō* | guard, protect | "to guard" | Synonym of τηρέω; "custody and protection." |
| ἄπταιστος | *aptaistos* | not stumbling, sure-footed | "without stumbling" | NT hapax; LXX only 3 Macc 6:39. |

| Greek | Transliteration | Basic meaning | In context | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| ἵστημι | *histēmi* | set, make stand | “to set” | Standing before a king or judge. |
| κατενώπιον | *katenōpion* | before, in the presence of | “in the presence of” | Eph 1:4; Col 1:22. |
| δόξα | *doxa* | glory | “His glory” / “glory” | |
| ἄμωμος | *amōmos* | without blemish | “unblemished” | Sacrificial and moral. |
| ἀγαλλίασις | *agalliasis* | exultation | “gladness” | Exuberant joy. |
| μόνος | *monos* | only | “only” | Cf. v. 4. |
| σοφός | *sophos* | wise | “wise” | TR/Byzantine only; cf. Rom 16:27. |
| σωτήρ | *sōtēr* | savior | “our Savior” | Royal title in the Greco-Roman world; in the Bible, of God. |
| μεγαλωσύνη | *megalōsynē* | greatness, majesty | “greatness” | Heb 1:3; 8:1. |
| κράτος | *kratos* | power, dominion | “power” | Doxological term. |
| ἐξουσία | *exousia* | authority | “authority” | |
| αἰών | *aiōn* | age | “forever” | “Before all the age … into all the ages.” |
| ἀμήν | *amēn* | truly, so be it | “Amen” | Hebrew liturgical response. |

## E. The Historical and Cultural World

**Doxologies in Jewish and Christian worship.** Jewish prayer was rich in blessings and doxologies ascribing glory to God, and the five books of the Psalter each close with one (Pss 41:13; 72:18–19; 89:52; 106:48; 150). Early Christians continued the practice, and doxologies often closed letters that would be read in worship (Rom 16:25–27; Phil 4:20; 1 Tim 1:17; 1 Pet 4:11; 5:11; 2 Pet 3:18). Jude’s letter, read aloud in the community, would end in worship.

**“Savior” in the Roman world.** Hellenistic kings and Roman emperors were often hailed as “savior” (σωτήρ) and “benefactor” in inscriptions and official language.[175] When Christians called God “our Savior” and gave him “glory,”

“power,” and “authority,” they were making a claim that implicitly relativized every human ruler. Jude’s doxology is not a political manifesto, but its language would not have been neutral in the first-century world.

**Standing in the presence of a king.** In the ancient Near East, to stand in the presence of a king was an honor reserved for those admitted to court. To be “set” before God’s glory “unblemished” and “in gladness” is the image of acceptance at the royal court of heaven.

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175. Abbott-Smith, s.v. σωτήρ (see n. 9).↩

## F. Connections Across Scripture

**Romans 16:25–27; Ephesians 3:20–21 (form).** The closest parallels in form: “to Him who is able … to the only wise God, through Jesus Christ, to Him [be] glory” (Rom 16:25, 27, LSV). The parallel probably explains the addition of “wise” in some manuscripts of Jude.

**1 Timothy 1:17; 1 Peter 4:11; 2 Peter 3:18 (doxologies).** Other New Testament doxologies use similar vocabulary. Second Peter ends: “to Him [is] the glory both now, and to the day of the age! Amen” (2 Pet 3:18, LSV), a doxology to Christ that resembles Jude’s.

**Psalms 121; 56:13; 116:8 (being kept from stumbling).** The Old Testament roots of Jude’s promise.

**Colossians 1:22; Ephesians 1:4; 5:27; 1 Thessalonians 3:13 (presentation unblemished).** The goal of God’s work is a people presented holy and blameless before him.

**1 Chronicles 29:10–13 (attributes).** David’s blessing of God, ascribing greatness, power, glory, and kingdom to him.

**John 17:5; 2 Timothy 1:9 (before time).** “The glory that I had with You before the world was” (John 17:5, LSV); grace “given to us in Christ Jesus, before the times of the ages” (2 Tim 1:9, LSV). These texts share the critical text’s vision of glory before time.

## G. Scholarly and Theological Questions

**1. Which text of v. 25 is original?** Most scholars accept the longer text of the critical editions, with “through Jesus Christ our Lord” and “before all time,” and without “wise.” The Byzantine form is shorter in two places and adds “wise,” probably from Rom 16:27. Readers of the LSV should know that their translation reflects the Byzantine form here.

**2. Is the doxology addressed to God or to Christ?** It is addressed to "the only God our Savior," with glory ascribed "through Jesus Christ" (critical text). Some later doxologies are addressed directly to Christ (2 Pet 3:18; Rev 5:13). Jude's is addressed to God through Christ, and that reflects the pattern of early Christian worship.

**3. Does "able to guard you without stumbling" guarantee perseverance?** As in Chapters 1 and 11, Christian traditions answer differently. All agree that the doxology expresses confidence in God's power and faithfulness. Some read it as a guarantee that true believers will persevere. Others read it as a statement of God's ability that believers must still respond to. Jude's placement of the doxology after v. 21 suggests that he did not see the two as competing.

**4. "Is" or "be"?** The verbless Greek allows both. The LSV's "[is]" emphasizes that glory already belongs to God. The traditional "be" emphasizes the worshipers' acknowledgment.

## H. The Passage Within Jude

The doxology completes the letter's frame. The opening described the readers as "called, … loved … and … kept" (v. 1). The ending praises God who is "able to guard" them (v. 24). Between these two statements of God's keeping lies everything else: the intruders, the examples of judgment, the woes, the images of disorder, the call to build, pray, keep, wait, and show mercy.

Every major theme of the letter is gathered in these two verses:

- **Keeping and guarding:** "able to guard you" (v. 24), completing the τηρέω thread (vv. 1, 6, 13, 21).
- **Stumbling and falling:** the danger shown by the wilderness generation, the angels, and the intruders, and averted by God's power.
- **Blemish and purity:** "unblemished" (v. 24), in contrast to the stains (v. 12) and the stained garment (v. 23).
- **Glory:** the "glorious [ones]" slandered by the intruders (v. 8), and the true glory of God before which the readers will stand (vv. 24–25).
- **Joy:** "in gladness" (v. 24), the final mood of a letter that began with mercy, peace, and love.
- **Salvation:** "our common salvation" (v. 3) and "God our Savior" (v. 25).
- **Lordship:** "our only Master and Lord—Jesus Christ" (v. 4) and 'through Jesus Christ our Lord' (v. 25, critical text).
- **Time:** ancient examples, present dangers, and future judgment, all embraced by the eternal glory of God, 'before all time, and now, and forever.'

Jude wanted to write about “our common salvation” (v. 3) and was forced to write a warning instead. In the doxology he finally gets to write about salvation, and he does it in praise.

## I. Contemporary Understanding

*Suggested applications, distinct from the original meaning.*

**Ending in worship.** Jude ends a hard letter with praise. Christians facing conflict, confusion, or danger might learn from his example to return, finally, to the worship of God, not as an escape from difficulty but as the truest response to it.

**Confidence that is not self-confidence.** The doxology’s emphasis on God’s ability frees believers from depending on their own steadiness. That is good news for the wavering, the weary, and those who have stumbled before.

**Joy as the end.** The final picture is of believers standing before God’s glory “in gladness.” Christian faith, for all its seriousness about sin and judgment, aims at joy. Communities that have forgotten that may need Jude’s ending as much as his warnings.

**Using the doxology.** Jude 24–25 has long been used as a benediction at the close of Christian services. Its use may be enriched by remembering its context. It is spoken to people who face real dangers, by someone who knows those dangers well, in confidence that God is greater.

## J. Reflection and Discussion

1. How does reading the doxology after the rest of Jude change its meaning for you, compared with hearing it as a stand-alone benediction?
2. What does “stumbling” look like in your life or community? How does the promise that God “is able to guard you” speak to that?
3. Jude pictures believers standing before God’s glory “unblemished, in gladness.” What does that picture suggest about the goal of the Christian life?
4. The critical text includes “before all time, and now, and forever.” What difference does it make to think of God’s glory as stretching back before creation?
5. Jude both commands believers to keep themselves (v. 21) and praises God for keeping them (v. 24). How do you hold these together in your own life?

## K. Sources

- Texts: section A from the SBLGNT, the INTF NTVMR manuscript transcriptions (CC BY 4.0), and eighteen free translations (eBible.org); section L from the WLC, SBLGNT, Brenton, Charles, BSB, and WEB; inline quotations from the translation named with each (eBible.org editions).
- Greek: SBLGNT and apparatus (WH, Treg, NIV, RP, NA28 data); Robinson–Pierpont; TR.
- Abbott-Smith, s.vv. φυλάσσω, τηρέω (synonym note), ἄπταιστος, κατενώπιον, ἄμωμος, ἀγαλλίασις, μεγαλωσύνη, κράτος, σωτήρ.
- 3 Maccabees 6:39 (Brenton's Greek Septuagint).
- Greek of 1 Pet 4:11 from SBLGNT.

## L. Texts Highlighted in This Chapter

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this chapter is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### 1 Chronicles 29:11

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**11** לְךָ יְהוָה הַגְּדֻלָּה וְהַגְּבוּרָה וְהַתִּפְאֶרֶת וְהַנֵּצַח וְהַהוֹד כִּי־כֹל בַּשָּׁמַיִם וּבָאָרֶץ לְךָ יְהוָה הַמַּמְלָכָה
וְהַמִּתְנַשֵּׂא לְכֹל לְרֹאשׁ

*English (BSB)*

**11** Yours, O LORD, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the splendor and the majesty, for everything in heaven and on earth belongs to You. Yours, O LORD, is the kingdom, and You are exalted as head over all.

*English (WEB)*

**11** Yours, LORD, is the greatness, the power, the glory, the victory, and the majesty! For all that is in the heavens and on the earth is yours. Yours is the kingdom, LORD, and you are exalted as head above all.

### Psalm 41:13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**13** [41:14] בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵהָעוֹלָם וְעַד הָעוֹלָם אָמֵן וְאָמֵן

*English (BSB)*

**13** Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting. Amen and Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**13** Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting and to everlasting! Amen and amen.

## Psalm 56:13

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**13** [56:14] כִּי הִצַּלְתָּ נַפְשִׁי מִמָּוֶת הֲלֹא רַגְלַי מִדֶּחִי לְהִתְהַלֵּךְ לִפְנֵי אֱלֹהִים בְּאוֹר הַחַיִּים

*English (BSB)*

**13** For You have delivered my soul from death, and my feet from stumbling, that I may walk before God in the light of life.

*English (WEB)*

**13** For you have delivered my soul from death, and prevented my feet from falling, that I may walk before God in the light of the living.

## Psalm 72:18–19

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**18** בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל עֹשֵׂה נִפְלָאוֹת לְבַדּוֹ **19** וּבָרוּךְ שֵׁם כְּבוֹדוֹ לְעוֹלָם וְיִמָּלֵא כְבוֹדוֹ אֶת־כֹּל הָאָרֶץ אָמֵן וְאָמֵן

*English (BSB)*

**18** Blessed be the LORD God, the God of Israel, who alone does marvelous deeds. **19** And blessed be His glorious name forever; may all the earth be filled with His glory. Amen and amen.

*English (WEB)*

**18** Praise be to the LORD God, the God of Israel, who alone does marvelous deeds. **19** Blessed be his glorious name forever! Let the whole earth be filled with his glory! Amen and amen.

## Psalm 73

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** מִזְמ֗וֹר לְאָסָ֫ף אַ֤ךְ טוֹב֙ לְיִשְׂרָאֵ֣ל אֱלֹהִ֔ים לְבָרֵ֖י לֵבָֽב **2** וַאֲנִ֗י כִּמְעַ֥ט נטוי רַגְלַ֑י כְּאַ֝יִן שפכה אֲשֻׁרָֽי **3** כִּֽי־קִנֵּ֥אתִי בַּהוֹלְלִ֑ים שְׁל֖וֹם רְשָׁעִ֣ים אֶרְאֶֽה **4** כִּ֤י אֵין֙ חַרְצֻב֣וֹת לְמוֹתָ֔ם וּבָרִ֖יא אוּלָֽם **5** בַּעֲמַ֣ל אֱנ֭וֹשׁ אֵינָ֑מוֹ וְעִם־אָדָ֥ם לֹ֝א יְנֻגָּֽעוּ **6** לָכֵ֤ן עֲנָקָ֙תְמוֹ֙ גַּאֲוָ֔ה יַעֲטָ֖ף שִׁ֣ית חָמָ֑ס לָמוֹ **7** יָצָ֣א מֵחֵ֣לֶב עֵינֵ֑מוֹ עָבְר֥וּ מַ֝שְׂכִּיּ֗וֹת לֶ֣בֶב **8** יָמִ֣יקוּ וְיְדַבְּר֣וּ בְ֭רָע עֹ֣שֶׁק מִמָּר֑וֹם יְדַבֵּ֥רוּ **9** שַׁ֝תּ֗וּ בַּשָּׁמַ֥יִם פִּיהֶ֑ם וּלְשׁוֹנָ֥ם תִּֽהֲלַךְ בָּאָֽרֶץ **10** לָכֵ֤ן ישיב עַמּ֙וֹ֙ הֲלֹ֔ם וּמֵ֥י מָלֵ֖א יִמְצ֣וּ לָמֽוֹ **11** וְאָמְר֗וּ אֵ֭יכָה יָדַ֣ע־אֵ֑ל וְיֵ֥שׁ דֵּעָ֖ה בְּעֶלְיֽוֹן **12** הִנֵּ֣ה־אֵ֭לֶּה רְשָׁעִ֑ים וְשַׁלְוֵ֖י עוֹלָ֣ם הִשְׂגּ֣וּ חָֽיִל **13** אַ֤ךְ־רִ֥יק זִכִּ֗יתִי לְבָבִ֑י וָאֶרְחַ֖ץ בְּנִקָּיוֹן֣ כַּפָּֽי **14** וָאֱהִ֥י נָ֝גוּעַ כָּל־הַיּ֗וֹם וְתוֹכַחְתִּ֥י לַבְּקָרִֽים **15** אִם־אָ֭מַרְתִּי אֲסַפְּרָ֣ה כְמוֹ֑ הִנֵּ֥ה דוֹר־בָּ֝נֶ֗יךָ בָּגָ֥דְתִּי **16** וָאֲחַשְּׁבָ֣ה לָדַ֣עַת זֹ֭את עָמָ֣ל הִ֣יא בְעֵינָֽי **17** עַד־אָבוֹא֮ אֶל־מִקְדְּשֵׁי־אֵל֒ אָ֭בִינָה לְאַחֲרִיתָֽם **18** אַ֤ךְ בַּחֲלַקּוֹת֙ תָּשִׁ֣ית לָמ֔וֹ הִפַּלְתָּ֖ם לְמַשּׁוּאֽוֹת **19** אֵ֣יךְ הָיוּ֮ לְשַׁמָּה֒ כְּרֶ֣גַע סָ֭פּוּ תַּמּ֣וּ מִן־בַּלָּהֽוֹת **20** כַּחֲל֣וֹם מֵהָקִ֣ין אֲדֹנָ֑י בָּ֝עִ֗יר צַלְמָ֥ם תִּבְזֶֽה **21** כִּ֤י יִתְחַמֵּ֣ץ לְבָבִ֑י וְכִלְיוֹתַ֖י אֶשְׁתּוֹנָֽן **22** וַאֲנִ֣י־בַ֭עַר וְלֹ֣א אֵדָ֑ע בְּהֵמ֖וֹת הָיִ֣יתִי עִמָּֽךְ **23** וַאֲנִ֣י תָמִ֣יד עִמָּ֑ךְ אָחַ֖זְתָּ בְּיַד־יְמִינִֽי **24** בַּעֲצָתְךָ֥ תַנְחֵ֑נִי וְאַחַ֖ר כָּב֣וֹד תִּקָּחֵֽנִי **25** מִי־לִ֣י בַשָּׁמַ֑יִם וְעִמְּךָ֥ לֹא־חָפַ֖צְתִּי בָּאָֽרֶץ **26** כָּלָ֤ה שְׁאֵרִ֣י וּלְבָבִ֑י וְחֶלְקִ֥י אֱלֹהִ֖ים לְעוֹלָֽם **27** כִּי־הִנֵּ֣ה רְחֲקֶ֣יךָ יֹאבֵ֑דוּ הִצְמַ֥תָּה כָּל־זוֹנָ֝ה מִמֶּֽךָּ **28** וַאֲנִ֣י קִרְבַת־אֱלֹהִ֣ים לִי־ט֑וֹב שַׁתִּ֥י בַאדֹנָ֥י יְהוִ֗ה מַחְסִ֫י לְסַפֵּ֥ר כָּל־מַלְאָכוֹתֶֽיךָ

*English (BSB)*

**1** Surely God is good to Israel, to those who are pure in heart. **2** But as for me, my feet had almost stumbled; my steps had nearly slipped. **3** For I envied the arrogant when I saw the prosperity of the wicked. **4** They have no struggle in their death; their bodies are well-fed. **5** They are free of the burdens others carry; they are not afflicted like other men. **6** Therefore pride is their necklace; a garment of violence covers them. **7** From their prosperity proceeds iniquity; the imaginations of their hearts run wild. **8** They mock and speak with malice; with arrogance they threaten oppression. **9** They set their mouths against the heavens, and their tongues strut across the earth. **10** So their people return to this place and drink up waters in abundance. **11** The wicked say, “How can God know? Does the Most High have knowledge?” **12** Behold, these are the wicked— always carefree as they increase their wealth. **13** Surely in vain I have kept my heart pure; in innocence I have washed my hands. **14** For I am afflicted all day long and punished every morning. **15** If I had said, “I will speak this way,” then I would have betrayed Your children. **16** When I tried to understand all this, it was troublesome in my sight **17** until I entered God’s sanctuary; then I discerned their end. **18** Surely You set them on slick ground; You cast them down into ruin. **19** How suddenly they are laid waste, completely swept away by terrors! **20** Like one waking from a dream, so You, O Lord, awaken and despise their form. **21** When my heart was grieved and I was pierced within, **22** I was senseless and ignorant; I was a brute beast before You. **23** Yet I am always with You; You hold my right hand. **24** You guide

me with Your counsel, and later receive me in glory. **25** Whom have I in heaven but You? And on earth I desire no one besides You. **26** My flesh and my heart may fail, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever. **27** Those far from You will surely perish; You destroy all who are unfaithful to You. **28** But as for me, it is good to draw near to God. I have made the Lord GOD my refuge, that I may proclaim all Your works.

*English (WEB)*

**1** Surely God is good to Israel, to those who are pure in heart. **2** But as for me, my feet were almost gone. My steps had nearly slipped. **3** For I was envious of the arrogant, when I saw the prosperity of the wicked. **4** For there are no struggles in their death, but their strength is firm. **5** They are free from burdens of men, neither are they plagued like other men. **6** Therefore pride is like a chain around their neck. Violence covers them like a garment. **7** Their eyes bulge with fat. Their minds pass the limits of conceit. **8** They scoff and speak with malice. In arrogance, they threaten oppression. **9** They have set their mouth in the heavens. Their tongue walks through the earth. **10** Therefore their people return to them, and they drink up waters of abundance. **11** They say, “How does God know? Is there knowledge in the Most High?” **12** Behold, these are the wicked. Being always at ease, they increase in riches. **13** Surely I have cleansed my heart in vain, and washed my hands in innocence, **14** For all day long I have been plagued, and punished every morning. **15** If I had said, “I will speak thus”, behold, I would have betrayed the generation of your children. **16** When I tried to understand this, it was too painful for me— **17** until I entered God’s sanctuary, and considered their latter end. **18** Surely you set them in slippery places. You throw them down to destruction. **19** How they are suddenly destroyed! They are completely swept away with terrors. **20** As a dream when one wakes up, so, Lord, when you awake, you will despise their fantasies. **21** For my soul was grieved. I was embittered in my heart. **22** I was so senseless and ignorant. I was a brute beast before you. **23** Nevertheless, I am continually with you. You have held my right hand. **24** You will guide me with your counsel, and afterward receive me to glory. **25** Whom do I have in heaven? There is no one on earth whom I desire besides you. **26** My flesh and my heart fails, but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever. **27** For, behold, those who are far from you shall perish. You have destroyed all those who are unfaithful to you. **28** But it is good for me to come close to God. I have made the Lord GOD my refuge, that I may tell of all your works.

## Psalm 89:52

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex; verse numbers in brackets are those of the Hebrew Bible)*

**52 [89:53]** בָּרוּךְ יְהוָה לְעוֹלָם אָמֵן וְאָמֵן

*English (BSB)*

**52** Blessed be the LORD forever! Amen and amen.

*English (WEB)*

**52** Blessed be the LORD forever more. Amen, and Amen.

### Psalm 106:48

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**48** בָּרוּךְ־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מִן־הָעוֹלָם וְעַד הָעוֹלָם וְאָמַר כָּל־הָעָם אָמֵן הַלְלוּ־יָהּ

*English (BSB)*

**48** Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting to everlasting. Let all the people say, “Amen!” Hallelujah!

*English (WEB)*

**48** Blessed be the LORD, the God of Israel, from everlasting even to everlasting! Let all the people say, “Amen.” Praise the LORD!

### Psalm 116:8

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**8** כִּי חִלַּצְתָּ נַפְשִׁי מִמָּוֶת אֶת־עֵינִי מִן־דִּמְעָה אֶת־רַגְלִי מִדֶּחִי

*English (BSB)*

**8** For You have delivered my soul from death, my eyes from tears, my feet from stumbling.

*English (WEB)*

**8** For you have delivered my soul from death, my eyes from tears, and my feet from falling.

### Psalm 121:3

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**3** אַל־יִתֵּן לַמּוֹט רַגְלֶךָ אַל־יָנוּם שֹׁמְרֶךָ

*English (BSB)*

**3** He will not allow your foot to slip; your Protector will not slumber.

*English (WEB)*

**3** He will not allow your foot to be moved. He who keeps you will not slumber.

## Psalm 150

*Hebrew (Westminster Leningrad Codex)*

**1** הַלְלוּ יָהּ הַלְלוּ־אֵל בְּקָדְשׁוֹ הַלְלוּהוּ בִּרְקִיעַ עֻזּוֹ **2** הַלְלוּהוּ בִגְבוּרֹתָיו הַלְלוּהוּ כְּרֹב גֻּדְלוֹ **3** הַלְלוּהוּ בְּתֵקַע שׁוֹפָר הַלְלוּהוּ בְּנֵבֶל וְכִנּוֹר **4** הַלְלוּהוּ בְתֹף וּמָחוֹל הַלְלוּהוּ בְּמִנִּים וְעוּגָב **5** הַלְלוּהוּ בְצִלְצְלֵי־שָׁמַע הַלְלוּהוּ בְּצִלְצְלֵי תְרוּעָה **6** כֹּל הַנְּשָׁמָה תְּהַלֵּל יָהּ הַלְלוּ־יָהּ

*English (BSB)*

**1** Hallelujah! Praise God in His sanctuary. Praise Him in His mighty heavens. **2** Praise Him for His mighty acts; praise Him for His excellent greatness. **3** Praise Him with the sound of the horn; praise Him with the harp and lyre. **4** Praise Him with tambourine and dancing; praise Him with strings and flute. **5** Praise Him with clashing cymbals; praise Him with resounding cymbals. **6** Let everything that has breath praise the LORD! Hallelujah!

*English (WEB)*

**1** Praise the LORD! Praise God in his sanctuary! Praise him in his heavens for his acts of power! **2** Praise him for his mighty acts! Praise him according to his excellent greatness! **3** Praise him with the sounding of the trumpet! Praise him with harp and lyre! **4** Praise him with tambourine and dancing! Praise him with stringed instruments and flute! **5** Praise him with loud cymbals! Praise him with resounding cymbals! **6** Let everything that has breath praise the LORD! Praise the LORD!

## 3 Maccabees 6:39

*Greek (Septuagint, as printed in Brenton's edition, public domain)*

**39** Ἐν αἷς καὶ μεγαλοδόξως ἐπιφάνας τὸ ἔλεος αὐτοῦ ὁ τῶν ὅλων δυνάστης, ἀπταίστους αὐτοὺς ἐῤῥύσατο ὁμοθυμαδόν.

*English (Brenton, 1844)*

**39** The Ruler over all did during this time manifest forth his mercy gloriously, and did deliver them all together unharmed.

## John 17:5, 12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**5** καὶ νῦν δόξασόν με σύ, πάτερ, παρὰ σεαυτῷ τῇ δόξῃ ᾗ εἶχον πρὸ τοῦ τὸν κόσμον εἶναι παρὰ σοί. … **12** ὅτε ἤμην μετ᾽ αὐτῶν ἐγὼ ἐτήρουν αὐτοὺς ἐν τῷ ὀνόματί σου ᾧ δέδωκάς μοι, καὶ ἐφύλαξα, καὶ οὐδεὶς ἐξ αὐτῶν ἀπώλετο εἰ μὴ ὁ υἱὸς τῆς ἀπωλείας, ἵνα ἡ γραφὴ πληρωθῇ.

*English (BSB)*

**5** And now, Father, glorify Me in Your presence with the glory I had with You before the world existed. … **12** While I was with them, I protected and preserved them by Your name, the name You gave Me. Not one of them has been lost, except the son of destruction, so that the Scripture would be fulfilled.

*English (WEB)*

**5** Now, Father, glorify me with your own self with the glory which I had with you before the world existed. … **12** While I was with them in the world, I kept them in your name. I have kept those whom you have given me. None of them is lost except the son of destruction, that the Scripture might be fulfilled.

## Romans 16:25–27

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

*English (BSB)*

**25** Now to Him who is able to strengthen you by my gospel and by the proclamation of Jesus Christ, according to the revelation of the mystery concealed for ages past **26** but now revealed and made known through the writings of the prophets by the command of the eternal God, in order to lead all nations to the obedience that comes from faith — **27** to the only wise God be glory forever through Jesus Christ! Amen.

*English (WEB)*

## Ephesians 1:4

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**4** καθὼς ἐξελέξατο ἡμᾶς ἐν αὐτῷ πρὸ καταβολῆς κόσμου, εἶναι ἡμᾶς ἁγίους καὶ ἀμώμους κατενώπιον αὐτοῦ ἐν ἀγάπῃ,

*English (BSB)*

**4** For He chose us in Him before the foundation of the world to be holy and blameless in His presence. In love

*English (WEB)*

**4** even as he chose us in him before the foundation of the world, that we would be holy and without defect before him in love,

## Ephesians 3:20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** Τῷ δὲ δυναμένῳ ὑπὲρ πάντα ποιῆσαι ὑπερεκπερισσοῦ ὧν αἰτούμεθα ἢ νοοῦμεν κατὰ τὴν δύναμιν τὴν ἐνεργουμένην ἐν ἡμῖν,

*English (BSB)*

**20** Now to Him who is able to do so much more than all we ask or imagine, according to His power that is at work within us,

*English (WEB)*

**20** Now to him who is able to do exceedingly abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that works in us,

## Ephesians 5:27

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**27** ἵνα παραστήσῃ αὐτὸς ἑαυτῷ ἔνδοξον τὴν ἐκκλησίαν, μὴ ἔχουσαν σπίλον ἢ ῥυτίδα ἤ τι τῶν τοιούτων, ἀλλ᾽ ἵνα ᾖ ἁγία καὶ ἄμωμος.

*English (BSB)*

**27** and to present her to Himself as a glorious church, without stain or wrinkle or any such blemish, but holy and blameless.

*English (WEB)*

**27** that he might present the assembly to himself gloriously, not having spot or wrinkle or any such thing, but that she should be holy and without defect.

## Philippians 4:20

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**20** τῷ δὲ θεῷ καὶ πατρὶ ἡμῶν ἡ δόξα εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων· ἀμήν.

*English (BSB)*

**20** To our God and Father be glory forever and ever. Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**20** Now to our God and Father be the glory forever and ever! Amen.

## Colossians 1:22

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**22** νυνὶ δὲ ἀποκατηλλάγητε ἐν τῷ σώματι τῆς σαρκὸς αὐτοῦ διὰ τοῦ θανάτου— παραστῆσαι ὑμᾶς ἁγίους καὶ ἀμώμους καὶ ἀνεγκλήτους κατενώπιον αὐτοῦ,

*English (BSB)*

**22** But now He has reconciled you by Christ’s physical body through death to present you holy, unblemished, and blameless in His presence—

*English (WEB)*

**22** yet now he has reconciled in the body of his flesh through death, to present you holy and without defect and blameless before him,

## 1 Timothy 1:17

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**17** τῷ δὲ βασιλεῖ τῶν αἰώνων, ἀφθάρτῳ, ἀοράτῳ, μόνῳ θεῷ, τιμὴ καὶ δόξα εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων· ἀμήν.

*English (BSB)*

**17** Now to the King eternal, immortal, and invisible, the only God, be honor and glory forever and ever. Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**17** Now to the King eternal, immortal, invisible, to God who alone is wise, be honor and glory forever and ever. Amen.

## 1 Timothy 6:16

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**16** ὁ μόνος ἔχων ἀθανασίαν, φῶς οἰκῶν ἀπρόσιτον, ὃν εἶδεν οὐδεὶς ἀνθρώπων οὐδὲ ἰδεῖν δύναται· ᾧ τιμὴ καὶ κράτος αἰώνιον· ἀμήν.

*English (BSB)*

**16** He alone is immortal and dwells in unapproachable light. No one has ever seen Him, nor can anyone see Him. To Him be honor and eternal dominion! Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**16** He alone has immortality, dwelling in unapproachable light, whom no man has seen nor can see, to whom be honor and eternal power. Amen.

## 2 Timothy 1:9

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**9** τοῦ σώσαντος ἡμᾶς καὶ καλέσαντος κλήσει ἁγίᾳ, οὐ κατὰ τὰ ἔργα ἡμῶν ἀλλὰ κατὰ ἰδίαν πρόθεσιν καὶ χάριν, τὴν δοθεῖσαν ἡμῖν ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ πρὸ χρόνων αἰωνίων,

*English (BSB)*

**9** He has saved us and called us to a holy calling, not because of our works, but by His own purpose and by the grace He granted us in Christ Jesus before time began.

*English (WEB)*

**9** who saved us and called us with a holy calling, not according to our works, but according to his own purpose and grace, which was given to us in Christ Jesus before times eternal,

## Hebrews 1:3

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**3** ὃς ὢν ἀπαύγασμα τῆς δόξης καὶ χαρακτὴρ τῆς ὑποστάσεως αὐτοῦ, φέρων τε τὰ πάντα τῷ ῥήματι τῆς δυνάμεως, δι᾽ αὑτοῦ καθαρισμὸν τῶν ἁμαρτιῶν ποιησάμενος ἐκάθισεν ἐν δεξιᾷ τῆς μεγαλωσύνης ἐν ὑψηλοῖς,

*English (BSB)*

**3** The Son is the radiance of God’s glory and the exact representation of His nature, upholding all things by His powerful word. After He had provided purification for sins, He sat down at the right hand of the Majesty on high.

*English (WEB)*

**3** His Son is the radiance of his glory, the very image of his substance, and upholding all things by the word of his power, who, when he had by himself purified us of our sins, sat down on the right hand of the Majesty on high,

## Hebrews 8:1

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Κεφάλαιον δὲ ἐπὶ τοῖς λεγομένοις, τοιοῦτον ἔχομεν ἀρχιερέα, ὃς ἐκάθισεν ἐν δεξιᾷ τοῦ θρόνου τῆς μεγαλωσύνης ἐν τοῖς οὐρανοῖς,

*English (BSB)*

**1** The point of what we are saying is this: We do have such a high priest, who sat down at the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in heaven,

*English (WEB)*

**1** Now in the things which we are saying, the main point is this: we have such a high priest, who sat down on the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens,

## James 3:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** πολλὰ γὰρ πταίομεν ἅπαντες. εἴ τις ἐν λόγῳ οὐ πταίει, οὗτος τέλειος ἀνήρ, δυνατὸς χαλιναγωγῆσαι καὶ ὅλον τὸ σῶμα.

*English (BSB)*

**2** We all stumble in many ways. If anyone is never at fault in what he says, he is a perfect man, able to control his whole body.

*English (WEB)*

**2** For we all stumble in many things. Anyone who doesn’t stumble in word is a perfect person, able to bridle the whole body also.

## 1 Peter 4:11, 13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** εἴ τις λαλεῖ, ὡς λόγια θεοῦ· εἴ τις διακονεῖ, ὡς ἐξ ἰσχύος ἧς χορηγεῖ ὁ θεός· ἵνα ἐν πᾶσιν δοξάζηται ὁ θεὸς διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ, ᾧ ἐστιν ἡ δόξα καὶ τὸ κράτος εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων· ἀμήν. … **13** ἀλλὰ καθὸ κοινωνεῖτε τοῖς τοῦ Χριστοῦ παθήμασιν χαίρετε, ἵνα καὶ ἐν τῇ ἀποκαλύψει τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ χαρῆτε ἀγαλλιώμενοι.

*English (BSB)*

**11** If anyone speaks, he should speak as one conveying the words of God. If anyone serves, he should serve with the strength God provides, so that in all things God may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom be the glory and the power forever and ever. Amen. … **13** But rejoice that you share in the sufferings of Christ, so that you may be overjoyed at the revelation of His glory.

*English (WEB)*

**11** If anyone speaks, let it be as it were the very words of God. If anyone serves, let it be as of the strength which God supplies, that in all things God may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom belong the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen. … **13** But because you are partakers of Christ's sufferings, rejoice, that at the revelation of his glory you also may rejoice with exceeding joy.

### 1 Peter 5:11

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**11** αὐτῷ τὸ κράτος εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων· ἀμήν.

*English (BSB)*

**11** To Him be the power forever and ever. Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**11** To him be the glory and the power forever and ever. Amen.

### 2 Peter 3:18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**18** αὐξάνετε δὲ ἐν χάριτι καὶ γνώσει τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ σωτῆρος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ. αὐτῷ ἡ δόξα καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς ἡμέραν αἰῶνος. ἀμήν.

*English (BSB)*

**18** But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To Him be the glory both now and to the day of eternity. Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**18** But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To him be the glory both now and forever. Amen.

### Revelation 1:6

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**6** καὶ ἐποίησεν ἡμᾶς βασιλείαν, ἱερεῖς τῷ θεῷ καὶ πατρὶ αὐτοῦ— αὐτῷ ἡ δόξα καὶ τὸ κράτος εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων· ἀμήν.

*English (BSB)*

**6** who has made us to be a kingdom, priests to His God and Father—to Him be the glory and power forever and ever! Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**6** and he made us to be a Kingdom, priests to his God and Father—to him be the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen.

### Revelation 5:13

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**13** καὶ πᾶν κτίσμα ὃ ἐν τῷ οὐρανῷ καὶ ἐπὶ τῆς γῆς καὶ ὑποκάτω τῆς γῆς καὶ ἐπὶ τῆς θαλάσσης, καὶ τὰ ἐν αὐτοῖς πάντα, ἤκουσα λέγοντας· Τῷ καθημένῳ ἐπὶ τῷ θρόνῳ καὶ τῷ ἀρνίῳ ἡ εὐλογία καὶ ἡ τιμὴ καὶ ἡ δόξα καὶ τὸ κράτος εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας τῶν αἰώνων.

*English (BSB)*

**13** And I heard every creature in heaven and on earth and under the earth and in the sea, and all that is in them, saying: “To Him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be praise and honor and glory and power forever and ever!”

*English (WEB)*

**13** I heard every created thing which is in heaven, on the earth, under the earth, on the sea, and everything in them, saying, “To him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be the blessing, the honor, the glory, and the dominion, forever and ever! Amen!”

# Afterword: Reading Jude Whole

We have walked through Jude phrase by phrase, stopping at reefs and clouds, angels and archangels, Enoch and the love feast. It is worth stepping back, as Jude's first hearers would have done when the reading ended, and hearing the letter once more as a single word.

Jude wrote to people he loved about something he loved, "our common salvation." What he found was a community in danger. People had slipped in who spoke impressively, claimed visions, sat at the common table, and taught that grace made holiness unnecessary. Jude did not respond with a treatise. He responded with memory. Remember the people saved from Egypt who did not believe. Remember the angels who left their place and Sodom's fire. Remember Michael, who did not presume to judge even the Devil. Remember Cain, Balaam, and Korah. Remember what Enoch said and what the apostles told you. In each memory, Jude saw the present more clearly. The story of God's people had seen this danger before, and God had not been defeated by it.

Yet the letter does not end in memory, and it certainly does not end in denunciation. It ends with a community building itself up on a most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit, keeping itself in the love of God, and waiting for the mercy of Jesus Christ. It ends with that community reaching out in mercy to the wavering, snatching the endangered from the fire, and showing compassion even where caution is needed. And it ends with praise to the God who is able to keep his people from stumbling and to bring them, faultless and rejoicing, into the presence of his glory.

Three sentences may summarize what Jude asks of every generation that reads him:

**Remember what God has done and said.** The faith was delivered once for all. Its shape is known. Novelty is not the measure of truth.

**Keep yourselves in the love of God.** Faithfulness is not mainly a matter of fighting enemies but of remaining where God's love has placed us, through building up one another, prayer, and hope.

**Show mercy.** Those who contend most earnestly for the faith should be the quickest to reach out to the doubting and the endangered, because they themselves live by mercy.

Around these three sentences stand the two great statements that frame the letter: you have been called, loved, and kept; and God is able to guard you

without stumbling. Between them lies everything else, the danger, the warnings, and the work. Jude’s readers, then and now, are invited to live in the space those two statements define, in confidence that the one who kept them from the beginning will keep them to the end.

To Him be glory. Amen.

# Part Two: Reference

# Appendix A. Significant Textual Variants in Jude

This appendix collects the variation units in Jude that affect translation or interpretation. The manuscripts come first: section A of each chapter shows, verse by verse, what ten of the earliest and most important Greek manuscripts read, checked against the transcriptions of the INTF New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room (CC BY 4.0). This appendix draws those readings together. For each unit it also gives the reading of the SBL Greek New Testament (SBLGNT), the Nestle–Aland 28th edition (NA28), the Robinson–Pierpont Byzantine text (RP), and the Textus Receptus (TR), and it shows how each of the eighteen free English translations reads it.[176] Approximate manuscript percentages, where given, come from the Text-Critical Greek New Testament notes. They count manuscripts without weighing them and are included only to show how a reading is distributed.

**How to read the tables.** “+” means “adds,” and “–” means “omits.” “Byz” refers to the Byzantine majority text.

## A.1 Summary table

| v. | SBLGNT | NA28 | RP (Byzantine) | TR | Significance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | ἠγαπημένοις “loved” | same | ἡγιασμένοις “sanctified” | ἡγιασμένοις | Moderate: affects the letter’s love theme |
| 3 | κοινῆς ἡμῶν σωτηρίας “our common salvation” | same | – ἡμῶν | – ἡμῶν | Minor |
| 4 | δεσπότην “Master” | same | + θεόν “God” | + θεόν | Moderate: older English Bibles read two persons |
| 5 | εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ πάντα ὅτι Ἰησοῦς | same (NA27: … ὅτι ὁ κύριος ἅπαξ …) | ἅπαξ τοῦτο ὅτι ὁ κύριος | same as RP | **Major**: Christology |
| 7 | τρόπον τούτοις | same | τούτοις τρόπον | same as RP | Word order only |

| v. | SBLGNT | NA28 | RP (Byzantine) | TR | Significance |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | οἱ ἐν ταῖς ἀγάπαις | same | – οἱ | – οἱ | Minor (grammar of σπιλάδες) |
| 12 | παραφερόμεναι “carried away” | same | same | περιφερόμεναι “carried about” | Minor |
| 13 | εἰς αἰῶνα | same | same | εἰς τὸν αἰῶνα | None in meaning |
| 15 | πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς “all the impious” | πᾶσαν ψυχήν “every soul” | + αὐτῶν “their” | + αὐτῶν; ἐξελέγξαι | Moderate: relation to 1 Enoch 1:9 |
| 16 | αὐτῶν | ἑαυτῶν | αὐτῶν | αὐτῶν | None in meaning |
| 18 | ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου | same (NA27 adds τοῦ) | ἐν ἐσχάτῳ χρόνῳ; + ὅτι | same as RP | None in meaning |
| 19 | οἱ ἀποδιορίζοντες | same | same | + ἑαυτούς “themselves” | Moderate: “separate themselves” (WBS) vs. “cause divisions” |
| 20 | word order | same | different order | same as RP | None in meaning |
| 22–23 | three clauses, ἐλεᾶτε … σῴζετε … ἐλεᾶτε | same | two clauses, ἐλεεῖτε διακρινόμενοι … ἐν φόβῳ σῴζετε | same as RP | **Major**: number of groups; mercy vs. rebuke |
| 24 | ὑμᾶς “you” | same | αὐτούς “them” | ὑμᾶς | Minor |
| 25 | μόνῳ θεῷ “only God” | same | + σοφῷ “wise” | + σοφῷ | Minor: assimilation to Rom 16:27 |
| 25 | διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν | same | – | – | Moderate: glory “through Jesus Christ” |
| 25 | πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος “before all time” | same | – | – | Moderate: glory before time |

176. Manuscript readings: INTF, New Testament Virtual Manuscript Room, transcriptions of P72, P78, 01, 02, 03, 04, 018, 020, 044, and 1739 (CC BY 4.0), https://ntvmr.uni-muenster.de/, checked by `tools/make_texts.py`. Editions: SBLGNT apparatus, https://www.sblgnt.com/download/86-Jud-APP.txt; eBible.org SBLGNT edition (files dated 30 October 2026) with NA28 notes; Robinson–Pierpont 2018 and the Textus Receptus (eBible.org); Text-Critical Greek NT notes (eBible.org `grctcgnt`). ↩

## A.2 How the eighteen translations read the major variants

Each translation follows a particular form of the Greek (or, for the Douay-Rheims, the Latin Vulgate). The table shows how each one reads the variants that change the English. It is generated from the translations themselves by `tools/make_texts.py`. A dash means the translation does not have the word or phrase.

| Translation | v. 1 | v. 4: “God” | v. 5 | v. 15: “their” / “among them” | v. 19 | vv. 22–23: groups | v. 25: “wise” | v. 25: “through Jesus Christ .. before all time” |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| TNT (1534) | sanctified | yes | the Lord | yes | cause divisions | two | yes | — |
| GNV (1560; 1599 ed.) | sanctified | yes | the Lord | yes | separate themselves | two | yes | — |
| DRA (1582; 1899 ed.) | loved | — | Jesus | — | separate themselves | three | — | yes |
| WBS (1833) | sanctified | yes | the Lord | yes | separate themselves | two | yes | — |
| NOY (1869) | loved | — | the Lord | yes | separate themselves | three | — | yes |
| RV (1881) | loved | — | the Lord | — | cause divisions | three | — | yes |
| DBY (1890) | loved | — | the Lord | — | set [themselves] apart (word supplied) | two | — | yes |
| YLT (1898) | sanctified | yes | the Lord | yes | separate themselves | two | yes | — |
| ASV (1901) | loved | — | the Lord | — | cause divisions | three | — | yes |
| WEB (2000; 2020 ed.) | sanctified | yes | the Lord | — | cause divisions | two | yes | — |

| Translation | v. 1 | v. 4: “God” | v. 5 | v. 15: “their” / “among them” | v. 19 | vv. 22–23: groups | v. 25: “wise” | v. 25: “through Jesus Christ .. before all time” |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| T4T (2008–2017) | loved | — | the Lord | — | cause divisions | three | — | yes |
| OEB (2010) | loved | — | the Lord | — | cause divisions | two | — | yes |
| ULB (2017) | loved | — | the Lord | — | cause divisions | three | — | yes |
| FBV (2018) | loved | — | the Lord | — | cause divisions | three | — | yes |
| LSV (2020) | loved | — | Jesus | yes | cause divisions | three | yes | — |
| BSB (2022) | loved | — | Jesus | — | cause divisions | three | — | yes |
| MSB (2022) | sanctified | yes | the Lord | yes | cause divisions | two | yes | — |
| TCENT (2022) | sanctified | yes | the Lord | yes | cause divisions | two | yes | — |

Reading across the rows shows the textual families. Tyndale, the Geneva Bible, Webster, and Young’s Literal Translation follow the Textus Receptus. The World English Bible, the Majority Standard Bible, and the Text-Critical English New Testament follow the Byzantine Majority Text. The Revised Version, Darby, the American Standard Version, the Translation for Translators, the Open English Bible, the Unlocked Literal Bible, the Free Bible Version, and the Berean Standard Bible follow critical texts, and Noyes mostly does. The Douay-Rheims follows the Latin Vulgate, which is why it reads “Jesus” in v. 5 and “reprove” in v. 22. The Literal Standard Version mixes readings from both traditions (see A.4).

## A.3 Notes on the major units, with the manuscript evidence

**Jude 1: “loved” or “sanctified.”** ἠγαπημένοις, “loved,” is the reading of P72, ℵ, A, B, Ψ, and 1739; ἡγιασμένοις, “sanctified,” is the reading of K and L and of about 90% of all manuscripts. The critical editions all read “loved,” judging it the earlier and harder reading. “Sanctified in God the Father” looks like a scribal improvement of the unusual “loved in God the Father,” perhaps influenced by 1 Cor 1:2. See Chapter 1.

**Jude 4: “only Master [God] and Lord.”** The added θεόν, “God,” is absent from P72, P78, ℵ, A, B, C, and 1739, and present in the later manuscripts Ψ, K, and L. It appears in the Byzantine tradition and produced the traditional English rendering “denying the only Lord God, and our Lord Jesus Christ” (WBS). Since a single article governs the nouns, even the longer text most naturally refers all the titles to Jesus, as the WEB’s rendering of the Majority Text shows: “our only Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ.” See Chapter 2.

**Jude 5: “Jesus” or “the Lord.”** This is the most discussed variant in the letter. “Jesus” (written ΙΣ) is read by A, B, and 1739. “The Lord” (ΚΣ) is read by ℵ, the first hand of C, Ψ, K, and L, and by most later manuscripts; a corrector of C changed it to “God.” The early papyrus P72 has “God Christ.” The editors of NA28 adopted “Jesus,” reversing NA27, and the SBLGNT reads it too. The placement of “once” also varies. See the deep dive in Chapter 3.

**Jude 15: “all the impious” or “every soul.”** “Every soul” (πᾶσαν ψυχήν), the reading of NA28, is found in P72 and ℵ, and corresponds to 1 Enoch 1:9’s “all flesh” (Charles). “All the impious” (πάντας τοὺς ἀσεβεῖς), the reading of SBLGNT, is found in A, B, C, and Ψ, and matches Jude’s emphasis on “impious”; 1739 has “all impious people.” K and L add “their,” as the Byzantine text does. See Chapter 8.

**Jude 19: “who cause divisions” or “who separate themselves.”** The TR’s added ἑαυτούς creates the traditional English rendering “These are they who separate themselves” (WBS), suggesting withdrawal. Among the manuscripts checked, only C and a corrector of 1739 have it. The critical and Byzantine texts lack it, which gives “these are the ones who cause divisions.” See Chapter 10.

**Jude 22–23: two groups or three?** The manuscripts preserve at least six forms. ℵ and Ψ have three clauses (mercy, rescue, mercy with fear), as do the SBLGNT and NA28. A and 1739 also have three clauses but begin with “refute” (ἐλέγχετε) instead of “show mercy,” as do Tregelles and the Tyndale House Greek New Testament (as reported). B has two clauses, “have mercy on some who doubt, saving them by snatching them from fire; have mercy on others with fear,” the form printed by Westcott and Hort. C has two clauses beginning with “refute.” K and L have the two-clause Byzantine form, and P72 has a short two-clause form of its own (“snatch some from fire; on those who dispute have mercy with fear”). Clement of Alexandria’s paraphrase suggests a two-part text. See the deep dive in Chapter 12.

**Jude 25: the shape of the doxology.** “Through Jesus Christ our Lord” is present in every manuscript checked except K. “Before all time” is present in ℵ, A, B, C, Ψ, L, and 1739 (1739 without the article) and absent from P72 and K. Both phrases are absent from the Byzantine text and the TR, and so from

the LSV and the other translations that follow them (see A.2). “Wise,” found here in K and L, is probably borrowed from Rom 16:27. See Chapter 13.

## A.4 What the variants show about the LSV

The LSV states in its preface that its New Testament is based on the Textus Receptus and the Majority Text, departing from them “in certain, specific instances … where the evidence seems incontrovertible.”[177] Jude illustrates this policy well. In vv. 1, 3, 4, 5, and 22–23 the LSV adopts readings of the critical editions against the Byzantine majority. In vv. 15 and 25 it keeps the Byzantine readings. Readers of this book should therefore keep in mind that the LSV’s English does not always correspond to a single printed Greek edition. The commentary notes every place where that matters.

177. LSV preface, https://www.lsvbible.com/p/the-preface-to-literal-standard-version.html (accessed 7 November 2026).↩

## A.5 How significant are these variants?

None of Jude’s variants affects any central Christian doctrine. Several affect how particular verses are read: whether Jesus is named as Israel’s deliverer (v. 5), how many groups the readers are to help (vv. 22–23), and whether glory is ascribed to God “through Jesus Christ” and ‘before all time’ (v. 25). Honest reading includes knowing where the text is uncertain, and good textual scholarship lets readers see how much of the text is secure. For Jude, by any measure, almost all of it is.

## Texts Highlighted in This Appendix

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this appendix is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Romans 16:27

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

*English (BSB)*

**27** to the only wise God be glory forever through Jesus Christ! Amen.

*English (WEB)*

## 1 Corinthians 1:2

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** τῇ ἐκκλησίᾳ τοῦ θεοῦ, ἡγιασμένοις ἐν Χριστῷ Ἰησοῦ, τῇ οὔσῃ ἐν Κορίνθῳ, κλητοῖς ἁγίοις, σὺν πᾶσιν τοῖς ἐπικαλουμένοις τὸ ὄνομα τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ ἐν παντὶ τόπῳ αὐτῶν καὶ ἡμῶν·

*English (BSB)*

**2** To the church of God in Corinth, to those sanctified in Christ Jesus and called to be holy, together with all those everywhere who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, their Lord and ours:

*English (WEB)*

**2** to the assembly of God which is at Corinth—those who are sanctified in Christ Jesus, called saints, with all who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ in every place, both theirs and ours:

## 1 Enoch 1:9

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**9** And behold! He cometh with ten thousands of His holy ones To execute judgement upon all, And to destroy all the ungodly: And to convict all flesh Of all the works of their ungodliness which they have ungodly committed, And of all the hard things which ungodly sinners have spoken against Him.

# Appendix B. Disputed Interpretations at a Glance

This appendix summarizes the main interpretive questions discussed in the commentary. For each one it lists the principal options and the position this book takes, with the chapter where the evidence is discussed. “Preferred” means the reading this book judges most probable. It does not mean the other options lack merit.

| v. | Question | Options | This book | Chapter |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Who is the author? | (a) Jude, brother of Jesus and James; (b) a later writer using his name; (c) an associate writing for him | (a) a responsible conclusion; not treated as proven | Intro §1 |
| 1 | “Kept … Jesus Christ” | kept *for* / *by* / *in* Jesus Christ | “for” most natural; all three possible | 1 |
| 3 | What is “the faith”? | the content of the gospel and its moral shape; personal trust | content (with its moral shape) | 2 |
| 4 | “Written beforehand” | (a) in earlier prophecies; (b) in heavenly books; (c) predestined individually | (a) | 2 |
| 4 | “Only Master and Lord” | both titles of Jesus; or (TR) God and Jesus | both of Jesus | 2 |
| 5 | Who saved the people from Egypt? | Jesus; the Lord; God | Jesus (textual and theological discussion) | 3 |
| 6 | Which angels? | (a) Watchers of Gen 6 / 1 Enoch; (b) primordial fall of Satan; (c) Sethite reading of Gen 6 | (a) | 3 |
| 7 | Antecedent of “these” | the angels; the intruders | the angels | 3 |
| 7 | “Other flesh” | (a) angelic flesh; (b) same-sex relations; (c) sexual immorality generally | (a) primary; general immorality also condemned | 3 |

| v. | Question | Options | This book | Chapter |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | “Dreaming” | claimed revelations; moral fantasy; delusion | claimed revelations (Deut 13) | 4 |
| 8 | “Lordship” | the Lord’s authority; angelic powers; church leaders | the Lord’s authority | 4 |
| 8 | “Glorious [ones]” | angels (good or evil); human leaders | angels | 4 |
| 9 | Source of the Michael story | lost ending of the *Testament/Assumption of Moses*; oral tradition | the Moses literature (with uncertainty) | 4 |
| 9 | “A judgment of slander” | (a) a slanderous judgment; (b) a condemnation for slander | both presented; same lesson | 4 |
| 11 | Which aspect of Cain? | hatred/murder; corrupting others; denial of judgment | open; possibly all | 5 |
| 11 | “They perished” | prophetic aorist; fate already sealed | prophetic certainty | 5 |
| 12 | σπιλάδες | hidden reefs; stains/spots; deliberate double sense | reefs (stains possible) | 6 |
| 12 | Love feast and Lord’s Supper | one event; distinct events | probably not yet separated in Jude’s time | 6 |
| 12 | “Twice dead” | fruitless and uprooted; present and second death; sin and judgment | open; complementary | 6 |
| 12–13 | Source of the nature images | 1 Enoch 2–5 and 80; general biblical imagery | probably 1 Enoch | 7 |
| 13 | “Wandering stars” | planets; meteors; stars as fallen angels | stars as rebellious heavenly beings (with “planets”) | 7 |
| 14–15 | Status of 1 Enoch for Jude | (a) Scripture; (b) a genuine prophecy within a non-canonical book; (c) a respected text quoted for a true statement | open; principles for weighing the options given | 8 |

| v. | Question | Options | This book | Chapter |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | “The Lord” | God (as in 1 Enoch); Jesus | Jesus, in Jude’s application | 8 |
| 16 | Whom did they flatter? | wealthy hosts; potential followers; leaders | unknown | 9 |
| 17 | Does v. 17 imply a late date? | yes; no (apostles spoke “to you”) | not necessarily | 10 |
| 19 | ἀποδιορίζοντες | cause divisions; make distinctions; separate themselves (TR) | cause divisions / make distinctions | 10 |
| 19 | ψυχικοί | the opponents’ own term turned back; Jude’s own term | possibly ironic; uncertain | 10 |
| 20 | “Praying in the Holy Spirit” | Spirit-led prayer generally; charismatic prayer; prayer in the sphere of the Spirit | Spirit-led prayer (others compatible) | 11 |
| 21 | “The love of God” | God’s love for us; our love for God | God’s love (primary) | 11 |
| 22 | διακρινομένους | doubting/wavering; disputing | wavering | 12 |
| 22–23 | Two groups or three? | three-clause text; two-clause forms | three (with uncertainty) | 12 |
| 25 | Supplied verb | “is” (declaration); “be” (wish) | both senses present | 13 |

## Texts Highlighted in This Appendix

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this appendix is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in R. H. Charles’s translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

### Genesis 6

Printed in full in Chapter 3: see Genesis 6.

### Deuteronomy 13

Printed in full in Chapter 4: see Deuteronomy 13.

## 1 Enoch 2

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** Observe ye everything that takes place in the heaven, how they do not change their orbits, and the luminaries which are in the heaven, how they all rise and set in order each in its season, and transgress not against their appointed order. **2** Behold ye the earth, and give heed to the things which take place upon it from first to last, how steadfast they are, how none of the things upon earth change, but all the works of God appear to you. **3** Behold the summer and the winter, how the whole earth is filled with water, and clouds and dew and rain lie upon it.

## 1 Enoch 3

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** Observe and see how (in the winter) all the trees seem as though they had withered and shed all their leaves, except fourteen trees, which do not lose their foliage but retain the old foliage from two to three years till the new comes.

## 1 Enoch 4

*R. H. Charles, The Book of Enoch (1917), public domain*

**1** And again, observe ye the days of summer how the sun is above the earth over against it. And you seek shade and shelter by reason of the heat of the sun, and the earth also burns with growing heat, and so you cannot tread on the earth, or on a rock by reason of its heat.

## 1 Enoch 5

Printed in full in Chapter 7: see 1 Enoch 5.

# Appendix C. Jude and 2 Peter: The Parallel Passages

This appendix sets the parallel passages side by side, first in the Greek of the SBL Greek New Testament and then in two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). The texts are generated directly from the source files by `tools/make_parallels.py`, so they are exact. Each verse of Jude is also given in eighteen free translations in section A of its chapter. For discussion of the relationship between the two letters, see the Historical and Literary Introduction, §8.

**Summary of the evidence.** The two letters share a sequence of themes, images, and rare words. Three Greek words occur in the New Testament only in these two letters: συνευωχέομαι (“feast together”), ὑπέρογκος (“swollen”), and ἐμπαίκτης (“scoffer”).[178] Jude contains material not found in 2 Peter: the quotation of Enoch (vv. 14–15), the named dispute of Michael and the Devil over Moses’ body (v. 9), Cain and Korah (v. 11), the wild waves and wandering stars (v. 13), and the closing exhortations to mercy (vv. 20–23). 2 Peter adds the flood and Noah (2:5), Lot (2:7–8), Balaam’s donkey (2:16), and the scoffers’ question about Christ’s coming (3:4).

## Jude 2 ‖ 2 Pet 1:2

> **2** ἔλεος ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη καὶ ἀγάπη πληθυνθείη.
>
> — Jude 2, SBLGNT

> **1:2** χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν.
>
> — 2 Pet 1:2, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **2** Mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you.
2 Peter: **1:2** Grace and peace be multiplied to you through the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord.

*WEB.* Jude: **2** May mercy, peace, and love be multiplied to you.
2 Peter: **1:2** Grace to you and peace be multiplied in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord,

*Observation:* Same wish formula, πληθυνθείη (“may it be multiplied”). Jude’s triad (mercy, peace, love) differs from 2 Peter’s pair (grace, peace).

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178. Computed from MorphGNT/SBLGNT lemmas; see `research/data-notes.md`.↩

## Jude 4 ‖ 2 Pet 2:1–3

> **4** παρεισέδυσαν γάρ τινες ἄνθρωποι, οἱ πάλαι προγεγραμμένοι εἰς τοῦτο τὸ κρίμα, ἀσεβεῖς, τὴν τοῦ θεοῦ ἡμῶν χάριτα μετατιθέντες εἰς ἀσέλγειαν καὶ τὸν μόνον δεσπότην καὶ κύριον ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦν Χριστὸν ἀρνούμενοι.
>
> — Jude 4, SBLGNT

> **2:1** Ἐγένοντο δὲ καὶ ψευδοπροφῆται ἐν τῷ λαῷ, ὡς καὶ ἐν ὑμῖν ἔσονται ψευδοδιδάσκαλοι, οἵτινες παρεισάξουσιν αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας, καὶ τὸν ἀγοράσαντα αὐτοὺς δεσπότην ἀρνούμενοι, ἐπάγοντες ἑαυτοῖς ταχινὴν ἀπώλειαν· **2:2** καὶ πολλοὶ ἐξακολουθήσουσιν αὐτῶν ταῖς ἀσελγείαις, δι’ οὓς ἡ ὁδὸς τῆς ἀληθείας βλασφημηθήσεται· **2:3** καὶ ἐν πλεονεξίᾳ πλαστοῖς λόγοις ὑμᾶς ἐμπορεύσονται· οἷς τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ, καὶ ἡ ἀπώλεια αὐτῶν οὐ νυστάζει.
>
> — 2 Pet 2:1–3, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **4** For certain men have crept in among you unnoticed—ungodly ones who were designated long ago for condemnation. They turn the grace of our God into a license for immorality, and they deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ.
2 Peter: **2:1** Now there were also false prophets among the people, just as there will be false teachers among you. They will secretly introduce destructive heresies, even denying the Master who bought them—bringing swift destruction on themselves. **2:2** Many will follow in their depravity, and because of them the way of truth will be defamed. **2:3** In their greed, these false teachers will exploit you with deceptive words. The longstanding verdict against them remains in force, and their destruction does not sleep.

*WEB.* Jude: **4** For there are certain men who crept in secretly, even those who were long ago written about for this condemnation: ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into indecency, and denying our only Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ.
2 Peter: **2:1** But false prophets also arose among the people, as false teachers will also be among you, who will secretly bring in destructive heresies, denying even the Master who bought them, bringing on themselves swift destruction. **2:2** Many will follow their immoral ways, and as a result, the way of the truth will be maligned. **2:3** In covetousness they will exploit you with deceptive words: whose sentence now from of old doesn’t linger, and their destruction will not slumber.

*Observation:* Intruders: Jude's παρεισέδυσαν ("they slipped in") and 2 Peter's παρεισάξουσιν ("they will secretly bring in"). Both deny the Master (δεσπότης). Jude speaks of the past, 2 Peter of the future.

## Jude 5 ‖ 2 Pet 1:12

> **5** Ὑπομνῆσαι δὲ ὑμᾶς βούλομαι, εἰδότας ὑμᾶς ἅπαξ πάντα, ὅτι Ἰησοῦς λαὸν ἐκ γῆς Αἰγύπτου σώσας τὸ δεύτερον τοὺς μὴ πιστεύσαντας ἀπώλεσεν,
>
> — Jude 5, SBLGNT

> **1:12** Διὸ μελλήσω ἀεὶ ὑμᾶς ὑπομιμνῄσκειν περὶ τούτων, καίπερ εἰδότας καὶ ἐστηριγμένους ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ἀληθείᾳ.
>
> — 2 Pet 1:12, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **5** Although you are fully aware of this, I want to remind you that after Jesus had delivered His people out of the land of Egypt, He destroyed those who did not believe.
2 Peter: **1:12** Therefore I will always remind you of these things, even though you know them and are established in the truth you now have.

*WEB.* Jude: **5** Now I desire to remind you, though you already know this, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, afterward destroyed those who didn't believe.
2 Peter: **1:12** Therefore I will not be negligent to remind you of these things, though you know them and are established in the present truth.

*Observation:* Both remind readers of what they already know.

## Jude 6 ‖ 2 Pet 2:4

> **6** ἀγγέλους τε τοὺς μὴ τηρήσαντας τὴν ἑαυτῶν ἀρχὴν ἀλλὰ ἀπολιπόντας τὸ ἴδιον οἰκητήριον εἰς κρίσιν μεγάλης ἡμέρας δεσμοῖς ἀϊδίοις ὑπὸ ζόφον τετήρηκεν·
>
> — Jude 6, SBLGNT

> **2:4** Εἰ γὰρ ὁ θεὸς ἀγγέλων ἁμαρτησάντων οὐκ ἐφείσατο, ἀλλὰ σειραῖς ζόφου ταρταρώσας παρέδωκεν εἰς κρίσιν τηρουμένους,
>
> — 2 Pet 2:4, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **6** And the angels who did not stay within their own domain but abandoned their proper dwelling—these He has kept in eternal chains under darkness, bound for judgment on that great day.

2 Peter: **2:4** For if God did not spare the angels when they sinned, but cast them deep into hell, placing them in chains of darkness to be held for judgment;

*WEB.* Jude: **6** Angels who didn’t keep their first domain, but deserted their own dwelling place, he has kept in everlasting bonds under darkness for the judgment of the great day.
2 Peter: **2:4** For if God didn’t spare angels when they sinned, but cast them down to Tartarus, and committed them to pits of darkness to be reserved for judgment;

*Observation:* Sinning angels kept (τετήρηκεν; τηρουμένους) in gloom (ζόφος) for judgment. 2 Peter adds ταρταρώσας, “casting into Tartarus.”

## Jude 7 ‖ 2 Pet 2:6–8

> **7** ὡς Σόδομα καὶ Γόμορρα καὶ αἱ περὶ αὐτὰς πόλεις, τὸν ὅμοιον τρόπον τούτοις ἐκπορνεύσασαι καὶ ἀπελθοῦσαι ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἑτέρας, πρόκεινται δεῖγμα πυρὸς αἰωνίου δίκην ὑπέχουσαι.
>
> — Jude 7, SBLGNT

> **2:6** καὶ πόλεις Σοδόμων καὶ Γομόρρας τεφρώσας καταστροφῇ κατέκρινεν, ὑπόδειγμα μελλόντων ἀσεβέσιν τεθεικώς, **2:7** καὶ δίκαιον Λὼτ καταπονούμενον ὑπὸ τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων ἐν ἀσελγείᾳ ἀναστροφῆς ἐρρύσατο— **2:8** βλέμματι γὰρ καὶ ἀκοῇ ὁ δίκαιος ἐγκατοικῶν ἐν αὐτοῖς ἡμέραν ἐξ ἡμέρας ψυχὴν δικαίαν ἀνόμοις ἔργοις ἐβασάνιζεν—
>
> — 2 Pet 2:6–8, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **7** In like manner, Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, who indulged in sexual immorality and pursued strange flesh, are on display as an example of those who sustain the punishment of eternal fire.
2 Peter: **2:6** if He condemned the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah to destruction, reducing them to ashes as an example of what is coming on the ungodly; **2:7** and if He rescued Lot, a righteous man distressed by the depraved conduct of the lawless **2:8** (for that righteous man, living among them day after day, was tormented in his righteous soul by the lawless deeds he saw and heard)—

*WEB.* Jude: **7** Even as Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, having in the same way as these given themselves over to sexual immorality and gone after strange flesh, are shown as an example, suffering the punishment of eternal fire.
2 Peter: **2:6** and turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah into ashes, condemned them to destruction, having made them an example to those who

would live in an ungodly way, **2:7** and delivered righteous Lot, who was very distressed by the lustful life of the wicked **2:8** (for that righteous man dwelling among them was tormented in his righteous soul from day to day with seeing and hearing lawless deeds),

*Observation:* Sodom and Gomorrah as example. 2 Peter adds the rescue of Lot and inserts the flood (2:5) to make a biblical sequence.

## Jude 8 ‖ 2 Pet 2:10

> **8** Ὁμοίως μέντοι καὶ οὗτοι ἐνυπνιαζόμενοι σάρκα μὲν μιαίνουσιν, κυριότητα δὲ ἀθετοῦσιν, δόξας δὲ βλασφημοῦσιν.
>
> — Jude 8, SBLGNT

> **2:10** μάλιστα δὲ τοὺς ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ μιασμοῦ πορευομένους καὶ κυριότητος καταφρονοῦντας. Τολμηταί, αὐθάδεις, δόξας οὐ τρέμουσιν, βλασφημοῦντες,
>
> — 2 Pet 2:10, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **8** Yet in the same way these dreamers defile their bodies, reject authority, and slander glorious beings.
2 Peter: **2:10** Such punishment is specially reserved for those who indulge the corrupt desires of the flesh and despise authority. Bold and self-willed, they are unafraid to slander glorious beings.

*WEB.* Jude: **8** Yet in the same way, these also in their dreaming defile the flesh, despise authority, and slander celestial beings.
2 Peter: **2:10** but chiefly those who walk after the flesh in the lust of defilement and despise authority. Daring, self-willed, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignitaries,

*Observation:* Defiling the flesh, despising lordship (κυριότης), slandering the “glorious ones” (δόξαι).

## Jude 9 ‖ 2 Pet 2:11

> **9** ὁ δὲ Μιχαὴλ ὁ ἀρχάγγελος, ὅτε τῷ διαβόλῳ διακρινόμενος διελέγετο περὶ τοῦ Μωϋσέως σώματος, οὐκ ἐτόλμησεν κρίσιν ἐπενεγκεῖν βλασφημίας, ἀλλὰ εἶπεν· Ἐπιτιμήσαι σοι κύριος.
>
> — Jude 9, SBLGNT

> **2:11** ὅπου ἄγγελοι ἰσχύϊ καὶ δυνάμει μείζονες ὄντες οὐ φέρουσιν κατ’ αὐτῶν βλάσφημον κρίσιν.

> — 2 Pet 2:11, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **9** But even the archangel Michael, when he disputed with the devil over the body of Moses, did not presume to bring a slanderous charge against him, but said, “The Lord rebuke you!”
2 Peter: **2:11** Yet not even angels, though greater in strength and power, dare to bring such slanderous charges against them before the Lord.

*WEB.* Jude: **9** But Michael, the archangel, when contending with the devil and arguing about the body of Moses, dared not bring against him an abusive condemnation, but said, “May the Lord rebuke you!”
2 Peter: **2:11** whereas angels, though greater in might and power, don’t bring a slanderous judgment against them before the Lord.

*Observation:* Angels do not bring a slanderous judgment. 2 Peter omits Michael, the Devil, and Moses.

## Jude 10 ‖ 2 Pet 2:12

> **10** οὗτοι δὲ ὅσα μὲν οὐκ οἴδασιν βλασφημοῦσιν, ὅσα δὲ φυσικῶς ὡς τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα ἐπίστανται, ἐν τούτοις φθείρονται.
>
> — Jude 10, SBLGNT

> **2:12** οὗτοι δέ, ὡς ἄλογα ζῷα γεγεννημένα φυσικὰ εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν, ἐν οἷς ἀγνοοῦσιν βλασφημοῦντες, ἐν τῇ φθορᾷ αὐτῶν καὶ φθαρήσονται,
>
> — 2 Pet 2:12, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **10** These men, however, slander what they do not understand, and like irrational animals, they will be destroyed by the things they do instinctively.
2 Peter: **2:12** These men are like irrational animals, creatures of instinct, born to be captured and destroyed. They blaspheme in matters they do not understand, and like such creatures, they too will be destroyed.

*WEB.* Jude: **10** But these speak evil of whatever things they don’t know. They are destroyed in these things that they understand naturally, like the creatures without reason.
2 Peter: **2:12** But these, as unreasoning creatures, born natural animals to be taken and destroyed, speaking evil in matters about which they are ignorant, will in their destroying surely be destroyed,

*Observation:* Slandering what they do not know; irrational beasts; destruction.

## Jude 11 ‖ 2 Pet 2:15–16

> **11** οὐαὶ αὐτοῖς, ὅτι τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Κάϊν ἐπορεύθησαν, καὶ τῇ πλάνῃ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ μισθοῦ ἐξεχύθησαν, καὶ τῇ ἀντιλογίᾳ τοῦ Κόρε ἀπώλοντο.
>
> — Jude 11, SBLGNT

> **2:15** καταλιπόντες εὐθεῖαν ὁδὸν ἐπλανήθησαν, ἐξακολουθήσαντες τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ ὃς μισθὸν ἀδικίας ἠγάπησεν **2:16** ἔλεγξιν δὲ ἔσχεν ἰδίας παρανομίας· ὑποζύγιον ἄφωνον ἐν ἀνθρώπου φωνῇ φθεγξάμενον ἐκώλυσεν τὴν τοῦ προφήτου παραφρονίαν.
>
> — 2 Pet 2:15–16, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **11** Woe to them! They have traveled the path of Cain; they have rushed headlong into the error of Balaam; they have perished in Korah’s rebellion.
2 Peter: **2:15** They have left the straight way and wandered off to follow the way of Balaam son of Beor, who loved the wages of wickedness. **2:16** But he was rebuked for his transgression by a donkey, otherwise without speech, that spoke with a man’s voice and restrained the prophet’s madness.

*WEB.* Jude: **11** Woe to them! For they went in the way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error of Balaam for hire, and perished in Korah’s rebellion.
2 Peter: **2:15** Forsaking the right way, they went astray, having followed the way of Balaam the son of Beor, who loved the wages of wrongdoing; **2:16** but he was rebuked for his own disobedience. A speechless donkey spoke with a man’s voice and stopped the madness of the prophet.

*Observation:* Balaam and his reward. 2 Peter omits Cain and Korah and adds the donkey.

## Jude 12 ‖ 2 Pet 2:13; 2 Pet 2:17

> **12** οὗτοί εἰσιν οἱ ἐν ταῖς ἀγάπαις ὑμῶν σπιλάδες συνευωχούμενοι, ἀφόβως ἑαυτοὺς ποιμαίνοντες, νεφέλαι ἄνυδροι ὑπὸ ἀνέμων παραφερόμεναι, δένδρα φθινοπωρινὰ ἄκαρπα δὶς ἀποθανόντα ἐκριζωθέντα,
>
> — Jude 12, SBLGNT

> **2:13** ἀδικούμενοι μισθὸν ἀδικίας· ἡδονὴν ἡγούμενοι τὴν ἐν ἡμέρᾳ τρυφήν, σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι ἐντρυφῶντες ἐν ταῖς ἀπάταις αὐτῶν συνευωχούμενοι ὑμῖν, … **2:17** Οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται.
>
> — 2 Pet 2:13; 2 Pet 2:17, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **12** These men are hidden reefs in your love feasts, shamelessly feasting with you but shepherding only themselves. They are clouds without water, carried along by the wind; fruitless trees in autumn, twice dead after being uprooted.
2 Peter: **2:13** The harm they will suffer is the wages of their wickedness. They consider it a pleasure to carouse in broad daylight. They are blots and blemishes, reveling in their deception as they feast with you. … **2:17** These men are springs without water and mists driven by a storm. Blackest darkness is reserved for them.

*WEB.* Jude: **12** These are hidden rocky reefs in your love feasts when they feast with you, shepherds who without fear feed themselves; clouds without water, carried along by winds; autumn trees without fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots;
2 Peter: **2:13** receiving the wages of unrighteousness; people who count it pleasure to revel in the daytime, spots and defects, reveling in their deceit while they feast with you; … **2:17** These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

*Observation:* Both use συνευωχούμενοι (“feasting together”), found in the NT only in these two passages. Jude’s σπιλάδες (“reefs” or “stains”) stands against 2 Peter’s σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι (“spots and blemishes”), and Jude’s ἀγάπαις (“love feasts”) against ἀπάταις (“deceptions”) in the critical text of 2 Peter, words that differ by two letters. Jude’s waterless clouds become in 2 Peter “springs without water and mists driven by a storm.”

## Jude 13 ‖ 2 Pet 2:17

> **13** κύματα ἄγρια θαλάσσης ἐπαφρίζοντα τὰς ἑαυτῶν αἰσχύνας, ἀστέρες πλανῆται οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους εἰς αἰῶνα τετήρηται.
>
> — Jude 13, SBLGNT

> **2:17** Οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται.
>
> — 2 Pet 2:17, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **13** They are wild waves of the sea, foaming up their own shame; wandering stars, for whom blackest darkness has been reserved forever.
2 Peter: **2:17** These men are springs without water and mists driven by a storm. Blackest darkness is reserved for them.

*WEB.* Jude: **13** wild waves of the sea, foaming out their own shame; wandering stars, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

2 Peter: **2:17** These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.

*Observation:* The phrase ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους … τετήρηται (“the gloom of darkness has been kept”) is applied in 2 Peter to the springs and mists.

## Jude 16 ‖ 2 Pet 2:18

> **16** οὗτοί εἰσιν γογγυσταί, μεμψίμοιροι, κατὰ τὰς ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι, καὶ τὸ στόμα αὐτῶν λαλεῖ ὑπέρογκα, θαυμάζοντες πρόσωπα ὠφελείας χάριν.
>
> — Jude 16, SBLGNT

> **2:18** ὑπέρογκα γὰρ ματαιότητος φθεγγόμενοι δελεάζουσιν ἐν ἐπιθυμίαις σαρκὸς ἀσελγείαις τοὺς ὀλίγως ἀποφεύγοντας τοὺς ἐν πλάνῃ ἀναστρεφομένους,
>
> — 2 Pet 2:18, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **16** These men are discontented grumblers, following after their own lusts; their mouths spew arrogance; they flatter others for their own advantage.
2 Peter: **2:18** With lofty but empty words, they appeal to the sensual passions of the flesh and entice those who are just escaping from others who live in error.

*WEB.* Jude: **16** These are murmurers and complainers, walking after their lusts—and their mouth speaks proud things—showing respect of persons to gain advantage.
2 Peter: **2:18** For, uttering great swelling words of emptiness, they entice in the lusts of the flesh, by licentiousness, those who are indeed escaping from those who live in error;

*Observation:* ὑπέρογκα, “swollen” or “inflated” words, found in the NT only in these two passages.

## Jude 17–18 ‖ 2 Pet 3:1–3

> **17** Ὑμεῖς δέ, ἀγαπητοί, μνήσθητε τῶν ῥημάτων τῶν προειρημένων ὑπὸ τῶν ἀποστόλων τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ· **18** ὅτι ἔλεγον ὑμῖν· Ἐπ’ ἐσχάτου χρόνου ἔσονται ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἑαυτῶν ἐπιθυμίας πορευόμενοι τῶν ἀσεβειῶν.
>
> — Jude 17–18, SBLGNT

> **3:1** Ταύτην ἤδη, ἀγαπητοί, δευτέραν ὑμῖν γράφω ἐπιστολήν, ἐν αἷς διεγείρω ὑμῶν ἐν ὑπομνήσει τὴν εἰλικρινῆ διάνοιαν, **3:2** μνησθῆναι τῶν προειρημένων ῥημάτων ὑπὸ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν καὶ τῆς τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν ἐντολῆς τοῦ κυρίου καὶ σωτῆρος, **3:3** τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες ὅτι ἐλεύσονται ἐπ’ ἐσχάτων τῶν ἡμερῶν ἐν ἐμπαιγμονῇ ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι
>
> — 2 Pet 3:1–3, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **17** But you, beloved, remember what was foretold by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ **18** when they said to you, “In the last times there will be scoffers who will follow after their own ungodly desires.”
2 Peter: **3:1** Beloved, this is now my second letter to you. Both of them are reminders to stir you to wholesome thinking **3:2** by recalling what was foretold by the holy prophets and commanded by our Lord and Savior through your apostles. **3:3** Most importantly, you must understand that in the last days scoffers will come, scoffing and following their own evil desires.

*WEB.* Jude: **17** But you, beloved, remember the words which have been spoken before by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ. **18** They said to you, “In the last time there will be mockers, walking after their own ungodly lusts.”
2 Peter: **3:1** This is now, beloved, the second letter that I have written to you; and in both of them I stir up your sincere mind by reminding you **3:2** that you should remember the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets and the commandment of us, the apostles of the Lord and Savior, **3:3** knowing this first, that in the last days mockers will come, walking after their own lusts

*Observation:* Remembering the apostles’ words; scoffers in the last time/days following their own desires (ἐμπαῖκται; only here in the NT). 2 Peter adds the prophets and specifies mockery of the promise of Christ’s coming.

## Jude 24–25 ‖ 2 Pet 3:17–18

> **24** Τῷ δὲ δυναμένῳ φυλάξαι ὑμᾶς ἀπταίστους καὶ στῆσαι κατενώπιον τῆς δόξης αὐτοῦ ἀμώμους ἐν ἀγαλλιάσει **25** μόνῳ θεῷ σωτῆρι ἡμῶν διὰ Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν δόξα μεγαλωσύνη κράτος καὶ ἐξουσία πρὸ παντὸς τοῦ αἰῶνος καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς πάντας τοὺς αἰῶνας· ἀμήν.
>
> — Jude 24–25, SBLGNT

> **3:17** ὑμεῖς οὖν, ἀγαπητοί, προγινώσκοντες φυλάσσεσθε ἵνα μὴ τῇ τῶν ἀθέσμων πλάνῃ συναπαχθέντες ἐκπέσητε τοῦ ἰδίου στηριγμοῦ, **3:18** αὐξάνετε δὲ ἐν χάριτι καὶ γνώσει τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ σωτῆρος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ. αὐτῷ ἡ δόξα καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς ἡμέραν αἰῶνος. ἀμήν.

> — 2 Pet 3:17–18, SBLGNT

*BSB.* Jude: **24** Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling and to present you unblemished in His glorious presence, with great joy— **25** to the only God our Savior be glory, majesty, dominion, and authority through Jesus Christ our Lord before all time, and now, and for all eternity. Amen.
2 Peter: **3:17** Therefore, beloved, since you already know these things, be on your guard so that you will not be carried away by the error of the lawless and fall from your secure standing. **3:18** But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To Him be the glory both now and to the day of eternity. Amen.

*WEB.* Jude: **24** Now to him who is able to keep them from stumbling, and to present you faultless before the presence of his glory in great joy, **25** to God our Savior, who alone is wise, be glory and majesty, dominion and power, both now and forever. Amen.
2 Peter: **3:17** You therefore, beloved, knowing these things beforehand, beware, lest being carried away with the error of the wicked, you fall from your own steadfastness. **3:18** But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To him be the glory both now and forever. Amen.

*Observation:* Both close with a warning against falling and a doxology. 2 Peter's doxology is addressed to Christ.

## Material in Jude without a parallel in 2 Peter

- The greeting's description of believers as called, loved, and kept (v. 1).
- The exodus example, with the reading Ἰησοῦς, "Jesus," in the critical text (v. 5).
- The story of Michael and the Devil over Moses' body (v. 9).
- Cain and Korah (v. 11).
- Wild waves of the sea and wandering stars (v. 13).
- The quotation from 1 Enoch (vv. 14–15).
- "Grumblers" and flattery (v. 16).
- Those who cause divisions, not having the Spirit (v. 19).
- Building, praying in the Holy Spirit, keeping in God's love (vv. 20–21).
- Mercy for the doubting and rescue from the fire (vv. 22–23).

## Texts Highlighted in This Appendix

Every passage cited or alluded to by reference in this appendix is printed here, original language first: Hebrew or Aramaic from the Westminster Leningrad Codex, Greek from the SBL Greek New Testament (the Septuagint for the Apocrypha), followed by two public-domain English translations, the Berean Standard Bible (BSB) and the World English Bible (WEB). 1 Enoch is given in

R. H. Charles's translation. A long passage already printed in full earlier in the book is linked rather than repeated.

## 2 Peter 1:2, 12

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**2** χάρις ὑμῖν καὶ εἰρήνη πληθυνθείη ἐν ἐπιγνώσει τοῦ θεοῦ καὶ Ἰησοῦ τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν. … **12** Διὸ μελλήσω ἀεὶ ὑμᾶς ὑπομιμνῄσκειν περὶ τούτων, καίπερ εἰδότας καὶ ἐστηριγμένους ἐν τῇ παρούσῃ ἀληθείᾳ.

*English (BSB)*

**2** Grace and peace be multiplied to you through the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord. ... **12** Therefore I will always remind you of these things, even though you know them and are established in the truth you now have.

*English (WEB)*

**2** Grace to you and peace be multiplied in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord, ... **12** Therefore I will not be negligent to remind you of these things, though you know them and are established in the present truth.

## 2 Peter 2:1–4, 6–8, 10–13, 15–18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ἐγένοντο δὲ καὶ ψευδοπροφῆται ἐν τῷ λαῷ, ὡς καὶ ἐν ὑμῖν ἔσονται ψευδοδιδάσκαλοι, οἵτινες παρεισάξουσιν αἱρέσεις ἀπωλείας, καὶ τὸν ἀγοράσαντα αὐτοὺς δεσπότην ἀρνούμενοι, ἐπάγοντες ἑαυτοῖς ταχινὴν ἀπώλειαν· **2** καὶ πολλοὶ ἐξακολουθήσουσιν αὐτῶν ταῖς ἀσελγείαις, δι᾽ οὓς ἡ ὁδὸς τῆς ἀληθείας βλασφημηθήσεται· **3** καὶ ἐν πλεονεξίᾳ πλαστοῖς λόγοις ὑμᾶς ἐμπορεύσονται· οἷς τὸ κρίμα ἔκπαλαι οὐκ ἀργεῖ, καὶ ἡ ἀπώλεια αὐτῶν οὐ νυστάζει. **4** Εἰ γὰρ ὁ θεὸς ἀγγέλων ἁμαρτησάντων οὐκ ἐφείσατο, ἀλλὰ σειραῖς ζόφου ταρταρώσας παρέδωκεν εἰς κρίσιν τηρουμένους, … **6** καὶ πόλεις Σοδόμων καὶ Γομόρρας τεφρώσας καταστροφῇ κατέκρινεν, ὑπόδειγμα μελλόντων ἀσεβέσιν τεθεικώς, **7** καὶ δίκαιον Λὼτ καταπονούμενον ὑπὸ τῆς τῶν ἀθέσμων ἐν ἀσελγείᾳ ἀναστροφῆς ἐρρύσατο— **8** βλέμματι γὰρ καὶ ἀκοῇ ὁ δίκαιος ἐγκατοικῶν ἐν αὐτοῖς ἡμέραν ἐξ ἡμέρας ψυχὴν δικαίαν ἀνόμοις ἔργοις ἐβασάνιζεν— … **10** μάλιστα δὲ τοὺς ὀπίσω σαρκὸς ἐν ἐπιθυμίᾳ μιασμοῦ πορευομένους καὶ κυριότητος καταφρονοῦντας. Τολμηταί, αὐθάδεις, δόξας οὐ τρέμουσιν, βλασφημοῦντες, **11** ὅπου ἄγγελοι ἰσχύϊ καὶ δυνάμει μείζονες ὄντες οὐ φέρουσιν κατ᾽ αὐτῶν βλάσφημον κρίσιν. **12** οὗτοι δέ, ὡς ἄλογα ζῷα γεγεννημένα φυσικὰ εἰς ἅλωσιν καὶ φθοράν, ἐν οἷς ἀγνοοῦσιν βλασφημοῦντες, ἐν τῇ φθορᾷ αὐτῶν καὶ φθαρήσονται, **13** ἀδικούμενοι μισθὸν ἀδικίας· ἡδονὴν ἡγούμενοι τὴν ἐν ἡμέρᾳ τρυφήν, σπίλοι καὶ μῶμοι ἐντρυφῶντες ἐν ταῖς ἀπάταις αὐτῶν συνευωχούμενοι ὑμῖν, … **15** καταλιπόντες εὐθεῖαν ὁδὸν ἐπλανήθησαν, ἐξακολουθήσαντες τῇ ὁδῷ τοῦ Βαλαὰμ τοῦ Βοσὸρ ὃς μισθὸν ἀδικίας ἠγάπησεν **16** ἔλεγξιν δὲ ἔσχεν ἰδίας παρανομίας· ὑποζύγιον ἄφωνον ἐν ἀνθρώπου φωνῇ φθεγξάμενον ἐκώλυσεν τὴν τοῦ προφήτου παραφρονίαν. **17** Οὗτοί εἰσιν πηγαὶ ἄνυδροι καὶ ὁμίχλαι ὑπὸ λαίλαπος ἐλαυνόμεναι, οἷς ὁ ζόφος τοῦ σκότους τετήρηται. **18**

ὑπέρογκα γὰρ ματαιότητος φθεγγόμενοι δελεάζουσιν ἐν ἐπιθυμίαις σαρκὸς ἀσελγείαις τοὺς ὀλίγως ἀποφεύγοντας τοὺς ἐν πλάνῃ ἀναστρεφομένους,

*English (BSB)*

**1** Now there were also false prophets among the people, just as there will be false teachers among you. They will secretly introduce destructive heresies, even denying the Master who bought them—bringing swift destruction on themselves. **2** Many will follow in their depravity, and because of them the way of truth will be defamed. **3** In their greed, these false teachers will exploit you with deceptive words. The longstanding verdict against them remains in force, and their destruction does not sleep. **4** For if God did not spare the angels when they sinned, but cast them deep into hell, placing them in chains of darkness to be held for judgment; … **6** if He condemned the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah to destruction, reducing them to ashes as an example of what is coming on the ungodly; **7** and if He rescued Lot, a righteous man distressed by the depraved conduct of the lawless **8** (for that righteous man, living among them day after day, was tormented in his righteous soul by the lawless deeds he saw and heard)— … **10** Such punishment is specially reserved for those who indulge the corrupt desires of the flesh and despise authority. Bold and self-willed, they are unafraid to slander glorious beings. **11** Yet not even angels, though greater in strength and power, dare to bring such slanderous charges against them before the Lord. **12** These men are like irrational animals, creatures of instinct, born to be captured and destroyed. They blaspheme in matters they do not understand, and like such creatures, they too will be destroyed. **13** The harm they will suffer is the wages of their wickedness. They consider it a pleasure to carouse in broad daylight. They are blots and blemishes, reveling in their deception as they feast with you. … **15** They have left the straight way and wandered off to follow the way of Balaam son of Beor, who loved the wages of wickedness. **16** But he was rebuked for his transgression by a donkey, otherwise without speech, that spoke with a man’s voice and restrained the prophet’s madness. **17** These men are springs without water and mists driven by a storm. Blackest darkness is reserved for them. **18** With lofty but empty words, they appeal to the sensual passions of the flesh and entice those who are just escaping from others who live in error.

*English (WEB)*

**1** But false prophets also arose among the people, as false teachers will also be among you, who will secretly bring in destructive heresies, denying even the Master who bought them, bringing on themselves swift destruction. **2** Many will follow their immoral ways, and as a result, the way of the truth will be maligned. **3** In covetousness they will exploit you with deceptive words: whose sentence now from of old doesn’t linger, and their destruction will not slumber. **4** For if God didn’t spare angels when they sinned, but cast them down to Tartarus, and committed them to pits of darkness to be reserved for

judgment; … **6** and turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah into ashes, condemned them to destruction, having made them an example to those who would live in an ungodly way, **7** and delivered righteous Lot, who was very distressed by the lustful life of the wicked **8** (for that righteous man dwelling among them was tormented in his righteous soul from day to day with seeing and hearing lawless deeds), … **10** but chiefly those who walk after the flesh in the lust of defilement and despise authority. Daring, self-willed, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignitaries, **11** whereas angels, though greater in might and power, don't bring a slanderous judgment against them before the Lord. **12** But these, as unreasoning creatures, born natural animals to be taken and destroyed, speaking evil in matters about which they are ignorant, will in their destroying surely be destroyed, **13** receiving the wages of unrighteousness; people who count it pleasure to revel in the daytime, spots and defects, reveling in their deceit while they feast with you; … **15** Forsaking the right way, they went astray, having followed the way of Balaam the son of Beor, who loved the wages of wrongdoing; **16** but he was rebuked for his own disobedience. A speechless donkey spoke with a man's voice and stopped the madness of the prophet. **17** These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever. **18** For, uttering great swelling words of emptiness, they entice in the lusts of the flesh, by licentiousness, those who are indeed escaping from those who live in error;

## 2 Peter 3:1–3, 17–18

*Greek (SBLGNT)*

**1** Ταύτην ἤδη, ἀγαπητοί, δευτέραν ὑμῖν γράφω ἐπιστολήν, ἐν αἷς διεγείρω ὑμῶν ἐν ὑπομνήσει τὴν εἰλικρινῆ διάνοιαν, **2** μνησθῆναι τῶν προειρημένων ῥημάτων ὑπὸ τῶν ἁγίων προφητῶν καὶ τῆς τῶν ἀποστόλων ὑμῶν ἐντολῆς τοῦ κυρίου καὶ σωτῆρος, **3** τοῦτο πρῶτον γινώσκοντες ὅτι ἐλεύσονται ἐπ' ἐσχάτων τῶν ἡμερῶν ἐν ἐμπαιγμονῇ ἐμπαῖκται κατὰ τὰς ἰδίας ἐπιθυμίας αὐτῶν πορευόμενοι … **17** ὑμεῖς οὖν, ἀγαπητοί, προγινώσκοντες φυλάσσεσθε ἵνα μὴ τῇ τῶν ἀθέσμων πλάνῃ συναπαχθέντες ἐκπέσητε τοῦ ἰδίου στηριγμοῦ, **18** αὐξάνετε δὲ ἐν χάριτι καὶ γνώσει τοῦ κυρίου ἡμῶν καὶ σωτῆρος Ἰησοῦ Χριστοῦ. αὐτῷ ἡ δόξα καὶ νῦν καὶ εἰς ἡμέραν αἰῶνος. ἀμήν.

*English (BSB)*

**1** Beloved, this is now my second letter to you. Both of them are reminders to stir you to wholesome thinking **2** by recalling what was foretold by the holy prophets and commanded by our Lord and Savior through your apostles. **3** Most importantly, you must understand that in the last days scoffers will come, scoffing and following their own evil desires. … **17** Therefore, beloved, since you already know these things, be on your guard so that you will not be carried away by the error of the lawless and fall from your secure standing. **18** But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To Him be the glory both now and to the day of eternity. Amen.

*English (WEB)*

**1** This is now, beloved, the second letter that I have written to you; and in both of them I stir up your sincere mind by reminding you **2** that you should remember the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets and the commandment of us, the apostles of the Lord and Savior, **3** knowing this first, that in the last days mockers will come, walking after their own lusts … **17** You therefore, beloved, knowing these things beforehand, beware, lest being carried away with the error of the wicked, you fall from your own steadfastness. **18** But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To him be the glory both now and forever. Amen.

# Glossary of Greek and Theological Terms

Greek words are listed by transliteration, with the Greek form and the verse in Jude where it appears. Lexical summaries draw on Abbott-Smith's *Manual Greek Lexicon of the New Testament* (1922) unless noted.

## Greek words

**agapē** (ἀγάπη), vv. 2, 12, 21. "Love." In the plural (v. 12), "love feasts," the community's shared meals. See Chapter 6.

**agapētoi** (ἀγαπητοί), vv. 3, 17, 20. "Beloved," Jude's address to his readers.

**agalliasis** (ἀγαλλίασις), v. 24. "Exultation, exuberant joy."

**akarpos** (ἄκαρπος), v. 12. "Fruitless."

**alogos** (ἄλογος), v. 10. "Without reason"; τὰ ἄλογα ζῷα, "irrational animals."

**amōmos** (ἄμωμος), v. 24. "Without blemish," used of sacrificial animals, and morally "faultless."

**antilogia** (ἀντιλογία), v. 11. "Contradiction, dispute, rebellion." In the LXX it is used for the "water of contention" (Meribah).

**anydros** (ἄνυδρος), v. 12. "Waterless."

**aphobōs** (ἀφόβως), v. 12. "Without fear," here meaning without reverence.

**apodiorizō** (ἀποδιορίζω), v. 19. "To mark off; to make divisions." NT hapax.

**aptaistos** (ἄπταιστος), v. 24. "Without stumbling, sure-footed." NT hapax.

**archangelos** (ἀρχάγγελος), v. 9. "Archangel, chief messenger" (LSV). Used of Michael.

**archē** (ἀρχή), v. 6. "Beginning; rule, domain." The angels' assigned position (LSV "principality").

**asebēs, asebeia, asebeō** (ἀσεβής, ἀσέβεια, ἀσεβέω), vv. 4, 15, 18. "Impious/ungodly," "impiety," "to act impiously." Jude's key description of the intruders.

**aselgeia** (ἀσέλγεια), v. 4. "Licentiousness, shameless excess."

**atheteō** (ἀθετέω), v. 8. "To set aside, reject."

**aidios** (ἀΐδιος), v. 6. “Everlasting.”

**aiōn, aiōnios** (αἰών, αἰώνιος), vv. 7, 13, 21, 25. “Age” and “age-long, eternal.” The LSV renders αἰώνιος “continuous.”

**blasphēmeō, blasphēmia** (βλασφημέω, βλασφημία), vv. 8–10. “To slander, revile”; “slander.” Used of abusive speech against anyone, not only against God.

**deigma** (δεῖγμα), v. 7. “A specimen, example (as a warning).” NT hapax.

**despotēs** (δεσπότης), v. 4. “Master, owner, sovereign.” Used of Jesus.

**diabolos** (διάβολος), v. 9. “Slanderer, accuser; the Devil.”

**diakrinomai** (διακρίνομαι), vv. 9, 22. ‘To dispute’ (v. 9) or ‘to doubt, waver’ (v. 22).

**dikē** (δίκη), v. 7. “Justice; the penalty carried out.”

**doulos** (δοῦλος), v. 1. “Slave, servant.” Also an honorific (“servant of the LORD”).

**doxa, doxai** (δόξα, δόξαι), vv. 8, 24, 25. “Glory”; in the plural (v. 8), “glorious ones,” that is, angels.

**ekporneuō** (ἐκπορνεύω), v. 7. “To give oneself up to sexual immorality.” NT hapax.

**ekrizoō** (ἐκριζόω), v. 12. “To uproot.”

**eleos, eleaō** (ἔλεος, ἐλεάω), vv. 2, 21, 22, 23. “Mercy”; “to show mercy.” In the LXX ἔλεος chiefly translates Hebrew *ḥesed*.

**elenchō** (ἐλέγχω), v. 15. “To expose, convict.”

**empaiktēs** (ἐμπαίκτης), v. 18. “Scoffer, mocker.” In the NT only here and 2 Pet 3:3.

**enypniazomai** (ἐνυπνιάζομαι), v. 8. “To dream.” In the LXX, used of the false prophet as “dreamer” (Deut 13).

**epagōnizomai** (ἐπαγωνίζομαι), v. 3. “To contend for.” NT hapax.

**epaphrizō** (ἐπαφρίζω), v. 13. “To foam up.” NT hapax.

**epithymia** (ἐπιθυμία), vv. 16, 18. “Desire, craving.”

**epoikodomeō** (ἐποικοδομέω), v. 20. “To build upon.”

**gongystēs** (γογγυστής), v. 16. “Grumbler, murmurer.” NT hapax.

**hagioi** (ἅγιοι), vv. 3, 14. “Holy ones”: God’s people (v. 3) or angels (v. 14).

**hagiōtatos** (ἁγιώτατος), v. 20. “Most holy.” The only superlative of ἅγιος in the NT.

**hapax** (ἅπαξ), vv. 3, 5. “Once, once for all.”

**harpazō** (ἁρπάζω), v. 23. “To seize, snatch.”

**hyperonkos** (ὑπέρογκος), v. 16. “Swollen, excessive; arrogant (of speech).”

**hypechō** (ὑπέχω), v. 7. “To undergo, suffer (a penalty).” NT hapax.

**katenōpion** (κατενώπιον), v. 24. “Before, in the presence of.”

**klētos** (κλητός), v. 1. “Called.”

**koinos** (κοινός), v. 3. “Common, shared.”

**kratos** (κράτος), v. 25. “Power, dominion.” Common in doxologies.

**kyriotēs** (κυριότης), v. 8. “Lordship, dominion.”

**megalōsynē** (μεγαλωσύνη), v. 25. “Greatness, majesty.”

**mempsimoiros** (μεμψίμοιρος), v. 16. “Complaining of one’s lot, querulous.” NT hapax.

**metatithēmi** (μετατίθημι), v. 4. “To change, transfer; to turn one thing into a pretext for another.”

**miainō** (μιαίνω), v. 8. “To defile.”

**oikētērion** (οἰκητήριον), v. 6. “Dwelling, habitation.”

**ouai** (οὐαί), v. 11. “Woe!” The prophetic announcement of judgment.

**paradidōmi** (παραδίδωμι), v. 3. “To hand over, deliver.” The technical term for passing on tradition.

**parapherō** (παραφέρω), v. 12. “To carry away.”

**pareisdyō** (παρεισδύω), v. 4. “To slip in secretly.” NT hapax.

**phthinopōrinos** (φθινοπωρινός), v. 12. “Of late autumn.” NT hapax.

**phylassō** (φυλάσσω), v. 24. “To guard, protect.” Near synonym of τηρέω.

**physikōs** (φυσικῶς), v. 10. “Naturally, by instinct.” NT hapax.

**planē** (πλάνη), v. 11. “Error, deception, wandering.”

**planētēs** (πλανήτης), v. 13. “Wanderer”; ἀστέρες πλανῆται, “wandering stars.” The source of English “planet.” NT hapax.

**plēthynō** (πληθύνω), v. 2. “To multiply.” πληθυνθείη: “may it be multiplied” (optative).

**poimainō** (ποιμαίνω), v. 12. “To shepherd, tend.”

**prographō** (προγράφω), v. 4. “To write beforehand.”

**psychikos** (ψυχικός), v. 19. “Natural, soulish, unspiritual.”

**sklēros** (σκληρός), v. 15. “Hard, harsh”; “harsh words.”

**sōtēr** (σωτήρ), v. 25. “Savior.” A title also given to kings and emperors in the Greco-Roman world.

**spilas** (σπιλάς), v. 12. “Reef, rock in the sea”; in later Greek, “stain.” NT hapax. See Chapter 6.

**spiloō** (σπιλόω), v. 23. “To stain, defile.”

**syneuōcheomai** (συνευωχέομαι), v. 12. “To feast together.” In the NT only here and 2 Pet 2:13.

**tēreō** (τηρέω), vv. 1, 6, 13, 21. “To keep, guard, preserve.” Jude’s key word.

**zophos** (ζόφος), vv. 6, 13. “Deep gloom,” associated with the underworld.

## Grammatical and theological terms

**Aorist.** A Greek verb form that presents an action as a whole, without reference to its duration.

**Canon.** The list of books a community recognizes as Scripture.

**Critical text.** A Greek text reconstructed by editors from the manuscripts in order to approximate the earliest recoverable text (for example, NA28, SBLGNT).

**Byzantine text / Majority Text.** The form of the Greek text found in the majority of (mostly later) manuscripts, edited by Robinson and Pierpont among others.

**Doxology.** A formula ascribing glory to God.

**Etymological fallacy.** The mistake of assuming that a word’s origin or component parts determine its meaning in use.

**Hapax legomenon** (plural *hapax legomena*). A word that occurs only once in a given body of literature, here the New Testament.

**LXX (Septuagint).** The Greek translation of the Hebrew scriptures, used widely by Greek-speaking Jews and early Christians.

**Optative.** A Greek verb mood used for wishes and prayers. It is rare in the New Testament.

**Participle.** A verbal adjective ("having been loved," "praying").

**Perfect tense.** A Greek tense presenting a completed action with continuing results.

**Pre-existence (of Christ).** The belief that the Son existed before his human birth.

**Prophetic aorist.** The use of a past tense to describe a future event as certain.

**Pseudepigrapha.** Ancient Jewish (and Christian) writings attributed to biblical figures, such as 1 Enoch and the *Testament of Moses*.

**Pseudonymity.** Writing under another person's name.

**Second Temple Judaism.** Judaism from the rebuilding of the temple (late sixth century BC) to its destruction in AD 70.

**Targum.** An Aramaic translation and paraphrase of the Hebrew scriptures.

**Textus Receptus (TR).** The printed Greek text of the Reformation era, which underlies Tyndale, the Geneva Bible, and their successors.

**Theophany.** An appearance of God.

**Type / typology.** A person or event in Scripture understood as a pattern of later persons or events.

**Watchers.** In 1 Enoch, the angels who descended to earth and took human wives (Gen 6:1–4).

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**wilderness generation**: Hist. Intro, **Ch. 3**, Ch. 5, Ch. 9, Ch. 13
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**Zechariah 3**: Hist. Intro, **Ch. 4**, Ch. 12

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